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I.I Worldviews

Metaphysical mutations — that is to say radical, global transformations in the values to which the majority subscribe — are rare in the history of humanity. The rise of Christianity might be cited as an example. Once a metaphysical mutation has arisen, it tends to move inexorably toward its logical conclusion. Heedlessly, it sweeps away economic and political systems, aesthetic judgments and social hierarchies. No human agency can halt its progress — nothing except another metaphysical mutation. It is a fallacy that such metaphysical mutations gain ground only in weakened or declining societies. When Christianity appeared, the Roman Empire was at the height of its powers: supremely organized, it dominated the known world; its technological and military prowess had no rival. Nevertheless, it had no chance. When modern science appeared, medieval Christianity was a complete, comprehensive system which explained both man and the universe; it was the basis for government, the inspiration for knowledge and art, the arbiter of war as of peace and the power behind the produc-

tion and distribution or wealth — none of which was sufficient to prevent its downfall.

MICHEL HOUELLEBECQ, *Elementary Particles*

What Mr. Houellebecq does not mention is that we are in the process of another “metaphysical mutation”: the post-modern globalist worldview. The process whereby one worldview is overtaken by another is unclear. In an earlier post (Evola on Christianity in Europe¹), Julius Evola attributed the rise of Christianity during the Roman Empire to a “miracle”. One can idly hope for another miracle or else participate in the process of restoring a Traditional worldview.

Addendum 2020 Perhaps Houellebecq addressed the issue in *Submission*².

The Miracle that Evola referred to was Constantine³’s vision of Christ before his big battle.

The futility of the human race to control events is the reason for a miracle, not a catastrophe as some desire. So what do you do while you are waiting?

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LL2DzqrUNQc>

Posted on 2008-04-14 by Cologero

* * *

Michael on 2020-04-15 at 10:22 said:

“The futility of the human race to control events is the reason for a miracle, not a catastrophe as some desire. So what do you do while you are waiting?”

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=27>

²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=8417>

³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=11425>

Waiting for that, we work on ourselves according to what is given to us, but in that process we start to see more. While the human race's attempts to control events is futile, history is directed through conscious agents. So while we wait, we learn about the forces, agents, and our place among it all? Perhaps then we remember what we were supposed to do.

1.2 Descarte's Nightmare

The battle differentiates, selects, creates hierarchy; especially when – to use the traditional terms – it is not the lesser battle, but the greater battle; not the battle of man against man, or against the world, but the battle of the supernatural element of man against everything in him that is nature, sensation, materiality, ferment, delusion of grandeur; against the chaos that is within him, before it is outside him.

JULIUS EVOLA

The rule and criterion of truth is to have made it. Hence the clear and distinct idea of the mind not only cannot be the criterion of other truths, but it cannot be the criterion of that of the mind itself; for while the mind apprehends itself, it does not make itself, and because it does not make itself it is ignorant of the form or mode by which it apprehends itself.

GIAMBATTISTA VICO (commenting on Descartes)

The fundamental difference between the traditional and modern world views is the knowledge of a spiritual level of reality that transcends our ordinary experience. This spiritual level is the source of all manifestation and is known, not through empirical evidence or a process of reasoning, but rather through a direct “knowing”, called Intuition or gnosis. This gnosis is not irrational, but is supra-rational, that is, above reason, though not contrary to reason.

The traditional teaching is that man is a tripartite being, that is, a Unity of Spirit, soul, and body. These states of being are hierarchically arranged, with the lower state subordinated to the higher states.

The modernist denies the existence of a spiritual state of being, and thus, of any knowledge that transcends the senses or the reasoning faculty. Science ignores it completely by its very methodology, and regards any claim to the contrary as delusional. The major exoteric religions accept the existence of the spiritual realm, but insist it can be known only by faith, with a caste of priests or ministers keeping guard over it.

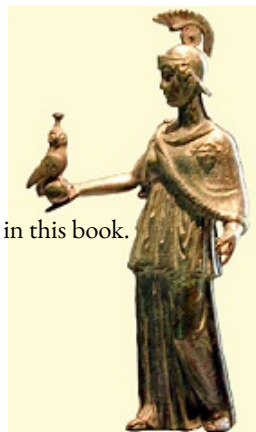
Now, the difference between the Traditional and modern world view must not be understood in a temporal sense, but rather ontologically. “Tradition” indicates a transcendental source that impinges on the empirical at every time and place. “Modern” indicates the denial of such transcendence, viewing the empirical as self-contained. Thus, the Traditional and modern world views are independent of time and place, and have always been with us, with one predominating over the other. Other times, these two spirits are found battling each other for influence.⁴

Posted on 2010-03-14 by Cologero

1.3 The Owl of Minerva

The owl of Minerva flies at dusk.

Seeing in the Dark This proverb from Hegel means that philosophy can only understand a cycle at its end. Hence, it is not helpful at its beginning, so anyone who is now engaged in the “battle of ideas” can hope for little more than a pyrrhic victory at best. Rather, it is a struggle of



⁴For the remainder of the essay, please go to Chapter 17 in this book.

visions or world views. Pace Hegel, the Owl of Minerva is not a philosopher. The owl is wise not because he can think but rather because he can see in the darkness. While the world sleeps, the owl is vigilant at night. Thus, the men of Tradition must also be vigilant during the darkness.

At the beginning of a cycle, there is no need for philosophy. Man lives in immediacy following his Tradition faithfully and there is no need for questioning, and no need for wonder which is the motivation for philosophy. Unperturbed by the conflicts of competing thoughts, he lived with certainty. When an issue arose, he didn't think about it. Rather he followed the Tradition of his ancestors and his gods without question. His moral code was duty to the city, family, and gods. This code prescribed all his actions, which had to be executed precisely, and there was no room for subtleties. These rites maintained the souls of his ancestors and brought their blessings; he expected his sons to do the same for him after his death. These civilizations lived in relative internal harmony, sometimes for millennia.

Only with the decline of a cycle does thought arise. The corrosive effect of discursive thought calls everything into question. It no longer suffices to follow the ancestors and gods, one must also give a reason for doing so. Those skilled at logical and creative thinking become the philosophers. They offer their services to men in search of understanding. Others, such as the Sophists, notice that thought is an end in itself and can be used for persuasion apart from its actual truth value. The Sophists are the first propagandists and sell their services.

Three Civilizations

...bisogna tener ben fermo questo punto, indispensabile per una formulazione imperiale e romana dell'idea razzista e confermato

da ciò che fu proprio alle grandi civiltà arie d'Oriente, all'antica Roma, al Medioevo romano-germanico.

We are focusing on the civilizations of the Borean race, as Fabre d'Olivet called it, who origins were in the mythical Hyperborea, whence it spread to India, Central Asia and Europe. There is not the time or energy to deal with the traditions of Asia, Africa, or the Amerindians. Furthermore, we have been focusing on just three Borean civilizations of a traditional nature, omitting the Nordic and Celtic traditions which are no less important. But since Julius Evola identified them as the three main civilizations of Indo-European origin, they serve as a good basis for discussion.

Hyperborea We can get a glimpse into these people only through extrapolation. By the interpretation of myths we can try to reconstruct their society. For this, we are relying on **Bal Tilak**, **Fabre d'Olivet** and **Herman Wirth**.

Bharat Khant Bharat Khant was the ancient name for the Vedic civilization of India. This is the oldest group that we have documentation for, which includes the Vedas and the Laws of Manu. It is most important for us today because of its rich metaphysical tradition which comprise the six orthodox schools, all deriving from the Vedas. This should not uncritically be confounded with the contemporary religion of Hinduism. Unlike Hinduism, the Vedic civilization included ancestor worship, animal sacrifice and rejection of reincarnation.

The Ancient City By this, we mean the ancient city-states of Greece and Italy. Although their origins are obscure, their traditions and eventual decline are reasonably well documented. That makes their study invaluable to those of use seeking the light hidden by the darkness.

Christendom Instead of circumlocutions such as “Medieval period” and the like, we will use this term to describe the civilization that arose in Europe following the fall of Rome, without intending by that term to impose a particular theological interpretation on it. To put a time frame on it, we mean the approximate thousand year reign from Constantine to the Reformation, which united spiritually much of Europe. We will see that it had its declines that mimicked the decline of the Ancient City, at least in principle if not in detail. But here we have the added advantage that its origins are also documented. Thus, we can see what it adapted from its predecessor and what it rejected. This will serve as a useful model for a new cycle.

Three Types of Men Each period was marked by a special type of man who embodied its superior aspects. These were never theoretical men, or those with the “best idea”, but men of a higher knowledge, a direct knowing or gnosis that can never be fully encompassed in thought. The knowing took various forms.

The Seer The type of the Vedic period was the **Rishi** and the **Yogi**. The Rishi, or seer, had clairvoyant vision to see into the nature or essence of things beyond the accidental, incidental, or the trivial. The Yogi was the man of power: for bhakti yoga, power over the emotions; for karma yoga, power over one’s actions; for jnana yoga, power over one’s mind. The jnani, or knower, was master of his mind. By transcending the stream of thoughts, which held no more significance to him than the movement of clouds across the sky, the jnani gained direct insight into the nature of things.

The Hero The Hero of the Ancient City was the **Hero**, the patriarch of a family, the founder of the city. As priest, he was the link between the gods and men and had the power to invoke their blessings. As

king, he had the power of command over men. He had the power to interpret the omens, because in order to predict the future, he had to create the future.

The Believer Christendom began where the Ancient City left off, in particular, it separated the roles of priest and king, without, however, secularizing the latter as had been done in the successive revolutions of the previous era. This leads to two different figures, united in faith, although different in temperament. These are the Saint and the Knight. Rather than seeking godhood by means of the rituals and sacrifices of their sons as in the age of heroes, they relied on their respective devotions to the True God and the True Man. The **Saint** through his ascetical practices was drawn toward theosis (divinization). The **Knight** of heroic valor followed the path of the Fedeli d'Amore to lead to the alchemical marriage.

The Way Forward

Io ho difeso e difendo idee ... nella misura in cui riprendono una tradizione superiore e anteriore ... in quanto appartengono al retaggio della carattere universale e mantenutasi in Europa fino all'Rivoluzione francese. Nello stesso spirito ... dei grandi filosofi cattolici del principio di autorità, de Maistre e Donoso Cortes ... I miei principi sono solo quelli che prima della Rivoluzione francese ogni persona ben nata considerava sani e normali.

The way forward is indicated by Evola as quoted above: to defend the higher traditions of Europe that every well born person considered sane and normal. We need not look back to the distant past, just to Europe before 1789 since these principles have a universal character. To reject these principles, as those of the new right seem to do, is to squander our legacy and dishonor our ancestors. If anyone is unclear about those

principles, please read Donoso Cortes' essays⁵, as Evola recommends.

The way forward is based on authority as illustrated by our examples. In future posts we will lay out some programs described by **Fabre d'Olivet** and **Saint-Yves d'Alveydre** based on theocracy, Synarchy and the spiritual unity of Europe. But ultimately, it will depend on men of vision, seers, heroes, and those of unshakable faith.

Posted on 2011-06-30 by Cologero

1.4 The New Intellectual

Noli foras ire, in te ipsum redi: in interiore hominis habitat veritas.

Don't go outside yourself, turn back into yourself; the truth resides in the interior of man.

ST. AUGUSTINE

The following passage is taken from **Ultima Thule** by Arthur Branwen⁶, where he is describing the beginning of Evola's interest in prehistory. [My translation.]

The central idea of this Evolian study, that along with other of his writing of that time shows the guiding influences of a new cultural perspective different from his earlier interests, was that in Germany of those years, there was emerging a type of culture intended to promote a spiritual and political rebirth that takes as its starting point the study of the most archaic roots of the German, and European, people. A culture that does not stop at

⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf>

⁶<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/UltimaThule.pdf>

pure erudition and tends instead to create a *forma mentis*, a reflection of a new state of mind tending to abandon the Spenglerian *Decline of the West*, not assimilable in any way to the various sciences of antiquity studied in an “antiseptic” manner in the universities which, on the other hand, in themselves do not demand any interior change and do not change in any way the relationship between man and the world.

In other words, one cannot hope to understand these ancient myths without oneself becoming spiritually like the people who created those myths. One has to know the way they thought and felt, that is, their *forma mentis*. Man cannot be studied from the outside as though he is nothing but a chemical reaction.

Posted on 2010-06-30 by Aeneas

* * *

Robman on 2010-07-01 at 10:21 said:

This nordicist stuff just seems like the flip side of afro-centrism.

Cologero on 2010-07-01 at 12:15 said:

I have no idea what afro-centrism is, nor what its “flip side” is. Doesn’t sound like much of an argument.

Bear in mind, we are not here defending any particular position. Just describing the theories and motivations for them from a particular era.

Nevertheless, we do accept the idea of a Primordial Tradition, so it is a legitimate question to discern its nature and origins. Wirth and Evola used myths, sagas, legends to try to answer that question. So, it is really the methodology we are dealing with, and its suitability for the subject matter – not a particular conclusion.

Robman on 2010-07-01 at 12:46 said:

“Flip side” means reversal of, and afro-centrism is an movement by black “scholars” in America who claim that blacks were the font of all culture, religion, and civilization. This “primordial tradition” traditionalists like Guenon and Evola are fond of seems to be based on the

argument there is a single metaphysic, and somehow they postulate that it must also have originated terrestrially in one place and then been dispersed through migrations. I don't believe the preponderance of historical and archaeological evidence bears this out, but of course then the counter-argument would be that that's because I'm a positivist rationalist who is limited in his scope. Yet I don't think the tenuous symbolism and legends the traditionalists use to buttress their argument are persuasive or point to any metaphysically super sophisticated nordic culture at the north pole either.

Matt on 2010-07-01 at 15:36 said:

Robman,

Keep in mind that a significant amount of what Guenon and Evola talk about in their writings on the primordial tradition is meta-history. To them, the metaphysics that you speak of did not have a terrestrial origin.

And although I'm not sure about Guenon, but Evola never believed all the human races and civilizations have a single origin (though if a lot of that is incorrect due to mistranslation of Italian or lack thereof, Cologero should not feel wrong to make the correction if I have made a mistake). He postulated that the indo-europeans and a few other races have a common origin (whether of a physical or non-physical nature), but they don't share a common origin with what he referred to as the southern races. From what it appears to me, Afro-centrists believe all races and civilizations have the same origin in the African race.

Robman on 2010-07-01 at 16:51 said:

Matt,

It seems to me that while they argue that the metaphysic is of a transcendent super-human order, if was nordic polar inhabitants who first gleaned it and then disseminated it south during their migrations. Otherwise, why else would Evola have been influenced by Wirth and decided that the primordial tradition was ultimately Nordic as opposed to mediterranean? Their view seems to have something of the hermetic "as above, so below", insofar as terrestrial history should reflect meta-history.

But even if it is as you say it is, only a meta-history, then what is it we have here? Just another creation myth of a religious character?

As to human origins, they never seem to have clarified this point that I'm aware of. I know they reject evolution and hold that everything has devolved from a primordial golden age, including man himself, but what does this mean? How did man come to be then? Did he materialize into human biological form from spirit as theosophists claim?

Cologero on 2010-07-01 at 18:53 said:

If you deny a single metaphysic, then you deny the possibility of knowing. The “flip side” of positivist rationalism is that there is no possibility of knowing the truth; just a never-ending series of scientific postulates always in danger of being overthrown. As to the question of origins, science has shown itself to be noticeably inept, in particular, of explaining the origin of the universe, life, and thought. Yet we experience the world around us, our life, and our thinking. You can leave the question there, in the vain expectation that a future scientist will explain it all someday. Or you could be, like a very small group of men, driven to discover a more incisive methodology that can lead to an understanding of the answers to such questions.

So it is not unfair to claim that the positivist rationalist is limited in his scope, since he himself denies the possibility of transcending that limit, whereas the metaphysician does not. It's your life and your choice (assuming you accept the possibility of “choice”). Live it the way you prefer.

Cologero on 2010-07-01 at 18:56 said:

Yes, leaving out the details, that is more or less Evola's position. There is a book published about 100 years ago by an educated Hindu titled, “The Arctic Home of the Vedas”, which brought much evidence to the same thesis. It has not been disproven, as much as neglected, since such a view is now regarded as “politically incorrect”.

Cologero on 2010-07-01 at 19:06 said:

As the article pointed out, the questions you ask cannot be answered in a satisfactory way to a positivist rationalist; it requires a change of consciousness. As a starting point, ask yourself the following questions:

- 1) How did you come into existence? Not just as a body, but as “Robman” with a sense of identity and will.
- 2) When did you first become aware of yourself as an “I”, a separate being from your social milieu.
- 3) How do you accomplish anything? For example, dinner tonight. Did you plan it, think about it, envision it? Then did you act on it, perhaps by shopping, cooking, or eating out? How exactly does an idea in your mind – or spirit, English hides the equivalence of the two words – materialize itself into physical form?

Will on 2010-07-01 at 19:12 said:

Part of the importance of myth is its function as ‘neuro-linguistic programming.’ As Cologero wrote, “one cannot hope to understand these ancient myths without oneself becoming spiritually like the people who created those myths.”

To some extent, whether or not a myth is literally or historically true is of secondary importance. Or rather, the literal is only one level of meaning in myth, and a rather superficial

one at that. When we are young, we believe the stories about heroes and gods to be literally true. Then we get older and more skeptical, and we doubt that these things could have actually happened. But if we persist in engaging myth, deeper levels of meaning begin to open up, such as the principles or ideals that myths can express.

So I'm not particularly concerned with whether or not human beings came from the North, or from Africa. Each is a myth that serves a particular function for particular people. I think Robman's observation about Afrocentrism and Nordicism has some truth to it. But I don't think this poses a problem. I sympathize with Afrocentrism to the degree that it can create ennobling myths for people of African descent. All peoples benefit from such myths – it gives you something to live up to.

These days, we're all supposed to believe that we are the chance mutations of monkeys. That's not very ennobling. Indeed, it tends to give people license to give in to their lesser natures – after all, we're just mammals with 'selfish genes.' Maybe in the future human beings will figure out a way to make this mythos work for us. But as for now, we seem to be stuck in the "world where God is dead" that Nietzsche and Evola wrote about.

Cologero on 2010-07-01 at 22:08 said:

You cannot compare the *use* of myth to come to a spiritual understanding with the artificial creation of a myth, or better said, "noble lie"; they are of a totally different and incomparable order.

The fundamental reason, as we have endeavored to make crystal clear, is that this spiritual understanding is available only to the few; in particular, only for those few willing to undergo the spiritual transformation necessary for such an understanding. This is quite different from "noble lies" intended to influence the masses.

Will on 2010-07-01 at 22:56 said:

There is a story from the Buddhist tradition in which a man is traveling to India. His mother, a very devout Buddhist, learns of this and makes her son promise to bring her back some sort of relic or holy object from the land of the Buddha's birth. The son promises, but in the course of his travels, forgets to get anything. So on the way back, he sees the corpse of a dog laying in the street, and he pulls a tooth from it. He tells his mother that he has brought her one of the teeth of the Buddha. She believes him and venerates the tooth as a sacred object. Through her faith and devotion, she generates real merit and ultimately becomes enlightened.

In this story, the distinction between a noble lie and an authentic myth is blurred. It suggests that what one brings to one's spiritual practice – one's general disposition and intention – is, if not the most important factor, then at least a very important one.

This is not to say that we cannot distinguish between authentic, traditional myths and modern counterfeits (like that book *The Shack*, for example). But I think we have to keep in

mind that what works for one person will not necessarily work for another.

This relates to Burckhardt's exposition of the relation between knowledge and will. If one is fortunate enough to encounter good doctrine, including good myths, then presumably this can expedite one's spiritual growth. But if one is not so fortunate, and is born into some strange cult or without access to good teachers, one can still progress if one's intention is pure.

I have to take issue with your statement that spiritual understanding is available only to a few. While I certainly agree that only a few achieve profound realization, all traditional doctrines state that what is realized is in fact common to all. Even Evola acknowledged this, and they don't come much more anti-egalitarian than him.

Robman on 2010-07-02 at 01:33 said:

Having to choose between a potentially spiritually transforming "noble lie" and the existential quandary rationalism leaves one in is an unsettling one to have to make, but personally, it would probably be my nature to choose the latter. I'm asking myself what would be the purpose of traditional metaphysics? For one to reintegrate himself with metaphysical reality? If so, how does a "noble lie" of a nordic polar realm, if it were only a fiction, help achieve this transformation?

Will on 2010-07-02 at 10:28 said:

Robman, I appreciate your question and your perspective. In my opinion, rationalism and "noble lies" relate to what the Buddhist tradition calls nihilism and eternalism – the two extremes. Nihilism says that nothing means anything and we can't know anything, and eternalism vests everything with some kind of grand meaning. The right view is said to be neither of these.

Corresponding to these are extreme skepticism on the one hand, and extreme naivete or gullibility on the other. If we veer too far in either direction, our view becomes skewed. I've met plenty of new agers who are willing to believe anything that sounds vaguely 'spiritual', so long as it makes them feel good in the moment. That would be naivete. I've also met skeptical, 'scientific' people who refuse to consider anything at all beyond a reductionist, materialist worldview.

The notion of a Nordic polar realm is related to the myth of the Golden Age. The Tibetans believe that the Kingdom of Shambhala exists either on this earth in a 'hidden land' or in another dimension. Christians believe that the Garden of Eden still exists, but entrance is barred. I think these myths convey the notion that the divine is real and knowable and realizable, but I'm not entirely sure how important it is to 'believe' in such things, particularly if one is more skeptically inclined. Perhaps other writers will have more to say on that. There are styles of meditation and practice that work with skepticism and the analytical qualities of the mind, such as the Madyamaka tradition in Buddhism. (That's the tradition I've studied the most, so sorry if my examples keep coming from there.) I think this relates to the earlier distinction between different types of yoga: jnana yoga (knowledge), bhakti yoga (devotion), etc. People

have different inclinations and talents.

Cologero on 2010-07-02 at 12:51 said:

Evola writes in *Pagan Imperialism*⁷:

We, on the contrary—basing ourselves on a tradition much more ancient and real than the one which can be claimed by the “faith” of Western man, on a tradition which is not proved by doctrines, but by deeds and works of power and clairvoyance—affirm instead the possibility and the concrete reality of what we have called “Wisdom”. We thus assert the possibility of a positive, direct, methodical, empirical knowledge in the “metaphysical” field, just as the one science strives to gain in the physical field, and, just like science, it remains above any moral or philosophical belief of men.

So you need not surrender your hard-headed rationalism, nor believe in any doctrines, myths, or “noble lies”. However, you do need the tools to investigate the metaphysical field, through direct and empirical experience.

Cologero on 2010-07-02 at 12:54 said:

Thanks for posting this. We are definitely not talking about myths, allegories, or “noble lies”. The answer to the question of origins involves a knowing, not a believing.

Will on 2010-07-02 at 14:12 said:

Thanks, everyone. I'm grateful to be able to discuss this with intelligent and civil people.

Gottling, that quote from Charles Upton is great, and also gives me some insight into Plato's doctrine of the Forms or Ideas, which I'm still trying to wrap my head around. Upton has a book on romantic love, which I haven't read yet, but I suspect it would inform the earlier discussion on chivalry and Tantra.

And the quote from Evola brings us back to the fact that what we are talking about is the potential to effect qualitative changes in our state of being. I'm curious to know what people think or have experienced about how this works. Does it relate to the feeling of inspiration and a kind of natural connection one has with certain ideas or myths? Since this discussion began with a question about Hyperborea, how might that myth or idea work in relation to gnosis?

Also, as an aside to Cologero, do you plan on finishing the translation of *Pagan Imperialism*?

⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/PaganImperialism/ThoseWhoKnow.htm>

Robman on 2010-07-02 at 14:50 said:

Will, I don't mind the Buddhist references, since I too have somewhat studied it in the past decade and meditate regularly. My degree of "enlightenment" is quite another matter, though. Buddhism as it is interpreted today is also another story altogether. I think it was Coomaraswamy who stated that Buddhism today is known for all the things it originally wasn't. Evola's book "The Doctrine of Awakening" delves into pre-sectarian original Buddhism along those lines.

As far as the Nordic polar mythos, I'm not sure how it can be spiritually useful, except to a select few. This mythos, to my understanding anyway, seems to be directed at raising the spiritual esteem of those of Nordic or "Aryan" racial type. I think Evola's idea was that spiritual race ultimately manifests in biological race, and that the Aryan type, as the highest caste, was some kind of spiritual elect. Though this idea is flattering if you're white, doesn't it ultimately fetishize race? Doesn't the Polar mythos foster the notion that metaphysical insight is the preserve of a select few? In this, it would become something akin to Judaism. And doesn't this ultimately lead to a biological attachment which hinders detachment and spiritual advancement?

Robman on 2010-07-02 at 15:03 said:

Gottling, that was a difficult quote you provided and I'm not sure I understood it fully. However, I have read Upton's Atlantis and Hyperborea essay, and my reading of it was that Upton doesn't at all take it literally but merely symbolically.

Cologero, I read the words, and yet I have no idea what they really mean. Whether people speak of wisdom, metaphysical insight, experience of the noumen, gnosis, enlightenment, satori, mystical union, etc., to me it ultimately remains an abstraction. I haven't the foggiest what this experience entails, what it's aims are, or what imaginary polar nordic realms have to do with it. Even meditation for me is nothing more than a few stolen moments of psychological peace- far from any direct experience of niravana or the void, whatever that even means. Maybe I am just a profane modern westerner, but that's where it stands.

Matt on 2010-07-02 at 18:10 said:

Robman,

Evola's quote is speaking about the way knowledge of the metaphysical/transcendent is obtained. Evola explains that its not obtained from mere faith that modern western Christianity preaches, nor can it be obtained from the rational discursive thinking. It can only be obtained by a direct experience. Evola has described it as a type of positivism (or spiritual science), a higher positivism, similar in a way to the lower positivism of the physical sciences that obtain knowledge (though be it of a relative nature) of the physical dimension from a direct empirical way. And since Evola sees the way to knowledge of the metaphysical as a science, it is therefore beyond typical moral trappings. This is the method of the long past western initiatic tradition,

and to a lesser extent seen in the Eastern Orthodox doctrine of *theoria* that teaches a direct empirical experience of God's uncreated energies, which is the only concrete way of knowing the divine (unlike Catholicism's idea that only faith and/or rational discursive thinking are the ways to know the divine, or the protestant idea that the divine can only be known from naive faith). And for Evola, only the few have the ability to successfully follow this way, and the modern age makes it that much harder for western man since the initiatic tradition has been almost entirely lost in the west.

And Will, I share the same sentiments. Its nice to talk about these ideas in a civil manner, which is rarely seen today, especially on the internet. It reminds of one of Cologero's earlier posts on the respect shared between certain thinkers of the western tradition, who had a respect for each other even if they disagreed notably in some areas. Unlike most men, they did not view ideas as weapons to be used against each other.

Will on 2010-07-02 at 20:57 said:

Robman, I agree with your comment about the fetishization of race. I am not happy about the co-optation of Traditionalism by people whose main agenda is identitarian politics. According to traditional doctrine, the only identity that ultimately matters is the Atman, or *tathagatagarbha*, or God. This is not to say that racial and cultural traditions don't matter at all, but if we are going to discuss them in light of Tradition, I think we should keep our priorities in line. Otherwise, the kind of biologic and egoic attachment you mention comes into play. Fortunately, the 'negative theology' of the Buddhadharmā, which ruthlessly analyzes all phenomena as impermanent and not-the-Self, is a good antidote to such thinking. NA ME SO ATTA!

That being said, I do find the Polar mythos interesting, and I certainly don't care that it isn't politically correct. Nowadays, there is a tendency to view these types of studies through the lens of Nazism, as if that was somehow the only possible outcome of such a line of thought. But to dismiss a whole generation's scholarly and philosophical work because of some notion of guilt by association is really throwing out the baby with the bathwater. It's wrong to attach a stigma to Germanic myth and ancient history just because the Nazis liked it.

Evola has a great line in *Men Among the Ruins*: "The Idea, only the Idea must be our true homeland. It is not being born in the same country, speaking the same language or belonging to the same racial stock that matters; rather, sharing the same Idea must be the factor that unites us and differentiates us from everybody else." Personally, this is the view I subscribe to. I am most impressed by people who display admirable qualities such as wisdom, skill, strength, self-control, modesty, determination, perseverance, and other such virtues.

Will on 2010-07-02 at 21:11 said:

Matt, I like your exposition of the Evola quote. The notion of "higher positivism" seems to me an apt description of what that first and greatest generation of Traditionalist writers were

doing when they ingeniously laid out the objective metaphysical unity behind the seemingly disparate religious traditions of the world.

In regards to Evola's views on methods – how to go about actually striving for this direct knowledge that can manifest “deeds and works of power and clairvoyance” – he seems to have focused most on that in *Introduction to Magic*. And as you said, magic for Evola is a science – a ‘science of the I.’

Robman on 2010-07-02 at 21:57 said:

I don't care about the political incorrectness of the polar myth either, and that's not why I question it. I'm just curious as to its veracity and the coherence of traditionalist claims- whether it is historically true, or if it's only archetypal symbolism.

As to Evola, I get mixed signals from reading the man. On the one hand, he emphasizes the idea as you note above, yet at the same time seemed to stress Aryanism as the highest of karmic human destinies within manifestation, not just as a caste and spiritual type, but as a corresponding physical type as well. In one of his books, which I don't believe has been translated into English yet, he delves into physical anthropology and provides numerous pictures of European types with his own typological classifications. Which is it?

As far as his race of the spirit and line about “The Idea”, this sounds eerily like what modern liberals are trying to construct in modern “proposition nation” America. The results, in my opinion, are negative. So again, Evola often confuses me.

Robman on 2010-07-02 at 22:19 said:

Since we've been discussing Herman Wirth and Hyperborea, here is an article you might or might not find somewhat interesting.

<http://heatherpringle.wordpress.com/2010/02/23/herman-wirth-and-the-origins-of-writing/>

It seems this work might back up some of Wirth's ideas. But what is especially striking to me is where it states:

“Indeed, she proposes that the ancient sign language may have originated in Africa and arrived in Europe with modern humans—a proposal that would have horrified Wirth.”

I can't imagine that Chinese, or Africans, or Central Americans, or anybody else, for that matter, would be so generous and anxious to ascribe cultural developments found on their own soil to Europeans, for example. Yet western scholars often seem so frivolous with the western legacy in letting others take credit for it. The vast bulk of modern westerners do indeed seem to fetishize race, but other people's races rather than their own. What strange people we are.

Will on 2010-07-02 at 23:23 said:

The observation about the similarity to the 'proposition nation' concept is good. Realistically, I don't think you can make a nation that way; certainly not one as large as the United States. But a tribe or an organization or small community, perhaps.

Also keep in mind Evola's notion of the two ways of being outside the caste system: as a transcender, or as a pariah. In his call for an elite based on spiritual vision and principle, he is calling for transcendence of the caste system, whereas the liberal notion of the 'proposition nation' seems to be more about the lowest common denominator.

I can't comment on the Evola text that you mention as I haven't read it. I can only say that I don't regard him as an infallible source, although obviously I respect his work a great deal. In his autobiography, he describes his work on racism as an attempt to introduce superior, spiritual principles into the discussion, which was widespread at the time, and which was overrun with the biological reductionism that he considered an error. I think Evola saw the Aryan idea as a suitable Ideal for the West, but in his writings it's clear that he respected the accomplishments of many cultures – not in a modern, PC relativistic way, but based on merit and objective evaluation. I'd like to see more of that. In modern politics, it seems like you have to choose between being a relativist or a chauvinist.

Robman on 2010-07-03 at 12:02 said:

Will, here is the text I was referring to, but it's in German, and though my German is limited, I was able to glean the gist of some of the captions below the pictures provided. But it does look like Evola was delving into physical typology here:

<http://www.velesova-sloboda.org/misc/evola-grundrisse-der-faschistischen-rassenlehre.html>

For example, if you look at plate no. 8 of Buddha, Evola writes, "classical Nordic Aryan features are visible".

Will on 2010-07-03 at 23:06 said:

Robman, thanks for the link. I don't read German, so I'm afraid I'm still at a loss here. I did look at the pictures, but without being able to read the commentary, I don't know in what context they are being displayed.

A couple thoughts come to mind on this.

In regards to the picture of the Buddhist statue (it doesn't look like Saykamuni – maybe Padmasambhava?) the tradition holds that there are certain 'marks' of a Buddha; among these, many physical characteristics. I don't have a list of them offhand, but these characteristics provide guidelines for artists in the tradition when they are depicting Buddhas in their artwork. The long earlobes are one such mark.

Within the Buddhist tradition, the three aspects of being – dharmakaya, sambogakaya, and nirmanakaya; or essence, energy, and form – are considered inseparable, and so it follows that

the outer form would have some relation to the spiritual essence of a person.

So Evola may have held, in accordance with traditional doctrine, that certain physical characteristics correspond to certain psychological or spiritual traits (Yukio Mishima has some similar ideas in his book *Sun and Steel*.) Or he may have been adapting his ideas to the already existent German discourse on race, in his attempt to influence the course of events there. I don't know. Interesting that the photos are all of faces, not whole bodies. Mishima wrote instead of bodily traits and their correspondences. Can one be obese and still be 'Aryan?' (According to the Tibetans, yes: Dolpopa, the founder of the Shentong school, was so fat he had to be carried around on a door. He was also the most enlightened teacher of his time.)

I find it ironic that people today condemn Evola for his views on race, when the fact of the matter is that it took more guts for him to propound these views directly to Fascist and National Socialist authorities – views that were very 'politically incorrect' according to the standards of the time – than it does to condemn him today. Indeed, anti-Semites at the time condemned Evola because they noted that, according to his doctrine, a Jew could have the soul of an Aryan, and vice versa, which makes it very difficult to persecute Jews!

As Socrates discovered, the rabble hates a man who makes them think.

1.5 Archaeology of the Soul

What tradition can remain to us of those generations that have not left us a single written line? ... Fortunately, the past never completely dies for man. Man may forget it, but he always preserves it within him. For, take him at any epoch, and he is the product, the epitome, of all the earlier epochs. Let him look into his own soul, and he can find and distinguish these different epochs by what each of them has left behind.

NUMA DENIS FUSTEL DE COULANGES, *The Ancient City*

What we see described here is a method to uncover tradition. Like an archeologist at a site, we dig deeper and deeper into the soul to uncover more and more layers. Mr. Fustel studies legends and rites preserved by later Romans in order to extrapolate backwards to more ancient times. He also makes connections to the Vedas and Laws of Manu, which have

been preserved until our time. Mr. Fustel was neither an esoterist nor a Hermetist, yet he understood this method. How much more, then, can a Hermetist uncover in a similar manner.

A simple Internet search will display incessant arguments about whether or not such and such a writer (e.g., Aurobindo) is a “traditionalist” or which “tradition” is more suitable. These discussions are along the lines of which tattoo to buy; different tattoos may appeal to different types of men, yet it will never be more than skin deep. Gornahoor is not interested in such debates, since there is only one Tradition: call it the Hyperborean Tradition⁸, or the Indo-European, or La Tradizione Romana⁹. The way to understand it is to return to the Primordial State, deep within the soul. Hermetists do not recognize each other through their erudition, but rather through their depth.

Thus, Gornahoor wants to change the terms of the discussion. Whatever your exoteric path, your “tattoo” as it were, there are some common elements. The Hermetist must undergo the three trials¹⁰. He must master the four elements¹¹. He understands the cosmic and juridical order¹². He practices Hermetic meditation¹³. He must have drunk the silence¹⁴, by calming the oscillations of the mind¹⁵. He understands the esoteric meaning of power and his True Will¹⁶.

In short, this path is not for the man with a pedigree but rather for the

⁸See Section 2.1 in this book.

⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1275>

¹⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1902>

¹¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1161>

¹²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2053>

¹³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=898>

¹⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1082>

¹⁵<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/moral-purification-of-the-will>

¹⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1993>

Twice-born, or noble man¹⁷. This path is not for the man with a degree, but rather for the man of power¹⁸. This path is not for the specialist, but rather for the **genius**¹⁹.

Posted on 2011-04-13 by Cologero

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HOO on 2011-04-14 at 13:01 said:

'According to this second and new version of history, civilization breaks down into epochs and disconnected cycles. At a given moment and within a given race a specific conception of the world and of life is affirmed from which follows a specific system of truths, principles, understandings, and realizations. A civilization springs up, gradually reaches a culminating point, and then falls into darkness and, more often than not, disappears. A cycle has ended. Perhaps another will rise again some day, somewhere else. Perhaps it may even take up the concerns of preceding civilizations, but any connection between them will be strictly analogical. The transition from one cycle of civilization to another—one completely alien to the other—implies a jump, which in mathematics is called a discontinuity.' [Evola, J. "The Hermetic Tradition" p. 13]

Cologero on 2011-04-15 at 07:59 said:

Yes, Hoo, but you omitted the following paragraph, in which Evola continues with his own version of the archeology of the soul. Otherwise, there could be no possibility of recovering the Hermetic tradition, which may be latent in some of us, those of us who "remember". Evola claimed that there still existed some Roman families who maintained a hearth and continued to practice the ancient rites.

1.6 The Science of Prehistory

In *Il mito del sangue*, **Julius Evola** has an important chapter on the theories of **Hermann Wirth**. In particular, Evola is interested in Wirth's thesis of the Polar, or Hyperborean, origin of the Nordic race, a theory

¹⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1216>

¹⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1856>

¹⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=319>

that himself accepts. He begins the discussion with a quote from Oswald Menghin, the rector of the University of Vienna:

More than any other discipline, the science of prehistory has been brought, and even more, should be brought, to the center of the spiritual battle of our times. I don't think I'm mistaken in asserting that general prehistory will be the science that guides the next generations.

Unfortunately, Prof. Menghin's advice is little followed today. There are a few reasons for that. The primary reason is that few people are even aware that there is a spiritual battle in progress; moreover, even fewer, probably, even understand what a spiritual battle is.

Then there is the problem of methodology. The belief is prevalent that the only approach involves the scientific method. Perhaps this method can provide a little information, but it does not, and never could, offer any insight into the inner nature or spirit of prehistory. Obviously, that would prove useless in a spiritual battle.

Finally, there is the question of pragmatism. Because of the emphasis on the false doctrine of evolution, few see the purpose of even looking into the prehistorical past in order to gain insight into the present. In this view, it is the future that matters, and the past something to be overcome or forgotten.

Yet, at the time he wrote, Evola had reason to be optimistic. He continues:

In recent times there can be found in many circles a significant impulse to return to origins. The origins, here, appear under a special, spiritual light. He turns back to a presentiment that in primordial times he lived in a still pure state with meanings and symbols that were then lost, obfuscated or altered. Prehistoric research was brought from the level of lifeless scientific-archeological

or anthropological positivism to a level of spiritual synthesis, guaranteed, thereby, to open new horizons for the true history of civilization.

This impulse apparently ran out of gas. Instead of opening new horizons, we have three major theories of origins that limit what we know about ourselves.

The first is the biological view, that man is a genetic accident, made “in the image of animals”, or that the Nordic race evolved out of Africa. The individual is no longer a spiritual being with a Will, but rather the resultant of various electro-chemical processes in the brain.

Next is the return to polytheism. First of all, the purpose of the study of prehistory is not to return to the forms of the past; they are “the past” for a good reason. Secondly, as we learned from Guenon, polytheism is a sign of decadence and any genuine primordial tradition is necessarily monotheistic.

The worst, of course, is the negative, whiny, and ignorant rants of some who see nothing but decadence and disease, not only in the present state of Western man, but also in the past. Instead of recognizing a primordial unity, they propose a plurality of unrelated peoples and ideas. Compare that with the grand and inspiring vision — *The Flowering of European Civilization* of **Donoso Cortes**²⁰ —, that unifies the greatest civilization of the West and relates them to the present.

Posted on 2010-06-28 by Aeneas

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Cologero on 2010-07-02 at 12:57 said:

It is important to recognize that the rejection of the “theory of evolution” is not the same as believing in some sort of so-called “creation science”. The point is that science is simply not

²⁰See Section 6.2 in this book.

competent to deal with the topic; it necessarily remains in the realm of metaphysics. "Involution" is a metaphysical concept.

James O'Meara on 2010-07-09 at 10:32 said:

Re 5:

Yes, the issue isn't 'evolution' at all the rather the mechanism of 'natural selection' [the 'biologism' of point one above]. Evola was perfectly happy to speak of 'evolution of the soul,' for example. The materialists have cleverly gotten everyone to use 'evolution' to mean simply 'change' which no one, of course, denies; except for some "5,000 year" creationists. And that's the other clever move: to label anyone who questions 'natural selection' as a knuckle-dragging Bible-thumper.

Cologero on 2010-07-12 at 12:40 said:

Yes, though the complete statement of the theory is "natural selection by random variation".

It is not so much the "natural selection" part of the theory, since every organism must be able to survive in its environment. It is the "random variation" – which is really a non-explanation – that is in question, since everything must have its sufficient reason.

As Evola and other Hermeticists say, the sufficient reason for existence is Will. That is the point of the True Will, to manifest one's highest possibilities. Manifestation (things that happen) seems random to those who sacrifice their will to external forces.

1.7 Hope and Change

Hope

Even the smallest initiative of a single man or group of men when it is properly organized, can result in a surprising variety of effects and long-term results. As soon as one realizes this fact, one becomes completely immune against despair.

CHARLES MAURRAS

Change

History sometimes produces surprising reversals or changes of direction. The secret of action consists in recognizing them and

knowing how to make use of them, for although obviously we are not going to be able to reverse the whole direction of events by our personal and random tinkering with its works, sometimes quite a small push or twist of ours can set it rolling in a different direction and at a different speed.

JEAN OUSSET, *Action*

Posted on 2011-07-04 by Cologero

2.1 Hyperborea and the Primordial Tradition

In general, the men whom pride makes melancholy, always discontented with the present, always uncertain of the future, love to reflect upon the past from which they believe they have nothing to fear; they adorn it with smiling colours which their imagination dares not give to the future. They prefer, in their somber melancholy, superfluous regrets without fatigue to real desires which would cost them some efforts.

FABRE D'OLIVET

Introduction There exists an egalitarianism of thought, whose presumption is that human consciousnesses are fundamentally alike, both across time and also across the different strata within society. But this is irreconcilable with some fundamental metaphysical principles¹: the doc-

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=823>

trine of cosmic cycles presumes a difference over time (diachronic) and the doctrine of castes presumes a difference within time (synchronic).

Previous writers on Tradition have not always drawn out fully the consequences of these doctrines. Their view has been static and treated the various traditions as though they were mushrooms arising spontaneously after the rain. The consequence has been that “tradition” often devolves to a type of comparative religion with debates about which tradition is the “best” or more “suitable”, and so on, based on little more than contingent historical events or polemical “sound bites”. Instead, these doctrines should throw light on why certain forms appeared where and when they did and what is the relationship to each other. The Western or Roman Tradition is the evolution of the Hyperborean Primordial Tradition² (understood as the unfolding in time due to the forces of cosmic cycles). Thus, we trace the development from the North to the East to the South and to the West. Then, towards the end of a complete cycle, the full effects of the Kali Yuga being to manifest. There are reasons for all this.

Diremption and Man The appearance of man brought about a diremption in the cosmos. This split Heaven from Earth, with Man as the reconciling force. Initially, the consciousness of man had direct intuitive knowledge of both Heaven and Earth; the soul, or psyche, was experienced as a life force or *elan vital*, rather than the complex of thoughts, feelings, likes, dislikes, images and so on, that trap man in subjective isolation.

Primordial State In contrast, the Hyperboreans in the Primordial State would have lived in purity (undivided mind and will) in the light of the sun followed with long nights interspersed with a dim light on the horizons where the sun is struggling to rise or set.

²<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/UltimaThule.pdf>

There is abundance to satisfy all needs, the Hyperborean knows when he is satiated. The mind is free of fear, worry, anxiety. Death is experienced, not as destruction, but rather as a transformation to a different state.

There is an intuitive awareness of God and the universal order by clairvoyant vision, just as we now recognize a tree or a mountain by direct experience. Thinking is regarded as another sense, along with sight, hearing, touch or taste. Discursive thought — of the “yes” and the “no”, of the “good” and the “evil” — is not present. Instead, thoughts are experienced as voices from the celestial hierarchies (gods or angels) or communications from ancestors or as commands from rulers.

Knowledge is passed on by myths, symbols, and rites, in poetic forms.

Temporal power is exercised without force and obeyed willingly; the structure of society is held together by bonds of loyalty, family, and love. Commands are experienced, not as an imposition from the outside, but rather as the direct revelation of spiritual authority in one’s own consciousness.

Recommended reading

- Anonymous, *Meditations on the Tarot*
- Antoine Fabre d’Olivet *Hermeneutic Interpretation of the Origin of the Social State of Man*
- Arthur Branwen, *Ultima Thule: Julius Evola e Herman Wirth*
- B G Tilak, *The Arctic Home in the Vedas*
- Julian Jaynes, *The Origin of Consciousness in the Breakdown of the Bicameral Mind*
- Rene Guenon, *The Great Triad*

- Rudolf Steiner, *Spiritual Beings in the Heavenly Bodies & in the Kingdoms of Nature*

Posted on 2011-01-09 by Cologero

* * *

James O'Meara on 2011-01-09 at 21:36 said:

"Previous writers on Tradition have not always drawn out fully the consequences of these doctrines. Their view has been static and treated the various traditions as though they were mushrooms arising spontaneously after the rain. ... Instead, these doctrines should throw light on why certain forms appeared where and when they did and what is the relationship to each other."

Oddly enough, I was re-reading *Revolt Against the Modern World* this weekend, and it occurred to me that this is exactly what makes Evola distinctive. Part One constructs a model of "Tradition" derived from a survey of world traditions, using a method of synthesis ["the Traditional Method"] which I've previously compared to such methods as [here] to Spengler's "physiognomic tact" and [on my blog] Clive Bell's artistic sense. Part Two then surveys actual [well, according to him] historical developments, identifying various 'cycles' as Tradition interact, declines, recoups, etc.

By contrast, Schuon is the anti-Evola, taking each tradition as a 'mushroom' or a-synchronic whole ["The Christian", "The Taoist" etc.]. H. Smith took this model and calcified it further, if possible, into a cookie-cutter eso/exo model for all world religions, taken as such with no analysis at all.

This is exactly what made Evola so interesting, both theoretically as well as in practice [his attempts to influence contemporary events], after coming from reading Guenon etc., who by contrast seem like armchair theorists.

Schuon take everything today as given, and accounts for change or conflict by the all-purpose 'divine adaption'. Evola, and even Guenon, are able to dig beneath the surface and explain, say, the Roman tradition as an ongoing reconquest of telluric influences by a Nordic cycle etc.

Mark on 2011-01-10 at 16:00 said:

I will post here to comment on Kadambari's comment that Putin has declared Russia an Orthodox country. The reality is that the adoption of Christianity by the Northern peoples has caused a rupture in their spirit. Their pagan imagination has a tendency to want to go to deeper myths.

<http://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1111/j.1469-8129.2008.00329.x/abstract>

"ABSTRACT. As in all post-Soviet states, the Russian intelligentsia has been preoccupied with the construction of a new national identity since the beginning of the 1990s. Although the place of Orthodox religion in Russia is well documented, the subject of neo-paganism and its consequent assertion of an Aryan identity for Russians remains little known. Yet specialists observing the political and intellectual life of contemporary Russia have begun to notice that the development of references to 'Slavic paganism' and to Russia's 'Aryan' origin can be found in the public speeches of some politicians and intellectual figures. This article will attempt, in its first section, to depict the historical depth of these movements by examining the existence of neo-pagan and/or Aryan referents in Soviet culture, and focusing on how these discourses developed in different spheres of post-Soviet Russian society, such as those of religion, historiography, and politics."

<http://www.springerlink.com/content/j30056125185344h/>

Perun's revenge: Understanding the *duxovnaja kul'tura*

The one thing that it seems that Kadambari has not been able to appreciate is the fact that a Christian conscious and a "Pagan" unconscious has affected the people of the North in a different way than the people of the South.

It has interested me as to why the synthesis of Paganism and Christianity has caused a rupturing in the person of the North to the point where if we take someone from Scandinavian descent, if they take their religion seriously, then they become either a fundamentalist Protestant or Asatru, whereas this does not arise as much in the Greek or Italian.

Cologero on 2011-01-10 at 18:47 said:

That is an interesting point, Mark. I have a post in mind that explores that very topic, though I've delayed it because it is inconclusive. Perhaps, I'll post it anyway, after a little preparation.

2.2 *Arctic Home in the Vedas*

From the dead sun springs a daughter more beautiful than her
sire, and mankind starts afresh from the life-raiser and his bride-
Life.

In which we briefly outline the idea of cosmic cycles, and illustrate them initially in the revelation of the originary Hyperborean source of

the Vedas. This is then extended to Traditions following the Vedas. Finally, there is some speculation on the future course of the West. The foundation is the book *The Arctic Home in the Vedas* by **Bal Tilak**.

Cosmic Cycles Since a more complete exposition can be found in Rene Guenon's writings, from whom these notes are taken, and elsewhere, we provide here just the most basic outline.

Cycle: represents the process of development of some state of manifestation

Minor cycle: one of the more or less restricted and specialized modalities of that state

Since the **Law of Correspondence** links all things in universal Existence, is necessarily and always a certain analogy, either among different cycles of the same order or among the principal cycles and their secondary divisions

Kalpa: total development of a world. One cannot speak literally about its duration so that duration has a purely symbolic value. Perhaps not in our world because time is one of its determining conditions.

Manu: there are 14 Manus, each ruling over a Manvantara. There are two septenary series. The first septenary is that of descent, or devolution, and includes ours. The second is ascent or evolution.

Manvantaras: cycles have a character that is both cosmic and historical, they concern terrestrial humanity, also linked to events occurring outside the history of humanity. There is a correlation between the cosmic and human orders. This means, for example, that events in the human realm correspond to events in the celestial spheres.

These relate to the 7 **svargas** and 7 **patalas** which represent states respectively higher and lower than the human state. By correspondence, these can be related to the 14 manus.

A Mantavara is subdivided into 4 **yugas**. We are allegedly in the last yuga, the Kali Yuga. The starting date and exact duration are not known, according to Rene Guenon.

There are 7 **Dvipas** or regions into which our world is divided. They are represented as islands or continents, but not parts of present-day earth. They may also refer to planetary spheres.

These ages, states, and regions also have symbolic meanings, since there is a sacred geography as well as a profane geography. Henry Corbin discusses this topic in his books, and it is also confirmed by Rene Guenon:

There is also a symbolical geography;
indeed, in this connection, there is a very significant correspondence between the domination of the West and the end of a cycle, for the West is the place where the sun sets.

Thus, when he mentions the distinction between Eastern and Western understanding, this is no way simply a geographic distinction; i.e., there is no “magic dirt” in the East. Guenon amplifies the idea:

To the extent that a man ‘Westernizes’ himself, whatever may be his race or country, to that extent he ceases to be an Easterner spiritually and intellectually.

The converse is also true. Unfortunately, this is too often overlooked so there are some who fantasize about going east to find an “initiatric centre” or give up entirely. Often, they justify this decision because of the “corruption” they see in the Church hierarchy, as though India and Egypt are free of such corruption. These masters of ignorance have a loud presence on social media. The truth is that real initiates like Savonarola,



Figure 2.1: Bal Tilak

Boccaccio, and Dante were complaining about corruption in the Church a thousand years ago. (See Canto XXI, *Paradiso*, for example.)

How, then, could Dante describe his spiritual journey? His passage through Purgatory and Heaven are descriptions through the higher and lower stages. Guenon provides us with the general idea, but we need to get the details from others who have made the trip.

Hyperborean Migration The idea of a migration of a branch of the Borean race from a polar region to India has been a mainstay in esoteric literature. That is now considered outré and dismissed as the “Aryan Invasion Theory”. Times change. Bal Tilak, the author of *The Arctic Home in the Vedas*, was a Hindu nationalist and considered himself to be Aryan; so, it is not a Nazi fantasy. Perhaps there is no genetic, archaeological, or documentary proof. Nevertheless, as Georges Dumezil documented, there is still the trifunctional social organisation from Scandinavia, across Europe, to India that needs to be explained. Moreover, there is similarity in the mythologies of the various Indo-European people.

In any case, it may be best to regard Hyperborea as transcendent geography or one of the seven Dvipas. That is how the Greeks understood it, since only the gods could visit it. Apollo would arrive there by a swan.

Nevertheless, Tilak probes through the Vedas looking for clues for an actual migration several millennia ago. In particular, he sees astronomical facts that match the experience of those living in a land close to the North Pole. For example, the original Roman calendar had 10 months, ending in December. That is because it would be followed by two months of darkness during which days could not be counted. It continues in that vein, relying as much on Western scholars as on the Vedas themselves.

Sometimes it gets tedious, much like exegesis on Genesis; is a “day” 24 hours or does it refer to an age? Nevertheless, it is worth the trouble because of the vast amount of information in it.

The Vedas are eternal and without beginning. However, we owe the

textual version to the seven Rishis who could “see” the vedas from the beginning of the Kalpa. A deluge had destroyed the Vedas at the end of the previous Kalpa. Tilak’s method is to juxtapose the Theological view in the Vedas with a corresponding Historico-scientific view gathered from external and profane sources. He also relies on comparative mythology relating Celtic, Greek, Roman, and Egyptian myths to corroborate the Vedic myths. Most importantly, Tilak regards the Zend Avesta, the sacred text of the Zoroastrians, as authoritative.

The Divine Word Since, this is an introduction, we can only point out some highlights; maybe someday we can do a more exhaustive review. This is an important point:

Vedic names and forms of species are eternal, and it is by remembering these that the world is created by Brahmâ at the beginning of each Kalpa. The Veda is, therefore, the original WORD, the source from which everything else in the world emanated, and as such it cannot but be eternal.

Tilak points out that this doctrine is tantamount to the notion of the divine *Logos* of the Alexandrian school.

The duration of the various ages or yugas were in dispute. For example, by an early reckoning, the Kali Yuga would have ended soon after the birth of Christ. Although they knew nothing of that event, the authors of the Puranas in the first centuries AD, refused to believe the Kali Yuga had ended. Hence they extended the duration from 1000 human years to divine years (360 human years). Tilak points to similar artifices to fudge the dates for various purposes. The alternative is to assume that the Christian Era represented the end of the Kali Yuga and the beginning of an ascent.

The point is that the authors preferred to understand the ages by their qualities, not merely as the passage of quantitative time. Also, the original

timeframes were much shorter than the fantastical extended duration of the ages that get passed around today.

Excursus on Method Tilak is very thorough, although the text points out the difficulty of fully understanding the Vedas in all cases. Both Evola and Guenon accepted Tilak's thesis; the latter actually thought very highly of Tilak. Guenon reveals some contradictions in his doctrines that require explanation. For example,

- Guenon claims Tilak was a non-Westernized Hindu. **FACT:** Tilak was quite familiar with European science, history, and mythology. Moreover, he had deep respect for the German Indologist, Max Müller.
- Guenon tediously rails against “profane” science, history, philosophy, etc. **FACT:** Tilak relied heavily on those “profane” fields of study to fortify his thesis.
- Guenon hates Vivekananda, but loves Tilak. **FACT:** Vivekananda was esteemed by not just Tilak, but even Hindus in India to this day.

The point is that it is a mistake to disdain “profane” scholarship when it might be helpful. By the Law of Correspondences, science and metaphysics should not be in conflict since they deal with different levels of existence. Guenon has done us a great service by his explanations of metaphysics and symbolism, by his deep comparisons of different traditions, and by expanding our understanding to include the full range of authentic human spirituality. There is no “Guenonian doctrine” per se, since he is just rephrasing the doctrines of traditions that pre-existed him.

At the end of the day, Guenon does not judge Tradition; Tradition judges Guenon. That is lawful, not a negative judgment.

Traditional Forms It is one thing to mention the possibility of different stages/regions/states, etc., and quite another to fill in the details. That would perhaps require another Rishi, not for a new revelation, but rather for a deeper understanding. Tilak gives us some clues about how the different stages of Tradition might look.

The Letters to the Seven Churches in the Book of Revelation represent the seven stages of the development of Tradition. The following list represents Valentin Tomberg's understanding of the stages. This list is remarkably consistent with Tilak's exposition of the Vedas, with some speculation about the future.

1. **Ephesus:** The old Indian (Vedic) culture. This is primal revelation given to the Rishis in India.
2. **Smyrna:** The old Persian (Zoroastrian) culture. The Zend Avesta also retained a memory of the Hyperborean revelation.
3. **Pergamos:** The Chaldean-Egyptian (Hermetic) culture. This is based on the revelation of the Logos to the Alexandrian school.
4. **Thyatira:** The Greco-Roman (pagan) culture. Although the Greeks retained some memory of Hyperborea, much came through Egypt. The Greeks had the same understanding of "name and form" from Vedic metaphysics, despite the different emphases of Plato and Aristotle.
5. **Sardis:** The Anglo-Germanic (Christian) culture. The Christian religion transformed Europe with a deeper revelation. Building on the Vedas and Hermetics, it understood the Logos as not just the creator, but also as equal to God as well as saviour and judge. Christianity got its philosophy from the Greeks and its Theology was enriched by the Alexandrian school as Vladimir Solovyov pointed out.

6. **Philadelphia:** The Slavic-Russian (also Christian) culture. The Slavic nations should be the preservers of Tradition. We shall see how that plays out.
7. **Laodicea:** The American, i.e. Western Hemisphere, (future) culture. North and South America will look quite different in the future. More cannot be said at this time.

There are three churches of the past, two of the present, and two of the future. But do not take the history and geography too literally, for they represent streams that are always active in us.

Posted on 2020-07-23 by Cologero

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Christopher on 2020-07-23 at 15:48 said:

"Guénon tediously rails against "profane" science, history, philosophy, etc. FACT: Tilak relied heavily on those "profane" fields of study to fortify his thesis."

While I agree generally with the tediousness of Guénon in this regard, I don't believe it to be a contradiction. Guénon has, at various times, cited archaeological findings (his article on La triple enceinte druidique comes to mind) and defended the potential use of profane archaeology, even while criticizing its current usage. In his article on the Place de la tradition atlantéenne dans le Manvantara (Le Voile d'Isis, August–September 1931), he wrote:

« On ne saurait être trop prudent quand il s'agit de civilisations entièrement disparues, et ce ne sont certes pas les tentatives de reconstitution auxquelles se livrent les archéologues profanes qui sont susceptibles d'éclaircir la question ; mais il n'en est pas moins vrai que beaucoup de vestiges d'un passé oublié sortent de terre à notre époque, et ce ne peut être sans raison. Sans risquer la moindre prédiction sur ce qui pourra résulter de ces découvertes, dont ceux qui les font sont généralement incapables de soupçonner la portée possible, il faut certainement voir là un « signe des temps » : tout ne doit-il pas se retrouver à la fin du Manvantara, pour servir de point de départ à l'élaboration du cycle futur ? »

"One cannot be too cautious when dealing with civilizations that have completely disappeared, and it is certainly not the attempts at reconstitution made by profane archaeologists that are likely to shed light on the matter, but it is no less true that many vestiges of a forgotten past are coming out of the ground in our time, and this cannot be without reason. Without

risking the slightest prediction about what may result from these discoveries, whose possible significance is generally not suspected by those who make these discoveries, we must certainly see this as a 'sign of the times.' Should not everything be found at the end of the Manvantara, to serve as a starting point for the elaboration of the future cycle?"

Logres on 2020-08-05 at 23:20 said:

"The alternative is to assume that the Christian Era represented the end of the Kali Yuga and the beginning of an ascent." Rudolf Steiner seems to have come to this conclusion, and much of what you review in Tilak resonates with what I've been able to glean there.

<https://martyrion.blogspot.com/2015/11/jesus-of-gospel-of-matthew.html>

It is not only in man that a change has taken place; everything in Nature, everything on Earth, was also changed at the descent of man. It was therefore not enough for man simply to say: All this is maya, is illusion – let us raise ourselves to the spiritual world! We shall then certainly have changed ourselves, but not all that has become changed in the world around us.' So the Iranian did not say: 'Around me is maya on every side – I will rise above this maya, will overcome it in myself, and so attain to spiritual worlds.' No, he said: 'Man belongs to the world around him; he is but a part of it. Therefore if that which is divine in him, and which descended with him from spiritual heights, is to be changed, then not only man must be changed back again, but everything that surrounds him must also be changed back to what it was.' This feeling gave this people a special impulse to enter energetically into the task of transforming and changing the world. While the Indian said: 'The world has changed, deteriorated; what we now behold is maya,' the people of the north said: 'Certainly the world has come down, but we must so change it that it is made into something spiritual once more!'

The idea being, that by the very fact of the Fall, lower matter is redeemed by the presence of the ruined image of God, and is now "involved". This translates into understanding "struggles between cultures", although not entirely literally. For instance, Steiner cites the Turanian struggle here:

The Turanians in the north toward Siberia, who had inherited a lower astral clairvoyance, had no desire to establish external civilization, and

their passive disposition, influenced by many priests who practiced magic, led them frequently to occupy themselves with lower magic, and even black magic. To the south, the Iranians, with an inclination to influence the sense world by their human spiritual force, were working in a primitive way at the beginnings of civilization.

This is the great contrast between Iranians and Turanians. These facts are expressed in a beautiful myth: the legend of Djemjid.

Thank you for the note on the Seven Churches, and indeed, the entire article.

2.3 Fight over Origins

Julius Evola opens the chapter *The Arctic Myth* from *Il mito del sangue* by describing the state of prehistoric research:

Oswald Menghin, rector of the University of Vienna, wrote these characteristic words, "More than any other discipline, the science of prehistory is being brought back, and still more must be brought back, to the center of the spiritual battle of our time. I don't believe I am mistaken in affirming that general prehistory will be the science that will guide the next generations." In the most recent years, in many circles a significant drive to return to the origins has taken place. The origins, in this case, appear under a special, spiritual light. We return to the intuition that, in primordial times, meaning and symbols existed in a still pure state that was then lost, obfuscated, or altered. Prehistoric research, moved from a plane of disanimated scientific-archeological or anthropological positivism to a plane of spiritual synthesis, promised therefore to open up new horizons for the true history of civilization.

In a sense this is still true, as the battle for control over the narrative of prehistory rages on. However, the prehistory preferred by Evola, based on the Arctic myth of **Fabre d'Olivet**, **Hermann Wirth**, and **Bal Tilak**,

has been relegated to the world of cranks and conspiracy theorists. Unfortunately, the alternative myths of origin, that have adherents today, remain far from any “plane of spiritual synthesis”.

The preferred “scientific” myth of educated (read indoctrinated) people today involves the neo-gnostic belief in a big bang that led to an undifferentiated humanity by the random walk theorized by **Charles Darwin**. In this story, man arises from a great, but incomprehensible, cosmic accident, thrown into a world he cannot understand, and placed in unjust situation, both individually and socially. Hence, the task of man is to develop a higher consciousness that sees beyond the creator of these injustices into a future utopia of liberty, equality, and brotherhood.

The competing myth in the West sees the world as created just, but injustice then entered the world through one man’s sin. There are different degrees of literalness that goes with this story, from the adamant to the flexible who try to accommodate the scientific view. However, they all share the same materialist, empirical presumptions, so no reconciliation or synthesis on that level is possible. Evola points to the alternative:

In support of the Nordic idea a new myth was therefore necessary, a myth as audacious, as it was rich, complex and articulate, was now the material of the know-how to dominate and organize according to a unique explicative principle. Such a myth was forged by the Dutchman Hermann Wirth with the recovery of the arctic theory ... with the reconstruction of the origin, history and civilization of the Nordic-Atlantic race. The theory of Wirth is to be considered as a bold surprise, whose profound directive impulse referred to extrascientific intuitions which then sought to be justified through a very laborious philological, anthropo-geological, mythological, and symbolical apparatus.

While at one time, it may have had great explanatory power, it has little serious traction today. Tilak’s so-called “Aryan Invasion Theory” is now rejected by academics, no one reads Fabre d’Olivet, and Wirth’s book is

effectively unavailable. It is pointless to simply repeat what has been said and it is ludicrous to associate this with stories of UFOs or underground worlds. To be taken seriously, its alleged explanatory powers must be used to explain things.

First of all, we must not look East, but rather to the North. There is a primordial monotheistic tradition that took various forms in the period of migrations, just as languages did, while retaining similar structures. We have brought to light aspects of those traditions, emphasizing their similarities and continuity.

There is an unfortunate tendency in most of those interested in the concepts of tradition, and that is over-intellectualization. But the realm of the spiritual is inaccessible to this type of analysis. What is necessary is the imaginary reconstruction of spiritual states through a type of meditation, based on myths, symbols, rites, legends, and so on. The men capable of doing that will be the creators of the new world, not those addicted to the Demon of Dialectics³.

Posted on 2011-09-24 by Cologero

* * *

logres on 2011-09-24 at 19:25 said:

It's interesting that Lewis and Tolkien were looking "north" as well – they are practically all that Christendom has left these days. Isn't there a northern myth in the East, as well?

Zmaj on 2011-09-25 at 04:15 said:

I don't see the way in which you oppose Guenon by looking to the North. If he emphasized the East, it was as a bastion of remaining traditional forms, especially those that reflect the purity of primordality in their initiatory sophistication. He explained his view that the primary movement of the tradition throughout our cyclical development was from the Northern home, to the West, and finally Eastward as Western degeneracy accelerated. So what do you look to in the North? Might one argue that you must first look to the East (or the esoteric West) for a vehicle to guide you North?

³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3053>

Guenon related knowledge of Central and South American peoples that made reference to an Atlantic home. As for a northern myth in the East, if we allow that the northern myth corresponds to the polar myth (even without reference to names like Atlantis and Borea), we find the symbolism of the mountain throughout the east from Islam to India to Japan, with Polaris holding great significance in Taoism. These symbols represent a place of supernatural origin in these traditions, just as Borea represents the earthly origin of the derived supernatural traditional forms.

Concerning the Southern Negroid races, will someone comment on their place in relation to the Northern myth? I understand that they are the decadent legacy of a previous cycle of developed civilization; what does this say about their condition during/relations with Borea and Atlantis and the related cataclysms? Was their earlier civilization a counterpart to Borea or one of its earliest derivatives? Guenon treated the topic of savages somewhat enigmatically, probably with good reason.

As for today's common beliefs, what do you all make of the article here?

<http://www.abc.net.au/news/2011-09-23/aboriginal-dna-dates-australian-arrival/2913010>

Matt on 2011-09-26 at 17:37 said:

Is it accurate to say that the Aryan Invasion/migration theory is now rejected by academics? From my understanding, the vast majority of linguists still hold to it, and great bulk, possibly the majority of archaeologists and anthropologists also hold to it.

Cologero on 2011-09-26 at 23:10 said:

You tell me, Matt. Do you know of any specific academic who has defended that idea. We can start with Amazon, and we don't see many supporters on the first page. Perhaps an academic may support the idea of an invasion from Central Asia, but other than Tilak, who has supported the idea of Hyperborean origin? It won't fit with the "out of Africa" theory, which probably most academics implicitly accept despite a complete lack of evidence.

But the question I asked is why does Evola refer to it as a myth rather than a theory? And he claims it is the result of "extrascientific intuitions", which is only afterwards justified with a "very laborious philological, anthropo-geological, mythological, and symbolological apparatus". This would seem to rule out academics.

Matt on 2011-09-27 at 19:41 said:

Oh I thought you were referring to the migrations of the Indo-Aryans into northern India. Sorry I'm just so used to hearing people talk about that when "Aryan Invasions" comes up that I thought that's what you were referring to it.

But yes, when it comes Hyperborea and academics, your statement is quite accurate.

[I'm still curious about a recent academic book on the AIT, wherever they may have originated.]

Matt on 2011-09-27 at 19:48 said:

And as for the first page of Amazon, its not surprising that the books listed that present whats called the "Out of India" theory are all written by what appears to be Indian nationalists (its been long known that that theory has been tightly connected with the nationalist movement).

Cologero on 2011-09-27 at 20:02 said:

How long has that been known? Wasn't Bal Tilak a leader in the India independence movement?

Matt on 2011-09-28 at 01:00 said:

Yes, Tilak was apart of the independence movement. To be honest, I'm not sure how well his view of where the Vedas were composed and to where they're composers came from resonates within the nationalist movement (though I bet it doesn't resonate strongly).

But getting back to Out of India, that theory did seem to arise right at the time when the Indian nationalist movement was blossoming, and therefore its ties with the movement have always stuck to it. Whats interesting though it that a recent genetic study showed that the genetic marker R1a (which is associated with the Indo-Aryans and Indo-Europeans as a whole), seems to have originated in northern India, which would give some weight to the out of india theory (though it still has a significant amount of linguistic, historical, archaeological, and genetic evidence going against it). Interesting nonetheless. But as you and Evola have pointed out, none of these competing theories really get at any idea of a spiritual synthesis (and they most likely never will).

What was the recent academic book on the AIT that you mentioned?

Perennial on 2011-09-29 at 02:52 said:

Does anyone have any thoughts as to how Adam and Eve would fit into a Northern/Aryan origin? I do not recall either Guenon or Evola addressing this specific issue. I am curious as to how Nordic idea would fit into a primordial fall.

Boreas on 2011-09-29 at 05:16 said:

"Does anyone have any thoughts as to how Adam and Eve would fit into a Northern/Aryan origin? I do not recall either Guenon or Evola addressing this specific issue. I am curious as to how Nordic idea would fit into a primordial fall."

Are you asking that is a similar myth found in the Nordic traditions? Are you aware of the story of Ask and Embla (Adam and Eve) to whom Hroptri-Odhinn ("the cosmic Christ" / mystical

christos) gave life, light and intelligence?

I read about the myth of Heimdall the last weekend and the myth and Heimdall's character resembled in my opinion a lot the myth of the fall of Lucifer (without the 'war in heaven' part) and it also reminded me about the theosophical teachings of the humanity of the moon-cycle. (Heimdall is said to be originally a moon-god).

Eagle on 2011-10-02 at 17:00 said:

[Nordics, such as Snorri Sturluson, wrote down the Norse myths. Cologero]

"Are you asking that is a similar myth found in the Nordic traditions? Are you aware of the story of Ask and Embla (Adam and Eve) to whom Hroptri-Odhinn ("the cosmic Christ" / mystical christos) gave life, light and intelligence?"

We have no way of knowing how much Christian alteration we have of the Norse myths. Consider who copied them down and when.

Boreas on 2011-10-03 at 04:23 said:

"We have no way of knowing how much Christian alteration we have of the Norse myths. Consider who copied them down and when."

That's true, but we must stick to what we have of them, make the best out of it, and then make our own further examinations and studies. I'm not saying that Odin or Balder = Christ or Heimdall = Lucifer (prior to fall, which I consider to be a cosmic and not a "moral" incidence), but there are a lot of convergences and similarities in the myths and symbols.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-04 at 10:58 said:

The idea that 'civilised' history can only be charted from around 3,000 BC is nonsensical sd clearly – obviously – there were more ancient peoples than this around way past this point. For Atlantis it's fairly simple, you're looking at a zone that stretches from the Caribbean coast to the Senegal region, possibly a series of large islands. The Bay of Bengal area is another massive 'hot spot' for mega-ancient civilisations and in fact sunken cities are cropping up all over the place, not to mention pyramids. The largest pyramids in Europe – gigantic things far bigger and even more astronomically precise than the Great Pyramid – were recently unearthed in Bosnia, and China has kept its 150 plus pyramids well hidden from view for reasons best known to China. Last I saw they were planting trees on them to hide them even more. The Sphinx, as we know, is around 10,000 years old and there's no indisputable evidence that the Great Pyramids were built for Cheops. They could be waaaaay older than that, but most people will suck up the info. fed to them from the Egyptian authorities that a few thousand slaves built the things in 20 years with sand shelves, logs, a few chisels and big round stones. Big round stones to create the most mathematically precise sculptures and buildings ever seen on Earth. By the way, did you know the great pyramid actually has 8 sides not 4? It doesn't become clear until the Autumn

equinox (for a few seconds), when one half of one side is in shadow and the other in light. It is even possible that we live in a binary star system that the ancients knew about and that we are yet to discover...(possible, I said, not certain yet!). Perhaps Sirius is more than we previously imagined. Joscelyn Godwin argues that Hyperborea was in ancient Britain, which does not seem unreasonable given that we have a large solar (Apollonian) monument at Stonehenge. Also regarding ancient destroyed worlds, in a certain part of India, near to Bangladesh, I think, there is evidence of an immense nuclear cataclysm many thousands of years ago, based on analysis of the soil and levels of radiation. The main problem for human beings in sorting out the order of things is that (for the most part) our memories just ain't what they used to be. It is likely that there have been past disasters of such magnitude – and so terrifying – that there is a collective mental block about them ingrained into our DNA....Agree that The Fall occurs cosmically but also within each microcosm, and there have been many reverberations throughout known and unknown history as successive generations encounter the same stumbling blocks.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-04 at 17:16 said:

Just an addendum about the twin sun theory: For more info from ancient sources read "The Holy Science" by Sri Yukteswar.

Yuga Theory

Sri Yukteswar's introduction to The Holy Science includes his explanation of the Yuga Cycle – revolutionary because of his premise that the earth is now in the age of Dwapara Yuga, not the Kali Yuga that most Indian pundits believe to be the current age.[4] His theory is based on the idea that the sun "takes some star for its dual and revolves round it in about 24,000 years of our earth – a celestial phenomenon which causes the backward movement of the equinoctial points around the zodiac." [1] The common explanation for this celestial phenomenon is precession, the 'wobbling' rotating movement of the earth axis. Research into Sri Yukteswar's explanation is being conducted by the Binary Research Institute.

Boreas on 2011-10-06 at 03:04 said:

Charlotte: As I've been studying the theory of the four yugas, I've myself come to a somewhat certain conclusion – with no authority on the matter of course – that there are yugas within yugas within yugas within yugas – all the way to the most minimal part of time cycles. What I mean is that the four time cycles repeat themselves in every yuga: there is the golden age of the Kali Yuga, the silver age of the Kali Yuga, the bronze age of the Kali Yuga, and the iron age of the Kali Yuga; and all these four cycles and the whole of the particular Kali Yuga can be within a greater Dwapara Yuga, for example. (I would like to hear thoughts about the exactness of this thought pattern from someone who is knowledgeable in these matters.)

2.4 The Hyperborean Race and its Branches

This is Part 2 section 7 of *Sintesi di dottrina della razza* by **Julius Evola** in which he discusses the Hyperborean race. The texts that he refers to are *Revolt Against the Modern World* and *The Myth of Blood*; the chapters in *Revolt* on the Hyperboreans should be read in conjunction with section.

From the corporeal perspective, this can be understood as a specific race of humans. From a spiritual perspective, it can be understood in terms of sacred geography. In the latter case, the Hyperboreans represent a race of people who lived in the light, i.e., in self-effulgent consciousness. Or both interpretations can coincide.

The limit that can be given to our doctrine of the race regarding the exploration of its origins lies at the point when the Hyperborean race had to abandon the Arctic home in successive waves following different paths, because of the freezing that rendered it uninhabitable—it was already pointed out, in previous citations, justification for the idea that the Arctic region became completely ice bound only after a certain period: the memories of that home, preserved in the traditions of all peoples in the form of various myths where it always appears as a “land of the sun”, as an island continent of splendour, as the sacred ground of the God of light, and so on, were already, in this respect, rather eloquent.

Now, at the point of the beginnings of the prehistoric Hyperborean emigrations, the Hyperborean race could be considered, among all of them, the superior one, the super-race, the Olympic race reflecting in its extreme purity the very race of the spirit. By and large, it seems that all the other human stocks existing on the earth in that period, appeared either as “races of nature”, that is, animalistic races, or, as races that had become “races of nature” through involutions of the preceding racial cycles. In fact, the traditional teachings speak of a civilization or of an

Antarctic race that had already fallen into decline in the period of the first Hyperborean emigrations and colonisations, and whose Lemurian residues were represented by sizable groups of black and Malaysian races. Another racial stock, distinct both from the Hyperboreans and from the Antarctic-Lemurians, was that which originally occupied the Eurasian continent (the Finnish-Mongoloid race) as the yellow-brown race and, as the as red-brown race and also again the yellow-brown, occupied both a part of the Americas and Atlantic lands that are now extinct.

It would obviously be absurd to attempt a precise typology of these prehistoric races and of their primordial combinations in regards to exterior characteristics. We must refer to them only to prevent some misunderstandings and to be able to orient ourselves among the ethnic formations of the successive periods. Also, the investigation of skull fossils can tell us very little, both because race is not characterized just by the skull, not even the simple race of the body, because there are reasons to justifiably assert that, for some such races, fossil remains could not be preserved up until our time. The dolicephalous, or elongated skull, combined with a tall and slim figure, blonde hair, clear skin, blue eyes, is, as we noted, characteristic of the most recent descendants of the Nordic races who came directly down from the Arctic regions. But all that does not constitute the final word; even within the limits of the positive order, it is necessary to bring in considerations proper to the study of the race of the second level [race of the soul] in order to get our bearings.

In fact, we already said that the essential element for race is not given by simple corporeal and anthropological characteristics, but by the function and the meaning that they have in the whole of a given human type. Dolicephalous men with a tall and slender build are also found in fact among the black races, and a white coloration and almost blue eyes are found among the Ainu of the Far East and the Malaysian-Polynesian races, naturally having a totally different significance in such races. Nor must we think here only of anomalies or tricks of nature, in certain cases

being able to treat of extinct somatic survivals in the proceeding types from races which, in their most remote zenithal period, were able to have similar characters to those which, in the period we are considering, were instead found concentrated in the Nordic-Hyperborean element and here accompanied, up to a relatively recent period, by the significance and by the corresponding inner races.

As to the emigration of the races of Hyperborean origin, having previously written about them in the books previously cited, we can limit ourselves to noting three principle currents. The first took the direction northwest to southeast reaching India and having as its final echoes the Indian race, indo-afghan and indo-brachimorphic in Peters' classification. In Europe, contrary to what you may believe, the traces of such grand currents are less visible or, at least, more confused, because they had a superposition of waves and therefore a composition of successive ethnic layers. In fact, after this current in the northwest-southeast direction (the transversal Nordic-Aryan current), a second current followed the direction West to East, in most of its branches through the routes of the Mediterranean, creating centres that sometimes should be considered even more ancient than those derived from the preceding transversal wave, because in this case it is not always about a forced emigration, but also of a colonization occurring before the destruction or the eventual uninhabitability of the original centres of the civilization of Hyperborean origins. We can call this second current, with the related trunk of races, Ario-Atlantic, or Nordic-Atlantic, or, finally, Atlantico-Occidental. In fact, it originates from an Atlantic land, in which it constituted a centre that, at its origin, was more or less an image of the Hyperborean centre. This land was destroyed by a catastrophe, whose memory likewise is found in the mythologized memory of the traditions of almost all peoples, and then after the waves of the colonizers a true emigration followed.

It is said that the land of Atlantis was familiar at its origin with a type of facsimile of the Hyperborean centre, because the data reaching our

time lead us to think that a regression happened, both from the point of view of race and from the point of view of spirituality, in these Nordic stocks who had already ventured towards the south in the most ancient epoch. The mixing with the red-brown aborigines seems, in this regard, to have had a destructive and sizeable role, and if a precise record in Plato's story is not found, in which the union of the "sons of the gods"—of the Hyperboreans—with the indigenous people was given the blame in the end, that recall what, in other recorded myths, are described as the "fall" of the heavenly race—of the "angels" or, again, the sons of the gods, *ben elohim*—who mated, at a particular moment, with the daughters of men (of the inferior races), committing a contamination significantly likened to, by other texts, the sin of sodomy, carnal relations with animals.

Further reading

From the positive, scientific perspective, see *The Science of God* where the physicist Gerald Schroeder discusses the existence of pre-Adamic hominoids.

In *The Psychology of Man's Possible Evolution*, Peter Ouspensky mentions the possibility of the existence of pre-Adamic hominoids.

Boris Mouravieff, who claims to be drawing on ancient Western traditions, accepts the existence of a pre-Adamic race in his *Gnosis* trilogy.

The idea of the polar origins of the Hyperborean race was discussed in *The Arctic Home in the Vedas* by **Bal Tilak** based on myths recorded in the Vedas.

For a recent theological and metaphysical discussion of the existence of humanoid animals, see *Knowing Ape from Adam*⁴.

Posted on 2015-03-01 by Aeneas

* * *

⁴<http://edwardfeser.blogspot.com/2014/12/knowning-ape-from-adam.html>

John Bardis on 2011-03-26 at 22:12 said:

In regard to the reference to Mouravieff and the pre-Adamics, this has to do with the idea that a human has three so-called centers: moving, emotional and intellectual (while animals lack the intellectual center). But, then, humans also have higher emotional and intellectual centers.

According to Mouravieff there are, basically, two species of humans: those with higher centers and those without higher centers. So someone without the higher centers would be an animal with an intellectual center—a very smart animal.

Those without higher centers live only one life, like animals, then they die. People with higher centers reincarnate.

Those without higher centers can be quite attractive physically, as tends to be the case generally with animals. After all what is more beautiful than a horse or a tiger or a hawk? And, in fact, these people without higher centers very often have blue eyes and blond hair, as everybody knows.

Mouravieff, of course, isn't talking about ancient pre-history. He is talking about the situation today. And in fact those without higher centers far out number those with higher centers.

Cologero on 2011-03-26 at 23:18 said:

Of course Mouravieff is referring back to ancient pre-history, as in the first chapter of Book 2. M. claims that there were two distinct creations: first pre-adamic humanity and then Adam. M. also refers the the miscegenation of the two races in terms very similar to Evola's:

It is since Adam that man has received the capacity to pass from growth to development in his evolution, and *only part of the humanity of those times received this gift*. The Bible speaks of a long period of coexistence of the first humanity alongside adamic humanity. It later refers to the latter as passing through a period of recession following mixed marriages which were considered by God as evidence of *great perversity* ... the first humanity still retained animal characteristics

I don't recall anywhere that M. described the physical characteristics of pre-Adamic man, so they don't seem to be identifiable with any specific peoples today. In any case, we are primarily interested in the spiritual race, as you described, rather than the corporeal race.

Mr. Bardis, you must travel in rather exalted circles where "everyone" knows the inner states of their associates. I myself am dubious about that claim. The primary difficulty is that the Adamic man who has the higher states only in potential — that is, unactualized — is indistinguishable from the pre-Adamic man who lacks them totally.

John Bardis on 2011-03-27 at 07:39 said:

Well, yes, certainly, there is the whole question of ancient pre-history.

And the main problem, of course, that Mouravieff deals with at great length is how Adamic man can actualize his higher states.

But there's a further problem that is of much interest to Mouravieff, and that is, quite simply: What is the place in society of pre-Adamics? I suppose, in terms of caste, they would be the fourth caste. Obviously this caste makes up the vast majority of the population. So, then, there are very serious ethical and social questions involved here.

As to your last point, yes, certainly, that's why I mentioned that the color of eyes or hair or skin has nothing to do with it, at least today. Undoubtedly before the mixing of the races such factors gave a clear indication of the matter.

Cologero on 2011-03-27 at 11:56 said:

In chapter 14 of Book 3, M does attempt to address that issue. Yes, the fourth caste, because only the first three castes are "twice-born" ... a phrase used in the Vedas, by Evola, and again by Mouravieff. I brought it up because it is fundamentally the same position as other esoteric teachings ... something M himself points out. What he does, though, is to move the question of race totally to the spiritual realm, a direction Evola also traveled, but only halfway.

So the challenge is whether Mouravieff has truly revealed esoteric Christian teachings that had been kept secret. If true, what does it do to the alleged idea of Christian universalism or the idea we are "all children of God"? I don't see how this could be resolved short of a sufficient number of Adamic men becoming "twice born"; they would "see" it.

John Bardis on 2011-03-27 at 13:52 said:

There's an implicit argument in Gurdjieff-Ouspenski-Mouravieff that is quite suggestive.

Natural man is either man 1, man 2, or man 3. With spiritual development one gets man 4, man 5, man 6 and man 7 (with man 8 making one brief rather unfortunate appearance).

Supposedly it takes 100 natural men to support the existence of one man 4, 100 men 4 to support the existence of one man 5, 100 men 5 to support the existence of one man 6, and 100 men 6 to support the existence of one man 7.

So, then, one can imagine the redeemed earth has having a population of 101,010,101 adults, consisting of one legitimate ruler of the world and 100 million natural men. So this problem of how to integrate these natural men into society is quite pressing.

But, then, there's the question: Could this planet support a man 8? This would require a population of more than 10 billion adults—and, again, with a full 10 billion of them, almost all of them, being natural men.

Of course I'm not suggesting that the above is the literal, scientific truth. It is just a hopefully suggestive model.

Cologero on 2011-03-29 at 20:05 said:

Isn't the situation more dire than you suggest with mere numbers? Unlike Traditional societies, where the spiritual order was recognized and accepted, the natural man of today, in his spiritual democratism, does not even accept the possibility of such an hierarchy that you propose. How then would he ever consent to support it?

John on 2011-03-30 at 18:33 said:

According to Mouravieff there are a certain number of souls assigned to our planet. The final redemption of the earth will take place when all the souls can incarnate at the same time.

The final redemption is also associated with the coming again in glory of one who Gurdjieff calls a man #8.

This suggests that there are 100 million souls assigned to our planet. This means that our planet should be able to sustain the existence of 10 billion "natural men". This, of course, isn't possible without the development of technology.

This also has to do with the question of the Pope as opposed to the councils. If the Church isn't big enough to sustain a man #7, then the men #6 would be involved in a council. Or if the Church were big enough to support several men #7, then this would call for a council. But if there are 100 men #6, then a man #7 will rule. And if there are 100 men #7, then Man #8 will come in glory to rule the world.

This has to do with the resurrection of the body. This has to do with the kingdom of heaven on earth.

What "natural man" will support is the least thing to be concerned about. It is odd, by the way, that as animals become extinct, or as the population of animals decreases, the population of humanity increases. Is this just a coincidence?

Cologero on 2015-03-03 at 21:20 said:

Obviously, despite the many responses to the poll question, this is not very interesting. I am aware of one outside comment: *The Sons of God*⁵.

Marcel K. on 2015-03-04 at 08:31 said:

I have read the German translation by the man himself several times over the last few years. Lately I have been questioning the 'white nationalist views I have held in the past, which makes

⁵<https://evolacomment.wordpress.com/2015/03/03/man-is-the-son-of-god/>

this the most problematic of Evola's writings for me, due to the heavy influence of Nordicism thought which I consider to be pseudoscientific at best. Evola emphasizes that the second and third level of racial classification are more important than the first, but states that there is a significant correlation between the corporeal race and the races of the soul and the spirit. Like Ludwig Clauß he believed that a solar spirit is correlated with a 'Nordid' anthropological type, which he considered to be the original Indo-European type.

Today we know that the 'Nordid' type developed as an adaption to the harsh climate of northern Europe, and that the bearers of Indo-European culture were of a different type which, for all we know, might not have been all that European in the racially modern sense. I think that in order to solve the problem of race, Evola's simplistic theories concerning the homeland of the Indo-Europeans and their anthropological type have to be rejected. The primary significance of the Hyperborean race and the *Urheimat* is that of a myth, but I believe it would be wrong to base this myth on a faulty anthropology like John and Ted did in their comments.

However I think it is too early to dismiss the notion that there exists a mysterious physical type in which the solar spirit is very common. Perhaps with modern genetic and anthropological evidence we will eventually be able to trace back Indo-European civilization to a distinct physical type. I wouldn't rule out the possibility that there is a modern group of people who retained this type, or in whom it reemerged. Consequently we might be able to predict where a revival of tradition is most likely to occur. But to my mind it is just as likely that the focus on physical race is entirely misguided, and that a connection between the race of the body and the race of a spirit does not exist.

This comment is very rambling and I apologize if it misses the mark.

Cologero on 2015-03-04 at 09:00 said:

Actually, Marcel, your comment is right on the mark. That is why we have been reluctant to publish the full translation, despite its being nearly complete. Such a discourse on race and the Hebrews will not be understood in today's climate. Evola himself, in his later books, toned down the rhetoric he used in the 30s and 40s; not surprisingly, they are the most "popular" (viz., *Ruins*, *Tiger*). I don't think Evola is so much simplistic, rather that he has an utter disdain for positive science. His methodology of using myths to reconstruct the past is opposed to "objective" scientific methods.

The deeper issue, which is Evola's real motivation, is to oppose universalism, individualism, rationalism, and evolutionism. I think there are more effective ways to do that. For example, Gornahoor has been promoting a typology based on the various possibilities of inner dispositions, i.e., based on one's dominant center of sensation, emotion, or thought. This serves the purpose that the notion of "spiritual race" was intended to serve while being independent of physical race. Moreover, it is tied into the traditional notion of the interior states of man, so it is verifiable ... not scientifically, but esoterically.

William Neville on 2015-03-04 at 10:27 said:

While I agree that publishing such material would probably open up a good deal of misunderstanding and futile argument, one cannot disregard the meaning of physical race altogether. Inner states trump their outer manifestations, yet the symbolism of the outer race still points to something higher, even if that something higher no longer exists within the person bearing the physical mark of it. Though a juvenile biological racism is to be much avoided, I don't think it is a mistake that people have recognized something special in the fair northern races for thousands of years

For example, let us look at what Pope St. Gregory the Great said about the Angles (the antecedents of modern day Anglo-Saxons), according to the Venerable Bede. We can see that he acknowledges the supernatural significance of their fair skin and light hair, etc. while recognizing that it did not (at the time) reflect their individual inner state in terms of salvation and enlightenment:

"I must here relate a story, handed down to us by the tradition of our forebears, which explains Gregory's deep desire for the salvation of our nation. We are told that one day some merchants who had recently arrived in Rome displayed their many wares in the marketplace. Among the crowd who thronged to buy was Gregory [not yet elected pope], who saw among other merchandise some boys exposed for sale. These had fair complexions, fine cut features, and beautiful hair. Looking at them with interest, he enquired from what country and what part of the world they came. "They come from the island of Britain," he was told, "where all the people have this appearance." He then asked whether the islanders were Christians, or whether they were still ignorant heathens. "They are pagans," he was informed. "Alas!" said Gregory with a heartfelt sigh, "how sad that such bright faced folk are still in the grasp of the Author of darkness, and that such graceful features conceal minds void of God's grace! What is the name of this race?" "They are called Angles," he was told. "That is appropriate," he said, "for they have angelic faces, and it is right that they should become joint heirs with the angels in heaven. And what is the name of the province from which they have been brought?" "Deira," was the answer. "Good. They shall indeed be rescued de ira— from wrath—and called to the mercy of Christ. And what is the name of their king?" "Aelle," he was told. "Then," said Gregory, making play on the name, "it is right that their land should echo the praise of God our Creator in the word Alleluia."

Lu Dongbin on 2015-03-04 at 15:15 said:

Regarding the racial type of the original Indo-Europeans, I am not inclined to agree that the bearers of Indo-European culture were not racially "Nordid" or at least "Nordish." The evidence is overwhelmingly in favor of them being Nordic racially due to the fact that the Nordid type is present in all IE groups to some degree, as far West as Ireland and as far East as the Tocharians/Da Yuezhi, whose mummies discovered in Xinjiang confirm this fact.

Furthermore, it is known that this type pops up among Pashtuns, Hunza, Pamiris, Kalash, Kashmiris, Persians, Kurds, and so on even today, albeit rarely. The Brahmin castes of India still have the highest incidences of Europic features in relation to the rest of the population and ancient Greco-Roman literature is replete with various figures who possessed Nordic racial features, such as Achilles, Alexander the Great, Sulla, etc. Furthermore, thunder gods like Thor and Indra are often described as copper-bearded, to say nothing of other gods like Apollo, etc.

In my view, arguing that the original Aryans or Indo-Europeans were not racially Nordic or Nordish is more due to the modern backlash against the regimes which propagated that view in the 1930s and 40s, political correctness, modern Indian nationalism, and so on. It's very obvious what type they were, which is why most of the early European investigators prior to any politicization of the issue held that view.

The above says nothing about the spiritual race I realize, but nonetheless felt it worthwhile to add. While the Hyperborean seat also has a spiritual dimension, I think the memory of such a seat in the various mythologies of IE people as well as the data presented in Tilak's "Arctic Home in the Vedas" leads to convincing evidence that it was also a historic reality.

Max on 2015-03-04 at 16:18 said:

If the Tradition began in the North, it is reasonable that it should return towards the end. The mission of the middle ages could be seen as a transmission of the torch from west and northwards. According to the ancient sources it seems that the polar region had a pleasurable temperate climate which is obviously not the case today and i am unsure of what geological process causes that and if it will reverse someday. It could be interesting to compare the mythological sources to what the natural sciences know of the ice ages.

Concerning the movements out of the Arctic during the big freeze, there is the notion of "ice-age refuges": places somehow sheltered from the worst conditions. It is likely that not everyone relocated to southern lands but that some populations survived maybe isolated and surrounded by glaciers, giving rise to genetic bottle necks in northern populations. New findings are coming to light, it was previously thought that the whole of Scandinavia was covered by several kilometers of ice but that view is turning out to be false. Solid ground existed and some species of plants and animals were never extinct in the northern regions of Eurasia and consequently did not have to recolonize from the south. Exactly where they survived however is more uncertain. In any case, we know that the northern human racial characteristics could only develop in extreme conditions and in isolation, probably in a very small group of people.

For a race to actually live in the conditions after the descent of darkness gives "inner light" a whole new meaning so i find ideas like the "personal sun" interesting in that regard. Just imagine spending maybe months and years in deep meditation, almost hibernation, with the Sun all the while preserved internally like a sacred memory. In Norse mythology the primordial cow Audhumbla licked the ice and from there emerged the first Man while her life-giving milk ran in

rivers to the four corners of the world. If thinking about what could possibly sustain humans in such harsh conditions milk is an answer. Compare a map of worldwide lactose-tolerance with the current theories on cattle domestication in the middle east to see if there is any inconsistencies. The Nordic race is the only one to be completely adapted to a life together with animals without having to kill them for meat. This should be kept in mind when meditating on Man's original task on earth as guardians and protectors of the animals and forests. Peoples of the germanic and nordic countries to this day feel strongly for animals even though it has been sentimentalized into irrational forms lately.

In earlier times it was said that we all have to eat or be eaten, life is sustained by death, the world is a circle and so on. We now know that is not altogether true. There is another possibility of true freedom, goodness and beauty by cooperation for the benefit of everyone. I read somewhere that the greatest act of charity is towards those we do not expect anything in return from.

Just because i had Aguéli on my mind recently i would like to mention that he was responsible for preventing Spanish-style bullfighting in France by shooting and wounding the matador with a revolver. He also smoked opium, dressed in strange costumes, partook in an-archistic conspiracies, painted modern art, traveled through the orient and translated esoteric arabic treatises on "the people of blame". Well, at least it is refreshing to see intellectuality and uncompromising action united in one person considering how uncommon that is.

If it is possible for humanity to inherit original sin from one man, the merit of the forefathers should also be equally possible to inherit. It means that the lineage and in the end race really matters. Even if several races or families have a common origin, not all of them may have preserved that heritage equally. In the case of a king, he is the highest representative of the nation or the city because he is the fullest expression of their nature. The head of the senior line that in the purest and most undiluted way preserve the original impulse and wholiness and by his presence will allow his subjects to be whole as well, directing their action higher.

In old Aryan society, worse than death was exclusion -becoming an outlaw. Failure to live by the law means life outside the law, astonishingly moral and simple. Our present society however idealizes criminals and outcasts. Relegation to the forest is not necessarily a punishment since the forest is apart from outlaws inhabited by solitary mystics and holy men. When looking for the way forward, and some are not even aware that there is anything to look for, it is easy to miss the forest for the trees. The truth is we have been judged to the forest passage, an exile, and the first step is a change of perception: "We are already in the forest".

"The real issue is that the great majority of people do not want freedom, are actually afraid of it. One must be free in order to become free, because freedom is existence – it is above all a conscious consent to existence, and the desire, perceived as a personal destiny, to make it reality. At this point man is free, and this world filled with oppression and oppressive agents can only serve to make his freedom visible in all its splendor, just as a great mass of primary

rock produces crystals through its high pressure." -Ernst Jünger, *The Forest Passage*

Aeneas on 2015-03-15 at 19:55 said:

They (Evola, Guenon) write of the increasing density of men, more or less, equivalent to the distinction of pneumatic, psychic, and hylic men. As such, the Hyperboreans cannot be identified strictly by DNA (the hylic/material level) nor even by archeological clues, which actually would reflect the soul level. The gap between the man whose self-understanding is as an I with a will compared to the man who regards himself as a "computer made of meat" is enormous.

Hence, identification can only be made by "remembering". This is a truth that is not found, but "willed" as Scaligero points out. Those who do remember will need to find each other.

Max on 2015-10-05 at 12:34 said:

George MacDonald wrote a children's novel on the theme of Hyperborea called "At the Back of the North Wind".

"'You see, Diamond,' said North Wind, 'it is very difficult for me to get you to the back of the north wind, for that country lies in the very north itself, and of course I can't blow northwards.'"

No road leads to that mysterious country. When approaching the magnetic north, compasses presumably become useless. Young Diamond in the story however finds his way. There is a fitting proverb: "The sailor does not ask for tailwind. He learns to sail". A sailor makes use of what circumstances he happens to be in to reach his destination. Knowing how to sail the winds does not exclude faith as some people seem to think. It is not possible to avoid the north wind by attempting to steer around, one must pass through.

When the child arrives at the threshold to the land beyond the north wind, he finds it surrounded by a barrier of ice and guarded by North Wind, now more resembling a great figure outside an Egyptian temple. He still recognizes her and walks towards her, having a feeling of being swallowed up in whiteness.

We do not get to know much about this country since it is difficult to talk about, but the author mentions a Durante who also knew it. Nevertheless, from the stories about Diamond's life upon returning to the world, we can see some of the fruits of his journey such as:

Incapable of lying

Not affected by fear

Seeing the good in humans and events

Awareness of an underlying melody to life

Becoming an inspired poet

Intuitively understanding animals and little children

"'The cabbies call him God's baby,' she whispered. 'He's not right in the head, you know. A tile loose.'"

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-06 at 05:27 said:

I should reread Tilak's "Arctic Home". There is a Serbian edition with a very good preface by late Dragoš Kalaji.

As someone who never had access into any kind of secret, esoteric knowledge or gnosis, my opinions and thoughts on the subject of Hyperborea and other "lost civilizations" remain in a domain of exoteric musings and intuitive pedestrian epistemology.

To me, Hyperborea (Yperboreia) is a Sacred, Polar Center manifested on all levels of existence, from terrestrial, material one all the way up to the Celestial or Cosmic one (Cosmic North of my personal mythos). But, over the ages of spiritual degradation, lower materializations vanished behind the hermetically sealed gates, remaining 'open' perhaps only to a very few Initiates (who must ascend through a pillar of Light because 'neither by ship nor on foot would you find the marvellous road to the assembly of the Hyperboreans'). The most profane interpretation, the materialistic one, is echoed in fairy tales, existing through such indelicate currents like, for example, Ray Harryhausen's "Sinbad and the Eye of the Tiger". Although, viewed from high esoteric planes, profane and childish, this mythopoeic capsule in a form of a cheap fantasy movie can plant a seed into child's consciousness which is still very much 'Golden Age'-like, initiating him/her into a sacred mystery. But in the eye of a spiritually atrophied, mechanized individual, this medium remains an empty shell. This is why it's important for our children to read mythology. Or watch Ray Harryhausen's movies, or read Conan the Barbarian. Or all of the above.

Hyperborea – Lemuria axis often sparked my imagination because I felt in it a sort of primordial struggle, a 'battle' between Good and Evil, Light and Darkness. Strangely enough, Harryhausen's Sinbad visits Lemuria in the 'Golden Voyage of Sinbad', finding an exotic land covered in jungle and quasi Hindu temples and palaces, already aged and ruined and inhabited by primitive aghori looking tribes who practiced human sacrifice to a grotesque Centaur god. And surprise, surprise, another deity worshipped deep in their caverns is – Kali. In our own reality, living in the Kali yuga, seems that Lunar Lemurian influence is on a rise, threatening to flood entire world, including the North, with its waves of darkness.

Perhaps David Icke isn't completely crazy and his reptilians are simply spiritual Lemurians who became a ruling elite after the removal of what was left of a true European solar nobility? (a la reptiloid Jews, just look at Soros, Barbara Spectre or Nataniel Rothschild and tell me if they look completely human?) Icke, being unable to interpret the true depth of this mystery, simply tells us instead a materialistic story based on ufo's and alien memes.

There is also a dichotomy, perhaps, between Black Sun and Golden Sun, with the former one having a dominant influence in our world, at least in the Kali yuga. Maybe because it represents a hidden, secret Sun? National Socialists heavily used Black Sun and it seems to me that it's somehow connected with the Antarctic, more than the Arctic, which is very interesting if true.

Theosophists considered South Pole a source of all lethal astral and cosmic forces, while

the North is the fountain of all beneficent ones, thus being related to the practices of right hand and left hand path. There is some confusion about what is today LHP, since, living in the 'evil' age, being antinomian would mean being 'good'. In that sense, Black Sun use must be some kind of a 'Ride the Tiger' practice. I am just guessing.

2.5 The Son of Duty

In *Men Among the Ruins*, **Julius Evola** writes:

Ancient Indo-European traditions regarded the procreation of a son as a "duty": because of this, the firstborn was called the "son of duty," in distinction from any subsequent children.

This involves both a distortion and an omission. The son is not a duty of the father, but rather the duty the son inherits. Furthermore, the distinction mentioned, but not specified, is not without import. **Fustel de Coulanges**, in describing the Aryans, quotes the entire sentence that Evola relies on:

The oldest son was begotten for the accomplishment of the duty due the ancestors; the others are the fruit of love.

Hence, Evola's criticism of those who choose family life is without merit. The ensuing children are not sons of duty; hence they are not bound to follow Evola's path that sometimes more resembles a Gorean fantasy than that of a serious man. The idea that children are desired as the fruit of love and not the result of impulsive sexual urges is ignored by Evola. In the *Aitareya Brahmana*, which Evola was familiar with, the value of a son is described by **Narada**⁶ in no uncertain terms:

⁶<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Narada>



The delights of in the earth
The delights in the fire
The delights in the waters of living beings,
Greater than these is that of a father in a son
A son is a light in the highest heaven.
The gods said to men:
A sonless one cannot attain heaven,
All the beasts know this
This is the broad and auspicious path
Along which men with sons fare free from sorrow.

This is how our ancient Aryan ancestors actually lived. The **Aryan gods** advised a man to have sons; this is not just an aberration of the Catholic god as Evola insinuates. Yes, but not just the gods, even the beasts know as much. So in criticizing the family, Evola stoops lower than the animals.

Besides love and joy, there is a third factor: a sonless one cannot attain heaven. It is not just a question of continuing a biological line, but more important is the continuation of a spiritual tradition.

Now a man may sacrifice his family life to focus on a spiritual life or even, perhaps, a secular order (which Evola claimed existed) of unmarried men. Of course, once a man has fulfilled his "duty", he may choose the celibate life of a sannyasi. But in Evola's conception, these choices hardly count as a sacrifice. Now this is counter to what he writes in *The Metaphysics of Sex* about marriage. This is summarized by his quoting **Louis Claude de Saint-Martin**:

If mankind knew what marriage is, it would have at one and the same time an extraordinary desire for it and a tremendous fear of it; for by means of it man could once again be made like God or could end in total ruin.

Pace Evola, we believe Saint-Martin understood perfectly well what he wrote, but that is a topic for another time.

Posted on 2012-04-03 by Cologero

* * *

apeiron on 2012-04-05 at 19:29 said:

Leonidas picked the famous 300 Spartans on the predicament that they had a "son of duty" to their name. So some of the most celebrated heroic band of solar men in Western history, procreated. Today, the act of familial procreation is seen as a bourgeois "facist" institution by the left and as "judaic familial values" from the "new-right". How is this a healthy or even functional view of our ancestral destiny if this is the layman's view and not that of an exceptional and vocational spiritual type?

I believe Evola also deliberately confuses the old testament quote of "go forth and multiply" to the lower type of materialist man. In saying this however, we're left with the beings of sacrifice, the celibate saints, priests, holy-men and mystics who actively chose the sterile life to center their energies entirely towards god/godhood. What are we to make of that tradition (even though Evola actively chose not to be traditional as demonstrated on this site) ?

Angolmois on 2012-04-11 at 05:44 said:

Marriage and children is a university / school of spirit, as the ancients knew it. For many people it would be a very good school to learn essentials of spiritual and religious life, such as (self-)sacrifice, commitment, focusing of sexual and erotic energies (for the wellbeing and integrity of one's own constitution), and so on.

There's is nothing inherently bourgeois in family life and having / raising children, but I do understand why spiritually inclined people don't marry and / or have children; especially in this age of decline and anti-tradition family – society, civilization at large – is not what it was in the past, and it can be both a spiritual and a practical, financial burden because of reasons too many to even mention in a short comment; our crumbling civilization does everything in its power to kick people with children and healthy family values to the drain. Of course there's always the possibility of keeping the flame of tradition (and bloodline) alive in one's own part, but is this the best way to do this, and not just the most wishful thinking that one can engage in?

This is why I understand Evola's views about marriage and children very well. It should also always be remembered what Evola meant by his words and writings, and to whom they were first and foremost aimed at: for men, warriors and sages of tradition.

I believe Männerbunds were not homosexual in nature – they were a-sexual – beyond sex.

If someone discards the bible as a whole on the basis of "semitic values", they certainly have not read their New Testament through.

Cologero on 2012-04-11 at 07:42 said:

I wish I could accept that, Angolmois, but this shows Evola's naïveté. First of all, he was no warrior and no sage. Granted there may be some men who choose an ascetic path early in life, but in the normal course of things, that choice is made after having fulfilled one's duties. In ancient Greece, the indomitable phalanx was manned by father and son, uncle and nephew, fighting beside each other, not by celibate warriors.

Despite all his talk about loyalty, fidelity, and authority, Evola committed himself to nothing; not to his own nation, not to his leader, not to any specific Tradition. He unfairly criticized the great philosopher Giovanni Gentile who, unlike Evola, did not philosophize in a vacuum. He raised a family, had a worldwide reputation as a philosopher, and participated in forming the Italian government, specifically in the reform of education (something Evola only talked about).

When the Nazis kidnapped Mussolini and formed the ill-fated Salò Republic, Gentile followed him, although he had nothing to gain; the Allies would have treated him gently. Against the advice of his family, he understood what loyalty meant. After the war, Gentile was gunned down in the streets of Florence by Communist partisans. Meanwhile, Evola remained behind in

the safety of Rome. When the allies came looking for him, his mother helped sneak him off to Austria. Try to convince me who was the real man.

He advocated birth control for the women to be abused by the Mannerbund. Where did he expect them to come from, if a woman was under the protection of fathers, brothers, and then husbands? Apparently, from the Bohemians, or perhaps slaves from other nations and races. Apparently, he couldn't conceive that birth control used in that way led to the feminism he decried. Paradoxically, it also gave every Western man the same privileges with women that he would have reserved to the mannerbund.

The final effect of Evola's anti-family tirade is that it has brought some unsavoury figures into the sphere of Tradition, the sort of male that would never have been allowed in Traditional leadership.

Angolmois on 2012-04-12 at 04:08 said:

You are right about many things, Cologero. I if anyone do not look well many Evola's views about women, which were quite harsh, dangerous and abusive. He certainly was "too solar" in his emphasis, and this shows everywhere in his thinking and in even in his fate.

Sparrow on 2015-04-06 at 00:40 said:

While your criticism of Evola is harsh, I can't help but find myself in full agreement, Cologero. A lot of these same observations came to me when reading his works, before finding Gornahoor. Despite his intelligence, or possibly because of it, Evola lacked good sense, and could be an incredibly argumentative, hypocritical, and selfish person. His sexist views on women (I don't mean "sexist" in the liberal sense, where acknowledging difference between the sexes and supporting gender roles makes one a "misogynist.") seemed ironic to me, considering it was certainly not to his detriment that his mother distracted Allied agents long enough for him to sneak out the door. He couldn't be pleased no matter what anyone said or did (e.g he didn't hesitate to mockingly criticize Guenon).

It is incredibly pedantic of me, but I feel the need to point out that Gentile was not killed after the war. He was killed in 1944. Ironically, he had been arguing for the release of anti-fascists (guess that's like petting a rabid dog, only for it to bite your arm off). Goes to show what happens when you attempt to show compassion to those of the Leftist persuasion.

Bharat Khant. Vedic civilization

3.1 The Great Migration

Due to the cooling of the arctic region, the Boreans were compelled to migrate southward. This probably accounts for the legends of wars against the Meridionals. **B. G. Tilak**, in his book *The Arctic Home of the Vedas* estimated this to have occurred around 8000 to 5000 BC.

Vedas Tilak bases his theory on the internal evidence of the Vedas, the sacred books of Hinduism. In particular, Tilak noticed in them astronomical phenomena that are compatible with life in the Arctic. There are four Vedas written as long poems in an archaic form of Sanskrit; they are considered to be revealed scripture, and all orthodox systems of Hindu philosophy are based on them, or the Upanishads, an extension to the Vedas. Tilak considers their origin to be beyond time, hence he traces it to the Hyperboreans. Tilak writes:

There is no reason to doubt either the competency or the trustworthiness of the Vedic bards to execute what they considered to

be their sacred task or duty, viz., that of preserving and transmitting, for the benefit of future generations, the religious knowledge they had inherited from their forefathers. ... what is achieved in more recent times can certainly be held to have been done by the older bards in times when the traditions about the Arctic home and religion were still fresh in their mind.

Poetic Consciousness As was previously mentioned, caste structure was being established during this period. The tradition embodied in the Vedas was entrusted to the Rishis, which means “seer”. The rishis were still able to remain in direct communion with the supernatural. Tilak writes:

We may safely assert that the religion of the primeval Arctic home was correctly preserved in the form of traditions by the disciplined memory of the Rishis.

Nevertheless, the lower castes still retained features of the Primordial State. In particular, their consciousness was still motivated by poetry, rhythm, and command, rather than discursive thought. This left them with the power of concentration and great energy, since they were free of the energy-sapping phenomena of boredom, anxiety, daydreaming, and so on. Tilak explains:

The hymns were public sung and recited and the whole community, which must be supposed to have been interested in preserving its ancient religious rites and worship, must have keenly watched the utterances of these Rishis.

Now these recitals would have gone on for hours, if not days during certain festivals. Besides the Vedas, there would have been legends and myths, some of which were probably adapted to the Mahabharata and Ramayana. Vedic Sanskrit was a syntactically complex and semantically

rich language; because of its difficulty, it is accessible in the West only to a small pool of the highly intelligent and educated. Yet, during the Vedic era, the masses were in rapt attention to these recitals.

We can see the decline in later periods. The Cistercian monks chant 30 psalms per day, completing the cycle of all 150 psalms in 5 days. St Bernard said that was in concession to human weakness, since all 150 psalms should be chanted every day.

Shakespearean plays were intended for popular audiences, yet only high-brows will pay to see one today. Even as late as 19th century England, certain poets were “rock stars”; people would wait in anticipation for a new poem from Tennyson.

In our time, the closest we have is a rock festival. Yet, sensory overload in the form of sex, drugs, loud noise and light shows are required to hold the attention of an audience. Even at that, the appeal is always to animalistic and emotional states, not to awaken higher intellectual states as in the Vedic recitals.

The Warrior Caste Nevertheless, as time goes by, the issue of castes is altering consciousness. Herman separated the venerable men and selected the warriors. For this system to persist, the question of the membership in the castes would arise again. In better times, when men were free of personal ambition and were in organic relationships, the question did not arise. Over time, the rishis were no longer seers, but became mere scribes, repeating the old hymns and texts by rote.

In the Mahabharata, the problem of membership in the warrior caste is revealed. **Ekalavya** was a man of low caste who, nevertheless, trained himself to be the best archer in the land. When he approached the martial arts teacher, Drona, about being admitted to his ashram, Drona ordered him to cut off his thumb. Of course, without his thumb, Ekalavya could no longer draw his bow. Another element is that Ekalavya was of mixed race, which was probably the reason he was excluded.

Thus we come to the end of the second age.

Posted on 2011-01-13 by Cologero

* * *

kadambari on 2011-01-14 at 09:10 said:

"Another element is that Ekalavya was of mixed race, which was probably the reason he was excluded."

Western interpretations of Ekalavya are interestesting. He was not accepted because he was not a Kshatriya. Other characters in the Maharbharata are also rejected, for example, Karna, is of divine origin in the story, but has been raised adopted by a charioteer, so he is unable to duel with Arjuna which is reserved only for Kshatriyas. No one mentions his race really, but humble background as they think he is the son of the charioteer when he is not.

Eklavya probably came from those tribes that had not been Sanskritized. It is not so much as being of "mixed" race, but of not being of a clan which recognizes the Vedic rites and culture. The story proves that men can be human and flawed and it is Ekalavya who is the hero at the end, and Drona appears mean minded. The fact that they wrote about these things even back then shows that people were aware that caste can be problematic in some instances in excluding worthy people.

Draupadi the wife of the Pandavas is known to be extremely dark skinned so her name is Krsna which means dark, and Krishna is often represented as black. So there are exceptions. Also tribals being people who are not a part of the Vedic clan and do not follow Vedic culture, could be of all colors and variety as Hindu culture encompassed a great area back then.

For example, the royal clan of Rajputs who are known to be handsome were tribals initially and outside Vedic culture, and not original Kshatriyas. They seize power and draw up geneologies for themselves as descending from the original Kshatriyas... So these things are not as simple as people seem to think...

kadambari on 2011-01-14 at 09:47 said:

Also I forgot to add that Tilak was a Hindu nationalist and not a scholar. It was not uncommon for Hindus to just accept what was fashionable amongst the indologists back then. Many more things are known today than in his time as a result of scholarship...

One interesting thing is the people of Kailash. People think that they are the remnants of Alexander. They are not. They are remnants of the original Vedic pagans who were not Sanskritized. There were many such people in Afghanistan, tribals who were not Sanskritized, but these people were forcibly converted to Islam as recent as in the 1800's. However, in Afghanistan, the

Hindu royal clans and ethnicity were completely wiped out and the people today are descended from Turko-Mongols and other people from the Middle East, and are not of the same lineage as when Afghanistan was Hindu. Draupadi the princess in the Mahabharata is known to be from Gandahar (modern day Afghanistan). So was Panini who wrote Sanskrit Grammar. Back then, Afghanistan was a part of greater Kashmir.

kadambari on 2011-01-14 at 13:14 said:

"3.Kadambari: I have understood that Krishna's name "black" is a title which refers to the fact that he represents the unmanifested Self as Arjuna refers to the empirical ego-self. Your interpretation of them seems to be largely historical, am I right?"

I understand that. I am not saying that Draupadi was black, but simply that she is known to be very dark in the Vedas. So all these things were not as strict as one thinks, its not as if people liked only blondes and so on. Obviously in North India in those times from where our culture arises, people were generally fair and sharp featured, but color is more complex than what we understand it in modern times. For instance, it used to be common for Kashmiris to be grey eyed red haired, but no one thinks they are superior just because they are fair and so on. This is what I am saying. I think the idea was to have the Vedic clan values. Many fair peoples in those areas were also tribals and were not Sanskritized, such as the remnants of people in the Kailash who still worship Pagan gods, these people would not be accepted simply because they are fair and so on. I am sure Sanskritization of various ethnic groups took place over a large period of time.

I recently came across people from Andhra. They are black but incredibly educated and gentle people, quite unlike what one associates with blackness in the West, with stable families and values.

Also regarding those simple remnants of tribals that got converted into Islam in Afghanistan in the late 1800, I feel their fate would have been much better if they had come under the Hindu fold gradually.

As for Dalits and so on, as I said, people had come up with religions that gradually tried to absorb these people without destroying the traditional structure such as Buddhism. Unfortunately, after the Islamic invasions, Hindus do not have time to think of their fellows and become incredibly orthodox, this was a means of survival. One has to understand that the destruction that took place is so unsettling and massive, it is hard for a culture to reassert itself in this kind of circumstance. I think classical civilization survived in the South until the sixteen century before the destruction of the Vijayanagar empire, which is why people from the South even though they are dark can be very superior as they have those values left. The north is barbaric because of Islamic influence and destruction. We say all the thug values came into India from the Middle East.

kadambari on 2011-01-14 at 13:44 said:

@Ismo

Also what I mean by Sanskritization is shown by the Rajputs who were famous for their beauty and chivalry. They were tribals who became Sanskritized fairly late in Indian history, they are not the Vedic Kshatriyas, although they claim their lineage to be, they were no less brave. Kind of like what Goethe said about Shakespeare's Julius Caesar, "They are all thoroughly Englishmen but the Roman toga suits them well...". Rajputs would fight to the last man and when they knew they would be defeated, their wives and children would commit suicide and embrace sandalwood flames they would go into battle with the ashes of their cremated family on their foreheads. Later they become corrupted and gradually give in and begin to give their daughters to Muslims rulers as they cannot expel them but not all Rajput clans do so. They were always brave, but their weakness was that they quarreled amongst themselves instead of uniting in the face of the enemy.

But then most of India's aristocratic classes were exterminated or converted during the invasions.

But still you have to understand that when Islam overran most of Asia, it was not able to convert the Hindus so easily. And today a vast Islamic population is still a hindrance to India's growth by virtue of the fact that the culture is regressive and does not assimilate to the majority like other groups.

kadambari on 2011-01-14 at 16:57 said:

Ismo,

I know that this is out of context, but I could not believe it that 100,000 British have converted to Islam so far, most of them women. Recently I read an article in the Times that thousands of British girls were being sold into the sex trade by some Islamic gang. And Tony Blair's sister in law is said to have converted and wears a scarf. Seriously, what is wrong with these folks?

As for tribals in Afghanistan I was talking about, the place is Nuristan, formerly called Kaffirstan, land of the infidels! There were still some tall blue eyed pagan non Hindu Afghans till the late 1800's but they all got converted to Islam. I really feel sorry for some Afghans I see on TV. Many of them just seem simple hill people who ended up brutalized by the wrong religion!

kadambari on 2011-01-14 at 19:52 said:

Ismo,

Even the Dravidian Hindu city of Vijayanagar was so magnificent existing as late as the sixteenth century, it was completely destroyed by a force of Muslim rulers surrounding it, and rendered uninhabitable, today one sees only the ruins, and even those are impressive. This

marked the end of classical civilization in the South. On the glory of Vijayanagar, a Portuguese traveller writes: "The city is as large as Rome and very beautiful. It is the best provided city in the world."

When one sees the ugly cities in India today overcrowded and unplanned, it is quite hard to believe that cities like this existed not too long ago...

kadambari on 2011-01-15 at 11:39 said:

Ismo,

I mentioned the Dravidian city of Vijayanagar because it was the last Hindu stronghold and a great city. Real Hindus are a tiny minority in India today, that is, Hindus who understand their civilization. Vijayanagar was a Dravidian city, but it was based on classical Hindu ideals of hierarchy and so on, that is, the role of Kingship and priesthood is that which is defined by classical Indian civilization. This shows that the "idea" can have different manifestations in different contexts.

Also, it is worth noting that Eklavya is a hero in the story not because he tries to destroy the Drona's order because it is unfair to him, but he shows that he is fit for it, by exemplifying its ideals to the fullest. He is said to meditate on Drona, that is, internalize the ideals which Drona represents, which is what makes him what he is.

Also of interest is the student teacher relationship that is exemplified in the story. Eklavya still considers Drona his teacher (Guru). Now the Guru in the traditional sense is held in the highest regard. He taught his students free of charge and at the end before the students would depart, they would give a gift to the teacher which is voluntary called "Guru-dakshina". There are interesting legends about how students would value their teacher to such an extent that they would be ready to give anything to the teacher in exchange for the knowledge he imparts, and Kings lose entire kingdoms in the Mahabharata as they wish to keep the word to the Guru and give him what he demands... Now it is in this context that Eklavya gives his thumb as "Guru-dakshina" as Drona asks for it and he has told Drona that he will give him whatever he desires. It is interesting that in these legends, importance is given to keeping one's word, no matter what difficulties it causes. Truthfulness is valued, there are tales of heroes who never tell a lie and so on. The Mahabharata is full of hundreds of tales, and is to Hindus what the Iliad and Odyssey was to the Greeks.

At the end, if anything, the tale of Eklavya shows that Drona's action was unjust, and that Eklavya is noble. Even Drona ultimately repents for his sin (asking for Eklavya's thumb).

Will on 2011-01-16 at 12:09 said:

I am very unfamiliar with the Mahabharata, but I have heard this story before. It seems to me that, like myths in general, it is subject to multiple levels of interpretation, depending on

who is being taught, or what is being taught, and perhaps also when someone is being taught, i.e. in what Age.

What strikes me is that Eklavya is absolutely certain that to be an archer is his destiny and that Drona is his guru, so much so that Drona's rejection of him doesn't change this at all. So then he makes a statue of Drona and relates to that as his guru, such that when he is asked where he learned to be an archer, he does not claim to be self-taught, but rather says that Drona taught him.

The guru is a personification of a higher power, because it's easier to relate to another human being than to the Absolute as such. But it seems that Eklavya, through exceptionally pure devotion, was able to connect with the higher aspect of his guru, even though outwardly he was rejected.

This is about the nature of devotion, sincerity, and perseverance. It's like the Buddhist story of the old woman who worships a dog's tooth, believing it to be a holy relic, and becomes enlightened. It's said that authentic devotion to a phony guru is better than half-assed devotion to a fully realized master. I don't know if Drona is supposed to be a phony guru or not, but from Eklavya's perspective, it doesn't matter, because his devotion is pure.

In the West, there is a lot of confusion and misunderstanding of the nature of the guru-disciple relationship, because we don't really have a corresponding relationship in our own sacred traditions. (Though there are traces of something similar among the ancient Greeks, such as the story of Plotinus and his master.) And the fact that more than a few Easterners have taken advantage of our naivete on this matter doesn't help.

kadambari on 2011-01-16 at 13:45 said:

"I don't know if Drona is supposed to be a phony guru or not..."

The Mahabharats is amazing to read, although ten times the size of the Iliad and Odyssey. One never gets bored reading it though.

No Drona taught the princes the arts of war was was superior in his knowledge. The story just shows his human side, he also does not hesitate to favor his son, although he is not a Kshatriya, and shows other weaknesses. I suppose that these stories are interesting because they show the human character in all its forms, the strong aspects and the weak.

"It seems to me that, like myths in general, it is subject to multiple levels of interpretation, depending on who is being taught, or what is being taught, and perhaps also when someone is being taught, i.e. in what Age."

I do not think so, people have always been clear on the meaning of these stories, the glorification of a noble character is not hard to miss. The only times they are misintrepreted is when Brahmin haters use it to show that they were cruel in a one sided way, or to justify such actions today. Again the story just shows Drona's weakness, he is a great teacher, but he also has some human failings.

4.1 The Political Philosophy of Confucianism

OKAWA Shumei (1886-1957) was a Japanese religionist and class-A war criminal. In 1942, after the bombing of Pearl Harbor, he wrote an introduction to Islam and translated a book about the “perennial wisdom”. He was arrested by the Americans for his political leanings and faced certain execution. On the first day of the Tokyo Trials, upon entering the courtroom he yelled randomly in German and slapped Prime Minister Tojo on the head, and was shortly found to be insane. While in the mental hospital, he made the first Japanese translation of the Qu’ran.

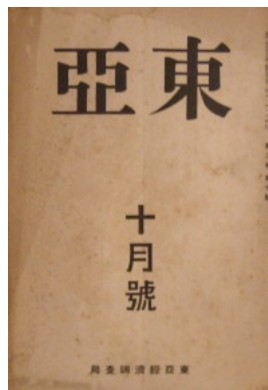
In this essay, which first appeared in the magazine *East Asia* in October 1930, Okawa advocates for a radical break with Western political thought by reviving and revitalizing Confucian order.

To aspire to Confucianism is without a doubt to make clear the Tao. And since the Tao is nothing if not a principle for individual life, Confucian-

ism is an attempt to expound how men might live a righteous life. Now, a righteous life is a principle that realizes the correct relation between what we call “I” and what we call “not I”. Confucianism divides what is “not I” into the Three Powers, Heaven, Earth, and Man. This is the Tao of Confucianism. To be precise, Confucianism is the principle that realizes the proper relations between Heaven, Earth, and Man. In China, the scholars considered least worthy were thought of as “lacking knowledge even of the Three Powers”. When the English poet Wordsworth versifies on the necessity of holding a proper idea of God, Nature, and Man, it corresponds to this precisely.

Now, Confucianism teaches that he who accords to Nature knoweth the Way. Mencius says that “you must possess the five virtues yourself and extinguish your selfish nature”, and this means the same thing. The autonomy of morality, which Kant outlined so carefully with his utterly precise logic, was not a unique discovery of the German philosophers. The Confucians rapidly grasped this truth based on their depth of experience. For example, Mencius’ Four Sprouts are none other than a study of the foundations of human morality. What he calls a “Sprout” is a “natural foundation” from which morality can be grown. And so, in Confucianism, to work for ethical completeness is called development, or self-growth, or self-discipline. This capacity is inherent in oneself—he who possesses infinite possibilities for future action must start with an education in what is good. Therefore, the Tao as it pertains to Heaven, Earth, and Man first and foremost is something that should be realized through growing the natural foundations of morality in the self.

What is Heaven? Heaven is the origin of our existence. Most directly,



this is our parents, and above them is our kin and ancestors. The origin of our ancestors is in the race, and the origin of that is in the universe. The correct relation to hold towards Heaven, that is to say, "religion", is called in Confucianism Honor. This means growing and refining our essential human feelings of reverence and respect.

What is Earth? It is Nature as regarded by the mind. The most personal encounter we have with this is through our physical bodies, as well as the accompanying feelings of desire in our minds, as well as the external changes that these desires demand. The correct relation to hold towards Earth, meaning first the establishment of control over one's mind with regards to nature, and second the unification of one's attitudes, which may narrowly be called "morality", is called in Confucianism Right. This means disciplining and training the essential human sense of shame, so that we will face towards Heaven unashamed and have good expectations for our life on Earth.

What is Man? Men are the individuals of good character whom you value equally with yourself. A well-bred man reasons with logic and acts with morality. Using logic, he understands the limitless possibilities of the complete knowledge of the universe, and thus is endowed with infinite possibility to realize in our lives, according to our intentions, the meaning of all things that it is possible to know. This personal limitlessness is called in Confucianism "natural intellect, natural ability". Therefore, the proper relationship towards Man is to constantly develop the capacities of our natural intellect and ability, to our mutual benefit. Saying that this is realized through a purification of our natural tendency for sympathy and sentiment, Confucianism calls this Virtue. However, the collective effort to develop many intellects and abilities according to the parts of each and every life of many human beings in community is usually called politics. That is to say, the term politics is nothing other than an attempt to objectivize, or systematize Virtue.

Confucianism is therefore a Tradition that clarifies the three inter-

ests of religion, morality, and politics. Rather than breaking up these three ideas into separate fields of specialization, it understands them to interoperate as a single whole, and endeavors to elucidate the “Tao” as a principle for all human life which contains all three. This is a point which has caused much outside confusion about the nature of Confucianism. One [Western Orientalist] will claim that Confucianism is a moral teaching, another will claim it chiefly conveys information about government, while still another lists it among the world’s religions, but all their interpretation began from this source. For example, one Prof. Douglas calls Confucius’ teaching nothing more than “a plain, matter-of-fact system of morality”. But Confucianism is not a religion in the Western conception of the thing, nor is it ethics or political science. Confucianism is not a single one of those, but is indeed all of them at once. Recognizing this as an internal structure, we can resolve the external confusion: this is a Tradition which we will understand nothing of from a Western perspective.¹

Here, **OKAWA Shumei** begins to make his departure from the basic principles of Western political thought obvious, deploying a slightly Hobbesian character from the 3rd century B.C., and demonstrating his Confucian orthodoxy. It is interesting to consider this contrast of rules vs. rulers in the modern cases of businesses, schools, etc.

The political thought of Confucianism is built on top of this fundamental spirit. Accordingly, most orthodox Confucianists could not be made to target politics as a thing standing alone and separated from religion and morality. The personal training for politicians, given names like “study of ethical use of authority” and “way to a virtuous nation”, was never a

¹A postwar revision, and further thoughts on the concept of “religion”, can be found on my website: <http://avery.morrow.name/blog/2013/02/the-tao-of-the-east-and-the-last-samurais-testament/>

thing separated [from the basic texts and principles]. According to Confucianism, as politics is the embodiment or systematization of Virtue, so the most essential basic requirement of the politician is to amass much virtue in their hearts. So most Confucian political works are expositions of knowledge intended for the ruler or politician. That is, to explain to the ruler the correct attitude for his heart, and how to attain virtue and compassion in his heart, is the basic method of Confucian political science.

For example, the Han *Treatise on Punishment and Law* states, “An ancient saying has it that even if the whole room has been eating and drinking, if there is one person crying to herself in the corner, no one in the room can enjoy themselves. And for a ruler, just like the case of that room, if even one person in his realm is treated unfairly, one’s heart takes pity.” An edict of Emperor Zhang of Han states, “The sovereign must treat the people as if he were their father or mother, answering hardships with love, teaching loyalty and virtue, and administering appropriate punishment.” Throughout the *Shi Jing*, the ruler is portrayed as the mother or father of the people.

Indeed, as a consequence of understanding politics as the embodiment of Virtue in this way, the political ideal of Confucianism can be summarized in a phrase as “domestic tranquility”. Domestic tranquility means that for all of the people that exist in a nation, throughout their lives, negatively speaking they meet with no obstacle, or positively speaking, they are able to fulfill their respective functions. Nevertheless, regardless of the institution or organization, the expectation of true domestic tranquility does not mean that it is rigidly enclosed by [bureaucratic] considerations. At the top of Xunzi’s thesis on sovereignty, he uses the phrase, “**Rulers, Not Rules**”. And this phrase is the single clearest declaration of Confucian philosophy as it relates to systems and organizations, meaning that the aim of politics is not the *rules*, but the *character of the politicians*. Indeed, Xunzi’s full statement is as follows:

Not a country in disorder, but a leader in disorder; not rules of order, but rulers in order. The methods of the archer Yi are not lost, yet such an archer does not appear generation after generation. The laws of King Yu of Xia still exist, yet the Xia could not continue their rule. Thus, laws cannot stand alone. Categories cannot apply themselves. If there are good men then the nation will survive. If there are no good men then it will be lost. Laws are the sprouts of order, and the man of virtue is the field in which that order grows. If men were virtuous enough we could even do without laws, but if no man is virtuous, no laws will suffice to save us, and we will fall into disorder. One who can simply count off the laws without knowing the Right behind them, no matter how learned you might call him, if he is given authority disorder will result. Therefore, a good king goes swiftly in search of good men, while a bad king seeks out power.

You ask how to rule a nation. You should first ask how to discipline yourself, before you can run a nation. The sovereign rules, and with his right rule comes right views. The sovereign is a bathtub, and his people are like the water. Water follows the shape of the tub. If he is a round tub, they will be round, and if he is a square tub, they will be square. It does not matter if it is the sovereign's edicts or his mere whims. King Zhuang of Chu preferred slender bodies, so there was starvation at court. If you must ask how to discipline yourself, you do not yet know how to rule your nation.

Mencius means the same thing when he says frankly that "without men of virtue, there can be no rule", and a famous chapter from Confucius' *Doctrine of the Mean* goes, "The government of Wen and Wu is recorded on tablets. Let there be such men and the government will thrive; but without such men, the government decays. With men who heed the Tao, government flourishes, just as agriculture flourishes when the Tao of the Earth is heeded; indeed, government matures just as reeds

shoot forth from the soil," expressing the same idea.

The theory being expounded in *Doctrine of the Mean* is as follows. An ideal government existed in the time of Kings Wen and Wu, which can be verified through various documents. People like them can govern splendidly, but without people like them, good governments can crumble. If good people are promoted to government, it is like plants growing from rich soil, and the results will come quickly. The rise and fall of individual politicians has immediate consequences in politics, just as a sudden change in soil quality has an immediate influence on the plant. Regardless of political system, our politics depends on the character of the people in it. And the type of people who will be appointed depends solely on the character of the ruler. Moral principles must be protected to establish good character. And virtuous love must be cultivated to possess those moral principles.

Translation notes: The term "man of virtue" means an educated elite, and is similar to how Julius Evola employs the term "Aryan".

The Confucius translation is adopted from several English sources, rather than Okawa's incomprehensible late medieval transliteration (which he re-translates in the next paragraph). The first fourth of the Xunzi translation, about the archers and the Xia, is derived from Kurtis Hagen, *The Philosophy of Xunzi*, Open Court Press, 2007. The rest is original and somewhat loose, but I swear to God he really does say the sovereign is like a bathtub.

Now, **OKAWA Shumei** takes out the big guns, attacking the founder of Legalism as impeding the cultivation of virtue, and by implication Western political theories which aim for the same legalistic goal. What the reader might not realize is that in denouncing Han Fei, who lived in the 3rd century B.C. and had an influence on all Far Eastern political thought thereafter, Okawa is

arguing for a return to a very ancient ideal indeed. When a group of ultra-nationalists tried to overthrow the constitutional monarchy of Japan in the name of direct Imperial rule, Okawa was sent to prison for five years for providing the theoretical principles for such a political concept.

This concept, the greatest conceivable system to realize human ideals in an actual nation, comes into obvious opposition with the political philosophy of the West, which attempts to induce people to march automatically, so to speak, towards progress and perfection. Western political thought, in the words of Xunzi, has “rules, but no rulers”; that is to say, it values creating good “laws” over creating good “men”. Even in China, some sages like Shen Dao, Yin Wen, and Han Fei value law over men in their writings. Han Fei, especially, fiercely attacks the idea of “rulers without rules” in one of the chapters of his book, and devotes himself to organizational structure. What he claims is that waiting for a man of virtue to appear is like a hungry man refusing to eat for a fortnight while he waits for a prime rib to arrive; the poor soul will simply starve to death.

His argument goes like this: Even with a total disinterest in organizational structure, a nation can be ruled by the likes of an Emperor Yao. And even with the finest organizational structure, a nation ruled by a tyrant would quickly dissolve into chaos. But a great Emperor Yao or a tyrannical King Jie will appear only once in a thousand years. Most rulers are neither Yao nor Jie. To create a nation that can be ruled by ordinary rulers, we must create the appropriate institutions. Creating people rather than rules creates a nation that can only be ruled once in a millennia, while creating rules for people will make a nation that is only disrupted once in a millennia.

Han Fei declares this to be a truth that is difficult to deny, and indeed, if we place our faith completely in the personality of a ruler, the result will be as Han Fei describes. But in Confucianism, even if there have been some who put an undue emphasis on it, there has been no one

who disputes the meaning and value of “laws”. Actually, in the *Doctrine of the Mean*, the three major functions of the ruler are piety, governance, and intellect. Piety implies both religious courtesies and moral customs, while governance means legal and political systems, and intellect refers to literacy. Without grasping the aforementioned three things, one cannot be a ruler in either name or reality. Even the most earnest abstract desire for a “domestic tranquility”, without institutions in place to ensure true domestic tranquility, we would not expect anyone to call someone a real politician. Mencius says, “Mere good intentions do not build a government, nor do mere laws.” The “mere” here means subjective, or abstract. Confucianism, therefore, does not at all ignore structure, but recognizes that spiritual development must be esteemed over mere structure.

The success of all systems is, without a doubt, the result of a success of the human spirit. Therefore the true meaning of a structure cannot be grasped by the people who join into that structure if they lack a spiritual foundation. It becomes accordingly difficult to maintain it effectively. A genius who knows all 3,000 rules of etiquette and 300 marks of majesty, if he fails to grasp the true meaning of piety, will simply fall into useless, machine-like imitations. And in order to grasp the true meaning of piety, we need true hearts and good faith. This is why Lu Jiuyuan said, “If we fail to overcome our own selfishness, it will be difficult for us to know virtue. And without a full knowledge of virtue, we will know not what rules and regulations are for.”

I continue directly into the conclusion. Hopefully all the readers of this blog will be quite gratified to see this independent manifestation of the Traditional principles.

Now, in Confucianism, there is a strong emphasis on “love for relatives”, or “veneration for noble deeds” as a principle for social life. In the *Doctrine of the Mean*, Confucius teaches: “The humanity of virtuous behavior is made evident in the case of love for relatives. The ability of

righteousness to set things straight is made evident when we honor noble men. The decreasing measures of the love due to relatives, and the steps in the honor due to the worthy, are produced by the principle of propriety." The implication of this passage is, approximately, as follows. Virtuous love binds people together, and its most striking manifestation is in our natural affection for our parents and kin. In contrast, justice is a type of discrimination. Its most striking manifestation is when we naturally hold some sense of respect towards noble men, that is to say, those whose moral values tower above all of us.

Nevertheless, we do not love all of our relatives equally. Even if the original source of virtuous love is an indiscriminate, equal substance, it is utterly unforgivable for its manifestation to be uniform in nature. Our reverence towards ethical exemplars, too, is of the same nature. In the manifestation of virtuous love and reverence, the attempts to confer a correct order are the grounds that generate the various forms and systems of social life. It is an indispensable condition for a Confucian social order that social inequalities are generated from a correct moral foundation.

Both love for relatives and veneration for noble deeds are called much more simply "filial piety" or "respect for the elders". One of the first statements in the *Analects* reads, "A youth should be filial at home, and, when abroad, respectful to his elders." The model for household life necessitates recognizing the position of parents, and each sibling among the children disposes of his "self" and faithfully works for the sake of his family and clan, continuously realizing an order of being. Honoring virtue, similarly, underlies the model for national life, and Confucius teaches that the exercise of authority both large and small necessitates a shared concept of virtue, which people must entrust to the statesmen, abandoning their "self" interests and faithfully obeying the authority of the state.

Therefore, the duties of the men of noble birth in China were not rule of the country—personal oversight as administrators—in the usual sense, but were actually the promotion of able men to wield authority in

roles both great and small. Therefore, it is said that “if we hasten to get the right men, the self is checked and the nation is put in order, the merits are great and one’s name is celebrated, and one is worthy of being called a sovereign. If we do not hasten to get the right men, but instead focus on getting the labor first, then people will work for their own purposes and divide the nation, merit is abandoned and one’s name is besmirched, and the very soil and grain of the nation will certainly be endangered. The worthy sovereign seeks out the men and, having found them, may rest.”

“If the people be led by laws, and uniformity sought to be given them by punishments, they will try to avoid the punishment, but have no sense of shame. If they be led by virtue, and uniformity sought to be given them by the rules of propriety, they will have the sense of shame, and moreover will become good.” This is a famous saying of the *Analects*, and a summary of the essential spirit of Confucian political philosophy. [...] And there is one point on which Confucianists and Legalists agree. Namely: what constitutes an upright citizen, in other words the attempt to forge a tempered and cultivated political individual, is a separate matter from the legal system, in other words the attempt to establish a systematized nation-state. Again, in other words, while Legalism insists on the strictly impartial nature of legislation, Confucianism remains the first principle at the root of litigation [because the goodness of a person is based in Confucian values].

In this way the political doctrine of Confucianism is generally not called one of constitutionalism, but is rather rite-ism, and the relation between laws and rites is perfectly encapsulated by Liang Qichao, who said that “laws treat the symptoms, but rites are preventative health.” According to Confucian political science, the sole foundation of good government is indeed cultivation of culture and learning: “right learning brings good customs, and good customs bring good government.”

The political thought of Confucianism, as clearly indicated by all the histories, was never implemented closely in China. The finest im-

plementation of it up until now was in our own nation's Tokugawa period. The shape of our nation in that era rivals and even exceeds that of China's Spring and Autumn period, showing that the political ability of the Japanese far outstrips that of Han Chinese. The China of the Spring and Autumn Period was not much different from the old shogunate in population, area, or feudal development. Accordingly, the political ideals of Confucius and Mencius, although meant for a united China, became much more relevant in our own country, and our political ability was not just a realization of those ideals but a superior realization to that of China.

Thus in the Tokugawa period, the ideal that made the sovereign parent to the nation became ingrained in the hearts of the provincial lords, and when one province achieved a temporary state of good leadership, other provinces felt a need to compete [as in sibling rivalry] and strained to achieve the same standard, creating a splendid government. That China later descended into pandemonium and confusion despite its cultivation of Confucianism is not due to any insufficiency in Confucianism itself, but the fault lies in the political incompetence of the Han.

The pointedness of this last paragraph lies in the fact that Okawa has just made use of brilliant reformists like Liang Qichao (1873-1929), but unlike their Japanese counterparts, the Chinese reformists failed to rebuild and modernize China.

All credit for the production of this translation lies with the Okawa Shumei Study Group which made these materials available. All fault for the numerous translation errors and misrepresentations lies with me.

Posted on 2013-02-21 by Avery Morrow

* * *

Lemonheadz on 2013-02-22 at 00:28 said:

Did Okawa have any contact with Guénon or his school of thought?

Avery Morrow on 2013-02-22 at 00:35 said:

Okawa unfortunately seems to have missed out on Guénon and his school. His leanings in that direction, though, are demonstrated by a book he translated for a man named Paul Antoine Richard, the husband of Sri Aurobindo's spiritual successor "The Mother". Richard's book is indistinguishable from Aldous Huxley's *The Perennial Philosophy* which was written 2 or 3 years later. After long conversations with Richard, Okawa became a big fan of Sri Aurobindo despite a lack of thorough reading into his philosophy.

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-22 at 17:58 said:

Honour also consists in admitting your sources. You don't learn from China and Korea and then take their women as your sex slaves and their men as forced labour. Japan behaved with great dishonour during WW2 and was punished by Heaven for it.

I strongly advise that in studying the Far Eastern form of the tradition, we should avoid the Japanese derivative forms and look to the roots in China and Korea....

For the record let me also say that the Koreans are a much stronger martial people than the Japs, they beat the French and Americans in the XIXth century and the Japs many times over the centuries, last time being WW2.

I am presently preparing to be initiated into a Korean order....

Avery Morrow on 2013-02-22 at 21:24 said:

I can't really comment on your principle that the truthfulness of a text can be judged by the circumstances its author lived in, nor that military defeat is a sign of martial strength, but I feel obliged to at least correct your inaccurate claim of "sex slavery"; not only was no slavery involved in Japan's military brothel system, but it was taken over by the Americans and used in the Korean War, and a similar system was set up by the Americans in Vietnam, purchasing women from impoverished Vietnamese families. Please see this academic summary of research into the subject.

Janus on 2013-02-23 at 17:37 said:

I must disagree here...the extent to which a woman in poverty can really be said to be "willing" in her prostitution is highly debatable. The amount of freedom she really had once in the hands of soldiers, Japanese or American, even more so.

Janus on 2013-02-23 at 17:42 said:

The tripartite division of Confucianism presented here is interesting, but does it not focus more on the cult of the ancestors than the cult to Divinity? Or is this Divinity contained in the "universe" which births the race, ancestors and parents?

The acknowledgement of Confucianism as an organic "living" practice, rather than just a philosophy is essential and something I am glad to see here. The western insistence on dividing learning, work, life, religion, and so on is a major sign of its degeneration. His comment on the western perspective is spot on, although I must agree with doubts expressed about using the Japanese rather than original Chinese perspective, particularly one coming from the Imperial era of the 20th century rather than pre-Meiji Ishin.

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-23 at 17:57 said:

It's a tricky matter. My grandfather was a rikuguntaisa in the Japanese army during the Greater East Asia War but after visiting Korea I feel as if I need to make penance for his misdeeds.

Avery Morrow on 2013-02-24 at 06:43 said:

This is too late at this point, but I'm sorry for my rather accusatory and grumpy comment. I thought about it a lot today, and I am certain my attitude stems directly from reading too many high-tempered Internet arguments.

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-28 at 21:53 said:

The author shows his racism by blaming the problems of China on racial defects and not on failures of character, failures that afflict men in all nation, and have made Japan a cultural and political colony of America since 1945.

In fact, China under the Qing dynasty was a quite stable and functional regime until the British imposed opium addiction on the Chinese people.

I see a contradiction in that the author praises Edo period Japan, which was a peaceful, feudal, and autarchical era yet he supported ultra-nationalism which was more like Fascism in supporting an expansionist centralised state under the dictatorial rule of the Mikado who was no longer the spiritual figurehead he was under the shogunate but an actual Bonaparte-type sovereign under this sytem (I'm thinking also of Ikkai Kitta)

Avery Morrow on 2013-02-28 at 22:01 said:

You forget that China was not the only East Asian nation struggling with Western interference; Japan was also thrown into crisis by Western temporal power, and its response was quite different from China, while its blazing fast modernization and militarization was due in large part to the efforts of Emperor Meiji himself.

Okawa witnessed the failure of both China and Korea to adapt in his own lifetime, and the near subjugation of both nations by the West; he has ample reason for his patriotic attitude. I

would wager that he is actually a more appealing figure than Evola, who discarded sentimental ties to family and nation.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-01 at 18:01 said:

Modernisation.....that's the problem.....in order to fight the West, Japan became a western power.

China and Korea failed, yes, though in the Korean case the failure is arguable as I can attest to the survival of Korean tradition through my own studies in that nation. But the failure is simply that of traditional falling to modern which is not a good thing in my book, as I'm a supporter of the old ways.

Asian patriotism like any patriotism is a good thing but not when it becomes a tool for colonialism – if Japan had led Asia against the West he'd have been heroic but instead the Japs decided to just enslave fellow Asians in Manchuria, Korea, and China.

PS – the US tried to open up Korea in 1866 the same way they did with Japan in 1853 but that time the Koreans won and the big noses came home dead.....

I prefer Evola's attitude of placing principles above false realities.....he saw the true state of his Italy and did not fail to expose it.....

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-01 at 18:44 said:

To try to drag the discussion back to the actual nature of this essay, I don't think Evola's political vision is that far from Okawa's, except that the situation in Italy ensured that Evola could never dream of implementing a Traditional government, whereas Okawa had many adepts hoping to do just that.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-01 at 23:13 said:

I hope I am discussing Okawa's essay here when I raise issue with the fact that he claims China never properly implemented Confucianism, I would like to know that if he is correct, then how would he describe the ruling ideology of the Chinese empire from the Han dynasty (200 BC) to the end of the Qing (1912 not counting its revival in Manchukuo, 1930s)?

The difference I am seeing between Okawa and Evola, correct me if I am in error, is that whereas Evola wanted the unification of Europe under a supranational Emperor that transcended nationalisms, Okawa believes Japanese nationalism can unify Asia under Japanese domination ?

Janus on 2013-03-02 at 00:31 said:

Fascinating piece, though I must too express my disappointment at his ease in asserting that there was some racial flaw in the Han which caused the decline in China, especially when he mentions periods in Chinese history when righteous rulers came to power.

I'm also glad to see that he discussed Legalism, the philosophy predominant in influence in China today, especially on the political stage, and that he can do so without quickly dismissing it. Political ideas and movements are revealed for what they are without men and women of quality making up the numbers: utopian ideals at most, and farces leading to tyranny at worst (see the Conservative revolutionaries, who allowed their ideas to be hijacked by those for whom Aryans were a mere biological race). It is essential to make good laws in the State, but even more to realize that they are there to craft good human beings. This is the most radical assertion one can make in the political and social realm, and a dangerous one which can lead to tyranny if there is no direct and positive correlation between position in the hierarchy and standard of character and accountability.

I heard two quotes in a performance of the Trial of Socrates which I think beautifully encapsulates the Confucian view in a democratic context: "In a democracy, you're only asked to do two things: obey the law, and try to change it if you think it's wrong." and "You accepted the constraints of the law every time you accepted our protection and did not speak in the Assembly in order to craft the best laws possible." Without good and just men, there is no good and just order.

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-02 at 05:09 said:

What was actually implemented from 200 BC to the 1930s was Legalism, which was argued in this essay to be a distortion of the original tradition. (In the same way that the Christian medieval world was a distortion of the Roman imperium? Maybe? Hmm.)

That's a great question. I honestly don't think Okawa had such a naively imperialist view, but his geopolitical analyses are yet on my to-read list, and if I translate anything else by him on Gornahoor I will mention what I learn.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-02 at 17:32 said:

@ Avery

It would be good to read more of Okawa's ideas, as the close relationship between geopolitics and tradition is something I feel Guenon and Evola did not see.....

It's very interesting, the subject of Legalism, I remember reading once someone tried to argue that Maoism is actually derivative of Han Fei Zi, it is true that to some degree Mao admired Qin Shi Huang, the persecutor of the Confucians.....

In a western context, do you think Plato is closer to Confucius or Han Fei ? The fact that he wrote a book of Laws seems to indicate P. thought he could legislate for a state beyond the capabilities of individual men ?

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-02 at 18:35 said:

Just as a particular example, I think Plato's belief in the communal upbringing of children puts him squarely on the side of a Legalist legislating morality. That's not to say this idea is horribly dangerous, since Israel's kibbutzim implemented something like it and did not end in disaster. Nor is Legalism anti-Traditional; the early modern period was full of such attempts to preserve exoteric manifestations by putting them into law.

But the Roman imperium was not characterized by a huge list of laws and a great bureaucracy maintaining them. People's instincts for things like raising their own families were considered to be basically good, and only needed cultivation through education. I think Okawa and Evola are both right to claim that in the "world of Tradition", Law is only expressed through obedience to the Principles, which are self-explanatory and within every human heart.

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-02 at 23:28 said:

One last note: if anyone would like to flesh out their knowledge of Xunzi I found a Ph.D. thesis which supports Okawa's thesis that Xunzi defended real Confucianism from Legalism, actually closely imitating the conclusion that Confucianism supports the concept of laws but Legalism turns this into an obsession.

<http://scholarspace.manoa.hawaii.edu/handle/10125/3023>

Excerpt: "While Confucian constructivism can support a theory of universal human rights, if it is to remain Confucian, it would not emphasize this because Confucianism perceives reasons not to foster a strong rights culture. Rights are viewed as legalistic mechanisms which, if over-emphasized, can erode informal mechanisms such as li (ritual propriety), the maintenance of which is considered critical to maintaining a healthy society. Citing several passages from the Xunzi, along with other Confucian texts, Ch'ii T'ung-Tsu concludes: 'Confucians firmly believed that ... The order or disorder of a state ... depends completely upon the maintenance or the decay of li' (Ch'u, p. 241). To the degree rights seem to undermine rites, they will likely continue to be resisted."

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-02 at 23:57 said:

Avery, so in your view one can be a Confucian or a Legalist and still be Traditional ?

Would you define the Torah or the Shariah as versions of Legalist thought ?

I wonder if the purpose of Confucianism and Legalism are for different ages, the age of Yao and Shun compared to our time from a Hindu perspective is different points and the cycle and different styles of governance perhaps may be required ?

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-03 at 00:24 said:

I would agree that Confucianism and Legalism are both Traditional and suited different ages, since this is grounded in historical fact as well. It's also obvious that rabbinic halakah did not exist when Israel was a kingdom (the Torah and Talmud are not solely legal texts). But

shariah just as clearly comes from the “seal of the Prophets” himself, befitting the 8th century AD.

This exchange has made me wonder much more seriously whether a “return to Confucianism” would approximate a Protestant desire for the simplicity of the earliest sources without the awareness that we are living in a degenerate age. Evola, of course, would disagree, and there are plenty of medieval texts that assert that Confucius takes primacy over his commentators, but I would like to see what Schuon says on the matter.

The Ancient City. Greek and Roman civilizations

5.1 Race and the Myth of the Origins of Rome I

This essay by **Julius Evola** was originally published in the journal *La Difesa della Razza*.

In the context of the recent series of posts, this can be understood as the “Noble Lie” about the birth of Rome. From the point of view of profane history, these myths are simply superstitions. Evola, on the other hand, drawing on Vico, Bachofen, Guenon, *inter alios*, views such symbols, myths, and legends as witnesses to the inner spirit of a people, which cannot be grasped simply in the accumulation of historical facts. Logically, this technique leads him to move beyond the merely physical and zoological understanding of race to the notion of the races of the soul and of the spirit. (This is a reformulation of the Rosicrucian notions of the folk soul and folk spirit.)

In this first part, Evola brings to light two aspects of the myth. First is the idea that the founder was born from the union of a

god with a mortal woman. The god confers spiritual qualities on the founder. In this case, Mars, as the god-father of Romulus and Remus, is the spirit of warrior virility, not just on the twins, but on the entire city.

The second aspect is being saved from the Tiber as infants. For Evola, this represents the hero, the seer, etc., men above the flow of time.

The defect in Evola's methodology is that he is left in the same position as the profane historian: the third person perspective. Although he sees more deeply, he is still an outsider and does not participate in the myth. So, yes, for him, too, it is a Noble Lie. For the Romans, Mars was a living being, not some abstract force, and the story of their miraculous rescue from the Tiber was considered history, not legend.

Although we can get some idea of the spirituality and mentality of the Romans from Evola's analysis, a scholarly discussion cannot lead us to that same state. For that, the method of Hermetic meditation described by **Valentin Tomberg** is much more helpful¹. This is a lesson for those hoping to establish a new regime somewhere, sometime: they must create a noble lie that is also a spiritual truth.

In his *Life of Romulus* (I,8), **Plutarch** writes:

Rome would not have risen to such power had it not had, in any way, a divine origin, such as to offer to the eyes of men something great and inexplicable.

Cicero repeats the same thing (Nat. Deor. II,3,8) and considered (Har. Resp., IX, 19) the Roman civilization as that which through sacred knowledge "surpassed every other people and nation": *omnes gentes nationesque*

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=898>

superavivums. Sallust called the ancient Romans *religiosissimi mortales* [the most religious mortals].

On the other hand, in our day all of that is fantasy or superstition for many “serious” persons and many “critical” minds. The “facts” are the only things that count for them. The mythical traditions of the ancients have no value, or they have it only insofar as it is supposed that, here and there, they are confused reflections of real events, that is to say, tangibly historical. There is, in that, a fundamental misunderstanding that was already denounced, to a certain degree by our **Giambattista Vico**, then by Schelling, still more recently by Bachofen and, finally, by the most recent school of the metaphysical interpretation of myth, and by those little known today (Guenon, W. R. Otto, Altheim, Kerenyi, etc.). According to all these writers, the mystical traditions are neither arbitrary creations more or less on the poetic and fantastic plane, nor deformations and transpositions of historical elements. Especially in regard to origins, it was correctly pointed out that symbols and legends,

if only in a dramatized form, represent actually and truly the history of the beginnings of a nation, but not the history of events occurring materially on earth, but rather of spiritual processes that have given birth to a new people alongside other people although different in culture and civilization: history, so to say, of its prenatal period.

Legend and history are tightly connected; the former proceeds through interiorization and is dispersed through images, while the latter proceeds through exteriorization as facts and events. These images are the result of formative living forces, facts are organized by the human thought. In legends one is transported by formative forces; in the other, there is premeditated organization of facts. But the legend is the invisible part and root of history; it is not poetry, rather it is a reality much vaster than history itself. The threads of the destiny of a people that unravel visibly in

the most various ways in their historical development, go back to the impulses, to the creative spheres, to which the heroes of its legends are connected.

In a particular way, **Bachofen** revealed that even at the point in which evidence, by being recognized as a myth, came to be rejected by profane history, even when it is a positive witness to the spirit of a people.

In that way, a study of mythical traditions, using new criteria, can lead us to interesting conclusions from the point of view of a theory of race that is not defined by the material aspects of the issues, but also addresses the inner reality of race.

On the occasion of the current anniversary of the Birth of Rome, we want to illustrate this interpretative method, applying it precisely to the exegesis of the myth of our origins. The legends related to the birth of Rome concentrate such a quantity of sensitive elements based on general meanings of civilizations and mythologies of Aryan peoples, that a special work would be necessary to analyze them and clarify them adequately. Therefore, we will point out here only the most notable themes, among which are: the miraculous birth, the theme of being “saved by the waters”, the “wolf”, the “tree”, the rival pair of twins.

The myth of the union of a god with a mortal woman, in the present case, of Mars with Rhea Silvia, from which union Romulus and Remus were born, recurs in almost all traditions in regard to the birth of “divine heroes”. Zeus and Leto gave birth to Apollo, Zeus and Alcmene to Hercules, Heracles being the symbolic hero of the Doric-Achaean Aryan peoples, and Apollo having a connection with the land of the Hyperboreans and with the primordial Nordic-Aryan races. An analogous origin, in properly Germanic traditions, is attributed to the heroic peoples of the Volsungs, to which Siegfried belongs.

In the ancient royal Egyptian tradition — whose remote origin can with good reason also be considered to be Aryan, Atlantic-Occidental — every sovereign is thought to have been begotten by a god uniting with

the queen: this tradition in which the hidden meaning of the myth comes to the fore, inasmuch as a miraculous birth without the help of a man, of a human father, was imagined. Since the queen had her consort, the idea that her son was conceived by a god, being awakened to life by her husband, could only indicate that he, not in his moral part, but so to say, in that eternal and “divinatory” part, had to be thought of as a type of incarnation of a decisive supernatural element that came to confer a royal dignity on him.

In the case of Rome, therefore, Mars is such an element from above, that is, the divine representation of the principle of warrior virility. Such a force stands therefore at the origins of the Eternal City and at the basis of its secret origin, veiled by the legend: so that in some traditions from the era of the Roman Republic itself, it will be directly conceived as the “son” of Mars. And this “Mars” force is associated with those who may be the guardians of the sacred flame of life; symbolically: with a vestal (Rhea Silvia).

The twins Romulus and Remus are abandoned to the waters and are saved from the waters. Here again is a symbolic theme recurring in many traditions: Moses is saved from the waters, the Indo-Aryan hero Karna is left in a basket in the river and is saved from the waters, and so on. But the symbol contained in the most ancient Aryan tradition is especially important, i.e., the Vedic tradition, in which ascetics are depicted as “supreme natures who stand on the waters”. Analogous explanations and, therefore, the hidden meaning of such a symbol, can be clarified as follows: the waters have traditionally always depicted the current of time, i.e., the basic element



of mortal, unstable, contingent, passionate, fleeting life. The weak man is taken from the waters and carried from the waters. The seer or hero, the ascetic or the prophet is saved from the waters, or is capable of standing on the waters, or of not sinking in the waters. Hence, in the myth of the origins of Rome this symbol must again characterize the “divine” element of the founders of Rome, their, so to speak, supernatural dignity.

This is the second and concluding part of the essay by Julius Evola on the race and origins of Rome.

He points out the symbolism of fig tree, which was also the tree associated with the Buddha’s awakening. The next symbol is the She-Wolf who suckles the twin babies. The wolf curiously has a dual symbolism: it can represent both the forces of light and the forces of darkness. This is often depicted as the battle between order, or Logos, with Chaos.

It is interesting to point out that the primal symbol of the wolf has been replaced in our time with the lap dog.

The spirit of Rome is exemplified by the manifestation “of a principle of light and of order, of an ethic and a vision of life that is witness to the Aryan spirit”. Here it is made clear that the Roman race is known through its spirit, not its genetics. So before constructing our Republic, it is necessary to describe that principle, ethic, and vision.

The twins find refuge near the fig tree [*Ficus Ruminalis*] and are suckled by a She-wolf. The word Ruminal contains the idea of feeding: the quality of Ruminus, related to Jupiter, alluded to the quality of “nourisher”, of the “god who gives nourishment” in the ancient Latin language. But this is the most elementary aspect of the symbol. In general, in the most ancient traditions of the Aryan races, the tree is the symbol of universal life, it is the tree of the world or the cosmic tree. If it is in form of a fig tree as it appears in the legend of Roman origins, precisely as a “*fico indico*”

[Banyan tree] — the ashwattha tree — it is depicted as upside-down in the Indo-Aryan tradition to express that its roots are from above, in the “heavens”. The idea of a mystical food from the tree is a often recurring theme: the myth of Jason, Hercules, Odin, Gilgamesh, etc. Naturally, according to the races and their spirit, this then presents diverse variations. We know from the Hebraic myth that to pick and eat from the tree in order to make oneself like god is considered as the principle of guilt, abuse of power, and a curse. Things are conceived in a very different way in the myths of the Aryan races and even in the paleo-Chaldean myth of Gilgamesh. Also, in the legends of the Ghibelline Middle Ages, the heroic theme prevails and the tree often appears as that of the universal empire, reaching it in the symbolic lands of the mysterious Prester John means insuring the same dignity that the ancient Ario-Iranian rulers associated with the title of “king of kings”.

Returning to our main subject, in the myth of the twins at the origins of Rome, we therefore have the allusion to a supernatural food from the Tree — but also from the She-wolf. The symbol of the She-wolf, considered in its entirety and in all the stories that refer to it, has an ambiguous character. Lucian and Emperor Julian recall that, in the ancient world, on the basis of the phonetic resemblance between the two words, the idea of the wolf [*lupo*] and of light [*luce*] are often associated: *lykos*, which in Greek means world, sound like *lyke*, light. But there are also figurations of the wolf as a hellish animal, as a dark force. The Wolf thus appears to us in the double aspect, symbol of a ferocious and savage nature and also as the symbol of a luminous nature. This duality is verifiable, not only in Hellenic-Mediterranean prehistory, but also in the Celtic and Nordic. In fact, on the one hand in the Nordic-Celtic and Delphic cults the “wolf” is connected to Apollo, i.e., to the Hyperborean, Nordic-Aryan god, simultaneously conceived as the solar god of the golden age and significantly associated by Virgil with Roman greatness. “Sons of the wolf”, on this basis, was a designation for warrior and heroic peoples of Nordic-Germanic

origins, designations that persisted even to the epoch of the Goths and Nibelungs. Yet, on the other hand, in the Edda, the “age of the Wolf” signifies a dark age, marking the epoch of the outbreak of savage and elementary forces, almost of the power of chaos, against the forces of the “divine heroes”, or Æsir.

Now we can certainly also relate this duality to the principle that, according to the legend of origins, “fed” the two twins insofar as we see it reflected in their very nature, that is, in the antagonistic duality of Romulus and Remus, as related to us in the myth. As others already noticed, so also the theme of a single principle from which an antithesis is differentiated, whether depicted by the antagonism of two brothers or twins or, in general, of a couple, is found again in many traditions, and not rarely in respect to particularly significant moments for the origins of a given civilization, race, or religion. For example, we only recall that in the ancient Egyptian tradition Osiris and Set are two brothers of discord — sometimes conceived as twins—and one incarnates the luminous power of the sun, the other, a dark, “infernal”, principle, whose generation is called the “sons of the impotent revolt”. Does not something similar also show through perhaps in the Roman legend? Romulus is the one who marks the contour of the city as the meaning of a sacred rite and a principle of *limit*—of order, of law—having received the right of putting his name to the city from the apparition of the solar number, of the *twelve* vultures. Remus is instead the one who violates such a limit and is killed for this reason. One could say that the primordial force of Roman origins thus are differentiated and destroys the “dark” powers that contained in themselves, affirms in its luminous aspect of order, Olympian domination, purified warrior force.

There have been attempts to see in the contrast between Romulus and Remus the reflection of the contrast between opposed Aryan racial forces, or of the Aryan type, and non-Aryan or pre-Aryan types. Research of this kind is without doubt interesting: problematic in its conclusions,

if it intends to remain exclusively on the plane of material facts, or archeological and anthropological evidence. It has greater possibilities if it also penetrates the myth and legend in order to extract elements that integrate research in other domains. Naturally, in order to accomplish that, it also needs to resolve to outline general frameworks of various aspects of ancient Roman society, considering, for example, with various writers, somewhat probable that the social system of castes of ancient Rome had a racial substrate.

In this totality, it is interesting to examine the link between the two principles, whose symbolic figurations could well be Romulus and Remus, with the two hills Palatine and Aventine. The Palatine is, as we know, Romulus' hill and the Aventine is Remus'. Now, according to the ancient Italic tradition, on the Palatine, Hercules met the good king Evander (who significantly founded a temple of the goddess Victoria on the same Palatine hill) after having killed Cacus, son of the Pelasgian (pre-Aryan) god of the subterranean fire: and Hercules conquered and killed in Cacus' cave, *located in the Aventine*, and erected an altar to the Olympic god, to whom he was allied according to the Hellenic myth. Researchers like Piganiol, are of the opinion that this duel between Hercules and Cacus — with the corresponding opposition of the Palatine and Aventine hills — could be a mythic transcription of the battle waged by peoples of opposing races.

The mythic legend of the origins of Rome is therefore saturated with deep meaning. The triumph of Romulus and the death of Remus is the key to the origin hidden in Romanity, and the first episode of a dramatic, outer and inner, spiritual, social and racial battle, in part known, in part still enclosed in symbols or in events not yet penetrated with respect to their most essential aspect, almost, we will say: with respect to the "third dimension". Through this secular battle Rome rises gradually and asserts itself in the world as triumphal manifestations of a principle of light and of order, of an ethic and a vision of life that, in its original and uncor-

rupted forms, is witness to the Aryan spirit. And we know what it is, according to the most widespread tradition, the conclusion of the legend of origins: it is the apotheosis of Romulus, Romulus deified,

“he returned from the earth to heaven after his mortal part was destroyed by means of the dazzling fire.”

So what has been treated is neither fantasy, nor poetry, nor rhetoric. Analogous explanations recur in the traditions of all peoples, according to a uniformity that should lead anyone to reflection. Also in regards to Romulus, the myth contains a faith and a spiritual certainty: it is the meaning of a reality that, freed from the person and symbol, was not once, but will always be, and will always be present, in its greatness beyond history, the race that knows how to recall the “mystery”.

Posted on 2014-12-08 by Aeneas

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Cologero on 2014-12-11 at 21:20 said:

Tomberg quotes Hans Leisegang:

Every myth expresses, in a form narrated for a particular case, an eternal idea which will be intuitively recognized by one who re-experiences the content of the myth.

This is what Evola is getting at. So, of course, the myth “contains” the eternal idea. Were it a simple reflection, then anyone could understand it. Rather, the idea is embedded, or hidden, in the myth, so it is discernible only to those who make the effort to re-experience it.

William Neville on 2014-12-13 at 01:51 said:

Thank you for these translations, Cologero – this is valuable material.

It hadn’t occurred to me before, but I wonder if Dante-specifically chose the She-Wolf as one of the beasts blocking the way out of the Dark Wood in the Divine Comedy as a reference to the She-Wolf in the story of Rome’s founding. It would be interesting to meditate on and investigate.

5.2 The Mystique of Race in Ancient Rome I

This essay by **Julius Evola**, which will appear in two parts, was originally published in the journal *La Difesa della Razza*.

By “race”, Evola means both something less and something more than is meant by the word today. “Less” in the sense that a race refers to any group of people of a common stock or lineage. “More” in the sense that he includes the transcendent, spiritual, and mystical aspect of race, not just biological or physiological characteristics. In this essay, he describes the mystical element of race in ancient Rome. A lineage was founded by a spiritual father, not necessarily the common biological ancestor; this father determined the cult, laws, and customs of his lineage.

Note on translation: I have left the words *lares*, *manes*, *penates*, *genius* (NOT a clever person), *gens*, and *gente* untranslated, following the model of *The Ancient City* by **Fustel de Coulanges**. The interested reader should consult that work for the proper definitions.

The literature on racial theory has not failed to emphasize everything that shows the importance attributed to lineage, people, origin, and ancestry in ancient Romanity at that time, and has also conducted research to recover the Aryan or Nordic-Aryan element and type in Romanity and to follow its destiny. Because of the predominant interests in modern racial theory and in the very nature of its development, this research is therefore almost always focused on the basically exterior and subordinate elements: thus it remains on the level of ancient law and custom, on certain aristocratic traditions, on the direct or indirect evidence in respect to a give physical type and, somewhat less often, is conveyed in the field of the most noted and widespread certain cults and myths. It is curious

that, as far as we know, it is instead almost systematically neglected a series of sources that, in regard to the higher aspects of the doctrine of race, present a special meaning and are richly documented. The reason for that is in the predominance of the prejudice—which we previously reported in this journal—to consider the whole of what in Roman antiquity had a super-rational and properly traditional character as fantasies, imaginations, superstitions, and finally, as something unserious and negligible. In this way a great part of the ancient Roman world still waits to be explored and this exploration, if conducted possessing the right principles and suitable qualification, is destined to yield valuable results, not just in regards to a spiritual and religious consciousness of the forces of the race.

The lares, penates, manes, genii familiari, the archeget heroes and so on are notions well known to anyone who has made even elementary studies of ancient Roman history. But known to what degree? Also, like the equivalents of dead and mute things that are conserved in museums, like the verbal residues of a world that is felt as foreign and “dead”, as much to leave us indifferent, at least, for whatever technical and academic reasons, they are not compelled to make special studies of sources and traditions, in place of mere culture, resulting in a worthy monograph. To integrate such signs, including pulling sufficient elements from them to make us understand the meaning and fundamental truths of ancient Roman and, in general, Ario-Mediterranean, humanity is a task that, with very rare exceptions, is not at all felt. However, even by this we understand the most precise and significant racial profession of the faith of ancient Rome, not a “philosophized” profession of faith restricted to any cultured circle, but alive and active in the most original, most widespread, most revered traditions.

The notions of lares, penates, genies, heroes, etc., are in good measure interdependent. In various ways, they all refer to the ancient Roman awareness of the mystical forces of blood and race, to the lineage, considered not only in its corporeal and biological aspects, but also in

its “metaphysical” and invisible, but not “transcendent”, aspects in the limited dualist meaning that has come to prevail for such terms. The single, atomic, deracinated individual does not exist. When he presumes to be a being in itself, he is deceived in the most pathetic way, because he cannot even name the last of the organic processes that condition his life and finite consciousness. The individual is part of a group, a folk, a *gente*. He is part of an organic unity, whose most immediate vehicle is blood, and is extended both in space and time. This unity is not “naturalistic”, is it not determined and called to life solely through natural, biological, and physiological processes. Such processes just constitute his exterior side, the necessary but not sufficient condition. There is a “life” of life, a mystical force of blood and folk. It subsists beyond the forces of the life of the individuals that are dissolved in it at death or that are given by it through new birth: it is therefore a *vitae mortisque locus* [a place of life and death]—a place that encompasses life and death and that for that very reason stands beyond both.

To maintain a living, continuous, and deep contact with this profound force of the race is the most direct and essential form of *pietas*, religiosity, the basis and condition of every other, the principle canons of family laws are its consequences and applications, even in relation to the earth, that it itself—as the notion of the *genius loci* shows—maintains mysterious and “mystical” relations with the blood and the original strength of the people or *gens* that possesses it and lives there. Looking toward the origins, there is the sense of a “mystery”—there is the myth both of beings having come from above, and of men who transcended humanity, to loosen their life from their person and to thus constitute it as the superindividual force of a folk, of a lineage, of an ancestry that will see its origin in it. Ideally, there is a contact and a perfect match of the individual with this power, to be able to signify through it the apotheosis, i.e., the conquest of the privilege of immortality, and to confer on it the right to be considered even a “son”—in a higher sense—of the being of

the lineage, if even a type of new manifestation of this being itself.

This is the essence of the mystical-racial creed of ancient Ario-Mediterranean and, particularly, Roman, humanity. The significance that it gives to the race as spirit, beyond that of the body, is an irrefutable fact and constitutes the base of the belief of the entities indicated and of the meticulous worship that was dedicated to them. We will put forward some evidence that will also be valid to highlight further aspects of the central ideas we succinctly exposed.

According to a noted work of Macrobius (Sat., III, 3) the lares for the Roman were “the gods that make us live: they nourish our body and govern our soul”. Naturally that must not be understood in an ingenuously literal way, but in reference to the mystery of the ultimate forces of our organism. As we pointed out, not one of the most important processes that are at the base of our organic and psychic-physical life depends directly on our power and is illuminated by our consciousness. Ancient man, while he was uninterested in the exterior, physical work of such processes, which are studied by modern positive sciences, instead focused all his attention on the forces that were presupposed by them and that precisely—in a higher and symbolic sense—“nourished” and “governed” our life. Macrobius’ testimony, among many others, is the most explicit in indicating that the ancient cults of lares, manes or penates were indeed related, above all, to such forces.

These moreover were brought back to a single origin in close relation with the idea of race.

The most ancient documents of the cult of the lares give us mainly their divinity to the individual and embodies it in the *lar familiaris* [the family spirit], the sole, but ideal, father, of a given race; this word, in reality, means not that he created materially the race at its origin as the forefather, but that he is the divine cause of its existence and duration.

SAGLIO, *Dict. Des Antiquités grecques and romaines*, III.

The *lar familiaris* was also called *familiae pater*, father or root of the family or of the *gens*, under this aspect identified with the *genius generis*, the genius [spirit] of a given lineage. Now the word *genius* was still meant more distinctly as the hidden and “divine” force that generates—*genius nominator qui me genuit*—the creator of a given race is *generis nostri parens*, the word *genius* already in itself is related to the words *geno*, *gigno*, i.e., to the idea of generating, that lies at the base of the same word *gens*, *gente* [folk]: here it is still a question for the real power that acts beyond physical generation, in the union of the sexes (*a gignendo genius appellatur*, Consorino, *de die nat.* 3), through which the nuptial bed has also the name of *lectus genialis* (bed of the folk) and every offense to the sacredness of aristocratic marriage and to the lineage was considered as a crime above all in the face of the *genius* of the lineage.

The ancient writers relate *genius* not only to the *geno*, *genere* (to generate), but also to the word *gero*, so that, by being etymologically inexact it is not less significant in relations of the idea that they had of the entity in word. This reconciliation in fact brings to light the conviction that the force constituting the mystical origin of a given lineage and the matrix of every generation, remains as a “presence” in the group corresponding and by way of principle governs, directs, and sustains the life of the individuals². Our language still has the word “*geniale*” [brilliant, inspired], but just to designate a rather different thing, also opposed to the most ancient conception. The “inspired” individual, as commonly meant, is more or less the one who invents, who has some “bright ideas”, on the rebellious, disordered, individualistic basis. In the ancient conception, geniality could be conceived only as a special inspiration or inspiration that the individual enjoyed not in that way, but essentially in relation to his race and blood, to the *genius*, to the divine element of his *gens* and the tradition of the *gens*.

²HARTUNG, *Die Religion der Römer*, I.

Posted on 2015-01-13 by Aeneas

* * *

scardanelli on 2015-01-14 at 10:24 said:

Sedir on race, etc in "On Dreams":

Around this flame, the immense organisms of the human spirit circulate as an army of asteroids around its sun. Here, let it be understood that each of our bodies, each of our fluids, our magnetic

properties, our sentiments, our mental faculties our powers of action are just so many individual organisms, classified in hierarchical autonomy.

Each of these parts of our selves is free, yet is drawn into the evolutive line of the total self. In turn, this self is free, yet it is physically drawn by the planet, socially by one's race, and spiritually by one's religion. Thus, our ponderable body seems to be the media by means of which the terrestrial forms raise themselves to the invisible, and how the objects of the immaterial worlds lower themselves to the visible world.

rhondda9 on 2015-01-15 at 12:48 said:

I want to thank you for the tip to read "The Ancient City". Interestingly, I have been reading *Prolegomena to the study of Greek Religion* by Jane Harrison. It was first published in 1903 and again in 1955. When I looked up The Ancient City and perused the table of contents, I was struck by the themes similar to Harrison's book. Thus, further investigation is required.

Raúl on 2016-10-17 at 10:06 said:

The reason behind the ritual of the Manes is, in hindu words, that the pretas become pitris, ie. that the soul impresion on the corpses enter in the generation cycle for others being. In this way not only the ancestors 'born again'. but the living are in peace.

Raúl on 2016-10-17 at 10:11 said:

If the ancestors are of people who is 'born again'. the initiatics qualifications pass to the family, and in the other case, shudra and dalits can do the inferior possibilities that belong to they and the society is in order.

Raúl on 2016-10-17 at 10:54 said:

I used the expression reborn in two ways, one as transmission of hereditary characteristics, which comes from the dead, and another as the state of the patricians having been initiated.

In my first comment, the first, and in my second comment, the second.

5.3 The Mystique of Race in Ancient Rome II

This is the concluding part of the essay by **Julius Evola** titled “La Mistica della Razza in Roma antica”. It was originally published in the journal *La Difesa della Razza*.

Beyond the specific issues concerning Ancient Rome, I hope some of you will recognize two larger points.

First of all, this essay confirms what we have said about the aristocratic interiority being centered on the higher mind, the mens, the ajna chakra, the seat of intellect and intuition, that commands the lower soul and the body. To be blunt, that describes the true “aristocrat of the soul”.

The second is the idea of destiny and the spiritual impetus behind it. A people, a family, and so on, have certain spiritual qualities at their origin. The purpose of rites and worship was to keep those qualities present in order to project them into the future. The modern mind, including most neo-pagans, cut off the past in order to create a future with no relationship to it. But human nature will not be denied. Instead of being guided by past heroes and sages, able to distinguish good and evil, the deracinated contemporaries will latch onto any spiritual influences at random. Devoid of true identity, they will create artificial identities.

The “presence” of the *genio*, the lares or the penates in the group to which it corresponded, was made aware and symbolized by the *fire*, the sacred flame, that had to burn uninterruptedly in the center of the patristic houses, in the temple placed in the *atrium*, the place where the *pater familias* celebrated the rites and in which the various members of the domestic or aristocratic group were gathered for meals, for example, which itself had a ritualistic significance in ancient Roman and Aryan life. For example, a portion of the food was reserved for the god of the domestic

fire, in order to remember the unity of life that connected the individuals to him—a unity of life and also a unity of destiny. In certain aspects, in fact, the *genius*, beyond being the principle that determines the fundamental traits of the individuals arising under his sign, was also conceived as the directing principle of his most important and most decisive acts, like the one who helps and guides him, so to speak, from behind the scenes of his finite consciousness, becoming the ultimate cause of his destiny, both good and evil, that was intended for him. In that way, this being of the ancient Roman racial cult successively gave rise to popular depictions, which however conserve very little of the original meaning: we can for example recall the undeniable relation of the *genius* with the popular Christian conception of the “guardian angels” or of the good and evil angels, these images that have become absolutely mythological and deprived of the essential and concrete relation with the blood and mystical forces of the race.

The intimate connection existing between the individual and the *lares*, the *genius*, and in general with the divinity symbolized by the sacred fire of a given bloodline, and the living character, assumed to be present and acting in such a divinity, explain the peculiarities of the ancient cult. This entity of the fire appeared as the natural intermediary between the human world and the supernatural order. Starting from the idea of the unity, fulfilled in the bloodline and in the race, of the individual with a force that, as the *genius* or the *lares*, was more than physical, ancient man was convinced of the real possibility of the influence on his own destiny precisely in this way. Special rites had to propitiate and ennoble in order to ensure that a transcendent influence was of help to his strengths and actions through the mystery of blood and race to which he belonged. A specific character of the most ancient cults of the most ancient Aryan societies was its anti-universalism. Ancient man did not turn to a God in general, a God of all men and all races, but the God of a lineage, in fact, of his *gente* and his family. And vice versa: only the members of the

group that corresponded to them, could legitimately invoke the divinity of the domestic fire and to think that their rites were efficacious. It is easy to pronounce negative judgments and formulaic stereotypes, like that of "polytheism"; it is difficult to clarify what that was about in the ancient world, because the meaning of the ancient religion became almost entirely lost in the ensuing centuries. We limit ourselves to make two points.

First of all, there is a visible hierarchy that legitimizes the ancient aristocratic-racial Aryan and Roman cult. In an army, one does not directly address the supreme leader, but rather the hierarchy on which he immediately depends, because of the fact that he, or the individuals closest to him, were able to settle the situation, without needing to go higher up. Likewise, admitting a universal God was not a reason to exclude every intermediary and to condemn any reference to the particular mystical forces that are closer to a folk or race and connected in a concrete unity of destiny and life. Celsus even brought up the hierarchical argument against the accusation of polytheism made by the Christians by observing, by analogy, that whoever pays tribute to obedience to an authority delegated to the government of a given province implicitly pays tribute to the central government, while whoever claims to address it solely and directly, beyond being impertinent, can, in reality, be acting in an anarchic way. And it is well known that Romanity, beyond particular aristocratic cults, also recognized more general cults, parallel to the universality to which the eternal city gradually elevated itself, and also indicates on the level of entities, like the *lares* or *genii* themselves, because there was also a national conception of the *lares*, for example, where they attributed a cult to the *lares militares*, or they spoke of the *lares publici*, or they referred to the mystical force of the imperial lineage, to the "demigods who founded the city and established the universal empire", or they introduced the idea of "genius or universal demons".

In the second place, ancient traditional man did not reduce the cult

to a mere sentimental disposition for which the rite was only an empty ceremony. Those who considered the relationship between the human world and the divine as real and effective, thought that there existed precise conditions. One of these was race and blood. Even without wishing to enter the complex field of the metaphysical presuppositions of the cult, it appears evident that the force, to which the individual thought he owed his life, that he supposed "present" in his same body but to which he attributed superindividual and supernatural characteristics, was conceived as the most direct and positive path to return to what is highest in life. The race, as race of the spirit, was therefore a religious value, it contained a sacrament, it was hidden by "magic", and that for considerations, one must recognize it well, in their positive and realistic mode.

The oath on the *genius* in Roman antiquity was made while touching the center of the forehead, and the cult of the *genius* itself did not lack a relation with that of the Fides, the personification of essentially Aryan and virile virtue, of fidelity and loyalty. The detail related to the gesture of the oath is, for every expert, rather interesting, because it related the *genius* and the entities similar to it back to *mens*, to the intellectual and virile principle of life, hierarchically superordinate both to the soul and to the purely corporeal forces: it cannot be by chance that the place attributed by the Roman tradition to *mens* — the center of the forehead — was that which in the Indo-Aryan tradition certainly assigned the ajna chakra to the force of "transcendent virility", and to the so-called "center of command". With that in mind, the suspicion is unlikely, that in the Roman family cult, if not exactly of superstitious personifications, was a type of "totemism", the totem being the dark entity of the blood of a tribe of barbarians, related to the forces of the animal kingdom. We see instead that the ancient Roman world gave to the gods of the race and family group precisely some supernatural traits, the mind, *mens*, or the *nous* conceived in Mediterranean antiquity exactly as the supernatural and "solar" principle of man.

Certainly, we must not generalize and think that it is about that in every case. The traditions encompassed in the ancient Roman world are more varied and complex than has been supposed up to now. Both ethnically and spiritually, diverse influences met in the most ancient period of Rome. Some are actually related to inferior forms of cult — inferior either by belonging to a non-Aryan ethnic substrate, or by representing a regressive and materialized form of somewhat more ancient cults, of Aryan and particularly Atlantico-Occidental origin. That is valid also for the cult related to mystical forces of blood, race, and family, that in some cases and phases has, let us admit, “crepuscular” traits, with special regard to their inferior chthonic aspect predominantly related to that matching instead celestial and super-terrestrial symbols.

One can nevertheless not contest the idea that in the greater number of cases the highest tradition was present in Rome and that in its development Rome was able to “rectify” and purify to a not negligible measure the different traditions that it had included. So against the myths which, in reference to the cult of the *lares* at Acca Larentia, to the *re plebeo* Servio Tullio, and to the Sabine element remaining at an inferior level, we have the “heroic” elements of the cult of the *lares* and *penates* and such elements assume ever more significance in the events at the time of the Empire. Some think that the same term “*lares*” comes from the Etruscan *lar*, a word that means leader or chief, which however was related to chiefs and leaders like Porsenna and Volumnio. A very widespread tradition among the ancients, of which it suffices to recall Varrone, identifies the *lares* with the “heroes”, in the Greek sense of demigods, of men who have transcended nature and were made participants of the indestructibility of the Olympics so that it validates, in spite of its generalization, Mommsen’s idea through which every gens would have had as one of its heroes, the principle of the people that was venerated precisely in the person of the *lar familiaris*.

The supernatural and “regal” side of the ancient cult of the mystical

forces of blood is emphasized with that. This is not everything. On the one hand, the funereal epigraphs attest to the Roman faith that the principle of immortality for his descendants was the *lares* themselves: many epigraphs do not indicate the negative “telluric” possibility of a type of dull and nocturnal post mortem survival in an underworld, but they affirm the higher idea that death is the principle of a superior existence. They put death exactly in relation, to which they were dedicated, with the *lares* or heroes of his people. On the other hand, as previously noted, Romanity would universalize the notion of the *lares*, extending it to the central dominating force of Romanity. We find therefore the inscriptions dedicated to the *lar victor*, the *lar martis et pacis* and finally to the *lares Augusti*. It is already in an environment in which it is not about more of the race as gens and nuclear family, but as folk and political community. Even outside the race so conceived, a divine force, a mystical entity, is presented, connected to the destinies of war, victory, and triumphal peace—*lar victor*, *lar martis et pacis*—and connected finally to the “genius”, to the generating principle of the leaders, the Caesars, to the *lar Augusti*.

With that we will now discuss a very different subject which is the Aryan conception of the fortune and destiny of the leaders, the city, and nations. For now, we believe we have brought sufficiently to light the meaning of the mythical figurations and cults typical of the ancient Roman peoples, where unequivocally the consciousness of blood and race resided and where religiosity was not a factor of evasion and universalism, but constituted the most solid cement of the unity of folk and bloodlines. The mystery of blood was a central idea of ancient Roman spirituality and to disregard it means to be condemned to a superficial and profane understanding of the most tangible, noted, and celebrated aspects of the law, custom, and ethics of ancient society.

Posted on 2015-01-25 by Aeneas

5.4 Rape of the Sabine Women

At the founding of Rome, Romulus was favoured by the gods, though his city was impoverished and heirless. There are three qualities that correspond to the three functions or castes, as stated in Table 5.1:

Quality	Meaning	God	Caste
Di	The favor of the gods	Jupiter	Brahman
Virtus	Courage or manly energy	Mars	Kshatriya
Opes	Resources, property means of action, fertility, and propagation	Quirinus	Vaishya

Table 5.1: Qualities vs. castes

Romulus Romulus claimed to be the son of Mars and was a favorite of Jupiter. As High Priest, Romulus founded Rome with a ritual at the auspicious moment. He and his young followers were strong and brave, or, as they would have said, “virtuous”. Nevertheless, they were impoverished and without women. To remedy these deficiencies, Romulus sent the following message to the neighboring cities:

Cities ... arise from the lowest beginnings. As time goes on, those which are aided by their own valor and by the favour of the gods achieve great power and renown. They said they were well assured that Rome’s origin had been blessed with the favour of the gods, and that valor would not be lacking; their neighbours should not be reluctant to mingle their stock and their blood with the Romans, who were as truly men as they were.

Titus Tatius Titus Tatius, king of the Sabines, scorned Romulus' offer. The Sabines were wealthy and complacent, and could not discern any positive qualities or accomplishments among the Romans. Seeing the Romans as a ragtag collection of Trojan immigrants and a criminal element, the Sabines scorned that offer, although several of their young women seemed attracted to the Romans.

The Abduction The Romans then abducted many of the women during a festival; this was not really a "rape" as the women seemed to go somewhat willingly and then accepted life as Roman wives. Titus Tatius attacked, gained entry into the city by a bribe, and pushed the Romans back. In response, Romulus resorted to prayer:

O Jupiter, it was thy omen that directed me when I laid here on the Palatine the first foundations of my city... . Deliver the Romans from their terror and stay. I here vow to thee, O Jupiter, a temple, to be a memorial to our descendants from the City saved by thy present help.

The prayer was answered and made known to Romulus, who then commanded his troops:

Romans, Jupiter Optimus Maximus commands us to stand and renew the fight.

With that, the Romans held their ground and drove the Sabines away. When the battle became stalemated, the Sabine women intervened, making the point that they ought not be forced to choose between their husbands and their fathers. The two tribes reconciled and the Sabines were absorbed into Rome as the third function or caste, which completed the Roman city.

Conclusion From this story, we see illustrated several Traditional points. First of all, Romulus offers a sacrifice to Jupiter and then discerns his Will. But, having discerned Jupiter's Will, Romulus is not passive; *virtus*, or power, is necessary to bring that will into manifestation. This incident makes clear the relation between contemplation and action, the priest and the warrior, although Romulus himself plays both roles.

In contrast, Titus Tatius depends on his gold, material wealth, bribes and trickery, as befits the Vaishya. The Sabines as a race of the Soul or race of the Spirit are now forgotten, although as the race of the body, they live on as an element of the miscegenated Roman race.

There is nothing inapplicable to today. Even for Christians, divine predilection and predestination are dogmas, although you don't hear much about them today. God will favor some over others, in particular, those who offer prayer and sacrifice. Clearly, the God who "loves all his children equally" is a recent innovation. Predestination means that those "saved" will be able to obtain everything they need for that end. Universalism as a serious teaching is a recent innovation.

Finally, those who rely only on their "opulence" and wealth have already lost their spirits and souls. Not valuing fertility and propagation, they can see in the abduction of the Sabine women only the desire for fellatio in the back seat of a chariot or the need to fill administrative posts in the growing bureaucracy. Their genes may very well persist, although not necessarily in the form they envision.

Reference: *Archaic Roman Religion*, Vol I, by Georges Dumézil

Posted on 2011-04-05 by Cologero

5.5 Priest and King in Rome

Although we have written about caste in *Caste and Social Order*³, it will be helpful to address it more broadly. **Georges Dumézil**, whose research into the social order of Indo-European peoples came too late to have any influence on either Guenon or Evola, extends our understanding through common historical, philological and mythological patterns. We intend to focus here on the ancient Roman system.

Functions There is often a confusion over the nature of “hierarchy”, particularly for those who can only think in terms of rigid structures of command and control. Instead, we think to think in terms of functions and dialectical relationships. Dumézil recognized three fundamental principles, or functions, which correspond to the inner nature of three different types of men. These are:

1. The maintenance of cosmic and juridical order
2. The exercise of physical prowess
3. The promotion of physical well-being

Clearly these functions correspond to the three higher castes: Brahman, Kshatriya, Vaishya. In one sense, they are in opposition, but that is resolved in a higher understanding. For example, the “spiritual authority” of the Brahman and the “temporal power” of the Kshatriya can be united in a higher principle, viz, **the will to maintain the cosmic order in the physical realm**. Then, the three castes are united in the principle of initiation, the “twice-born”, as opposed to the Sudra who are not initiated. One could even go further: the four castes from the entire social body and, as such, in opposition to the outcastes.

³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1698>

Mythology The social order on earth is a reflection of the order of the gods. For the Romans, **Jupiter**, **Mars**, and **Quirinus** are the gods for the respective three functional castes. Note how this mirrors the functional caste structure. Jupiter represents the highest, or Brahman, caste, then Mars the Kshatriya and finally Quirinus, the Vaishya. Furthermore, since the function of the Brahmin caste has two aspects — one facing the cosmic order and the other facing the juridical order of the city — it is represented by two gods. In the case of the Romans, these are **Jupiter** and **Dius Fidius**. These, then, would correspond to the Royal function and the properly priestly function.

Nature of Authority It is easy to forget, in our day, that life for the ancients was totally dominated by religious conceptions, down to the smallest detail. Every important action was accompanied by a rite; even the home had its sacred hearth and daily rituals, with the paterfamilias acting as priest. There was no notion of positive law⁴; every law of the city was considered to be of divine origin. We see in the example of the Spartan battle at Plataea⁵, that their action is utterly irrational from the secular perspective: *while their kinsmen are dying from the attack of the Persian archers, the Spartans passively hold their ground until the diviner determines the proper moment to initiate the battle just from “reading” the entrails of a sacrificed animal.*

Priest and King Just as the father was both head of the family and priest at home, so also, in the ancient traditions, the chief priest of the city religion was also its king (also called *prytanes* or *archon*). This shows that there was no separation between the royal initiation and the priestly initiation. The king would maintain the public sacred hearth, offer sacrifices, lead the prayers, and preside over religious ceremonies. Fustel de

⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=447>

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2024>

Coulanges describes the inauguration of a Roman king:

These king-priests were inaugurated with a religious ceremonial. The new king, being conducted to the summit of the Capitoline Hill, was seated upon a stone seat, his face turned towards the south. On his left was seated an augur, his head covered with sacred fillets, and holding in his hand the augur's staff. He marked off certain lines in the heavens, pronounced a prayer, and, placing his hand upon the king's head, supplicated the gods to show, by a visible sign, that this chief was agreeable to them. Then, as soon as a flash of lightning or a flight of birds had manifested the will of the gods the new king took possession of his charges. ... There was a reason for such a custom; as the king was to be supreme chief of the religion, and the safety of the city was to depend upon his prayers and sacrifices, it was important to make sure, in the first place, that this king was accepted by the gods.

Here, if nothing else, we see the notion of the divine right of kings and the role of lightning as a sign from God, even to this day.

Since the Traditional man depended on the gods in all aspects of his life, he certainly depended on the priest who was the intermediary between himself and the gods. His power of prayer, sacrifice and augury made him the clear leader of the city. Thus, the chief priest was also the magistrate, judge and military chief.

Romulus and Numa Romulus, the first king of Rome, knew the science of augury and founded the city in accordance with religious rites. He created the cult of Jupiter and build the first temple to the god. Romulus was a warrior king and urged the Romans to cultivate the art of war. While Romulus aggrandized Rome through war, the next king, Numa, aggrandized her through peace. Numa reformed and codified the Roman cult, with its three branches devoted to Jupiter, Mars, and Quirinus. For the bloody sacrifice of his predecessor, he substituted the unbloody

sacrifice of bread and wine. He also founded a shrine dedicated to Fides Publica and taught the Romans the oath of Fides, which refers to faith. Dumézil writes on this topic:

When Christianity gave the substantive noun “faith” and the verb “believe” the overtones they still have today, it was at the very least rediscovering and revivifying very ancient usages.

Conclusion We hope that this will clear up some questions, while raising even more serious ones. First of all, it establishes the rationale for the caste hierarchy. The ruler is not subservient to the priest because, in fact, the ruler is the chief priest. This understanding persisted into the Hermetic Tradition as we saw in Thomas Campanella’s *City of the Sun*⁶, in which the metaphysician is also the ruler. Furthermore, unlike the priest of today, the priest had real power (spiritual, not temporal): his prayers and sacrifices are efficacious, his auguries insightful.

In Romulus and Numa, we see the beginning of the dialectic that persists to our day: the warrior-priest vs the mystical priest; the terrible vs the ordered; Dionysus vs Apollo. Numa’s successor, Tullus Hostilius, mocked Numa and his institutions, as well as piety to the gods, on the grounds that it made men cowardly and effeminate.

For the ancients, both the laws of Romulus and those of Numa were divinely inspired, so they lived with the contradictions. For the Hermetist, every apparent opposition is a polarity that is resolved in a higher synthesis.

References:

The Ancient City, Numa Denis Fustel de Coulanges

Mitra-Varuna, Georges Dumézil

Gods of the Ancient Northmen, Georges Dumézil

Archaic Roman Religion (2 vols), Georges Dumézil

⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=518>

Posted on 2011-04-04 by Cologero

* * *

Max on 2018-08-30 at 18:06 said:

The same type of opposition as that between Romulus and Numa is envisioned by Vico in the tension between the Israelites emphasis on law and reason and the divine as accessible interiorly, contrasted to the work of providence active in the gentiles auspicious understanding of embodiment. Neither of them necessarily invalidates the other, and we can even combine the two currents.

The conclusion of an article by John Headley "On the Rearing of Heaven: The Machiavellism of Tommaso Campanella" was quite revealing:

"The actual indebtedness of Campanella to Machiavelli was more than peripheral, exceeding simply the incidental resort to cunning tactics. By profoundly appropriating the idea of religion's social and political utility, originally a product of Paduan Averroism, Campanella joined many political theorists of the Counter Reformation in judging religion by its effects, its utility, while nevertheless maintaining for himself its claims to truth. Similarly preoccupied with power and its effective exercise in this world, Machiavelli formulated and imparted to Campanella what became the central problem of his life: the empowerment of Christianity. The friar attempted to resolve for his own age the question which the secretary had hesitated to address in his own time; in his quest to achieve the predominance of a viable ecclesiastical state in Italy as well as papal theocracy throughout the world, Campanella in effect took up Machiavelli's challenge to realize a politically militant Christianity. That other interpretation of Christianity, to which Machiavelli occasionally alluded, Campanella would spend a lifetime pursuing in order that heaven might truly be reared."

Very few wish to touch upon political Christianity today. Although for most of history "church and state" were the same. In ancient Israel, the state and its administration was basically the temple. The utility of religion need not be controversial, and does not detract from a higher understanding. It would be more surprising if it were no good for anything. Christian institutions have unfortunately come to downplay their own potential.

Your quote of Rushdoony in the introduction to *Pagan Imperialism* was intriguing. The word *moloch* supposedly comes from the combination of the consonants for king, *malik*, to the vowels for shame. However, *Melki-tzedek*, who Guénon says is the link to the primordial tradition, is "The King of Righteousness", and senior to the priesthood of Aaron. Is there anyone who knows what Campanella had to say about *Melki-tzedek*?

Rushdoony left me confounded, so I am unsure of whether it is worth pursuing him further. It cannot be right that what is deemed heretical if uttered by a king, becomes sacred when restricted to the confines of a book. It might be true that all law, *ius*, is originally religious in

nature, but is not one of the main features of sacred law to avoid having to worship the law book as an idol. Not to criticise law as such, but presumably, all words of God passed through a human of some sort before being written down, notwithstanding that it is also wise to preserve exceptional revealed words for future generations. Those words must however be made alive again continuously.

Matt on 2018-08-30 at 23:30 said:

Max,

I have just recently started reading Rushdoony. He was a name I would sometimes hear others mention – usually accompanied with hysterical shock and horror. I decided to finally start reading some of his work, since, like you, the quotation Cologero provided in his introduction caught my attention. Some of his work can be found on online sites like scribd.

I'm currently reading his work *The One and the Many: Studies in the Philosophy of Order and Ultimacy*. Rushdoony thinks the relationship between the One and the Many is one of the key metaphysical questions a person needs to consider. The book's main thesis is essentially that all non-Christian religions and worldviews focus on one at the exclusion of the other (the One is primary, or the Many is primary), whereas Christianity – Reformed/Calvinist Christianity, what he really means – brings the One and Many into the Godhead as the primary reality. From there, he attempts to chart all the real world implications (past, present, and future) that arise from the chosen answer.

I'm close to halfway through the text; it's an engaging read. I'll hold off on any definitive conclusions about his worldview until I finish reading it and his other key works, but I will say this: Rushdoony does not come off as the boogeyman of "Christian Fascism" that was conjured up from the nightmares of a Christopher Hedges. It would seem Rushdoony would answer his accusers' charges that fascism, as opposed to his reconstructionist socio-political order, is a modern manifestation of the pagan belief of the One being primary at the expense of the many, which envisions the state as God incarnate.

It would have been interesting to see a conversation between Rushdoony and Evola. Instead, we got one with Bill Moyers. I guess we get the conversations we deserve.

Adam J. Franz on 2019-11-16 at 08:12 said:

Cologero,

What is the source for Numa's sacrifice with bread and wine. Not at all surprising, just wondering if I need to leaf through Livy or something.

This is my first post, but I love your content and have been reading it for several years.

Cologero on 2019-11-16 at 08:44 said:

Try Numa bread wine sacrifice⁷

The purpose was to allow the lower classes – for whom meat was a rarity – to offer sacrifices.

5.6 The Spirit of Roman Civilization

With this article from the December 1940 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, Evola takes up the idea of Romanity, and its continuity beyond the Roman Empire itself. While different from the mystical vision of Guido de Giorgio, based on Dante, it is equally spiritual. Following a conception of Spengler, the difference between culture and civilization is noted. Along the way, the features of the Old Right are delineated. Readers are encouraged to contrast them with contemporary pretenders to represent the right. We wonder where the *hierarchical order* will come from, and who is describing the *supreme, divine and transcendent power*, or is even capable of recognizing it.

With the appearance of every new work on Roman Civilization, we experience a certain sense of annoyance: in fact, for the most part, we take notice of books of this type only perfunctorily, they do not reveal any new idea, they repeat the clichés of earlier “positivist” interpretations, adding only the rhetorical hype of commemoration, thereby producing a pathetic effect, and whatever true meaning it has of our original tradition, it is not so much illuminated by similar writings, but rather trivialized and almost profaned.

We were therefore pleased to have been removed, at least once, from prejudices of that type in reading a very recent book of crystalline clarity written by **Pietro De Francisci** on *The Spirit of Roman Civilization*⁸.

⁷<https://www.google.com/search?q=numa+bread+wine+sacrifice&oq=numa+bread+wine+sacrifice>

⁸*Spirito della civiltà romana*, 1940

Above all, beginning with its first chapters, we had to admit: Finally there is an authoritative person who hits the mark and knows what must be considered essential in Romanity. And we also found ourselves totally consenting to the justification of the books, viz., that no constructive revolution is a creation from nothing, but has as conditions the return to elementary principles and factors, which for us can only be those of the original tradition of Rome. And De Francisci also very correctly criticizes those who break our history into two parts: the history of Rome and her Empire on one side, the history of Italy on the other.

As for Corradini, so also for De Francisci, Italianity and Romanity are a single thing, or said better: they *must* be a single thing, on the basis of a decisive choice of their own callings and traditions: that is, we must exalt, consider as our own, and glorify as “Italian” only what is of value to us in our history, as “Roman”, and not have any lenience or mitigation for the rest. De Francisci correctly says that to bring youth to the awareness of the power and depth of the current of Romanity that spreads throughout all our medieval and modern history, eliminating wrong ideas and destroying old and new prejudices, means to draw on precious nourishment for the ideal strength of our revolution.

Who does not see the abyss that separates similar positions from those which, nevertheless like De Francisci, had to have the direction of the fascist Istituto Nazionale di Cultura [National Institute of Culture]—we mean Giovanni Gentile, who did not hesitate to assert what Romanity is for us, but only in the empty rhetoric of life and content, because for him the true Italian tradition is identified with a series of suspect thinkers and heretical rebels starting with the Renaissance, as if in fascist Italy itself no others should be seen and desired except those involved in the development of Italy of 1870?⁹.

As the premise of his treatise, De Francisci, following up on an idea from Spengler, makes the appropriate morphological distinction between

⁹When Italy was unified.

culture and *civilization*. Culture, both as an intellectualistic phenomenon, as well as refinement of the material conditions of the life of a people, has nothing to share with *civilization*, reality. De Francisci writes this very profound passage:

Civilization is not only a manifestation of the prevalent intellectual activities but the complex and concrete expression of all the energies of the spirit: it is not only the ruler of man in his exterior nature, but is at the same time the dominion of man over his own human nature, the awareness of coordination with other men, of subordination to a certain hierarchical order, and of dependence on a supreme, divine and transcendent power.

It is a unitary and organic construction which, by being such, even permeates the political field, i.e., it also presupposes a political organization as the realizer and promoter of the fundamental values resting on the base of the organization itself. And in this special point, we see the contrast between the idea of civilization and the abstract conception of “culture”, as meant in its modern understanding, in which, culture would be a kingdom to itself, alienated from everything that is “political”, instead of being the highest animating and justifying force of the political, as always happened in all traditional civilizations and, at the forefront, let us admit it now, in the Roman civilization.

Now, De Francisci studies the ancient Roman world exactly in respect to “civilization” in this precise meaning. Rome was eminently “civilization” and its greatness must speak to us in the sense of this unitary and anti-intellectualist ideal. What was the specific face of such a civilization? What are the fundamental, typical, and constant elements of its “style”? De Francisci considers four above all:

First of all, *clarity* and *simplicity*, founded on a precise and certain intuition of reality, and not only of visible reality, but also—it is the merit of our author to recognize it—invisible reality.

While the Romans were realists, they never were materialists: thus few people like the Romans carried with themselves for centuries the conviction of the existence of a will and a transcendent power, to which laws must be adapted and human conduct conformed. But clarity and simplicity are the elements of grandeur

These are reflected—as the echo of something eternal and detached from the small events of individuals, from everything that is *pathos* and sensibility—in the *monumental* element of the Roman world. Furthermore, the *unity* that together is organicity and solidity, founded on a balance of forces and factors, on a wise bond that surpasses and encompasses all varieties, distinctions, complications: unity as formative and organizing power.

An order results from it, which, while “it was experienced as a transcendent system of principles determined by the very nature of things” (which is the ancient Aryan conception of *cosmos* or *rta*¹⁰), is expressed in a rigorous, definite, and essential style: intolerance for everything that is disordered, uncertain, subjective, scattered. Precision and clarity predominate in the *ethos*, but not as only a human norm, but rather as the rigorous objectification of a supersensible reality.

In that regard, De Francisci rightly opposes those who prefer to portray the ancient Roman as dry, lacking sentiment and imagination. What, alone, remains alien to the Roman soul, was the sterile subjectivism that surrenders itself to the caprices of the arbitrary in which every moral energy is scattered and dissipated:

But not for this reason is his interiority less rich, which consists above all in the adhesion of the spirit to the norms of a higher Order.

This is demonstrated in the three virtues of *pietas*, *fides* and *gravitas*. And, as we ourselves on other occasions have emphasized, the lack of imagina-

¹⁰<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rta>

tion in the Romans is more a sign of superiority than inferiority: it is to be taken in the sense, as De Francisci says:

The imagination of the Romans is not a gratuitous game of intellectual boldness, it is not the creation of a world of images detached from reality, but an instrument to seal this reality in well-defined forms, to frame and organize its forces.

The same thing must be pointed out regarding the accusation made against the Romans of having degraded thought in favour of action. But what thought is this about? No one denies the scarce sympathy of the Romans for theoretical constructions. But action itself, when it proves to be coherent, consistent, and efficacious—De Francisci notes—does that not itself bear witness to a thought, or rather, a higher power of thought? All the history of the Romans stands to demonstrate that they believed in such values and held firm to principles which, through their experience, were defined, made precise, affirmed, and even assumed an ever more universal importance and applicability.

Political power, spiritual authority, divine law, sin, divination, totalitarianism and freedom in Ancient Rome In the order of the structural element, there is a specific element in the “civilization” of Rome, i.e., a hierarchy, in which the preeminence is reserved to political values: everything is assumed and organized in the operation of the State. But we were pleased to see that De Francisci avoided a double false turn in which, in this regard, he finishes the greatest part of the modern interpretations of Romanity. In fact, in the first place, such a preeminence of the political element is not at all to be understood according to certain modern political pretensions to the primacy of a temporal power over any spiritual authority. The political and religious elements in ancient Rome were in an indissoluble union. The starting point of the Roman was the

awareness that divine and transcendent forces exist and act behind human and historical forces. So the highest principle of Roman “politics”, and consequently of every determination of will and action, was that of conforming individual and collective life to the *fas* [divine law],

The revealed divine will, which is the supreme law against which it is not possible to rebel without committing a *nefas* [sin], i.e., not just a reproachable act but has mortal consequences.

After all, De Francisci had already mentioned the religious base of the first Roman law in his earlier *History of Roman Law*. In the new book he recalls the profound significance relative to the fact of the inseparable connection of the *imperium* of the Roman political leaders, with the *auspiciu*m [divination], that is to say, with a discipline having as a presupposition the possibility of coming into relationship with the divine forces and of presenting the directions, along which they were able to confirm and empower human forces and actions. Even if De Francisci doesn’t go beyond an examination deeper into the meaning of the rite in the ancient world, but in that there is quite enough to clearly distance it from those, in this regard, who see only “superstitions” and “obtuse fatalism” in order to appreciate, in the Roman *i*us [law], only its positive juridical cadaver.

The other prejudice, which is often fostered in relation to the totalitarianism of Roman political civilization, relates to *libertas* [civil liberty]. But, again, it is impossible to judge the ancient world with modern measures, which then are simply false and misleading. De Francisci clearly points out all the respect that ancient Rome attributed to *libertas*: but it is a concrete *libertas*, comprising in itself the concept of limits: it is freedom as the faculty and the legitimate right of movement, of acting, of disposing oneself, and even within a well-defined space, within a positive hierarchy, where each recognizes his own: *suum cuique*. So the Roman would know an exemplary balance of *auctoritas* [responsibility] or *lex*

[law] and *libertas* while disregarding the democratic concept of equality characteristic of Hellenic decadence, in the surpassing individualism with a determination of limits, with an obsession with hierarchy, with a coordination of activity. And this is another of the aspects, according to which Romanity remains, for centuries, the sign and symbol of a higher political and traditional ideal.

Roman upheavals, Asiatic cults and the end of the first Romanity

Since we nailed down the truly valuable and, for many, the illuminative, aspect of De Francisci's new work in these terms, let's allow ourselves to make some other points.

First of all, in regard to origins: It is true that, in this respect, one hears nothing said about them today. Nevertheless, whoever has eyes sufficiently trained can recognize and discern what there is of value in regards to race and spiritual forces of the world of the origins. On the Aryan problem in Italy, on the meaning of the crossing or make up of various symbols and costumes—for example the rites of burial or cremation, solar cults and telluric-maternal cults, etc.—the spiritual relations between Etruria and Rome and so on, little or nothing is found in De Francisci's book. Now, if one does not succeed in having a, so to speak, *dramatic* vision of the ancient Italic world, as it concerns both race and spirit, one can in no way grasp the true meaning of Rome, her battles, her mission, her destiny.

In relation to that, what is equally missing in the work of De Francisci is any investigation of what we would call the "subterranean history" of Rome. In his book, attention remains concentrated on history in the common bi-dimensional meaning of the term, even if examined with undeniable acumen. The analysis of the most profound, spiritual aspect of certain social rifts and certain oppositions of worship in Rome is not made. What was, for example, the influence that acts, in ancient Rome,

through the Sibylline Books¹¹? It is a problem, among many others, of the subterranean history of Roma, whose importance is anything but to be neglected.

De Francisci, as we said, saw clearly in the connection of the human will, and therefore of action, to a more than human significance, an element characteristic of Roman reality. And it was emphasized more particularly by others that the Roman perceived essentially the revelation of the divine not in space, as a vision, but in time and in history, like action. Now, can one recognize that, without also recognizing that a history of Romanity will always be incomplete, if it does not become, to a certain degree, a *metaphysics of history*, i.e., if it does not strive to grasp a symbolic content in its objective way in the more important and decisive upheavals of Romanity? The danger of digression and pure personal interpretations, here, naturally, is great. Nevertheless, it is necessary to do something in this direction, if Roman history is to truly speak to us. Does De Francisci know the famous introduction to Bachofen's *Legend of Tanaquil*? In this old work, even in reference to Romanity, there are methodological ideas that still are particularly important today¹².

Also, De Francisci treated various problems of the imperial period, such as the importation of "Asiatic" cults and their significance, in only an "historical" way, in the current meaning of the word. The racial moment on the level of the elements of civilization and cult, were not developed. For example: what of the Asiatic cults and forms of the same imperial cult, referring back, in spite of the degeneration of their exterior expressions, to elements of a common archaic Aryan tradition, inasmuch as, for example, certain aspects of the Augustan religious reform, in fact, call back to life some ideas forgotten or obscured by the first Romanity?

¹¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sibylline_Books

¹²Such as the interpretation of legend as history and the use of imagination or intuition to grasp it. *Translator's note*

The causes of the decline of the Roman Empire, its rectification in the Middle Ages, and future prospects

Instead, the best is the analysis made by De Francisci of the various political and social factors and various attempts of the restoration of the late imperial period. He brings to light the true cause of decadence: the universal Empire could only hold on provided that the expansive moment would have a corresponding moment of deconcentration and national-racial intensification. Although indispensable, a unique supreme point of reference—the imperial divine authority—could not be sufficient: it would have been necessary instead to provide simultaneously for the spiritual and material defense of the Italic-Roman race as the matrix privileged by elements destined to govern and command in the world. In place of that, Rome accepted cosmopolitanism, the turmoil of leveling and disarticulation. The Empire presumed to embrace universally the human species without distinction of race, peoples or traditions, on the only basis of the supreme central divine power, and close to a break up and a “positivisation” of the ancient juridical idea, at this point turning into the natural law.

On such a basis we tend to believe that contrary to the opinions of most and, it can be said, judging by some of his comments, of De Francisci himself, Christianity, or at least a certain Christianity, assumed the inheritance of only the negative aspects of the Empire. In fact, only in terms of the “spirit”, universalistically, it proposed to unify and gather the scattered peoples in the Empire; and if, beyond that, it created in the clergy a hierarchy and a central power, it was created without any racial presuppositions: the clergy was recruited from all the classes and peoples and, because of celibacy, could not constitute a caste, it could not give rise to a regular tradition, also supported on blood, as instead happens in many ancient Aryan societies.

Only in the Middle Ages, by means of the Aryo-Germanic contribution, a certain rectification of these negative aspects of the legacy of the last Romanity arose. The organic ideal arose. Catholicism itself came

to show less the traits of a universalistic religion than those of the faith characteristic of the fighting block of the Aryan and European nations of "Christianity". And it is in these terms and in forms that, as we have had the occasion recently to note in this journal, today have a curious aspect of current affairs and even of "futurism", that the purest force of our origins is reaffirmed beyond the decline of the first Rome.

Posted on 2012-04-15 by Aeneas

* * *

Cologero on 2012-04-16 at 22:41 said:

Keep in mind that we aren't posting this to teach ancient history. Rather, we do so to reach those few readers who resonate to this description of ancient Rome, and begin to recognize themselves in it. Possibly, they may then remember who they are.

Cologero on 2012-04-19 at 23:20 said:

Evola manages to skip over 1500 years in a paragraph and show signs of a hope that would be dashed. It is the latter Evola, the man among the ruins, that English only readers know. These pre-WWII writings paint a different picture.

There are interesting points here. The first Rome was already in decline. It was becoming universalistic, ethnically mixed, and infected with Asiatic cults. But how could it not be? That is the very nature of Empire. Christianity was just one of those Asiatic cults, but it is important because it became the dominant one. Evola, and apparently De Francisci, claims that Christianity (as Catholicism, a "certain" form of it) inherited the worse aspects of the decline of the Empire. In other words, it was not the cause, but rather the result, the decline of the first Romanity.

Again, Evola points to the rectification of Catholicism under the influence of the Germanic peoples in conjunction with the Romans. But he claims this rectification did not apply to the priestly caste, that is, the spiritual element of Catholicism, something Evola wants to bracket out. However, Catholicism did become the faith of the warrior caste of the nations within Christendom. That is undeniable, but it is hardly obvious how the warrior religion can be split off from its spiritual aspects. Here, we prefer to follow Dante and De Giorgio.

But the final sentence says more than the entire essay. At the time the essay was written, Evola was hopeful another Roman-Germanic alliance, in the form of the Axis powers, was the real future that would reaffirm the forces of the First Rome. After all, let us not forget that the First Reich was the Holy Roman Empire, the creation of the original Roman-German alliance.

Of course, we now know that was not to be. Nevertheless, the essay does indeed have the aspect of current affairs and a futurism, although not in the sense hoped for. A de-Christianized Europe without spiritual moorings and without a faith for its warriors, is following the downward path of the First Rome. Europe is universalistic, ethnically mixed, and besieged with Asiatic cults. A very few see that as a problem, but most do not. The former may resort to desperate tactics.

Is a rectification possible? Do we need another poll question?

Graham on 2012-04-19 at 23:57 said:

One observes a similar cosmopolitanism, both racial and spiritual, preponderating in Rome since Vatican II. With the same deleterious effects.

Evola seems to blunder slightly on the issue of priestly celibacy, since this isn't the main reason why Christianity has never had a real priestly caste. Celibacy has only been required of priests since the 11th Century, and even then only in the Latin Rite. In the Coptic Rite, for instance, where priestly marriage is actually encouraged, a caste of priests has never emerged. Many further details could be added but are unnecessary. This discipline was added for the Latins in large part to counteract the incipience of a priestly caste. So there are deeper reasons at work.

Is it Gornahoor's position that Christianity's congenital lack of an hereditary priestly caste is anti-Traditional?

With apologies for quoting at length, I would like to expose the readers here to an argument made by Olavo de Carvalho in a debate against Alexander Dugin. I believe Logres has made reference to this debate before, but unfortunately – in my opinion – only to Dugin, the less intellectually forcible of the two men.

"The strength of the Orthodox Church as a historical agent has penetrated deeply into the mind of Professor Dugin, shaping his "holistic" notion of theocratic empire. He does not conceive of the empire but as a structure emanated from the Church and united to her, symbolically, in the person of the Czar. In an interview given in 1998 to a Polish magazine[15] he qualifies as "heresy" the distinction between Church and Empire that shaped Western civilization. But without this separation, the only hypothesis left is that the borders of religious expansion coincide with the map of the empire with pinpoint accuracy. Now, the various empires and imperial nations existing in history have always had well-defined borders that separated them from other empires and independent nations. In this case, the imperial religion becomes only an expanded national religion. What is then the Czar? One of two things: either he is the head of a mere national religion having no possibility of expanding itself beyond its borders and looking with deadly envy at the expansion of her Western competitor, or, alternatively, if he wants his religion to impose itself as universal belief, he has to invade all countries and become the emperor of the world. Both the National-Bolshevik project and its Eurasian version are born from an internal contradiction of the Russian imperial religion. The Eurasian project is the only way out for the

Orthodox Church if she does not want to remain confined to the limits of the Russian nation, failing in her declared mission as a universal religion. Meanwhile, the Roman Catholic Church can expand comfortably to the last frontiers of Paraguay and China without the need to carry an empire on its back. And that was, in fact, what happened, while the Orthodox Church, through the medium of Professor Dugin, is still looking for an exit leading to the world and does not see other means of finding it but to constitute herself into a World Empire."

<http://www.theinteramerican.org/blogs/olavo-de-carvalho/257-olavo-de-carvalho-debates-alexandr-dugin-ii.html>

It is clear that Dugin backs the same 'totalitarian' vision as Evola advances in this article, one which the Catholic Church's understanding of universality has always rejected. And indeed it can legitimately be asked which of the two visions is the more universal – the one that necessitates militaristic expansion, or the one that simply requires adventurous missionaries? I would like to ask which of these two visions, if either, Gornahoor supports – the total fusion of spiritual and temporal powers envisioned by Dugin and Evola, or the somewhat looser cooperation of Mr. de Carvalho and, it seems, the whole of the Catholic tradition. Has this been addressed somewhere?

Cologero on 2012-04-20 at 00:47 said:

No, the lack of a hereditary caste is not anti-traditional. Guenon did not think so, since Islam has no such thing. Even by Evola's standards, viz., caste is something transcendent and essential to a man's identity, caste is not necessarily dictated by biology. In may be forgotten today that priests used to have to meet certain standards as far as manliness, physical health, even mannerisms and postures; these should be regarded as the recognition of someone's caste.

Excellent point about Dugin and Evola. Evola never could accept the separation of the two powers in the Middle Ages. We have been preparing the background to bring Solovyov back into the picture. Unlike Evola, he regarded the separation of the spiritual and temporal powers as an advance. So did Tomberg. Since their respective domains are different (albeit hierarchically related), it seems better to separate them. For example, look up the post on the City of the Sun.

Our position is that the only real unity is a spiritual unity based on a valid tradition, not a pseudo-unity based on biology, race, military conquest, heresy, or a social contract. I believe we have made this point often enough. In Penty's Common Mind we read:

From a sociological point of view, the first function of the Church is to maintain in society the acceptance of common standards of thought and morals. This is a necessary condition of any stable social order, because if men are to share a common life they must share a common mind, for there must be a common mind if men are to act together. We have moved so far away from the thought and impulse of the Middle Ages that

there are few to-day who recognise the fundamental importance of the common mind to any successful ordering of our social arrangements. Yet it is only necessary to reflect on the general social and political situation to-day to realise that in recognising its importance the Mediaevalists were right while the Modernists in failing to do so are wrong.

You can easily substitute "Ancient Rome" or "Spiritual Authority" for "Church" in this passage.

Logres on 2012-04-20 at 08:01 said:

I was just thinking of John Romanides' criticisms of Charlemagne, last evening, & how perfect they sounded five years ago. It's becoming clearer that the West (in fact) did the "one thing necessary" in the wake of Rome's collapse. I need to re-read Carvalho & Dugin's exchange; the Penty article on Right Hand Path is excellent. And I finally understand (after re-reading Soloviev's Law of Development article, here) how the "devolution" of spiritual/temporal linking doesn't entail the disappearance of the Tradition, but sets up a re-convergence out of Freedom, per Tomberg.

<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3571>

5.7 Romans and Spartans at War

A few nights ago, I began to watch a video on-line by a cute and vivacious neopagan young woman. In a voice filled with giggles, she boasted about how laid back she and her boyfriend were. In particular, if he didn't light the candles in just the right way, they didn't concern themselves with it. That's when I clicked the stop button.

In *The Ancient City*, **Numa Denis Fustel de Coulanges** described in detail, more than a generation before Dumezil, the religious practices and social organization in ancient Rome and Greece (with frequent references to comparable practices in the Vedic civilization of India). He describes how the whole of life was oriented toward the transcendent, and that rites accompanied every activity from meals, to governance, to war. Needless to say, these rites were expected to be done perfectly, according to custom.

The ancients are seen to have subsumed all their activities to the will of the gods; gods who did not necessarily love them, nor offered eternal guarantees. For the ancients, the mystery of creation was not of interest, but rather the mystery of generation. Hence, their religion was intimately tied up with worship of ancestors and with keeping their memory alive. Thus, the attack of the counter-tradition on the family goes much deeper than the sociological ramifications; its real aim is to extirpate the very basis of Tradition.

Very often, the discussion of Tradition has been abstract, particularly in regard to caste. To illustrate the dynamic of the relationship among the castes, I will quote two passages, describing battle scenes, one Roman, the other Spartan. Note how the warriors, in a tremendous display of self-discipline, submit their actions to the judgments of the spiritual leaders.

Let us examine a Roman army at the moment when it is preparing for battle. The consul orders a victim [sacrificial animal, usually a chicken] to be brought, and strikes it with the axe; it falls: its entrails will indicate the will of the gods. An aruspex [or haruspex, a priest specializing in this task], and if the signs are favorable the consul gives the signal for battle. The most skillful dispositions, the most favorable, circumstances, are of no account if the gods do not permit the battle. The fundamental principle of the military art among the Romans was to be able to put off a battle when the gods were opposed to it. It was for this reason that they made a sort of citadel of their camp every day.

This demonstrates that the judgment of the priests was important than any merely tactical considerations. This is illustrated even more dramatically in the case of the Spartans, who await that judgment, even in the face of imminent personal danger.

Let us now examine a Greek army, and we will take for example the battle of Plataea. The Spartans are drawn up in line; each one

has his post for battle. They all have crowns upon their heads, and the flute-players sound the religious hymns. The king, a little in rear of the ranks, slaughters the victims. But the entrails do not give the favorable signs [according to the diviner ... a type of priest], and the sacrifice must be repeated. Two, three, four victims are successively immolated. During this time the Persian cavalry approach, shoot their arrows, and kill quite a number of Spartans. The Spartans remain immovable, their shields placed at their feet, without even putting themselves on the defensive against the arrows of the enemy. They await the signal of the gods. At last the victims offer the favorable signs; then the Spartans raise their shields, seize their swords, move on to battle and are victorious.

Fustel summarizes all this by pointing out the role of religion in the lives of the ancients. There is never a question of the secular powers (kshatriya, vaishya) overthrowing that order, although the King often encompasses spiritual authority along with temporal power.

Thus, in time of peace, as in war time, religion intervened in all acts. It was everywhere present, it enveloped man. The soul, the body, private life, public life, meals, festivals, assemblies, tribunals, battles, all were under the empire of this city religion. It regulated all the acts of man, disposed of every instant of his life, fixed all his habits. It governed a human being with an authority so absolute that there was nothing beyond its control.

Posted on 2011-03-29 by Cologero

* * *

James O'Meara on 2011-03-30 at 09:47 said:

Ah yes, main criteria for making a religion, or anything, acceptable is: just be cool with it, man! The the only imperative is to have no imperative [just as the only intolerance is against

those who are 'intolerant' i.e., do not practice total tolerance for favored groups]. Often confused with the New Age as such, its roots are actually far back in the history of soi disant 'Liberalism' and so its effects are more widespread, indeed all pervasive, as James Kalb, for instance, has shown in his *The Tyranny of Liberalism*. We must attack Libya because Gadaffi is violent! We must kill the Serbs because they practice genocide! You'll notice how the image of Zen in the West is old men serving tea, not Samauri warriors or Kamakazi pilots. Take it easy, doood.

5.8 Silence, Rhythms, Forms

It is a monstrously ironical fact that the only civilization which professes to discount heredity and to put all its faith in environment is unique in having no positive environment to offer.

MARTIN LINGS

Speaking from the Heart Since we started the translation of *La Tradizione Romana* in the middle, we left out the explanation of some concepts he alluded to. **Guido De Giorgio** lists the moments of the Divine Cycle as Silence, Rhythm, Forms, and the Primordial Tradition. That is how we ultimately want to see it, not as it appears to man in the merely human state. I don't know yet if I'll make De Giorgio's chapters available, but in the meantime I will provide my own thoughts. The fundamental issue is that the negative moment has passed. The crisis of and the revolt against the modern world have, by this point, been fully exposed, at least to those few men with an affinity to that point of view.

Hence, it is no longer necessary to rely solely on exoteric teachings, e.g., ancient Hopis beliefs, or some Etruscan fertility goddess, and so on. We are convinced, quanto basta? We are so accustomed to think discursively, to talk about something out there, to debate interpretations. Instead, it is necessary to unthink, to be in the Silence. As Guenon pointed out, the Silence is not a possibility of manifestation, we cannot point to it

or see it, certainly not hear it. Rather, it is a clearing, wherein something can appear.

Of course, there is no end to the thoughts that vie for that space, as nature abhors a vacuum. Who, however, takes this exercise seriously? Namely, to be watchful, to be on guard, to be careful which thoughts are allowed in. The dominant thoughts are loud and insistent, they agitate rather than calm. The subtle thoughts come from further away, they are attenuated, soft, and they can be missed without the Silence, until we can vibrate at that same level.

The Rhythm of Time

Just as today's most obsessive notion is that of the material reality of time, self-existent time was the first lie of social life. As with nature, time did not exist before the individual became separate from it. Reification of this magnitude—the beginning of time—constitutes the Fall: the initiation of alienation, of history.

JOHN ZERZAN, *Elements of Refusal*

Man is not yet under the thumb of quantity, as there is a natural rhythm to his life. Time is cyclic, not linear. Time is not independent or “outside” him, i.e., dominating him. Rather, it is experienced as the “unfolding” of being, its revelation and reflection in manifestation. The future is in the present, not some “promised land” of scientific knowledge or societal evolution.

He performs his rites and ablutions on a cosmic scale, with the rising and setting of the sun, the motions of the planets. He eats when hungry, sleeps when drowsy. He does not need a clock to tell the time. Similarly, he knows the seasons by their different qualities. He has no need of calendars to tell him when to expect spring or winter.

When time becomes quantified, it becomes linear, because there is no geometry of time (alone). Yet even physicists measure time through

rhythms, as the second is defined as so many cycles generated by the cesium atom. Since time slows down the faster something moves, there is no absolute standard of time. If one physicist stays put and another takes a high speed trip, for each of them, a second will still count the same number of cycles from their cesium clocks. However, when the traveler return, they will find they each counted a different number of seconds.

So, there is no way to avoid rhythm in understanding time. The modern choice is quantitative and exterior, i.e., to count something “out there”. But human time is also based on a rhythm, but it is qualitative and interior. It is only a modern prejudice to suppose that physical time is superior. There is, or at least was, an echo in this in Islam. A month does not end with the passage of a certain number of days, but rather by the appearance of the new moon. Hence, the beginning of the month is locale dependent and not universal. If the night is cloudy and the moon not visible, the current month may get an extra day.

Hence, in a fully human world, we determine cycles and ages by qualitative rhythms not by counting. For example, as was pointed out, the Hindu scriptures on the length of the yugas is accessible to all (although the actual numbers are in dispute). If all that is true, it cannot be the real teaching, which is always accessible only to the few. If the relative lengths of the yugas differ, that is not because there is an absolute “objective”, exterior, standard to count the days. Rather, it is because in later yugas, time is compressed as human change speeds up. This is the esoteric meaning.

Artifacts Beyond the natural things, which are reflections of ideas in the divine mind, man creates his own artifacts, which arise from his own mind. You often hear people casually remark that technology is “neutral”, things can be used for good or evil, but they themselves are neither. That is not quite true, as there is no point of neutrality. As man creates artifacts, he alters his environment, the sphere in which he lives and operates. An artifact will turn out to have uses beyond what it was designed for, so

there will be unintended consequences.

In the transition to a sedentary lifestyle, changes necessarily occur beyond the expected. A division of labour becomes necessary and a hierarchy results. Since, for example, the land flooded by the Nile needs to be known with precision, quantification becomes more important; this knowledge becomes known to the few. The increase in food production leads to the ability to horde (i.e., saved labour or capital), and the population will increase even as their lifespans get shorter.

In later ages, man has difficulty is distinguishing between the natural and the artificial. He begins to assume that everything is conventional or a “social construct”, without reference to anything transcendent. The success of the artifacts leads men, in their hubris, to believe they have conquered nature. As the experience of the transcendent is lost, man becomes the centre.

Humanism, which purports to magnify man, actually means the abolition of man, i.e., the elimination of his transcendent nature (**Martin Lings**: *Ancient Beliefs and Modern Superstitions*). Lings points out how modern medicine, while extending individual lives, ends up weakening society:

Modern medicine means, in the long run, the abolition of health through degeneration of the species caused by the development of a system which allows man, and therefore in a sense forces him, to flout on an enormous scale the law of natural selection which is nature’s antidote to decadence. To say that we live in a world where everybody is half-dead because nobody dies is clearly an exaggeration, but that at least is the trend.

A medical doctor shows that general IQ has been declining¹³, the more learned we believe ourselves to be.

¹³<http://iqpersonalitygenius.blogspot.com/2013/05/approx-1-sd-decline-in-general.html>

Primordial state Man in the primordial state, in the "Golden Age", lives in a state of nature, but by that we mean nature as created, not de-spiritualized nature, the flattened two-dimensional world of appearances of modern man, which is random, aimless. Rather, nature is three dimensional, "seen" as the reflection of higher states (i.e., "formal cause") and with purpose ("final cause") in an interconnected whole. This is the meaning of organic, "organized", all the parts ordered to the totality. In three-dimensional nature, there can be no perversity. These are not "theories" but rather the result of a direct perception; that is why he has no need for such theories.

There is no need for hierarchy: a man is the priest in his own household, he hunts his food, he manufactures his tools. He is in direct communion with the gods, devas, angels, who were not yet relegated to some celestial abode or remote mountaintop. His mind is not yet cluttered with his "personal" thoughts, fantasies, concerns, and so on, exactly what modern man considers the source of his very identity: "I think, therefore I am."

Posted on 2013-07-11 by Cologero

* * *

Scardanelli on 2013-07-16 at 19:00 said:

"We are so accustomed to think discursively, to talk about, to talk about something out there, to debate interpretations. Instead, it is necessary to unthink, to be in the Silence."

Precisely. I find that I've grown tired of debates and discussions and seek only a transformation of experience. I read and seek knowledge of course, but ultimately what I seek is instruction on operative or "practical" issues if that is the correct wording. I especially appreciate these posts that clarify the way, the daily struggle... I wish it was easier to discuss things of this nature.

muaddibbr on 2016-07-12 at 09:42 said:

"You often hear people casually remark that technology is "neutral", things can be used for good or evil, but they themselves are neither. That is not quite true, as there is no point of neutrality. As man creates artifacts, he alters his environment, the sphere in which he lives and operates. "

Pretty good. What do you recommend for further readings on this point (on technic)?

5.9 The Establishment of a Traditional Society: Workers

Metaphysics of Castes. Workers

This is the chapter on the workers from *La Tradizione Romana* [The Roman Tradition] by **Guido De Giorgio**. In this part, De Giorgio reviews the metaphysical foundations of the notion of castes and prepares the groundwork for the discussion of the specific functions of the workers. In his understanding of the degeneration of castes, De Giorgio says here what Nietzsche should have said, had he had the proper background. What De Giorgio describes as the “principle of freedom” is an essential point to understand.

They constitute the third and final caste that corresponds to the domain of Forms in the sphere of the active life. They should really form the penultimate caste, the last begin the Servile workers, but from the median and reconciliatory point of view in regards to a true and proper return to the spirit and traditional form most easily realizable in the current conditions of humanity, we adopted the threefold formula while knowing that in a more perfect traditional society the number of castes must be raised to four in analogous correspondence with the full realization that, as we pointed out, beyond Silence, it includes a state, the supreme, absolutely undefinable, state designated, in the most complete tradition, with the name of “Fourth” and that is the domain of Absolute Ineffability.

This state comprises and resolves the threefold formula—Silence, Rhythms, Forms—in an integrative indistinction that distinguishes it precisely from them as the mystery of the irreducible unity in its ineffable essentiality. In it the divine cycle is completed totally and integrally. From here the analogous necessity of a fourth caste that would include the Servile workers whose activity assumes the most austere, most elementary, most terminal form.

The constitution of castes must be understood in this way, according to the great law of analogy, i.e., in relation with the divine cycle and not from a purely human and partitive point of view that would have no reason to exist through its fragility and inadequateness to the truth. It is not despotism that creates the castes and especially the servile caste, but rather a necessity of development inherent to the mirroring in the human world of a divine complex that is the one and only reality. The current state of humanity, the apparent abolition of castes, corresponds to the erroneous and confused vision that men make themselves of the divine world: the Divine Principle is currently for men everything they want it to be, i.e., an indecisive and vaguely imminent fog, as men, having abolished caste distinctions, are likewise everything that they want.

The vision of a divine chaotic level corresponds to the leveling human chaos where all pseudo-mysticisms, philosophies, and nontraditional currents flow together, constituting the impure bundle of solidified forms.

But the abolition of castes is unrealizable and they exist even if not explicitly admitted and recognized: their hidden, invisible existence, over which democratism has stratified a leveling haze, creates an incongruence that should strike every person equipped only with good sense. Everyone knows that men are not currently in their place and that the division of the active life is arbitrary and unjustified, because everyone is pushed, constrained by circumstances, by his own impulse and not by a conscious force of order, of the state, and of duty. Everyone knows that there are servile workers who dominate and masters who serve, and that even in the two first castes there are atrocious anomalies and that in the third caste these are furthermore still more remarkable: that is due to the absence of the traditional spirit, to democratic leveling which believes it can enslave those who cannot be enslaved, the determinative characteristic of the inalienable and indivertible human person.

This lasts for centuries and the current confusion is only the result of a slow and progressive degeneration due to the purely apparent superior-

ity of man over the divine, of servitude over freedom, of confusion over order, and disorder over true hierarchy. What determined this fall must be ascribed to the incomprehension of that which constitutes the nature and the form of freedom, confuses with the arbitrary, and forces on everything the humanizations of reality that is actually of an absolutely divine order. Now the constitution of castes is based on the true concept of liberty considered in its four essential forms: absolute liberty in the Priests, conditioned liberty in the Warriors, conditionality in the Workers, servitude in the Servile workers. The two extremes are represented by the first and last caste in as much that what is affirmed in the first is denied in the last and vice versa: they constitute the alpha and omega between which the distinctive qualification exist. Reuniting the two extremes in the unification of the absolute principle that is God, one reaches the integral equalization that cannot be realized unless in the divine place, which is definitely affirmed by all traditions. One will easily understand that by reflecting on the true purpose of castes, to arrange the imbalances in a hierarchy where every element is contained in its own sphere in a way to constitute a homogeneous whole in which nothing introduced disturbs the traditional linearity. Seen from above, the constitution of castes is not presented as a scale that goes from the higher to the lower, by as a system of concentric circles around an absolute point that is the traditional unity.

All the castes are therefore to be considered on the same level and is unfortunately the incomprehension of this elementary truth that has produced the democratic illusion and error. Instead of putting themselves at the higher point of view that is the divine order, men have descended into the human level that has no value when it is cut off from the divine and thus the revolt has happened in the sense of the same caste which, going beyond its limits, has flooded like a river that runs over the banks and violently levels what it floods. Then, after having cut off the human from the divine, with a logic of free will whose unconsciousness is truly

stupefying, the divine plane is confused with the human and what is equal in the eyes of God, they want to transform to equality in the eyes of man, not knowing that equalization is possible only through a being who is beyond the plane considered and, as such, through His own summit, glimpses a unique level while this level does not exist below. They even go back to the sacred texts in order to justify this error of perspective, interpreting it in the most absurd way, overturning every traditional order, abandoning the true God to create a god in man's own image and likeness. It is seen in the abolition of true order, that distinctive, determinative and determined order of castes, the affirmation of the principle of liberty, not knowing that this in the absolute sense exists only in God, while in man it is conformity to the law of God. According to which every element of creation must remain absolutely in its place in order to be the normal element of nature. But since this democratic leveling was unnatural and restrictive, the castes were transformed into classes and the activity generally understood as a complementary way in the unity of tradition and contemplation, was transformed into work, i.e., into pain, coercion, since such is the meaning of the Latin word.

That explains the class warfare that is the degenerate form of disputes between the castes, which, as we said, is always limited to the first two for reasons of quite another order than those who fuel the claims of the current lower classes. Now "work", properly called, can be applied only to the caste of Workers if this is considered as the last for the reason already mentioned, and not to the Warriors and Priests whose activity is absolutely of a totally different order. The latter are tutelary of the divine constitution, the former protectors of the human constitution, and neither of the two castes therefore leads by its activity to the satisfaction of its own needs: therefore in a truly traditional society, it is necessary that the last caste provides the maintenance of the first two, neither the Priest nor the Warrior, being able to work, and that in an absolute way, since work would impede the fulfillment of their very difficult task, the

maintenance of the traditional order.

Referring to the circular symbolism which we just mentioned, if this represents the traditional world as a circle whose center is constituted by the Priests and the circumference by the Warriors, the very close relationship of these two castes in a perfectly organized society will appear: the Warriors represent the centripetal convergence that binds all the points determining them in the univocal axis. They, with their power, defend the traditional purity, which cannot be accomplished materially by the Priests who are contemplatives and who must be protected in the external order by the Warriors. In the convergence resulting from the harmony between these two powers, the two greatest energies of the traditional world, true, integrally solid, power is achieved, the forest of swords that protect God's enclosure. We recommend to everyone to achieve in its fullness the results that would be obtained from the harmony and the cooperation between the spiritual authority and temporal power through the true destinies of humanity brought back into the great traditional riverbed.

Divine Nature of work and art The Worker¹⁴ caste includes every assignment operative in the individuals who do not belong to the two preceding castes which constitute the base of traditional society: authority and power. When we speak of activity, for this last caste, we mean every type of labor both of the strictly material order like the crafts and of those seemingly more elevated like the professions, since both are remunerated individually. In the two higher castes, we do not speak of truly individual activity since their members work constitutively for the maintenance of the two higher powers, while here, in the last caste, it is a question of an active personal determination whose fruit, however, remains limited to the individual order, while contributing to the general order. We are in the domain of Forms, the last determination of visible

¹⁴I have translated the root *lavor-* as labor and *oper-* as work to be consistent.

reality whose essential characteristic is individualization. In this caste, as in the two higher castes, persons can be included who in reality should not belong to it, which is the indication of the current disorder due precisely to the lack of traditional unity whose most obvious characteristic is the arbitrary distribution of wealth. But in a truly traditional society in which the castes are rigorously established, remunerated labor should be limited to the majority, i.e., to those who neither know how to nor can do otherwise, incapable of the pure contemplation of the Priests and the pure activity of the Warriors.

It is therefore necessary to insist on the analogy between the various castes and the three degrees of reality, i.e., Silence, Rhythms, and Forms, in order to understand their true purpose. If the Forms constitute the most exterior part, that does not mean that their determination does not reflect, in a thousand aspects, the invariable unity that is the one true reality. Every form is a symbol and every symbol is the vehicle of a profound truth whose importance must never be forgotten. So-called objects, things, are likewise mirrors that variously reflect the unity of the creative rhythm in multiple aspects. Man, in ordinary life, makes use of tools that he himself constructs but whose symbolic meaning is currently unknown, while in a traditional society this meaning is precisely what is more important because it provides all the value to the thing without which it would be deprived of universal purpose. Hence, the necessity that the tool be patiently constructed and not serially, with an individual labor that itself is the symbol of the effort through which it is elevated to a higher reality of an absolutely spiritual order.

It will be easy for everyone to distinguish the value of an object, the fruit of patient and assiduous work, quite different from that accomplished by a brutal, external, artificial, and sterile process like an assembly line. Hence, the artistic beauty of the most humble tools of an era and the banality of what is produced in modern times by the machine. Previously, there was art, the profound meaning of symbolic correspondence, and

the indicator of this was exactly the care, the commitment with which every object was constructed by the strictly personal work of the craftsman with a diligent technique, in strict analogy with the spiritual renewal wrought in the contemplative and ascetic domain. Every craft then symbolically represented the fixation, in Forms, of a process of an absolutely spiritual order related to a higher reality of which the material world is an appearance, in the strictly etymological sense: man, the creator, makes use precisely of so-called matter—not neglecting the etymology of this word—that is the last, final concretion of reality, in order to redeem it from its apparent blindness and lead it to the transparency of an analogical correspondence with a higher world. So that while in the already made Forms among which man lives, that are the patterns of the Rhythms, are likewise found mirrors of the higher reality, the objects, the things, the tools that man constructs are new forms and represent the work that he must undertake laboriously in order to liberate himself from his humanity and restore in himself the divine state. *Ars et labor*: art is the knowledge of the analogical relationships that govern Forms, by means of Rhythms, and achieve them, i.e., make them porous, transparent, to the breath of God who expresses them, while labor is exactly this effort of enucleation of the deep, hidden, veiled reality, protected in matter from which it must shine through to reveal itself to man. There is thus a contact between the interior—man—and the exterior—nature—which is resolved in a single reality of realized and experienced expression, therefore abolished in its crude materiality and restored to its true origin and purpose.

Thus understood in its profound meaning that justifies it and makes it necessary, art is a redeeming purification that reestablishes the creative rhythm obfuscated and neglected by the preoccupations of ordinary life. This life, in an absolute way, is a death, not a life, i.e., the avulsion of the world and man from the true reality of the world and of man realizable only if hidden in divine reality whose origin it symbolically expresses.

Tools, the most common objects of use, were not created for the satisfaction of our needs, but only to express the analogical relations between appearance and reality, between what appears and what is, between the world and God: their practical efficiency is of the second order and is of value only for true serfs, i.e., for those whose intellectual myopia is so widespread that it results in the exclusion of every truth beyond the environment of their terrestrial life. If, in a state of primitive perfection, it is necessary to think of the exclusion of every order in order to reach or extend what was already given, if man, in this state, gathered the fruits of the earth and fed himself with them and did not complete, with his work, what naturally surrounded him, in later stages, distancing himself from this original standard, he had to reconstruct the access to the divine from which he had fallen and thus a new necessity: art.

To those who know how to examine in depth what we said, the relationship between art and life will appear evident, initially unified so that art was the life itself considered as a rite, then increasingly more discordant, life was reduced to its lowest function and art limited to those who cannot decide to reject truth, up until the current time in which life is really death and art, deprived of every sacred and realizing character, is an expressive monstrosity wherein all the misery of the world and man is reflected.

Art is not redeemed by making of it a need of the spirit: the spirit, and in an absolute way, is nothing if not the Spirit of God, i.e., the breath that is in life, that penetrates and informs the whole man, that makes him feel, act, think according to God, not according to his own humanity. What is human remains human, therefore purely bestial and inferior, which is the level of this humanity, just as everything that is iron remains iron from the most common utensil to the most refined artistic product, both able to lead back to the unity of origin when their exteriority is removed. In fact, what constitutes art for modern men is precisely exteriority instead of the sacred, symbolic content, what this exteriority expresses by relating

to a reality of a transcendent order in the absolute meaning of the word and to a truth of divine order.

Man, in the development of his human faculties, remains man, i.e., nothing: what he feels, lives, accomplishes, thinks, if not beyond the human environment, is destined to perish because it cannot extend beyond time that is succession and beyond space that is materiality.

He remains closed in this prison that he adorns with the most lavish funereal pictures, so that to the extent he embellishes it, so much more will the tomb will exist for him as long as he lives: but, after the dissolution of the body, who is there to take care to lead him into the place of truth, dooming him eternally to that death that he had already experienced in life by rejecting every effort for the surpassing of human limitations. Homo humus: as long as he remains earthbound, he will be doomed to fecundate the earth and to perpetuate the lucifugous illusion that is the detrital, lower world: it is necessary that he clear up the illusory obscurity, due to ignorance, in the light of truth and that he expresses from himself what is hidden, i.e., the other half, which could mean the passage from the archaic word *hemi*, referring to the general meaning of half, to *homo*, where the circularity of the *o* represents the realizing universalization of all the human faculties transposed into the divine and integrated in a essentially superhuman plane. Art is the expression of this transposition that is a true and proper transformation, i.e., a surpassing of the form that is obtained by replacing it in the plane of its normal purpose as symbol of a higher truth. But it is necessary that art is in everything and not in part, that it is not exiled from life and that it does not represent only what we could call the kingdom of fringe utopias, but rather it imprints on the most humble of objects, tools, the seal of its symbolic purpose.

This is craftsmanship, these are the crafts: to depict in every material substance, with a labor of diligent understanding, the intimate, symbolic value, expressing a truth of a higher order, from agricultural instruments and those of the weaving mill, from the most common objects of wood

and earth to the construction of house and temple. They are various modes of expression of a unique reality that signify as all the ways lead to God if truly it is God who is sought and not a simple derivative human more or less dressed up and idealized for the use that one wants to make of it.

How Science Displaces Work and Tradition Hence, the corporations also originally represented modes of realization of the divine organized in a regulatory body that established its purpose. This is the real and deep significance of art, craftsmanship, professions, corporations, and let us not pretend that they all come to fathom it, but what is important is that the *pauci optimi* [the few of the best], who ought to participate in restoration of tradition, understand what is hidden under the appearances of “utility” and “activity”, expressions so dear to those who understand nothing because they realize nothing beyond the illusion of the world and man, both considered without relationship to divine reality. If man is one half, he has to search for the other in order to be made whole, i.e., to be truly man—*homo homo*—and one could say, without making a game of words, that he then will truly be man when he ceases to be so. Likewise the world—if it concludes its etymology—that is attired, ornamented, under which the truth of God is hidden, then it will truly be the world, i.e., the place of purification and resurrection, when it is the world, purified from every ignorance, likewise it also will become—the *lapis manalis*¹⁵ removed—the wide abyss for the precipitation in the spectral kingdom.

From everything that we have mentioned, one easily understands how and why—not for simple purely aesthetic reasons, therefore negligible in themselves—the machine, in all its forms, represents a veritable profanation of labor, because it removes every sacred character, every profound meaning, violating its secret, denaturizing its purpose, suppressing

¹⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lapis_manalis

all those seeds of redemption that constitute the *raison d'être* of manual work and of art.

The return to a traditional society would entail a prudent progressive normalization that would be, for the ignorant mass, a true and proper regression but which could be accomplished gradually without creating catastrophes. It is enough that the *pauci optimi* understand, to their full extent, the absolutely positive consequences that would result from a comparable return to normality: it is a question here, more precisely, of the human dignity that would be restored and reintegrated in all its hierarchical development, in all its expressions, in all its aspects, in all its fields, in all the castes, in all men.

In order to become sacred, labor must be accomplished by man and not by the machine that, as is clearly observed, takes revenge on man, destroying him in the most blind, bestial and inhuman way, violently and fatally. A renovation worthy of the name entails the return to the norm of human labor, a restitution of those conditions of existence suitable for the development of the great energies that lie buried in man and that can permit him to reach and truly integrate the divine world of reality.

Labor, once connected to its necessary base of meditative concentration, of patient meticulous contact with the world of Forms, in order to perceive the Rhythms and realize the Silence, would again become sacred for all men and each one could, according to his possibilities, accomplish what he is destined to do and that he is strongly removed from that outrageously superficial and profaning modernity.

May the earth, the sea, the sky be restored to their elementary purity, returned to their symbolic purpose, the earth in order to construct house and temple, the base point for the elevation from the human to the divine, the sea to the navigation between the two shores that separate the transient from the divine, the sky to the penetrative flight into the reality of God that is the only reality, and that the machines are gradually, prudently reduced and eliminated in order to make a place for man and

put him visibly, without intermediaries, in the face of the difficulties of his celestial task on the earth. Because he cannot escape from the earth if he does not know it, if he does not penetrate it, if he does not make it transparent, letting the holy spirit of the real achievement pass there, returning to labor and art, enriching again the impoverished world, mutilated and profaned by the machine. This was created by the lowest part of man, from what in man is the negation of man because it is the negation of God. We allude to profane science, to that which for so many centuries gives itself the false privilege of redeeming humanity from the chains of materiality.

Here a position of the absolute level that does not admit subterfuge and loopholes is necessary. There is only a single science, sacred science, in an absolute way, i.e., the knowledge of true man restored to his elementary function, to his base, to his centre, to his reason to exist, to his life; to his being, to his purpose, to his perfection, to his universality, to God. This is the only science, the only power derived from the knowledge of his own limitations—it is well established—and of exceeding the limits of terrestriality for the effective realization of the divine possibilities: in this sense only *scire est posse* [to know is to be able] and not otherwise.

One goes to God with and in the spirit of God, becoming again sons of God, be it formulated in the integrative fullness that does not admit secondary residues and disturbances. All traditions affirm it, with different expressions, in various forms, but with an intentional unity that no one can misunderstand and confuse. *Ars una species mille*. What is sacred remains such in every tradition of truly divine order and every race is given a tradition conformed to its possibilities, to which it must remain faithful in order to not make the task of traditional integration difficult, while it is permitted only to very few to return to the Primordial Tradition that is in direct contact with the divine plane.

The true science is therefore that contained in the traditional body and has as its goal the return of man to God in all the forms, through

all the levels, and according to all the possibilities. Sacred science is the true absolute and definitive knowledge of man and the world in God and comprises various planes of development according to the domain to which it is applied, each one of these planes, however, not able to, nor ever having to, be considered in itself, but all in convergence, in accordance with the unity of the traditional axis, into a single point. This was maintained in antiquity and in the Middle Ages. Science instead is of the exclusively profane order and considers visible reality exteriorly, as it appears not as it is, by integrating itself in such a case in the invisible reality and, taking as the base point exteriority itself, it determines laws.

Therefore, while sacred science is fixed, immutable, eternally constituted and causes stable and permanent traditional societies, profane science is mutable, unstable, progressive and, with its development, gives origin to anti-traditional, precarious, and transient societies.

The domain of sciences is the visible, i.e., therefore, the superficial that, as such, separated from the body to which it belongs, is illusory and as nonexistent; the successive development of scientific hypotheses shows the inanity of an effort destined to remain sterile, unproductive, since truth indefinitely postponed into the future, i.e., never realized, is not a truth. What is concrete and positive for science is truly the ephemeral and the negative, i.e., the phenomenal appearance considered in itself, because as we said, when brought back to its invisible root, it reacquired another meaning, another attribution, and another reality.

This sign in the theoretical field can suffice: how much then is the development of the so-called western civilizations the most conclusive demonstration of the practical advantage derived from the applications of science? One thinks of the misery, the precariousness, the frivolity of current existence and one will understand what results science applied to life can lead to. It is not allowed to insist on that without falling into the realization that every reasonable man can currently make, considering the shortness of the duration of life, its sussultatory character, the

rising devirilization of humanity, the precariousness of everything, the spasmodicity of every bond, the insecurity of every system, finally the instability that is the indicator of a permanent abortive process due to the absence of traditional fixity.

Science, having become secular, i.e., popular, became the dominion of everything because it is accessible to everyone through its exteriority, superficiality, and facility and was the principle stimulus to the so-called servile awakening, to the progressive democratization of Europe since, after eliminating every true traditional knowledge and excluding every spiritual surpassing, it leveled hierarchy and, with its practical industrial applications, it amazed the foolish and caused libertarian unrest in the masses, of which the current world is the strongest and most authentic expression. Humanity let itself deviate by easy explanations, by immediate practical applications and has forgotten to ask itself up to what point could it reach such a pronounced deviation from the traditional axis. First of all, science has infinitized so-called nature, divinizing it and exalting its mysteries as if there could be other mysteries outside the divine, then it made a stir on a problematic god who follows with his benevolent eye, approving, the progressive contaminations, and finally, acting autonomous, was proclaimed the guide of research and master of life. Man, destitute of all his power, i.e., the very surpassing of his own humanity in order to reach higher and decisive states, was given instead a false creativity in the world of exteriority that lasts as long as his life and is prolonged as long as he is ignorant.

Conclusion Even those who say and believe they adhere to a tradition have accepted science as the expression of an achievement that, according to them, would not collide with the truths of the divine order; more impure and blind than the others, they implicitly repudiate every spirituality and show they do not know the fundamentals of sacred science: this is exclusive of every knowledge that does not replace the elements of creation

in the circularity of dependence by a unique center of which they are only appearances. Men, accustomed to the separative visions of things, in considering elements and forces, distanced themselves from integrative contemplation for which everything loses precisely that material and determined consistency that is the foundation of scientific investigation. Science rises when traditional knowledge no longer succeeds in maintaining supremacy through the disintegration of its own unity: philosophy, also secular, has substituted for sacred wisdom.

It is a fateful cycle that is fulfilled and whose origins must be traced back to the very nature and the frame of mind of the people of the West incapable of maintaining intact the traditional solidarity in order for them to be brought to the exteriority of the active life. With the progressive dimming of sacred motifs secular motifs arose and the attainments that man was no longer able to accomplish in the domain of the supersensible were limited to those that were easy and exterior for a childish craving for visible concreteness. While the creative process starts from the internal to the external, the scientific process comes from the external, which does not exist as such, to a purely nonexistent and ideal internal subordinated to that which does not exist except as depending on appearance: hence the scientific hypothesis claims to be the standard of method.

The current condition of humanity and antitraditional blooming are due in great part to science, to the scientific spirit, but also to philosophy that, with science, has substituted for sacred science. Philosophy, subordinated to Revelation, is a preparatory and necessary stage to higher truths that must be integrated, experienced, in order to be known: without revelation, it is sterile and false and is transformed into veritable diverting nonsense. Philosophy is based exclusively on reason, which presupposes a revelatory light in order to be guided to truly decisive ends be it only in the theoretical sense: isolated from this, it cannot find any absolute point of reference, because the absolute is beyond reason and beyond man in the sense that these cannot approach it unless ceasing to be it,

which does not prevent them from passing through his terrestrial existence, as everyone will easily be able to convince himself considering that Ascetics and the Saints, those, i.e., those who from this life have reached a permanent state of beatific vision that is fulfilled in eternity, certainly not able to be realized within the limits of time and space. Philosophy is a preparation to sacred science and can constitute its theoretic side only if it is subordinated to it, because otherwise it is nothing: it would not even be of interest to show how and why, from the Renaissance on, modern thought unwound following a direction that is ever more antitraditional in order to be liberated from sacred science that necessarily must precede it because it is focused and productive.

To what extent can Pascal's famous phrase¹⁶ suffice to denounce the incongruity and inadequacy of the god of the philosophers and poets. Divine reality is revealed and no philosophy, if it remains such, can realize it: this possibility is to be excluded in an absolute way: all the acrobatics of human reason will never succeed in grasping that which, being simple, original, and absolute, offers itself from itself through direct realization and cannot actualize itself through a discursive process that is only direct and mediated. Moreover, after what has been said, in the domain of divine unity there is only divine unity itself and what is human is not excluded from it as simply nonexistent, or, better said, as existing only as long as ignorance lasts: this dispelled, and sacred science tends precisely to that, true and proper realization is initiated that, as unitary and passing beyond what is produced and generated, can rigorously be called metaphysical and metarational. We could also call it "intuition" although no psychological quality is given to this term: the psyche in fact is below the spirit, the intellect, the heart—these three terms denoting, under three aspects, the same type of integrative activity of the divine. The spirit expresses the direct integration whose absolute type is the di-

¹⁶God of Abraham, God of Isaac, God of Jacob — not of the philosophers and scholars.

vine breath, the intellect expresses the cognitive permeation, the heart expresses radiant receptivity: by means of the first, one is elevated, with the second, absorbed, in the third, one is welcomed and realizes himself. Representing here a vertical axis, the spirit is the peak, the intellect the base, the heart the center that gathers the two extreme points and extends them, prolonging them horizontally, hence the Cross as radiant symbol of universality and unifying centrality.

No one will dare assert that philosophy can be elevated to this sphere which is of an integrally revelatory order because it is superhuman in the absolute sense of the word. These truths constitute exactly the traditional body, the sacred science, whose transmission happened in a divine way: this knowledge is the true knowledge for the absoluteness and legitimacy of the efforts accomplished in the same axis of truth.

If the Priests are the depositories of it, all men, even the Workers, must extend themselves by giving to their activity a sacred intention and not considering it as the pure satisfaction of their needs and desires. These cannot be, in the seat the truth, distinct in the lower and higher, material or spiritual, in the absolutely erroneous meaning that the moderns give to the last term when they apply it to that which is called the cultural environment. Culture is a profane thing and does not come close to true spirituality: we admit that it perfects the sensibility and develops the intelligence, but it rests completely outside of that which is sacred and real precisely because it is sacred. It is something empty and superficial and is reduced to a vision of life where all the prejudices of the modern era flow into each other, from so-called historicity to linguistics, all exterior sciences that leave intact the domain of the true reality which evades any separative analysis and false constructive synthesis. As behind the Forms there are Rhythms, so behind the visible there is the invisible and as modern sciences stop only at what is expressed but not at that which expresses. Actually, cultural prejudice contributed to the current decline with a dense network of loci communes [commonplaces] which is ap-

plied indiscriminately to the present and the past, all being considered *sub specie alteritatis* in its own function and not as the reflection of a quid that eludes exterior analysis. This is not the place to insist on modern deviations which have behind them a centuries-old preparation which led to the current madness. Nevertheless many symptoms of nausea, fatigue, and glut bring hope that a radical change can still be produced in a progressive way and without too violent perturbations. This rectification can and must happen from the inside to the outside, i.e., it is necessary that the orientation of thought changes and determines the progressive return to normality: let us say "return" meaning especially a restoration of the traditional spirit because the exterior forms can never be reproduced; the cycles do not renew themselves and do not return backwards, repeating developments already accomplished. Nor is it possible to predict how this traditional return will happen if first it is not really initiated with stable foundations and with roots that sink into the very core of the integrally restored traditional unity.

The sad anomalies of current life, the discomfort of individuals and peoples, all the previous misunderstandings serious in themselves but fueled by freedom granted with impunity to those who are not worthy of it, the impoverishment, the progressive cover-up of existence, the vanity of facts, the lack of a secure direction capable of satisfying not only the small needs of small men, but above all the needs of integral man in his true revelatory function of the divine essence—all that brings hope that an awakening can and must be accomplished provided that the *pauci optimi*, conscious of this necessity, does not let itself be submerged by the ignorance of the anonymous and profane crowd.

But if we start from the divine truth as the basis of orientation and we restore the axis of convergence integrally, an endeavor to which the Priests and the Warriors must contribute to, consciously united as being truly the sustainers of tradition, it unites them because the former contemplate and by contemplating realize, the latter because they liberate

activity from its contingent utilitarian character developing it in protective adherence to what is sanctified in the Temple through the maintenance of the sacred deposit, then truly the last caste, which is the most numerous and constitutes the great mass, will also reclaim the Sacred Path where every feeling, symbol of a higher purpose, is established in a single direction like a river from a thousand ripples contained within the same banks, and will be reconstituted, with the fascification of all the energies turned to a single end, the new trunk on the old roots which are still alive and ready to regerminate because revived from the eternal breath of God.

Posted on 2013-06-30 by Cologero

* * *

Graham on 2013-07-02 at 00:12 said:

There are three points somewhat unclear to me.

(1) He speaks of a 'Fourth' state which unifies the others in ineffability, and of an analogous 'fourth' state of Servile Workers. Am I correct in understanding that they comprise those who are 'outside' the caste system, the former by being above it, the latter by being beneath it?

(2) Later he speaks of work versus activity. Am I right in taking this distinction to have some relationship to the principle of freedom? With respect to the circular symbolism he employs, do the rings nearer the centre 'act' in a higher degree, while those approaching the periphery 'work'. It is unclear to me. AK Coomaraswamy writes that the artisan's activity is composed of both contemplation (in conceiving the work) and servile labour (in executing it). Personally, I have found that purely intellectual endeavours feel more nearly like work (in the sense of pain and toil) than do endeavours where 'theory' flows into manual activity.

(3) The meaning of the principle of liberty escapes me. Man's liberty is conformity to the law of God – so far so good. Caste forms a part of this law, self-evidently, so we can say that far from being oppressive, it is most free – a man is most free when he occupies the station conforming to his nature. But can we still say that the upper castes, insofar as they are closer to the centre, have 'more freedom' than the lower castes? There is something quantitative about this thought, and which is incongruent with my experience of being more free when operating within my natural capacities.

I do hope that the next installment will have more to say about the role and possibilities of the Workers. As an aside, for those who may have forgotten, Guenon's *Reign of Quantity* has several excellent chapters bearing on the crafts and their spiritual possibilities.

Avery on 2013-07-03 at 21:41 said:

Graham:

(1) By analogy of India, the fourth caste is part of the initial caste system and is not outside it. Arguably the creation of outcastes is unbalancing and therefore undesirable in Tradition.

I wonder if this missing fourth has anything to do with Plato's *Timaeus* and *Critias*, where the fourth is a necessary part of stability in three dimensional geometry, even though fourths constantly seem to go missing in those dialogues.

(2) Can we get the original word Giorgio is using here? He doesn't seem to be talking about work (*opus*) but labor. Labor, in both its masculine and feminine meanings, is a necessary task but one that requires less intellect than work.

Now some writers claim that work is supposed to be inferior to philosophy. Hannah Arendt places both contemplation and politics above work in classical civilization, and only contemplation in medieval civilization. In my opinion, though, an *opus* is something that, despite being physical, rises above the animal need for labor, as reflected in the ornate work put into all physical objects at the height of great civilizations.

Jacob on 2013-07-03 at 22:26 said:

This discussion reminds me of Josef Pieper's "Leisure, the basis of culture". If you guys have time it's worth picking up. Fairly short, but very good.

Cologero on 2013-07-03 at 23:54 said:

RE (2), this is the sentence: "le caste si sono trasformate in classi e l'attivit  generalment intesa come via complementare, nell'unit  tradizionale, di quella contemplativa, si   trasformata in lavoro, cio  in pena, in costrizione, poich  tale   il senso del termine latino"

Rather than the normal word "lavoratore", he calls this class the "operarii", a neologism.

Why would Arendt put the nobility with the workers in the medieval era? They didn't think so.

The worker's freedom is conditioned since he works with forms as an individual, unlike the Priests and Warriors (although the difference between "conditioned" and "conditionality" is unclear, at least in English.) The Priests tries to transcend form, and the freedom of the warriors is conditioned by his necessary activity in the world, but not by individual forms, they deal with the whole. That does not mean the worker is not free.

The labor of the animal is always natural. The work of man is transcendent and is the reflection of a supernatural reality.

Avery on 2013-07-04 at 01:09 said:

Thank you for the original quotation. Giorgio's creation of a neologism shows that he understands and maintains the essential distinction between labor and opus.

"Why would Arendt put the nobility with the workers in the medieval era? They didn't think so."

If the caste system functions as an order then no part can be disregarded; the whole thing is equally traditional and must remain in balance. I made a very bad summary of Arendt on the way to that point. She was not trying to lump workers and nobility together, but rather show how politics was degraded from a formerly sacred status. Classical politics was seen as part of the pursuit of the sacred, while medieval secular power became distinct from spiritual authority, although it aimed for harmony between the two. (Modern politics, of course, is even worse!) The classical philosophers focused much of their efforts on trying to perfect the earthly city, but Augustine told us to abandon the earthly city and seek the divine. Obviously Arendt's argument was way more complex than this but my memory works best with concrete examples.

Michael on 2013-07-04 at 20:29 said:

Has there ever been a culture that has gone from being like ours to having castes? I can't think of one in recorded history, but there might be something in mythology that speaks to moving from a dark age to a traditional society.

Cologero on 2013-07-05 at 09:18 said:

Following the dissolution of the Roman Empire, there was a concerted effort (documented in Georges Duby's "The Three Orders") to re-establish society on the basis of the three functions described by Georges Dumezil.

Logres on 2013-07-14 at 22:23 said:

This is fabulous; particularly the passage on the cross being the symbol of heart, intellect, & spirit united. I think there are many "workers" who know something is wrong, & are working, with the hope that the Priests & Warriors will begin to act in time.

Michael on 2013-07-17 at 21:13 said:

This is a bit off topic but related since de Giorgio is talking the three orders. To what extent is membership in one of the orders by birth? Evola talks about the priestly caste being twice born, but that would mean that some of the upper caste (or the priests or nobility) are not really of that order if they are not initiates. I think of the nobility of today and it does not seem that they are particularly noble except for birth.

If being twice born is the criteria, then who makes the call?

I apologize if this has already been answered elsewhere.

Cologero on 2013-07-18 at 23:39 said:

Michael, the three castes that Guido De Giorgio wrote about should be "twice born" as they still are in India AFAIK. Not so long ago in Europe, the priests obviously had their orders, the nobility would probably belong to some order of chivalry, and the workers had their guilds.

5.10 Hungry Ghosts

If we don't feed our ancestors, they become hungry ghosts, tormenting, cursing, and frightening us.

Greece and Rome appear to us in a character absolutely inimitable; nothing in modern times resembles them; nothing in the future can resemble them.

NUMA DENIS FUSTEL DE COULANGES, *The Ancient City*

In his still valuable work *The Ancient City*, **Numa Denis Fustel de Coulanlges** reveals the rules by which Greece and Rome were regulated, particularly through their religious cult. There is no doubt that the "conditions of human government" are now much different from theirs (and have changed several times in between). Fustel denies that the changes result from chance or by force as sole explanations.

The cause which produces them must be powerful, and must be found in man himself. If the laws of human association are no longer the same as in antiquity, it is because there has been a change in man.

This change, he says, is in the "intelligence", that is, the ways and patterns of thinking. In other words, besides genetic changes which occur slowly

over time, there is a psychic evolution¹⁷, a change in consciousness, which takes place more quickly. Any attempt to base society on genetics alone (race of the body), without taking into consideration the race of the soul, will certainly fail. Likewise, any attempt to “go back” to the past, without grasping the changes in thought and forms of consciousness, will be futile.

Nevertheless, it is Gornahoor’s position that there is a continuity with our past, and we cannot understand ourselves without taking this past into account. The past leaves traces in our thought¹⁸, whose effects on us are real, even if they operate unconsciously. The Hermetic method is depth, so we need to extract the genetic sources of our psychic lives by digging into these layers of thought, a process which is called “reading the Akashic record.” Usually, as Guenon and Evola do, this involves contemplating symbols and myths of bygone eras, though in this case, we also have written documents.

This is much more than an idle intellectual exercise, since the cult of the dead has been the keystone to the religion of Romanity. Fustel notes that concern for the dead has been part of Indo-European religion. The most ancient generations, long before there were philosophers, believed in a second existence after the present. They looked upon death not as a dissolution of our being, but simply as a change of life. Fustel rightly points out that they rejected reincarnation, even in the Vedas. They recognized two post-mortem states:

- The “celestial abode” that was reserved to the few great men, the heroes.
- A shadowy underground existence attached to the body, family, and place.

¹⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1664%22>

¹⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2178>

The ancient Greeks and Romans buried the dead with clothing, utensils and weapons. “They poured wine upon his tomb to quench his thirst and placed food there to satisfy his hunger.”

It was important to bury the dead so they would they would have a dwelling place. The soul with no tomb was a wandering spirit, vainly seeking the repose he craved (we still say “may he rest in peace”). As a wandering ghost, he could never find the offerings and food it needed. He became malevolent, tormenting the living, bringing disease, ravaging harvests and frightening them. Thus, unlike the moderns whose funereal ceremonies are meant to assuage their grief, the ancients performed them for the benefit of the dead.

The ancients did not so much fear death in itself, but were tormented by the possibility of an improper burial. For example, after one sea battle, the Athenians executed the victorious generals for neglecting to bury the dead.

Periodically, the tomb would be visited by the family, who brought gifts of flowers, wine, and food, again for the benefit of the deceased. In the aftermath of the battle between Sparta and Persia¹⁹, a contingent of the Spartan army visited the battle site annually for at least 600 years.

Yet the duty of the living was not just to provide for the dead, but also to worship them as gods of a sort. This was common to the Romans, Hellenes, and also the religion of the Rig Veda and **Laws of Manu**. A neglected soul became a malignant spirit while an honored one protected the family. Every pater familias was priest in his own home and kept a hearth where he would perform the rites. Hence, a man was concerned that he die without a son who would provide for his needs in the afterlife.

Fustel mentions a further development, or a deeper understanding, where the dead were not always confined to their tombs and their souls lived together in an underground abode. Here rewards and punishments were distributed according to the lives men had led in this world. Fustel

¹⁹See Section 5.7 at this book.

ridicules the earlier beliefs and sees a contradiction where we see a deepening. But we are not so inclined to ridicule our ancestors nor to accept that such practices and beliefs that dominated so much of their daily life were vain and useless exercises. He also explicitly contrasts it to his Catholic faith in order to protect it from his objections to pagan practices, while, again, we see continuity and deepening.

For Catholics, unlike neo-Christians, had a similar dual outlook. The **Saints**, like the **Heroes**, went to Heaven while the rest were relegated to a lesser existence in Purgatory where they are in need of the prayers and offerings of the living. Further, the postmortem state is dependent on the quality of the life one lived, in contrast to neo-Christians who reject any such correspondence.

It is clear that we in the West no longer honor our dead, not just those who oppose the past, but unfortunately even by those who claim to be recovering Tradition. Hungry ghosts are wandering the land in revenge, despoiling our cities, and frightening our people. Steps to take include:

- Honor and remember the dead. Don't speak evil of them.
- When celebrating the lives and accomplishments of our heroes, remember them on the death day, not their birthday.
- Have sons and pass on Tradition.

And this²⁰ is the tradition we pass on:

Here has passed the greatest people of history, and the most astounding of human civilisations: that people must have taken grandeur from the Egyptian, brilliancy from the Greek, strength from the Roman, and, beyond the strength, the brilliancy, and grandeur, something more valuable than grandeur, strength, and brilliancy—immortality and perfection.

²⁰See Section 6.2 in this book.

JUAN DONOSO CORTES

Posted on 2011-06-14 by Cologero

* * *

Graham on 2011-06-15 at 12:07 said:

Could you clarify: what is the relationship between the Akashic record and Purgatory? If I understand you, to say that the souls of our ancestors dwell in Purgatory is the same as to say they are inscribed in the Akashic record. Therefore, to read the Akashic record means to be in communion with the souls of our ancestors. Understanding and propitiating them, in addition to being a filial duty, will bring their protection. Ignore them and they will wreak revenge.

Cologero on 2011-06-20 at 21:49 said:

By "Akashic record", I was referring to the traces left in consciousness of earlier beliefs and events. The examples of saying "rest in peace", in bringing flowers to cemeteries, or belief in ghosts are some of these traces. They use to have a positive and objective meaning, but are really meaningless (or subjective) gestures in any contemporary frame of reference.

As you point out, Traditional European pagan societies did indeed see the necessity to propitiate the souls of their ancestors, so those "gestures" mentioned above made sense in that world view. So it is legitimate to ask whether those societies were deluded and obsessed with meaningless gestures, rites and rituals, in other words, it was a fiction useful for establishing roots, giving meaning, and maintaining continuity and stability.

Or is the contrary correct? To wit, Tradition was correct and our failure to be in communion with and revere our ancestors results in our current state of spiritual upheaval. If so, then how and where was this aspect of Tradition maintained? I say that doctrines such as Purgatory and the veneration of Saints are developments of that Tradition. The souls in Purgatory require the prayers and sacrifices of the living to 'rest in peace'. We pray to patron saints for specific purposes just as the ancients would have prayed to the corresponding god or goddess. I am here not interested in theological or biblical justifications for these practices, which may have their place, but whose necessity arises only when a real experience has been lost and the doctrines becomes a mere belief.

The fact is that is what Tradition was in ancient Roman, Greek and Vedic practice. The man of Tradition feels a compelling need to pray for the dead and ask for their intercessions.

Graham on 2011-07-18 at 10:27 said:

The book 'Purgatory Explained' by one Fr. Schouppe, confirms some correspondances between Catholic and pagan beliefs. Fr. Schouppe relies on scripture and the testimony of saints and mystics for his exposition. Apparently, the soul in purgatory dwells in the grave, – that is, "locally" and in the 'underworld' – and is potentially the source of many temporal and spiritual benefits for the living. Several chapters dwell on the virtue of filial piety. I haven't finished the book, but there has been no mention of such souls becoming malignant or vengeful.

Cologero on 2011-07-18 at 12:24 said:

Thanks for pointing this out. I looked at some of it on Amazon. It says the souls can bring "blessings". There is another book on the same topic (which I am not familiar with) with the coincidentally fascinating title "Hungry Souls". Isn't the point of the book is that there is more than a mere correspondence between "beliefs"? There is a real correspondence between experience, even if the understanding of those experiences differs in some respects.

5.II The Religion of the Ancient City

City States Each family in the Ancient City had its own religion, gods, and rites based on its ancestors, with the head of the family as its priest. Families could unite, called a phratry or curia, in a common worship without eliminating the family rites. They would create a new hearth, offer a sacrifice to the new god, and share the meal in communion. A tribe would consist of several phratries, thus uniting families. Once formed, it was closed to outsiders as it had its own form a worship. A city, then, comprised several tribes, each maintaining its own cult, while establishing a new cult for the city.

Condition of Unity So the city was a hierarchical confederation of families, curias, and tribes, not an assemblage of individuals. A higher entity could not interfere in the interior of a lower. A child was ritually admitted to his family within the first week, into the curia at a later age, and into the city as a teenager at which point he became a citizen. At each point he was initiated into the new cult. It was the spiritual unity created

by the highest cult that united them as a people. It was the hierarchy of religious ideas that inspired and organized the city.

Religious Practice Each city had its own rites, liturgies, gods and forms of worship. There was nothing in common between cities, the priests maintained the sacred books in secrecy, and aliens were not allowed to participate or even enter a temple. No deviations or innovations were allowed.

High Priest and King When a new city was created, by some splitting off from the city or uniting with other tribes, the new city followed the same model. The leader was the High Priest who led the prayers, performed the rites, offered the sacrifice, and interpreted the omens. Thus the founder of a city was a holy man before he was a king. His primary virtue was piety and he exhibited a cold and lofty impersonality, making him more than a man, a god.

The High Priest of the city was also its King and his principal duty was to perform religious ceremonies. The ancients felt themselves to be totally dependent on their gods, and their religion was intertwined with every aspect of daily life. The king derived his authority from maintaining the city's hearth and was appointed by the gods. The allegiance was thus freely given and not dependent on force. The temporal power of the King did not extend to all the citizens. Rather, it went from the King to the heads of the tribes, who ruled over the families and clients of the tribe.

The Alien The citizen participated in the religious ceremonies of the city and if he failed to do so, he would cease to be considered a citizen. The alien could not participate in worship and was outside the protection of the gods of the city. The presence of the alien in a temple would defile it, so rites of purification would be necessary and a new hearth rekindled. Only rarely could an alien become a citizen, and then, only if he was a

citizen of some other city. Although citizens may welcome a stranger, he was still restricted from the benefits of citizenry.

Autonomy Each city was autonomous, united by its common worship. Thus larger alliances with other cities was inconceivable. One city could not rule a nearby city by sending a governor, since that governor would have no spiritual authority in the other city. Warfare between cities was also a spiritual battle between the respective gods. The victors would assassinate every man, woman and child of the losers, or else sell them into slavery. Sometimes the cities could form an alliance and share some forms of worship. The spiritual element counted for everything and genetic, linguistic, and cultural ties did not matter.

Conclusion The citizen had no freedom of religion; either he participated in the religion of the city or he was banished. The hierarchy of family, tribe and city introduced the idea of a wider and wider influence of the gods, but the knowledge of the one god had been lost. Philosophers and initiates in the mystery schools would have known otherwise, yet they also participated in the sacred ceremonies of the city. The esoteric did not preclude the exoteric, a point emphasized by Guenon and Tomberg.

The practices common to the Ancient City recur in different ways in the Medieval period. Priesthood, prayer, sacrifice, communion meals, liturgy, reading the signs of the times, piety, dispassion, the spiritual integrity and unity of the polis, insider vs outsider recognition, spiritual authority, the primacy of spiritual unity over genetic similarity: these are all aspects of Tradition of the past. The Tradition of the future will look similar.

References

Numa Denis Fustel de Coulanges, *The Ancient City*

Fabre d'Olivet, *Hermeneutic Interpretation of the Origin of the Social State of Man*

Julius Evola, *Pagan Imperialism*

Posted on 2011-06-22 by Cologero

* * *

Jupiter on 2011-06-22 at 02:50 said:

It's a good thing civilized religions like Buddhism and Christianity do away with quite a bit of this blasphemous pagan nonsense.

Matt on 2011-06-23 at 01:26 said:

"It's a good thing civilized religions like Buddhism and Christianity do away with quite a bit of this blasphemous pagan nonsense."

What exactly makes Buddhism and Christianity civilized and paganism uncivilized nonsense? Both Christianity and Buddhism incorporated most of the religious practices of the regions that each doctrine spread to (in different ways) which the last paragraph of this post makes note of. Its about whether one sees a continuity between the classical/ancient era and the medieval era (the view of Tradition) or one sees little to no connections at all between the two eras (the view of the modern mindset).

Jupiter on 2011-06-23 at 07:35 said:

There's no continuity between the degeneration at the end of one cycle and the enlightened brilliance at the zenith of another.

The kinds of things in this article have more to do with the Brahmins and Pharisees than the Buddha and the Christ. Superstitious plebeian savagery that assumes the Absolute gives a damn whether we make sacrifices to this dead relative or that piddly little nature spirit.

Matt on 2011-06-23 at 13:31 said:

Jupiter,

That is an interesting take. But if you see what is stated in this post as an example of a degeneration in the Greek and Roman Era, wouldn't that therefore mean it happened right at the founding of Greek and Roman states, and therefore, a degeneration can't even be spoke of, since in your view, the ways of the Greeks and Romans were wrong from the start? After all, the religious rites and practices of the households had been around since the founding of those two civilizations. And it wasn't limited to just the plebs. The patricians had the rites and ceremonies

of their households as well. And to connect this with the east, the rites of the Brahmins had been around since the start of the Vedic Era (as seen in the scriptures).

I do agree that there was a degeneration in India before the Buddha (over speculation by the Brahmins, breaking down of how the rites were performed), as well as one before the Medieval Civilization of Europe (hedonism, the rites largely became an empty formalism, possible nature animism, etc.), but I don't think the rites themselves are examples of the degeneration.

5.12 The Degeneration of the Ancient City

The traditional sacred king was himself of a divine nature and the "gods" were his peers; he was, like them, of "celestial" stock, he had the same blood as they; he was thus a centre, an affirmative, free, and cosmic principle.

JULIUS EVOLA, *Pagan Imperialism*

We assume the readers of Gornahoor prefer scientific instruction to popular propaganda. The path to gnosis requires the first trial, which is to purge all opinions, beliefs and propaganda from one's mind, at least provisionally. Only then can things be seen clearly.

Next, we plan to show how the Medieval period re-established the City as Empire, which events had to happen as they did, and how the degeneration of the Middle Ages followed the same sequence. Only then can we be in a position to look for possible ways forward.

Tradition, Family, Property Whenever **Julius Evola** refers to Paganism, he means the Religion of the Ancient City²¹, whose tripodal support was **Tradition, Family, and Property**. The City was hierarchically arranged under the leadership of the King, and under him, the leaders of the tribes, clans, and families. The religion was based on ancestor worship. The citizen's day and year was structured around the religious rituals of

²¹See Section 5.11 in this book.

the levels of the hierarchy, which included his own role as priest in his own household. The nature gods that we incorrectly identify as paganism were secondary, although there were temples to Zeus, Apollo, and so on, depending on the city. But even then, they were restricted to the city and had no universal significance.

Pietas (piety) was the highest virtue and meant the duties owed to the gods, the cities, the king, the heads of the hierarchies, which had to be scrupulously observed to avoid becoming ritually impure. A citizen did not make a major decision without first checking the omens. Evola describes their spiritual attitude:

There is no room in it for passion, nor for its antithesis, nor for “effort”, and even less for “humanity” and “feeling”. It starts from absolute centres without hatred, without craving and without pity; from a calmness which terrifies and immobilises; from a level of “creative indifference” superior to every opposition.

The families maintained these traditions generation after generation and the purpose of the laws of the city was to ensure the continuation of the traditional rites. Wealth was measured in terms of property, not money.

Revolt of the Aristocracy The Greeks themselves referred to the period of the Kings as their “**Golden Age**”. Evola emphasizes that the king himself was a semi-divine figure, which was not an abstraction or a mere honorific title:

the principle of divine right must be understood concretely and not in a formal and conventional manner: it must be understood in the sense that an actually deified being, as person — beyond any convention and any exterior acknowledgement from another authority — showing an extra-human nature, has the true and legitimate right to rule.

As such, the king was priest, since he was the link to the gods; he was also chief warrior and magistrate, since only he had the passionless indifference to arbitrate the claims of competing tribes or families. Over the course of centuries, perhaps because the king no longer displayed such priestly powers, the aristocracy began to challenge the power of the king. The king was stripped of his political powers, but he could not be removed from his role as Chief Priest. This led to the development of a separate priestly caste while the rule of the city was transferred to a Senate formed by the leading oligarchs.

Revolt of the Clients Only the families who could trace their source back to a pater had a religion, that is, they had the prayers, rites, sacrifices and so on, which were held in secret. However, there were other families, called clients (vassals), which had no pater, hence no religion. They would participate in the rites of the family they were attached to. They did the labour for the family, though they had no rights to property of their own, certainly no civil rights as we would understand them today.

Over time, the role of the clients changed. They may have lost their religion, as their priest may have lost his power, the omens proved false, the sacrifices ineffective. Horizontally, the clients of different families could congregate, forming a separate class within the city. Then vertically, when the army was divided into centuries rather than families, clients would find themselves in different divisions from the pater, diminishing his authority. The client, thus, became a power bloc. At times they could align with the king against the aristocracy, at other times with the plebs.

Revolt of the Plebs Around the city, there developed a population of outsiders, with no family, tradition, or religion. These plebs consisted of alien migrants looking for work (the clients were not numerous enough to do all the servile work of the families), bastard children of the families, clients who escaped from the family, exiles from other cities, and so on.

Following the stages of the degeneration of the city, the status of the plebs changed due, in part, to their mere numbers. The change from a property to a money based economy also changed their situation, since they could become wealthy as artisans, traders, and so on, apart from landed property. Wealth began to replace family, blood and tradition as the symbol of status in the city. Whereas property was sacred and could not be mortgaged in the ancient city, money could be loaned at interest.

This represents the ultimate decline of the city. Although the families continued their private worship (Evola claimed that even in the Rome of his day, there were still families that maintained a hearth), they effectively lost control of the city. It was no longer hierarchically arranged, but stratified into classes with constantly shifting alliances. The king was no more, money was supreme, the meaning of the ancient laws forgotten. Democracy became the accepted form of government and the plebs even led religious rites, thus debasing the hereditary priesthood.

The Religion of the Plebs Lacking fathers and ancestors to worship, the plebs are without religion. That is why Tomberg could write that the lowest classes are atheists. A pleb may try to make himself a god, redolent of the enthronement of the goddess Reason of the French revolution. More typically, lacking hearths of their own, they would attach themselves to the temples of the nature gods. Thus what we today want to recognize as paganism, viz., the cult of the Olympic gods and goddesses (or their Roman counterparts), was actually the religion of the under-class. This is why Evola held the neo-pagans of his (and our) time in utter contempt²².

While the ancient religion continued to be practiced, it was really an empty formalism. The ancestral gods were forgotten, and the nature gods became the norm; they belonged to the universe, not a particular family or city. Wandering poets spread this new religion.

²²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2007>

In this milieu, the philosophers could be more public. Thus, **Pythagoras** brought back the idea of a Supreme Being, **Anaxagoras** understood the God-Intelligence reigning over all men, the Logos as the cosmic order was taught by **Heraclitus**. **Zeno**, the Stoic, believed in a universal God of the entire human race and the idea of a State for them. **Plato** and **Aristotle** sought to understand the structure of man and the state. Such self-doubt would have had no place in the Ancient City.

Summary We have made the barest presentation, since our purpose is not to write history, but rather to understand the principles behind events; we encourage our readers to check out the history books reading them in the light of their understanding of metaphysics and tradition.

The errors of the so called new right, alternative right, neo-pagans, and similar anti-traditional movements that claim to represent the “right” should be quite obvious at this point. The degeneration of castes is a process inherent in any civilization and is not caused from the outside. We have absolutely demonstrated that the decline of the city happened centuries before Jews or Christians were in any way implicated. These are some of the errors of the non-traditional right:

- Money as status symbol and the introduction of usury was not a Jewish injection into the City.
- Ironically, neo-paganism was the religions of the plebs, outcastes and pariahs, and pre-dated Christianity by centuries.
- Monotheism was the understanding of the most intelligent and educated of the pagans, not an innovation introduced by Christians.
- Long before the first Christians, the pagan Stoics entertained notions of Universalism and the Brotherhood of Men.

Posted on 2011-06-26 by Cologero

* * *

Here is a quick list of points to ponder, though hardly exhaustive.

- It is an error to regard the pagan civilization as unitary. That is the point of describing the successive degenerations of the tradition. By the time of Empire, Rome was already degenerate and miscegenated.
- Your definition and understanding of "monotheist" is leading you to a gross misunderstanding. Please use the word in the way we have used it.
- The Vedic civilization is Tradition, not Hindu India which is something else. One cannot be initiated into a Traditional city, had you bothered to read the post. One had to be born into it. Danielou can be nothing other than an outcaste. In the Ancient city (including the Vedas), one achieved immortality by having sons (or else risk becoming a hungry ghost), so its too bad for both you and Danielou. You should be disappointed with the pagans, I'm just the messenger.
- We have dealt with the issue of Christian polytheism, which proves our point.
- We are interested in the origins and destiny of one people: the Hyperboreans, their descendants, migrations, and eventual unification. That requires a spiritual unity, not genetic, as has been made clear. There is an anonymous text floating around, whose actual source is Fabre d'Olivet. But they left out the concluding chapters on the necessity of a "supreme pontiff", that is, the high priest of all Europe.
- I know my English isn't so good, but didn't we make the point that the city was composed of a hierarchy of families, clans, tribes? So would be Empire under the high priest be the same? Haven't we over and over said that for Tradition unity doesn't mean non-differentiation, but rather hierarchy and harmony.

The whole exercise, therefore, has been to draw out the principles, not just to repeat mindless propaganda that appeals to the emotions of some manly past. Alas, there is no one paganism to return to, which, as Evola pointed out, was just one of the Aryan civilizations. If we prefer to mine the third such civilization to discover those principles, it is because we have some deep reasons for doing so.

Matt on 2011-06-27 at 23:57 said:

It is interesting that you state that the olympic gods was the religion of the underclass, instead of the cthonic/underworld gods (are you thinking of writing a post on that subject in the near future) as what Evola and others suggested. I thought the post was good. Did a nice job of pointing out that the process of degeneration starts within the civilization.

Looking forward to your post on the Middle Ages.

Cologero on 2011-06-28 at 00:38 said:

The cult of the Ancient City was based on ancestor worship. The nature gods of Olympus also had their temples, but they were secondary. The ancients were neither tolerant of other gods nor syncretistic, despite what the new right and neo-pagans claim. The cult of Zeus in one city was different from another, so there was no commonality.

When the plebs came into positions of power, they had no family gods, so the only way to integrate them into Rome was to allow them entry into the temples of the Olympic gods. Rome had the three main cults of Jupiter, Mars, and Quirinus corresponding to the three main castes. As the memory of the ancestors began to fade, and the rites became lax, paganism came to be exclusively associated with the cult of these gods and the other nature gods.

The problem with the neo-pagans and the new right is their tendency to conflate centuries, or longer, into a single anachronistic panorama, whether they deal with pagans or Christians. Instead of communicating in terms of principles, they become evangelists for some sort of imaginary neo-paganism that is scantily related to the ancient city. They also fail to deal intelligently with the Middle Ages, considered by both Evola and Guenon to be the last example of traditional civilization in the West. In reality, I don't really care to refute them, since they do that pretty well on their own. My only goal is to dispute their claim to be so-called "Traditionalists", otherwise I wouldn't waste much effort.

The fundamental objection is that they are really partisans, that is, propagandists, and not interested in objective, metaphysical, or scientific knowledge. That is why, for example, they whine about Charlemagne so much, since their simplistic formula is "pagans good, Christians bad" and this partisanship colours all their commentary. We, on the other hand, prefer to analyze events in terms of principles such as how can spiritual unity be extended from the City to the Empire? What are the roles of the Pope and Emperor, and how are they related to the High Priest and King of the ancient city? How was the caste system manifested in the Middle Ages? and so on.

Matt on 2011-06-28 at 03:55 said:

Cologero, re-reading the post again and taking some things into account, I think I now understand what you mean by using the word nature in reference to gods. Placing the olympic gods in that category (for lack of a better term) along with the cthonic ones now makes sense. Would the term "supra-natural" (above the sphere of fate and necessity) be valid for the ancestral

heroes?

Cologero on 2011-06-28 at 08:24 said:

The Olympic gods had their domains over nature: the wind, thunder, the sea, crops, and so on. They are, therefore, related to Destiny or Fate, and are portrayed thus in the myths..

The gods of the city are associated with Will, so yes, in a sense that is opposed to fate and necessity. The City is where men act, apart from the natural forces (fate, necessity) to which man is subject. The rites were designed to placate the gods to gain their favour. Note that purity is necessary, the ancient city was not tolerant and did not allow "false" or alien gods into their city or cult. Those without family were excluded from the rites of the city.

Cities with a common ancestor would be "friends"; cities with an incompatible genealogy were "foes". No one had to wait for Carl Schmitt to figure that out. That is a factor that gave Rome a great advantage. Some 20 cities between Asia Minor and Italy claimed descent from Aeneas. Thus they were by necessity allies to Rome, despite any differences in ethnicity or language.

This is the pagan way, based on family, friends, foes, tradition, exclusiveness, reading omens, rites, rituals, animal sacrifices, and so on. We see none of that from the neo-pagans, who nonetheless claim to be their spiritual heirs. Apparently they are learning this from "academic" philosophers of the new right. If that is so, I want to reassure everyone that I have absolutely no academic credentials.

Ismo on 2011-06-29 at 15:26 said:

A few points from concerning the spiritual (ideal) and concrete battle, Evola, and this article:

1. Today's battle is fought primarily on the plane of ideas, and there is absolutely NO point or hope in trying to fight the material battle, since the whole existential atmosphere is against it. The cyclical wheel and the Kali Yuga is only too close to its ending for a 'grand scale correcting action'. no matter how far away it may seem to be from the human stand point. This is the whole point of 'riding the tiger'. I think you and other New Rightists are aware of this also. This should NOT be a call to inaction or for the lack of principles, but absolutely the other way around, however. However, in today's world it is possible to wake up only those few individuals who still have some sort of a foundation, no matter how confused it may be. It must be realised that what you, Cologero (and myself / others of the same inclination) are doing is planting the seeds of the coming age. The world and its masses are too dead or deaf to wake up other than via massive catastrophes and other existential destructions.

2. As regarding the jews, I think most of those who have studied history know their negative role as instruments of destruction etc., yet again, what we are right now facing is the fact that most of those who are physically or otherwise 'aryan' are in many ways not really acting any differently. Evola also noticed this fact in his *Path of Cinnabar* and said that there's no point in making the separation into jews and aryan today in larger scale; he also made it clear that a

jew can have an aryan soul and vice versa, and this is really the only thing that matters and is nowadays as plain as daylight. My point in this is the following: The degeneration of Aryans by jews is an overt simplification (though an attractive one, if one wishes to find an enemy to point ones finger to), because, if the Aryan would have been alive and well in his soul and spirit, he could have resisted the seed of degeneration in its germinal form. Of course this takes nothing out the instrumental role the jew has played in all of it, but the cause itself is much deeper and is partly if not wholly in the cyclical conditions. Evola also warned that making faux targets is one of the weapons of the counter-tradition / black forces, and blaming the jews about everything is precisely one of the faux targets; just see what has happened via Nazis and their fundamentalist anti-semitism and distorted aryanism! "It is important not to give weapons to enemies." – Evola

3. As for Family and Property, these are not a priori "bourgeois" institutions. The bourgeoisie as a class (and class mentality itself) didn't even exist before modernism. Evola always recognised the important instrumental role of the bourgeoisie, although it can easily be interpreted from his writings that he despised them (and most of humanity, to be precise, aha). This is, however, a mis-interpretation: Evola only wished to make it clear, that the Vaishyas (=bourgeoisie) and Shudra need to be kept in a tight leash by the spiritual and intellectual elite, and that every great civilisation is and has been made / being given birth by this small minority and not by the merchants and servants who lack the truly creative potential. This has been recognised, by the way, as one of the very reasons the jews have been at the forefront as instruments of the Kali Yuga = They, as a collectivity, cannot create anything of their own, they can only steal, plunder and distort. History proves this, so this is not an opinion or a personal prejudice.

Lastly: the greatest of mistakes we can do is to fight petty, personal and egoistic fights. This is precisely what the real enemy wishes, to divide and conquer.

Perennial on 2011-06-30 at 01:20 said:

Ismo, Brilliant! Brilliant! Brilliant! Excellent post, and exactly the right type of position we need to take. I have often pointed out that the forces of Tradition should reserve their internecine battles until AFTER victory, and not before. We can shoot it out after the modern world is nothing but a heap of ashes. In any case, you are right, we must build the foundation of the inner resistance before any talk of broader engagement can arise, because at this point awareness is too low to allow for a possible victory. Time, patience, and building strong fortifications and foundations with ideas, customs, and understanding will lay the road for our ultimate, and even inevitable, triumph over this decadent age.

Ismo on 2011-07-01 at 08:48 said:

Thank you both for your kind words. Perennial already said the main points about Evola's stance and how it should be looked upon. I think the most important thing in it, with which every one of us can easily familiarize with whether we disagree or differ with his extremist anti-

bourgeois elitism or not, is that spirituality, culture and true intellectuality (and not the modern academic 'intellectualism'. should be the defining values over economic or social questions in a narrow sense.

Ismo on 2011-07-01 at 08:58 said:

Oh, and one thing that I forgot as an example: Leonidas of Sparta and many other Spartan warriors had both families and property. If one dared call them "bourgeois" they'd penetrate one's hearts with the spear of destiny!

The point is that it matters nothing if one has children or not or money / property or not, it is the inner bourgeois mentality with its vulgar and cowardly "values" one needs to erase for good.

Cologero on 2011-07-01 at 10:02 said:

Thanks for your points, Ismo, but I'll make some further clarifications. There is a difference between the property (meaning land estates) class and the money class. in the Ancient City, land was sacred, therefore it could not be mortgaged; it could not be exchanged without a religious rite. The money economy was different, since money could be easily exchanged. The underclass and out-castes could participate in the money economy; that eventually undermined the City, and more so, the Empire. It was important to the aristocratic class to pass on the religious traditions exactly, which required sons. This is Tradition, not engaging in a costume drama at the feet of an Asian master.

One must not confuse personal choices made in the open society of today with the traditional outlook. In the Ancient City, there was no choice. One participated in the religious rites of the city, one followed its laws, and so on. The whole of life revolved around Tradition. To continue the Tradition, a man needed to have sons. If anyone sees in this "bourgeois values", then his understanding is deficient. In the modern world, there is no such way of life. Guenon chose to go to Egypt where he raised a family. (He did not go to India because of the birth-right caste system, which he could not have participated in. Nothing to do with passport issues.)

Since he did not regard the Catholic church as traditional enough, Evola made the deliberate choice to live WITHOUT tradition. He hoped the political zeitgeist of the time would eventually lead to the restoration of the pagan civilization, similar to what I have described; it was not to be. Therefore, one should NOT use him as an example of following tradition. There are many ways to live in the modern world, but only one in the Ancient City. His was just one way to cope. Therein lies the absurdity of calling oneself a "Traditionalist"; a man is living a tradition or he is not. We are not.

A further point about his personal life. Evola lived simply, his needs were few. He had book royalties and a small salary from his regular writing for the journal *La Vita Italiana*. He lived with his mother, although not in the basement. After the war, he relied on benefactors.

A further point, Ismo. The greatest danger is a traitor in the midst. The 300 were defeated not by the Persians, but by one of their "own". It is best to expose them early.

Cologero on 2011-07-02 at 09:18 said:

It's interesting that Kerouac, like Evola, lived with his mother. So what happens when everyone is a rebel? We get the pathetic sight of 60 year old men in pony tails dancing with jerky movements to Credence Clearwater Revival. If their goal was to epater la bourgeoisie, what happens when they become the bourgeoisie? The Western ideal has been the puer aeternus, and in this deracinated, feminized, homosexualized world, he now runs the show. It is an easy thing to be an anarchist, and much more difficult to follow the cosmic order. This rebel without a cause is tolerated, even encouraged, in this world. It turns out they are easy to control, because a man without a tradition, the man who rejects his tradition, has no culture and is easily propagandized and advertised to.

So who is the new rebel for our age? Men with guns and natural sons who follow in the ways of their ancestors, the ways that every well bred man considers sane and normal.

James O'Meara on 2011-07-02 at 11:31 said:

Even if Evola didn't intend everyone to live as he did, our evaluation of him depends on how he managed it; extreme poverty, like Simone Weil or bank robbery, makes a difference. I have read that after the war he lived in an apartment in Rome "provided" by a Prince who was a fan. Reports of his last days indicate a maid of some kind. When did Evola live with his mother, Colgero, may I ask? Who supported whom? When Kerouac finally started making money his mother was old enough to need his care, so one way or another he wound up spending most of his life with her.

Of course, "living with one's mother" takes on a different connotation if you are, say, Prince Charles. This raises the vexed, for me at least, question of "Baron" Evola's nobility. I haven't found any trace of such a family among the Sicilian nobility, although there was a Natale "Joe Diamond" Evola (February 22, 1907 – August 28, 1973) who was a New York mobster who briefly became boss of the Bonanno crime family. Was it common for Sicilian nobility to enter the Mafia? Was Joe a black sheep sent abroad? Or was it Julius who, like Michael Corleone, tried to leave the Family?

Cologero on 2011-07-02 at 12:37 said:

There is no trace of the name "Evola" in the Sicilian nobility registries. But, then, Evola is the Italianized spelling of a Norman name. In the 1400s or so, the Sicilian nobility was replaced by outsiders in order to consolidate the power of the invaders, and the Evola line may have been a casualty. The first Salvo arrived from Tuscany, presumably to fill one of those roles; that is probably why "Salvo" is in the registry.

We here at Gornahoor are interested in the actual dharma of the traditional civilizations, not in the lifestyles of modern rebels. The moment now has a different quality; were it still the time to "ride the tiger", I wouldn't bother with a public blog that brings me no benefit (I have no red thermometer or tip jar; we don't sell books or t-shirts or journals. I have asked for help with work, but I think most men today would prefer to send me \$20 than to actually do something.)

Dharma, piety, duty: that is how a man evaluates his fellows. Evola supported the fascists, but wouldn't commit. He ran away when the allies reached Rome (sneaking out the back, while his mom kept them at bay), while Giovanni Gentile, a far nobler man whom Evola criticized unfairly, stood by the Salo Republic against the wishes of his family. Evola knew and accepted what the popes wrote against democracy, liberalism, socialism, yet opposed them publicly. He praised the "Catholic philosophers of authority" (de Maistre, Donoso Cortes) while rejecting any authority over himself.

Apparently he believed he was beyond caste and beyond tradition, but when the bodhisattva returns, he nevertheless pretends to play the game.

Izak on 2011-07-02 at 19:10 said:

I didn't care for the beginning of this debate at all, but this conversation just got very, very interesting.

"It is an easy thing to be an anarchist, and much more difficult to follow the cosmic order. This rebel without a cause is tolerated, even encouraged, in this world. It turns out they are easy to control, because a man without a tradition, the man who rejects his tradition, has no culture and is easily propagandized and advertised to."

This has always been one of my basic maxims on approaching life in the 21st century. I also am of the opinion that Evola has a very distinct danger to him, which is that he can be romanticized much more easily than the other traditionalists like Guenon or Burckhardt, or whoever. Schuon allowed himself to be turned into a demigod of some sort, and he led people down the wrong path. Rudolf Steiner wound up being the romantic hero of the new age, having schools created in his name — I've seen Waldorf schools, and I recognize nothing of a traditional character in them. Krishnamurti has led many men astray. They all have magnetic presences.

All of this is why I get wary very, very quickly with those who cite Julius Evola's opinions on things that don't really concern the primordial tradition, or which aren't really connected to deeper issues not of the current times. I think "Ride the Tiger" was probably the most important book he wrote because it concerns the strategy for the here and now, but it is also very problematic. I don't believe I've ever read a book in which I agree with so much, and at the same time so little!

Ouranoi on 2011-07-02 at 19:38 said:

Yes one of the more interesting threads that have appeared here. It's always important

to note the practicality of any traditional method applied to living it in reality. In these cases romanticism and dogmatic ideology can no place here although in the midst of time they feed on each-other. There is a reason people did things in the past the way they did due mostly to opportunity and circumstance.

Ouranoi on 2011-07-02 at 19:39 said:

while we're at it I could not resist with this interlude on the subject of Evola's nobility and his mother (Concetta Frangipane) which is surname of one of Sicily's oldest aristocracies (the crest is distinctly Norman in character):

<http://www.regione.sicilia.it/beniculturali/bibliotecacentrale/mango/franchi.htm>

http://www.sicily-genealogy.com/cognomi_defghi.htm

It's all well and good to try and knock Evola's character but he only fled when the allied police came literally knocking on his door (his mother distracting them) giving him precious seconds to flee out the back. Did anyone question William Joyce's tip off from MI6 insiders when he too fled Scotland yard by minutes to make his infamous career in Berlin?

Perennial on 2011-07-03 at 03:35 said:

Fair observance Ouranoi! You apparently are better educated on Evola's personal life than most. I will note that in my readings of Evola's life, all that is said is that he was a Baron from Sicily, not a Sicilian noble. The Regno delle Due Sicilie may not have, in fact, been a source of his nobility at all. In any case, I accept Evola more as my philosophical benefactor, my spiritual godfather so to speak. I do not feel compelled to accept his views without exception (and I do not) and mostly use him as a foundation for building my own edifice, which, I believe, is what being traditional is all about. Tradition focuses our lives away from the unimportant, through ritual and customary practices, and gives our minds the freedom to focus on higher things. It is after people stopped living by custom and tradition that they began to pester their minds with other ludicrous nonsense, not having the ability to discern what is, in fact, actually important and worth meditating on. Real freedom is in knowing who you are, and where you are from, and from there where you can go. The idea today that people need to build an edifice from scratch within themselves and without is too much to ask of the average person. We all need a foundation to build from, for few individuals are in the position to build it for their own. Thus Tradition.

Matt on 2011-07-03 at 04:10 said:

Cologero, your comment on baby boomer hippie rebels was funny and on the mark. Unlike many young people my age who think having parents like that is a mark of pride, I personally would be downright embarrassed if I was raised by parents like that (fortunately I wasn't).

And yes, it does seem a little odd, to say the least, that Evola, who considered himself to be apart of the warrior caste, chose to flee fascist Italy instead of staying to fight for something that he defended in his political writings at that time (for the most part). I think that is what is truly more revealing of the unsavory side of his character (not saying that his unsavory side encompasses all of his character), not his general support for fascism, but his lack of will in defending it when the time came.

As for the talk of fathers and sons, I hope that we are not quick to disregard the way of the monk as a viable path of revolt (and a path to true knowledge) to the current age.

5.13 The Mind of the Ancient City

The Primordial State of Mind It is necessary to recognize that the citizens of the **Ancient City** were not academics or philosophers, they were not converts to the religion of the city, nor were they immigrants. The only way to be part of the city was to be born in it (or to be a client of a citizen); we have already described the initiation ceremonies. Their state of consciousness was different from and incompatible with the modern mind, and was closer to the Primordial State²³. In that state, a man's concern was his duty and to do it perfectly. Such a man's consciousness was undivided, something hard for moderns to grasp when everyone today is so cantankerous.

The rites of the family, clan, tribe or city were oral, not written, and passed down from generation to generation. This is why it was so important to have a son, although adoption was also an option. Apart from the performance of his duties, a man didn't suffer from a divided mind; he was, so to speak, beyond good and evil. If a client failed in a task, a chief could punish or execute him with no sense of guilt. The enemies of a city would be slain — man, woman, and child — or perhaps sold into slavery. That is what it means to not “love your enemy”. Of course, your enemy does not love you either . . . it certainly focuses the mind. Your enemy was

²³See Section 2.1 in this book.

not someone of a different race, or an adherent of a rival political system; rather he was someone who worshipped different gods. The gods of the city were jealous gods.

The performance of rites was critical. If a **Vestal virgin** allowed the hearth fire to go out, or lost her virginity, she was buried alive. At least in the **Inquisition**, a heretic had a fair trial before being tortured to death. The destiny of the city depended on the sacred fire. Only citizens could take part in a sacrifice at the fire. The heroes were worshipped in the city, sometimes for a thousand years, and to possess their relics was a sign of good fortune. Some today still save the bones of their heroes.

Fate Although the ancients were very skilled at their arts, such as farming, generalship, and so on, there was always a factor outside man's control that oftentimes caused the most skilled to fail. This was the element of chance, or fate. In the city, everything that happens is the result of man's will. Lacking the conception of abstract thought and principles, by analogy, fate is attributed to the will of the gods. Thus, the men of the city sought good fortune for their families and the city through their rites, sacrifices, invocations, and auguries, all designed to bring on good fortune from the gods.

Nevertheless, over time, they had to notice that their rituals were sometimes ineffective. Also, with the multitude of gods, each with their own requirements, there could arise conflicting claims of duty, both binding. These competing claims were a theme of Greek drama. The general policy was to imitate the gods. However, the gods themselves often fought each other. Hence, one should follow the oldest god. This led to Zeus, or ultimately to Uranus. But Uranus mistreated his children which went against the entire practice of the city.

The Philosopher Eventually such conundrums had to awaken in some minds the "knowledge of good and evil", or discursive thought. Once

things could be questioned, the blind and unquestioned system of duties holding the city together began unraveling as we have seen.

If true knowledge was the knowledge of the unchanging, the necessary, and the whole, then the gods themselves were ignorant. That is why they were in conflict. Hence, it is insufficient to follow the gods, one must develop an understanding of the ideas. This is the metaphysical meaning of polytheism: the gods are ignorant of the whole and hence cannot serve as a reliable guide for life. They fight because they are ignorant. So the man who tries to follow the gods will be drawn into their own inconsistencies and conflicts, thus can never be a whole man or know his true will.

The philosophers, formerly restricted to mystery schools become more public. They debate the meaning of duty, justice, the city, nobility, piety and so on. For the old guard of the city, they understand that if the philosopher follows the ideas, then he has no need for the gods. This is what got Socrates into trouble. Yet Socrates has his own conundrum. Society is impossible without the sanctity of following ancestral customs, which is the duty or piety to the gods, who seem to be unnecessary.

On the one hand we have, as fundamental, a blind **love** (that is, without knowledge) for the gods, because justice is whatever is willed by the gods, without question or external ground. On the other, we have **knowledge**, or wisdom, as fundamental and we love whatever we know to be true and good, which are superior to the gods. In the dissolution of the Ancient City, this question motivated the next Traditional civilization.

Posted on 2011-06-28 by Cologero

The Second Rome. Christendom

6.1 Spiritual Reinvigoration

Across the centuries, it is the drowsiness of the disciples that opens up possibilities for the power of the Evil One. Such drowsiness deadens the soul, so that it remains undisturbed by the power of the Evil One at work in the world and by all the injustice and suffering ravaging the earth. In its state of numbness, the soul prefers not to see all this; it is easily persuaded that things cannot be so bad, so as to continue in the self-satisfaction of its own comfortable existence. Yet this deadening of souls, this lack of vigilance regarding both God's closeness and the looming forces of darkness, is what gives the Evil One power in the world.

JOSEPH RATZINGER, *Jesus of Nazareth: Holy Week*

The primary source of beings, he is also the principle of cohesion and harmony; he makes of the created world a COSMOS, an ordered universe, by giving it a meaning and a value, by orienting it toward a goal.

HUBY

Last weekend I listened to a long interview on a new right site criticizing “Christianity”. There was nothing new in it, just the same repetitious, and mostly false, claims. On the other hand, I suppose he looks around and sees nothing compelling in the religion of his ancestors, and projects that back into time. Unfortunately, he has no understanding of metaphysics, so most of his objections are wide of the mark.

So I want to address some of his concerns at a deeper level. But first of all, let us be clear about the meaning of “religion”. It is not first of all about hard-to-believe stories. In this regard, we rely on **Rene Guenon**’s description of the fundamental points of religion and tradition in order to evaluate the Traditional Christian religion. It can also serve as a set of guidelines for anyone trying to design a new religion on his kitchen table. Since most of these issues have been dealt with in other essays on this blog, I will only sketch them out here.

The Elements of Religion Guenon identifies three properties necessary for a religion. These are:

- Doctrine or dogma
- Moral law
- Cult or worship

Doctrine Dogma or doctrine represents the intellectual element of religion. Guenon has elaborated a fundamental metaphysic in several of his books. Hence, a true tradition is in conformance with that metaphysic. Now religious dogmas can be restated as metaphysical doctrine, but the opposite is not the case. That is because dogmas take form in specific historical situations.

For example, the dogma of monotheism is understood doctrinally as representing the primary principle of Being. Closer to our task, Ratzinger elucidates the Christological dogmas defined at Nicaea and Chalcedon by bringing out their deeper meaning in respect to our understanding of what it is to be a person, or the relationship between the human and divine will.

Moral Law A religion is based around a moral law which is its social element. If the created world is a “cosmos”, it has an inherent order. Unlike a rock which has no choice about following the cosmic order, a person can deviate from it. The moral law guides us into being in conformance with that law. Somewhat paradoxically, this leads us to freedom, since the alleged “freedom” in acting against the law turns out to be bondage to lower forces.

Antinomianism is rife in Christian thinking today. “Love” is understood as the absence of moral law, since that is seen as “judgmental” or “intolerant”. This sort of “love” is the love of servitude. As **Nikolai Berdyaev** points out:

Man is in a state of servitude. He frequently does not notice he is a slave, and sometimes he loves it. It would be a mistake to think that the average man loves freedom. A still greater mistake would be to suppose that freedom is an easy thing.

That is the danger of antinomianism. As Jesus said, “If you love me, you will keep my commandments.”

Cult and Worship The religious rites tie the intellectual and social elements together. All rites have a symbolic character, and so can also be understood in their metaphysical sense. Moreover, rites are also efficacious as conduits of a spiritual influence.

Exoterism and Esoterism Guenon points out that a tradition has an exoteric or outer aspect as well as an esoteric or inner aspect. Guenon writes:

Exoterism, comprising the more elementary and easily understandable part of the teaching, which was consequently more readily brought within everybody's reach, is the only aspect to be expressed through the writings that have come down to us in a more or less complete form.

Esoterism, being more profound and of a higher order, addressed itself as such only to regular disciples of the school who were specially prepared to receive it, and was the subject of a purely oral teaching.

Nevertheless, they do not represent two different teachings and cannot be contradictory. Oftentimes, the esoteric understanding is misunderstood by the super-correct exoteric adherents, who consider a threat and a different religion. On the other hand, esoterists can become prideful and forget their connection to the exoteric teaching. The burden is on the esoterist to avoid causing scandal. That is why they should participate in the rites, even when they are understood on a deeper level, and avoid trying to force their ideas on the exoterists.

As an example, Ratzinger points out that Jesus is “observant”, i.e., exoteric: he celebrates the Jewish feasts, prays in the Temples, recites the psalms. Yet he also provides the inner meaning to exoteric ideas such as the purity regulations, the inner meaning of the Ten Commandments, and the Temple. Jesus followed temple, prayed psalms. But he also brought something new, i.e., the inner meaning of the commandments, or the temple.

Symbols, Myths, and Science The interviewee also complained about the stories that he could not believe. That is not an uncommon problem,

first of all because in the current state of degeneration there is little or no self-awareness as a spiritual being in many people. Nevertheless, this could still be a problem for seekers. Hence, we have pointed out Guenon's and Evola's understanding of myth, even translating some of Evola's essays on the myths of the founding of Rome.

Likewise, we've pointed out the deeper meaning in the infancy narratives of Jesus. Guenon also insisted that there could not be any conflict between positive science and metaphysic properly understood. That is why we posted an essay on the story of Adam and Eve. Moreover, we've used the examples of the positivists August Comte and Charles Maurras to show that there is no necessary disconnection between science and the natural moral law as such.

Cause of Degeneration Another common objection is that "Christianity" somehow "caused" the degeneration of the European people. In other words, a healthy minded people somehow grasps onto an idea that then causes their decline. That is an obvious absurdity, confounding cause and effect. Rather, a degenerate people, having lost sight of their spirituality, will then latch onto inferior ideas. Evola, in *Sintesi*, understands this, although in a rather confused way.

We can continue to call the Germanic peoples of the invasions of the Roman Empire "barbaric"; barbaric, however, not in relation to degenerate Roman civilization, in which those people appeared, but in relation to a higher stage from which those races had fallen. Among the proofs of such an interior degeneration, or spiritual obscurity, is the relative facility with which such races converted to Christianity and then to Protestantism. For that reason, the Germanic peoples in the first centuries from the fall of the Western Roman Empire to Charlemagne, were not able to oppose anything of importance in the spiritual domain to the crepuscular forms of Romanity.

That is, he claims, the Germanics had already degenerated by the time of their invasion of the Roman Empire; hence they readily converted to Christianity. Oddly enough, in his view this degeneration lasted until Charlemagne, the driving force behind Christian Europe. So the inner logic does not support Evola's contention. It is true that the Germanics had fallen from a higher stage, but it was Christianity that then raised them back up, to form the foundation for the Medieval civilization.

Alleged Semitic Influence Another objection is that Christianity carried Semitic ideas into the European mind. Once again we turn to the thoughtful pagan Julius Evola. In this passage, he points out that the ancient Hebrews were spiritually sound.

It is not the ancient Hebraic, messianic idea, but its degeneration and materialization that is the true focal point of the subversive forces turned to the final destruction of our civilization and to a Satanic dominion over all the forces of the earth. In its original sacred form, prior to the period of the prophets (that indicated the first mystical and democratic fall of Israel's ancient tradition), the idea of the Messiah had many traits in common with familiar conceptions and ideals of essentially Aryan civilizations, from which, moreover, the Hebrews more than once borrowed many elements.

JULIUS EVOLA, *Transformazione del Regnum*

He sees the idea of the expectation of the return of the "Messiah" as equivalent to the return to a "Golden Age". When the Messianic ideal degrades into a merely material form, devoid of its spiritual roots, then there is subversion. This is more or less what some have called the "immanentizing the eschaton". So here we have the justification for the Nine Worthies¹.

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=331>

Conversion of Iceland A final point is the idea that Christianity was somehow forced on the pagans. Apart from some isolated cases, that was not what generally happened. As an example, we can point to the story of the conversion of Iceland. First of all, we cannot deny the courage of the Vikings, their ferocity in battle, fearlessness in the face of death, and their love of their fate.

Nevertheless, there was a certain amount of thuggery, as the Eddas reveal. They would often raid unprotected monasteries on the coast of England, even extracting ransoms from Paris. By the standards of the Saxon **Robin Collingwood**², this disqualified them as a civilization.

Moreover, there was the acceptance of human sacrifice, e.g., of a slave when her master died, or of a boy killed to guard a buried treasure until its owner died. Does that make you squeamish? If so, then perhaps you have absorbed Christian sensibilities. You don't see neopagan revivalists promote such customs. But back to Iceland.

Around the year 1000 AD, Christianity had already appeared so the population became divided. The *Saga of Burnt Njal* tells the story of a debate between the Christians and the Pagans. Each party declared its own laws; thus the Christians refused to be under the laws of the Pagans, and vice versa. The Christian leader went to the pagan priest **Thorgeir** to determine what the law should be.

Thorgeir spent the day in meditation. On the following day, the Christians and Pagans met again to hear his decision. Thorgeir explained that there could not be two conflicting laws and asked for pledges from both sides to abide by his decision.

In short, Thorgeir proclaimed that the Christian law would prevail, so that idol worship, exposing children to perish, and eating horseflesh sic would henceforth be prohibited. Furthermore, the holy days of Christianity would all be observed.

The Christians could have easily been suppressed, but the superiority

²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7992>

of Christian civilization was recognized. Nowadays, that is denied, even by most Christians who believe in the separation of Church and State. It is forgotten that Christ is also the lawgiver, so that the social Reign of Christ³ is the norm.

Reinvigoration Religion in the West today has lost its spiritual focus and is often little more than a humanitarianism or bland moralism. There are ideas that should be a living presence, not empty phrases. We have addressed several of these: the Sky Father, Cosmic Christ, Divine Sophia, Angels & Demons, theosis, spiritual warfare, the need for awakening. There are necessary efforts required for this reinvigoration. This applies, *a fortiori*, to neopagan revivalists if they aspire to anything more than a superficial change.

Posted on 2015-04-02 by Cologero

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-03 at 16:23 said:

A really excellent piece. I'm going to have to post a link to it. As well as the challenge presented by the secular right of both Nietzschean and techno-commercialist schools, we also have to deal with the challenge posed by neo-Pagan movements such as the 'New Right'. While these groups may possess admirable insight and correct political doctrines, they are missing many of the pieces to the larger jigsaw that will be a successful and ultimately triumphant Reaction.

Have a blessed Easter, Cologero

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-03 at 16:47 said:

Excellent article. Linked to it. It is critical that we meet the challenge of Pagan as well as secular rightists. It is not enough to have a few pieces of the greater jigsaw if we wish to see an eventually triumphant Reaction.

Have a blessed Easter, Cologero

³<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7768>

francismercuri on 2015-04-05 at 01:24 said:

Concerning the alleged Semitic roots of Christianity: it is of interest that while there are those, as you point out, representing something of a "right-wing of Western civilization" if you will, who bemoan the influence; with the American popular "right", we find the other extreme—those who, calling themselves Christian, idolize every sort of idealization of Jewish religion and history, to the point of having something of a "Jewish envy". And, both seem to miss the boat.

Christianity is not, as these Christians (and there atheist opponents agree), a "reformation" of "Judaism" (or the Old Testament covenant), nor even a prolongation of it—it is something entirely different, whose relation with the OT involves two main points:

1) That it took the OT "forms", and installed them with new, and apparently contradictory meanings.

2) It developed the physical strata from Adam/Eve to Joseph/Mary in which to, "in the fullness of time", allow the Christ to take flesh, after which, the previous "mantle" was done away with, and of no more import.

Bulgakov points out, and contradicts those who consider the OT God as representing the "Age of the Father", because he argues that with the Mosaic "I am that I am", something of an exclusivity is involved, without suggesting a Father/Son relationship. Then, Jesus comes on the scene with something strange, the notion of God as "Abba", "Our Father". For Bulgakov, the "Age of the Father" is represented better by paganism than OT "Judaism", although this seems best balanced with Berdyaev's observations regarding the involvement of Jews in the history of revelation.

Of those extreme, literalist, Judeaphile "Christians", their logic has led to another consequence, which is mass support of political Zionism, and gross anti-Islamism. These "dispensationalists" consider that the ultimate aim of history must involve the rebuilding of the physical temple of Jerusalem, and restoration of primitive Jewish sacrifice, thus conditioning their support of this or that "war". But, from a Christian point of view, this is not only nonsense, but demonic. As we said, Christianity is something "different" and "new"—as Paul said, blood sacrifice is not only no longer a valid element of tradition, it is, when offered, an offering only to the infernal kings and princes. This is the "Abomination of desolation".

And, so with Christ, a new law and new order came to being, cutting asunder anything of the previous covenant, while revealing a very new God.

There was need for "salvation", along with existence of free will; while neither the blood sacrifice of old, or man fallen, left to "evolution", could accomplish the act as such. Thus a new man had to be, partaking of both possibilities, while being neither alone. It is both "this" and "that", while being neither "that" nor "this". In Christ arisen as first born of the dead, Nietzsche's formula is reversed, for "That which should be is; and that which is should be".

Jacob on 2015-04-05 at 17:10 said:

It seems to me (though I guess it is arguable) that Christianity still has those three things Guenon says a religion needs. So it is not broken, but just needs redirection.

I think it'd be correct to say Christianity is the fulfillment of all Traditional paths and not only Judaism. The comment a few posts ago about Christ being a priest in the order of Melchizedek as opposed to the order of Aaron has really stuck with me.

francismercuri on 2015-04-05 at 18:22 said:

Jacob: In addition to Paul's Letter to the Hebrews (7), and Psalm 110, note the Roman Catholic Eucharistic Prayer I (sadly, seldom used these days)...

"Look with favor on these offerings and accept them as once you accepted the gifts of your servant Abel, the sacrifice of Abraham, our father in faith, and the bread and wine offered by your priest Melchisedech".

<http://www.catholicliturgy.com/index.cfm/fuseaction/text/index/4/subindex/67/contentindex/22/start/9>

Logres on 2015-04-05 at 19:35 said:

If I am remembering correctly, Evola's dealing with Nietzsche in *Revolt Against the Modern World* was both more sensitive and appreciative, and more dismissive, of him, than the New Right would be comfortable with.

Pickman on 2015-04-06 at 15:10 said:

The problem still remains with the question of origins. No matter how far down the line we are, the point of ownership for the Western Indo-European (Aryan if you wish) Caucasian will still be problematic.

It was this initial schism of origins that had a profound effect on Evola and much of the Right in general. To the extent that it can be solved at all, still remains indeterminable despite these passages.

Pickman on 2015-04-06 at 15:13 said:

The "alleged" Semitic influence, is still a noteworthy variable to contemplate. It is not alleged, but a fact. How we deal with this has become a matter of mental gymnastics.

Logres on 2015-04-06 at 23:19 said:

The alleged influence on what object? The influence had already entered the barbarian peoples (which explains, for instance, why when you read about the Gallic Wars, Caesar comes off as a good deal more even handed and just than most of the Celtic tribal leaders, like Indutiomarus). Are you talking about the West, Christianity, or perhaps the Aryan peoples? I agree there are a lot of mental gymnastics masquerading in the real world, but it's certainly fair to

point out that the “nice” kid who’s hanging with the bad crowd can’t really blame their “influence”, since bad company corrupts good morals. There was already an inner correspondence, or “elective affinity” to begin with. Maybe the Semites were smart to dump their moral and mental refuse on such willing test subjects; it would be hard to say from the perspective of the New Right. It’s certainly been a winning strategy so far.

Cologero on 2015-04-08 at 01:12 said:

The “problem” exists in your own mind, Pickman. Apart from the “right in general”, which has absolutely no interest for us, Evola identified the origin. Bal Tilak provided evidence from the Vedas and Herman Wirth attempted a more scientific proof. In addition, there were Teodoro Poesche, Karl Penka, and Ludwig Wilser, in case you want to do your homework. Since you’ve shown no evidence of being familiar with any of these ideas, your one sentence dismissal is a waste of the disk space that I am paying for.

No issue of import has ever been resolved through philosophical demonstration or scientific proof. Hence Evola ultimately points to Fabret d’Olivet who was privy to traditional and esoteric sources. Now you may choose to live your life like Schroedinger’s Cat in a state of mental indeterminacy, but a man has to make a decision one way or the other.

Justin on 2015-05-12 at 12:34 said:

An excellent piece, Cologero. Your treatment of Exoterism and Esoterism brought to mind the late great Stratford Caldecott’s description of Christianity as “a kind of Esoteric Judaism turned inside out and offered to the world.”

<http://thechristianmysteries.blogspot.co.uk/2011/11/is-christianity-esoteric.html>

6.2 The Flowering of European Civilisation

To the profound comprehension of this law of the intellectual generation of ideas, are due the marvels of Catholic civilisation. To that wonderful civilisation is due all that we admire and all that we see. Its theologians, even considered humanly, put to the blush modern and ancient philosophers; her doctors excite wonder by the immensity of their science; its historians by their generalising and comprehensive views, cast those of antiquity into the shade. St Augustine’s “City of God” is, even today, the most profound book of history which genius, illuminated by the rays of

Catholicity, has presented to the astonished eyes of men. The acts of her Councils, leaving aside the divine inspiration, are the most finished monuments of human prudence. The Canonical, excel in wisdom the Roman, and the feudal, laws. Who is before St Thomas in science, St Augustine in genius, Bossuet in majesty, St Paul in power? Who is greater as a poet than Dante? Who is equal to Shakespeare? Who surpasses Calderon? Who, like Raphael, infused life and inspiration into the canvas?

Place people in sight of the pyramids of Egypt, and they will tell you, "Here has passed a grand and barbarous civilisation." Place them in sight of the Grecian statues and temples, and they will tell you, "Here has passed a graceful, ephemeral, and brilliant civilisation." Place them in sight of a Roman monument, and they will tell you, "Here has passed a great people." Place them in sight of a cathedral, and on beholding such majesty united to such beauty, such grandeur to such taste, such grace to such delicacy, such severe unity to such rich variety, such measure to such boldness, such heaviness in the stones, with such suavity in their outlines, and such wonderful harmony between silence and light, shade and colour, they will tell you,

Here has passed the greatest people of history, and the most astounding of human civilisations: that people must have taken grandeur from the Egyptian, brilliancy from the Greek, strength from the Roman, and, beyond the strength, the brilliancy, and grandeur, something more valuable than grandeur, strength, and brilliancy—immortality and perfection.

DONOSO CORTÉS, *Essays on Catholicism, Liberalism and Socialism*

Posted on 2009-10-14 by Cologero

6.3 The Continuity of Tradition

I deny absolutely that the ancient cults were ever given up in Rome or Athens, until the day when they were supplanted in the hearts of all men by the victorious religion of Christ. In other words, I believe that there has never been a real breach of continuity in the religious beliefs of any nation on this earth. The outward form or inner meaning of the creed may have changed; but we shall always find some Gallic Teutates making way for the Roman Jupiter, Jupiter for the Christian God, without any interval of unbelief, in exactly the same way as the dead give up their inheritance to the living.

ARTHUR DE GOBINEAU, *The Inequality of Human Races*

This should be no surprise to those who have followed some comments of **Bishop Williamson**⁴. Whatever anyone may think of his opinions on recent historical events, his theological views follow ancient traditions. After all, he was the rector of seminaries in Minnesota and Argentina. We should read the Greeks, he says, because they demonstrate the world's moral order, or the cosmos. But here we are more interested in their metaphysical understanding of the God.

Bishop Williamson explains the difference this way:

An infinitely good God gives to each of us life, free-will and time enough, if we make the right use of the suffering exactly dosed by his Providence (Mt.X, 29-31), for us to choose to spend our eternity rather with him in Heaven than without him in Hell. The Greek answer is incomplete, but not wholly wide of the mark. Instead of God the Father, they have a Father-god, Zeus, and instead of Providence they have Fate (Moiras).

⁴<http://www.romancatholicimperialist.org/2011/06/bishop-williamsons-eleison-comments.html>

Now whereas for Catholics Providence is inseparable from God, the Greeks separate Zeus from Fate so that they sometimes clash. That follows from the Greeks having a too human concept of their gods. Nevertheless they do conceive of Zeus as more or less benignly directing the universe and of Fate as being unchangeable, as is Providence within the true God (Summa Ia, 23, 8; 116,3), so that they are not wholly wrong. Moreover they have more respect for their mythical gods, and for the moral order guarded by them, than do a host of modern writers, who have no respect for any god at all, and who set out to negate any trace of a moral order.

In light of metaphysical categories, we see that Zeus is not **Infinite**, since he is limited by Moira (as well as by his brothers Poseidon and Hades). In the Catholic view, the possibilities of manifestation are included in Providence, which is inseparable from the Infinite God. Even Destiny is ultimately in God through dominion over the world process. In the Greek view, Zeus himself is subject to Destiny, though with Providential influence over the world. Nevertheless, the goal of the moral order is the same, achieved through the greater and the lesser battles.

We can surmise that the time had come to introduce the more apt Christian concept of God to replace the metaphysically imprecise popular Greco-Roman conception. This is not to say that an alien imposition occurred, but rather that the time had come to reveal the newer conception. The older conception was appropriate to the mentality of the time. It probably is, for most believers, who seem to relate to God more as Zeus than as the Infinite God of the metaphysicians.

Posted on 2011-11-07 by Cologero

6.4 The Valorization of the Middle Ages

Occasionally the question comes up, as it has again this week, as to why we focus so much on the spirituality, symbolism, social structures, and

history of the Middle Ages. Although the answer can be pieced together from various posts, it may be good to summarize it in one place. Clearly, the primary authors who have awakened the knowledge of Tradition regarded the Middle Ages as exemplifying the Traditional spirit. Since it is closest to us, at least those of us in the West, in time, language, and culture, it seems to be the most suitable model for demonstrating tradition in action. This, despite the fact that Rene Guenon points out that the contemporary West is as distant from the Middle Ages as it is from the Asian civilization; after all, isn't to be called "medieval" considered an insult today?

In 1937, **Mircea Eliade** wrote an essay, "The Valorization of the Middle Ages" in which he mentioned **Julius Evola**, **Rene Guenon**, and **Ananda K Coomaraswamy** among the exponents of those elites who recognize the importance of the symbol and the primacy of transcendence in the Middle Ages. He followed that up with two radio programs on the Secret Language of **Dante**, the Fedeli d'Amore, and the Holy Graal, themes quite familiar to readers of Evola and Guenon. Hence, those neo-pagans and new rightists who disvalue the Medieval civilization reveal their ignorance, or at least distance, from the intellectual leaders of Traditional understanding.

Beyond its own value, the proper understanding of the Middle Ages is the gateway to understanding other traditions. We can point out three in particular:

1. The Western pagan tradition was preserved in the Middle Ages, which is made clear in the idea of the two Romes⁵.
2. Ananda Coomaraswamy mentions several works of the Ancient and Medieval eras⁶ that are necessary preparations for any Westerner to understand the teachings of the Vedanta.

⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3904>

⁶<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=556>

3. Guenon, in his book on Dante, points out that Dante was greatly influenced, directly or indirectly, by Islamic and Sufi sources.

Clearly, those seekers looking at Sufism or Hinduism for an initiation into Tradition, ought to be well-grounded in the practices and literature of the Middle Ages before making that decision.

Addendum: Since this topic has also come up recently, remember that for most of the Middle Ages, the Latin and Eastern churches were united; even after the schism, the theology was similar; hence, anything of traditional value in the East can also be adopted, or recovered if necessary, by the West. The Greek speaking part of the Empire regarded themselves as Roman, as much so as the West. The breach between the two was to a large extent the result of the Nordic influence on the Western Empire, which was the result of Nordic and Roman collaboration as Evola often points out.

Posted on 2012-09-02 by Cologero

* * *

Logres on 2012-09-02 at 23:05 said:

My impression is that the Middle Ages are largely the subject of intense ignorance (to begin with), even Rightists having large misconceptions, or at least preconceptions, and very little patience with changing that. On top of that, they mistrust the populist, "lunar" element of the Middle Ages, the very existence of which (comfortably) actually testifies to the comprehensive and solar "totality" of that civilization; they are unable to see any continuity (for instance) between a cult of a saint or around the Virgin as it relates to the Imperium and more "celestial" patterns. This is an unfortunate situation. Especially in America is the concept embedded of a "Dark Age" with "the Middle Age". It is virtually impossible to overcome, or even to suggest, in polite conversation.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-03 at 00:16 said:

I am curious if you men are familiar with the arguement of Aleksandr Dugin, who in his book THE METAPHYSICS OF THE GOSPEL (sadly only available in Russian but I can give you

some excerpts if you'd desire) claims that orthodox Christianity is a full and complete Tradition, and that the loss of Tradition in the West stems from the Latin church's breaking away from Orthodoxy in 1054 AD. With this argument Dugin manages to synthesise Christianity with Evola by saying that the Ghibbelineism that Evola was so fond of (Frederick II etc.) represented a western orthodox backlash against the usurpations of the papacy. Dugin also mentions that the system Dante outlined in *De Monarchia* is the same as the Byzantine symphonia of church and state which the papacy destroyed in the west with their wars against the emperors.

I would like to know Cologero and/or Logres opinion on this line of reasoning as it will help us get to the heart of the matter in what must be done for the West.

Cologero on 2012-09-03 at 00:56 said:

I'm inclined to accept that, Jason-Adam, although Dugin's full work would be most interesting. I believe Evola wrote somewhere that the Council of Trent did not go back far enough in asserting Tradition. I'll take another look at *De Monarchia* with that thought in mind.

jwthomas on 2012-09-03 at 01:49 said:

My Middle Ages history professor often recommended this book, *The thirteenth, greatest of centuries*, as the best summary of the virtues of that era. I never got around to reading it but I see it's still in print with a new edition out last year.

Logres on 2012-09-03 at 10:05 said:

Jason-Adam, if you care to post excerpts, either here or at the Forum or by email, that would be very gratifying. Dugin is a very interesting writer – at least on the points you mention, he sounds quite accurate – the papacy did fracture the West when it supported the Italian city-states against the Emperor. I'm especially inclined to agree since Cologero thinks so as well – I am not sure how any complete Church could be expected to maintain an authentic esoteric tradition if it divorces itself from the ethos and Imperium and folkways of a people, by arrogating such a fractured position to itself as the Papacy did – they essentially cut themselves off from the Nordic spiritual centers, which had repercussions later on, not to mention they threw in their lot with the Normans and their various deprivations.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-05 at 06:13 said:

from <http://arctogaia.com/public/eng-parad.htm>

Catholicism is a fragment of Orthodox Christianity, because information, before the dissonance the West was as Orthodox Christian as the East; in addition this fragment is distorted and claims priority and completeness.

Catholicism is anti-Byzantinism, and Byzantinism is complete and authentic Christianity, containing not only the dogmatic purity, but also the allegiance to the social and political, state

doctrine of Christianity. In the very general outline, we may say, that the orthodox Christian conception of the symphony of the powers (vulgarly called "Caesarean Papistry") is associated with the comprehension of eschatological significance of not only the Christian Empire. Hence the teleological and soteriologic function of the Emperor, based on the 2-nd message of Saint Apostle Paul to Phessalonicians, in which the question was about the "holding one", "cathelon". The "holding one" is identified by the orthodox Christian exegetes with the Orthodox Christian Emperor and the Orthodox Christian Empire.

The defection of the Western church is based on denial of the symphony of the powers, on the rejection of the social and political, but at the same time eschatological doctrine of the Orthodox Christianity. It is eschatological because the Orthodox Christianity links the presence of the "holding one", which hinders the "advent of son of perdition" (=antichrist), with the existence of just politically independent orthodox Christian state, in which the temporal power (Basileus) and the spiritual power (patriarch) are in strictly defined correlation, determined by the principle of the Symphony. Consequently, the deviation from that symphonic Byzantine paradigm means, "apostacy", defection.

Catholicism from the beginning – i.e. right after the defection from the united Church – took another model instead of the symphonic (caesarian-papist) one, in which the authority of Roman Pope spread also onto the spheres, which were strictly referred to Basileus's competence in the symphonic scheme. Catholicism broke the providential harmony between the temporal and spiritual dominions, and, according to the Christian doctrine, fell into heresy.

The spiritual crisis of Catholicism became especially apparent by the sixteenth century, and Reformation was the peak of that process. However, we should note, that as long as in the Middle Ages in Europe there existed the tendencies, which had more or less propensity for the restoration of the adequate model in the West. The Ghibelline party of German princes Hohenstaufens was the bright example of "unconscious Orthodox Christianity", quasi-Byzantine resistance to the Latin heresy.

as-Sluwfakiyyah on 2015-09-23 at 17:25 said:

Could you please provide a brief recommendation for some essential titles of this literature that you mention above? Divine Comedy and Summa Theologica are some of the obvious candidates I guess.

Cologero on 2015-09-23 at 23:44 said:

@as-Sluwfakiyyah:

There are the sources recommended by Coomaraswamy: Vedanta and Western Tradition⁷. Along with Thomas Aquinas, there is Bonaventura, especially *The Soul's Journey to God*.

⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=556>

On the other hand, the primary literature may be difficult to understand for someone without the background to properly understand it. I'll gather some titles of the secondary literature, if no one else has any recommendations. A good place to start would be Guenon's *Crisis of the Modern World*.

Logres on 2019-09-03 at 21:44 said:

As the years creep by, I have found no reason to disagree with your assessment, Mr Salvo, that the Middle Ages is the "latest" and therefore closest traditional civilization to the consciousness of the West. I remain convinced that it is so entirely misunderstood today as to render most of modern assessments and opinions on it "not even wrong". Medievals seem to have instinctively somehow "known it all", at least at whatever level they were capable of grasping. Their life is a powerful argument for the need to undo the schism in the Western Church. They even kept baptized "pagan" elements of the Northern peoples inside the pale of civilization. I don't think any there is any "improving" on it, only developing it: democracy seems to inevitably wind up in corrupted oligarchies and degenerated fellaheen mobs. At least in the Middle Ages, a corrupt king could have a hunting "accident" in the forest, and life would move on.

6.5 From Virgil to Dante

The Middle Ages are so called because it represents the era between Antiquity and modernity. We can also regard it as the Traditional society between the Ancient traditional world and the coming Traditional society of the future. That the Middle Ages represent Tradition is beyond dispute. Now, there may be some contemporary Europeans (or their descendants) who do not feel part of that tradition and identify with some alleged northern tradition that has no relationship to either the Ancient or Medieval worlds. That, however, does not change the facts; furthermore, we accept that Northern tradition as an integral part of the one Western, or Hyperborean, tradition, which has taken several forms.

To make clear the reasons, we shall rely on the wisdom of Rene Guenon. The reader can then proceed as he likes, whether to seek to renovate and renew the Medieval tradition, or to use it as a model for the next great

Tradition. In the end, they may very well amount to the same thing. Let us begin at the beginning.

Christianity originally had both in its rites and doctrine an essentially esoteric and thus 'initiatic' character... the earliest Christian church would have had to be a closed or reserved organization.

So Guenon comments on the impenetrable obscurity that surrounds the origins and early stages of Christianity, which points to a deliberate design. Why, then, did the Church become open and exoteric? He explains:

If we consider the state of the Western world in the age in question, it is easy to see that, had Christianity not 'descended' into the exoteric domain, this world would soon have been deprived of all tradition, for the traditions that had existed until that time, especially the Greco-Roman tradition, which naturally was predominant, had reached an advanced state of degeneration heralding the imminent end of their cycle of existence.

The conversion of Constantine implied, by a sort of official act of imperial authority, a recognition of the fact that the Greco-Roman tradition had thenceforth to be considered extinct.

Nevertheless, the initiatic tradition with Christendom continued. Back to Guenon:

From Pythagoras to Virgil, and from Virgil to Dante, the 'chain of the tradition' was undoubtedly unbroken on Italian soil.

This continuity is not unknown. The monk **Dom Odo Casel** recognized a continuity between the rites of the pagan mysteries and those of the early Church. Guenon admits the possibility of both

I. Spontaneous initiation

2. Exceptional cases in which a virtual initiation that had remained attached to the sacraments might have become effective

He recognizes the certain writings from the Middle Ages were “manifestly initiatic in character”. He mentions the **Order of the Templars** and the Chivalric Orders, for example, and the **Fedeli d’Amore**, which included Dante as well as several other Italian poets, whose origins can be traced back to the earlier Sicilian poets and the Troubadours. Guenon points out that it was a requirement that initiates write love poetry, which is really an allusion to the **Divine Sophia**. This is also found among the Sufis such as Attar, Hafiz, or Rumi. At a certain point, the trail goes cold, ending with the more secretive Rose Cross. This does not mean necessarily the total end of initiatic rites in the West, just that they went deep underground.

Nevertheless, the Eastern Church did maintain a valid initiation in **Hesychasm**, whose “initiatic character is indisputable”, according to Guenon. Guenon had always recognized, even in an early book such as his *Hinduism*, that there was a valid metaphysic in the Alexandrian fathers in the East and in neoplatonism in the West. As Gornahoor has pointed out, the French follower of Guenon, Albert Gleizes⁸ recognized in **Plotinus**, **Augustine**, and **Boethius**, the founders of Western Christendom.

Hesychasm teaches a technique of invocation which is called in Greek, *mneme*, that is, remembering, on which any reader of Gornahoor can recall our emphasis. So, we can observe a closed and secret Church that became exoteric, while retaining an initiatic tradition. That then went underground. Now should we really be surprised that the esoteric teaching should now make itself visible? We have mentioned the “coincidence” of two specific events⁹. In Mouravieff, there is a claim to an initiation

⁸<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1430>

⁹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=334>

on **Mount Athos** itself, along with an instruction to make its teaching public. In **Valentin Tomberg**, again beginning in the East, we witness a sudden conversion to the Roman Church. The two books, different in tone, but similar in depth, reveal an esoteric teaching. Won't it suffice to repeat what Tomberg writes about remembering and evocation.

Memory is the magic, in the subjective domain, which effects the evocation of things from the past... The present remembrance is the result of a magical operation ... where one has succeeded in evoking from the black void of forgetfulness a living image from the past.

Nothing is ever lost. If we can only learn to remember, the mysteries of the past will be revealed again. As the Nordic adage states, the divine sleeps in the rock¹⁰: Forgetting is to remembering as sleeping is to waking.

Back to the earlier point, why was it necessary to forget? It was to re-establish the traditional arrangement of spiritual authority and temporal power, Christ and Caesar, the Pope and the Emperor, Jesus as Priest and King. Jesus as prophet, represented in the Tarot as the unnamed Hermit, and the Church of John, had to be submerged, even to the point that Evola regarded its revival as an Utopian dream¹¹. Yet there was an erstwhile monk who, a century ago, was aware of it¹² and expected its return.

The more important reason for the exoterism of the Church was so it could provide a path for salvation. This may mean nothing to many people in our day, but perhaps the need to meditate on the Four Last Things¹³ to be convinced otherwise. For those who insist on going deeper, for whom 'Paradise is still nothing but a prison', the answer is less clear.

They say, when the student is ready the master appears. So to trust in that is to make oneself ready — by study, prayer, meditation, spiritual

¹⁰<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=5>

¹¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=43>

¹²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2917>

¹³<https://www.catholictradition.org/Classics/4last-things.htm>

exercises, and right action — and trust in initiation will come, whether by ordinary or extraordinary means.

Some may chose a valid initiation elsewhere, for example, by a Tibetan lama or a through a Hindu mantra. It is a mistake to believe, as apparently some readers of Gornahoor do, and many others that I have read about, that such an initiation commits one to a specific path. Quite to the contrary and for a Westerner it is almost always an error and hindrance. Guenon is quite clear about this and explains it in detail.

The question was whether Dante was Catholic or Albigensian. For others it seems rather to be whether he was Christian or pagan. For our part, we do not think that such a point of view is necessary, for true esoterism is something completely different from outward religion, and if it has some relationship with it, this can only be insofar as it finds a symbolic mode of expression in religious forms. Moreover, it matters little whether these forms be of this or that religion, since what is involved is the essential doctrinal unity concealed beneath their apparent diversity. *This is why in the past initiates participated in all forms of worship, following the customs established in whatever country they happened to be.*
[my emphasis]

This is why one should be suspicious of those who make a big show of donning Buddhist or Hindu garb in a Western country while reciting foreign texts. A true initiate will follow the customs of his home, recognizing legitimate spiritual authority and temporal power, honoring his ancestors, participating in its rites, and building solidarity with his kith and kin. He can accomplish more by explicating the symbols and dogmas of his own Tradition rather than by introducing an alien vocabulary. The mark of understanding is to be able to rephrase things in one's own words rather than in repeating someone else's wisdom.

All quotes are from *Insights into Christian Esoterism* and *The Esoterism of Dante* by **Rene Guenon** unless otherwise indicated.

Posted on 2011-10-29 by Cologero

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Will on 2011-10-30 at 10:48 said:

Excellent post.

A couple tangential points. In Guenon's book on Dante, he mentions the Spanish author Miguel Asin Palacios who wrote a book claiming that Dante borrowed or stole his vision of paradise from the Sufi Ibn Arabi. Guenon's perspective, of course, is that such correspondences are not indicative of theft, but rather of confirmation, as when two scientists performing the same experiment achieve the same result. If anyone is so inclined, it would be interesting to learn more about the possible connections between Dante and Ibn Arabi. If indeed there was 'cross-pollination' between the Templars and the Assassins during the Crusades, it seems possible that Sufi initiatory chains may have made their way into Christendom, along with the re-introduction of Greek wisdom that was occurring at the same time.

Second, the Nordic adage which is quoted reminded me of the Tibetan tradition of terma teachings. Padmasambhava, the Buddha of Tibet, supposedly hid teachings to be discovered by later disciples. Some he hid in physical locations like rocks and mountains, and some in more subtle locations such as in the mindstreams of his students, to be discovered in a later lifetime. These terma teachings, which are complete systems of spiritual practice, are supposedly still being discovered in the present day, all over the world.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-30 at 11:29 said:

I concur, excellent post and very well timed also.

Just a few spontaneous thoughts on this. Firstly the emphasis on memory I agree is crucial with respect to remaining conscious once awakened, and this is made well known to any initiate, who is urged to remember to drink from the lake of memory! (although I also think that at some point – perhaps for some not all – there is also an exercise in forgetting required, perhaps as needs must and perhaps as practice for certain potentials available following Resurrection?)

In any event I agree with VT's assessment that with memory we are in the realm of the supernatural. Funnily enough I had another dream last night in which I was urged to remember something. Most of the dream was an average dream, but at the very end a man who I have met once in a supernatural context (two years ago), appeared standing at a table where I had just finished eating and handed me a book. It was a smallish book, very old, with gilded covers that

at first glance was engraved with a number of circles and a man sat in one corner looking up at them. 'Do you remember this?' my visitor asked. I looked back down at the book and recognition hit me like a thunderbolt. I made a dramatic, gasping 'GADZOOKS!!' type sound, which made him chuckle, then said 'yes I do, from two years ago, but I can't quite remember what, why...'. 'Try to remember', he told me, then disappeared. In both the dream and upon awakening I realised that the circles represented the Sephiroth on the Tree of Life, which of course I've seen many times, but the addition of the man in the corner seemed to be new and it was evident I was being asked to recall something from a very specific point in time, a couple of years previously as I mentioned. This is probably only relevant to me and no-one else, I'm simply reinforcing the point that our memories can contain the history of absolutely everything – there being nothing new under the sun – and only need activating by whatever means.

Memory of the love and light of Christ especially, and how it feels in that first eternal moment when one 'turns around' and sees Him for the first time....

For the rest, I agree with the value and authenticity (for want of better terms) of the Hesychasm practice and also, while we're at it, with what you say towards the end about initiation and the notion 'when in Rome do as Rome does' or indeed when in Bali do as the Balinese do, etc etc. This is reasonable, polite and wise practice that reinforces the idea of universal divinity. This notion is definitely helping me to settle into a firmer form of practice and discipline. While I've travelled widely and feel a natural compassion and affinity with all native peoples and traditions, at the end of the day I am a Celtic Christian living in England and my natural path and responsibility lies here for as long as I'm here. As a matter of fact a week or so ago I found myself a spiritual supervisor in this tradition and I'm just getting the house in order before starting on November 1. (please wish me luck, I would most dearly love to return to my childhood adolescent state of rigorous self-discipline and will power!)

Finally, seeing as you mentioned Dante, here is my very favourite passage from Paradiso:

The glory of him who moves everything penetrates the universe and shines in one part more and, in another, less.

I have been in the heaven which takes most of his light, and I have seen things which cannot be told, possibly, by anyone who comes down from up there.

Because, approaching the object of its desires, our intellect is so deeply absorbed that memory cannot follow it all the way.

Nevertheless, what I was able to store up of that holy kingdom, in my mind, will now be the matter of my poem.

Blessings to you all this fine day Cxx

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-30 at 11:34 said:

Will, seeing as you mention another poetic master, here are a couple of extracts from Ibn Arabi's works that I found very inspiring and comforting, from the Journey to the Lord of Power:

And in the first states of trust, four miracles befall you. These are the signs and evidence of your attainment of the first degree of trust.

These signs are crossing the earth, walking on water, traversing the air, and being fed by the universe. And that is the reality within the door.

After that, stations and states and miracles and revelations come to you continuously until death.

*

And if you do not stop with this, He reveals to you the surface signs, you will be admonished with terrors and many sorts of states will befall you. You will see clearly the apparatus of transformations; how the dense becomes subtle and the subtle dense.

And if you do not stop with this the light of the scattering of sparks will become visible to you, and there will be a need to veil yourself from it. Do not be afraid, and persevere in the remembrance of God, for if you persevere in the remembrance of God, disaster will not overcome.

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Perhaps we can admit that great minds think alike to some extent at least, truth being universal, but that doesn't necessarily mean one plagiarises from the other, simply that they're speaking of the same essential reality?

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-30 at 12:03 said:

This is the picture on the cover of this book, which as it happens I haven't read (not that I know of, not in this life at least!). I think I will now tho...

http://books.google.co.uk/books/about/Gates_of_light.html?id=u6fXjw7ogtgC

6.6 From Clovis to Charlemagne

Under Constantine's rule, Rome became more Christian. Over the next few centuries, some significant leaders brought Christianity to most of Europe. Christmas day was significant in these events.

Clovis (466-511) Clovis was the first of the 40 kings of France; he united all the Frankish tribes under one ruler. He was Baptized on Christmas Day 496, and three thousand of his companions converted with him.



King Ethelbert Pope Gregory the Great, having encountered some young Anglo-Saxons in a Roman slave market, was impressed by their beauty and blonde hair. He sent 40 Benedictine monks, under the leadership of Augustine of Canterbury (as he came to be known) to evangelize the English.

King Ethelbert embraced Christianity. Then he and 10 thousand citizens were baptized on Christmas day, year 597. The king's baptism was the baptism of an entire people, who gladly followed their leader. From there, St Boniface and several monks set out to evangelize the Germans.

Charlemagne A century later, St Boniface was sent from England to evangelize the Germans. Progress was difficult, but after he felled the Donar Oak, without the gods subsequently striking him down, many pagans converted.

Charlemagne became King of the Franks in 768. As the Father of Europe, he re-united most of Roman Europe, even adding new lands to it. Charlemagne was not only a warrior, but the arts and sciences began to flourish again in Europe in the period called the Carolingian Renaissance. He valued learning and education. He encouraged the book publishing on a variety of topics, even founding a library at court. One of his favourite books was Augustine's *City of God*.

Charlemagne's Coronation as Emperor of the Romans took place on Christmas day, 800 in Rome. The Roman people acclaimed:

To Charles Augustus, crowned by God as great and pacific Emperor of the Romans, life and victory.

Augustus was the same title claimed by Constantine, emphasizing the continuity between what was to be the Holy Roman Empire with the classical Roman Empire.

Posted on 2019-12-25 by Cologero

* * *

Cologero on 2020-01-26 at 19:54 said:

But the recovery of the Mediterranean West is prepared by the Empire of Charlemagne who, through a universal force characteristic of men who hold the spiritual and ethnic-blood heritage of the Romulean lineage, organizes Italy, France and part of Spain: it is strengthened with the supernationalist constitution of the Holy Roman Empire, continues its struggle through the maritime daring of the Maritime Republics of Genoa, Venice, Pisa and Amalfi.

Massimo Scaligero, *La Razza di Roma*

6.7 The Western Tradition Reviewed

In which we review some prior posts on the western tradition and demonstrate the inner continuity from the Vedics through the Greeks to the Medievals. We also articulate the essence of idealism and the nature of the priest.

We have several times pointed to the three great Indo-European civilizations: the Hindu, the Greco-Roman, and the Medieval. That is its depiction from the outside, but we have alluded to their interior connection, which is more important. Specifically, that means that they appear as three forms of the same inner spirit. Interestingly enough, **Vladimir Solovyov** approaches them from their interiority, identifying the same three forms as did Evola. The inner relationship of these forms will be taken up more fully at a later time.

There may sometimes be the feeling that the “transcendental unity of religions” represents some sort of lowest common denominator. Solovyov indicates the opposite when he writes:

From the religious point of view, the goal is not a minimum but a maximum of positive content. The richer, the more alive and concrete a religious form is, the higher it is. The perfect religion is not one that is equally contained in all religions (the indifferent foundation of religion); the perfect religion is one that possesses and contains within itself all religions (the complete religious synthesis). The perfect religion must be free from all limitation and exclusiveness, not because it is deprived of every positive particularity and individuality, but because it contains in itself all particularities and is not exclusively attached to any one of them, possesses all of them, and is therefore free from all of them. The dark fanaticism that holds to a single particular revelation a single positive form, denying all others, and the abstract rationalism that disperses the whole essences of religion into a fog of indeterminate concepts, fusing all religious forms into a single empty, impotent, colorless generality, are equally repugnant to the true conception of religions.

Solovyov points out the Christian metaphysics is compatible with that tradition, and that is why they could speak of “Christians before Christ”. He even points that the Egyptian theosophy of **Hermes Trismegistus** is a part thereof. He explains it this way:

The originality of Christianity lies not in its general views but in positive facts, not in the speculative content of its idea but in its personal incarnation.

But those positive facts are outside the scope of this discussion, so we are content to point out the identity of its speculative, or metaphysical, content with what preceded it.

Roman High Priest For over 2700 years, the Roman High Priest has been the spiritual center of the Ecumene. Recently, a new one was selected. Although I am not too concerned with the specifics of the who,

what, and where, it is nevertheless important that the seat be filled. Nevertheless, the reactions of the secular media was interesting.

First of all, they were all impressed that Pope Francis is “for the poor”, something they derive from his non-ostentatious lifestyle. That is something they can grasp, since it is one of the corporeal works of mercy. These works are acceptable to them because they are based on the natural principle of “do unto others what you would have them do unto you.” Obviously, a hungry man, woman, or child should be fed, when possible. However, that does not mean the creation of a permanent underclass that does not feed itself when possible. That is the Marxist principle of “to each according to his needs”, which is not the same thing.

Of course, man does not live by bread alone, so the spiritual works of mercy are more important. Here the secular media falls away. The first of them is “to instruct the ignorant”; the sophists of the fourth estate do not consider themselves ignorant, and so they resist such instruction. They seem to tolerate it in Francis, since they presume it is merely a relic from bygone times and will eventually be forgotten in the general progress of humanity.

Ultimately, none of that matters, since the true idea of priesthood itself is what has been forgotten, not only among the secularists, but it seems even among the priests. **Guido De Giorgio** seems to capture that essence:

Priests are not men, they are vowed, they are consecrated, they have nothing apart from God, since they chose God and cannot, and must not, forget it, but not even those who get close to them can forget it. The priest has no family, no ties, he is excluded from the world, and excluded voluntarily, a denier of “ordinary life” for having chosen the “extraordinary life”, that adheres totally to the divine truths and acts on men negatively, in order to distract them from the fallacies of the world and to make them understand what they lose while winning the game of life. If he is connected to few

living in the world outside the world, in continuous contact to sacred truths, in a way that they can, without apparent sacrifice, pass unencumbered, that cannot and must not constitute a good formula for the majority who, if it admits the world, subtracts God.

Magical Idealism Yet, it is insufficient to dwell on the speculative content alone with actualizing its contents. Metaphysics is a science, not a system of rational discourse. In *Essays on Magical Idealism*, Evola points to some of the roots of his thought, among which is Giovanni Gentile, who was the foremost Italian philosopher at that time. Evola points out that Gentile limits himself to the disputes of university professors, when his system of thought was quite close to a method of self-realization. Evola writes:

Modern idealism can be defined this way: a deep need toward an absolute self-realization, which however the I does not acquire immediately in its interiority, but it simply *knows*, comprehending it from the outside in the phenomenon that it produces in the abstractly rational order. In Giovanni Gentile this situation appears in a particularly clear way: in him the effort of encompassing and dominating the whole of the world in an immanent principle reaches its perfection; but, on the other hand, this principle remains a simple ideal entity, it is the “transcendental I” that we criticized and yet it expresses only the pallid reflection of that deep individual power that existed for example in Michelstaedter. If Gentile could really call “I” the “pure act” of his rationalism, then one would find him appearing not as the university professor, whose “actuality” has as its goal the reform of the scholastic program, but as that cosmic centrality that the esoteric teaching points to, as examples, the type of the *rishi*, the *yogi*, the **Christ**, and the **Buddha**.

Posted on 2013-03-25 by Cologero

* * *

Synodius on 2013-03-26 at 12:25 said:

What is disturbing about this new pope is that under the mask of humbleness he is giving up papal symbols and traditions which represented the spiritual authority. He finds it hard to perform even such a simple act as papal blessing in order to not offend anyone. It is not Francis personally that matters, but the fact that the revolution is fully in charge since the last council. It seems that this pope may give the Church the final blow with irreversible democratization, wild ecumenism and support of socialism

George Goerlich on 2013-04-01 at 22:11 said:

I noticed the same as Synodius. It appears he is symbolically assuming the role of the “anti-Pope”. Not in the sense of Satan, but in the sense of not-being a Pope. A Pope who denies the title, symbols, and position of a Pope.

6.8 Catching our Breath

The fool does more harm by his ignorance than the wicked man
by his wickedness.

AL-GHAZALI

It is time for a recap what has been accomplished thus far in our project to determine the lineament of the Western Tradition, which we claim is as real and as important as anything arising from the East. First of all, we outlined the features of the religion of the Ancient City, how the city was founded by a man-god, its cults, the importance of spiritual authority and its caste based social structure. We showed its decline due to the degeneration of castes which led to the decline of the ancient pagan civilizations due its forgetfulness of its own tradition.

We turned to the next stage of Western tradition, which was both an overthrowing of its decadent predecessor as well as being in continuity¹⁴

¹⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3281>

with it; this is called Christendom. Ignoring the rather bizarre conspiracies that abound today, we rely instead on **Rene Guenon**'s sober and intellectually sounder understanding. Christianity at its inception was a mystery religion, founded by a man-god, just as were all the Greek and Roman mysteries and cities. You can accept this claim or not, it has no bearing on what follows. As it became the dominant religion, it was compelled to become exoteric as the social structures of the Roman Empire unraveled. However, we see maintained the outward characteristics of a traditional society: the distinction between spiritual authority and temporal power, as well as a caste based structure with a strong warrior caste¹⁵ with its own set of orders. Nevertheless, Guenon insisted on the esoteric character of the dominant spiritual tradition of Christendom, providing many examples from Gospel stories to **St. Bernard** to **Dante**, inter alios.

Next, we pointed to Ananda Coomaraswamy¹⁶, a man whose immense intellect bridged both East and West. He listed several Western authors whose depth of thought rivals that of the East. It would be risable, if it weren't so tragic, to see well meaning men turning to the East while remaining utterly ignorant of the great Western Traditional minds. Please read that piece over and over.

Even **Julius Evola** had to concede the Traditional nature of Christendom, as much as he disliked its dominant spiritual tradition. Yet, he did make the important point that it was the result of the collaboration of Roman and Nordic elements, the result of which was the spiritual unity of all of Europe, something which did not exist prior to the Middle Ages nor after it following the various reformations and revolutions. His claim that the best aspect of the Middle Ages was its pagan elements is like saying the best part of a cup of coffee is the sugar. They cannot be separated. Furthermore, the spiritual authority defines what it is, which is why *Sola Scriptura* needs to be rejected.

¹⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=277>

¹⁶<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=556>

We then did a creative re-reading of several important figures of Christendom, understanding them as exponents of an esoteric tradition. This, I believe, was very fruitful and it needs to be extended and developed by others. That brings us to the next step which is Guenon's contention that the esoteric tradition has been totally lost in the West, or else it is deeply hidden. We pose the question somewhat differently. First of all, we deny that it has been lost as Tomberg and Mouravieff demonstrate. Whatever their defects may be, they absolutely show the continuing influence of Hermetism, at least in the East of the West. If you doubt the significance of that, please go back to that Coomaraswamy piece and then look up what the ancient Christians wrote regarding Hermes Trismegistus.

The second point is somewhat different. Now, the religion of the Ancient City is certainly lost, in the very real sense that it is unrecoverable — it was lost even at the time of the Roman Empire when men no longer understood their own traditions. The revival this paganism requires a revelation from a man-god and can never be the result of an artificial reconstruction or re-enactment. On the other hand, the metaphysical teachings of Christendom have not been lost and they even have adherents today. What we can admit, instead, is that the teachings remain virtual, not actual. It would take a gnosis (not a conceptual understanding) to make them actual. However, since they are virtual and not genuinely lost, there remains the possibility of their being actualized. Thus, any objections to self-initiation are beside the point. Anyone confirmed by someone with valid orders has this understanding virtually; under the right circumstances, it can be made effective. We have recently provided examples of the Infinite¹⁷ and the Intellectual Soul¹⁸ which demonstrates beyond a doubt the understanding of the Middle Ages.

Now, we are about to turn to some modern thinkers to show the way from the virtual to the actual. **Vladimir Solovyov**, who represents

¹⁷<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3261>

¹⁸<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3390>

the East of the West, was concerned in overcoming the breach between them. As Guenon points out, there is a relationship between theological and metaphysical language. Gornahoor has never engaged in religious polemics, which are pointless. However, Solovyov has developed a metaphysical system which is compatible with his theological understanding. What Guenon hinted at, Solovyov actually accomplished. That is why it is so important to anyone envisioning the religion of the future. Even those who foresee a return to some sort of paganism have to achieve the same level of metaphysical understanding.

Posted on 2011-11-20 by Cologero

6.9 Dante and the Holy Culmination of the Roman Tradition

From *La Tradizione Romana* by **Guido De Giorgio**.

The traditional gold vein of Rome in the living unity of the two forms supplementing each other in a perfect match and equilibrium, is found again in all its wholeness in Dante who was the first to reveal the mystery of Romanity. The sacred arriving at the creative synthesis of the elements contained in the ancient and new traditions for which he can be called the prophet of Fascist Catholicity [Cattolicità Fascista] in the absolute meaning of the expression.

Poetry in him resumes its place and its sacred destination, it follows “the footprints” as Boccaccio said, the traces “of the Holy Spirit”, it is no longer psychological and artificially descriptive, but an initiation, revelation, and realization. While theology is expository and proceeds discursively, submitting itself to the limits of reason illuminated by revelation, poetry grasps with supersensible intuition the mystery of the symbols

and internalizes them, transforming them into shapes, living them, surpassing their representative exteriority so that to make of them the most suitable vehicle for liberation. In this sense, and in this sense only, Dante is the poet and the Comedy is the sacred poem, vehicle of the divine truth and supreme effort, the highest perhaps that was ever accomplished, to transform the sensible image the reason for the realization of traditional metaphysical principles, grasped in two directions, the ancient and the new, indissolubly unified in the occult name of Rome that is the seal of the divine song.

Thus, the universality of Dante was unique among men and poets, even though the anagogical interpretation of the Comedy had not yet been tried, in order to be completed and realized only ascetically by those who belong to the Race of the Spirit and who are the true key bearers of sacred science and the fasces bearers of divine power.

The Comedy is the supreme pilgrimage of the worlds considered as the only temple of God: if the point of departure is the earth and that of arrival is heaven, this apparent duality shows man only what he must reach when *he is not what he is*, what he must become in order to be what he is, and how his earthly humanity is only a veil, when removed, the Divine Reality is revealed in His original unity, ineffability of the Ineffable. Only at this point poetry ceases and with the realization of the mystery of man who is the Reality of God, the Comedy finishes because the pilgrimage is completed, the end is reached, death is overcome, *feri* [becoming] became *esse* [being] and *esse* the radical non-existence of the Divine Night.

Heaven and earth are dissolved in the last smile of the Comedy, when the bright axe that dominates the Fasces [Fascio Littorio], resolving the enigma of the two-faced Janus through the plenary universality of the Cross, revealed the occult name of Rome and dissolved the Vestal fire on the lips of the Lord of the last rite. Here the mystery ends and the brilliant flashing ends in the essential tonality of the Silence, lord of Forms and

Rhythms, the highest peak of integral realization. The ancient and new tradition led the poet to the secret of the Primordial Tradition, to the "*letizia che trascende ogni dolzore*" ["joy that transcends every sweetness of delight"]. In the paradisiacal vortex, it is completed and having completed itself it untied the traditional knot, nor can there be anything in what alone is it integrally and completely.

This is the miracle of the occult name of Rome and this is the reality of Dante and the Comedy.

The vision of the peak, insofar as it is so imperfect of the expression that tries to grasp its mystery, permits it to better consider the foundation and the progression and, what is more important to our task, the unification of the two traditions in Rome, i.e., in the Spirit of God. It is not possible to allude to this, unless metaphorically, in this simple introduction to the doctrine of the Roman Tradition, that cannot try to be more than what it is, a vestibule to the Temple, a preparation to the work of integral restoration of Traditional Romanity contained in the Comedy that is the sacred poem of Rome, no longer the ancient and new, but the eternal.

If Virgil represents the ancient tradition and Beatrice the new tradition and if, at the threshold of the Terrestrial Paradise, Virgil disappears before Beatrice, Beatrice also disappears when the divine mystery is grasped by Dante in its immediate realization and what then remains, above and beyond the two traditions unified forever is, climactically, Rome.

Virgil guides the poet through the world of Forms and Rhythms, in the two spheres of bodies and shadows, that he knows perfectly because he belongs to a tradition in which these two domains particularly were meticulously observed and studied, domains that constitute the subterranean and sublunar underworld whose secrets are fully treated in the three Virgilian works "*sotto il velame delli versi strani*" ["under the veil of strange verses"].

The ancient Roman tradition attached great importance to the knowl-

edge of the immediate and psychic world governed by laws of internal, occult order, that embrace the totality of beings and things considered always with reference to the forces whose expression they are. The so called "concreteness" of the Romans was based exactly on the precise meaning of these forces that act most visibly in the existence of man inserting there a hidden network of which the events, especially "chance" events, as the common people believe, are the most significant effects: these forces are either propitiated, dominated, or determined. Virgil represents in the Comedy the knowledge of the two subterrestrial and superterrestrial worlds, the latter term however meant in the much more precise sense that must be given to the third element, the air, which symbolically corresponds to the subtle elements, the Rhythms, more through their "diffusivity" than for their nature.

In hell, we are present at the extreme concretion of these unchained forces and, so to speak, precipitated in the closed vortex of ignorance, while in Purgatory, we catch sight of them liberated from the formal element in their spontaneous structure of the subtle body, the shadow. Virgil guides his disciple with "art" up to the threshold of the Terrestrial Paradise from which ascent will begin at the paradisiacal levels, i.e., at the higher states that are forbidden to them because they realize only by means of Revealed Science, Beatrice.

Up to this point the two traditions remain separate even though the one is resolved in the other, that indicates Dante's dismay at Virgil's disappearance in the face of the vision of Beatrice. In the Terrestrial Paradise we have the explanation of the traditional integration, after the theory that leads the symbolic cart in front of the central tree which revives, discovering the reigns of the Silence where only the ascension to the divine states is accomplished. In other words, the second tradition is not opposed to but reveals the first, and completes it, bringing it back to the invisible centre from which everything emanates and to which everything returns as long as it is stripped bare to its original essence.

What in the first tradition is the *Imperium* [empire], is the *Regnum* [kingdom] in the second, while separately they indicate respectively temporal power and spiritual authority, there is an absolute seat in which while converging they merge into each other, and this seat, materially, symbolically, and actually is Rome. So that, while the second tradition illumines and reveals the first, the first precedes, prepares, and exists only for the affirmation of the second; there is an initial necessary opposition that is resolved only in Rome when, i.e., a unifying centre is found that is at the same time the neutral point where the traditional quarrel ends.

It is not easy to express this succession and fusion that must not be considered historically but on a plane where the symbolic values remain such even if unknown or misunderstood until a new light suddenly illuminates them and reveals them. For the two traditions which we discussing, Rome is this light and the Comedy is the poem of sovereign and Holy Rome, the unifier, while Fascism is the operator of the synthesis in which the two forms are compounded in a new revelation of power. The greatness of Dante consists in the statement of these two aspects, the ancient and the new form, of the same tradition that is Roman universality, and, while in *De Monarchia* he combats, as he says, *pro salute veritatis* ["I engage in battle in this book for the cause of truth"] to reclaim the ancient tradition that had to remain to sustain the second. In the Comedy he arrives at the realization of the unification, at what we will have to call traditional perpetuity, showing the reality of a transhumanization [passage from a human state to a superhuman state] in all its levels that embrace beings and elements, world and afterworld [*soprammondo*], heaven and earth, from Forms to the Rhythms in the Silence.

He is therefore the advocate of Sacred Science in the living, and not theoretical, wholeness of the Roman Tradition, of the *Imperium* and the *Regnum*: the ancient and new traditions mutually sustain each other, avoiding thereby all incongruity of a conflict that would impoverish them, impeding their supreme synthesis which is, practically, the equilibrium

of the temporal and the spiritual and, at the centre of realization, the complete transfigurative process, the integral initiation, the real ascent from the earth to the elementary and trans-elementary heaven.

All the symbols of the ancient tradition live again in the creative light of the achievement, the union with god [*indiamento*], and the Argonautic enterprise finds its fulfillment in the revelation of the true face of God with which the last canto and the last canto of the "Sacred Poem" end. The vein of gold, the vestment of glory, is dressed by Dante in the great light of Rome, highest peak in the radiant circularity of the Ineffable. All the traditional sciences flow together in the Comedy through a dynamic complexity of states and a perfect knowledge of the transitions in the ambit of the three worlds through which the process of the cosmic-human illusion takes place, up to its resolution in the supreme principle in the three phases corresponding to the death, resurrection and transfiguration of man in God. The process of death is slow, gradual, and it embraces all terrestrial experience in its most interior forms to which the vices correspond in the moral sphere, i.e., animality: from here, the *descending* hierarchy of the underworld where the realizing interiority assumes over itself all human development reducing it to a totalizing unity of life integrated in the being that had and lost the light, Lucifer. He represents the maximum concretion in the scheme of diabolic unity, the inverse reflection of the divine unity of which he has only the Trinitarian analogy in the three faces that are turned antithetically while in God they are homocentric and confluent.

Human plurality is resolved in its huge body, congealing itself, solidifying itself, petrifying itself: he represents the fall, the precipitation, the last terrestrial coagulation of the impassable waters, the freeze, the totalization of ignorance and darkness: its night corresponds, according to the reverse analogy, to the night of God, to the precreative indistinction in which all the determinations of being are based, as in him all the determinations of non-being, i.e., of evil. The analogy is perfect even in

that Lucifer is the first and the last as God is the alpha and omega, but while in the first case, one has a duality of movement represented by the fall, in the second instead we have the essential unity of the opposites considered as the two confluent points of the divine cycle. Lucifer who *was* the first *is* the now the last: in him the temporal cycle is resolved in the eternity of evil, as in God the eternity of good is resolved. The two main antitheses represent what can be called the highest *critical polarity*, i.e., the terrifying point of active realization, that precisely in which Virgil very painfully creates the *overthrowing* which is a *rectification* where the descendant interiority becomes the ascendant interiority and the place of damnation, the basis of salvation. From the stony precipitation whose symbol is Lucifer the ascendant rectification begins and the stone that is concretion and fall becomes the basis necessary for the flight toward the elementary complexity and the trans-elementary totality.

Purgatory is the place of the second birth from Forms to Rhythms in a hierarchical purification of which the seven terraces [of the mountain of Purgatory] are pointers: it is not a passage from Forms to Rhythms but a resolution of Forms in Rhythms, of the body in the shadow, of corporeity in psychicity where then even this is freed in the spirituality that is the Silence, Paradise. Virgil's "art" is the perfect knowledge of the two spheres, the Forms and the Rhythms, through which the decoupling from error and from the ignorance of human and terrestrial fallacy is accomplished hierarchically, since reality is one, that of God, but a man has knowledge of this reality only when he integrates it, realizes it, becomes it. Up to what is not completed, it is necessary to traverse the levels of development that, from the human point of view, are the three corresponding to Hell, Purgatory, and Paradise. Dante in the Comedy proposes and exposes all the experience of realization, the complete, integral initiation, through positive knowledge, lived in all the levels that lead from the human to the divine. In the two first kingdoms, the ancient tradition sufficed to lead this path to completion and Virgil represents the science and the knowl-

edge of the laws that govern the subterrestrial and sublunar world. He disappears before Beatrice because he dissolves in her, is completed in her, not because he opposes her as would be the case if Dante had considered the two traditions irremediably different and antagonistic as everyone believes, as much by those who exalt the first as by those who oppose the second. Beatrice appears at the moment when the first guide, Virgil, has completed his work and embraces the gross and subtle manifestations, the Forms and Rhythms. The exercise of human reason in its complete and normal development naturally leads to the sphere where a process of mystical union with God [*indiamento*] is initiated in the levels of the non-formal, i.e., in the zone of the Silence represented symbolically by the heavens.

Here Sacred Science, Beatrice, carries out the integrative cycles of unity in a flight that is light and salient flame between the Rhythms circularly untying itself in the plenitude of the Divine Being. The Trinitarian scheme is amplified in the assumption of the nine hierarchies, effulgent wings that facet the divine infinity of the joyful love of the Angels, Archangels, Principalities, Powers, Virtues, Dominations, Thrones, Cherubim, Seraphim, where celestialty is engraved in relations of light and splendour in the face of the terrestriality which is overcome, resolved, and dissolved in the divine whirlpool. There still remains, in the first seven heavens, the divisibility of the light with planetary vertices in a progressive self-realization of perfection in unity, a display of radiations in the body of the divine diamond.

In the residence of the sun where the zodiacal band combines with its perfection of the ternary and quaternary resolved in the supreme syntheses of the trinity ($12 = 1 + 2 = 3$), the mystery of the Perfect Man, the Triumphant Christ emerges, the perfection of the divine sonship in absolute assumption of radiance. It comes after the last creative level of the ninth heaven of the Trinitarian perfection, assuming in each of the Divine Persons the seal of the others so to project the mystery of the

Ineffable in the creative circularity, then finally the absolute level, the culmination perpetuating itself in the eternal scheme of the worlds, the Empyrean. Here Beatrice disappears, not like Virgil, to permit a progress, an arriving, an end, but to unravel the mystery of the Last Seal where the virginal matrix carries out the cyclic reduction of the light in the very face of God. The last level of Silence is integrated in the same riverbed of the Divine Night where the pulse of the Ineffable vibrates in the realizing unity of God, the Supreme Zero, transcendence of the plenitude itself, darkness of the Ineffable.

The purely exterior literary merits that common men [*volgo*], the *profanum vulgus* [unholy rabble], admire in Dante have no importance and would nullify the value of the Comedy in the very eyes of Dante and of those who can and know how to understand the purpose for which the poem was composed.

It would be necessary to feel ashamed to still speak of, and only of, “art”, “poetry”, “brilliant construction”, in the modern sense of the word when one alludes to Dante’s work which is only and eminently sacred in spirit and structure, while the allusions to historical persons are clearly motivated by Cacciaguida at the end of canto XVII of the Paradise. But these allusions hide well dramas other than those that the profane see in it. Regarding these, the central motive, the general orientation, are understood, traditionally speaking, but it is not, nor perhaps will ever be, possible to explain entirely due to the impossibility of retracing the elements of a tradition that, in Dante’s time, was entirely oral. As to the strength and the expressive completeness so steadfast in Dante, it is due to the very substance of the topics treated: it is about *poetry of inspiration* in the absolutely sacred meaning of the word and those who know what is meant by such an expression, know the imbued power of the realizing wave that moulds the word in a type of revealing plasma where the specular miracle of the perfect reflection is accomplished. The same Rhythm, the homophony is adequate to the state that tries to be

expressed in a way to constitute as many *topoi* or static forms, normative traces in which the transfiguring synthesis from the image to the idea is completed, to substitute for the oral initiatic transmission.

The moderns, therefore, who for centuries have read, studied, and commented on Dante resign themselves to understand nothing of it as long as they persist in not considering him as a prophet, a sacred poet, whose work is the highest expression, perhaps unique, in the Roman Tradition, an eternally new synthesis of the two traditional forms that in Rome, in its occult name, will find their completeness and their perfection. Here is his greatness and his true originality: if the expression reaches a plastic and vibratory perfection never before equaled, that is due to the sacred character of the Poetry which catches the eternal light of revelation in the transience of phantasms and concentrates it in radiant syntheses. In Dante, East and West are balanced in a unique centre that, substantially, is the Primordial Tradition, i.e., the unique most important traditional universality and ultimate realization. Never during the Middle Ages were the relationships between East and West so close: never in those great centuries had the traditional elements completed each other and disclosed each other for oral transmission, direct from master to disciple and from disciple to disciple. Dante appears exactly at the end of this era but in a period in which Dominicans and Franciscans, although already degenerate and hostile, had outlined the two greatest ways of realization of the divine—cherubic and seraphic—homocentric even if divergent by nature and process. He unites these two ways substantially, bundles [*fascifica*] them without confusing them. And it is necessary to note that when we use the term *fascificare*, we mean nothing that can be considered, even if only vaguely, syncretism or mixture: to bundle in the pure traditional sense means to give to each way, to each element, a unique direction, a centre, an axis without confusing them: this is the novelty of the traditional steadiness.

There is one bond that captures the twelve rods of the Fascist bun-

dle [Fascio Littorio] and there is one lightening power expressed by the double cut axe: the emblem is traditionally the greatest because it represents the confluence in the vertical direction, i.e., that of elevation and conquest. In Dante fascification is supreme, East and West, ancient and new Rome, temporal and spiritual, heaven and earth, world and after-world, man and God, everything gets becomes more marked, matches up, is unified at a supreme vertex that is Rome. This is Sacred Fascism, the true triumph of justice and truth in man and in the world: if there are quarrels, battles, falls, these have no importance since they take place in the bosom of a traditional society where everything is formed from the supreme balance assured by key bearers and fasces bearers, by the *Regnum* and the *Imperium* forever unified in Rome.

This is the perpetual peace, the universal peace which Dante constantly mentions in *De Monarchia* and in the *Comedy*: the reaching of the traditional equilibrium that can only contain and annul in a higher place of harmony the battles and the inevitable disputes in the world, where, since duality reigns, it is not possible to avoid conflict without which the supreme unifying element of Rome would be suppressed. But instead, when this element is restored to its true function and reestablished the bases of the Roman Tradition in their living integrity, a new greatness would rise from under the present ruins of the western world, a new purity of life and thought and the Temple protected by the sword would rise up in the light of Rome for the glory of God in the heavens and the peace of men on earth.

Posted on 2012-03-21 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2012-03-22 at 21:05 said:

Cologero, your hunch (more aptly, intuition) about Fr. Johnson was correct.

Here's Johnson's relatively new podcast on Guenon.

<http://reasonradionetwork.com/20120315/the-orthodox-nationalist-rene-guenon>

Boreas on 2012-03-23 at 12:36 said:

This text is like poetry in itself. A world of light and life eternal opened before my mind's eye when reading this. Beautiful, thank you.

"Night is preferable to a day."

Cologero on 2012-03-26 at 08:48 said:

Apart from the annoying mispronunciation of "Guenon", this lecture was more about Fr. Johnson than Rene Guenon. It addressed a small, albeit important, aspect of Guenon's oeuvre. A minor point: pace Fr. Johnson, Guenon did indeed make a distinction between Eastern "religions", such as Buddhism, and Western (so-called Semitic) religions.

Cologero on 2012-03-28 at 12:36 said:

Here we see de Giorgio as the reconciling force of the Western Tradition, finding unity and harmony where others can only see difference and conflict. Unlike contemporary men who read into the past their present experiences, this is how the Medievals saw themselves. Like the ancients, the medievals had their High Priest and Emperor in Rome; despite the differences in outward form, their was a continuity in their inner life. Dante is, therefore, the holy culmination, the prophet, the revealer of that continuity.

Poetry in Dante is has nothing to do with the psychological fantasies of the moderns; rather, for him, it is a revelation of the Holy Spirit, the way of initiation, with the goal of realization. The symbolism of the Comedy is intractable to the rational mind and is comprehensible only to those with a developed spiritual intuition.

The Comedy describes a pilgrimage, or a quest, from the three worlds, analogous to those of the Tao. When the path is traversed, death is overcome, becoming becomes being in the Divine Night.

When de Giorgio writes of Fascism, he is not just referring to a limited political movement in Italy of the 30s, but rather to the Roman Tradition, which was the ultimate source of the symbol of the Fasces¹⁹.

The Comedy leads us to the Primordial Tradition, which has a joy that transcends any little delights we may experience in our ordinary life. The path leads from earth to heaven. Nietzsche

¹⁹http://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/thumb/7/74/Fasces_lictoriae.svg/224px-Fasces_lictoriae.svg.png

exhorts us to “become what you are”. But it requires a Dante to tell us who we are and how we can become it.

Matt on 2012-03-28 at 17:14 said:

These translations of de Giorgio have been great. Are you thinking of translating anymore? His approach to Tradition I must say is rather fascinating (and from the description of him in Evola's Path of Cinnabar, de Giorgio the man is fascinating).

Matt on 2012-03-28 at 17:15 said:

Never mind, just read one of your earlier comments that states you will provide more. Apologies.

Cologero on 2012-03-28 at 19:02 said:

The way to encourage us to provide more translations, which, obviously, we do not require for ourselves, is to engage in a lively discussion in the comments. Readership has gone down in each of the four installments, so, unfortunately, not everyone shares your enthusiasm.

Cologero on 2012-04-05 at 07:45 said:

The occult, or secret, name of Rome is an idea that may be unfamiliar to some readers. Besides its public name, Rome had a secret name that was only used in certain rites and rituals. Only the High Priest and his associates even knew that name. Presumably, this secret name has long been forgotten. Some say it is Amor (Roma spelled backwards), which means Love.

Cologero on 2012-03-28 at 13:08 said:

“Shadow” here needs to be understood in the sense of shade, or ghost, as the ancients understood the post-mortem state in the afterworld. Vigil leads Dante through the worlds of gross and subtle manifestation (forms and rhythms). These worlds were well understood by the ancients, as Virgil wrote of them in his own inspired poetic works.

The ancient Romans knew the occult forces behind those worlds, which they either propitiated in their rites or learned to dominate. The third dimension of depth, these occult forces, elude the minds of the vulgar, both in the past and even more so in the present.

Hell, then, is the most concrete form of gross manifestation, and Virgil shows the way to subtle manifestation. However, he yields to Beatrice who brings Dante to the threshold of understanding non-formal manifestation. Most men, because they either adhere to the ancients or the medievals, can see only a division and a separation. However, Dante reveals that this division is illusory.

De Giorgio's view is quite different from that of Duke di Cesaro, who regards the ancient (and eventually even the medieval) tradition as something to be overcome and discarded in

some evolutionary master plan. No, de Giorgio shows that the ancient tradition is fully revealed and completed in the medieval tradition, which itself would be partial and incomplete without the earlier.

The each have their role in the synthesis. The ancient tradition is the Empire, or temporal power. This is where Evola stops and it colours his understanding of the Medieval synthesis. The medieval tradition is the Kingdom of God, representing spiritual authority. Both wings of the eagle are necessary, and this is the meaning of the symbol of the two-faced Janus²⁰. Rome is the centre, and the quarrel between the two traditions must end, once this is understood.

Matt on 2012-03-28 at 17:20 said:

"Shadow" here needs to be understood in the sense of shade, or ghost"

Kind of like a psychic corpse?

Cologero on 2012-03-28 at 19:14 said:

I'm afraid, Matt, that I cannot provide every reference for every conceivable topic, as much as I try. Since Virgil did include ghost stories, it would be nice if readers can fill in the gaps ... you cannot continue to expect George to do everything for you.

For those interested, a place to start is this painting by Ary Scheffer²¹.

Matt on 2012-03-28 at 19:48 said:

The question was rather redundant in hindsight.

Cologero on 2012-03-31 at 12:58 said:

We see in this segment that de Giorgio is confirming Guenon's teaching on symbols. He write: "symbolic values remain such even if unknown or misunderstood until a new light suddenly illuminates them and reveals them." The symbol is there, even if its full meaning is hidden, or occult. Dante reveals in the Comedy the meaning of the occult name of Rome.

He prepared the way in De Monarchia in which he revealed the full meaning of and justification for the first Rome. The way from a human state to a transhuman state is revealed in the Comedy. This is understood by very few today, and I suspect this is the first exposure of this occult teaching to most if not all Goranhoor readers.

Those who cannot move beyond the first Rome of the Imperium are unable to progress. Those who don't understand the second Rome of the Kingdom have lost touch with their own

²⁰<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Janus>

²¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/File:1855_Ary_Scheffer_-_The_Ghosts_of_Paolo_and_Francesca_Appear_to_Dante_and_Virgil.jpg

Tradition. Clearly we mean here a living connection, as de Giorgio writes, not merely a theoretical understanding.

"Indiamento" is the word used in neo-Platonism for the mystical union with God. Once again, de Giorgio is making clear this connection, at least for those who make the effort to see and are not blinded by their pre-existing prejudices.

The nine hierarchies, which we have described in *Spiritual Beings*²² can be understood as semi-divine beings or as higher, transhuman states. A fascinating metaphor used by de Giorgio refers to them as "facets". In other words, the "Trinitarian scheme" is passed through, as it were, the facets of a diamond, and like a prism, separate the divine Light into the multiplicity of the world. Hence, the angelic hierarchies assist in the creation (or emanation) of the world.

It is worth meditating on the idea of the Perfect Man, that is, the man who realizes all his possibilities as both Guenon and Evola have written about. The end of such a meditation will be the realization of the Absolute Being; but the way to such a realization is only through the Perfect Man.

Cologero on 2012-04-01 at 13:01 said:

Like his colleague Rene Guenon, Guido de Giorgio regards the Divine Comedy as an inspired work describing a spiritual path. Vulgar minds, and de Giorgio would include academics in this category, fail to grasp this aspect of the Comedy. Some even see in the Comedy, nothing but racism, anti-semitism, and homophobia²³. The many allusions to events in Florence of some 8 centuries ago hide deeper meanings that are lost on them.

Dante rectifies the division between the East and West, as his goal is the Primordial Tradition. The references to the Dominicans and the Franciscans represent two competing spiritual styles. They can be understood as the difference between Apollonian and Dionysian initiations.

Given the human situation, men continue to fight illusory battles: between Apollo and Dionysus, pagan and christian, east and west. At a higher level, these views are unified. When this becomes understood by all the parties, then the Western World will return to its previous vigour.

Cologero on 2012-04-06 at 11:29 said:

Why did Dante place Plato and the Philosophers in hell?

Some readers may remember Exit, who until now has honored a voluntary ban on commenting here. However, he did ask a pertinent question about the Comedy. On the assumption his question was sincere, I decided to pass the question on. Perhaps some readers are willing

²²<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1941>

²³http://takimag.com/article/the_divine_comedy_funniest_than_ever_taki_theodoracopulos/print#axzz1qoAHKtSq

and able to respond to it, keeping in mind all that we have written on the topic, following Guenon and Guido de Giorgio.

apeiron on 2012-04-06 at 16:08 said:

While the paganism of antiquity could interpret the divine, it only went half-way and this is discounting the prejudices of catholic dogmatism. Discursive thought is not unifying logos. That is the problem with philosophy. No matter how close the articulations are to the primordial (exempli gratia, Heraclitus) it begins the rationalist discursive cycle after the initial divine act has lost its potency. There is more power in the act.

Cologero on 2012-04-06 at 22:35 said:

Thanks, apeiron, for the intriguing comment, but that did not please the questioner. Unfortunately, the vulgar can interpret the Comedy as a travelogue, rather than as a description of states of consciousness on the path to the primordial state.

To clarify a point, the pagan philosophers and poets inhabit Limbo, just outside of Hell. There is no suffering per se (other than, perhaps, the loss of hope). They live in the natural light of reason and a natural happiness. Their post-mortem state is not a negative judgment of Dante, who greatly respects those poets and philosophers. Rather it is a matter of justice, since that is how the pagans themselves envisioned the afterlife. We alluded to this when we mentioned Virgil's description of ghosts or shadows, from Aeneas' descent to the underworld.

In an upcoming post, we will deal with Evola's description of the afterlife. While we respect Evola, this will show his limitations since he also cannot conceive of higher states. Evola did not know the occult name of Rome.

6.10 Haunted by the Emperor

Europe is haunted by the shadow of the Emperor. One senses his absence just as vividly as in former times one sensed his presence. Because the emptiness of the wound speaks, that which we miss knows how to make us sense it.

VALENTIN TOMBERG, *Meditations on the Tarot*

At the apex of everything, as myth and limit, the ideal of the *Chakravartin*, "the King of the World", the invisible emperor, whose strength is hidden, powerful, and unconditioned.

JULIUS EVOLA, *Pagan Imperialism*

The Gelasian Dyarchy **Rene Guenon** wrote an essay describing how the traditional ordering of society was based on both Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power. **Ananda Coomaraswamy** followed that up with a similar essay describing its application in Indian political thinking. Probably less well known is that the notion of the two powers is firmly rooted also in the Western tradition. The following letter from Pope Gelasius I to Emperor Anastasius in 492 summarizes this teaching:

There are two, august Emperor, by which this world is chiefly ruled, namely, the sacred authority (*auctoritas sacrata*) of the priests and the royal power (*regalis potestas*). Of these, that of the priests is weightier, since they have to render an account for even the kings of men in the divine judgment. You are also aware, most clement son, that while you are permitted honorably to rule over human kind, yet in divine matters you bend your neck devotedly to the bishops and await from them the means of your salvation. In the reception and proper disposition of the heavenly sacraments you recognize that you should be subordinate rather than superior to the religious order, and that in these things you depend on their judgment rather than wish to bend them to your will.

If the ministers of religion, recognizing the supremacy granted you from heaven in matters affecting the public order, obey your laws, lest otherwise they might obstruct the course of secular affairs by irrelevant considerations, with what readiness should you not yield them obedience to whom is assigned the dispensing of the sacred mysteries of religion? Accordingly, just as there is no slight danger in the case of the priests if they refrain from speaking when the service of the divinity requires, so there is no little risk for those who disdain—which God forbid—when they should obey. And if it is fitting that the hearts of the faithful should submit to all priests in general who properly administer divine affairs,

how much the more is obedience due to the bishop of that see which the Most High ordained to be above all others, and which is consequently dutifully honored by the devotion of the whole Church.

The obvious question, then, is why did not the Medieval civilization persist as long as other Traditional societies such as ancient Egypt, China, India, or even Rome. Clearly, the personal element entered into it, since the Pope and the Emperor often intruded into each other's domain. Then nationalism always threatened the spiritual unity and the political power of the Holy Roman Empire. That is why nationalism is anti-tradition.

Although Julius Evola was wildly incorrect in assuming the Emperor had dominion over the priests, his notion that the Emperor could also possess spiritual authority is worthy of consideration. Valentin Tomberg points out that the Pope and the Emperor are "posts", not necessarily different individuals. **Vladimir Solovyov** tried to bring the idea of Tsar and High Priest back into Orthodoxy. However, while the role of the spiritual authority was explicitly defined, the limits of temporal power were not. For that, we can look at the reign of the Holy Roman Emperor Frederick II, even though the unity he created did not survive his death.

The Viking Emperor Frederick II was the descendant of the Normans who had invaded Sicily, although he also had German and Sicilian blood. His intelligence was huge, in stark contrast to the mediocre leaders of our own time. He was trained in scholastic and classical philosophy, but also studied Aristotle and the Islamic philosophers Avicenna and Averroes. Fluent in six languages, he was also a promoter of the arts, particularly poetry.

Frederick served as the model for **Dante's** ideas on Monarchy. Thus, for him the State was as much part of the plan for salvation as was the Church. He also seems to have been the inspiration for Evola's description of the Emperor. Frederick claimed that he was the only true indi-

vidual in the State, since he is the One, not a part of another (like his subjects).

As King of Sicily, he sought to unify the nation; this required several elements:

- community of blood
- community of speech
- community of festivals
- community of history
- unity of law

This created a certain tension since it encouraged a nascent nationalism. The Church was less interested in blood ties, since it was a community of believers. Latin was preferred to the vernacular, and Church feasts to local festivals. This had to be carefully balanced, since it was the Church that guaranteed the Emperor's position as well as the Holy Roman Empire. This tension persists in our day.

The Rational Order Frederick's innovation was to base the State soundly on natural reason, so that it was not a matter of faith or belief. Hence it was purely natural, hence acceptable even to unbelievers. As such, the State was the resultant of three forces:

- *Justitia*
- *Necessitas*
- *Providentia*

To implement these ideas, Frederick created a separate hieratic order of intellectuals, modeled on the chivalric orders. This was not unlike the Prussian State under the Teutonic Order, since the constitution of the Prussian State was likewise based on a rational system. As a matter of fact, the Order of Teutonic Knights in Prussia and the Sicilian hierarchy mutually influenced each other.

Justice For Frederick, Justice is both the founder of, as well as founded in, the State. Kings and the State became necessary only because of the Fall. For Dante, the Roman Empire was symbolized by the Tree of Knowledge. The Emperor, then, would lead men back to the highest natural wisdom at the entrance to Paradise; then the Church would take up the task bring men back to that primeval state of innocence.

Adam was a law-breaker, hence the State and Justice became the remedy. Frederick implemented a new *Book of Laws* for Sicily. Its purpose was Justice:

daily to conceive new methods to reward the virtuous and to pulverize the vicious under repeated blows of punishment, when the old human laws under the changes wrought by time and circumstance no longer suffice to eradicate vice and to implant virtue.

Necessity Basing himself on the teachings of Aristotle and Aristotle's Arabic commentators, Frederick saw the State and the King arising from natural necessity. Hence, there was no need for any other justification. Earlier leaders may have claimed that the State was instituted by God, or a god, but that could not compel belief. As belief in the gods waned, the state lost its support. However, Frederick claimed that the need for a ruler could be grasped by reason, or else the human race would have destroyed itself. Dante later elaborated on this idea in *De Monarchia*, claiming:

Thus Monarchy is necessary for the safety, for the advantage of the world.

Of course, *Necessitas* encompassed more than that alone. It referred to the inevitability of things according to a natural law. Human life itself was subject to the law of Necessity. Rationality, then, results in the incorporation of the laws of nature into the positive law of the State.

Providence Frederick rejected the idea of a capricious God intervening miraculously into human affairs. Obviously, this is unlike the pagans, for whom the gods and goddesses were always interfering arbitrarily in world events. For Frederick, God's Providence was itself the Law, or the *Logos* as we would prefer to state it. That means that the natural order was itself the reflection of the Divine Order, and so Providence was Rational. The Scholastics had a similar definition:

Providence is the Reason of a purposeful order of things.

Moreover, it was the Emperor who was the mediator and interpreter of the Divine Plan.

Marriage Laws As an example of a specific application of Frederick's notion of Justice, we will consider the marriage laws that he implemented in Sicily. While not denying its sacramental value, Frederick regarded marriage as a necessity of nature for the preservation of the human race. Hence, the intention of those laws was improving the breed. Specifically, a Sicilian was forbidden to marry a non-Sicilian. This is his justification:

It has often grieved us to see how the righteousness of our kingdom has suffered corruption from foreign manners by the mixture of different peoples. When the men of Sicily ally themselves with the daughters of foreigners, the purity of the race becomes besmirched, while evil and sensual weakness increase, the purity of the people is contaminated by the speech and by the habits of the others, and the seed of the stranger defiles the hearth of our faithful subjects.

The Church was only concerned about the spiritual makeup of the marriage partners. That is, she follows a “moral logic” (in Valentin Tomberg’s terms), while the State follows an “organic logic”. This logic, moreover, is justified by the very nature of things.²⁴

Heresy Laws The Catholic Faith was declared the State Religion. Hence, heresy was not simply a crime against the Church, but was considered to be treason against the State. It was considered both blasphemy against God and an attack on the Emperor. Hence, heresy was a State matter and did not involve Church officials. In this, Frederick modeled these laws on Imperial Rome.

Multiculturalism The heresy laws did not apply to the Jews, Muslims, and Orthodox Greeks living in Sicily. Nevertheless, they were segregated from the Catholic Sicilians. Moreover, they were subject to their own laws. For example, the Jews were permitted to follow their own religious laws. They were even exempt from the laws against usury, which would have consequences years later. Although Jews and Muslims could not be oppressed, they were never full citizens. The same tolerance was not afforded to heretics or apostates.

The primary reference for this material is *Frederick the Second* by Ernst Kantorowicz.

Posted on 2017-01-04 by Cologero

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Mark Citadel on 2017-01-18 at 12:05 said:

²⁴We discussed the idea of the right of the state to determine its genetic makeup in *Social Surgery* (<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=8253>). Clearly, Frederick was centuries ahead of Bradley in this regard.

A lot of food for thought here (Tomberg is one author I should certainly read more of). What would be your response to Maistre's critique of basing the state around 'reason'? Is the kind of 'reason' that Maistre criticized of a different order than Frederick's?

In your view, does the priestly caste have any judicial authority. If not for heresy, then for what, beyond intra-ecclesiastic discipline?

Reza on 2017-01-20 at 11:20 said:

Just a minor correction: Avicenna was not an "Arabic Philosopher". He was Iranian.

Otherwise a very interesting article.

[Thanks for bringing that to my attention ... unfortunately, I was quoting the book]

Cologero on 2017-01-23 at 21:08 said:

@Mark, I believe that Maistre had in mind attempts like Rousseau's to base the legitimacy of the state on pure reason; ultimately, there it can only be based on a spiritual authority. That does not imply that specific policies should be irrational; quite the contrary. Since you mentioned Tomberg, Tomberg identified orders of logic beyond formal logic: viz., organic logic and moral logic. That will be a topic here in the near future.

Mark Citadel on 2017-02-01 at 12:46 said:

I look forward to it! What you have said makes sense, dividing the core of society (which is esoteric) from the core of policy, which is based on sound reason.

By the way, I recently moved my blog over to WordPress, so feel free to update the link on your blogroll whenever you get the time.

<http://citadelfoundations.wordpress.com>

Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power

7.1 Action and Reaction

Although we have addressed the issue about the relationship between the spiritual authority and temporal power over and over, we may as well address it again with the hope and expectation that future commentators will offer more than links to other web sites. Here we are quoting Evola:

In fact, such a thesis expresses the brahmanical-sacerdotal point of view of an Oriental, which, as we have already exposed and regardless of what Guenon may think, is but one of the possible points of view and by no means can pretend to have an absolute and exclusive value.

Obviously, Guenon is expressing the brahmanical point of view which, by its very nature is incomprehensible to other castes due to their differing inclinations and functions¹. Of course, this “point of view” is more than

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1647>

an opinion, it is something that, according to Guenon and Tradition, can be *absolutely and exclusively* known.

If that were the case, it would seem obvious that the Guelf thesis of the subordination of the State, as temporal power, to a spiritual authority monopolised by a sacerdotal caste, would be correct. But it is precisely the premise of this thesis that is not only erroneous but unacceptable because unilateral. Thus we must, in these circumstances, start again from zero.

Here is the source of Evola's confusion. Apparently he objects to the idea of "subordination", but that would be accurate only by confounding the notion of spiritual authority with temporal power. The brahmin caste does not exercise power in that way. The Traditional analogy is to regard them as the two wings of a bird, not as a relationship of subordination. That relationship is not at all unilateral, but accepted by both sides, hence it cannot be erroneous by Evola's argument. We have given the example, which Evola was certainly familiar with, of the Spartans and Romans at war². The military caste waits for the priests to announce the auspicious moment. So even if we start again at zero, we still end up at the same place.

This is for us a certain point which, among other things, clearly reveals the possibility of a spiritual significance of royalty, in virtue of which it can absorb and transcend in itself the sacerdotal function and be, beyond a temporal power, a spiritual authority.

Well, yes, royalty can combine both functions as we have documented in the Ancient City³. In the essay that Evola is critiquing, Guenon himself admits the possibility of the priest-king, since the two functions draw

²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2024>

³<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2554>

on a common higher principle. We take pains to point this out, as we recently did in regards to Buddha⁴. Closer to home, Christ has always been regarded as both Priest and King. So rather than refuting Guenon's "point of view", Evola talks like a man who just yesterday discovered sliced bread.

From the purely metaphysical viewpoint, we do not speak of 'principles' to know but of spiritual states to attain, of transcendent contacts to achieve owing to forces that, ultimately, do not cease to belong to the integral being of man.

Once again, we do not understand this objection. the attainment of spiritual states is identical to knowing those states; there is no distinction between knowing and being, a topic that we may have to address at another time. We disagree that all forces ultimately belong to the integral being of man. There are certainly forces that transcend the human state. We previously quoted Guenon:

Action, no matter of what sort, cannot under any circumstances liberate from action; in other words it can only bear fruit within its own domain, which is that of human individuality. Thus it is not through action that it is possible to transcend individuality.

This is in perfect agreement with Evola, since Evola agrees that action is restricted to the integral being of man.

In the metaphysical and concrete sense, 'tradition' — we have sufficiently repeated over and again — is nothing more than the presence of such superior realisations as a continuity established from generation to generation by a chain of superior individualities. Wherever the royal tradition, defended by the warrior castes, has

⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3774>

been correctly understood, it never had any other sense but that one. 'Tradition' reduced to a doctrine, to a tradition of 'teachings' and of 'principles', is, in most cases, nothing but a *caput mortuum* — the 'letter', much more than the 'spirit'. And it is precisely on such grounds that 'churches' flourish, whereas the experience of heroism and of self-control is something which is far more engaging for it to give place as often to such ambiguities and to such falls of tension.

This is a valid point, as far as it goes. When a tradition is reduced to a set of doctrines to be accepted in an extrinsic sense rather than an intrinsic knowing of them the tradition is dead. Unfortunately, the royal and warrior tradition dies with it. We see that in the decline of the Roman Empire, when the aristocracy no longer understood their own rites and traditions. Evola gives a strong defense of the Kshatriya perspective, bearing in mind that it is a perspective not a refutation of other perspectives. Since very few men, and fewer in the West, are called to seek Deliverance from all states, Evola's path is more appropriate as we have defended in *The Cosmic Value of Human Action*⁵.

Since Guenon understands correctly (insofar as it has always been the traditional teaching) that 'knowledge', in the metaphysical sense, and 'realisation' (action) are one and the same thing and inseparable elements in the simplicity of an act, Guenon should not have any difficulty admitting that action — symbol of the warrior castes — can constitute a path just as metaphysical as 'knowledge'.

Once again, it seems that Evola is simply ignorant, since there is no argument about multiple paths. Guenon writes about the Path of the Gods (*devayana*) and the Path of the ancestors (*pitriyana*), where the goal of the former is the transcendence of all individual states. That is

⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1856>

simply not the path of the warrior. In the Vedantic tradition, there is jnana yoga (knowledge), karma yoga (action) and bhakti yoga (devotion). So, obviously those are paths, but isn't it obvious to everyone that those who follow the path of action are not those who maintain knowledge of the tradition? In the Ancient City, the knowledge of the traditional rites was kept alive for centuries, but not necessarily by those who performed them.

And perhaps should we remind Guenon of the Bhagavad Gita as an example of glorification of the warrior action that has nothing to do with the glorification of something material and temporal?

Well, Guenon refers to the Bhagavad Gita pretty often, himself. Nevertheless, did not Arjuna have to be convinced of the rightness of that warrior action? Krishna, the representative of the Brahmin caste, was Arjuna's teacher, so proper knowledge precedes right action. To regard the Gita as merely a text on the glorification of war rather than as a metaphysical teaching, is to greatly miss the point.

And does not the very concept of 'unmoved mover' used by Guenon as characterising the pure spiritual authority and defined as "the thought of thought", does it not refer to a modality of action, through this very notion of 'mover'?

Of course, but what is the point? This **unmoved mover**, or Self, is precisely that which is unaffected by action, since it is unmoved. Yet as we pointed out in *Salvation, Deliverance, Action*⁶, even the enlightened being appears at a certain place and time, and hence appears to act. As we quoted Lama Govinda:

He is no more a slave to law, but its master, because he has understood and realized it so profoundly. Through knowledge we

⁶<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3780>

master the law, and by mastering it, it ceases to be necessity, but becomes an instrument of real self-expression and spiritual freedom.

This is compatible with Evola's point of view as he has expressed it on many occasions. So the rupture he sees with Guenon is more apparent than real.

It is not about a conflict between a spiritual authority and a rebellious temporal power but, on the contrary, a conflict between two distinct forms of authority equally spiritual and yet irreducible. Here again, we cannot repeat ourselves. Our readers know what we are talking about.

No, we don't know what he is talking about. Originally, the Ancient City was ruled by a priest-king. Then the temporal power revolted, stripping the kingly powers from the leader. This is historically documented in a work known to Evola (i.e., *The Ancient City*).

The cause cannot reside in the upper hand that, at a certain point, temporal power took spiritual authority. How can such a thing be possible in the first place? Should the hierarchy of which Guenon speaks thus be conceived as something so abstract, to the point of admitting that the superior does not also have the task of being the strongest? And if this were not the case, how could the inferior have imposed itself on the superior and thus paralysed the irresistible power of spiritual authority and supplanted it with temporal power?

Good question, and how could the warrior caste and landed aristocracy be taken over by merchants and bankers? And how could the plebes create a council in the heart of Rome, and later destroy the monarchies of France and Russia? Does it begin with the decline of spiritual authority,

or the rebellion of lower castes who no longer support that authority? The idea that a warrior caste alone can unify an entire nation or Empire apart from a “sacerdotal” caste is impossible, both metaphysically and historically.

Conclusion Unfortunately, the overall tone of Evola’s essay is polemical, rather than reasoned. Properly understood, there is ultimately little to choose between two points of view, which, as such, cannot refute each other, but should instead enhance each other. Evola is too eager to bring in irrelevancies such as the so-called “sacerdotal” caste, or lunar and solar traditions, a classification due to Bachofen, not any traditional writer. A case can be made for a Hermetic tradition and an heroic path. After all, in the Middle Ages both were living options and the warrior caste had its own initiatory path, separate from the “sacerdotal” caste. Nevertheless, the former accepted the spiritual authority (though not the “power”) of the latter.

We can well understand the emotional power of Evola’s vision. Every man can envision himself as a warrior, hero, or alchemist, but it is much more difficult to see himself as a yogi or priest. That is because he thinks he understands what it takes to be a warrior, but it is less clear what it means to be a yogi, or someone who has transcended all states. The temporal power can never assume spiritual authority, it can only lose it. It will then lose itself in the bargain.

* * *

J on 2012-02-21 at 15:59 said:

This is a useful response. I left the previous link with no argument because you supposedly eschew arguments. I figured people can read and differentiate/unify on their own.

My initial problem wasn’t so much with your overall emphasis (else I wouldn’t bother), but rather a minor point which probably comes down more to style and personality—particularly the incessant picking at others who apparently don’t “get it”, using what I think are demonstrably unfair tactics to dismiss a whole category of people who are taking an action-oriented approach

involving something icky. I found it summarily dismissive and not really supported, since you failed to really identify of whom you were speaking and what makes their principles inherently incorrect. Lacking that, I had to presume it applies to all involved in anything labelled “sex magic”, which renders a rather absurd reading, but since you grew it to include everyone who has sex at all, perhaps I still don’t “get it”, either. The whole attempt to bring in thelemites (without so labeling them, and apparently not at all dedicated to their definition of “sex magic”) as some sort of counter-example was simply unnecessary and confusing.

Otherwise your points on metaphysics are well received and always bring about consideration, probably more than you would imagine, and I thank you for laying out a response to the issues raised in Evola’s article.

Of course this talk of “warriors” may make the path of action seem more interesting, or more emotive than talk of priests. I wonder to what extent the warrior’s experience of the nearness of death might transcend the priest’s playing at it. I wonder so not because it entertains me to select a better, or to pretend at being a warrior, but because I don’t think deliberately favoring one side or the other in these matters is really meaningful except to illustrate this or that point requiring the right perspective.

Cologero on 2012-02-21 at 23:12 said:

The reason you don’t “get it” is because what you are trying to get simply isn’t there in the first place. If we posit a goal of reaching certain higher states, then of course we become interested in how to achieve them. If doing something icky can lead to higher states, or at least prepare oneself for them, then please explain how so. Obviously, it is not the ickyness in itself, but something superadded to it. Otherwise, the original criticism stands. So what is superadded?

I did indeed provide an example from Crowley which referred to his own description of the practice. Perhaps you know thelemites who differ from Crowley in that regard, but then the word has no meaning. As Crowley points out, the idea is to exhaust the body and mind, presumably to shut down the normal discursive thought processes in order to allow something else to happen in consciousness.

There is also a problem with self-deception. A few weeks ago, I read of an American TV show where the contenders for a prize had to drink donkey semen. My first reaction was to regard it as icky, but then I realized there are whole categories of people who may enjoy the taste of semen and regularly consume it. So it wouldn’t really be a challenge for them.

For an understanding of action from different points of view, I can recommend these articles:

*Qualifications for Initiation*⁷

⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1161>

*Universality and the Heroic Life*⁸

*The Three Trials*⁹

*Builder of Worlds*¹⁰

logres on 2012-02-22 at 00:44 said:

Where does the “prophet” fit in?

Losang Shenphen on 2012-02-23 at 12:35 said:

Excellent observation, Mr Hoo, Gornahoor is quite amusing, one big joke in fact. It should only be read through a monocle.

H00 on 2012-02-23 at 13:29 said:

Losang Shenphen, why do you say this? And what is the use of a monocle when one has perfect vision?

H00 on 2012-02-23 at 18:17 said:

I'm not sure if anybody meant so, but to be clear, Traditional Sexual-Magic is not merely symbolic. Traditional sexual-magic involves the manipulation of energy (“subtle and vital currents (vayus)”) latent within the body. Nor is anything symbolic, when it is regarding a true symbol, merely so; as symbols are “magic, menial, psychic and moral operations” awakening new notions, ideas, sentiments and aspirations.” And they are always reflected in the organism. Regarding inefficient sexual-rituals, if those include those of Crowley or not; why would we worry that others fool themselves, enjoy themselves or suffer? Pashu does as pashu is. Cologero “To regard the Gita as MERELY a text on the glorification of war rather than as a metaphysical teaching”

Evola nowhere does this.

apeiron on 2012-02-23 at 21:20 said:

Evola has essentially understood that the two were once one that converged with each other (both temporal and spiritual power, the two-headed alchemical androgyne, Priest-King, Sacral Imperator).

This makes the most sense, as demonstrated linearly within an historical manifestation; all emanations beyond the first point are fractals that project a material reflection of an absolute paradisaical primordality. Call them lunar shadows if you will, but Evola ultimately recognized

⁸<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2885>

⁹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1902>

¹⁰<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1884>

their unified existence of the unmanifested absolute being. The trouble begins when someone argues for the legitimacy of one power above the other, when Evola simply makes the argument that they are both as legitimate and converged at the origins into a healthy symbiosis. Will, intellect and action united, this is the meaning of the Cross.

Once again, these breakaways (castes, ways of being, etc) if historically demonstrated, will fracture further away from the center and eventually revolt against each other into lower forms. Rule no.1 one: stay centered, avoid fall. Which is fundamentally why, origins, properly understood, are so integral to Tradition.

Cologero on 2012-02-23 at 22:34 said:

Yes, Hoo, I added the word MERELY. In all cases, the open question is exactly what is beyond the material and temporal?

So to return to sex magic, what is beyond the material and temporal? You imply subtle energy is within the body. Let us look at what Guenon writes:

The gross state is corporeal existence.

The subtle state includes extra-corporeal modalities of the human being as well as all other individual states.

These two terms are not truly symmetrical and cannot even have any common measure.

Hence, there are no subtle energies latent within the body, which would be a contradiction. So the subtle energies are to be found elsewhere than in the body. So it is far from clear how a physical act can awaken the awareness of such subtle energies, at least in any mechanical way. Of course, physical trials may provide the opportunity to confront one's fears, weaknesses, lusts and so on, and to develop the opposite qualities of courage, strength, fidelity. But this is far from automatic.

We have yet to hear from anyone regarding the specifics of sex magic in this regard. Also, oddly enough, no one has bothered to respond to this question: if we accept alchemical descriptions as symbolic, then why not the same for sex magic?

We have received almost no comments on Serrano's *The Test*¹¹. Here is some homework: practice sex magic with total detachment and no expectation; then report back on the results.

As for the fools, we have great compassion for them and endeavour to save them years of fruitless searching. Also, fools manage to teach us a lot. Isn't that the real meaning of the Tantras, the practice for the Kali Yuga? Specifically, that enlightenment is no longer constrained to certain paths and practices, but may arise from formerly forbidden sources, such as fools, women, or outcasts.

¹¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=70>

Cologero on 2012-02-23 at 23:19 said:

Yes, with a caveat. Guenon and Evola write of spiritual *authority*, not power. Resentment is the sign of the kali yuga as well as the idea that one caste is *over* another. Rather, it is a question of their respective functions or spheres of influence.

8.1 Il Capo

The rule of many is not good; one ruler let there be.

Ulysses, in Homer's *The Iliad*, and again by Aristotle at the end
of Book XII of the *Metaphysics*.

Much is made over the alleged Evolian reversal of the roles of the castes. This in part stems from his portrayal of the regal initiation being above the sacerdotal initiation, which arises from a misreading of some Hindu texts as Coomaraswamy pointed out. Evola also objected to the necessity for the Holy Roman Emperor to be consecrated by the Pope. However, the consecration is not the problem, but the idea of two rulers is. As Guenon points out the *The Lord of the World*, the idea of a single head is certainly traditional and the split in the Middle Ages was a deviation. Guenon writes:

By the Middle Ages, supreme power had already become divided
between the Empire and the Papacy. Such a division marks an or-

ganisation that is incomplete at its head since the common principle, on which the two powers depend, is missing.

So with the intent of completely putting this issue to rest, we will bring out the full meaning of Guenon's point, and with a minor tweak, this will bring Evola completely in line with Tradition on this point. In *La Tradizione Romana* Guido de Giorgio dedicated a section of the book to the "Constitution of a Traditional Society". The first three chapters deal with the three twice-born castes and the fourth with the idea of the "Capo" — Head, Chief, Leader. Beginning with Ulysses' statement, de Giorgio makes these points.

- A single Chief in time corresponds to the supreme unity in eternity.
- Since God is pure contemplation, so inversely the Chief will make of his life a pure activity dedicated to the preservation of His order in the world.
- The Chief holds temporal power and supreme authority whose dominion embraces all of active life.
- His work depends on the highest virtue: Justice.
- He the the Prince of the Warriors, but his power is exercised over everyone.
- Although he *arises* from the Warrior caste, he is *above* all the castes.
- He is consecrated by the first caste.
- He leads the second caste in the protection and preservation of Traditional order.

- He guards the “Temple” and protects the contemplatives so that spiritual truths are available to all.
- He is absolutely autonomous and the priests own him obedience, just as do the other castes.
- The priests must not interfere in temporal affairs.

To summarize: although the Chief is consecrated by the priests, his power is by Divine Right. He holds temporal power over all. His is a life of activity, since he is the means through which God’s will “Providence” is accomplished. In other words, by his dominion and action, he does not experience privation.

Posted on 2011-03-11 by Cologero

* * *

Albion on 2011-03-11 at 01:09 said:

Could one say that there is a difference between ecclesiastical/bureaucratic unity and visible unity?

Visionsofglory14 on 2011-03-11 at 02:09 said:

Evola seems to question the necessity of consecration. To him, it only becomes necessary in later, more decadent periods when sacerdotal temporal power begins to encroach on the regal. The true Brahman, in Evola’s interpretation, would not need consecration since his spiritual authority speaks for itself. Divine Right cannot be granted except by the spirit itself, so in his highest formation, the Chief would not need consecration.

Albion on 2011-03-11 at 08:00 said:

So what we would normally conceive as emerging in and from the invisible world to “manifest”, Evola considers to have had an actual physical emergence in its own invisibility? For those who could see?

Ted on 2011-03-11 at 18:03 said:

But for what it is worth: Evola does cite the Brihad Aranyaka Upanishad, in which a Kshatriya instructs a Brahmin, and when the Brahmin expresses surprise at his knowledge he replies that there were some secrets that the Kshatriyas still have not told the Brahmins. This is connected with Tantra, by the way. I don't have time to go into this right now. Perhaps tomorrow.

One last thing: In Volume One of Will Durant's "The Story of Civilization" ("Our Oriental Heritage"), he asserts that originally the Kshatriya class was superior to the Brahmins, who were their assistants. Ananda Coomaraswamy was one of the Durant's main consultants on this volume.

Cologero on 2011-03-11 at 19:24 said:

We have always written about the castes in terms of their roles and the type of persons of which they consist. This has nothing to do with "superiority" or "inferiority", except only incidentally. The role of the Kshatriya is to rule and administer. If that is what you mean by "superior", it really adds nothing.

kadambari on 2011-03-11 at 20:51 said:

... While Kings could have contempt for Brahmins as Kings, they also feared their knowledge and purity, and many sages had contempt for the life of the ruler or administrator and were feared and admired due to their wisdom, and even Kings feared the sages... In the Politics, Aristotle places the life of contemplation above the political life which is interesting, the enlightened man goes into it by a kind of necessity..

H00 on 2011-03-11 at 21:21 said:

Aristotle is writing very late in the transience of this planet (writing itself being a late degeneration), the split already being quite antique in his age; his perspective thus reflecting that.

kadambari on 2011-03-11 at 21:51 said:

The Greek term "Deinos" captures the respect and awe which superior beings evoked...

Ted on 2011-03-12 at 11:55 said:

I hesitate to go into this... but here goes anyway.

The Hyperboreans. A divine or semi-divine race which lived within the northern circumpolar region. Due to glaciation brought on by physical or meta-physical reasons, or perhaps both, they gradually moved south. In India, they were known as the Aryans.

In Genesis Chapter 6, as well as in the Book of Enoch, there is mention of the "Nephilim" or the "Watchers". Without going into detail here, which in any event can be found in Evola's "Revolt Against the Modern World", this myth refers to the interbreeding of this race with the local populations with which they came into contact with. The progeny were the Nephilim or the

Watchers, and they had superior abilities, both physical and metaphysical, than did the common run of "humanity". As Plato says in the *Critias*, when Posiedon mated with human woman on Atlantis, the progeny which resulted remained pure and noble until the human admixture became predominant. At that point they became corrupt. And Atlantis was destroyed, either through war, technological catastrophe, the misuse of magic or by an act of higher powers. The underlying cause of this destruction, of course, was the corruption of its population.

In India, a genetic analysis of the population conducted 7 or 8 years ago showed that the Kshatriya class in India had the highest proportion of foreign DNA of a European origin. The Brahmins were a somewhat close second. And the other two castes were far distant.

This seems consistent with Evola's contention that the Kshatriya class was the superior; the Hyperborean/Aryans set up those most close to the original genetic stream, the Kshatriyas, as the rulers, and then selected the close second Brahmins to be their assistants.

Cologero on 2011-03-12 at 13:14 said:

Wow, Ted, life would be so much easier in your sand-castle in the sky. Instead of having to prove his valor, intelligence, strength, virtue or leadership skills, all a man would have to do is display his genome and the masses of his genetic inferiors would make him dictator by popular acclaim.

And it is remarkable that men with high proportion of European DNA were or are incapable of performing the tasks appropriate to "lower" castes such as medicine, architecture, law, scientific research, art, and so on.

You obviously use Evola to support your claim (show us where he said the Kshatriya is superior because of his genetic stream); you may want to supplement this comment with what Evola says about the race of the spirit and the race of the body.

And explain to us, Ted, how these little factoids lead up to a spiritual transformation. Or should we prefer to sit around in despair cursing ourselves for not having chosen better parents?

Ted on 2011-03-13 at 12:38 said:

My purpose, of course, was not to describe the entire Indian caste system. I was merely discussing the rank of the various castes in light of esoteric teaching and genetic evidence.

Cologero on 2011-03-13 at 14:25 said:

Unfortunately, Ted, Evola never said what you say he said, just the opposite, in fact.

In the Chapter "Regression of Castes" in *Revolt*, he writes, regarding the process of regression:

"Authority descended to the level immediately below, that is, to the caste of the warrior." Hence, the warrior caste was never the first caste.

As for the genetic component, Evola specifically rejects this:

“regality of blood replaced regality of the spirit.” (which he considers a negative development)

Please end this discussion.

Ted on 2011-03-13 at 16:11 said:

But Evola does not, of course, reject the Hyperborean thesis. The influence of genetics and of the blood is transmitted to the descendents of the Hyperboreans, after their coupling with mortal women. Is this not a key component of traditional teaching?

kadambari on 2011-03-17 at 13:49 said:

@Graham

I am not one to believe that everything was perfect in traditional societies. For example, in Persia, the religion was an aristocratic religion, and many of the peasantry disliked the priests and thought them corrupt. But that does not mean that they could not sort out their affairs and needed to get all converted by the sword to an alien faith. It goes without saying that Persia makes Islam palatable through Sufism as it could not get out of it, changing its nature, Persianizing it; the real Islam can be found in Saudi and Pakistan, not the Persianized Islam...

In India, unlike Persia, movements like Buddhism lead to spreading of literacy. Buddhism is an internal phenomenon and sought to make tradition stronger by seeking to strengthen those aspects which were getting corrupted. You also have religions like Jainism in which the mercantile classes who perhaps felt were left out could express spirituality in a way proper to their culture, and so on. But none of these religions destroy the essential Indic unity of culture, which is why all these religions exist pretty much harmoniously. A culture can self-correct if it is left to itself, but when damage is done by external forces to an extent that an entirely way of life is lost, then it is exceedingly difficult to recapture that which is lost.

In India, the destruction was so great after the invasions that people's lives were destroyed and they would just wander about aimlessly after the devastations as they have no clue as to how to react as something they cannot understand has been imposed, this incidentally is where thugs come from, from people wandering about aimlessly after the invasions who have been rendered destitute who turn into thugs...

A proper understanding of Indic religions requires study at a deep level as there are many layers and nuances. My take on it is that if anything good survives there, it is nothing short of miraculous, as other societies never recovered from such devastations...

So the process of healing is likely to be a gradual one if it does not get subverted by forces that prevent healing of a culture, most of which today is home grown so Indians of course are fully responsible. I am just saying there is a larger backdrop to the state of affairs there, the history of the region is a complex one...

Cologero on 2011-03-18 at 13:19 said:

There were 3 editions of *Revolt*, originally published in 1934, then revised and enlarged in 1951, with a final revision in 1969. I have the edition by Edizioni Mediterranee, which is a reprint of the third edition.

HOO, I only mentioned Gregor in regard to Evola, not to his work in general. Despite Gregor's important works on the actual political philosophy of Fascism, he took pains to exclude Evola as a serious thinker in that vein. You may care to look up what we wrote about Fabre d'Olivet who did in fact write about the conflict between the Hyperboreans and black races to the South.

The issue at stake, HOO, which both you and Ted are both unable to grasp, is the false conflation of race and caste. Nothing written here, nor by Evola and Guenon, would support that. You yourself alluded to the work of Dumézil who recognized a tri-functional structure, not tri-racial. Thus in the Hittite civilization you mention. Hittites are members of all three castes, there is no racial segregation implied in that in the least. Do not confuse the caste system with an apartheid system; the latter is racially based, with two parallel and separated cultures occupying the same geographical space. This is not what the caste system is.

You quote Evola: "It is not a matter of indifference that a body has this shape rather than that one: it is not by chance and without consequence."

Exactly our point. It is not a matter of chance since it is a reflection of the spirit, not the cause of the spirit. Genetic evolution, by definition, is based on chance and random variations. How can that account for a spiritually superior race? Now Evola also wrote that if a man is not twice-born, then he is no different from any other man, whatever the color of his eyes. He is just at the first stage that is described in *Individual and Becoming*. Digest that for a day or two before I provide the full quote.

You can criticize the Dravidians, but they have at least kept the Vedic and Tantric Tradition alive, whereas the blue-eyes have not. There is no serious (i.e., not sensationalized by Hollywood) portrayals of the *Illiad*, *Beowulf*, the *Eddas*, and so on. This is fundamentally a spiritual problem, not a biological issue. This must be seen and understood, or no progress is possible.

John on 2011-03-29 at 19:33 said:

I was brought up to believe that the ideal was the warrior-scholar. This ideal is rarely or ever attained. Usually what you get is either an intelligent, knowledgeable, some-what cultured warrior or a scholar with a strong, steady-fast character.

In some families, rather than scholars giving birth to scholars, or warriors giving birth to warriors, you have scholars giving birth to warriors and warriors giving birth to scholars.

One thing that makes Evola attractive is that he is a scholar with a warrior's temperament. I know nothing about his father, but perhaps his father was a warrior.

In families that produce both warriors and scholars, then one or the other temperament will rule in a given temperament, but the other temperament will be that of his father, and therefore the temperament to which he owes obedience.

Cologero on 2011-03-29 at 19:55 said:

Good point, John, the elusive philosopher-king. Perhaps the Templars embodied that ideal, maybe Marcus Aurelius or Frederick II. But even if that idea is attained in one individual, it never alters the fundamental subservience of temporal power to spiritual authority.

8.2 The Meaning and Function of Monarchy

This essay by **Julius Evola** was published under the title *Significato e funzione della monarchia*. It was included in “La monarchia nello Stato modern” by Karl Loewenstein, 1969.

Monarchy as a Possibility Nowadays K. Loewenstein’s essay has provided the reader with an overview of all the various forms of monarchy and the possibilities that, in his opinion, remain for a monarchical regime in the present age. Monarchy, as we have seen, is not taken in the literal sense of the term (government of one man, power concentrated in one man) but, correctly, in its traditional and most current sense, i.e., with reference to a King.

Loewenstein’s conclusions are rather pessimistic. In order to exist in our day, monarchy should resign itself to being a shadow of what it had been. It could be conceived only within a democratic framework and, properly speaking, in the form of a parliamentary constitutional monarchy. Apart from England, which would be a special case, the model offered by the monarchies of the small states of northern and western Europe — Sweden, Norway, Denmark, Belgium, Holland, Luxembourg — is what should possibly be kept in mind.

In the analysis of the range of the various arguments adopted in favor of monarchy, Loewenstein tried to be objective, but was unable always to be so. The precise aversion to every principle of true authority is quite visible in him, while an insufficient emphasis is given to the factors of an ethical and immaterial character. Now we believe that if you were forced

to conceive of a monarchy only in an empty and democratized form, besides only being possible because it concerns marginal small states, not yet involved in the dynamism of the great forces of the era, we undoubtedly might as well end the discussion in the negative.

It must be recognized, however, that pessimistic conclusions regarding monarchy appear largely justified only if you hypostatize the situation of the current world and believe that it is irreversible and destined to continue itself indefinitely. This situation is defined by a general materialism, the prevalence of base interests, the egalitarian error, the government of the masses, technocracy, and the so-called “consumer society.” Except that we are beginning to multiply the signs of a profound crisis of this world of affluence and counterfeit order. Various forms of revolt are already noticeable, for which it is not impossible that it could reach a state of tension and a breaking point, and that, especially in the face of possible liminal situations, tomorrow different forms of sensitivity may be reawakened, reactions occurring similar to those an organism is capable of when it is mortally threatened in its deepest being.

The supplanting, or to a lesser extent, of this new climate is the decisive element also for the problem of monarchy. In our opinion, it should be placed in the following terms: What meaning could monarchy have in the case that such a change in climate should take place, and in what form could it be a center for the reconstitution of a “normal” order — normal in a higher sense? Certainly, the presence of a true monarchy in a nation would have a rectifying power, but this is a vicious circle: without the premise that we mentioned, any restoration would have a contingent, not organic and, in a sense, unnatural character.

The disorder present in the political field, everything that it shows of instability, dangerously open to subversion — to Marxism and communism — substantially derives from the deficiency of a superior principle of authority and from an almost hysterical impatience for such a principle, through which certain political experiences of recent times serve at

most as a convenient alibi. Speaking of a superior principle of authority, we refer to an authority that has an actual legitimacy and, in a certain way, a “transcendent” character, because without this, authority would lack any basis, it would be contingent and revocable. A truly stable center would be missing.

It is important to clearly fix this essential point, in order to differentiate the type of monarchy, which this essay deals with, from monarchy in the broad sense of power or government of one man. In fact, spurious counterfeit forms of authority are conceivable, and are even realized. Communist regimes are also based on a *de facto* authoritarianism that can disguise the crudest and even tyrannical forms which are the justifications that they mendaciously give. One can put the dictatorial phenomenon along the same lines if it is conceived otherwise than in relation to emergency situations as originally occurred in ancient Rome.

On the other hand, the antithesis, so often advanced between dictatorship and democracy, is relative, except that you examine the existential foundation of these two political phenomena, that is, a “state of the masses”. If the dictatorship has not purely functional and technical characteristics (an example is offered currently by the Salazar regime in Portugal), if it is based on pathos as in some recent plebiscitary and populist forms, the same element galvanizing it is activated by every democratic demagoguery. The dictator makes a bad surrogate to the monarch with the appeal to forces that confusingly seek a foothold, a center, whatever it is, just to come to the head of chaos, disorder, situations that have become unbearable. This also explains, however, the phenomenon of possible, abrupt changes in polarity as a result of some trauma that has suspended the cohesive and driving force of the system, as in a magnetic field when the power goes out. The most perspicuous case is perhaps provided, in this respect, by the astonishing change in the collective political climate occurring in present-day Germany, after the almost frantic mass enthusiasm that had characterized the previous dictatorial period. It is significant

that, on the contrary, a similar phenomenon of inversion was not produced in Germany after the First World War, because its antecedent was not a dictatorship but a traditional monarchy.

Through the “transcendence” of the principle of authority characteristic of regality, the monarchical regime constitutes the only real antithesis both to dictatorship as well as absolute democracy. We must indicate the basis of its superior right for that reason. The various forms that it may take and the ideas or symbols that can legitimize this transcendence according to the times, do not touch the essential: the essential thing is the principle. Loewenstein is right when he says that in a world desacralized by the natural sciences, in which religion itself is undermined, there can no longer be a question of the mystique of the monarchy that in other times was supported on specific theological conceptions and a liturgy. But if you take a look at the world of the holders of the crown at all times and in all places, the recognition of the need for a stable center can be seen as a common and constant theme, a pole, something that to be truly stable must have, in a certain way, its own principle in itself or from above, which must not have a derived character. In this respect one can take a look, for example, at F. Wolff-Windegg’s excellent work, *Die Gekrönten*. Someone rightly wrote: “A purely political royalty — it can certainly be said — has never existed.” Not so long ago, the sovereignty of divine right “by the grace of God,” did not imply, in its subjects, specific theological considerations; its value, so to speak, in existential terms, corresponded precisely to the need for a higher point of reference that absolutely does not happen when the king is such only through the “will of the nation” or “the people.” On the other hand, only under that assumption could those dispositions, those forms of behavior and customs of a higher ethical value develop, in the subjects, in the sign of loyalty, which we will discuss shortly.

So we cannot share Loewenstein’s opinion that the ideal argument in favor of monarchy is now invalidated. What he says is true, of course,

namely that the decline of monarchy is due not so much to democracy as to the coming of cars and aircraft, the automobile, television — you can say, in general, the technological industrial civilization. But here we have to wonder if, in fact, we are entitled to hypostatize this civilization, we must ask ourselves to what extent man wants to accord to everything a value different from that of a set of simple, mundane means, which in “consumer society” leaves an absolute inner emptiness. Let us repeat: it is primarily a question of the “dignity” of monarchy, an esteem and a right that always and everywhere drew from a supra-individual and spiritual sphere: sacred investiture, divine right, mystical or legendary filiations and genealogies, and so on, were only imagined forms in order to express an always recognized substantial fact, namely that a political order, a truly organic and living collective unity is only made possible where there is a stable center and an elevated principle in respect to any particular interest and the purely “physical” aspect of society, a principle independently having a corresponding intangible and legitimate authority. Therefore, in principle what Hans Blüher wrote is absolutely correct: “A king who lets his sovereign function be confirmed by the people, admitting thereby that he is accountable to the people — instead of being responsible for the people before God — such a king renounced his kingship. No infamy committed by a king — and God knows if they were not committed — destroys the mystical objective sanction of the sovereign. But a democratic election destroys it immediately.”

The bound of loyalty If in the past, the bond of fidelity that united the subject and follower with the sovereign could be treated as a sacrament — *sacramentum fidelitatis* — something that was preserved even later as the quite perceptible foundation of a special ethics, an ethic, in fact, of loyalty and honor, which could acquire a particular force in the assumption, just now indicated, of the presence of a personalized symbol. In normal times, the fact that the sovereign as an individual might

not always be at the height of the principle, did not matter; his function remained unprescriptive and intangible because obedience was not to the man but to the king and his person had value essentially as a support so that the capacity for super-individual dedication, that pride in serving freely and possibly even the readiness to sacrifice (as in the dramatic moments when a whole people rallied around their sovereign) could be awakened or propitiated, that they might constitute a way of elevation and dignification for the individual and, at the same time, the most powerful force to hold together the union of a political body and to limit in it what it has that is anodyne and disheartened, and in recent times has taken a dangerous extent.

That everything that cannot be achieved to the same extent in another form of political regiment, is quite obvious. A president of the republic can be flattered, but no one will ever recognize in him anything but a functionary, a "bourgeois" like any other, which only extrinsically, not on the basis of an inherent legitimacy, is vested with a temporary and conditioned authority. Whoever maintains a certain subtle sensibility perceives that "being in the service of their king", the "fight for their king" (even the fight "for their own country," despite the romantic coloring, has in comparison something less noble, more naturalistic and collectivistic), the "representing the king", all have a specific quality, all of which indicates instead a parodic, not to say grotesque, character when it pertains "to one's own president". Especially in the case of the army, high bureaucracy, and diplomacy (regardless of the nobility), this appears very obvious. The same oath, when it is not paid to a sovereign but to the republic or one or another abstraction, has something discordant and empty about it. With a democratic republic, something immaterial, but still essential and irreplaceable, is inevitably lost. The anodyne and the profane prevail. A monarchist nation that becomes a republic is, in a certain way, a "degraded" nation

If we observed that the kind of fluidity that forms around the sym-

bol of the Crown is quite different from what may be related to the exalted "states of the multitude", which can arouse or favor the demagoguery of a popular leader, the difference also exists with regard to any simple nationalistic mysticism. Of course, the sovereign also incarnates the nation, symbolizes its unity on a higher plane, establishing almost, with it, a "unity of destiny." But here we find the opposite of every Jacobin patriotism; there are none of those confused collectivizing myths that speak to the pure demos and that almost divinize it. It can be said that monarchy moderates, limits, and purifies simple nationalism; which, as it prevents any dictatorship replacing it with advantage, so it also prevents any nationalistic excess; it defends a structured, hierarchical, and balanced order. It is known that the most calamitous upheavals of recent times can be attributed mainly to unrestrained nationalism.

After what we have said, it is clear that we do not share at all the idea that monarchy at this point should be democratized, that the monarch should assume almost bourgeois features — "must come down from the august heights of the past and present himself and act in a democratic way," as Loewenstein claimed. That would simply destroy his dignity and his *raison d'être*, as we indicated. The king of the north European countries who carries a valise, who goes shopping in the stores, who consents to letting radio or television display his well-behaved family life to the people including his tantrum-throwing children, or else the Royal House that is provided for the curiosity and gossip of the news magazines, and whatever else one thinks, might make people close to the king, including, in the end, a good-natured paternal appearance (if the father is conceived in a bland bourgeois form), all this cannot avoid damaging the very essence of the monarchy. The "Majesty" then really becomes an empty epithet of the ceremony. It has rightly been said that "the powerful who, through a badly understood sense of popularity, consents to get closer, ends up in a bad way."

It is clear that take to take all that as firm, means going against the

current. But, again, we pose an alternative: it is a question of accepting, or not, a state of fact as irreversible, thinking that only the useless vestiges of monarchy can exist. One of the elements to consider in this regard is the intolerance in our world, for distance. The success of dictatorships and other spurious political forms is due, in part, precisely to the fact that the leader is seen as "one of us", the "Great Comrade," and only in these terms is he accepted as a guide and obeyed. In these circumstances the concern for 'popularity' and for "democratic" means is quite understandable. But that, basically, is anything but natural; we do not see why he should be subordinated when the leader, in the end, is just "one of us" when an essential distance is felt, as in the case of the true sovereign. So a "pathos of distance" — to use one of Nietzsche's expressions — should be substituted for that of affinity, in relationships that exclude any haughty arrogance on the one hand, and every servility on the other. This is a basic point, in its existential character, for a restoration of the monarchy. Without exhuming anachronistic forms, instead of propaganda that "humanizes" the sovereign in order to captivate the masses, almost on the same line as the U.S. presidential election propaganda, one should see to what extent traits of a figure characterized by some innate superiority and dignity can have a profound activity in a suitable context. A kind of asceticism and liturgy of power could play a part here. While just these traits will enhance the prestige of the one who embodies a symbol, they should be able to exert a force of attraction on common man, even pride, in the subject. Moreover, even in fairly recent times there has been the example of Emperor Franz Joseph who, while interposing the strict ancient ceremonial between himself and his subjects, while not imitating in the least the "democratic" kings of the small Nordic States, enjoyed a particular, not common popularity.

To sum up, the main prerequisite for a revival of monarchy, pursuant to the dignity and function which we mentioned, there remains, in our opinion, the awakening of a new sensibility for an order that is detached

from the most material, and also the simply “social”, plane, and tends to everything that is honor, loyalty, and responsibility, because similar values in the monarchy have their natural center of gravity; while, in turn, the monarchy will end up degraded, reduced to a simple formal and decorative survival when these values are not alive and active — first in an elite, then in a real ruling class. They are not the same chords that the defender of the monarchical idea and of any other system must make resonate in the individual and in the community. So it is absurd to entrust the destinies of the monarchical idea to propaganda and a praxis that approximately copies the methods of the opposed party in a democratic spirit. Even today being able to ascertain the appearance of tendencies toward an authoritarian center, towards a “monarchy” in the literal sense (= monocracy) is not enough, after what we said about the profound differences which the various objectifications of the principle of unity and authority may present. The meaning of what is not allowed to be sold, bought, or usurped in the dignity and participation in political life is a decisive factor and escapes like water through their fingers for those who think only in terms of matter, of personal advantage, hedonism, functionality, and rationality. If one must no longer speak of that meaning because of the famous Marxist “meaning of history”, which is claimed to be irrevocable, we might as well set aside definitively the cause of monarchy. This would, moreover, be tantamount to profess the most bleak pessimism in regard to what still can appeal to man of recent times.

Constitutional Monarchy After having considered the spiritual aspect of the problem of monarchy, it is necessary to indicate the aspects that are related on the positive, institutional, and constitutional plane. On such a plane, it will be necessary to make clear the specific function to attribute to monarchy and what differentiates a monarchical system from other systems. It is amazing that a comparable problem is almost not faced by the propaganda of the monarchists. In elections there were,

even in Italy, discourses by the monarchists who blamed, more or less on the same lines of other sectors of the opposition, the dysfunctions of the republican democratic and partocratic State and the danger of communism, avoiding however indicating, in no uncertain terms and without fear, in which terms the presence of the monarchy would positively eliminate both, or, better put, in virtue of which particular prerogatives the monarchy would be for so much.

If one is really a monarchist, one cannot concede that the monarchy becomes reduced to a simple decorative and representative institution, a kind of nice furniture or, according to the image mentioned by Loewenstein, something like the golden figure that was put on the bow of a galleon; the State, in concrete terms, would remain that of the republican parliamentary democracies, concerning the king only to countersign, as would a president of the republic, whatever the government and parliament decide. The restoration should instead involve a kind of monarchical revolution (or counter-revolution).

The well-known maxim “the king reigns but does not govern”, should be opposed to the other: “the king reigns and rules” — rules, of course, not in terms of the absolute monarchies of the past, but, in the normal way, in the framework of established law and a constitution. In this regard, the best example was given to us by the previous central European monarchies, for which Loewenstein has not hidden his strong antipathy. Not only a regulatory, moderating, and arbitral power with respect to various political forces should be reserved to the sovereign but also that of a last resort. The constitution and the law should not be made into fetishes. Constitution and law do not fall ready-made from heaven, they are historical formations and their intangibility is conditioned by the normal course of things. When this course fails, when faced with emergency situations, a higher power must assert itself positively, which has remained dormant and inactive under normal conditions; it does not for this reason cease to constitute the center of the system. The king is the

legitimate subject of that power. He can and must exercise it whenever it is necessary, saying, "Thus far and no farther," and preventing every subversive revolutionary movement (preventing it by means of a "revolution from above"), as well as any dictatorial upheaval whose only justification is the lack of a true center of authority.

It is not said that such power must be exercised directly by the sovereign; he may do it through a capable and decisive chancellor or prime minister who, strong in the support of the Crown and essentially responsible as its face, can deal with the situation. The case of Bismarck in the "institutional conflict" mentioned by Loewenstein corresponds to this possibility. Certain of the confidence of the sovereign, Bismarck could also take no account of parliament's opposition and by following his path, he made the greatness of Germany, receiving later the approval of his work in a new constitution.

One might venture to say that, in part, there was a similar situation at first sight when the King of Italy supported Mussolini, granting him powers that however, Victor Emmanuel himself, if he had not felt so constitutionally bound, could have exercised, so as to impose an order on an Italy shocked by subversion and the social crisis through new structures, without the need of fascism, and preventing those developments — defined by some in terms of a "diarchy" — which finally undermined to some extent his position through the presence, almost, of a state within the state. At decisive moments a sovereign should never forget the saying of an ancient wisdom: *Rex est qui nihil metuit* (The king is the one who fears nothing). Through a badly understood humanitarianism, in extreme cases, even the danger of battles in which blood might flow, he cannot be afraid because this is not about persons, but of making authority, order and justice rule above all things, against possible turmoil by a part of it. The formula, as we have already stated: "Thus far and no farther." In unexceptional situations Benjamin Constant's conception of the Crown as the "fourth power", as an arbitral and balancing function,

can be accepted. Even the rights recognized by Bagehot for the Crown: the right to be consulted, the right to encourage, the right to warn, are unexceptionable.

Therefore, a shift of the center of gravity should be effectuated with a monarchical restoration. A national delegation may also be chosen by the "people", according to some modality (which we will return to), but it should be responsible, in *primis et ante omnia*, over against the king, according to relations of personalized responsibility which would close the door on many forms of democratic corruption. The king should be, therefore, the supreme point of reference, and the previously mentioned values of loyalty and honor should be felt, rather than the representatives being the instruments of the parties and the mysterious, ephemeral entity of the "people" whom they exploited, and who alone has the power to confirm or repeal according to the system of absolute democracy, i.e., of officially recognized universal suffrage.

On the other hand, for a true renewal of monarchy the ideal of an organic State needs to be present, through which the problem of the compatibility in general between monarchy with the system of absolute parliamentary democracy cannot be evaded. The superimposition of one over the other can only lead to something of a hybrid. It is to be considered that if the hoped for change in mentality will be achieved, the absurdity of the system of representation based on indiscriminate universal suffrage will gradually be recognized, i.e., on the law of pure number, having as the obvious premise not the conception of the citizen as a "person" but his degrading reduction to an interchangeably undifferentiated atom.

In this regard, it must be remembered that modern democracy in its absolute form is one thing, another is a system of representation, the latter not necessarily coinciding with the former. It is known that a system of representation also existed in traditional monarchical States, but generally as organic representations, i.e., of bodies and orders, not of ideological parties. To want to consider the parties, the best system would

be bipartisan, accepting an opposition that acts constructively and dynamically within the system, not outside of it or against it. (For example, that a revolutionary or communist party, whenever it observes certain purely formal statutory norms, can be considered "legal" and must be allowed in a national assembly even though its stated or implied program is the overthrow of the existing order, is a true absurdity). Apart from the bipartisan solution, already adopted with advantage in England's monarchy, the representative system that through its most organic character should be harmonized with the monarchy would be traditional corporative, in the broadest sense, without reference to the attempt, which was made by fascism with the creation of a corporate rather than partocratic Chamber. Perhaps the current Portuguese system — the Spanish to a lesser extent — will approach the desired order. Loewenstein highlighted the alternative that would occur in the case of a restoration, because either the king is supported on the upper classes who are more inclined to sustain the monarchy, and then he would play into the hands of those who are quick to accuse him of conservative reactionism, or else he goes toward the working classes and, in general, starts acting as the "king of the people," and then he would dangerously alienate the support of the other part of the nation.

Conclusion Now, a similar turning point obviously presupposes the retention, the perpetuation, of the state of class struggle, in terms of Marxist ideology. But we believe that one of the prerequisites for a new, organic, and monarchical order must be seen exactly in overcoming this antagonistic division of national forces. Corporate reform should aim precisely at that, which the mentioned alternative is carried out, opposite which the restored monarchy would be found, or would fail to a large degree. Even if within corporations, or whatever you want to designate as the primary representative authority, opposing tendencies were asserted, one is to think that the preeminence given to the principle of jurisdiction

would reduce the ideological factor considerably in such differences.

In a sector that has become increasingly important to the system of corporate representatives on the basis of responsibilities could exhibit an actual character of a particular path of development exhibited by almost teratology presented by the technocratic element and, in general, by the economy. We know of the criticism against the technological civilization of consumption in the most advanced industrial society; the destructive aspects that are typical have been shown, the need to put a brake on economic processes that have become almost independent, like the image of the "unleashed giant" used by W. Sombart. Now it is not possible to envisage a brake on the system, a restraint, without the intervention of a higher political power. The task of adequately restraining and ordering on the strength of a more complete hierarchy of interests and values, the forces in motion in society, obviating also a paradoxical situation that has occurred in recent times, that of an increasingly strong state with an increasingly weak head, would evidently find the most favorable environment for its implementation in a true monarchical state.

Institutionally, the authority could be provided either by a single assembly, but, alongside representatives of economic and productive forces also comprising representatives of the spiritual and cultural life (as there were, in fact, in the 'General States' or Diets, similar assemblies of ancient traditional monarchical regimes), or by the bicameral system, an Upper House and a Lower House, the latter being truly corporative, the former making itself felt instead in the higher-level instances. We know that the latest "conquest" of absolute democracy was to reduce the upper House, or Senate, to a useless duplicate of the other House because even for it the principle of the election of the masses and of interim elections (at least for most of its elements) was asserted. As in the Italy of yesterday, the definition of the Upper House should be, instead, one of the essential tasks of the monarchy, even if only conveniently assisted, continuing the formal nature of the appointment from above.

In this way the Upper House would remain the political body closest to the Crown and it would be natural that loyalty, fidelity, and active impersonality were present in it to the highest degree. It should have power, authority, prestige, and a meaning different from that in the Lower House. As custodian of values and higher interests, it would constitute the real nucleus of the state, its "head". It would, therefore, have to emphasize its active functional character in the place of the codetermination of the political line, a character that will differentiate it greatly from what had been, in post-Risorgimento monarchical Italy, the Senate: an assembly of worthy people, of "high intelligent men", of notable personages according to worth, yet as essentially decorative role, without any real, vigorous organic function.

Without dwelling on the details, it is clear that a system of this kind would overcome the aberrations of absolute democracy and the republican partocracy and it would have its natural integration in the monarchy. Here monarchy would not be something heterogeneous, almost the remains of another world, superimposed on the current parliamentary system. Therefore, *de rigueur*, the problem of monarchy returns as part of a larger problem, that of the "revolutionary" reshaping of the entire modern state.

But for the functions of the monarchy that we have tried to sketch out, in order to be able not only "to reign" but also to have an active part — more or less critical depending on the circumstances — in the "government", it is clear that it would require a special qualification of the sovereign not only in terms of character, pursuant to the strict traditional education of princes, but also in terms of expertise, knowledge, and experience. This is made necessary by the character both of the times as well as the modern state. The ancient regal Far Eastern conception of *wei-wu-wei*, of "action without action", is suggestive, alluding not to a direct material action but to an action "through presence", as the center and quintessential power. This aspect, while maintaining its intrinsic va-

lidity in terms just mentioned, when, as in current times and probably still more in those that were predicted, everything is in motion and forces tend to move out of their normal orbit, needs to be integrated, while taking care that it is not crippled in this way.

As we said, in other times in a monarchy the symbol also had preeminence over the person; given the overall climate and given the strength of a long tradition and legitimacy, it was able not to be jeopardized by the merely human aspects of the person who in either case embodied it. If today or tomorrow we were to come to a restoration of the monarchy, this would no longer be possible: the delegate should be at most at the stature of the principle, not through the ostentation of the person, but through the opposite. He should also have the qualities of a true leader, a man capable of holding the scepter more than just symbolically and ritually. Such a qualification to this day cannot be only like that of the ages of the warrior dynasties. The qualities of character, courage, and vitality, while remaining the essential basis, should be united with those of an enlightened mind with the essential political knowledge adequate to the complex structure of a modern state and the forces at work in contemporary society.

The decline of traditional regimes had two causes which acted firmly even before the materialistic climate of modern civilization and industrial society was added. On the one hand, at the top there was in fact a growing inability to fully embody the principle especially when the general structures were beginning to creak; on the other hand, at the bottom, there was the failure, in the people who had become more or less the "masses", of a specific sensibility, of certain capacity of recognition. Therefore, the possibility of a monarchical restoration is subjected to a double claim, and appears to be conditioned by the removal of both negative factors. On the one hand, rulers would be valued, who owe their prestige not just to their super-elevated position or to the symbol that overshadows them, but who are also able to cope with any situation as exponents of an idea

and a higher power. On the other hand, a change in the general mental and moral level of the masses would be required, which need we have not tired of emphasizing.

Nowadays, one or the other conditions appear hypothetical. But if we do not have to come to essentially negative conclusions, to be drawn from studies on monarchy in the modern state, such as that undertaken by Loewenstein; if it must not be considered merely as an institution, a pale shadow of what monarchy was, it is now almost entirely devoid of its meaning and its essential *raison d'être*, there is no other way of laying out the problem. It is therefore worthwhile to repeat that the fate of monarchy appears to be, in a certain way, in agreement with that of the entire modern civilization and more properly depends on what may be the solution to a crisis which, as appears from many clues, is assailing the very foundations of that civilization.

Posted on 2013-06-12 by Aeneas

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h.ontologia on 2013-06-15 at 11:33 said:

We recommend Dr. Erik Maria Ritter von Kuehnelt-Leddihn. His book, "Leftism, From de Sade and Marx to Hitler and Marcuse", among other material, is available online free of charge.

Ash on 2013-06-16 at 21:25 said:

Unfortunately, Evola seems to be sinking into an emotional argument in this part of the essay, particularly with the vague accusation that the Republic has "something less noble" about it. He may have trouble convincing the Republican-era Romans, the Swiss, the Irish, or many other peoples of that fact. A Jacobin could just as easily make the argument "is it not far more noble to fight for the ideal and idea of the Republic than the petty wars of a man with a crown?" And those on Gornahoor who place the spiritual as coming before the temporal would have trouble against that argument, even if we're talking about a good King vs. an ideal Republic. He also forgets that the earliest kings were usually not hereditary. Sparta and Rome provide key European examples of this.

While I am a monarchist with regards to the Canadian/UK/Commonwealth and European monarchies, and with regards to the "ideal" forms of governance, I must confess I have always

found Maurrassian arguments more useful in this sphere: the role of the institution in the State. With regards to its ability to stand above petty day-to-day politics, I must say that our tradition of constitutional monarchy has at least allowed this aspect of the monarchy to become far more entrenched, one might say to an extreme. Certainly, monarchs like Tsar Alexander III, ruling with the “right and power of Autocracy”, are far more beholden to the daily trials, conspiracies, and deals of ruling a State. Evola does a good job of showing how monarchy can be a reflection of the universal order, but he fails to show why other forms of governance cannot be held valid in this regard as well. The Jacobin example can be cited here – should not the foundation of the State be an Idea rather than a position held by a person? (Devils’ advocate, of course).

Avery on 2013-06-17 at 04:48 said:

...whatever else one thinks, might make people close to the king, including, in the end, a good-natured paternal appearance (if the father is conceived in a bland bourgeois form), all this cannot avoid damaging the very essence of the monarchy... It has rightly been said that “the powerful who, through a badly understood sense of popularity, consents to get closer, ends up in a bad way.”

It is interesting to note that the Emperor of Japan has only addressed the people on three occasions. The first was when Emperor Meiji presented the Imperial Rescript on Education, a Confucian document that all schoolchildren of that era had to memorize as holy writ. The second was to announce Japan’s surrender; here the Imperial voice made it possible to believe the unbelievable. The third and most recent was when the present Emperor appeared on television to console the people, as a “fatherly” figure, after the 2011.3.11 earthquake. This was from beginning to end a well-intentioned idea for an extraordinarily horrific day, but at the same time I hope it is not repeated, for the reasons Evola describes above. It was of course based in the thinking of 20th century Europe, which long ago sunk to such frivolities as the “Royal Christmas Message” in Britain.

The same oath, when it is not paid to a sovereign but to the republic or one or another abstraction, has something discordant and empty about it. With a democratic republic, something immaterial, but still essential and irreplaceable, is inevitably lost.

Not that hard to put your finger on it; Evola did it himself in other works. When the people are asked to fight for representatives that they elected or for symbols of democracy, that is to say for a mirror of themselves, there is no honor involved at all. (Note that honor encourages heroic, not “humane”, behavior. A “humane” military is one in which the will to fight will be eclipsed.)

This is such simple psychology that Americans from the beginning have fought to defend the Constitution – that is, a document written by their forefathers which guarantees their freedom – rather than their President, the Union, or anything like that. This provided an artificial “distance” for the first two centuries of the Republic, and for the most part kept the military above politics.

In reality, though, the laws that grow out of the Constitution can be modified by the people, so the American military has in the past few decades noticeably degraded into a force fighting for “the will of the people”, which now makes it difficult to acknowledge any higher principles. One particularly disturbing example of this could be seen in this month’s blogs¹. The appearance of such internal confusion should make it possible for smarter people to calculate the decade in the near future when the American military will simply disintegrate.

As for the complaint about the large number of democracies, elected monarchies, or at least aristocracies in the Classical period: to associate these with the Faustian political systems is a misunderstanding. The kings of the Classical world were simply the head priests, and where there were no kings a direct appeal to the gods would do. Perhaps Evola will address this later on.

Jason-Adam on 2013-06-17 at 13:17 said:

@ Avery, I will need to depend on your judgement as I have never been to Japan, but can we say that the Japanese tradition is still living ? From what I know, it seems as post-WW2 Japan has been Americanised and filled with liberalism, pacifism, socialism and degeneracy not to mention “guilt” for the “crimes” of the past, maybe not as bad as in Germany but similar ?

Two things struck me about the Evola article, I read the full piece in Italian rather than wait for Cologero to finish the translation and twice he mentioned Portugal as offering an example of a normal socio-economic system. Traditional Catholic believe the same and point to Portugal as a superior case to XXth century Italian and German attempts to overcome democracy. A good book to read is this one : [http://www.strobertbellarmine.net/books/Derrick](http://www.strobertbellarmine.net/books/Derrick%20Portugal.pdf)

Another book that Evola’s piece reminded me of the THE MENACE OF THE HERD by Erik von Kuehnelt-Leddihn which by the way has some good points about the USA as well.

Avery M on 2013-06-17 at 21:32 said:

The best part of this article so far was in Part 1: A political order, a truly organic and living collective unity is only made possible where there is a stable center and an elevated principle in respect to any particular interest and the purely “physical” aspect of society, a principle independently having a corresponding intangible and legitimate authority. Even though the article is about monarchy, this actually makes a fine case for a democratic state like Portugal’s Estado Novo as long as it preserves a unwavering Catholic character.

¹<http://townhall.com/columnists/toddstarnes/2013/06/07/conservative-christian-soldier-told-not-to-read-levin-or-hannity-in-uniform-n1615420/page/full>

You are correct about liberalism and degeneracy in Japan, to an extent that many outsiders do not realize, but actually the conservative side of the intellectual world has put leftist historical views in eclipse, especially compared to Germany. A drive to learn from Japan's excesses but honor the sacrifices of the past is rather mainstream these days. And the Imperial House, as I indicated above, has proven much less willing than its European counterparts to beg the media for attention.

(On a side note, one thing I am concerned about is that Japan's netuyo online reactionaries, while their unconscious intuition may be similar to those on this blog, have no social mores, sense of duty beyond knee-jerk nationalism, or capacity for self-improvement. That's not really related to this article, though.)

Ash on 2013-06-17 at 21:47 said:

Agreed. Evola unfortunately does not mention here the ways in which a transcendent foundation could manifest outside of monarchy. A question about your comment on the American military though – when was it *not* an expression of the will of the people? Even at its very foundation it was fighting for states or for the Republic, which originated from a declaration claiming to speak for “We the people.”

Jason-Adam on 2013-06-18 at 14:28 said:

It is precisely because I could not find any transcendent ideal in the American military that I chose to abandon my original plans to attend West Point. I could not in good conscience serve something that I knew to be false and beneath me. While Evola probably would have advised me to join the army anyhow and use it as a personal means of development, I just felt like it would be dishonourable for me to participate in what I knew to be an evil and anti-traditional institution. Was I wrong ?

Ash on 2013-06-18 at 23:44 said:

Well, I certainly couldn't call the American military a “traditional” institution in the sense the word is used here. Politically speaking, I also think that it is currently doing great harm in the world, but whether or not serving would be good for ones' own development and whether that can be done in accord with the regime and program one is serving is something one would have to look so a spiritual advisor for. Speaking personally, I would not serve in the American military because of the regime it serves, but I would not call the institution in and of itself evil or dishonourable, and even less so those who serve in it to the greatest degree of honour that they can. I can certainly see Evola giving that strain of advice, but I would say that this would be an example of his tendency to lose himself in the symbol rather than what it represents (thus making a similar error to his monarchy argument). A man could probably develop virtue and soul serving a lesser regime, but if he has a choice in doing so then can that be reconciled?

Constantine Aetos on 2013-06-18 at 00:36 said:

This maybe a bit out of topic, but I wonder why Traditionalists have not published a political manuscript that is similar in structure to the Communist manifesto? Or is that too much to ask.

Avery on 2013-06-18 at 00:57 said:

You may take your pick of political manifestos:

<https://www.facebook.com/pages/Generation-identity-The-book/497600770293421>

<http://www.arktos.com/alain-de-benoist-and-charles-champetier-manifesto-for-a-european-renaissance.html>

<https://www.facebook.com/Traditionalism>

But if we mean philosophical perennialism, consider the idea of writing a manifesto to tell people to read Meister Eckhart or "The Alchemical Wedding" or something like that... it's kind of silly.

Cologero on 2013-06-18 at 06:53 said:

The short answer, Constantine, is that they are waiting for George to do it. Other than that, I find it quite remarkable that you were able to pack so many misconceptions into just two sentences. Kudos for that.

Jason-Adam on 2013-06-18 at 14:23 said:

Manifesto ? Try Men Among the Ruins for Evola's take. For those more in line with Europe's Mediaeval past try the writings of Plinio Correa de Oliveira.

Pickman on 2013-06-18 at 20:04 said:

The last successful attempt at that, Constantine, was the Bible (NT not just the 10 commandments). Practice the sacraments and doctrines of the Church to hammer in the necessary dogma. Exoteric manifestos have not fared well in the modern era.

Constantine Aetos on 2013-06-20 at 12:52 said:

Looks like I will be busy reading this summer.

Ash on 2013-06-20 at 22:38 said:

The mentioning of the Portuguese Estado Novo is a welcome concrete example of what Evola is imagining. The reign of Frederick the Great of Prussia and his successors would similarly seem to be along the lines he is considering. Unfortunately one of the things that undermined many of these regimes was that the "revolution from above" undermined its own authority by

depriving its citizens of the rights the regime itself claimed to uphold. It is always far better to win an enemy over than to fight him; similarly, the monarchic (or "conservative") state is more stable insofar as it defuses radicalism by co-opting it. This is something which Bismarck in particular understood with regards to his socialist foes, although much to his chagrin.

Their other fatal weakness, particularly in the case of Portugal, was that when it came to the actual act of governing, they were sometimes the victims of severe incompetence. Double-digit inflation was a recurring problem in Portugal, and bad planning during Spain's industrialization threatened the social order of the quickly expanding Spanish cities. Corruption was of course always a problem and this is a problem which any true proponent of an ordered State must face. It's not good enough to say "well look at the others"...we must strive to a higher standard.

As an aside, I'm currently reading Massie's "Nicholas and Alexandra", his work on the last Russian Tsar. It provides a good picture of the failures of this Tsar to maintain the more direct "autocracy" of the Russian monarchy and a firm hand on his advisors as revolutionary subversion spread. His father, Alexander III, would also likely be of interest to many on Gornahoor.

Nobility and Chivalry

9.1 Random thoughts on Chivalry

Some notes from reading the highly recommended history of medieval knighthood *Chivalry*¹ by Maurice Keen. Since Medieval Europe was the last great Traditional Indo-European civilisation, it is well worth the study. As it is recent in time to us, we can trace its origins and development directly from the sources, without the need to rely on ancient myths. In particular, the system of chivalry developed out of earlier Roman and Germanic traditions. The intellectual foundations of chivalry can be traced directly to their understanding, and often creative re-interpretations, of Roman, Greek, and Trojan warriors, such as **Hector**, **Alexander**, **Scipio**, **Julius Caesar**, and **Vegetius**.

On the self-development of the Kshatriya caste.

Classical ethics, classical jurisprudence and classical philosophy, though by no means irreconcilable with Christian thought and ex-

¹<http://yalepress.yale.edu/book.asp?isbn=0300107676>

exercising a powerful influence upon it, belonged to a pre-Christian tradition. Chivalry was thus reminded, forcefully, of the separation of the origins of its institutions from those of the priesthood, and of the original independence of its function — within the broad framework of divine providence — from the priestly one.

Chivalry

A knight was expected to be courteous, loyal, nobly spoken, well clad, generous, sincere, humble, truthful, and valiant. He protected the weak, defended the faith, had a taste for adventure, and composed poems for his lady love. We can see the beginning of sports leagues in the Medieval tournaments, as they pitted one township or region against another and flew their own colours. The knights would contend for fame and fortune, although defeat could bring death, serious injury, or financial ruin. The aristocracy would “scout” for the best knights to recruit for their own militias. If a knight lost a joust in a contest, he could expect to lose his horse to his opponent. He might also be captured by the victor and held for ransom. And we think football players are tough guys. The women admired their knights and inspired them to greater deeds. Some even pledged to marry the victors. Yes, it is true, in those days that was considered a reward, especially since it often meant “marrying up” in class.

The Three Matters There were three things that “mattered” to the knight of the Middle Ages:

- **The matter of Britain.** The “matter of Britain” relates to **King Arthur** and the Knights of the Round Table.
- **The matter of France.** The “matter of France” is about **Emperor Charlemagne** and his paladins.

- **The matter of Rome.** The “matter of Rome” concerns the ancient Roman empire while also encompassing ancient Troy and Greece.

These matters were the subject matter for the epic poems of the era. Compare that to what “matters” to today’s “man”, even in the so-called “manosphere”.

Boucicaud Boucicaud² was a knight inspired by the chaste love of his lady. He wrote poetry and exercised regularly to keep fit. He could do a somersault in full armour, vault fully armed onto his horse, and climb up the reverse side of ladder in armour, using only his hands. Boucicaud learned from **Vegetius**, **Scipio**, and **Demosthenes**. He permitted no loose women around the camp, deplored drunkenness, and was a stern disciplinarian. He learned eloquence to rouse his men to action and to explain himself to subject people.

Posted on 2010-03-05 by Cologero

9.2 Nine worthies: Champions of Chivalry

Old Law	Pagan Law	New Law
Joshua	Hector	King Arthur
David	Alexander	Charlemagne
Judas Maccabeus	Julius Caesar	Godfrey de Bouillon

The question has come up about why there is no visible warrior elite—in the Traditional sense—in our time. The simple answer is that

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jean_Le_Maingre

there is an insufficient mass of those who hold Traditional values intellectually, and the will and strength of character to communicate and live them out in the world. Since both Rene Guenon and Julius Evola considered Medieval Europe to be the last Traditional civilization in the West, it is instructive to study how the code of chivalry was creatively developed.

The warrior and priestly elites both looked back to the sources of their civilization. Although they proclaimed the same faith, and held the same broad outline of history, their choice of men to emulate were, of course, quite different. The primary heroes at that time came both from the ancient pagan world and from the stories of the Old Testament. The stories of these models of chivalry were scrupulously studied and then told and retold, usually in the form of the Medieval Romances. In the fourteenth century, Jean de Longuyon created a neat schematization in his *Voeux du Paon*. This set of three triads created the cult of the Nine Worthies.

Old Law The first triad comes from the Old Law and consists of Joshua, who led the conquest of the Holy Land, King David, the great leader of the Hebrews, and Judas Maccabeus, the warrior who led the fight against the Seleucids.

Pagan Law The next triad consists of Pagan warriors and includes Hector, the brave warrior of Troy, Alexander, the creator of the Hellenic Empire, and Julius Caesar, the Roman general and then emperor.

New Law The third triad refers to the Catholic civilization, heir of both the Hebrews and Pagans, and consists of King Arthur, the legendary British leader, Charlemagne, who founded the Holy Roman Empire, and Godfrey de Bouillon, the conqueror of the Kingdom of Jerusalem.

The models were chosen for their valor, prowess, and military success, and as “representative men”, each had a particular relevance. For example, Hector not only was courageous but had a noble and courtly nature. Alexander, besides his conquests, was known for his largesse.

The characters are also archetypal and the symmetry of the scheme reflects the Medieval view of history and destiny of European man. The Old Law prepared the way for the New. The Pagan law created the Pax Romana that allowed the spread of the New Law. And of course, medievals saw themselves as the true heirs of both the Hebrews and the Pagans, and their civilization as the fulfillment of God’s divine plan³.

Posted on 2010-03-25 by Cologero

9.3 Aristocratic Philosophy

Several weeks ago I had a conversation with a friend (?) of Gornahoor during which the topic of a “movement” came up, by which he meant a counter-revolutionary or rightist movement. I had read a post by an alleged leader of said movement that criticized egalitarianism. Following up on that thought, I suggested to my friend that the movement ought to sort itself out by rank. Specifically, if egalitarianism is false, then the different leaders are necessarily unequal. Therefore, it should be possible to determine which are from superior minds and which are inferior. To my surprise, he was appalled by that suggestion. He could only perceive

³There is much opposition to this schematization including, disappointingly, among those who self identify as “Traditionalists” (demonstrating, of course, there is no such thing). First of all, the moderns reject out-of-hand anything to do with the Middle Ages. The Judeo-Christians reject any influence of paganism. The anti-Semites reject any acknowledgment of the Old Law. And the neo-pagans reject the New Law of the Middle Ages. This all reflects the continuing dispossession of the European-descended peoples, whose heroes and history are denied and distorted. If there is a better way of elucidating the nature and destiny of European man, then it needs to be made public.

it as some sort of attack, basing his position on the idea that he should be in alliance with those who are “shooting” in the same direction he is.

But that is begging the question of what is the actual direction of the intellectual bullets. A movement needs to be a microcosm of what it hopes to achieve. Therefore, the movement ought to be clear about its spiritual ideals and its primary exponents, those who would lead, and who are to be the serfs. Otherwise, it is just a mulligan stew, a dish suitable only for intellectual hobos.

Instead of a movement led from above, there is a nebulous mass from below based on little more than popularity, facebook “likes”, and a continuous whirl of low quality discussions and arguments. This is the opposite of a hierarchic arrangement. In such an order, a neophyte is not at the same level as an adept. Furthermore, the neophyte is there to learn, not to be “converted”, and certainly not to argue. In order to identify potential members, initiatic organizations have classification schemes to identify various types of men. Certain types cannot qualify for the higher degrees, so it would be pointless to initiate them.

A straightforward classification system is based on worldviews⁴. For example, it is no accident that revolutions arising from the lower classes, as in the French and Russian revolutions⁵, have been explicitly atheist and materialist. Hence, leaders of the “movement” who are atheist and materialist are vulgar and would most likely belong to a lower caste in a Traditional society.

Philosophic Foundations A start in that direction is provided by the short book *Nobilitas*, by **Alexander Jacob**, of Indian descent despite his European sounding name. Its subtitle, which describes its aim, is “a study of European aristocratic philosophy from Ancient Greece to the Early Twentieth Century.” It consists of a series of vignettes highlighting the

⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3518>

⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4235>

political theories of 20 thinkers, all based on the ideal of the rule by the best. He writes in the Preface:

The superiority of aristocratic government is due not only to its cultural advantage, but also to its solid philosophical foundation. ... the term 'aristocracy' in my study is not used of a particular class of people so much as of a system of politics devoted to the cultivation of the rule of the best.

By this standard it is eminently fair to demand from the movement an explanation of its philosophical foundation and how the best would be trained and cultivated. Now philosophy, the love of wisdom, is concerned with ideas, hence most of the thinkers mentioned adhere to some form of philosophical idealism. From my point of view, I would have liked to see some medieval thinkers mentioned. Also, since biological racism is not a philosophy, I would replace their representatives in the book with **Julius Evola** who refuted the myth of blood in favour of the doctrine of spiritual races⁶. Finally, I would also add **Rene Guenon**, since his metaphysical teachings would connect Europe to the East.

Gentlemen and Religion Now such a short book cannot really describe the philosophical foundations, but only provide some of the more relevant conclusions that arise from them. Not all the thinkers are of the same depth and some are more political thinkers than philosophers in the true sense. However, that is not necessary since the aristocrats would themselves seldom be the philosophers, i.e., the spiritual leaders and educators. Instead, they would be trained in the art of ruling, so the goal of their education is to become gentlemen, not sages. **Edmund Burke** writes:

⁶<https://www.gornahoor.net/?tag=Sintesi-di-dottrina-della-razza>

Nothing is more certain, than that our manners, our civilization, and all the good things which are connected with manners and with civilization, have, in this European world of ours, depended for ages upon two principles; and were indeed the result of both combined; I mean the spirit of a gentleman and the spirit of religion.

Now, besides the philosophical foundation, we have two new criteria. Which proponents of the movement have the spirits of a gentleman and religion? Are they crude and vulgar, or advocates of a life of sensuality and debauchery? Do they make their case honestly and with integrity or are they full of half-truths and distortions? Is their religious spirit compatible with the history of Europe and the West or do they insist on some mass conversion — or more likely, deconversion — as the precondition for their movement?

Unity of Belief Next, is the need for some sort of “national” unity, however, nation, or nationalism, is defined. Giuseppe Mazzini explains the need for a “strong national uniformity of thought and faith”:

Liberty of belief destroyed all community of faith. Liberty of education produced moral anarchy. Men without a common tie, without unity of religious belief and of aim, and whose sole vocation was enjoyment, everyone sought his own road, not heeding, if in pursuing it, they were trampling upon the heads of their brothers — brothers in name and enemies in fact.

This brings us back to the beginning. Is the “movement” truly one of real brothers or one of nominal brothers but real enemies? Thus, a movement requires a unity of religious belief. A “big tent” movement is not organic, but is merely a heap⁷. So what is that belief and how possible is it a force for unity?

⁷<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1737>

So before adopting an intellectual affiliation, investing emotional capital, or even providing financial support, ask if your movement demonstrates these qualities. These are the fruit of a couple of dozen centuries of the aristocratic element in European thought. If you think something “new” is necessary, or even worse, a new type of man, you will certainly be disappointed. That is why what is required is not a revolution in the opposite direction, but the opposite of a revolution (Joseph de Maistre).

Posted on 2014-01-06 by Cologero

* * *

William on 2014-01-06 at 10:03 said:

I've been following Gornahoor for years now, and one example of a fairly pure aristocracy that keeps coming to mind is a proper martial arts dojo. It is easy to settle the question who is better ('aristos' – let's spar. The sensei is obviously one who knows – he can easily DEMONSTRATE his superior knowledge. The rest of the hierarchy of the dojo is equally easy to settle by the same means.

Not all dojos are equal, of course – when I started out, I looked for a dojo without a bunch of plastic trophies in the window – competing in local tournaments was not why I was there. And I looked for a sensei with a good heart (a 'gentleman'?) – I found one where the sensei had a masters degree in sports physiology and his 'day job' was working for the school district developing physical education plans for handicapped kids. Dojos like this are out there.

Looking back on 12 years now, I can say that practicing martial arts has turned out to be a spiritual practice which has deeply changed me for the better.

In short, the dojo is a living example of a working hierarchy/aristocracy. It has its own Tradition going back millennia. Of course these are small 'societies' – maybe a hundred students at a thriving school? But still, I'm thoughtful what could be learned from them which would apply to the larger questions considered on this site.

scardanelli on 2014-01-06 at 10:39 said:

I would say that the major difference is that in physical combat, there is a clear winner and loser whom all can recognize. We can all spar to a greater or lesser degree. When it comes to the esoteric, not all can recognize that which is superior because not all have experience of the esoteric. This knowledge cannot be demonstrated but only experienced within. Therefore those who do not know, do not know that they do not know so to speak.

An aristocracy is based upon the authority of those who have reached certainty within.

William on 2014-01-06 at 11:30 said:

I would say that the major difference is that in physical combat, there is a clear winner and loser whom all can recognize

I am not saying that martial arts is a replacement for esoteric work at all. But it is also far more than 'physical combat'. All that stuff about 'you are your own greatest opponent' is true. There is an enormous amount of 'inner' (esoteric) work that a martial artist has to do to progress, including but not limited to overcoming your own ego, overcoming your own fears, being faithful to discipline, humility in the face of a perfection you will never achieve, compassion for students less skilled than you because you need that same compassion from teachers who are your betters, being calm and fully present to your opponent. To me these all sound like spiritual lessons, not physical.

Even in sparring: in a dojo it is not so much about identifying a 'winner'. but an opportunity for both participants to try to apply what we've learned. When sparring with a less skilled student, I deliberately emphasize skills I know he is trying to develop. It's a brotherhood.

I'm certainly not suggesting that martial arts is any kind of silver bullet for The Work. But it can be a big help for some, and I still suggest it as a living working example of aristocracy/hierarchy.

William on 2014-01-06 at 11:38 said:

For myself, I know I need to submit myself to an authority and discipline greater than myself. So – where to find that? In the context of Gornahoor that would mean the Catholic Church, but where I live the local Catholic Church consists of singing folks songs in spanish to an out-of-tune guitar. And is the priest spiritually developed at all? Having worked as a church musician in churches for 40 years (Protestant and Catholic), I can say that spiritual development correlates poorly to official training and ordination.

For now, for me, martial arts is the best (though still far from ideal) solution to finding that authority and discipline I know I need.

JA on 2014-01-06 at 12:04 said:

"a life of sensuality and debauchery"

How would we explain then Catherine the Great, or the Marquis de Sade, or the Baron von Sacher-Masoch; all of whom were of the best blood ?

I've had the personal honour (or dishonour ?) of being in the same room with members of different royal houses, and honestly brothers – they can snort coke and party all night long as much as any ghetto child.....

Among a certain section of the masses, a careless and libertine way of life is actually associated with aristocracy in their little minds.....

William on 2014-01-06 at 13:49 said:

I've had the personal honour (or dishonour ?) of being in the same room with members of different royal houses, and honestly brothers – they can snort coke and party all night long as much as any ghetto child.....

Ha ha, precisely! Much the same could be said of cardinals and archbishops (the never ending sex scandals, for openers). Both ecclesiastical AND civil governance is far from 'aristos'.

The IDEA of 'aristocracy' is great (and all the variations on Plato's philosopher/kings) but how in heaven do we get there?

scardanelli on 2014-01-06 at 16:02 said:

William,

I am certainly not denegrating the martial arts. I'm only making the point that the esoteric cannot be demonstrated in the same manner.

I'm using authority in the sense of Tomberg's fourth letter. Authority is present "where there is present the breath of sacred magic, filled by the rays of light of gnosis emanated from the profound fire of mysticism." So, where in heaven do we find authority? First learn concentration without effort... This does not necessarily require submitting to the local Catholic Church. At any rate, the whole cannot be judged by the sins of the few. As Cologero has remarked, we get the church that we deserve.

Michael on 2014-01-06 at 21:06 said:

I will second what JA says: although I am sure there are exceptions, the aristocrats of the current age show little to no spiritual development.

Will following the path outlined in Meditations on the Tarot lead to a new nobility? Or is spiritual development, at a certain point, incompatible with nobility as we find it in the middle ages?

Scardanelli on 2014-01-07 at 13:01 said:

"However, that is not necessary since the aristocrats would themselves seldom be the philosophers, i.e., the spiritual leaders and educators. Instead, they would be trained in the art of ruling, so the goal of their education is to become gentlemen, not sages."

You're right Michael. I should have read more closely.

JA on 2014-01-07 at 14:32 said:

amongst many upper class people I know, a pseudo-Nietzschean attitude prevails that personal morality is for the bourgeois, the unenlightened and uneducated folks; and that for those of us of better blood and breeding we are pretty much free to have as much fun and pleasure as we want. In their thinking, the lower classes exist so that we can enjoy ourselves.....and then of course there are those aristocrats who having a "conscience" and "compassion" for those less fortunate become leftists.

Michael on 2014-01-07 at 18:42 said:

Is the "pseudo-Nietzschean attitude" the reason we have had the revolution that has resulted in the rule of the shudra? My recollection from Plutarch is that the Roman aristocracy did uphold a higher standard. On the other hand, the ruling class of ancient Greece was immoral in many instances.

The aristocracy of today most likely is just reflecting the degraded morality of the age.

Matt on 2014-01-07 at 23:25 said:

"The aristocracy of today most likely is just reflecting the degraded morality of the age."

Or better put, the modern age is just reflecting the degraded morality of the aristocracy. And the term aristocracy is probably not even the right term that applies to the current upper classes, as it means rule of the best; best in virtue and best in intelligence, neither of which the majority of those in the upper class can legitimately claim to represent.

August on 2014-01-08 at 02:35 said:

It doesn't matter what one does. Who cares about morality, especially now. The important part is what motivates him to do it, what is happening inside. If you have to persistently restrain yourself from a loose lifestyle, how are you any better from someone who indulges similar impulses? At most you've demonstrated better self-control, in the worst case it's just a matter of time until you relapse or some monstrous repression erupts in one fashion or another. And at least you know what you're dealing with in the presence of the openly indulgent.

When you have crossed a threshold, you know it because even if you WANT to, say, party like you did when you were a 20 year old, there is no longer anything inside you to allow you to do it. Sure, go buy some drugs and head to the club, but you may as well be baking muffins for all the inner participation that is taking place, and going through stupid motions quickly makes one feel stupid. When the inner mania evaporates, the superficial desire quickly goes too, and no restraint is required. Do you see why some people fear a spiritual correction more than death?

If 'aristocrats' aren't getting to this point, it could have something to do with the active tendencies, and vanity, of their class, which in our bland surroundings find convenient expression in the artificial drama-world of the drug-sex-party social complex. That they can't see how

pathetic it is to get bogged down in that and actually enjoy it is also perhaps to be expected, given that they historically relied on spiritual authority for direction. It also seems to be, originally, a signature British weakness.

Scardanelli on 2014-01-08 at 15:36 said:

In what sense are you using morality august? Perhaps I'm misunderstanding you. Morality isn't just an arbitrary law imposed upon ones ego from without and masking ones true depravity, but an expression of an inner state reflected in the outer. Thus morality is relevant in that when we act in a moral way, our wills are aligned with providence and impose this upon destiny, so to speak. Therefor it does matter what one does... To be moral is to redeem the flesh, to spiritualize matter.

August on 2014-01-08 at 18:09 said:

Though it should have been obvious from the lines following, I was referring to morality in the Protestant sense, an arbitrary behavioural convention, a residue, given excessive importance and divorced from real ties to the spiritual, eventually failing in its only potentially useful role of maintaining a kind of public order.

Cologero on 2014-01-08 at 21:11 said:

On the word of a modern day Greek aristocrat (Joy is a state of mind), drinking, debauchery, and sports competition are sources of joy if done with good breeding, style, and manners. A gentleman understands moderation, so he doesn't go to the extremes of a saint, yogi, or even philosopher.

Michael on 2014-01-09 at 18:17 said:

Cologero, Taki is a charming guy, and I think he is in many ways a good model, but how does debauchery fit in with theosis? Isn't the goal still to "be perfect as your heavenly Father is perfect?"

Gina on 2014-01-17 at 11:49 said:

Engaging post. This statement about the favoring of spiritual races over biological ones rings true in my opinion. I've felt it creates a problem in the modern day. Good breeding, higher education, and a deeper appreciation of sciences and art are all something that leaders should possess, and these are qualities that are not blood inherited, although money helps when on the road to spiritual attainment (in my opinion).

Many people can legitimately trace their family lines back to royalty. I am one of them. This doesn't make them great leaders or worthy to live off of tax payer money. I'd say this is a gross misuse of funds.

In Kabbalah, for instance “House of Jacob” is somewhat equal to saying “soul of balance”. The middle way. An aspect coming from Tiphereth. I also do believe that Jacob was historical, however, if you can trace your lineage back to him, you’re just as likely to be a King in Saudi Arabia as you are to be an accountant. Certain “Houses” meant spiritual grades in old times. We’ve become quite Pharisaic maybe in our interpretation of these hierarchical systems.

Good genes or potentially good epigenetic conditions are not hoarded in royal houses or amongst those in the elite bourgeois. However, our society seems to have destroyed the tenets by which purposeful mating was made important. I do see that. This is a bit of a religious and social crisis where the spirituality has been sucked from the materiality.

9.4 Prole Thoughts

Since I had been taking notes about various news programs over the past week, I was intending to comment on them. That turned out to be distasteful and probably futile, so instead I prefer to continue commenting on European aristocratic philosophy as succinctly summarized by Prof **Alexander Jacob** in his book *Nobilitas*; since it seems to be unavailable, there is all the more need to do so.

Many contemporary historians have lamented the lack of direct documentation provided by the “common” people of past generations. Hence, they go looking for letters to soldiers, or diary entries, etc., to fill in that gap. Today, there is no such problem at all. On the contrary, “prole thoughts” are all too available through the so-called “social media” of facebook, twitter, huffington post, and so on. Their interests, concerns, activities, and forms of thought are available for the next great historian of our age to digest. This, however, must be much more than a mere statistical study.

A half step up are found the poseurs. Not content with common interests, they use social media as a debating platform for politics, philosophy, religion and related erudite topics. Since it is impossible today to master all human knowledge, the days of the Renaissance Man are long gone. Nevertheless, most people feel competent to make definitive

judgments on complex issues of science, economics, ethics, sociology, and psychology. You would think a lifetime of average grades and standardized test results would discourage people, but it seems not to be the case. Without a teacher, everyone imagines himself capable of “A” work.

That is likely because at adulthood, his worldview is firmly set, for better or worse, and any challenge to it results in psychic distress. That is why such social media discussions often turn nasty. Someone once said that most men hold opinions that can each fit onto a placard. So a half dozen or so disconnected placards contain the framework for their entire life of the mind. The details don’t matter, since any content can be reframed within that framework, like some Procrustean bed. *Nobilitas* is intended to reach the one in two hundred men who are not satisfied with placards.

Rule of the Best Based on some recent comments, let us be clear what this means. The best are well born and well educated. Well born does not mean having the best parents, so strictly speaking it is not always a matter of a bloodline. Furthermore, to be “educated” means to have wisdom developed from within. In short, the raw matter must first be there and then it must be developed; obviously, a healthy social structure will develop such talent. This is contrary to the tabula rasa ideal of today in which everyone is considered to be born equal, and the task of education is to implant the right ideas into that empty space. I should mention at this point that the Greek ideal can also be found in the East, for example, in **Shankara’s** *Crest Jewel of Discrimination*.

Starting with the Greeks, we see the themes of the One, the Good, and the Logos. The wise man is one who can see the unity of spirit in the multiplicity of manifested things. The highest idea is the idea of the Good and the Logos or cosmic order is an object of contemplation. As we saw last time via Giovanni Gentile, the intellectualism of the Greeks gives way to the voluntarism of the Christian era. In the latter, there is

the same understanding of the One; however, the Good becomes Love and the Logos is no longer object but becomes subject. Moreover, Jung claimed that "individuation" was possible only in certain cultures. Keep these thoughts in mind in the historical manifestations of aristocratic philosophy.

Since modern ideals are so ingrained in nearly everyone today, it may be difficult to understand or come to terms with aristocratic philosophy. For example, the first principle is that the superior rules the inferior; in particular, the lower desires are to be ruled by the dictates of reason. On the contrary, today's standard is that the purpose of reason is to lead to the satisfaction of lower desires. In particular, the conventionally intelligent⁸ mark themselves by being sexually risqué, as though they can't find any other purpose for their intelligence.

In the social realm, the same principle holds. Plato claimed that untrained passions are found in children, women, and lower classes. Apart from children, perhaps, such a claim is now rejected, even as passion itself is celebrated. In particular, any movements that claim to be recovering the aristocratic philosophy ought not be run and organized by women.

I have noticed the tendency of some self-described elitist movements that have disdain for lower classes. On the contrary, the Greek model was the common good; society was to be organized even for the benefit of the lower classes. Actually, the philosophical elite, which corresponds to the traditional idea of the Brahman class, has little need for what pleasures the rest of society. Hence, the ruling elite have no need for sexual or financial exploitation, unlike what is found in all modern social systems. **Plato's** *Republic* would be ruled by a philosopher-king. Prof Jacob quotes Plato:

Unless either the philosopher become kings in our states or those whom we now call our kings and rules take to the pursuit of philosophy seriously and adequately, and there is a conjunction

⁸<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1582>

of these two things, political power and philosophic intelligence, while the motley hordes of the natures who at present pursue either apart from the other are compulsorily excluded, there can be no cessation of troubles for our states nor for the human race.

This is somewhat different from **Rene Guenon**'s view of the separation of spiritual authority from political power. The philosophers are the spiritual leaders, advisors, and educators, but few have the talent, or even the interest, for ruling. Hence, kings must be educated in the proper philosophy and willing to follow the direction of the philosophers. This system as such was not fully tried in the West until the Middle Ages in which the role of the philosopher was that of the Church and the king's legitimacy depended on the spiritual authority.

As for Plato's prediction of troubles for the human race if his ideal was not followed, can there be any doubt? Since, in the West, many have found pockets of stability, they are unaware of such problems and have scant sympathy for the actual victims of such troubles.

Of existing forms, Plato insists that kingship is the best provided there is rule of law. This is contrary to **Julius Evola**'s opinion⁹ that leaves no space for a separate spiritual authority in the monarchy and allows the monarch absolute power. However, for Plato and the Medievals, the positive law must be consistent with the cosmic law.

Rule of the Gentleman The other Greek thinker treated by Prof Jacob is **Aristotle**, who has a slightly different conception. While Plato's system goes to extremes, Aristotle recommends moderation. For Aristotle, the national good is superior to the merely individual good. Such a position is difficult to defend today in the West since the idea of a nation is mostly discredited. Hence, Western political systems are organized around providing goods and services to particular individuals based only

⁹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6548>

on their political influence. However, this is only partly true, since various subnations, based on race, ethnicity, religion, or even behavioral preferences, vie for goods apart from the good of the body politic as a whole.

Although Aristotle believes everyone should strive for the mean, there are still those who are superior and those who are inferior. A gentleman would be magnanimous, virtuous, just, and prudent in knowing how to apply higher principles to political life. He develops friendships among men of similar character.

Now, this is a sound corrective to Plato. A ruler ought not be as extreme or fanatical as Plato's guardians. This was the position in the Middle Ages, in which the nobility held the place of the gentleman. While a St. Francis of Assisi may be a model for the spiritual class, it is not intended as the proper way to rule a society. Unfortunately, fanaticisms of various types have been commonplace in the turmoil of the modern world.

Next: Rome and the Renaissance

Posted on 2014-01-12 by Cologero

* * *

JA on 2014-01-13 at 09:53 said:

This series is very informative and much needed, I look forward to the subsequent chapters.

Avery Morrow on 2014-01-13 at 11:39 said:

"While a St. Francis of Assisi may be a model for the spiritual class, it is not intended as the proper way to rule a society."

Honestly – even if someone happened upon this proper way to rule, who of this era would want to listen to them? Perhaps all we have left at this point, lacking any acceptable guidance from the old social elites, are pointers back to the unrefined Tao.

Michael on 2014-01-16 at 22:01 said:

I think the book is an excellent introduction to the topic, but it leaves me wanting to learn more. Does anyone have any suggestions for reading how aristocracies are established in the first place?

Cologero on 2014-01-16 at 22:57 said:

Yes, Michael, that is the point and it will be covered shortly. By way of introduction, I can make the following points.

First of all, it must be stipulated that the civilization of the Middle Ages represents in the West the closest approximation to a Traditional civilization as described by Guenon. Anyone who will give the matter at least serious consideration can hardly deny it.

So we can focus on its beginning stages so we can learn from it. The knights represent the ideal of the gentleman and the monks were closest to the philosophers, i.e., those dedicated to a higher calling above material and sensual pleasures. Plato's further division of the Republic into warriors and producers mirrored the Middle Ages.

The creators of the civilization of the Middle Ages were the *true* men among the ruins, i.e., of the Roman Empire. For them, it was a matter of life or death, not an effete intellectual theory as it has become today.

The social hierarchy was both consciously and unconsciously created and arose organically for the most part. Strong leaders such as Clovis and Charlemagne, established and protected that hierarchy. Certain intellectual currents, originating from the poets and religious authorities, provided the justification. We addressed that topic specifically over a year ago in *Pray, Fight, Work*¹⁰, even if no one then seemed to grasp its significance.

Now there are many other explanations for this, but they do not take into account the true nature of a Traditional civilization and social organization.

As for the "how" ... a Traditional civilization depends absolutely on an authentic Tradition. That is the ineluctable foundation which the Middle Age civilization was blessed with, and that foundation cannot be based on vague imaginings or unsupportable speculations. Without that, there is nowhere to go.

9.5 Prolegomena to Noble Philosophy

Nobility, the quality which I call true aristocracy, requires of a man the recognition of his guilt. In its depths, conscience, which is frequently covered up and suppressed, is always a consciousness

¹⁰<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=5198>

of guilt. The necessary thing is to take upon oneself as much guilt as possible and to put as little as possible of it upon other people. The aristocrat is not one who is proudly conscious of himself as first, as a privileged being, and who safeguards his position as such. The aristocrat is the man who is aware of the guilt and sinfulness of this first place, this privileged position of his. *The sense that one is being continually affronted is on the other hand, precisely a plebeian feeling.*

NICOLAI BERDYAEV

I've been away with severe bronchitis, probably resulting from a pneumothorax I suffered two months ago. I tried the auto-suggestion exercise, but was unable to achieve any lasting results. I found it difficult to reach any transcendent state as gasps for air brought me back. Of course, on the physical plane, possibilities may be exhausted in a process of densification. Despite trying ayurvedic and Santeria home cures, (everyone had an opinion), I eventually turned to heavy doses of white man's medicine. Interestingly, while the body is still subpar, there was a specific spiritual healing which I shall keep to myself.

In that time, I considered several ways to return to the topic. Specifically, what can we glean from the documentation we have on the formation of Tradition in the middle ages? This will require a review of the historiographical method as well as a refresher on the **Ancient City**. Although I like **Alexander Jacob**'s term "aristocratic philosophy", the title of his book, *Nobilitas*, better suits the purpose. The original term may be misleading, since it is a philosophy for aristocrats, not from aristocrats. After all, an aristocrat is a gentleman and therefore ill-suited to the nitpicking of critical philosophy. So while a **Socrates** is debating the meaning of courage, piety, justice, etc., in thought, only to end up in aporia, the aristocrat is effecting those virtues in being. He strives to "be" courageous, pious, just, and so on. Although I would prefer to use the

Sanskrit word for noble¹¹, the English “Noble Philosophy” will suffice for obvious reasons.

Yet even the word “philosophy” is misleading, since profane philosophy has come to mean something critical or speculative rather than a way of life. That is why Guenon distinguished between metaphysics and philosophy, yet “Hermetic philosophy” is actually metaphysics. Profane philosophy represents a decline, since it attempts to do in thought what had been accomplished in being.

In Professor Jacob’s study of aristocratic philosophy, there is a gap between ancient philosophy as represented by **Plato**, **Aristotle**, and **Cicero**, and the Renaissance and later thinkers. In a sense, profane philosophy represents decadence and a decline from more traditional thought. Thus, Plato created a republic in thought, whereas the ancient Greek city created them in reality. Those cities were established by a godling or man with divine qualities. They were initially ruled by a priest-king and religious rites organized the life the city and its inhabitants. Aristotle presumably had access to those ancient constitutions from which he developed his political philosophy. Cicero admitted he could not understand the ancient Roman customs and laws.

Ulrich Valange observed that High Culture requires culture creators and culture sustainers. So in the Ancient City, the founders were the creators and the nobility were the sustainers, so long as they kept the hearth burning. The clients, or plebes, had no culture of their own and simply followed the culture and rites of their particular ruling family. In this sense, therefore, the culture was “imposed” on them. This relates back to Berdyaev’s opening quote.

The esoteric method is neither argumentative nor empirical. Rather, it is descriptive, since to know requires an intuition, that is, something more like seeing. It is based on principle, so we don’t reason from the many to the One, but instead we strive to understand the many from

¹¹<http://www.behindthename.com/name/arya>

the One. Hence, the principle of the Ancient City, as it relates to High Culture, manifests as creators, sustainers, as well as the passive elements. We are not interested in the faux debates among these groups, but rather in observing how they manifest the principle.

The true aristocrats are acutely aware of their role as the culture sustainers and strive to fulfill that role. Whenever there is a failure in some regard, they become ritually unclean and need to restore the balance. Initially, this was exteriorized, but becomes interiorized in the Middle Ages as we shall see. They are motivated by honour and duty, not by their ability to dominate, although they exercise the power of command as necessary.

Lower than them, are the plebes. They can neither fully understand nor participate in the culture. Hence, they become prone to feelings of resentment. They feel that something has been “imposed” on them. We see that especially in certain neo-pagan circles, who complain that medieval Christianity was forced on them. Understand, from our perspective, that it is pointless to engage in some mock interminable debate; rather, we simply see what type of person holds what type of worldview. As a reminder, from the esoteric point of view, this is what **Rene Guenon** wrote, (regarding whether Dante was a Catholic or a pagan):

For our part, we do not think that such a point of view is necessary, for true esoterism is something completely different from outward religion, and if it has some relationship with it, this can only be insofar as it finds a symbolic mode of expression in religious forms. Moreover, it matters little whether these forms be of this or that religion, since what is involved is the essential doctrinal unity concealed beneath their apparent diversity.

Those who feel victimized, then, simply do not and cannot understand this. The prime example, as we have repeatedly pointed out, is the legend

of the Virgin Spring¹²; there we see the aristocratic and plebeian characteristics fully revealed. These are not judgments; rather they are descriptions of certain states of consciousness.

Next: The Foundation of the Middle Ages.

Posted on 2014-02-13 by Cologero

9.6 Notes of a Latter Day Knight

And it shall come to pass that I will pour out my spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy: your old men shall dream dreams, and your young men shall see visions.

JOEL 2:28

A knight is made, not born. He may have spent years like the prodigal son, living with the pigs, succumbing to Satan's three temptations of lust, the pride of life, and avarice. In our time, the knight of physical combat may not be necessary, but the knight of spiritual combat is needed more than ever.



Lady Love If he is fortunate, he may meet his Love, even if it is unrequited or even unknown. Such Love cannot be consummated carnally, the mistake made by Lancelot and Guinevere.

Her role is to send him on his quest. She chides him harshly when he falls short of the knightly ideal, through vulgarity, personal vanity, or

¹²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1416>

pointless showmanship of his skills. Yet her gentleness inspires him to excel and to become a better man than he ever thought possible.

If you are fortunate, you will be able to see yourself through her eyes.

Duels

Whatever is acquired by single combat [duel] is acquired with Right. For when human judgment fails, either because it is wrapped in the darkness of ignorance or because it has not the aid of a judge, then, lest judgment should remain forsaken, recourse must be had to Him who so loved her that, by the shedding of His own blood, He met her full demands in death. Hence the Psalm: "The righteous Lord loveth righteousness." This end is accomplished when, with the free consent of the participants, in love and not in hatred of justice, the judgment of God is sought through a mutual trial of bodily and spiritual strength. Because it was first used in single combat of man to man, this trial of strength we call the duel.

DANTE, *De Monarchia*

Combat can lead to the Truth, provided it is not motivated by rage, vengeance, or personal glory.

Initiation The *Ordre de la Rose-Croix catholique et esthétique du Temple et du Graal*¹³, founded by **Josephin Peladan**, consisted of three grades:

- **Neophyte** whose patron was **Leonardo da Vinci**
- **Chevalier** whose patron was **Dante**
- **Commander** whose patrons were **Saint John** and the Holy Spirit

Dante the artist shows the Knight the stages of the journey to Sophia through the Divine Feminine, represented by Beatrice.

¹³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Salon_de_la_Rose_%2B_Croix

Judgment

Nobility, the quality which I call true aristocracy, requires of a man the recognition of his guilt. In its depths, conscience, which is frequently covered up and suppressed, is always a consciousness of guilt. The necessary thing is to take upon oneself as much guilt as possible and to put as little as possible of it upon other people. The aristocrat is not one who is proudly conscious of himself as first, as a privileged being, and who safeguards his position as such. The aristocrat is the man who is aware of the guilt and sinfulness of this first place, this privileged position of his. *The sense that one is being continually affronted is on the other hand, precisely a plebeian feeling.*

NICOLAI BERDYAEV

The knight knows his state of being and judges himself more harshly than any outsider could.

Motivation

From this deeper principle you must do your works, without a why. I affirm it decisively: even if you do your works for the kingdom of heaven, for God, or your sanctity, although motivated by the other, even then you will not really be in the right. If you ask a true man, a man who acts from his depth: "Why do you do all your works?" he will answer you rightly only if he says: "I act only for the action itself."

MEISTER ECKHART

The Knight follows his Dharma, or Destiny.

Anti-Realism

The truth or falsity of idealism—and that means if man can or can't give certainty and sense to his life and his experience—cannot be demonstrated theoretically: it can be decided not through an intellectual act, but through a concrete realization.

JULIUS EVOLA, *Essays on Magical Idealism*

The animal mind cannot conceive of any reality beyond what appears to the senses. Yet, in the ascent to the divine, sensory images are left behind as one contemplates God and the Angels. Then the Knight returns to his Native Land, seeing through intuition, not the senses.

Intellectual Joy The animal mind believes that joy can arise only from sensory objects. Yet the greatest joy comes from intellectual pursuits. When I was a boy around 10 and 11, my parents sent me to weekly classes at the Boston Museum of Science. Afterwards, I would wait in the library to be picked up. My favourite topics were astronomy and mathematics. I learned the mystical symbols for the planets and constellations. I was fascinated with the ancient names of the stars like Aldebaran, Rigel, Betelgeuse, Sirius, Arcturus, so I kept a notebook full of such names.

The library had the four volumes of the *World of Mathematics*. There I read the proof the $1 + 1 = 2$ from the *Principia Mathematica* of Whitehead and Russell. I was astounded that those strange symbols could lead to such a result.

Then I learned the names of the Medieval Categorical Syllogisms, such as Barbara, Festino, or Baroco. I am certainly not alone in experiencing such joy.

Ascent through the Hierarchy

A process of mind is thinking only so far as it realizes the end of thinking, which is always to understand, that is, to see things within a system which renders them necessary.

BRAND BLANSHARD, *The Nature of Thought*

The evolution of knowledge is, as Plato long ago portrayed it, the emancipation of individual minds from their accidental limitations, and their education into the knowledge of the one real and intelligible world.

BERNARD BOSANQUET, *Logic*

An animal can only understand individual things. The spiritual knight, however, understands things and events in larger and larger wholes. Individual things are but the reflection of ideas in the Divine Mind. Then the individuals are understood as part of a larger whole. Next, he sees how things develop over time. And so on, until he reaches the more subtle realms. Each such realm corresponds to a level of the angelic hierarchy.

Purification The purification of the mind and the will begins in this life. If it is not completed at death, it will be continued in Purgatory. One is not “sent” to Purgatory; rather, it is the symbolic representation of his state of being at the time of death.

Heaven and Hell In the same way, Heaven and Hell are the names for our states of being; that is why there are gradations or levels in each of them.

The vulgar mind images Heaven as an extension of sensory existence, with the exceptions that your truck doesn’t break down, your dog doesn’t die, and your wife doesn’t cheat on you. But none of that can compare to the ecstasy of the Beatific Vision.

The whole divine order is revealed. Then, it is not the individual dog that matters, but rather the essence of the dog is understood in its place in the whole.

Those who choose to live in Hell on earth will simply continue in that state of being. Someone uninterested in holy things now, will not suddenly change course. Hell is to exist without love, so the denizens of Hell hate each other.

The Sannyasi

To accept suffering in itself and for itself, to consent to it, to seek it, to love it, to make its identifying mark and the very object of disinterested and generous love, to put perfect action in sorrowful passion, to be active up to the point of death, to make of every act a death and of death itself the act par excellence, here is the triumph of the will that disconcerts again nature and that in fact engenders in man a new — and more than human — life.

MAURICE BLONDEL, *Action*

When the knight becomes unable to engage in physical combat, he can become a sannyasi. He will give up attachment to worldly things and eschew the glamour of the world.

The advertisements for retirement communities show happy people riding bicycles with their friends to go play pickle ball. That is how a boy lives, not a man. We are given more years than are necessary to propagate the species. The purpose of those years is to allow time for spiritual development.

Mark of Cain The damned are envious of those whom God favours. God favoured Abel, so Cain murdered him. Cain's descendants are numerous; their goal is to overturn the cosmic order. The mark on the fore-

head from Ash Wednesday is a sign of humility and obedience to the King. Yet the same ashes on Cain's minions are his sign.

Our Spiritual Heritage

In the last days, God says, I will pour out my Spirit on all people. Your sons and daughters will prophesy, your young men will see visions, your old men will dream dreams. Even on my servants, both men and women, I will pour out my Spirit in those days, and they will prophesy. I will show wonders in the heavens above and signs on the earth below, blood and fire and billows of smoke. The sun will be turned to darkness and the moon to blood before the coming of the great and glorious day of the Lord. And everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved.

ACTS 2:17-21

The Sons and Daughters of Europe, the spiritual Knights of the Holy Roman Empire, have been bequeathed the greatest of spiritual and intellectual gifts: Platonic philosophy and the Catholic religion. One to feed the mind, the other, the heart.

Let us not be like the prodigal son who squanders those gifts.

Posted on 2019-03-13 by Cologero

* * *

Patricia Kay on 2019-03-14 at 14:10 said:

Thank you, as ever, for your stunning clarity of mind and kindness in articulating Truth in ways that are helpful.

9.7 The Law of Success

Those who make plans will be born to carry them out. Those who make no plans need not be born.

NISARGADATTA, *I Am That*

You are the “master of your fate” and the “captain of your soul,” by reason of the fact that you control your own thoughts, and, with the aid of your thoughts, you may create whatever you desire.

NAPOLÉON HILL, *The Law of Success*

The question of why some men are successful and others are not has always intrigued me. I am speaking, of course, only of those men who seem capable of great success: they may possess intelligence, creativity, charm, education, good breeding, yet never reach certain heights. In many cases Fortune plays a role, since chance can never be eliminated from life as a factor. Although we typically write from the perspective of the first caste, this post will focus on the second and third castes, that is, those involved in political and economic activity.

Napoleon Hill, in *The Law of Success*, published his study of the characteristics of several successful men of his era¹⁴. Success, according to him, begins in the imagination, with an idea. Obviously, this is the active imagination, not the passive imagination of daydreaming. Before dismissing this work as just pop psychology, this is just one of the Hermetic and/or spiritual teachings that he adapts to worldly success. A lot of contemporary New Thought or Law of Attraction teachings are distorted or incomplete renditions of Hermetic ideas.

¹⁴I am not particularly recommending Napoleon Hill, but am using him as a resource to understand the Kshatriya and Vaishya castes in the contemporary worlds.

The epigram above could have been written by Julius Evola, for example, who stressed the same inner state of self-mastery. It is no coincidence that Evola was concerned primarily with the Kshatriyas, not unlike Hill. Hill lists several negative emotions or habits—including suspiciousness, jealousy, uncontrolled sexual desire—that are obstacles to success. Enthusiasm, or thumos in our view, must be balanced with self-control. He mentions the Law of Mental Telepathy by which other can “tune in” to your thoughts. Your self-confidence will be sensed unconsciously by others. These examples can suffice for now.

An important quality for success is the ability to secure cooperation from others. This is called leadership. The main motives that impel men to action are:

1. The motive of self-preservation
2. The motive of sexual contact
3. The motive of financial and social power.

Those who understand those motives will have greater ability in motivating others. Note that the motive of rationality or intellect and the motive of spiritual development are not at the top of the list. The Leader will try to gain cooperation through group harmony, and endeavoring to convince them so subsume their own interests to the group identity. Hill writes:

Find a motive around which men may be induced to rally in a highly emotionalized, enthusiastic spirit of perfect harmony and you have found the starting point for the creation of a Master Mind. It is a well known fact that men will work harder for the attainment of an ideal than they will for mere money. In searching for a “motive” as the basis for developing co-operative group effort it will be profitable to bear this fact in mind.

Some leaders know this by chance, while others understand the laws of motivation consciously. What Hill says can be verified: watch the news, read web sites, and try to see them in action. See how group identity and cohesion is formed, for example.

Attraction and Repulsion Hill asserts that snap judgments and hunches come from a telepathic connection. Since men are not interiorly united, their audiences will pick up conflicting signals. That is why one man can be associated with widely divergent emotional reactions. Of course, the receivers of the telepathic communication have their own inner limitations, constrained by their three chief motives, which will distort the message. Unfortunately, most people never get beyond this reactive stage, particularly in the political realm. Facebook's success is based fundamentally on clicking "like", proving the point.

Yet this is to live at the very lowest state of stimulus/response of the etheric body, the pranamayakosha. This is the intellectual life of an amoeba. At least for the amoeba, attraction and repulsion can be a life or death decision, but for humans it just gets in the way of intelligent discourse.

White Collar Criminals and Success I will add my own law of industriousness. Few men will actually act on their idea. A major motivator for this blog was my encounter with two white-collar criminals, primarily through their ex-wives. I got to know a lot about them, in great part because the wives held a great admiration for the men, despite the lies, betrayals, and financial decline that came to them.

These men were actually quite industrious in developing their schemes, maybe because it can be more difficult to live a lie than the truth. I got to see a large part of it. Denying their own moral culpability for their crimes, they were quite libertarian in their views. By that I mean that, in their own minds, they never coerced anyone, and their marks voluntarily

played their roles in the scam, either out of greed, ignorance, or stupidity. The criminals felt no responsibility for the voluntary actions of their victims.

So I resolved to be industrious, since I have plenty of imagination and self-confidence. I have the first law of a “definite chief aim”, although I doubt anyone has figured it out. Most people who write me privately seem to think all these posts are random and independent, mostly for entertainment purposes. That is because they cannot grasp anything new, but can only interpret new things in terms of what they already know.

I must be low in a “pleasing personality” and the ability to “elicit cooperation”. The most inane facebook posts get several dozen, if not hundreds, of “likes”. Gornahoor, after weeks of research, and hours of writing from the heart for each post, might get half a dozen “pity likes”. I do appreciate them. We never get invited to speak at conferences or Internet podcasts.

So we are down to our last 50 posts. We could reveal the chief aim in #1001, or we may just fade away.

The Elusivity of Excellence

Imagine yourself suddenly discovering that most of your philosophy of life had been built of bias and prejudice, making it necessary for you to acknowledge that, far from being a finished scholar, *you were barely qualified to become an intelligent student!*

NAPOLEON HILL

The number of men who are able to live by pure reason, the higher intellect, or logos, is very small. The majority are dominated either by eros (sex, desire) or by thumos (anger, ambition). Hence, there will always be an irrational component in political and social life. In Napoleon Hill’s conception, reason is to be used for self-preservation, sex, and money.

In his own self-development, he came to realize three things regarding worldviews:

- That you may learn how and where you acquired your philosophy of life, in general;
- That you may trace your prejudices and your biases to their original source;
- That you may discover, as I discovered, how largely you are the result of the training you received before you reached the age of fifteen years

Even Hill's outlined plan for a more peaceful world cannot overcome that irrational component because it requires the manipulation of emotion.

By a life of pure intellect, I mean one that is dedicated, but not limited, to meditation of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty. This is rare to achieve, but well-worth the effort. Contrariwise, even intelligent and nominally educated people are focused on particulars.

- They are intrigued by true facts, but not by Truth
- They desire good things, but not the Good
- They are attracted to beautiful things, but not to Beauty

These all have their deformations.

- They are intrigued by falsities that confirm their prejudices and worldviews
- They desire the pleasurable, even if it is not ultimately good
- They are attracted to unusual and abnormal

I was educated in a Boston area school system that tried to teach excellence. The most intelligent, the best informed, and the cultured would be rewarded. However, the leaders of organizations attained, and retain, their positions, not through intellect alone, but because of their skills at organizing, not to say manipulating, others.

Patrician Rulers

Foolish consistency is the hobgoblin of little minds.

RALPH WALDO EMERSON

Since rule by the philosopher-king is unlikely, the best kind of regime is the rule of the gentlemen, that is, of the patricians whose wealth comes from land, not from commercial activity. Because such men are guided interiorly by thumos, there will always be an irrational element in political life. This should be obvious, not just in theory, but also is easily verified empirically. Those who aspire to a life of action should pay close attention.

Whereas the masses are passive and contribute to society by procreation, the gentleman class redirects eros into more creative channels. The desire for fame feeds their ambition to lead and to rule. Such men are necessary despite the risk of bad rulers, who are not fully rational. Napoleon Hill makes the following point, based on his studies of successful men:

All of the great leaders, in whatever walks of life they have arisen, have been and are people of highly sexed natures.

In colloquial terms, these are the “alpha males”. They have an excess of sexual energy that gets sublimated to fame, fortune, and ambition. This separates the successful in worldly terms from the merely intelligent.

A successful system of rule was the Roman consul in the early years of the Republic. There were two consuls, each with veto power over the

other. They were taken from the Patrician class and limited to a term of just one year. The idea of being a professional politician, such as we see today in the so-called Western democracies, was anathema. Today's professional politicians become skilled at just one thing: the learn how to manipulate the political system. The Patrician, on the contrary, had demonstrated his skill at being successful in the world, as was committed to the welfare of the nation, not to a political faction or party.

To jump ahead a couple of millennia, we can look at the phenomenon of **Donald Trump**. Let's detach from the spontaneous arising of either attraction or repulsion, often associated with him, and consider him as an archetype. Since the plantation system ended some time ago, Trump is the closest we have to a Patrician, having achieved financial success primarily through real estate rather than buying and selling, or worse. Moreover, he is an "outsider" to the political system. Like him or not, you would have probably felt the same way about particular Consuls. If his personality of off-putting to you, consider that a man cannot achieve such worldly success by being just like you. A young mother of four sons despises him, so I posed a question to her. Suppose a gypsy fortune teller offered these predictions for your sons:

1. One would get an MBA degree from Wharton, one of the top 3 business schools in the country.
2. The second son would make a billion dollars developing real estate around the world.
3. The third would become a big TV star.¹⁵
4. The fourth would run for president and defeat 16 other professional politicians

¹⁵I have never watched an episode of the Apprentice.

Objectively that is quite a resume and what mother would be displeased with that prognosis? Now I would prefer a Patrician to have more of that Roman dignity than we see in Trump. Nevertheless, in a democracy we can only vote for what is available. The question is still open: what kind of a man (or woman) do we admire? Someone who became wealthy by capitalizing on political connections? And excelling at party politics is hardly a skill worth bragging about.

Learn from this, all who aspire for leadership. It is never a matter of just winning intellectual arguments on abstruse issues. And minor contradictions don't matter. The intelligentsia – that is, those who earn a living solely on words like journalists, lawyers, and so on – get exercised by so called “gotcha” questions: a minor inconsistency, an offensive remark, etc. In that way, they become totally oblivious to the actual world, mistaken their purely verbal formulations for reality itself.

Posted on 2016-05-26 by Cologero

* * *

Thomas Blanchard on 2016-05-26 at 11:20 said:

I'm curious on what you base your assertion that Napoleon Hill is primarily concerning himself with Kshyatrias. His goals and attitude seem quite bourgeois – after all, you note that he puts reason at the service of self-preservation, sex, and money. You note that you're referring to both the Kshyatria and Vaishya castes, but what differentiates them? Is it the role of thumos dominating the soul versus eros/material appetite?

Cologero on 2016-05-26 at 12:20 said:

I need a little poetic license here, Thomas, and I thought it was clear I was not recommending Napoleon Hill as an authority. At the end I wrote: “to understand the Kshatriya and Vaishya castes in the contemporary worlds”. So the intention was to describe the contemporary manifestation of the castes, not their traditional roles. To give him his due, however, is it bourgeois to achieve self-mastery over your own thoughts? In describing the situation of the modern world, I took as a source someone who has studied successful people in that world. The laws of power have not changed over the centuries, however.

Hill is not putting reason at the service of ..., he is describing what people actually do. The source for the thumos comment is actually Plato: to the extent that rulers are led by thumos, there will be a residue of irrationality in politics.

The roles of the two castes are hard to differentiate today. Consider how much debate there is about the influence of commercial interests over the political process.

Pickman on 2016-05-26 at 13:50 said:

What good will it be to reveal the chief aim in the last post when it can no longer be debated? Why not now?

The reason this blog gets so little attention is simply because of its lack of marketing. It has great content but it's aesthetic presentation and outreach are rather muted. Whereas slick 'all style/spin and no substance' propaganda gets the masses attention. It has always been the case (perhaps an inversion of recognisable quality) but that is just the way the world media works.

Jacob on 2016-05-26 at 19:38 said:

Cologero, I'll be very sad when the posts on this blog end. I have always felt that you were the most insightful author I have ever read. I say this not as flattery, but because I believe it to be true. I often feel so alienated from the world today with its constant focus on desire and nothing more. At the same time I realize that I do need to be more industrious with the knowledge I have. Recently, I have begun to treat your writings in a way many treat sermons. Get a message that confirms my worldview and continue on without any deep reflection. In any case, thank you for your time.

On Trump: I am deeply conflicted because I really like how he is willing to bravely deny the tenets of the Left. However, he seems to be sign of our age as well. The man who is the most entertaining and outlandish gets the most attention. It's possible that he is using the tenets of post-modernism to achieve higher goals (riding the tiger), but I don't see any evidence that he has any knowledge of anything higher than power. Still it's better to take a bad leader who establishes order than complete chaos right? I'm almost to the point that withdrawal from the world (especially in politics) sounds like an appealing option.

Matt on 2016-11-09 at 05:15 said:

All those pundits trying to predict the presidential election would have done themselves a service by reading this post.

9.8 The Holy Knights Templar

It is unnecessary to summarize here the entire history of the **Knights Templar**, which can be found easily enough online, so we will just highlight certain points that are of interest. Ultimately, our goal is to consider the option of a Fourth Order of the Templars.

The Templars conjoined the two greatest archetypes of Tradition: the ascetic and the warrior. As is well-known, the great Church Doctor **St. Bernard of Clairvaux** created the *Rule for the Knights*, adapted for them from the *Rule of St. Benedict*. That is available as *In Praise of the New Knighthood*¹⁶.

Such an order of knights is hardly possible today, first of all because there is no desire among the hierarchy for such a venture. The other obstacle is that the means of warfare have changed so much. The various means for mass destruction have eliminated the role of the Knight. Although the ideal of the warrior ethic still exists, it has been incorporated into the special forces in the military services of secular states.

Nevertheless, the romance of the Knights Templar persists, despite or, in some cases because of, their ignominious end. The Traditionalist order of the Society of Saint Pius X¹⁷ sells an audiolecture *The Knights Templar*¹⁸ as well as a written history, *The Templars: Knights of Christ*¹⁹.

Hence, the last Templar grandmaster, **Jacques de Molay** ought to be a candidate for sainthood as a martyr for the faith. Instead, due to his fabricated condemnation by both Throne and Altar, Freemasonry — the enemy of the Church — has claimed him as one of their founders.

¹⁶http://digiHum.mcgill.ca/~matthew.milner/teaching/resources/docs/clairvaux_newknighthood.pdf

¹⁷<https://sspx.org/en>

¹⁸<https://angeluspress.org/collections/church-teaching/products/knights-templar>

¹⁹<https://angeluspress.org/products/templars-knights-christ>

Ludibrium There are two ways to do history. The ordinary way is two-dimensional, that is, the goal is to describe the relationship of physical events over the course of time. The esoteric way is three-dimensional history which is more concerned with identifying the spiritual forces that underlie material events. Among those factors are “archetypes” which are mythological motifs that manifest themselves repeatedly, in different forms, throughout history. The motif that we are interested in is that of esoteric and exoteric teachings. The esoteric teaching will assert itself, often in apparent opposition to the exoteric teachings. However, our goal is always to unite them.

Following the breakup of the Templars, some of them were absorbed into the **Order of Christ** in Portugal, and others returned to the East where they were first formed. The story is that the Templars reformed as the Rosicrucians who emerged publicly a couple of centuries later. **Johannes Valentinus Andreae** published the *Chymical Wedding of Christian Rosenkreutz*, one of the manifestos of the Rosicrucians. He referred to that document as a *ludibrium*, that is, play. This brings to mind Valentin Tomberg’s ideal of turning work into play. Secular historians will only be satisfied with material connections between events, but the third dimension will look for the reappearance of related ideas. The obvious clue is that a “secret” society will not be publishing manifestos.

The Knights Kadosh **Albert Pike** in the chapter Knight Kadosh²⁰ from *Morals and Dogma* adds to the mythical history of the Templars. He asserts that the first Knights took their vows before the Patriarch of Constantinople. That is incorrect; it was the Patriarch of Jerusalem. He then claims that the Templars had both an esoteric teaching, the Church of John, and an exoteric teaching, the Church of Rome. He implies that the exoteric teaching a smokescreen to hide the true teaching. However, there cannot be any conflict between the esoteric and exoteric teach-

²⁰<http://www.sacred-texts.com/mas/md/md31.htm>

ings. After all, the Templars were quite devout in their exoteric practice.

Nevertheless, the destruction of the Templars did have consequences. Pike claims that a remnant of the Templars continued under the auspices of Freemasonry. Their goal was to “to overturn the Throne and the Altar upon the Tomb of Jacques de Molay”. Having ended the French monarchy, they directed their efforts against the Pope. At the time that Albert Pike was writing, the second part of the task was incomplete. However, were he alive today, he may be less sanguine about the ultimate success of the revolution.

A Dilemma Resolved Pike implies that the revolution was a Pyrrhic victory, since the successor of the Templars perished, i.e., there is no longer a direct — or real — relationship to them. Therefore, we turn instead to the ideal relation²¹ and ask the same question. Pike makes the distinction between the Johannine and the Petrine current in the Templars. By rejecting the Petrine, he implies that the Rosicrucians and Freemasons are the heirs of the Johannine current. However, there has been revealed a more complete way to regard those currents.

The Russian esoterist **Valentin Tomberg** met with some students who had studied under Professor **Gregory Mebes**. In that group there were three grades: Martinist, Templar, and Rosicrucian. Certainly, then, Tomberg was immersed in the Johannine current. Nevertheless, he came to the realization that any doctrine of “two churches” was false. The Church of John was not a rival to the Church of Peter. Rather, their relationship was described this way:

The mission of John is to keep the life and soul of the Church *alive* until the Second Coming of the Lord. This is why John has never claimed and never will claim the office of directing the body of the Church. He *vivifies* this body, but he does not direct its actions.

²¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=8282#relations>

Hence, the spiritual current of the Templars belongs with Rome, although only the SSPX seems willing to revivify that connection.

A Fourth Order A latter-day Templar revival would not be a first, second, or third order, since it is a lay initiative, but a fourth order. The masonic temptation is to build, and this needs to be avoided. Hence, that would rule out much of what is called an “intentional community”. The alternative is a community that grows organically. Instead of a top-down model, that more traditional idea of subsidiarity²² is appropriate. Hence families would develop into phratries, and then tribes, in a natural way.

The Knights Templar was restricted to those already knighted. Moreover, each knight turned over his assets to the community. That would not be appropriate for a lay group. A family corporation²³ of some type would be fairer, and it would make it easier to leave without causing legal problems.

Entryism An Order needs to have a spiritual centre. One viable alternative is to affiliate to an SSPX chapel. Not only would there be a friendly atmosphere for medieval values, but a relatively small group would be able to exert influence. I will offer some specific suggestions in the mailing list.

The Templars survived for two centuries, and their demise was not the result of any internal tension. That is because they inserted themselves into a larger organisation, which granted legitimacy, cohesion, and spiritual support. Self-existing alternative movements today typically claim a factitious membership based either on a non-existent genetic similarity, or else the adherence to some small set of propositions. The first alternative cannot settle legitimate and important differences of opinion, and

²²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2554>

²³<https://info.legalzoom.com/establish-family-corporation-21136.html>

the second alternative is no different from the modern world.

Building an organisation from scratch outside of existing institutions is a daunting task. Even in democratic situations, the formation of new political parties – while theoretically feasible – has been totally ineffective in practice.

Distinctiveness There need to be outward distinctions, while not appearing to be overly eccentric. Obviously, a certain modesty in dress and the avoidance of much of popular culture would be mandatory. In another post, we will adapt the Rule proposed by St. Bernard of Clairvaux to make specific recommendations for lay groups. Of course, there will need to be some latitude for local groups to determine some of their own customs.

Posted on 2017-07-05 by Cologero

* * *

James on 2017-07-05 at 02:26 said:

Thanks for the great post. Looking forward to the next post on the subject.

Aleksandar on 2017-07-05 at 03:42 said:

"The Templars conjoined the two greatest archetypes of Tradition: the ascetic and the warrior."

I've been fascinated by this topic for quite some time. This is much needed today. A purpose for a man of traditional values, physically and mentally trained and disciplined individual, perhaps skilled in martial arts, or at least in tune with the heroic pathos, who at the same time avoids, much as possible, modern day degenerate influences designed to numb down, absorb and dissolve. What is left for him in today's world? One who assimilates two paths which are today artificially divided. Unfortunately, at the gym I mostly witness brutes and meatheads. Same thing with others who indulge in a more physical aspect of life. Who says that you cannot do all of that and same time cultivate your mind – not in a pseudo intellectual way, of course, working on your "brain sharpness" with self help books and pseudo yoga manuals, but through active involvement in the entertainment of higher ideas based on the true traditional knowledge?

Knight is now reduced to a mere expendable, mercenary, a cog in the wheel without a Divine guidance and higher purpose except serving the secular order. Modern day ascetics (not counting monks) are in some way NEETS, hiding away in the shadows but devoid of that Divine impulse to overcome their nihilistic state.

This is why I'm also interested in the phenomena of another archetype which reemerged in last few years (or decades) – a paladin. Similar to a Templar, a popular RPG class played by thousands, if not millions of kids (and adults) across the world in different fantasy video games. Paladin is based on Charlemagne's Twelve Peers, offering an image of ideal, heroic knight whose strength comes through religious devotion and asceticism. Sadly, many of these life options are now limited to a mere fantasy game, a role play. An impulse is certainly there, as evidenced in a certain rise of popularity of medieval knights, military orders and history through the online communities (ignited by the current events in the West, no doubt).

Fred on 2017-07-05 at 06:59 said:

Very good article, I will mention two things that can inspire a reflection.

In the Parsifal of Wolfram von Eschenbach, without a doubt an initiatic poem, the guardians of the Grail are called Templars and have white capes. Eschenbach himself was a knight.

About the remarks of Albert Pike I really want to point to the fact that the direction of the subversive project of modernity is usually closely tied to degenerated initiatic groups. In fact every error of modernity is a perversion of a traditional principle. For example liberty, equality and fraternity. It is explicitly evident in the pantheism of Spinoza and Giordano Bruno, clearly arisen from their own misinterpretations of hermetic and kabbalistic texts. So, freemasonry was the pretorian guard of the anti-traditional enlightenment, as natural for a subverted esotericism. The same can be said for Jews.

willehalminstitute on 2017-07-05 at 12:18 said:

@Fred: The "Templeisen" as they are called in Middel High German in Wolfram's Parzival cannot be the same as the Templars, at most their forerunners, because the Grail events described in Parzival took place in the 9th century, while the Templars only surfaced some two centuries later. I am basing myself on the research by Werner Greub in his book "How the Grail Sites Were Found – Wolfram von Eschenbach as a Historian" (see Grail Sites at <http://www.willehalminstitute.nl>) that I translated and published.

THAT on 2017-07-05 at 18:27 said:

It is a commendable initiative, but the fact that we know so little about the true nature of the secret doctrines and initiations of the original Templars makes the appropriation of the Templar identity by modern groups problematic. It will be based merely on the exoteric Templar image; anything more than that would be speculative.

And if entering into speculation, it is not outside the realm of possibility that the Templars did in fact have secret doctrines and practices, at least for the elite of the order, that were heretical and not merely a harmonious deepening of Catholic Christianity. Evola seemed to believe that much in his 'Mystery of the Grail'. The fact that they were exoterically devout Catholics proves only that they didn't really have any other choice than to pay lip-service to it.

De Molay and the Templars took high interest on loans in their role as bankers, and this at least doesn't add credit to the sainthood account.

What speaks strongly in favour of the Templars is of course Dante's support for them. Charles Upton, in the chapter "The Templars, the Freemasons and the Counter-Initiation" in 'Vectors of the Counter-Initiation', suggests that there may have been within the Templar complex both a stream of corrupted esoterism and a valid Christian current. The Templar-connected stream inverting the resources of their initiatory current for the sake of worldly power would have gone underground and seeded various conspiracies. Much of this is speculation that cannot be proved, but the most vital resources and secrets of the Templars were saved from the persecutors, and I find it hard to believe that the underground stream seeded from this wealth of initiatory empowerment was ever discontinued. I tend to believe this lineage may still be preserved by certain privileged and secretive elitist circles, but perhaps in a corrupted form.

Fred on 2017-07-05 at 19:46 said:

While the role of freemasonry as a counter-initiatic source demand that we at least acknowledge the possibility of counter-initiation and errors among the Templars there are several factors that witness in favour of the Knights.

First of all Dante and St. Bernard, then the fact that they were killed by King Philip IV, the man who did more than anyone else to undermine the two universal authorities of the middle age: the Pope he submitted and brought to Avignon, and the Emperor (France was the first of the great kingdom of Europe to declare the authority of his King as the highest and rejecting any nominal submission to the Emperor).

While a French puppet the Pope even intended to pardon the Templars, as shown in the Chinon parchment.

They were killed by the King who was the living embodiment of the ksatriya revolt against the traditional order of the medieval Christendom/Europe.

THAT on 2017-07-06 at 09:59 said:

St. Bernard marks the beginning of Templar history. I do not think there is any reason to assume they would have been corrupt from the beginning; so the Templar ideal as partly forged by St. Bernard would be valid no matter what eventually developed at the expense of its original purity within the shadows of the Order.

One subject for much speculation has been to what extent they were influenced and changed in their inner orientation and agenda by finds (some of which may have accelerated their rise to massive power; did this power go to their heads?) that they made in the East and by their contacts with various gnostic groups. The Order of Assassins, for example, was counter-initiatic in the extreme.

I am aware that the Templars were pardoned, but this could just as well be interpreted as a political move not necessarily based on objective truth, aimed at keeping the exoteric romantic legacy of Templarism as part of Catholic mythology; once the Templar organisation no longer represented a practical problem, one could conveniently forget about the shadowy esoteric affairs and honour the aspects of Templar history deemed good. I am not saying this has to be the right explanation, but it is a reasonable possibility.

What you say make for a good case, but the fact that corrupt forces are involved in a persecution does not guarantee that the persecuted is not corrupt as well. In all probability the case of the Templars is far more complicated than is allowed for by the one-sidedness often seen both in their accusers and apologists.

Cologero on 2017-07-07 at 22:58 said:

Interesting comments. I'll try to integrate them into another post, but here are some loose ideas in the meantime.

When I was a boy, one of my favorite TV shows was about a Paladin: *Have Gun, Will Travel*²⁴. The archetype is surely alive and doay, although hardly manifestable in the modern world, maybe like Junger's ideal of the Anarch. Unfortunately, it seems that in today's pop culture, that ideal has deteriorated to a wise-cracking wise guy, nearly indistinguishable from a sociopath.

The widespread image of Jacques de Molay depicts him with long hair and wearing a long flowing robe. St. Bernard specifically rejected that image of the Knight, and insisted the Templars keep their hair short. The lesson: be wary of any historical reconstructions of the Knights.

As for their sanctity, Bernard referred to the Knights as "holy martyrs". The contemporary witnesses to Molay's execution regarded him as a martyr, and collected relics. So the idea of sainthood is not so far fetched. Usury is more subtle. Perhaps you can categorize the Templars as usurers, if you regard their fees a mere "loopholes". The argument contra usury, it seems, is based on the misconception that money is constant. If I borrow a cup of sugar, I can return a cup of sugar in 6 months. I can bake a pie now and you can bake one using the same recipe in 6 months. But if I borrow \$5 to buy a bag of sugar now, there is no guarantee that you will be able to buy a bag of sugar when I return the \$5 in 6 months.

I think there is a misunderstanding about the esoteric/exoteric distinction. Without using those specific terms, Bernard alludes to the distinction several times in his "In Praise of the New

²⁴<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HAoE0hsGJyU>

Knighthood".E.g., he wrote "we must not let this literal interpretation blind us to the spiritual meaning of the texts [i.e., scriptures]". He mentioned how the commoners would receive the "milk" of doctrine, while the Knights would understand the "meat". The latter would include the recognition of the divinity in man and the spiritual sense hidden beneath the written word. The point is that the esoteric and exoteric are intimately related, even if the former is reserved for the few. Fundamentally, the esoteric is not some new "secret" doctrine, but rather a much deeper understanding of the exoteric doctrine. Anything else is subversion.

Please consider the distinction made between real and ideal relationships. We are not looking for an ongoing material secret transmission ["real"] of the Knights, but rather the reappearance in space-time of transcendent archetypes ["ideal"].

THAT on 2017-07-08 at 08:15 said:

I concur with your understanding of the exoteric-esoteric spectrum. Obviously I didn't mean to imply that 'esoterism' amongst the Templars must naturally and inevitably I have been some heretical 'secret doctrine' and so on, only that it is quite possible that the Order might at some point have come to secretly house such subversive elements, that would have inverted the original esoteric intention to some degree.

The "meat of doctrine" to which you refer was most clearly expressed in the case of Meister Eckhart, and that didn't go so well for him; this is the greatest weakness of Catholicism, as it leads exactly to the formation of "secret doctrines" that may become subversive, when the church doesn't allow for a smooth and continuous transition to open esoterism that is accepted as a deepening of exoteric doctrine.

I am not so knowledgeable about the question of usury, but you—and I apologize if I misunderstand you here—seem to be making too lightly of it; both Christianity and Islam have taken a rigorously strict approach to the question from the beginning, and this is because usury is a means that belongs to the Enemy. Any organisation touching upon it makes a compromise with him.

Speaking of the Enemy—and relating to your mentioning of entryism—it would be valuable to consider how this 'order-to-be' might guard itself against the infiltration of agents of subversion, of whom there is a never-ending supply these days.

I understand what you explain about 'real' and 'ideal' relationships, and that the ideal and archetypal relationship is intended in the case of this project; I only expressed the suspicion that an actual uninterrupted Templar transmission of some kind may still be running underground as part of "occult" elite operations. The possibility must be kept in the back of the mind as such forces might take special notice of any rising contemporary 'movement' connecting with the Templar archetype.

Fred on 2017-07-08 at 15:40 said:

I always felt the “meat of doctrine” much more in line with Catholicism in the allegorical esotericism of Amor than in Eckhart.

Maybe this is because I’m Italian but I see Dante, the *Roman de la Rose* and chivalric novels more closer to St. Bernard. As a cultural expression it feels much closer.

Eckhart was a German spirit, his emphasis on detachment feels almost Buddhist to me. His problems with the Inquisition were caused by the words he used: alien words to the culture of Latin Christianity.

Old Chap on 2017-07-09 at 12:32 said:

The downfall of the Templars shows us that such Orders and their slavish adherence to certain values is foolish in a world and a time where authentic, not superficial morality is a rarity. Since we live in a world without morals and just laws (where they exist on paper they are not followed in reality), all of these old sacred designs are simply impossible on any substantial scale. The fault lies with human nature which is markedly flawed, rather than a nonexistent elite which will never appear (still waiting for Christ’s return and all the other prophesied saviors of mankind). Faith alone does not supersede reality no matter how much one wishes otherwise. Chivalry is dead because there is no longer a use for it, as it would be an undeserved relic for a people more concerned with gossip and “winning” and consumerism and the endless array of meaningless “activities” and entertainments. (Just my two pence.)

Harharkh on 2017-07-10 at 14:55 said:

You live in fantasy land, old man.

Cologero on 2017-07-10 at 21:35 said:

Yes, grasshopper, and when you realize the illusory nature of your own existence, then you, too, may become enlightened.

9.9 The Symbolism of the Horse

Try as I might, I never made my wife happy. So I made it my task to learn how to please a woman. I then was able to please a dozen women, although it never made me happy. So I became an itinerant horse trader.

MULLAH NASRUDDIN

Guenon tells us in *Symbols of Sacred Science* that the Horse represents the Sun or Agni, and hence is a solar symbol. He also makes reference to this passage from Revelation 19:14-15:

And the armies that are in heaven followed him Christ on white horses, clothed in fine linen, white and clean. And out of his mouth goes a sharp two-edged sword, that with it, he may strike the nations.

Similarly, according to the Puranas, Kalki, the final avatar, will also come riding on a white horse at the end of the Kali Yuga, wielding a sword, to punish the nations.

On a more prosaic note, in pre-industrial times, the horse signified mobility (it was the quickest way to get around), abundance (it was costly to maintain a horse and develop skills in horsemanship), and power (the horse was effective in battle). Ramon Lull called the horse the “most noble of beasts”.

Ramon Lull is an interesting figure in the history of Chivalry. He was a knight born to wealth, who lived a rather dissolute life. Later in life, he had a “conversion” and he devoted his life to philosophy and God. His biographer claimed that Lull was a Hermeticist, a judgment that is certainly compatible with his written works. In *Perspectives on Initiation*, Guenon tells us:

Within a single organization, a kind of double hierarchy can exist, especially when the apparent leaders are themselves unaware of any link to a spiritual center. In such cases there may exist beside the visible hierarchy made up by those apparent leaders, an invisible hierarchy of which the members may not fulfil any ‘official’ function but who, by their presence alone, nonetheless assure an effective liaison with this center. In the more exterior organizations these representatives of the spiritual centers obviously need not reveal themselves as such ...

Interestingly enough, these “invisible” spiritual leaders often worked as jugglers and **horse traders**. One can certainly speculate that Lull came into contact with one of these so-called horse traders, from whom he learned Hermetic science.

Finally, this is what Lull wrote about the Knight’s horse in his *Book of Knighthood and Chivalry*, an instruction manual for young knights written in his later years:

The Knight’s Horse: Noblesse of Courage

To a knight is given a horse, and also a courser to signify noblesse of courage. And because he is well horsed and high is why he may be seen to be free from fear. And that is the significance, that he ought to be made ready to do all that which behooves the order of chivalry more than another man would. To a horse is given a bridle. And the reigns of the bridle are given to the hands of a knight because the knight may at his own will hold the course the horse and refrain him. And this signifies that the knight ought to refrain his tongue, and hold that he speaks neither foul nor false. And it signifies that he ought to refrain his hands, that he gives not so much that he is suffrour and needy. And that he begs or asks not; nor ought he be so hardy that in his hardiness he has reason and temperance.

Posted on 2010-03-06 by Cologero

* * *

Vijay Kumar on 2010-03-06 at 22:51 said:

When do we expect coming of Bhagavan Kalki... an *Avatar*²⁵ of present era... a messiah competent to uplift Dharma (righteousness)! In times of strife... when mutual trust amongst each other reaches its lowest ebb... coming of a messiah (Avatar) gets necessitated! Even man gods like Mahavira, Gautama Buddha, Jesus Christ or Prophet Mohammed fail in such circumstances!

²⁵<http://www.godrealized.org/Avatar.html>

*Who shall be Bhagavan Kalki*²⁶ is the biggest question! Coming of a man god coupled with powers of Chanakya (most able administrator in history of mankind) is only solution! Humanity looks forward to such a one... an ordinary mortal that against all odds upholds Dharma (righteousness) and succeeds in re-establishing peace tranquility abound!

GFJF on 2010-03-09 at 05:12 said:

My thanks. An interesting fact I ran across in Dumézil's 'Archaic Roman Religion' is that it was forbidden alike for the brahman and the roman priest of Jupiter to touch horses. According to Dumézil the horse was the animal of Mars and Indra (what relation to Agni?).

GFJF on 2010-03-09 at 05:36 said:

Ah, I see they are closely related.

<http://www.sacred-texts.com/hin/rigveda/rv06060.htm>

Max on 2015-02-14 at 07:38 said:

That priests are not to touch horses are significant. There are two possible interpretations as to the symbolism of the roman legionnaires helmet crests: the mane of a boar or the mane of a horse. In Norse mythology Freyr's boar is called Gullinbursti (Golden mane):

"... to Freyr he gave the boar, saying that it could run through air and water better than any horse, and it could never become so dark with night or gloom of the Murky Regions that there should not be sufficient light where he went, such was the glow from its mane and bristles."

The priestly equivalent of a knight's horse is the boar. Guenon in his essay "The Wild Boar and the Bear" relates the symbol of the boar directly to the primordial tradition explaining how Borea means "land of the wild boar". If a previous boar-symbolism is replaced by horse-symbolism it may mark a shift of focus from sacerdotal to martial function. The original meaning of wearing the helmet crests could then be interpreted as "Guardians of the Holy Land". In ancient times horses ran free as the wind across Eurasia, untouched by men, which means desire was pure.

9.10 Heroes and Vibhuti

A happy life is impossible; the highest to which man can attain is an heroic course of life.

ARTHUR SCHOPENHAUER

²⁶http://www.vijaykumar.org/who_shall_be_bhagavan_kalki.html

Then said his Lordship, “Well. God mend all!” – “Nay, by God, Donald, we must help him to mend it!” said the other.

THOMAS CARLYLE, *Epigraph to Latter-Day Pamphlets*

The Great Man was always as lightning out of Heaven; the rest of men waited for him like fuel, and then they too would flame.

THOMAS CARLYLE

Suckers try to win arguments, nonsuckers try to win.

FAT TONY

Avatars In *Letters on Yoga*, **Sri Aurobindo** describes the Avatar as the “one who comes to open the Way for humanity to a higher consciousness.” The primary exemplars he mentions are Krishna, Buddha, and Christ, a theme that Valentin Tomberg developed in his quest for the Bodhisattva. Although Avatars have “the knowledge necessary for their work, they need not have more.” Specifically, they need not know facts or theories that have no bearing on their mission, and should not be judged by those extraneous standards.

Furthermore, it is not the outer events of their lives that matter most, but rather “the spiritual Reality, the Power, the Influence that came with him or that he brought down by his action and his existence.” Hence, the outward events of Christ’s life are not as important as the spiritual power that has manifested long after his time. The hylic man is only concerned with the historical and material.

Vibhuti The Vibhuti, on the other hand, needs not to be aware of being a power of the Divinity. Nevertheless, he does embody some aspect of the divine, and “is enabled by it to act with great force in the world.”

When judged by human standards, the Vibhuti may not be recognized as such. Aurobindo explains that

they are not concerned with morality or immorality, perfection or imperfection according to small human standards or setting an example to men or showing new moral attitudes or giving new spiritual teachings. These things may or may not be done, but they are not at all the essence of the matter.

Vibhutis may be saints and sage, but they may also be men of action like a Julius Caesar or a Napoleon. There should be no surprises here since Caesar is considered one of the Nine Worthies²⁷. Aurobindo explains that their faults don't matter:

But do you really believe that men like Napoleon, Caesar ... were not great men and did nothing for the world or for the cosmic purpose? that God was deterred from using them for His purpose because they had defects of character and vices? What a singular idea!

The Idea of the Hero Thomas Carlyle has written about Vibhutis, at least of a certain type, in *On Heroes, Hero-worship, and the Heroic in History*. This study is of value, Carlyle says, because

Universal History, the history of what man has accomplished in this world, is at bottom the History of the Great Men who have worked here. They were the leaders of men, these great ones; the modelers, patterns, and in a wide sense creators, of whatsoever the general mass of men contrived to do or to attain; all things that we see standing accomplished in the world are properly the outer material result, the practical realization and embodiment, of Thoughts that dwelt in the Great Men sent into the world:

²⁷http://www.traditioninaction.org/religious/h097_Worthies.html

the soul of the whole world's history, it may justly be considered, were the history of these.

Now some of Carlyle's heroes are not at all appealing to me, and perhaps not to others. For example, I would oppose Oliver Cromwell. Moreover, Cromwell excited a derangement syndrome in his era: his dead body was exhumed, "executed", and decapitated, the head being publically displayed for years. But that is not the point. Rather, we should ask, "did he create history?" or "what do we learn about leadership from him?"

Carlyle chooses his heroes from their roles in the world. Oddly, the sequence of roles represents a sort of "degeneration" of castes. For example, the first is the Hero as Divinity, exemplified by **Odin**, a man-god who articulated a spiritual vision of the world. Next is the Hero as Prophet, no longer a man-god, but rather a messenger of God. This is **Mohammed**, whom Carlyle regards on a par with the Hebrew prophets of the Old Testament. **Dante** and **Shakespeare** are heroes as the inspired Poet. **Luther** and **Knox** represent the Hero as Priest; **Johnson**, **Rousseau**, and **Burns**, the Hero as the Man of Letters; and finally, **Cromwell** and **Napoleon** as the Hero as King. The word King means the "one who can". The Hero begins with a god who reveals the inner nature of the Universe to the Scandinavians, continues with those who are the Prophet, the Poet, the Priest of God, and concludes with those who are active in the world.

Religion

A man's religion is the chief fact with regard to him. A man's, or a nation of men's.

Carlyle does not mean by religion simply a man's nominal affiliation. Incessant debates over creeds do not penetrate deeper than a man's "argumentative region". The religious impulse goes much deeper:

The thing a man does practically believe (and this is often enough without asserting it even to himself, much less to others); the thing a man does practically lay to heart, and know for certain, concerning his vital relations to this mysterious Universe, and his duty and destiny there, that is in all cases the primary thing for him, and creatively determines all the rest.

That is because:

The thoughts they had were the parents of the actions they did; their feelings were parents of their thoughts: it was the unseen and spiritual in them that determined the outward and actual.

So Carlyle tries to get to the soul feeling of a religion, not its professed creed. As examples, he points out the characteristic feelings of various religious impulses:

- **Heathenism:** plurality of gods, sensuous representation of the Mystery of Life, physical force as the chief element. A recognition of the forces of Nature as godlike, stupendous, personal Agencies.
- **Christianism:** faith in an Invisible, not as real only, but as the only reality. Time, through every meanest moment of it, resting on Eternity; Pagan empire of Force displaced by a nobler supremacy, that of Holiness.
- **Scepticism:** uncertainty and inquiry whether there was an Unseen World, any Mystery of Life except a mad one.

Such core concepts determine the course of a man's—or a nation's—life. Carlyle dismisses two common theories about the origins of Religion, that are still common today.

- **Quackery.** The first is that it is quackery, a contrivance deliberately fabricated to get other men to follow. Perhaps quackery is a factor in the decline of religion, but at its origin, religion had to reach something deep in man in order to take hold.
- **Allegory.** The second is that religion is merely allegorical. That would make of religion a game, a sport. But a man's life is not a game, nor will a sane man give up his life for an allegory. A man does not live by a clever allegory, but rather by his deeply held view of the Universe. First there is faith, and only afterward can there be an allegory.

Carlyle then turns to Plato's cave. A man escapes from the cave and in astonishment suddenly sees the world anew, the same world that everyone else just takes for granted. Such a man would experience the world as beautiful, awful, and unspeakable. He would experience it directly, and not through the verbal superstructure of words and theories that promise to explain the world to us, but in actuality merely obscure its deep mystery.

Carlyle claims that Odin was such a man who stepped out of the cave. What others may have been feeling, yet unable to articulate, was brought to light by Odin. Carlyle explains:

the great Thinker came, the original man, the Seer; whose shaped spoken Thought awakes the slumbering capability of all into Thought. It is ever the way with the Thinker, the spiritual Hero. What he says, all men were not far from saying, were longing to say.

A thought, once awakened, does not slumber again. Odin gave his people the assurance of their destiny, he solved for them the riddle of life. There was also a recognition of the tragic sense of life:

They seem to have seen, these brave old Northmen, what Meditation has taught all men in all ages, That this world is after all but a show—a phenomenon or appearance, no real thing. All deep souls see into that—the Hindoo Mythologist, the German Philosopher, the Shakespeare, the earnest Thinker, wherever he may be: “We are such stuff as Dreams are made of!”

The Character of the Hero There is no point in reviewing each of the representative men selected by Carlyle as a Hero. The better course instead is to specify precisely what they represent, i.e., their characters. Carlyle reveals their essences which are easy to miss, given the harsh criticism that is the other side of being a Hero. Sceptics may call such a man false. Yet, how can a falsehood motivate millions of men for decades, centuries, even millennia? If the false is unnatural, then the Hero is **natural**. Carlyle explains:

A man must conform himself to Nature’s laws, be verily in communion with Nature and the truth of things, or Nature will answer him, No, not at all!

Moreover, he is **sincere**, his acts are not calculated:

the Great Man does not boast himself sincere, far from that; perhaps does not ask himself if he is so: I would say rather, his sincerity does not depend on himself; he cannot help being sincere!

That leads to the primary definition of the Great Man:

a deep, great, genuine sincerity, is the first characteristic of all men in any way heroic. Not the sincerity that calls itself sincere; ah no, that is a very poor matter indeed;—a shallow braggart conscious sincerity; oftenest self-conceit mainly. The Great Man’s sincerity is of the kind he cannot speak of, is not conscious of: nay, I suppose, he is conscious rather of insincerity; for what man can walk

accurately by the law of truth for one day? No, the Great Man does not boast himself sincere, far from that; perhaps does not ask himself if he is so: I would say rather, his sincerity does not depend on himself; he cannot help being sincere! The great Fact of Existence is great to him. Fly as he will, he cannot get out of the awful presence of this Reality. His mind is so made; he is great by that, first of all. Fearful and wonderful, real as Life, real as Death, is this Universe to him. Though all men should forget its truth, and walk in a vain show, he cannot. At all moments the Flame image glares in upon him; undeniable, there, there!

Thus, the Great Man is **original**, a messenger from the Infinite Unknown, whether as a god, a prophet, or a poet:

the words he utters are as no other man's words. Direct from the Inner Fact of things—he lives, and has to live, in daily communion with that. ... *It is from the heart of the world that he comes; he is portion of the primal reality of things.* God has made many revelations: but this man too, has not God made him, the latest and newest of all? The “inspiration of the Almighty giveth him understanding:” we must listen before all to him.

In many cases, his voice cannot be heard, as it is drowned out by the Idols of the Marketplace and the Idols of the Theatre²⁸. Lesser men cannot think beyond the known, or better said, beyond what they believe they know.

Faults Critics of the Hero typically focus on the man's **faults**, real or alleged. Lesser men believe that to be the way to truth while in fact it is a barrier to a higher truth. A Great Woman, **St. Teresa d'Avila**, in *The Way of Perfection* admonishes us:

²⁸<http://www.sirbacon.org/links/4idols.htm>

Look not on our faults.

The way to perfection is the overcoming of faults. Perfection is the goal, not the means. The very fear of faults is itself paralyzing. **Pope Francis** recently said:

Not taking risks, please, no... prudence... Obeying all the commandments, all of them... Yes, it's true, but this paralyzes you too, it makes you forget so many graces received, it takes away memory, it takes away hope, because it doesn't allow you to go forward.

Carlyle, too, understands this when he writes:

On the whole, we make too much of faults; the details of the business hide the real centre of it. Faults? The greatest of faults, I should say, is to be conscious of none.

Carlyle gives the example of King David as a Hero with faults, yet is the epitome of holiness. Faults are but the outward sign of an inner struggle:

The inner secret of it, the remorse, temptations, true, often-baffled, never-ended struggle of it ... In this wild element of a Life, he has to struggle onwards; now fallen, deep-abased; and ever, with tears, repentance, with bleeding heart, he has to rise again, struggle again still onwards. That his struggle be a faithful unconquerable one: that is the question of questions. We will put up with many sad details, if the soul of it were true.

Aurobindo is emphatic on this point. In our fallen world, there will be privations. Since privations, defects, and vices, are non-being, they should not be the focus. He writes:

Why should the Divine care about the vices of great men? Is he a policeman? So long as one is in the ordinary nature, one has qualities and defects, virtues and vices. When one goes beyond, there are no virtues and vices,—for these things do not belong to the Divine Nature.

Rather than a defect, the vices of the Vibhutis may be a necessary accompaniment, the shadow side perhaps, of their mission in the world. The reason that the vices of ordinary men are not as noticeable is because their entire lives are unremarkable. Aurobindo expresses it this way:

Men with great capacities or a powerful mind or a powerful vital have very often more glaring defects of character than ordinary men—or at least the defects of the latter do not show so much, being like themselves, smaller in scale.

Of course, a low energy person will never become great. Aurobindo concludes:

The great men have more energy and the energy comes out in what men call vices as well as in what men call virtues.

The Valet

No man is a Hero to his valet.

French saying

If that is so, Carlyle asserts that it is not the fault of the Hero, but rather a limitation of the Valet. The latter has a “valet-soul”.

The Valet does not know a Hero when he sees him!

That applies to the Sceptic, also. Carlyle makes this comparison:

The Valet expected purple mantles, gilt sceptres, bodyguards and flourishes of trumpets: the Sceptic of the Eighteenth century looks for regulated respectable Formulas, “Principles,” or what else he may call them; a style of speech and conduct which has got to seem “respectable,” which can plead for itself in a handsome articulate manner, and gain the suffrages of an enlightened sceptical Eighteenth century!

The passing centuries have changed nothing in this regard. The Valet soul of the 21st century is like that of the 18th. They can only be impressed by outward trappings and appearances. If anything, Sceptics today abound more than ever. As a matter of fact, it is a badge of honour to be a Sceptic. The Sceptic rejects anyone who doesn’t think, speak, or act in a way the Sceptic considers respectable. Neither the Valet nor the Sceptic can see the obvious:

The sincere alone can recognize sincerity.

Unfortunately, a world of Valets and Sceptics will hinder the Hero:

Not a Hero only is needed, but a world fit for him; a world not of Valets;—the Hero comes almost in vain to it otherwise! ... We shall either learn to know a Hero, a true Governor and Captain, somewhat better, when we see him; or else go on to be forever governed by the Unheroic.

Aurobindo gives us a similar warning:

People have begun to try to prove that great men were not great, which is a very big mistake. If greatness is not appreciated by men, the world will become mean, small, dull, narrow and tamasic.

Summary To understand more deeply than the Valet and the Sceptic, it is necessary to be attuned to God's activity in the world, which is the third dimension of History. Thus, human, all-too-human, standards are insufficient. Aurobindo describes it this way:

The Divinity acts according to another consciousness—the consciousness of the Truth above and the Lila below and it acts according to the need of the Lila, not according to men's ideas of what it should or should not do. This is the first thing one must grasp, otherwise one can understand nothing about the manifestation of the Divine.

Aurobindo agrees with Carlyle that falsehoods, shams, or quackeries will lack any spiritual impact on the world:

The Divine does not need to suffer or struggle for himself; if he takes on these things it is in order to bear the world-burden and help the world and men; and if the sufferings and struggles are to be of any help, they must be real. A sham or falsehood cannot help. They must be as real as the struggles and sufferings of men themselves

Hence, God works through the laws and conditions that he created. Aurobindo puts it this way:

The Divine Consciousness is omnipotent but it has put forth the instrumental personality in Nature, under the conditions of Nature, and it uses it according to the rules of the game —though also sometimes to change the rules of the game. If Avatarhood is only a flashing miracle, then I have no use for it. If it is a coherent part of the arrangement of the omnipresent Divine in Nature, then I can understand and accept it.

Jesus fed the multitudes with the loaves and fishes, but he did not eliminate Poverty. He cured the sick, but did not banish Disease. He raised Lazarus from the dead, yet did not end physical death. If you always need miracles or unusual events to prove the action of God in the world, you will be sure to miss it. Ultimately, we should not look for a material transformation of the world, but rather a spiritual transformation. The subtle rules the dense, and the outer is a manifestation of the inner. Aurobindo concludes:

Whatever is significant in the outward life is so because it is a symbol of what has been realised within himself and one may go on and say that the inner life also is only significant as an expression, a living representation of the movement of the Divinity behind it. ... The teachings of Christ and Buddha are spiritually true not as mere mental teachings but as the expression of spiritual states or happenings in them which by their life on earth they made possible.

Posted on 2017-08-08 by Cologero

* * *

James on 2017-08-09 at 05:06 said:
Thanks for another great post.

Fred on 2017-08-09 at 15:38 said:
“his dead body was exhumed, “executed”, and decapitated, the head being publically displayed for years. But that is not the point.”

I wish they did that in France with Voltaire and Rousseau, but instead they let them stay in pantheon with the punishment of listening to mass every day, until a new generation of revolutionaries freed them and honoured them again.

Matt on 2020-08-08 at 19:21 said:
I recently came across the Methodist theologian and educator Joseph Wesley Mathews. The following words could very well describe the Vibhuti:

From the book *Bending History*, he says that history is "... that movement from the No Longer to the Not Yet. History is not some philosophy à la Marx and Hegel, something you learned in school years ago, which you either flow with or get ground beneath. No, history is that going-onness where human decisions are made. ... wherever you have this going-onness between the No Longer and the Not Yet, there you have the elite cadre in civilization."

And from a talk he gave:

"We are going to visit the arena of Profound Humanness called "Integrity". Sometimes "integrity" is reduced to mean a kind of moral uprightness and steadfastness, in the sense of saying, "He has too much integrity to ever take a bribe."

But profound integrity goes far beyond this. Sometimes, in order to distinguish it from more limited popular usage, it is called "secondary integrity". This is the integrity which is not constrained by limited moralities, however well-intentioned. The integrity that is profound living is the singularity of thrust of a life committed and ordering every dimension of the self towards that commitment. Thus the self is in fact shaped by the self, and focused towards that commitment. You can say that an audacious creation of the self takes place in integrity, without which you are simply the creation of the various forces impacting you in your society.

Thus the basis of integrity is a destinal resolve – a resolve that chooses and sets your destiny and out of which your whole life is ordered. The object of that resolve is the ultimate decision of each person, and each person makes that choice, consciously or unconsciously. To do so with awareness is the height of man's responsibility. It is incarnate freedom. It is what real freedom looks like.

When man has thus exercised his freedom he realizes that to be true to himself ever thereafter he has a unique position to look at the values of his society. He is no longer bound by the opinions and codes of his fellow-man, but reevaluates then on the basis of their impact on his destinal resolve.

Thus the man of integrity is continuously engaged in a societal transvaluation, a moving across the values of society and reinterpreting them in line with his life's thrust. It does not give him the liberty of ignoring his society, but his obligation transcends the conformity of living within the codes and mores of his society. Thus the man of profound integrity always seems to not quite fit with his fellow-men, but his actions always are appropriate for him, even to those who oppose him.

No matter how odd the man of profound integrity appears to his neighbors, he experiences himself as securely anchored. While he is very clear that this world is not his home, nevertheless he experiences himself as having found his native vale. He experiences an eternal at-one-ness, not so much with the currents and waves of activity around him, but with the deeper trends of history itself. Amid the flux of wavering to and fro that is so evident in others, he experiences an inexplicable rootedness, as though he has sunk a taproot deep into the foundations of the earth itself. Though he experiences his life as a long journey, even an endless journey, towards

the object of his resolve, yet he never senses himself as a stranger on the journey. It's as if he'd been there before. Original integrity is experienced primarily by this sense of at-one-ness.

Kierkegaard once wrote a book about this kind of integrity that he titled, "Purity of Heart is to Will One Thing". An ancient philosopher focused his wisdom around this integrity with the advice, "Know yourself, and to your own self, be true."

10.1 The Frankfurt School

It seems, judging from the amount of attention it gets, that the Frankfurt school is better known, at least in name, among those on the “right” than those on the left who are allegedly influenced by its doctrines. Its founders were Horkheimer and Adorno, two basically unreadable authors. Then there was Herbert Marcuse, the idol of the New Left, and Eric Fromm, who was able to transpose many of their ideas into the idiom of popular culture.

The fundamental technique of the school is to combine the doctrines of Sigmund Freud and Karl Marx in a coherent system. It is important to understand the attraction of this doctrine. In any spiritual teaching — and I include the Frankfurt school, since it reflects a battle of minds — first the problem must be defined, and then a solution proposed. The problem is defined as widespread human misery resulting from inequalities. The solution, in conformity with the socialist mindset¹, is to locate

¹See Section ?? in this book.

it in social structures.

By means of Marxist theory, they move Freudianism out of the individual into the collectivity: the cause of oppression is not one's own superego, but rather the patriarchy that forms the superego. Thus, revolution against the established system of the patriarchy will lead to freedom; that is, the elimination of the internalized patriarchal values that create conflict in the individual, will lead to the free self-expression of the id in the pursuit of its instinctual pleasures. This revolutionary attitude is now commonplace, and even a "moderate" like Al Gore, can tell students to ignore their parents.

Obviously, this point of view is completely opposed to Tradition. In it, there is no transcendence and the primacy of instinct is the opposite of the control of the appetites by the spirit. Nevertheless, although the school is false in what it denies, there may be some truth in what it asserts. Even Julius Evola concedes that Freudian and Marxian analyses can apply to contemporary mass man as he is. Since the mass man has no sense of transcendence, particularly self-transcendence, nor any awareness of the role of Will in creating the circumstances of his life, he is open to see the sources to his basic dissatisfaction as coming from outside himself. The reinforcement of this attitude leads to resentment against hierarchical authority; the promise of the satisfaction of instinctual needs leads to support.

So, it should be obvious that the Frankfurt school in itself is not the problem. It is merely the latest phase of revolutionary thought that began with the Reformation and continued with the French and Russian revolutions. Since there are precious few that hold a complete counter-revolutionary mindset, there is little of intellectual depth able to point out where the school is false. There are attempts to oppose it on the basis of such factors as economic policies, genetics, religion (predominantly non-traditional), or race. However, none of these are "radical", that is,

they do not get to the roots of proper thinking. Take this quiz² again and see where you really stand.

Posted on 2010-04-01 by Cologero

10.2 Bonfire of the Vanities

Savonarola and Machiavelli in Florence.

Christianity has not been tried and found wanting; it has been found difficult and not tried.

GILBERT CHESTERTON

Chesterton must have failed to consider **Girolamo Savonarola** when he penned that line. First of all, there is no merit in a religion that is not worth trying. Second, every path is difficult, from the yoga path of **Patanjali**, to the eightfold path of **Buddha**, even the **Old Religion**. In all of them, there is devotion, duty, action, and wisdom. Only an egalitarian thinks that everyone must succeed the same way. Isn't that why we honor our Saints, Heroes, and Sages because some excel and point the way?

I won't repeat the history of Savonarola's rise to be Capo of Florence; those unfamiliar with that piece of history can easily look it up. In brief, Savonarola passed up the "easy life" in his father's business. The bourgeois life of family and property had no appeal to him; but tradition did, so he chose the path of a Dominican monk. Driven by an intransigent piety, he was unaffected by the lures of money, sex, and power, much like **Dostoyevsky's** idiot Prince. He was blessed [plagued?] with apocalyptic visions [hallucinations?] which came from God. These were the source of his power and his torment.

²See Section 21.1 in this book.

Initially, he did not stand out, but over time he became known for his devoutness and he attracted a devoted following to his fiery and inspiring sermons. A series of events including the death of Lorenzo de Medici, the invasion from France and the rebellion of Pisa led to a power vacuum which he was called upon to fill. Although Florence was at the peak of its economic power and the center of the intellectual Renaissance, this return to a Medieval cast of mind still appealed to a large portion of the public. As a sort of priest-king, he outlawed usury, made sodomy a capital crime (causing many in the upper crust to flee), and engaged roving street gangs to enforce moral codes. He is most known for the **Bonfire of the Vanities**, where citizens were encouraged to rid themselves of secular, sinful and vain items.

Was this truly the difficult Christian life Chesterton described? If so, was it truly that much different from life in the Ancient City? Evola regarded Savonarola as the last attempt of the ancient Aryan-Roman spirit to reassert itself amidst the decadence of the humanism of the Renaissance.

Eventually, Savonarola got in trouble with the Pope for pointing out the latter's immoralities and was driven from power; he, along with two younger monks, were burned. A young man in Florence, **Niccolo Machiavelli** was an acute observer of the rise and fall of Savonarola. As long as the people believed in him, Savonarola could rule; but when their faith faltered, he fell. Unburdened by a belief in the supernatural, Machiavelli wrote his impressions in the Prince.

if we desire to discuss this matter thoroughly, to inquire whether these innovators can rely on themselves or have to depend on others: that is to say, whether, to consummate their enterprise, have they to use prayers or can they use force? In the first instance they always succeed badly, and never compass anything; but when they can rely on themselves and use force, then they are rarely endangered. Hence it is that all armed prophets have conquered,

and the unarmed ones have been destroyed. Besides the reasons mentioned, the nature of the people is variable, and whilst it is easy to persuade them, it is difficult to fix them in that persuasion. And thus it is necessary to take such measures that, when they believe no longer, it may be possible to make them believe by force.

If Moses, Cyrus, Theseus, and Romulus had been unarmed they could not have enforced their constitutions for long — as happened in our time to Fra Girolamo Savonarola, who was ruined with his new order of things immediately the multitude believed in him no longer, and he had no means of keeping steadfast those who believed or of making the unbelievers to believe.

In *The Man of the Renaissance*, Ralph Roeder offers up his own opinions. He writes regarding the failure of this experiment in Florence:

Christianity and life were incompatible. What had goodness to do with life or compassion with nature? The only true solution was the renunciation of the world and the real core of his creed was death.

Roeder has identified the issue in spite of himself. Although Evola would hardly use the words “goodness” and “compassion”, isn’t he in some way close to Savonarola? However, to oppose nature, one must be hard, not compassionate. They agree that the true solution lies in renunciation, but that should lead to a higher, heroic life, not to death.

Yet Roeder follows Machiavelli in believing they are returning to paganism, although it is closer to the type of neopaganism that Evola opposes. Roeder makes this claim:

In the cramped past, in the poverty and ignorance of the Middle Ages, it had been possible perhaps for so unworldly a faith to

flourish; but with the affluence and culture the world had outgrown the ascetic faith of its forefathers and rediscovered, in the Classic Revival, that of its ancestors, for whom the first and last law was the satisfaction of life. Life — imperfect, ruthless, lusty, lawless — was richly enough, and the only mastery of nature lay in its imitation.

Yet, there is an inconsistency in Roeder when he writes of Machiavelli's view of the Ancient Romans:

The secret of their success was their virtue, that virile virtue — courage, energy, skill, resourcefulness, strength — which was the power of a man to function efficiently and fulfill his purpose. And since patriotism was his purpose, whatever impeded it — humanity or personal scruples — must be sacrificed with a robust conscience to the general welfare.

One cannot possess the virtues, while remaining obsessed with lusts and the “satisfaction of life”. And where there is lawlessness, someone must lay down the law.

Posted on 2011-07-21 by Cologero

* * *

Perennial on 2011-07-22 at 04:27 said:

I may be speaking vainly here, but Savonarola always struck me as a bit of a revolutionary figure himself. He certainly had heroic aspects about him, but is he really a counter-revolutionary? Established history does not seem to view him as such. A revisionism, perhaps?

Cologero on 2011-07-22 at 12:58 said:

Although we never specifically mentioned the term counter-revolutionary, Perennial, perhaps you are inferring that. After all, the Renaissance is one of the earliest stages of the on-going revolution. Hence, any opposition to that is part of the counter-revolution. Roeder seems to agree with that, since he regards the Renaissance as a rejection of the ignorant Middle Ages,

while Savonarola as a revert to that more Traditional age. Evola regards Savonarola as the last attempt to recover an earlier antique consciousness in opposition to the falsity of the Renaissance. (This is something known only by readers of Gornahoor in the Anglosphere, since it is a passing reference in one of his untranslated books.)

So, it is really up to you to show how Evola and Roeder misunderstand Savonarola and why we should lump him in, instead, with the likes of Luther, Robespierre, and Lenin.

Perennial on 2011-07-22 at 13:58 said:

I am going to cite wikipedia here, not because I think it is a fantastic source, but because it normally reflects the general understanding of a subject:

"Savonarola's religious actions have been compared to those of the later 17th and 18th century Jansenists, although theologically many differences exist. Savonarola did not produce a theological doctrine on salvation, and faithfully adhered to even minor theological definitions of the papal Magisterium. However, Savonarola's call to simplicity in church interior and his rigorous moral stances have been compared to those of Jansenists. Also the insistence on the immediate danger of Hell and the fewness of the elect can be considered to be a similarity.

After Savonarola's death, a secret Catholic group known as the Piagnoni sprang up in Florence to preserve his memory, organized into a sort of Catholic guild. Franciscan friars were prominent among the Piagnoni, and they briefly re-appeared in 1527 when they once again overthrew the Medici, but through intervention of the Holy Roman Empire it was brought to an end in 1530 at the Battle of Gavinana and the Medici were restored to power.

Savonarola left many admirers throughout Europe, in particular among religiously pious humanists who valued his deep spiritual convictions. Erasmus is said to have refused to become a Protestant partly because of the influence of Savonarola. At the same time, he is considered by Protestants to be a forerunner of the Reformation because of his criticisms of the papacy. Savonarola was said to be an inspiration to Michelangelo and Martin Luther."

If Savonarola was really building himself on ancient ideals, why was he an inspiration to protestants, humanists, revolutionaries and opponents of the Empire? I am just curious as to how he could have been so misunderstood by those he inspires, considering Joseph de Maistre and Evola are certainly not a party to any misunderstanding in our days. Perhaps it was his style, rather than substance? Would this be a warning to counter-revolutionary elements about avoiding the wrong appearance?

Matt on 2011-07-22 at 15:43 said:

Perennial,

Yes, it could very well be (and probably was) due to style. Since he criticised the pope at the time, that was probably the basis of his inspiration for the early protestants, as I'm sure any criticism of the papacy, regardless of the source, caught the admiration of the leaders of

the Reformation. Does some of Savonarola's actions prove as a warning to present and future counter-revolutionaries? Possibly. I suppose it depends if one is willing to take those risks he took.

Cologero on 2011-07-22 at 23:11 said:

In all fairness, that does not imply Evola's blanket endorsement of Savonarola's religious beliefs. Rather that the latter exhibits a certain spiritual attitude, or we could say, he exemplifies a specific "race of the spirit". The point is that such judgments have little to do with someone's particular affiliation.

Perennial on 2011-07-23 at 02:25 said:

So what we are really saying is, burn with the same fire as Savonarola, we just do not have to burn the same way. Savonarola stood as few men dare to stand. It seems, however, that his figure was ambiguous enough to be taken by the forces of subversion. Looking at my examples of de Maistre and Evola, for example, no ambiguity certainly exists there. Perhaps this is what I mean by being a warning to we of Tradition, that if we are to stand, we should stand clearly, marking our point of departure. Savonarola does not seem to have made his distinctions sufficiently clear, at least not to the forces of order, specifically the Empire. He certainly was not taken as a man of order either by the Empire, or the Church. As Christ says in Apocalypse: "I know thy works, that thou art neither cold, nor hot. I would thou wert cold, or hot." (Apocalypse 3:15) Savonarola might not have been such an unclear figure if he had more forthright about what he was about, aside from a moral standpoint. But Savonarola may not have had a wider perspective, which may also be another weak point for him. In any case, his example is worthy of further study.

Cologero on 2011-07-23 at 10:05 said:

The Luther connection is absurd. Savonarola rightfully criticized a particular pope for his lifestyle, not the papacy itself – a distinction you seem to understand from the comments on the priest-king. Luther's sensuousness was opposed to S., and while L. is often an inspiration to the neo-pagans (e.g., Chamberlain), he is the beginning of the end of Tradition in the West.

The only interesting point in that article is the Franciscan connection. S.'s own order, the Dominicans, abandoned him while the Franciscans felt a spiritual kinship. Compare S. to Francis, and more remotely to Augustine, the next link in the chain.

However, we are trying to avoid theological debates which only engage the mind. The issue is to understand the spirit of S., how does he view the world, how does he act in it, and so on, apart from any particular beliefs. S. has that dualist spiritual attitude to the world of nature, the attitude that Evola associates with the best of the pagans. It takes an imaginative meditation to put oneself in that position, a type of meditation we have described more than once. That is how we try to understand S., not by his "influences" or those he "influenced".

S. had visions and the gift of prophecy, which is an indication of an archaic consciousness.

As for your warning. The revolution will use any tool to further its end. My experience is that it is impossible to avoid the wrong appearance; most men do not think and cannot follow a train of thought. In particular those who are subjected to propaganda can only see ideas in terms of their indoctrination. I refer you to what we have written on astrology and on possession by elementals here and on the meditations blog. The first trial is not an optional exercise.

Visionsofglory14 on 2011-07-24 at 16:05 said:

Perennial does make the good point that without proper projection, a Traditional force can be swept up and used as a tool of the Revolution. Certain Neo-Christian forces today are marked by members who have visions of the same character that Savonarola has: fiery and apocalyptic. Their doctrine and attitude toward the modern world reflect this, yet they have been turned into the spearhead of anti-Traditional forces at work today. A post made a few weeks back by Protestants attempting to rectify Tradition with their belief reflects this: both Luther and Calvin earnestly believed their work to a regeneration of Augustinianism, even though the effect of their doctrine was the subversion of it.

Cologero on 2011-07-24 at 16:35 said:

Interesting thought. So you think a truck going backwards is the same as a truck going forwards? Hard to imagine.

In actuality, you have no idea what Luther and Calvin “earnestly” believed, and I suspect it is quite different from your suppositions. A man is responsible for his own consciousness and a false consciousness cannot be justified by any amount of enthusiasm, earnestness, or invincible ignorance. He is also responsible for all the consequences of his acts, even those unintended.

As an exercise, you could ask those neo-Christians if they accept any of the main principles of Tradition. For example, ask one what the “Logos” is and see if you get a coherent response.

Perennial on 2011-07-25 at 01:44 said:

Actually, Cologero, that would be a humorous exercise. Do not tempt me to try it.

Gabe Ruth on 2013-08-29 at 14:44 said:

Have you read Chesterton’s little piece on the Savonarola? It seems to me that you are not fair to GKC. He did not mean that there have never been any Christians, but that modern man has rejected the thing without trying it, often because he thinks he’s outgrown it.

“The great deliverers of men have, for the most part, saved them from calamities which we all recognise as evil, from calamities which are the ancient enemies of humanity. The great law-givers saved us from anarchy: the great physicians saved us from pestilence: the great reformers saved us from starvation. But there is a huge and bottomless evil compared with

which all these are fleabites, the most desolating curse that can fall upon men or nations, and it has no name except we call it satisfaction. Savonarola did not save men from anarchy, but from order; not from pestilence, but from paralysis; not from starvation, but from luxury. Men like Savonarola are the witnesses to the tremendous psychological fact at the back of all our brains, but for which no name has ever been found, that ease is the worst enemy of happiness, and civilisation potentially the end of man."

Regarding Savonarola's being of the left, consider what effect he had on the world. He built something, and it was true. That it was destroyed by evil does not make it less so, and to doubt the man because he was used in propaganda of the left is very naive. He built something, and most astounding of all it seems he did it by example, rather than by force. His rhetoric inflamed the hearts of a city to turn to virtue, and his actions backed up his rhetoric.

Pickman on 2013-08-30 at 22:51 said:

Why bother living at all is the essence of this article on "life". Repent, repent and duly repent until your reach an old age of bitterness and resentment of never living at all.

Live is my solution, live and not care for the reactions. Live by the heart and die by the sword my brethren and you will know ecstasies of spiritual heights beyond heaven itself! Joy my friends is the way and that only. Long live death!

Cologero on 2013-08-31 at 14:20 said:

Yes, Pickman, *Guadeamus igitur, juvenes dum sumus*³ is the right philosophy for the young. But, I assure you, there is no bitterness in old age, because *E' un bel giorno per morire*⁴.

10.3 Liberalism and the Individual

We now resume our review of one of the newer works of political theory. The point is not to critique it, but rather to see how its analyses and prescriptions expand or improve on similar projects based solely on Tradition. In *The Fourth Political Theory*, **Alexander Dugin** defines the essence of liberalism:

Liberalism as a whole rests on the individual as its most basic

³<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WfGXYkfLJ4s>

⁴<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X-tn5N8cw1k>

component. It is these individuals, collectively but in isolation from one another, that are taken as the whole.

Of course, we have previously remarked on this idea. In this view, society is a “heap” rather than an organic whole. That is why the liberal can sincerely believe that wholesale population replacement will result in no essential change to the liberal society. The corollary of the liberal assumption is clearly made by Dugin:

Liberalism as an ideology [calls] for the liberation from all forms of collective identity in general.

In particular, this involves the “denial of *ethnos*”, hence liberalism is ultimately an ethnocide. Moreover, other forms of collective identity are then seen as forms of oppression; this include race, gender sexual relations, and finally even gender itself. They are seen as artificially constructed categories that are incompatible with the freedom and full self-expression of the individual.

Dugin takes liberalism as the “first political theory”, at least if we are counting from the period called the Enlightenment. The second and third theories, intended to oppose liberalism, were communism and Fascism. Theoretically, these movements tried to supplant the individual as the basic atom of society with either class, race, or state. Nevertheless, liberalism triumphed over all of them. From the Traditional point of view, the second and third theories were just as inadequate as the first, since they ignore the fundamental understanding of transcendence. Dugin asserts:

Man is anything but an individual.

The Traditional alternative is that man is also a Person, to use the Medieval idea, also used by Guenon and Evola. Dugin plans to use the notion

of Dasein as developed by **Martin Heidegger** as the model to oppose the individual of liberalism. Yet, another existentialist, **Jean Paul Sartre** brought to light the fundamental presuppositions of liberalism, both of which are contradicted by Tradition. These are:

- Existence precedes essence
- There is no transcendental ego

In this view, man exists first then chooses in freedom who he is, i.e., his essence. Hence, he can be whatever he chooses to be. The self is not transcendent to the world, but is somehow embedded in it, and therefore limited by its “facticity”. In liberal social policy, this facticity must be overcome either through social engineering or technological means. For example, the liberal may believe that anyone can become a “rocket scientist” and will base education policy on this belief. The reality of the dearth of rocket scientists can be overcome by “better schools”, better teachers, better methods, and so on. The one exception who becomes a rocket scientist out of a hundred is regarded with pride and a vindication of the policies rather than the adventitious event that it is.

By ignoring transcendence, the liberal is subject to the two primal soul or psychic forces: *eros* and *thumos*. Hence, the idols of modernity are the pop star and athlete, who exemplify the cancerous growth of *eros* and *thumos* respectively. In contrast, in the Medieval era, the primary types according to **Frithjof Schuon** (*Light on Ancient Worlds*), were the Saint, the Hero, and the Sage who exemplifies the Intellect, the transcendent power that dominates the soul forces.

The Person, as such, is transcendent, yet takes on an essence when manifesting in space-time. In contrast to existentialism, the Person is transcendent to existence, yet has essential characteristics. In this view, Man is related in two directions: vertically, to the Absolute via transcendence, horizontally, to others through his essential characteristics of gender, family, and ethnos. Yet these serve to fulfill the Person, not to oppress him.

Without these larger supports, the individual as such can achieve little. Dugin writes:

The individual is granted freedom because the uses to which he can put it are extremely limited—it will remain contained within the tiny scope of his individuality and that over which he has direct control. This is the flip side of liberalism: at its core, it is totalitarian and intolerant of differences, and most especially opposed to the realization of a great will. It is only prepared to tolerate small people; it protects not so much the rights of man, but, rather, the rights of a small man. This small man can be allowed to do anything, but in spite of all his desire, he will be unable to do anything.

This is true. For many “individuals”, the most creative act of their life may be no more than choosing a tattoo or learning a new sex position. They may have little awareness of themselves as transcendent and fail to develop their Intellect. The Traditional society is criticized for being patriarchal and hierarchal; that is because no spiritual or political authority is recognized as natural, but rather authority depends solely on the consent of the individual. Nevertheless, the intent is not to oppress the masses, but rather to help them develop in the correct direction. Those with a weak Intellect or Will, can be guided and directed by the stronger members.

Some may object to this description on the grounds that no “liberal” truly acts the way described. We are merely pointing out the axioms and logic of liberalism. If no one can consistently and coherently think and act that way, then that is the limitation of the ideology itself. Of course, few will live, even in the modern age, solely by the unchecked forces of *eros* and *thumos*, and they will bring their Intellect into their way of life, even if not fully aware of it.

Posted on 2012-10-11 by Cologero

* * *

Mihai on 2012-10-11 at 03:46 said:

Liberalism is tolerance for all and everything EXCEPT for that which opposes "anything goes" and its insane consequences.

"at its core, it is totalitarian and intolerant of differences"

True, in liberalism the individual is only granted an external and chaotic type of freedom. Internally, he is to be subjected to an exterior and alien role, a role which society has come to name "everyday life", or "real life". It never even occurs to anyone to question the meaning of "real" in this context, because the power of liberalism is not based on principles and logic, but merely on jargon and slogans.

So, while "anything goes", a truly meaningful existence and lifestyle has become a luxury, which the liberal establishment is going to allow, if at all, only when the individual has fulfilled his obligation to "normal, everyday life".

Dominion on 2012-10-11 at 04:00 said:

A mistake I think Dugin makes in his fourth theory is that he rejects almost out of hand the reasons why liberalism arose. Liberalism makes a valid point, though from false principle, in that legitimate authority must be for the good of those which it has power over. This is easy to say, but in practice extremely difficult to achieve, particularly on the social and political plane. "For the good of the people" has been the rallying cry of many a despot and tyrant. It seems that those who can truly claim legitimate Traditional authority will rarely explicitly state that they have it, much less demand relentlessly that they be recognized as such. Hierarchy is a value which needs defending; the problem is that many who defend it have a tendency to use valid principles for their own ends.

Dugin's use of being-in-the-world as a basis for an ideology is far more ingenious than some seem to realize. While it is true, as some have stated, that the people will likely not be 'storming the Bastille' anytime soon over 'Dasein', However, the fourth political theory must be one which creates a slow shift, an enduring force in this waning of the current cycle, a theory which can be applied to people living their lives, formed by ethny and gender and culture and transcendence; not simply another way for the angst-ridden to try and realize their dream of a sexy revolution, flags and thunder behind them. Purposefully applying the principles of Tradition to shape ones being-in-the-world as a person, a people, and a civilization seems a prime way to allow Tradition to manifest in countless forms.

A question to you, Cologero: do you look at ethny and gender, etc, as being forms which allow a person to realize their transcendent Personhood, or are these aspects of the transcendent Person? Also, is this Person identical to the "true Self", or Atman?

william zeitler on 2012-10-11 at 10:05 said:

I've been following this blog for maybe a year, and still have only a vague idea of what you all mean by 'Tradition'. Is there a past post or article somewhere that clearly defines/explains what YOU mean by this term? Thanx!

Cologero on 2012-10-21 at 14:26 said:

Here is an essay, *Big Bird, Liberalism, and Perversion*⁵, that understands that the aim of liberalism is to obliterate all distinctions. Unfortunately, like most modernists, the author takes a medical approach and considers liberals as suffering from a childhood developmental disorder. If that were true, the antidote to liberalism would be some technique of psychotherapy or perhaps even a new psychoactive drug.

Logres on 2012-10-21 at 22:34 said:

Liberalism is always willing to annihilate actual inner diversity (usually built on history, race, culture, religion or a combination of such) in favor of a faux outer diversity; the price for this seems to be a total inner conformity and/or emptiness, itself a result of the ruins of that upon which Liberalism waded to power. I often wonder why it never occurs to them that there are trade-offs in reality, although I can see why their elite master class pursues it. The one thing they are absolutely opposed to is external monopoly (even if it protects an inner diversity or itself forms part of a larger global patchwork of diverse forms of government), yet this is precisely where they end up anyway: in the end, they will lose the material diversity they sold their soul for, after all. In any case, they have yet to develop a coherent, positive basis for discriminating between good and evil so that both are not equally "tolerated". Hence, chaos and lies and confusion abound.

Or so it seems to me lately...and I think about it, over and over again, trying to see some good way out for the Liberal regime...

10.4 The Misconception of Egalitarianism

Every doctrine is true in what it asserts but false in, or because of, what it excludes.

LEIBNIZ

⁵http://www.americanthinker.com/2012/10/big_bird_liberalism_and_perversion.html

I've been looking at some writings from the "right", or "tradition", or "conservatism" of various persuasions and I see that there many misconceptions, misunderstandings, and half-truths (i.e., wrong in what they exclude). This is the first in a series of posts that will discuss some of them.

A prevalent myth is the assertion that Christianity is inherently "egalitarian"; this opinion is so common that it is never substantiated. We'll assume for the time being that social egalitarian is what is meant, that is, there are no differences in social distinctions. We wonder, too, where in a social hierarchy the opponents of egalitarianism expect to end up. But getting back to the main point, let's just quote what Christians themselves have written on this point. Consider the following quotes carefully; the opposite of egalitarianism is hierarchy and authority. This may not be to everyone's liking.

As it is suitable that the institution of a city or a kingdom be made according to the model of the institution of the world, similarly it is necessary to draw from divine government the order (ratio) or Logos in Greek of the government of a city ... That is why authors of the Middle Ages could not imagine Christianity without an Emperor, just as they could not imagine the Universal Church without a pope. Because if the world is governed hierarchically, Christianity cannot be otherwise.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

When once men recognise, both in private and in public life that Christ is King, society will at last receive the great blessings of real liberty, well ordered discipline, peace and harmony. Our Lord's regal office invests the human authority of princes and rulers with a religious significance; it ennobles the citizen's duty of obedience.

POPE PIUS XI (1925)

No one doubts that all men are equal one to another, so far as regards their common origin and nature, or the last end which each one has to attain, or the rights and duties which are thence derived. But, as the abilities of all are not equal, as one differs from another in the powers of mind or body, and as there are very many dissimilarities of manner, disposition, and character, it is more repugnant to reason to endeavor to confine all within the same measure, and to extend complete equality to the institutions of civil life.

There is an almost infinite dissimilarity of men, as parts of the whole. If they are to be all equal, and each is to follow his own will, the State will appear most deformed.

POPE LEO XIII (1884)

It is not true that all have equal rights in civil society. It is not true that there exists non lawful social hierarchy.

POPE PIUS XI (1937)

This is how one arrives at the dictatorship of the proletariat, the class hostile to the hierarchical principle, which latter, however, is the reflection of the divine order. This is why the proletariat professes atheism.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

To recapitulate: social hierarchy is the reflexion of divine order. That is why opponents of the hierarchical order, from Thomas Paine to the sansculottes to the Bosheviks profess atheism. Atheists, then, who oppose egalitarianism, can do so only on the basis of the will to power and not on any moral authority.

Now the popes concede that there is an equality of nature — the essence of being human — but insist that the inequality of accidental qualities is legitimate and just. If is what those web sites mean by egalitarianism, they would be correct. In that case, they insist that there is a difference in human nature itself; that is, different individuals, groups, or races differ essentially. It is not clear what they would mean by that, especially since they base their arguments on genetic grounds (that is, accidental qualities). If there are essential differences among humans, (that is, differences by nature) or beings that appear outwardly to be human, then they need to make this clear.

Posted on 2010-03-30 by Cologero

* * *

Ben on 2011-06-25 at 15:57 said:

I really want to accept what you've asserted here in this post, as I'm a supporter of conservative, traditional monarchy and its relation to Catholicism... But I just can't swallow the idea of essential racial inequality. It just has such a ring of 19th century social Darwinism that I can't stomach. Is there any way you could clarify this idea?

Cologero on 2011-06-25 at 19:37 said:

Against my better judgment, Ben, I decided to allow your comment, as you seem to be a troll. First of all, we would encourage you to use your intellect in making judgments, not your dysphagia which is of no interest to anyone. There is nothing in that post that defends "essential racial inequality", and absolutely nothing at all that defends Darwinism. Actually, just the opposite, or did you forget to read it to the end?

Ben on 2011-06-25 at 23:13 said:

No, I have no interest in trolling at all. I'm just trying to understand this political philosophy, which I certainly want to support. And I didn't mean to accuse you or your sources of believing what I alluded to earlier; my problem was that if "the inequality of accidental qualities is legitimate and just," and genetics are accidental qualities, would that not imply that racial inequalities are legitimate?

Logres on 2011-06-26 at 01:27 said:

Ben, your argument would have to assume as another premise that "genetic material" compromises the sum total of a human being. Actually, from another point of view starting from your very premises, you are the one defending what you are attacking. Humans have to "be" in a particular way, so genetic material is essential without being completely exhaustive.

Ben on 2011-06-26 at 11:13 said:

So, in other words, there are other accidental qualities aside from what is handed down genetically? And in addition to that, there are the things Pope Leo XIII talked about as being common to humanity as a whole... So that a human being is a result of numerous diverse factors which contribute to his place in the hierarchy, yet even with the existence of the hierarchy there is still much that unites men.

Cologero on 2011-06-26 at 23:00 said:

Ben, your obsession with race can only be the result of indoctrination by the American educational system.

The Traditional view is that there is a cosmic order, which is just; piety, that is, the duty of following that order, is just. This is opposed to the view of the gnostics who regard the cosmos as the creation of an evil demi-urge; hence, they support revolution and the overturning of every manifestation of cosmic order.

Find the post on Providence, Will and Destiny. The world process (destiny) is neither just nor unjust; an apple falling to the ground acts neither justly nor unjustly. Similarly, a genetic process is just what it is. We accept our fate (*amor fati*), this is the second trial; this is not a weakness, despite what you may read elsewhere. At a deeper level, we understand this as a privation of our own nature.

But the relations between men are a different story; they can be just or unjust, in conformance with the order of things or a violation of it. Injustices arising that way are not legitimate. But this opens the issue of what are one's duties? A man is obligated to rectify his own injustices, but is he obligated to rectify natural inequalities or those brought on by another man himself? The modern man, who is a gnostic at heart, will answer yes to the latter.

Then there are alleged inequalities of Providence. These are related to the ideas of Predestination and Predilection, which can't be addressed here. If you are Catholic, check out Garrigou-Lagrange's book *Predestination*.

Ben on 2011-06-27 at 14:47 said:

It's amusing to me that you are able to see to the heart of my difficulty – yes, I am unfortunately the product (to a certain extent) of the American public school system. My earliest

education was in desegregated south Louisiana. As to my whether I'm Catholic, I'm in the process of conversion.

Sullen Eyes on 2023-03-29 at 22:47 said:

It's been quite a journey for me to grapple with egalitarianism. I came to Guenon, Schuon, and Evola through the contemporary Internet-based far right, and there's a lot of baggage that comes with that. It's been a long journey to unlearn that perspective at the reflexive, emotional level.

I've primarily based my practice around Vaishnava bhakti meditation, and the conception of "egalitarianism" in that tradition is very different from the contemporary political conception (if egalitarian is even a proper word to use for it). As I understand it: one's obligation to love God applies to all of His creation, even if there are differences of social and spiritual rank between beings as well as differences in orientation and vocation. Furthermore, the detachment from egoistic concerns naturally causes a sort of impartiality among sages.

I also find it somewhat interesting how little attention Sikhism, with its great emphasis on bhakti-based egalitarianism, has received among western writers whether they be writing about tradition or some sort of political philosophy. Reading the Japji Sahib has been illuminating for one who is as imbalanced as me.

10.5 The Rights of Man

The Rights of Man (see below), expresses the fundamental world view of modernity. There are those who believe it is a debatable question and that the more reasonable choice will prevail. However, there are fundamental reasons why that is not true. Tradition is not at all a political option, unlike various forms of modernity. We can schematize the perspectives as shown in Table 10.5.

As we take the **French Revolution** as the tipping point separating modernity from tradition, its dogmas can be found in the Declaration on the Rights of Man.

Article 1

Men are born and remain free and equal in rights. Social distinctions may be founded only upon the general good.

	Tradition	Modernity
World view	Supernatural	Natural
Rationality	Knowledge of cosmic law	Instrumental to achieve goals
Social distinctions	Real	Conventional
Natural inequality	Just	Unjust
Decision making	Logical	Psychological

Table 10.1: Rights of Man

Tradition is based on two related principles, which are both denied by article 1.

- Spiritual authority

A traditional society is based on some spiritual authority which determines what is true and good. Man is born either in sin or under illusion and can only become free after initiation into the rites of the city. The declaration states that man is born free and not subject to anyone else, hence he himself takes the place of God or the higher authority.

- Temporal power

The traditional society is based on a hierarchy of increasing power. This is understood as natural or divinely ordained. The declaration, on the contrary, admits social distinctions only insofar as the serve the common good. Thus, such distinctions are considered conventional, not natural.

Article 3

The principle of all sovereignty resides essentially in the nation. No body nor individual may exercise any authority which does not proceed directly from the nation.

This emphasizes article 1. There is no sovereignty beyond the nation, in particular, there is no spiritual authority higher than the laws of the nation. A fortiori, there is no church or spiritual organization beyond the nation.

Article 4

Liberty consists in the freedom to do everything which injures no one else; hence the exercise of the natural rights of each man has no limits except those which assure to the other members of the society the enjoyment of the same rights. These limits can only be determined by law.

In the traditional view, there is a cosmic law, sometimes called the natural law, which binds the liberty of man. Unlike the mineral, vegetable, and animal kingdoms, which are determined by the natural law, man has the free will to either follow or reject the cosmic law. Article 4 states that man's actions are totally conventional, oblivious to any higher law. A man's actions need not even be rational, which is itself considered an artificial construct limiting his liberty.

Article 6

Law is the expression of the general will. Every citizen has a right to participate personally, or through his representative, in its foundation. It must be the same for all, whether it protects or punishes. All citizens, being equal in the eyes of the law, are equally eligible to all dignities and to all public positions and occupations, according to their abilities, and without distinction except that of their virtues and talents.

The **general will** here takes the place of the will of God. In tradition, distinctions are viewed as a special calling or a birth rite. Article 6 regards distinctions as conventional and acceptable insofar as they serve the general will.

Article 10

No one shall be molested on account of his opinions, including his religious views, provided their manifestation does not disturb the public order established by law.

This article guarantees freedom of religion. Since man is born free and is his own sovereign, his beliefs cannot be limited. However, by article 2, his religious beliefs cannot be used to restrict others, hence the outer effects of such beliefs can be limited by law. In its statement, the American Bill of Rights seems more absolutist, but religious manifestations are still limited by law in the USA.

This article differs profoundly from the Traditional view, any hint of which will raise all the forces against it. In the traditional view, "Error has no rights", so religious views outside the spiritual authority have no guarantee, although they may be tolerated in order to maintain public order. This was certainly the case during the era of Christendom. Despite current misconceptions, even the ancient pagan world did not support complete freedom of religions.

Article 11

The free communication of ideas and opinions is one of the most precious of the rights of man. Every citizen may, accordingly, speak, write, and print with freedom, but shall be responsible for such abuses of this freedom as shall be defined by law.

The same comments to article 10 apply here also. Freedom of speech is considered an advance over the Medieval period. Nevertheless, there is an "out" in that abuses of such freedom may be restricted by law. Thus we seen in many Western countries in Europe or Canada have laws restricting speech. Interesting, not even truth is the standard, but rather public order.

So the problem that was supposed to have been solved in the Enlightenment still exists, to wit, who is the ultimate arbiter of speech. Since in the modern state, not even rationality can restrict man's liberty, so similarity conformance of speech to truth is not of ultimate import, even though the very goal of the Enlightenment is truth!

The traditional society regarded its foundation, laws, and mores as infallible. The modern state does not, nor can it do so. Actually, it is irrelevant, since the general will is the sole standard for law and is not subject to any higher truth, whether of a scientific, philosophic, religious, or metaphysical nature. This is critical to understand for anyone engaged in public debate in the modern world.

Posted on 2011-10-26 by Cologero

10.6 Rebuttal to Liberation Theology

"Liberation" is not only the goal of esoterism, but also of the various modern movements. There is a fundamental difference. The understanding of the former is that liberation is an individual task. That is, the esoterist seeks to free himself from his own illusions, attachments, desires, and so on. The goal of modern liberation movements is to define a victim and an oppressor; the victim then seeks to gain freedom from the oppressor.

In his book *Francis of Assisi: A Model for Human Liberation*, the Brazilian liberation theologian **Leonardo Boff** makes the following point:

The theme of liberation is not new, though it certainly is the strongest impulse in modern culture. Generally, we can state that the history of the past five centuries centers in large part on the process of emancipation.

This is an important observation. As the *strongest* impulse, any discourse that may challenge or refute such impulse cannot even be heard.

To do so would be to put one on the side of the oppressors, hence the enemy of liberation.

The History of Liberation In a brief passage, Fr. Boff lists several of the most prominent historical events of emancipation. The book was published in 1981, so an updated version would probably include some movements that were not even anticipated 30 years ago. This is his list, including its most representative figure:

- **Galileo Galilei.** The liberation of *reason* from within the religious totality that impeded the free flight of thought in the discovery of the working mechanisms of the world.
- **Rousseau.** The liberation of the *citizen* from the absolutism of the kings, to see the citizen as the real bearer and delegation of political powers.
- **Marx.** The liberation of the *proletariat* from capitalist economic domination with the aim of arriving at a socialist society without class distinctions.
- **Nietzsche.** The liberation of *life*, shortened and suffocated by the sophistication of metaphysics, morals, and culture.
- **Freud.** The liberation of the *psyche* from its interior bonds.
- **Marcuse.** The liberation of *industrial man*, reduced to one-dimension by the assembly line productions.
- **Feminism.** The liberation of *women* from a patriarchal and male culture, toward a less sexist and more personalistic society.

Reform and Revolution There are two incompatible ways to evaluate Fr. Boff's liberation movements, given that there is a cosmic order implied by the idea of the Good. The first is reform. When the social structures themselves no longer conform to the idea of the Good, whether due to the corruption or incompetence of the acknowledged authorities, then a reform is necessary. Specifically, this applies to the three spheres of religion, politics, and economics and their respective duties of leading the people to true liberation, peace, and prosperity.

Revolution, on the other hand, is actively opposed to the cosmic order and seeks its overthrow. While reform has a terminus, revolution is never ending, since every vestige of order can never be definitively overturned.

Analysis and Objections The history of liberation needs to be analyzed by its own standards. Has it truly led to the intended liberation?

- **Reason.** Has reason, liberated from any transcendental roots, provided new and viable answers to the problems of life?
 - It has not solved the problems of the nature and destiny of man
 - Rather than liberation from transcendental assumptions, it instead has embraced unprovable and unreasonable assumptions such as materialism, determinism, atheism, and positivism.
 - In liberating itself from religious and political authority, it has put itself under the corrupting influence of other authorities, so that so-called objective scientific research serves the interests of those false authorities.
- **Citizen.** In overthrowing the absolutism of kings, the citizen then put himself under the arbitrary opinions of the general will. Since

most of the citizenry is incompetent to understand complex political, economic, and sociological issues, the citizens become beholden to the influence and propaganda of special interests.

- **Proletariat.** The proletariat is hostile to the hierarchical principle. Hence, it has overthrown the rule of throne and altar. However, it has not eliminated inequality. Instead, it promotes performers and athletes as a new hierarchy.
- **Life.** While unheeded in his own time, Nietzsche and his ideas are now part of popular culture. Life without a transcendent aim is nothing but the will to power. However, power is finite and its distribution is unequal. We look in vain for the arrival of the superman, and see nothing but the mass man everywhere.
- **Psyche.** Freud promised the elimination of neuroses, etc., by the liberation of the ego from the superego and its acceptance of the id. In practice, this means sexual liberation. Instead of freedom, this has led to addiction to pornography and the mass use of sexual imagery to control the population and its purchasing habits. The vast number of people on psychotropic drugs in the Western nations indicates the failure of the liberation of the ego to achieve psychological health.
- **Industrial man.** The liberation from work is supposed to lead to multidimensional man, of the sort envisaged by Marx: a farmer by day, a philosopher by night. Instead, the increase in leisure has led to a population satisfied only by vulgar entertainment.
- **Women.** While women have been liberated in certain areas, feminism has been part of the atomization of society. The first patriarchy is the father-centered family. This is an organic unit that used to form the basis of society. With atomization, each member of

the family is an individual and their relationships to each other are nominal, accepted only as long as the relations are freely chosen by each member. An atomized society is easier to control and leads to mistrust, not to more personalistic relations.

True Liberation True liberation is never addressed in these historical movements. After historical liberation there is nothing left to do, as was shown by the students in *Kidz, Kulcha, Kreativitiy*⁶. Any movement that is opposed to the modern world needs to show how Reform will solve the problems of justice rather than Revolution.

Posted on 2014-05-12 by Cologero

10.7 Guenon Reader of Nietzsche

Only literature can give you that feeling of contact with another human spirit, with the totality of that spirit, his weaknesses and grandeurs, his limitations, his pettiness, his obsessions, his beliefs; with whatever moves, interests, excites, or disgusts him. Only literature can grant you access to a spirit of a dead man in a more direct, more complete, and deeper way than you would even have in conversation with a friend—as deep, as lasting as in a friendship. We never open up in a conversation as completely as when we face a blank page, addressing ourselves to an unknown reader.

MICHEL HOUELLEBECQ, *Submission*

In his novel, *Submission*, Michel Houellebecq refers to a philosophy dissertation, held at the Catholic University of Louvain-la-Neuve, entitled *Guénon lecteur de Nietzsche*⁷ by Robert Rediger. Over the past several

⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1582>

⁷*Guenon Reader of Nietzsche*.

months, I have made several efforts to track down a copy. A dear friend, an employee of the State Department stationed in Brussels, managed to locate a photocopy for me. When she stopped by on the way to visit her family stateside for Christmas, I was able to inspect it during her layover at the airport. Although there was not much time, I tried to extract its main themes.

The first thing to point out is the deep influence that Rediger's dissertation had on Houellebecq himself. This is shown in the main themes of the novel as expressed through the voice of Francois, his alter ego. Furthermore, the dissertation brought out several inchoate themes that were filled out in Rediger's later writings. Obviously, Rene Guenon was never a "reader" of Nietzsche. Rediger came to that conclusion when he wrote:

I don't think Guenon was influenced by Nietzsche especially. His rejection of the modern world was just as vehement as Nietzsche's, but it had radically different sources.

Decadence So it is not the sources that are of interest, but rather how Guenon and Nietzsche reached similar conclusions. Specifically, there was the recognition of the decadence of Europe, the failure of Christianity to forestall it, and the rise of Islam. Francois notes this:

The facts were plain: Europe had reached a point of such putrid decomposition that it could no longer save itself, any more than fifth-century Rome could have done. This wave of new immigrants, with their traditional culture—of natural hierarchies, the submission of women, and respect for elders—offered a historic opportunity for the moral and familial rearmament of Europe. These immigrants held out the hope of a new golden age for the old continent.

The USA is likewise in a state of decomposition, although the particular circumstances are quite different. The main difference, of course, is

that the European more or less recognizes his situation while his American counterpart is blithely unaware of his real situation. Even those who call themselves conservatives in the USA are in the dark. Right wing talk shows are in a tither about Muslim violence although they, of all people, should be more concerned about those who can kill the soul rather than those who kill the body. Hence, they condemn Islam for everything in it that is traditional. For example, they emphasize the West's concern for women's and gay rights, while praising the separation of any spiritual authority over political matters.

Rediger wryly pointed out:

Their irrational hostility to Islam should blind them to the obvious: on every question that really mattered, the nativists and the Muslims were in perfect agreement. When it came to rejecting atheism and humanism, or the necessary submission of women, or the return of patriarchy, they were fighting exactly the same fight.

Patriarchy This shows up first of all in the end of patriarchy in the West. In Francois' words, almost a direct quote from the dissertation:

At least patriarchy existed. I mean, as a social system it was able to perpetuate itself. There were families with children, and most of them had children. In other words, it worked, where now there aren't enough children, so we're finished.

Liberalism could overturn all the established institutions: the churches, education, the workplace, political leaderships, and so on. However, the attack on the family cannot be maintained, for without children, no society can continue to exist.

Nevertheless, liberalism is adamant, while birthrates plummet. There is no longer an organic community but rather a heap of unrelated consumers. Francois lists some examples:

- The eco-responsible bobo
- The show-off bourgeois woman
- The gay-friendly nightclubbing girl
- The satanic geek
- The techno-Zennist

In other words, everyone is a “type”, trying overly hard for a sui generis identity. The reader can identify more. For example, there is a facebook group called “Liberal and proud of it”. Thus, it is not a well-thought out worldview, but rather a tribal identity marker.

Francois, despite himself, is a “type”, perhaps the aging professor or the effete intellectual. His own life exemplifies the sterility of the modern world. Rejecting family life, he mates with his students, or with call girls when necessary. The sex scenes are not intended to be erotic, but rather sad. His preference is for anal sex or else he is ejaculating in some woman’s mouth – anywhere except where a well-bred man would consider healthy and normal.

Assimilation and Transformation Rediger then takes up a theme mentioned years ago on Gornahoor in *The Prophecies of Guenon*⁸. In the *Crisis of the Modern World*, Guenon wrote that only Catholicism could restore Tradition to modern world. Rediger agreed with Guenon about the medieval tradition:

The greatness of medieval Christendom, whose artistic achievements would live forever in human memory; but little by little it had given way, it had been forced to compromise with rationalism, it had renounced its temporal powers, and so had sealed its own doom.

⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=35>

According to Guenon, Church leaders had forgotten the deeper truths of Tradition. Rediger goes further, asserting that the Church itself is actively engaged in subverting Tradition. He wrote:

By dint of the affectations, the playful caresses, and the shameful fondling of the progressives, the Church had lost its ability to oppose moral decadence, to renounce homosexual marriage, abortion rights, and women in the workplace.

Even Guenon, after having failed to make any impact on Catholic thought, openly converted to Islam. Although Guenon claimed he did it for personal reasons, Rediger sees a larger perspective:

Today this fight to establish a new organic phase of civilization could no longer be waged in the name of Christianity. Islam, its sister faith, was newer, simpler, and truer.

As Guenon predicted, the available choices are degeneration, assimilation, and transformation. Degeneration cannot continue unabated. In the novel, Houellebecq opts for a gentle assimilation and then a transformation. He foresees an alliance between the Left and the Islamist elements. That is not so far-fetched since liberalism believes it can use Islam to further erode Christian influence. However, in Houellebecq's scenario, it is Islam that assimilates the Left.

Polygamy and the Social Order Guenon was single-pointedly focused on the metaphysical elements, so he provides little or no insight into actual Muslim religious life and practice. Rediger, on the other hand, does expand on those influences, while, at the same time, adding a distinctive Western element to Islam. For this part of the dissertation, he relies more on Nietzsche than on Guenon.

Then, Rediger, also following Nietzsche, claims that Christianity is fundamentally a feminine religion. Rediger quotes Nietzsche from the *Anti-Christ*:

If Islam despises Christianity, it has a thousandfold right to do so;
Islam at least assumes that it is dealing with men.

Rediger attributes the ideals of humanism and the rights of man to the dogma of the Incarnation. Now you may object that Medieval Christianity, which Rediger lauded, was itself patriarchal and masculine. Can anyone accuse Constantine, Clovis, Charlemagne, Arthur, or Boucicaut⁹ of being feminine? Moreover, the medievals admired the great pagan warriors like Hector, Alexander, Scipio, and Julius Caesar. Even St Paul regarded effeminacy as a sin. At this point, Rediger makes the only reference to Julius Evola that I noticed: he likewise claims that this masculine element in Medieval Christianity was due solely to the still existing remnants of paganism, but not to anything specifically Christian.

First of all, Rediger accepts Nietzsche's classification of life-affirming and life-denying religions, of which Islam belongs to the former. He writes:

Islam accepts the world, and accepts it whole. It accepts the world *as such*, Nietzsche might say. For Buddhism, the world is *dukkha*, unsatisfactoriness, suffering. Christianity has serious reservations of its own. Isn't Satan called "the prince of the world"? For Islam, though, the divine creation is perfect, it's an absolute masterpiece. What is the Koran, really, but one long mystical poem of praise? Of praise for the Creator, and of submission to his laws?

Rediger again turns to Nietzsche to justify the Islamic hierarchical and patriarchal order. There would be a small cadre of aristocrats on a large base of common people. Destitution would be reduced due to the requirement of alms-giving. Also, the extended family would be the "first responders", so to speak, in the event of the tragedies of life. These customs would reduce the size of the welfare budget. Unemployment

⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=277>

would be reduced as more women left the workplace to stay at home, raising children.

Polygamy, too, is understood as the will to power. The stronger and the most genetically fit would have more wives, hence more children. Of course, this means that some men will have no offspring at all. This brings to mind what we recently wrote about Social Surgery¹⁰. To what extent does the community have the right to regulate the genetic makeup of its members, assuming the goal is the common good?

At this point, Rediger becomes less convincing since he does not take his ideas to their logical conclusion. He makes a good point that men of all types and castes will select the same kind of women. For example, in mate selection, most men, regardless of intelligence or station in life, would prefer a Taylor Swift. Women, on the other hand, are more malleable in their mate selection; for example, she may overlook a man's looks or age if he is wealthy or powerful.

Moreover, woman's attraction can be trained. Rediger, thus, wants to define intellectuals as "alpha males", deserving of the better quality women. It is beyond belief that, in the West as it now is, that women will be attracted to studious Thomists rather than the team quarterback. However, on second thought, female students are often attracted to their male professors. Asian women, and to a lesser extent Latinas, are more likely than European women to find a STEM major sexually desirable.

To accomplish this, Rediger claims that there will be women who serve as matchmakers. The details of this process are fuzzy. It would be a simple matter to determine if Islamic countries are more biologically fit than Western nations. My understanding is that the opposite is sometimes the case due to the preference for cousin marriages. But perhaps Rediger's Westernized, Nietzschean version of Islam would become the norm.

¹⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=8253>

With a Whimper Overall, the social structure is based on submission, beginning with submission to God. Then there is the submission to the social order, and finally women's submission to men. Houellebecq sees the *Story of O* by **Pauline Reage** as the model for submission. He sees this as occurring without much incident. This is hard to believe, although, given that the *50 Shades of Grey* has sold more than 70 million copies, perhaps there is a secret desire to be dominated.

Thus, the transition occurs not with a bang, but with a whimper. Why would it be that way? Some would say it is a matter of convenience, as the intellectuals and others take advantage of the new opportunities that open up to them. Rediger concludes with a different answer:

In the end, it was a mystery; God had ordained it so.¹¹

If that is the case, then the mystery of the three rings¹² will have been solved.

* * *

aegishjalmer on 2015-12-14 at 00:40 said:

The supposed femininity of Christianity has been asserted by some of these thinkers. I assume they refer to the historical confessions and cultures. Can anyone explain what, if anything, is specifically feminine about the essence of Christianity?

Max on 2015-12-14 at 10:08 said:

On the immigrant situation

In practice, most Muslim immigrants are hardly traditional. Some of the first generation might be so to a degree, but it is the most liberal and westernized who leave their home countries in the first place. The next problem is that they do not manage to assimilate European civilization, and becomes distanced from their origin, which places them in a difficult position. This is even more pronounced in the second generation, who never received any organic influences from their own part of the world, and does not have a connection to our civilization either. It turns out that

¹¹Some of the translations from the French text are my own.

¹²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=7872>

second generation “muslims” are if possible even more rootless and lost than the indigenous population.

Those currently fleeing to Europe does not seem to seek the restoration of any kind of “Golden Age” for the continent, their main motivation is rather to live an easier westernized life without the presence of war. For example, some say that the reason they fled was to avoid being drafted to the army, hardly a noble posture. Perhaps they should make an attempt to sort out their own countries instead. If the material living conditions of Europe deteriorated, they would probably not hesitate to move back.

The immigrants think that they will be able to live an organic life similar to what they had in the Middle East, but with the addition of a Western standard of living. In reality they find themselves at the bottom of the societal ladder and with a lost sense of community. Material richness is not an absolute value, always being relative. So even if they are richer than in their old countries, they are much poorer compared to the new surroundings, and so begins to complain that is unfair and discriminating, even though they are a large cost for a society that provides them with everything. This country produces less than 50% of its food as it is, and uses a lot of energy simply for heating. Any leftists or “greens” should acknowledge that artificially increasing population in northern Europe is not very clever by their own standards of thinking, but they are not known for their coherence.

I find myself asking; in the liberals mind, who exactly is supposed to live in the Middle East? Because following their argumentation, that area of the world is made out to be completely unfit for human habitation. Therefore it could be a good idea for them to give it away for free to someone who still has use for a country of their own once it has been evacuated. In any case, a small comfort is that once enough immigrants have arrived here, either it will become so bad that no-one will want to come anymore, or the immigrants more xenophobic mentality will put an end to further immigration. A strong trend we see globally is decreasing differences between countries and continents, however not necessarily between individuals. Basically the rich parts of the world will be brought down a notch, and maybe it will further the possibility of reaching global political agreements.

If one were to have a realistic mass-immigration policy, and all of our “empty land” is so ideal for habitation as the politicians say, we should have some kind of settler policy like in the old American west: if you manage to carve out a living in the wilderness with your own hands, then you can have it and stay. People up here in the north respects efforts more than words; it should help integration greatly. They will also get a first-hand experience of why we are so “distant and cold” as they say, “cultural enrichment” should go both ways? While fleeing from war (in the narrative) these southerners complain about being housed in locations too remote out in the “wilderness”. With the human races of the world adapted to specific environments, we must not forget that they are largely descended from the first urban cultures, and it would be much better for everyone involved if they could “flee” to an area that is as similar to theirs

as possible, such as a neighboring country.

The bottom line as I see it, is that we as Europeans live in a mess of our own making, while any immigrants would live as foreigners in someone else's mess, which is arguably a much worse position. The right way to go is un-entanglement of the situation, not "cutting the knot", and I highly doubt that Muslims could accomplish that by themselves, which means outright replacement is not an option. The case of assimilation means Islam would come to be something other than what we currently know it as. Islam could not conquer Europe without profound adaption, and immigrants residing in northern Europe would in some ways be at a severe disadvantage, and not fare well, in the case we abandoned the modern welfare system for a more Islamic and/or Traditional way of life. It could just as well be what remains of Christian Europe that learns from Islam and comes out stronger.

Boreas on 2015-12-14 at 12:58 said:

@ aegishjalmer: Especially one thing comes to my mind, and that is the strong separation in Christianity between creator and the creature, which leaves the personality in a feminine role in regards transcendence. I'm aware that this doesn't apply to such high mystics (initiates?) as for example Meister Eckhart, but the general tendency of Christianity is without a doubt passivity towards Being. This is one reason why I personally rejected Christianity after considering it for a while. Even the Orthodox concept of Theosis emphasizes that man and God remain separate.

1234kid on 2015-12-14 at 19:29 said:

@boreas, doesnt this separation exist in islam?

Boreas on 2015-12-14 at 20:24 said:

@ 1234kid: as far as I can say and know, yes it does. Sufism seems to contain some higher elements and possibilities (like does esoteric Christianity), but yes, the general tendency in all the three great monotheisms especially in their exoteric manifestations is the same.

This again reminded me of this book which I have yet to read:

<http://www.sophiaperennis.com/books/christianity/christianity-and-the-doctrine-of-non-dualism/>

Ninth Card on 2015-12-15 at 17:12 said:

I think it's too convenient to say a tradition (christianity) is feminine and then consider everything that contradicts this statement as an exception.

What christianity had of pre-existing traditions was not inherited randomly but because of precise spiritual influences, as Guénon explained.

Part of the Egyptian, Roman, Germanic and Greek spiritual traditions survived in Christianity not as an exterior body but because they were compatible with its universal principle.

It happened the same thing with the influx of Daoism on Mahayana Buddhism, or Tantrism on Vajirayana Buddhism.

At the highest point of the christian tradition was Christianity feminine? Not at all. Confirmation itself is a knight investiture (the bishop give a soft slap for example) and makes one a "soldier of Christ", the highest ascetics, many greatest christian initiates used warrior metaphors to describe their spiritual method.

Admitting that it was not feminine but only because of paganism is like implying that the weak and degenerated modern Christianity of today is the true Christianity, and the greatest Christianity of the Middle Age was the fake one.

So pseudo-marxist catholics of today and protestants are true christians because they are feminine, while the greatest saints were fake christians because they used warrior words? This is absurd.

I'm nobody to contest people with great traditional knowledge like Evola, but most of what he wrote about Christianity is just a post hoc rationalization of prejudices he had even before he actually knew about Tradition. (Just look at his letters of when he was young)

All the critics agains modern Church are valid, it's just wrong to also project them in the past and extend them to the true traditional Christianity of the past.

Avery on 2015-12-16 at 01:37 said:

I don't think the nature of Christianity is strictly "masculine" or "feminine", but you can't deny that its nature is unique.

Daoism aims to harness the power of what is weak and meek for an esoteric (possibly initiated) elite. Christianity tries to harness the power of the weak and meek for the masses at large. Yet the history of Christendom is not one of submission but of reconquista, and conquista, in the name of the faith. Much later, the children of Christendom have shown a tendency to surrender their moral tenets in the interest of embracing difference and righting perceived injustices. What happened here?

I don't think Rediger or Houellebecq really plumb this idea to its depths. They are both clever men, but they can only see the psychological and demographic consequences of current visible trends.

Tom Walker on 2015-12-16 at 11:50 said:

I don't think that the Knights Templar or the Christian warriors at Poitiers 732 , Malta 1551 and 1565, Lepanto 1571 , Vienna 1529 and 1583 (to name but a few battles against Muslims) would regard Christianity as relatively " feminine" . Neither would their foes . The so-called femininity of Christianity is an Evola trope with no basis in reality .

Anyway , all souls are passive or feminine with respect to the Spirit.

Alistair Fraser on 2015-12-16 at 18:34 said:

@Max – a very thoughtful assessment below

1234kid on 2015-12-16 at 20:12 said:

@boreas, then in what way is islam addressing men where christianity is not?

i know this isn't your stance personally, im just trying to wrap my head around the idea of how a nietzschean islam would be a masculinizing force of good in the western world. two wrongs don't make a right, do they??

Boreas on 2015-12-21 at 10:32 said:

@ 1234kid: well, I'm not the one defending that position.

As regards all souls being passive in relation to being, there is a very revealing passage in 'The Doctrine of Awakening', page 86-87:

"... At this point the antitheses build up to a cosmic and titanic grandeur ending with the most paradoxical reversal of the point of view that is prevalent in Western religions. In fact, while the desire of surpassing the very Lord of creation, from this point of view, appears as something diabolical, the Buddha, instead, finds a diabolical plot in the exact opposite, that is in the attempt to stop him in the region of being, to make this region an insuperable limit, beyond which it is both absurd and mad to seek a higher liberation. Here it is the Malign One in person who urges the belief that the personal God, the God of being, is the supreme reality, and who threatens the Bud-dim with the damnation that is supposed already to have claimed other ascetics. And in another text his temptation consists of inducing the Buddha to confine himself to the path of good works, rites and sacrifices-to the path of theistic religions. But the Buddha discovers the plot, and speaks thus to M?ra: "Well I know you, Malign One, abandon your hope: 'He knows me not'; you are Mara, the Malign. Arid this Brahma here, O Malign One, these gods of Brahma: they are all in your hand, they are all in your power, You. O Malign One, certainly think: 'He also must be in my hand, in my power!' I, however, O Malign One, am not in your hand, I am not in your power."

There follows a symbolical test. The personal God, the Hebraic "I am that I am," the God of being, whose essence is his existence, as such, cannot not be, that is, he is bound to being, he is passive with respect to being. He has not the power to go beyond being. It is here that the test occurs. Who can "disappear"? That is, who is lord both of being and of nonbeing? Who rests neither on the one nor on the other? Brahm? cannot disappear. Instead, the Buddha disappears. All the world of Brahm? is amazed and recognizes "the high power, the high might of the ascetic Gotama." Limitation is removed. The dignity of the atideva, of one who goes beyond the world of existence itself, not to mention the "celestial" worlds, is demonstrated. It is only left to Mara the malign to try in vain to dissuade the Buddha from spreading the doctrine

Here, then, is one of the extreme points in the test of the vocations: not to crave even the highest of all lives—not only to pass from this shore to the other, but to apprehend that which lies beyond both. The words of the Awakened One are: “Nature, the gods, the lord of generation, Brahm?, the Resplendent Ones, the Powerful Ones, the Ultrapowerful Ones, all things, I have known, how unsatisfying are all things: this have I recognized and I have renounced all things, abdicated from all things. detached myself from all things, forsworn all things, disdained all things. And in this. O Brahma, not only am I your equal in knowledge, not only am I not less than you. but I am far greater than you.” And the words: “This is not mine, This am I not, this is not my self” must be said by the “noble son” for the whole of that world too. It is still “sams?ra.” Is a higher limit than this conceivable? For the Ariya it is conceivable. Attachment, dependence, and enjoyment are to be eradicated also in respect of the supreme goal of the Buddhist asceticism, that is to say, of extinction. Here is the final temptation and the final victory. Here the will for the unconditioned approaches the paradoxical. The ultimate truth of the series is this: he who thinks extinction, he who thinks of extinction, he who thinks “extinction is mine” and who rejoices in extinction—this man does not know extinction, does not know the path, is not to be counted among the “noble disciples.” Even in this region to feel desire and attachment—maybe a sublimated one—means not to realize the place and signification of real liberation...”

http://www.cakravartin.com/wordpress/wp-content/uploads/2008/11/the_doctrine_of_awakening.rtf

Olavsson on 2015-12-21 at 12:22 said:

Excellent commentaries, Cologero. I've been thinking of reading the novel 'Submission' for a good while. While the 'ideal' scenario for the West of course is a complete restoration of sacred order based on Europe's own tradition, it is certainly true that once a civilization has so utterly and completely betrayed the Spirit itself as has been the case with the West, it should not at all be surprising if that very same Spirit is forced to reestablish itself from without, so to speak. I wouldn't hesitate for a moment to choose a Europe integrated with a complete Islamic order over a Europe abandoned to modernity. This, many 'identitarians' today would no doubt see as treason. But I ask, what is worse to any noble man: betrayal of timeless divine order as such, or betrayal of some temporal collective identity? Essentially, there is only one war—the spiritual war—and two positions: for or against the integration of human life into the ascending path aligned with transcendental order.

However, it must be remembered that in practical reality the alternatives aren't that clear-cut. For example, the actual Islamic states that exist today do not represent authentic and complete traditional orders. Islamic civilization has degenerated: politically and socially; religiously, through compromises with modernity; and the 'radical' Islam most loudly advocating the restoration of a traditional and imperial Islamic order consists largely of violent fanatics with an inferior understanding of the tradition. As for the solution to modern disorder in Europe, there

are no promising prospects in sight worthy of optimism, whether from Islam or from anywhere else. (This, of course, should cause distress to no one, as we must cultivate detachment from any and every worldly passion.) We should also keep in mind what Guénon wrote on the advent of a 'Counter-Tradition' late in this cycle, which superficially would appear to be a turn away from materialistic modernity as we know it, but having the character of a grotesque parody of tradition more than anything else. ('Reign of Quantity and the Signs of the Times'). The reasons and signs supporting such a future are much more numerous today than they were in Guénon's time, even looking aside from the metaphysical consideration. In any case, those new 'rightists' and identitarians who claim to oppose modernity should shut up their opportunistic whining about "Islam" and get themselves some proper principles, knowing what they are really 'defending' other than a mixture of confused ideas and sentiments. I'd recommend checking out the self-designated reactionary and 'true right' website Righton.net for some rather amusing examples.

The quote and commentary on how our contemporaries all more or less fall into various ridiculous identity-"types" is important to take note of. This even happens to people who claim to be anti-modern and interested in Tradition, and I must admit to previously having fallen into this trap to some extent. The only way to truly avoid this danger is to practice complete detachment and cut off all personal and collective psychological bonds that obscure a pure and naked spirituality that is allowed to become the only guiding star. Easier said than done, of course.

The following reflections are pretty obvious; I only state it in case somebody less informed than Gornahoor's core community should read it:

I always thought Nietzsche's dichotomy between "life-affirming" and "life-denying" religions was nonsensical. If you are confined to a gloomy cave where you're deprived of the absolute light of metaphysical illumination and freedom, are you "cave-denying" if you see it as an inferior mode of being and try to forge a way out of it? The Buddha or the Christ weren't "life-denying" – I would say that "life-transcending" is a far more appropriate way of putting it. To think that Buddha's doctrine, for example, didn't "accept" the world "as such" is only possible because Nietzsche's understanding of Reality as such is far, far more narrow and limited than the gnostic vision of such masters. Regarding those who want to remain chained to "nature", however, I say: let them! Nothing is easier. But they should know that it is this "life-affirming" attitude that is feminine, even infantile, as in a being that is too attached to ever emancipate himself from the Great Mother that is cosmic life in a pantheistic sense – the cyclical generations of samsaric existence. The supreme expression of 'masculine', heroic spirituality, on the other hand, is *kaivalya*, to use a yogic term, the absolute detachment, liberation, the absolute self-abiding, immanent transcendence of ultimate, luminous reality. Truthfully, I see no inherent contradiction between this and Islam's positive attitude to Allah's cosmic revelation of "the world", or rather, of manifestation, which in Tradition embraces many more existential states of

being than the immediate sensible reality we take for “the world.” Even in the generic Hindu tradition, whose universal aim is moksha, supreme deliverance from conditioned existence, there is still traditionally a coexisting ‘affirmation’ of life that nearly surpasses that of Islam itself. Both masculine life-transcending and feminine life-affirming religious values can in fact coexist in the traditional order, all values in their proper place. And so, even in Islam, the impetus to spiritual transcendence has been strongly present. After all – and Rediger seems to contradict himself partly here – the emphasis of Islam is upon Allah, the Absolute, not upon “the world”; and while Allah is present within “the world”, He is also radically transcendent to it. This gives an inferior value to “the world as such” compared to the uncreated Reality of Allah.

@ Boreas: What spiritual path are you pursuing now if you rejected Christian Orthodoxy? Have you decided on a specific course of action?

Whether or not the “man and God remaining separate” (even in Theosis) must be problematic, depends on how it’s understood. At least it isn’t more problematic than the neo-Vedantist ideas critiqued somewhere on here about the highest transcendence being a sort of “merging” with a cosmic “Oneness”, disappearing in an impersonal sea. Certainly the overcoming of all dualism is required to participate in the most absolute ‘state’, but perhaps absolute unity (with Godhead) and absolute ‘Purushic’ separation or isolation of the Self is not as contradictory as some may think. Reminds me of the Vajrayana sage and initiate Dolpopa who said somewhere that ultimate reality is neither One nor many, being limited by neither. Such discussions often become overly abstract and speculative, much because what we’re trying to understand in verbal terms here essentially belongs to a reality that is inexpressible (the initiatic ‘secret’) and must be ‘experienced’ directly, as real transcendence, for infallible knowledge to be possible. This exactly was the reason for the Buddha Shakyamuni’s infamous ‘silence’ on such matters. But as a general rule, if a tradition excludes the possibility of ‘realizing’ a reality that is unborn, uncreated, unconditioned and so on, then it doesn’t go all the way to the peak of the ‘Greater Mysteries’ (see Guénon on the distinction between the ‘Lesser’ and ‘Greater’ Mysteries).

Regarding the question on the femininity and passivity of the soul in respect to Being or Spirit: This is indeed true for the soul as such. The point in Buddha’s asceticism, though (since Boreas quoted a passage from Evola’s ‘Doctrine of Awakening’) is to go beyond the soul as such since it is conditioned. What is inherently conditioned cannot “become” unconditioned – and if it could, it would no longer be the same thing. This is true of the soul. One can, however, “awaken” to the Tathata, Dharmakaya, the absolute nature that has always been unchanging and “behind” the obscurations and appearances of conditioned manifestation. But this does not mean that a *soul* strictly speaking suddenly becomes superior to the dimension of Being. Overcoming the limitations of the soul is possible because the soul is not our true, unborn nature that was before the world, before everything.

Boreas on 2015-12-21 at 15:20 said:

@ Olavsson: Good points regarding the soul and being. I stand corrected.

As to what my path is after rejecting Orthodoxy, I'm still undecided. Currently I'm trying to become an enlightened Pagan and I'm studying different heathen traditions. It might be that I'm arriving at some sort of "esoteric synthesis" (not syncretism) outside any established tradition. Maybe a term Christo-Pagan could be a fitting one for me personally. I'm avoiding the neo-pagan trap however, and would not hesitate to join Christian forces to establish "a social reign of Christ" (I'm still essentially a Monarchist), but that seems to be utopian thinking at the present moment, since all that the orthodoxes of my native land for example are talking socially is democracy, multi-culturalism and inter-faith relationships. I'm certainly not an anti-Christian though, since I value the teachings of Christ very highly.

ARYANWOLF5359021 on 2016-05-13 at 23:15 said:

"Nietzsche, with his prophetic awareness – in an intellectual sense – foresaw this coming disaster ... Man has been downgraded. He is now already 'sub'. We have been made sub-human. So we must take the Nietzschean image of reaching the *Übermensch* as an Islamic duty, an Islamic call." – Shaykh Abdalqadir as-Sufi

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Abdalqadir_as-Sufi

Cologero on 2016-05-14 at 09:49 said:

Time will tell, Aryan Wolf.

10.8 Guénon lecteur de Nietzsche

Mais seule la littérature peut vous donner cette sensation de contact avec un autre esprit humain, avec l'intégralité de cet esprit, ses faiblesses et ses grandeurs, ses limitations, ses petitesse, ses idées fixes, ses croyances ; avec tout ce qui l'émeut, l'intéresse, l'excite ou lui répugne. Seule la littérature peut vous permettre d'entrer en contact avec l'esprit d'un mort, de manière plus directe, plus complète et plus profonde que ne le ferait même la conversation avec un ami — aussi profonde, aussi durable que soit une amitié, jamais on ne se livre, dans une conversation, aussi complètement qu'on ne le fait devant une feuille vide, s'adressant à un destinataire inconnu.

Dans son roman, *Soumission*, **Michel Houellebecq** se réfère à une thèse de philosophie, soutenue à l'université catholique de Louvain-la-Neuve, signée Robert Rediger, et intitulée *Guénon lecteur de Nietzsche*. Au cours des derniers mois, j'ai fait de nombreux efforts pour traquer une copie. Une amie, employée du Département d'État en poste à Bruxelles, a réussi à localiser une photocopie pour moi. Quand elle était en route pour visiter sa famille aux États-Unis pour Noël, j'ai pu l'inspecter pendant son escale à l'aéroport. Bien que je n'ai pas eu beaucoup de temps, je cherchais à en extraire les principaux thèmes.

La première chose à souligner est l'influence profonde que la thèse de Rediger a eu sur Houellebecq lui-même. Ceci est représenté dans les principaux thèmes du roman tel qu'ils sont exprimés par la voix de François, son *alter ego*. En outre, le mémoire fait ressortir plusieurs thèmes rudimentaires qui ont été complétés dans les écrits ultérieurs de Rediger. De toute évidence, René Guénon n'a jamais été un « lecteur » de Nietzsche. Rediger est arrivé à cette conclusion quand il a écrit:

Guénon, à bien y réfléchir, n'a pas été tant que ça influencé par Nietzsche ; son rejet du monde moderne est tout aussi fort, mais il vient de sources radicalement différentes.

La Décadence Ce ne sont donc pas les sources qui sont d'intérêt, mais plutôt comment Guénon et Nietzsche sont parvenus à des conclusions similaires. Plus précisément, il en est la reconnaissance de la décadence de l'Europe, l'échec du christianisme à la prévenir, et la montée de l'Islam. François note ceci:

Il fallait se rendre à l'évidence : parvenue à un degré de décomposition répugnant, l'Europe occidentale n'était plus en état de se sauver elle-même – pas davantage que ne l'avait été la Rome antique au cinquième siècle de notre ère. L'arrivée massive de populations immigrées empreintes d'une culture traditionnelle

encore marquée par les hiérarchies naturelles, la soumission de la femme et le respect dû aux anciens constituait une chance historique pour le réarmement moral et familial de l'Europe, ouvrait la perspective d'un nouvel âge d'or pour le vieux continent.

Les États-Unis sont également dans un état de décomposition, même si les circonstances particulières sont très différentes. La principale différence, bien sûr, est que l'européen reconnaît plus ou moins sa situation alors que son homologue américain est allègrement inconscient de sa situation réelle. Même ceux qui se disent conservateurs aux États-Unis vivent dans l'obscurité. Les talk-shows d'extrême droite sont contrariés par la violence musulmane mais ils, de toutes les personnes, devraient être plus préoccupés par ceux qui ne peuvent tuer l'âme plutôt que ceux qui tuent le corps. Par conséquent, ils condamnent l'islam pour tout dans ce qui est traditionnel. Par exemple, ils soulignent la préoccupation de l'Occident pour les femmes et les droits des homosexuels, tout en louant la séparation de toute autorité spirituelle sur les questions politiques.

Rediger a ironiquement souligné:

Il était tragique, plaiderait-il avec ferveur, qu'une hostilité irraisonnée à l'islam les empêche de reconnaître cette évidence : ils étaient, sur l'essentiel, en parfait accord avec les musulmans. Sur le rejet de l'athéisme et de l'humanisme, sur la nécessaire soumission de la femme, sur le retour au patriarcat : leur combat, à tous points de vue, était exactement le même.

Le Patriarcat Cela se voit tout d'abord dans la fin du patriarcat dans l'Ouest. Dans les mots de François, presque une citation directe du mémoire:

Le patriarcat avait le mérite minimum d'exister, enfin je veux dire en tant que système social il persévérerait dans son être, il y avait des familles avec des enfants, qui reproduisaient en gros le même

schéma, bref ça tournait ; là il n'y a plus assez d'enfants, donc c'est plié.

Le libéralisme a pu renverser toutes les institutions établies: les églises, l'éducation, le travail, dirigeants politiques, et ainsi de suite. Cependant, l'attaque de la famille ne peut pas être maintenue, car sans les enfants, aucune société ne peut continuer à exister.

Néanmoins, le libéralisme poursuit catégorique, alors que le taux de natalité chutent. Il n'y a alors plus une communauté organique mais plutôt un tas de consommateurs indépendants. François énumère quelques exemples:

- le bobo éco-responsable
- la bourgeoise show-off
- la clubbeuse gay-friendly
- le satanic geek
- le techno-zen

En d'autres termes, tout le monde est un « type », en essayant trop dur de se doter d'une identité sui generis. Le lecteur en peut identifier plus. Par exemple, il y a un groupe Facebook appelé « libéral et fier de l'être ». Ainsi, il n'est plus question d'une vision bien raisonnée du monde, mais plutôt un marqueur de l'identité tribale.

François, malgré lui, est un “type”, peut-être le professeur vieillissement ou l'intellectuel décadent. Sa propre vie illustre la stérilité du monde moderne. Rejetant la vie de famille, il s'accouple avec ses élèves, ou avec des call-girls lorsque cela est nécessaire. Les scènes de sexe ne sont pas destinées à être érotique, mais plutôt triste. Sa préférence est pour le sexe anal ou bien il aime éjaculé dans la bouche d'une femme – n'importe où sauf où un homme bien élevé envisagerait comme saine et normale.

L'assimilation et la transformation Rediger prend alors un thème mentionné il y a quelques années sur Gornahoor dans *The Prophecies of Guénon*¹³. Dans *La crise du monde moderne*, Guénon écrit que seul le catholicisme pourrait restaurer la Tradition monde moderne. Rediger est d'accord avec Guénon sur la tradition médiévale:

La chrétienté médiévale avait été une grande civilisation, dont les accomplissements artistiques resteraient éternellement vivants dans la mémoire des hommes ; mais peu à peu elle avait perdu du terrain, elle avait dû composer avec le rationalisme, renoncer à se soumettre le pouvoir temporel, ainsi peu à peu elle s'était condamnée.

Selon Guénon, les dirigeants de l'Eglise auraient oublié les vérités les plus profondes de la tradition. Rediger va plus loin, affirmant que l'Eglise elle-même est activement engagée dans la subversion de la Tradition. Il écrit:

À force de minauderies, de chatteries et de pelotage honteux des progressistes, l'Église catholique était devenue incapable de s'opposer à la décadence des mœurs. De rejeter nettement, vigoureusement, le mariage homosexuel, le droit à l'avortement et le travail des femmes.

Même Guénon, après avoir échoué d'avoir un impact sur la pensée catholique, ouvertement converti à l'Islam. Bien que Guénon a affirmé qu'il l'a fait pour des raisons personnelles, Rediger voit une perspective plus large:

Ce combat nécessaire pour l'instauration d'une nouvelle phase organique de civilisation ne pouvait plus, aujourd'hui, être mené

¹³<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=35>

au nom du christianisme ; c'était l'islam, religion soeur, plus récente, plus simple et plus vraie (car pourquoi Guénon par exemple s'était-il converti à l'islam ? Guénon était avant tout un esprit scientifique, et il avait choisi l'islam en scientifique, par économie de concepts ; et pour éviter, aussi, certaines croyances irrationnelles marginales, telles que la présence réelle dans l'Eucharistie),

Comme l'avait prédit Guénon, les choix possibles sont la dégénérescence, l'assimilation et la transformation. La dégénérescence ne peut pas continuer sans relâche. Dans le roman, Houellebecq opte pour une assimilation douce et puis une transformation. Il prévoit une alliance entre la gauche et les éléments islamistes. Cela ne veut pas si farfelu puisque le libéralisme croit qu'il peut utiliser l'islam à éroder l'influence chrétienne. Toutefois, dans le scénario de Houellebecq, il est l'islam qui assimile la gauche.

La polygamie et l'ordre social Le seul point d'importance pour Guénon portait sur les éléments métaphysiques; tellement qu'il n'offre que peu ou pas d'aperçu de la vie religieuse musulmane réelle et pratique. Rediger, d'autre part, développe sur ces influences tandis que, dans un même temps, il y ajoute les éléments distinctifs de l'Ouest à l'Islam. Pour cette partie de la thèse, il repose davantage sur Nietzsche que sur Guénon.

Puis, Rediger, également suivant Nietzsche, affirme que le christianisme est fondamentalement une religion féminine. Rediger cite Nietzsche de L'antéchrist:

Si l'islam méprise le christianisme, il a mille raisons pour cela ;
l'islam a des hommes pour condition première.

Rediger attribue les idéaux de l'humanisme et les droits de l'homme au dogme de l'Incarnation. Maintenant, vous pourriez objecter que le christianisme médiéval, qui Rediger a loué, était lui-même patriarcal et

masculin. Quelqu'un peut-il accuser Constantin, Clovis, Charlemagne, Arthur, ou Boucicaud¹⁴ d'être féminin ? En outre, les médiévaux ont admiré les grands guerriers païens comme Hector, Alexandre, Scipion, et Jules César. Même St Paul a considéré mollesse comme un péché. À ce stade, Rediger fait la seule référence à Julius Evola que j'ai remarqué : il affirme aussi que cet élément masculin dans la chrétienté médiévale était due uniquement à des vestiges encore existants du paganisme, mais pas quelque chose de spécifiquement chrétien.

Tout d'abord, Rediger accepte la classification de Nietzsche d'affirmation de la vie et religions de la vie de renoncement, dont l'Islam appartient à la première. Il écrit :

l'islam accepte le monde, et il l'accepte dans son intégralité, il accepte le monde tel quel, pour parler comme Nietzsche. Le point de vue du bouddhisme est que le monde est dukkha – inadéquation, souffrance. Le christianisme lui-même manifeste de sérieuses réserves – Satan n'est-il pas qualifié de "prince de ce monde" ? Pour l'islam au contraire la création divine est parfaite, c'est un chef d'œuvre absolu. Qu'est-ce que le Coran au fond, sinon un immense poème mystique de louange ? De louange au Créateur, et de soumission à ses lois.

Rediger se tourne de nouveau à Nietzsche pour justifier l'ordre hiérarchique et patriarcal islamique. Il y aurait un petit groupe d'aristocrates qui surplomberaient une large base de gens ordinaires. Destitution serait réduite en raison de l'exigence de l'aumône. En outre, la famille élargie serait les « premiers intervenants », pour ainsi dire, dans le cas des tragédies de la vie. Ces éléments réduiraient la taille du budget de l'aide sociale. De plus, le chômage serait réduit parce que les femmes auraient quittés le milieu du travail pour rester à la maison, pour l'éducation des enfants.

¹⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=277>

La polygamie, aussi, est comprise comme la volonté de puissance. Le plus fort et le plus génétiquement ajustement aurait plus de femmes, d'où plus d'enfants. Bien sûr, cela signifie que certains hommes n'auraient pas de descendance du tout. Cela me rappelle ce que nous a récemment écrit à propos de Social Surgery¹⁵. Dans quelle mesure la communauté a le droit de réglementer la composition génétique de ses membres, en supposant que l'objectif soit le bien commun ?

À ce stade, Rediger devient moins convaincant car il ne pousse pas ses idées jusqu'à leur conclusion logique. Il mentionne avec raison que les hommes de tous types et castes choisiront le même genre de femmes. Par exemple, dans le choix du partenaire, la plupart des hommes, indépendamment de l'intelligence ou de la station dans la vie, préféreraient une Taylor Swift. Les femmes, d'autre part, sont plus malléables dans leur choix du partenaire; par exemple, elles peuvent négliger l'apparence ou l'âge d'un homme s'il est riche ou puissant.

En outre, l'attraction de la femme peut être formée. Rediger, donc, veut définir les intellectuels comme des "mâles dominants", qui méritent des femmes de meilleure qualité. Il serait incroyable que, dans l'Ouest comme il en est maintenant, les femmes seront attirés par les thomistes studieux plutôt que le « star » de l'équipe. Cependant, en y réfléchissant, les étudiantes sont souvent attirées par leurs homologues masculins. Les femmes asiatiques, et dans une moindre mesure les Latines, sont plus susceptibles que les femmes européennes de trouver un grand ingénieur sexuellement désirable.

Pour ce faire, Rediger affirme qu'il y aurait des femmes qui serviraient d'entremetteuses. Les détails de ce processus sont flous. Il est facile de déterminer si les pays islamiques sont biologiquement plus en forme que les pays occidentaux. Ma compréhension est que le contraire est parfois le cas en raison de la préférence pour les mariages entre cousins. Mais peut-être, la version occidentalisée nietzschéenne de l'Islam de Rediger

¹⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=8253>

deviendrait la norme.

Avec un gémissement Dans l'ensemble, la structure sociale est basée sur la soumission, à commencer par la soumission à Dieu. Ensuite, il y a la soumission à l'ordre social, et enfin la soumission des femmes aux hommes. Houellebecq voit dans *l'Histoire d'O* de Pauline Réage le modèle de soumission. Il voit cela comme se produisant sans grand incident. Ceci est difficile à croire, mais, étant donné que les « 50 Shades of Grey » a vendu plus de 70 millions d'exemplaires, peut-être il y a un désir secret d'être dominée.

Ainsi, la transition se termine sans éclat, mais avec un gémissement. Pourquoi en serait-il de cette façon? Certains diront que ce n'est qu'une question de commodité, que les intellectuels et les autres profitent des nouvelles possibilités qui s'ouvrent pour eux. Rediger se termine par une réponse différente:

Au fond, c'était un mystère ; Dieu en avait décidé ainsi.

Si tel est le cas, alors le mystère des trois anneaux¹⁶ aura été résolu.¹⁷
H/T DB for proofreading the French text.

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2016-02-17 at 10:38 said:

Rediger seems to echo Evola, but with a much more pro-Islamic tone (this makes sense as in the book, he has benefited from Islamic rule). I continue to believe Guenon was right on the viability for Christianity, though certainly the virility of Catholicism has slipped since his day. Understandably, he never interacted with Orthodoxy as most Western scholars would have presumed it dead, especially after the Iron Curtain descended.

¹⁶<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7872>

¹⁷For an English translation, see Section 10.7 in this book.

10.9 The Stupid Twenty First Century

Rather than watch the Academy Awards, I had some time to glance through some “conservative” or “right” web sites. The striking thing I noticed is the trend toward an Oprah Winfrey type of “confessional” writing and “conversion” experiences. On this, we agree with H L Mencken who never trusted anyone who had too many conversions. My recommendation is to end such writings immediately: it is demeaning and humiliating.

The other thing to notice is the complete lack of agreement. The Left is united on goals, just not, perhaps, on the method or rapidity of change. The alleged right is all over the place. Everyone loves a winner, and the Left is winning. It seems unstoppable, on the winning side of history, and without credible opposition.

Leon Daudet was a co-founder, along with Charles Maurras, of the journal *Action Française* and sympathetic to Rene Guenon (who likewise was, for a time, sympathetic to the goals of Action Francaise.) Guenon even refers to Daudet more than once. Regarding Guenon, Daudet wrote:

Since the time of the Encyclopedists, or even the Reformation, the West has been in a state of intellectual anarchy that is a veritable barbarism.

The civilization of which it is so proud rests upon a collection of material and industrial improvements (which exacerbate the risk of war) and a weak moral and intellectual substructure which lacks any metaphysical basis.

By different paths, I had reached a similar conclusion in my own analysis of the benighted nineteenth century, but my ignorance of Eastern philosophy, of which Guenon is a master, prevented me from laying out the formidable parallel that he presents to us. Although he does not expressly say so, it is evident that the West is threatened more from within, on account of its mental weakness,

than from outside, where its prospects nevertheless are also not so certain.

So those who suddenly have become aware of a ‘problem’ in the West, are really johnny-come-latelys. Perhaps the United States were immune from the effects of the European malaise and are just now catching up. Daudet traces it back to the 19th century, but Guenon and Evola, detect its roots in the Reformation, Enlightenment, and Revolution. Those who see in those historical movements the solution to the problem are unfortunately mistaken, despite their sincerity and good intentions. They have no place on the “right”. In his book, published in 1922, *The Stupid 19th Century*, Daudet writes:

The liberal is a man who venerates the good God but respects the devil He aspires to order and praises anarchy. ... The liberal dominates the nineteenth century. He is its teacher and pride. .. on the social level, as on the economic and political level, the harmful effects of liberalism are innumerable.

The unjustly scoffed at, vilified, execrated term “Reaction” must be boldly taken up again, if we want to chase away the blood-thirsty error, if we lead back to the true peace, institutions and notions of life with the collapse of the notions and institutions of death, honored in the 19th century.

Clearly, the collapse of the ideas of the 19th century has not yet occurred. Should it ever happen, it will be from its own inner contradictions, not from any intellectual threat from the right. Daudet leaves us with a list of deadly ideas from that century, though they are just as relevant today. Use it as a self-test to determine which side you are really on. I think a score of 20 or higher should suffice.

The clichés or deadly ideas of the 19th century

1. The 19th century is the century of science.
2. The 19th century is the century of progress.
3. The 19th century is the century of democracy, which is progress and progress continues.
4. The darkness of the Middle Ages.
5. The Revolution is sacred and emancipated the French people.
6. Democracy is peace. If you want peace, prepare the peace.
7. The future is science. Science is always beneficial¹⁸
8. Secular education is the emancipation of the people¹⁹
9. Religion is the child of fear.
10. It is States that fight. The people are always ready to come to agreement.
11. It is necessary to replace the study of Latin and Greek, which have become useless, with those living languages which are useful.
12. The relations between peoples are ceaselessly going to improve. We are racing toward a United States of Europe (EU).
13. Science has neither borders nor country.
14. The people thirst for equality²⁰.
15. We are at the dawn of a new era of brotherhood and justice.

¹⁸Global warming?

¹⁹Check out the test scores.

²⁰Some are more equal than others.

16. Property is theft. Capital is war.
17. All religions are the same, as long as they admit to the divine²¹.
18. God exists only in and through human consciousness. This consciousness creates God a little more each day²².
19. Evolution is the law of the universe²³.
20. Men are born naturally good. It is society that corrupts them.
21. There are only relative truths; absolute truth does not exist²⁴.
22. All opinions are good and worthy.

Posted on 2011-02-27 by Cologero

* * *

James O'Meara on 2011-02-28 at 19:39 said:

In Mann's *Dr. Faustus*, Leverkühn says something like: "The nineteen century must have been an unusually comfortable place; no one seems to want to leave it."

10.10 Monotheism, Totalitarianism, and other strange Memes

A meme is an idea that spreads from mind to mind, uncritically, much like the way a virus infects the body. Just as a virus is usually deleterious, if not fatal, to the host organism, so also is the meme to clear and critical

²¹And universal brotherhood.

²²I am god.

²³Every day I am getting better.

²⁴Except this one.

thinking. Because of some alleged or fantasized connection or compatibility between the new right/neopagan movement and Tradition based on memes, we find it once again to address them. These are:

- The illogic of mythos
- The relationship between monotheism and totalitarianism
- The origin of liberalism
- Volkisch arguments

Our primary goal is to clearly demonstrate the radical incompatibility between Tradition and the New Right because the latter movement claims an “inspiration” from the former. We will make that absolutely clear to any but the obtuse. This exercise is not to prove that one or the other false, but just to show they are logically and historically incompatible. Since the new right is primarily a political movement, we are not necessarily attacking their goals or tactics. They simply are not our goals or tactics.

Illogic of Mythos **Alain de Benoist** has openly stated his method is to prefer Mythos over Logos, as his inspiration is **Nietzsche** who regarded Reason as merely in instrument for the Will to Power. Hence, in this sense of the word, a myth is akin to a meme; it is to be accepted because it gives “life” or power, not because it is true. Nevertheless, new rightists argue as though they are saying something true; rather, they are using the power of rhetoric to persuade others to a point of view. That is why new right web sites are so concerned with graphics or appearing “hip”, as that is how you penetrate the mass mind. The conclusion is what counts, not the logical process to get there.

Monotheism and Totalitarianism This has got to be one of the strangest memes, articulated by Benoist in *Monotheism vs. Polytheism*²⁵, with a reach further than I would expect. Julian Assange ended his interview with the Muslim cleric Sayyid Nasrallah²⁶ by asking him about it. Listen to the response if you like (circa 25:00). Benoist's essay suffers from four major defects:

- Belief and Action
- Misunderstanding of Monotheism
- Myth of tolerance
- The Value of Totalitarianism

Belief and Action It is true that a strongly held belief leads to action. For example, if I believe the weather will be fair this weekend, I may make plans for a picnic on Saturday. However, my belief does not cause the picnic, because the weather may change and ruin my picnic. But that is Benoist's position. He claims that the belief in monotheism results in totalitarianism. His corollary, which doesn't even follow, is that belief in polytheism results in toleration. He simply assumes the preference of toleration, the ultimate liberal value, to totalitarianism. Not even considering the question of the truth of the two options, Benoist himself believes neither in mono- nor polytheism, since they are equally mythos, or unproveable and irrefutable perspectives. Hence, the two theisms act as shibboleths²⁷ to identify friend and foe. Polytheists are friends and are allowed in the new right circle of trust, otherwise, not, since they are masks for totalitarianism.

²⁵<http://home.alphalink.com.au/~radnat/debenoist/alain10.html>

²⁶<http://rt.com/news/assange-hezbollah-nasrallah-syria-263/>

²⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3736>

Misunderstanding of Monotheism Benoist's understanding of monotheism is absurd, stooping to the most primitive level. Monotheism²⁸, understood in the classical sense, is part of Tradition. Its roots in the West do not lie in the Old Testament, but rather in the constant Western tradition. **Plato** and **Aristotle**, each accepting an ultimate principle, recapitulate more ancient traditions, reaching back to the Vedas. **Plotinus**, who was a major source of doctrine for Evola, claimed that everything arose from the One. The Medieval understanding of God, as Being, continues that same thread. It is hardly worth commenting on Benoist's thesis, given its clearly false premises.

Myth of Tolerance The next claim is the polytheism leads to tolerance, a claim that is absurd metaphysically and false historically. If polytheism means anything at all, it means that there are multiple independent powers, not subject to some unique and supreme power (i.e., monotheism). How, then, is it possible for them to almost act in harmony? Obviously, it is not at all possible, so these powers will come into conflict with each other with nothing higher to resolve any such conflicts. Hence, Poseidon is a jealous god and resents the gift given to Zeus. Men are subject to the arbitrary and inconsistent whims of gods and goddesses, one offering blessings and the other putting up obstacles, or take up different sides in a conflict.

Historically, polytheism did not lead to mutual tolerance. This is clearly pointed out by **Fustel de Coulanges** in his *Ancient City*. When two cities came into conflict, they did not tolerate each other. Either the weaker became subservient to the stronger and was forced to acknowledge the latter's gods, or else it was utterly destroyed, men, women, children and livestock.

²⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3344>

The Value of Totalitarianism This is the final refutation of Benoist. Rather than a negative, this is essential to the Traditional world view, as Evola asserts²⁹. For the Traditional civilization, every aspect of life was guided by spiritual principles and cosmic law. Is the Law of Gravity totalitarian because everything that goes up must come down? Perhaps so, but that is in the very nature of things. Analogously, if there truly is a cosmic law, then all of human life is subject to it. Paradoxically, this leads to tolerance. In traditional civilizations, the cosmic law adapts to different cultural conditions, manifesting as positive law. If two such civilizations should confront each other and recognize the cosmic law mutually followed, they can distinguish between contingent adaptations and necessary principles. This reliance on common principles will allow them to resolve their differences. (Obviously, this doesn't happen in conflicts between strictly exoteric entities.)

Liberalism and the Folk

Liberalism

As to tolerance, it is surprising how far removed from the equity and prudence of the Church are those who profess what is called Liberalism. For, in allowing that boundless license of which We have spoken, they exceed all limits and end at last by making no apparent distinction between truth and error, honesty and dishonesty.

POPE LEO XIII, *On Human Liberty*

It is not our intent here to debate the irrefutable facts of history, but rather the spiritual roots of liberalism. Intolerance, which is not equivalent to totalitarianism, is a fact of life. Any healthy social body will resist

²⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4035>

influences that threaten it, including spiritual as well as material threats. Christians from time to time forced conversions, contrary to its alleged principles. Pagans tortured Christians, not to mention waged all out wars between each other. It is hardly a novelty and it is absurd to think it will never happen again. Ruling powers almost always use force to maintain themselves. When an American politician claims that Assad is “killing his own people”, I would like to ask him how many of his own people did Abraham Lincoln kill? Such actions are always felt justified by someone.

Benoist writes that Christianity and liberalism are spent forces and hopes for a new paganism to fill the vacuum. Perhaps it will, but I think we have demonstrated that ancient paganism was not quite what he envisions.

The meme we dispute is the New Right claim that liberalism is secularized Christianity. Benoist, given his early involvement with Maurras’ thought, certainly knows the long standing opposition between the two points of view. To combat that meme, we took the trouble to edit and format Donoso’s book on the topic³⁰. Leo XIII is closer to understanding liberalism than is Benoist. The former recognizes that in liberalism, there is no difference between truth and error, right and wrong ... they all assert and demand equal rights. But that is precisely the Nietzschean view espoused by Benoist: there is no truth, there are only perspectives.

The ethics of liberalism are not at all those of Catholicism, at least when it was Traditional. Instead, we claim, with much more justification than Benoist’s thesis, that it is actually the vision of Charles Maurras that is secularized Catholicism. If we accept Evola’s claim that the historico-material world is a reflection of spiritual reality, then a secularized version of that would be to take the reflection itself as the sole reality without reference to its spiritual underpinning.

That is precisely what **Charles Maurras**, following the lead of **Auguste Comte**, did. Positivism in their hands proposed a political and

³⁰<https://gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf>

social program that was compatible with, if not identical to, what any Catholic government would have implemented. Benoist certainly knows this, but neglects to mention it; his sycophants are ignorant of it. But Benoist rejected Maurras along with the latter's counter-revolutionary program. What he would replace it with is far from clear; however, it is necessarily not the counter revolution.

We don't know the purpose of the memes spread by Benoist, other than to stifle logical thinking and replace it with easily assimilable slogans. We suggest that those on the right who are uncomfortable with theological language and reject the supernatural put aside Benoist's books for a time. Check out Comte and Maurras; perhaps you will find more useful ideas.

Volkisch Movements The volkisch meme persists in some quarters; this is only a concern when they claim to be speaking for Tradition. In Tradition, the folk are lunar and passive. While there may be some sort of folk soul, it is changeable over time, just as is their material and biological constitution. As passive, the folk are absorbers of ideas, not creators. Ancient peoples believed they were founded by a divine being, usually an ancestor, who formed them, promulgated their laws, taught them their rites, and gave them a spiritual vision. This was subsequently developed by their priests, poets, and others from their spiritual and political elite.

From the Traditional perspective, then, we are not so concerned about what the folk believed, but rather about what the elite understood. We have heard recently commentators claim that "our people" are Baptists, and others say "our people" are Odinsts; they are speaking of the same people. That is a sentimental attitude, but lacking in spiritual depth. Lasting change requires a real conversion; then there will be a vision without which the people will perish.

Posted on 2012-04-25 by Cologero

* * *

logres on 2012-04-26 at 08:20 said:

Saladin always comes to mind, as an exemplar of somebody with whom the Crusaders could wage a war that was not a modern war of extermination, but a holy war by both sides, acknowledged as such.

So – “If two such civilizations should confront each other and recognize the cosmic law mutually followed, they can distinguish between contingent adaptations and necessary principles. This reliance on common principles will allow them to resolve their differences. (Obviously, this doesn't happen in conflicts between strictly exoteric entities.)”

The last point is well-taken; when the esoteric cores go, leaving the husks behind, the World Wars are on the way. Conversely, one sees someone like Dinesh D'Souza suggesting that Christianity has more in common with Islam than liberalism does, a suggestion which provoked a huge amount of anger from one of my progressive friends (who I think was frightened by the spectre of Christians and Muslims turning on their political masters together).

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dinesh_D%27Souza

Cologero on 2012-04-26 at 08:54 said:

Not just progressives, but neocons. I find it curious that in opposing Islam, neo-conservative commentators always seem to take the liberal position.

golgonooza on 2012-04-27 at 11:46 said:

The very process of secularization as commonly thought of as a 'rolling back' of superstition to create a space for the neutral and rational public sphere has been called into question by radical orthodoxy. It claims that liberalism has been born out of this belief in the neutrality of the secular, when in fact the secular is actually a pseudo-theological creation, replacing the sacred with different ultimate concerns.

For instance Neo-liberalism rests on the idea that political subjects need protecting from each other, from which the notion of rights comes. In this pseudo-theology the fundamental nature of the world is violence and power.

This just replaces the Augustinian view of the world as fundamentally harmonious – violence appears in this view as an intrusion into that order, and humans don't need protecting from each other, but reconciling with each other.

Cologero on 2012-04-27 at 20:20 said:

Good points, golgonooza. Pace the New Right, it reinforces in a different way that liberalism is not the logical outcome of Tradition, but rather a pseudo-Tradition, that arose from a rejection or reversal of fundamental principles.

Liberalism denies the existence of truth with the naive assumption it will spontaneously arise in a “neutral and rational public sphere” through debate and conversation. Instead, it became the battleground for different perspectives, subject only to the Will to Power. Those with the most power came to dominate the so-called neutral public sphere. Nietzsche’s thought is the logical outcome of the liberalism: he praises the will to power to embrace and promote perspectives rather than to arrive at Truth. The latter project, he calls decadent.

Nietzsche expected out of the ruins of liberalism that a noble pagan superman would arise. Instead, we ended up with the hermeneutics of suspicion. If the will to power is the ultimate reality, then of course power and violence is the result, both of which Nietzsche praised. But there is no **superman** to dominate and enforce his will over the rest. Instead we have a society of the petty minded, suspicious of each other, and battling over their respective material and sensual interests.

Evola's *Tools of the Occult War*

II.1 Tactics of the Occult War

Be wise as Lucifer and as innocent as the Holy Spirit.

The tactics of the **Occult War** describe the third dimension of history, that of depth, beyond the dimensions of space and time by which we conventionally view things. Yet, those who can only understand in terms of facts, material causes, and visible leaders still think at the level of brutes. Even worse, many men, wishing to be seen as intelligent, deliberately cultivate this view, thereby blinding themselves to any deeper understanding.

Let no one be deceived into believing that this is a simple matter. Even among those who desire to, or claim to, follow Tradition, there are many who fall victim to the tactics of the occult war, including some whom I have known personally for some time and would have expected a bit more insight.

This War, at its most fundamental layer, as the battle between the forces of Order and the forces of Chaos. This necessarily assumes, with-

out question or dispute, that there is a Cosmic Order, which we have been calling **Logos** and obviously a force behind that Logos, which we have called **Providence**, in accordance with Guenon and other Traditional and Hermetic authors. Hence, two requirements are imperative for anyone who wishes to consciously engage in this War.

1. He must understand the Cosmic Order
2. He must align his Will with the forces of that Order

The dimension of depth is the province of the Spirit, apart from and beyond any physical or material considerations. Obviously, then, to begin such an engagement, the spiritual warrior must first of all wage that battle in his own consciousness. Specifically, he must understand his own inner constitution, above all, the various layers of his soul life. He must strive to bring them into harmony with the Cosmic Order by subduing the lower layers to the higher. He must learn to harness the erotic and thumotic impulses that, left to themselves, lead to a process of inner integration.

To understand Gornahoor, readers must keep this foremost in mind. On the one hand, we have striven to describe the Cosmic Order in many different ways, apart from any a priori ideological commitment or allegiance to any particular movement or institution. We also hope to inspire others to take up arms in this battle in the way they see fit. In addition, one must also understand the forces of Chaos. Those forces employs several tactics, which we summarize below. We have already written about some of them in detail, others we shall take up as the need arises.

Scientific Suggestion This tactic involves the suggestion that science and the commitment to the world of facticity is the only way to understand the world. For example, we have described Francis Bacon's jettisoning of the knowledge of formal and final causes¹ as the basis for science,

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3468>

to the point where an educated man no longer knows what they are and think it fantastic when they are explained to him.

Replacement When men are no longer satisfied with science, they may turn to abstruse philosophical or ideological explanations. Such philosophical systems are so complex and subtle that their adherents spend several years, usually in their youth, to fully grasp them. This commitment and one-pointedness prevent them from reaching the dimension of depth. We see this today, unfortunately, even among those who aspire to Tradition, but commit to philosophic ideas, often of French origin, a strange counterweight to Guenon.

Counterfeits When the effects of Chaos are too obvious to ignore, some may turn to Tradition, but more often a counterfeit of Tradition. For example, we see today those who commit to a form of neopaganism that never existed as a Tradition anywhere, any time. These counterfeits take up the visual symbols and residues of earlier Traditions, but lack the understanding of their spiritual foundations.

Inversion This tactic begins by attacking spiritual intuition and gnosis, replacing them by psychological considerations. The logic and rationality of metaphysics is abandoned in favour of irrational and subconscious forces. Hence, there is the rise of all sorts of neospiritualities, extolled even in some New Right circles, that reject the actual Traditions, which they consider too rigid and limiting. Just today, some woman tried to convince me that masturbation is the key to discovering God. It is certainly a democratic and egalitarian notion, although you would think that enlightenment would be universal by now.

Ricochet This occurs when the representatives of one Tradition oppose themselves to other Traditions. Gornahoor has taken pains to point

out how Traditions agree at the level of depths and has not opposed any real Traditions. Yet there are many who attack the dominant and most recent Tradition of the West, whether out of ignorance or malice, for a fleeting political advantage. In the attempt to attract committed adherents, they end up on the same side as their enemies. For example, neopagan groups use the tactics of their declared enemies to discredit the Medieval Tradition, thereby undermining Tradition itself. The Ricochet is the best way to destroy every unity and solidarity.

Dilution The forces of subversion replace an idea that seems too radical at a given time, with a more diluted version that seems more acceptable.

Misidentification of Principle with its Representatives This has been a very effective tactic of the forces of subversion, since the mass of men are nominalists, meaning they cannot even understand principles but only individual things. Thus if some leader or member or adherent of a Tradition has betrayed his principles, men come to reject the principles themselves. This is all too common, even those I know personally who claim to be “Traditionalists”.

Replacing Infiltrations Unfortunately, organizations and societies whose original impetus was to preserve and promote some aspect of Tradition degrade over time. The leaders, as well as members, of such groups become ignorant of their founding spirits, and instead grow accustomed to the material benefits and unearned prestige that accrue to such leadership. Such organizations are easily discredited along with the principles they had been created to uphold.

Simplification Instead of making the effort to grasp complex forces and multifarious phenomena, men are too easily attracted to overly sim-

plistic explanations. For example, the modern ideals of liberalism, socialism, scientism, and rationalism are the outcome of several historical antecedents among which are the Renaissance, the Reformation, French Revolution, Marxism.

Clearly, that is replacing a spiritual cause with a material one. Then there are those who are part of such subversive movements, yet beyond all logic, still expect a different result. Some see a superficial commitment to certain issues, and then assume they are natural allies. However, at the level of depth, nothing could be further from the truth. The most egregious example that bypasses 1500 years of Western history in a one sentence slogan, attribute all the modern deviations listed above to an alleged secularization of the Medieval Tradition. Yes, I have heard that from educated men, as I'm sure many readers have.

Based on writings of different authors.

Posted on 2012-01-25 by Cologero

II.2 The Tools of the Occult War

In this article from the January 1938 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, Julius Evola describes his understanding of the occult war and its tactics. This should clear up two widely spread misconceptions.

- The first misconception is that the occult war has something to do with so-called occult or magical practices. To the contrary, it is not a question of men employing higher, or transhuman, forces to achieve their aim, but rather of those forces using men, with or against their will, whether they are conscious of it or not, to achieve aims apart from the desires of men.
- The second misconception is that Evola is an adherent of conspiracy theories. Conspiracy theories restrict themselves

to a two dimensional understanding of history, where some small group of men control events for their own ends. Evola is referring to something much deeper.

The rest of the article speaks for itself and it is surprising how, today, such a view is barely comprehensible. This is despite the work of **Wilhelm Wundt**, who made a similar point from a purely secular point of view. Yet the rapidity of the way public opinion can be swayed ought to give one pause.

Whatever Evola says about the occult war can only be understood by keeping in mind Guenon's writings of the anti-tradition, counter-tradition, and related topics. It may be surprising to some that Evola mentioned the Catholics as holding a similar understanding to his. That is understandable to those who only know the Vatican II church. But older writings do indeed describe an occult or spiritual war; the older Church and Evola even agree on the specific historical organizations or agents of the anti-tradition. We will, at some future date, reproduce some of those writings.

Part I The occult war is when the forces of worldwide subversion lead from behind the scenes, adopting means that almost always elude ordinary methods of investigation. The notion of an occult war belongs to a tridimensional vision of history, to a history considered not according to the two dimensional surface of apparent causes, events, and leaders, but rather one depending on the third dimension of depth, the hidden dimension, which retrieves the decisive forces and influences which are often not even ascribable to the simple human element, whether individual or collective.

Having used the adjective "hidden", it is necessary to make its importance precise, indicating that it is not a question of an obscure and irrational substrate of scientific history, of something that could stand in the known part of it, but in the same relationship by which the subconscious stands to the consciousness of waking in the individual. This

analogy is certainly exact, if considered from the point of view of those who, in this tridimensional view of events, appear not as the *subjects*, but rather of the *objects* of history: in their acting and thinking, they do not take into account the true influences which they obey and the true ends that are accomplished through them. They have their true centre more in the subconscious and unconscious than in their waking consciousness, yet, in this respect, we can certainly say that it is in the subconscious that the most decisive movements of the occult war develop.

But from the point of view of the true *subjects* of history, things are quite different, and we can speak, in this regard, not of the subconscious or the unconscious, but we must think of super-intelligent forces, forces that know perfectly what they want and the most appropriate means to realize what they want. To suppose that this substrate of history is accounted for by the “irrational”, by “life”, by “becoming”, or by whatever else of those confused entities invented by modern historicism at the moment in which they thought they went beyond so-called scientific historiography, is among the most dangerous errors. We believe, on the contrary, that we see in that one of the suggestions prudently spread in certain circles typical of the aims of certain movements of the occult war in modern times.

We will explain ourselves more clearly in what follows. For now, it is enough to establish this point: we must not allow the third dimension of history to vanish in the fog of abstract and philosophical views, but we must consider it inhabited and occupied by quite precise “intelligences”, whose expression and closest mouthpieces were almost always certain secret societies or organizations, but which must not at all totally express the intelligences, but just having their beginning and end in them.

Examining the various conceptions of history widespread in the West, perhaps it is the Catholic conception, out of all of them, that can claim views of the same type. It is typical of such conceptions, in fact, to see history not as a mechanism of natural, political, economic, or social causes,

but as the unfolding of a type of plan (the “providential” plan) opposed by adverse forces and their historical emissaries, forces that assume either the moralistic designations of the “forces of evil” or the religious one of anti-Christian forces or forces of the Antichrist. One such conception can already furnish a foundation when it is transposed from the teleological plan to a practical plan and if it makes its general principle through an interpretation deepened by events. In the second place, when it is generalized, establishing its susceptibility to still be of value in non-Christian civilizations, for which it will be well, in this regard and with reference to human institutions, to speak generically of forces of tradition and forces of the anti-Tradition, the forces of the spiritual hierarchy and revolutionary subversion, the forces of the cosmos and of chaos. In this particular case, the anti-Traditional forces will also appear naturally as anti-Catholic forces, insofar as, in the Catholic tradition, they are intended to combat the Traditional spirit in general, to destroy the basis of every hierarchy and to ruin their historical representatives.

In our time, we will never be able to insist enough on the necessity of penetrating a view of the type that must not be considered as one among the many possible “speculations” of philosophy, but rather as an indispensable organ for true action. We are pleased to reproduce here a passage of the famous Protocols, to which we had previously called attention.

The purely brute mind of the gentiles is incapable of use for analysis and observation, and still more for the foreseeing whither a certain manner of setting a question may tend. In this difference in capacity for thought between the gentiles and ourselves may be clearly discerned the seal of our position as the Chosen People and of our higher quality of humanness, in contradistinction to the brute mind of the gentiles. Their eyes are open, but see nothing before them and do not invent (except perhaps, material things).

It is a truthfully alarming thing to think in how many cases such a judgment about the gentiles—who would be, this this special reference which makes Israel the principle agent of worldwide subversion, the non-Hebrews, but who can also be considered, in general, as those who we already called the “objects of history”—has still today a profound content of truth. The point of view of the greater part of the so-called “men of action”, compared to those of the hidden adversaries, can certainly be said to be babies: they concentrate all of the strength on what is directly graspable with the hands, and are incapable of establishing the relationships of cause and effect beyond the range of an extremely limited zone and of a nature almost always grossly material. Moreover, there is a fundamental lack of principles, since they almost always believe that the point of view of action cannot be “dogmatically” subordinated to principles, but must be related to the “unavoidable necessities of the moment”.

Unfortunately, this is still the level typical of most counter-revolutionary forces. It is a situation that can be compared to that of someone who finds himself perfectly equipped for the high mountain, with boots, sack, cord, and pick and then finds himself, after happily passing many tests, facing an expanse of water, at a lake or a sea, throws himself into it enthusiastically, believing that his equipment will still help him and lead him forward. Instead, it will only be of use to make him sink more rapidly to the bottom.

The occult war is exercised on that which, with an image drawn from positive science, we will call the “imponderables”, or imponderable quantities. It is adopted fairly often to produce nearly insensible changes, from which sizable effects will proceed slowly but fatally. It almost never acts with forces opposed to other forces, but rather through an opportune direction of it, so as to lead to the desired effects. What Wundt called the heterogony of ends², plays a fundamental part in it: it is precisely about acting, while some forces or men believe they are willing and producing a

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Heterogony_of_ends

given effect, and it alone, in actuality, they will produce or prepare something else quite different from it, thus uncovering an influence and an intelligence that transcends them. It is for this reason that, on another occasion in *La Vita Italiana*, we said that the examination of the “differential” existing between the will and the event, between the principles or programs and the true consequences of it in history, offers the most valuable material for whoever truly wants to account for the true forces which history itself has obeyed.

But in this article we want to move beyond the general, and speak of a few of the most frequently used means, in our time, of the hidden powers of worldwide subversion to cover their action, to prevent that of their adversaries, and to continue to exercise their influence.

It is incumbent to point out that the idea here was often given by observations scattered in the various works of **Rene Guenon**. Guenon, in our opinion, has a nearly unique competence in all contemporary Western literature for similar types of problems.

Part II

These are the first four of the eight tools of the occult war identified by **Julius Evola**. For readers unfamiliar with the philosophical currents of Evola's time, “positive” is usually called “scientific” today, at least in English. He also criticizes the philosophies of life (e.g., certain Germans, perhaps even Nietzsche as “life-affirming”), becoming (Bergson, Whitehead), and absolute spirit (Hegel, Gentile).

As other manifestations of subversive forces, he goes on to mention a dilettantish “traditionalism” (which is rampant today) and even zoological racism (the “hipster racism” or “race realism” of today). Then there are all the New Age movements, which have only multiplied in the past 75 years. They hide the true Tradition and can be identified by their preoccupation with strange and unusual phenomena, rather than true spirituality; Evola calls

them demonic. We can add a certain fascination with the dark and the ugly, that some today want to identify with Tradition.

This is one topic that I hope will lead to many comments, discussing, identifying, and clarifying these tools of the subversive forces.

The Positivist Suggestion It is necessary to get used to thinking that the so-called “positive” mode of doing history and of considering events is somewhat less a spontaneous product and prejudice typical of a very limited mentality, than a *suggestion* spread methodically in modern culture by anti-traditional forces, with the purpose of “covering” their action. Whoever believes that history is simply made by men and determined exclusively by economic, political, and social factors sees nothing else. And it is exactly such a world that “sees nothing else” that is needed by whoever wants to act clandestinely. A civilization dominated by the “positivistic” prejudice offers the ideal condition for an action developing along the “third dimension”: and this is exactly the case of the current civilization.

Previously, we mentioned besides “positivistic” interpretations, those having as their basis abstract ideas of becoming”, of “life”, or even of the “Spirit”. In that we can consider a case of the application of a second tool of the occult war, which is:

The Tactic of the Surrogates It is followed, every time that the danger of an “awakening” is manifested and the energies seek to turn beyond the plan dominated by ideas, in the operation of which the occult game of the forces of subversion can easily take place. In the case now mentioned, these confused ideas of “becoming”, “life”, “absolute Spirit”, etc., in fact, are only a decoy thrown at those no longer satisfied with positivistic patterns, and those whose gaze does not bring itself where it should. From the fog of such ideas, the field of action remains so well covered, as by the dark night of “positivistic” agnosticism.

The “tactic of the surrogates” develops, however, in a much more characteristic and effective way under the form of:

Tactic of Falsifying Substitution This is what we are talking about. When the effects of destructive action, appearing even on the material plane and giving rise to clearly visible phenomena, exhibit a degree hot enough to provoke a reaction, this reaction confusedly seeks symbols and myths to serve as the base for an engine of reconstruction, and can also find it legitimate and consistent with its goal. It is almost always about symbols and points of reference that, in their historical aspect, remaining in the traditional past, recalled from atavistic depths through the forces of an organism that feels itself threatened by final destruction. In these cases, the occult war does not take place with a direct action, i.e., not by opposing such symbols, but ensures that they do not circulate and are not worth falsifying or counterfeiting, inasmuch as the reaction either remains limited, or diverted, or even overturned in an opposite direction, on which they naturally move on to apply the same influences present in the evil against which they wanted to act and in the decadence, from which they wanted to rise up from and believed in good faith to be rising up from.

This tactic can develop in diverse domains, in the political as well as in the spiritual camp, and seems today to have a totally special efficiency. It is worth looking at an example.

The most typical is constituted by “traditionalism”. The vague aspiration of a return to tradition, i.e., to a hierarchical and qualitative order centered in a transcendent spirituality and in an elite of its qualified and legitimate representatives, is diverted to in the form of “traditionalism”, i.e., of vague assumptions of a dilettantish, or militant, character that confuses Tradition with custom and the routine, that leads into a narrow-minded particularism, that stops at given, handed-down forms, and knows nothing of their spirit. In such a way, they present an easy

game to their adversaries and provide a good decoy to those who, through the false goal of anti-traditionalism, bring their true blow against tradition and foment new developments of revolutionary subversion. So the reaction remains contained and the maneuver leads successfully to prearranged goals. What, in certain extremist circles, the idea of race threatens to become because of some assumptions in terms of zoological materialism, as so even the Nordic-Aryan idea and even the pagan idea, come back to a conjuncture of the type. It is about ideas that, if they were understood and represented in accordance with their true nature and their ancient spiritual and traditional content, could certainly carry out a creative and healing action within the limits of some peoples of the North. As they appear instead in the circles already indicated, first of all because of a lack of principles, then because of a profound incomprehension and deformation of the ancient "Aryan" world, and finally through the tyranny of immediate interests and irrational impulses, make us suspect the effect of a distorting action of the type indicated. In relation to the new Italy, one should make every effort that something of the type does not occur in certain re-evocations of Romanity. The idea of ancient Rome certainly exists among those who today could have the greatest reconstructive efficacy: it is necessary to see that this efficacy is not paralyzed by means of the reconstituted facsimiles or by mere rhetorical resurrections, or by academic, erudite, archeological and even simply juridical, political assumptions, to which naturally elude completely the central strength and soul of the Roman symbol.

Tactic of Reversal The secret forces of worldwide subversion knew perfectly that the fundamental premise of order to be destroyed was the supernatural element, spirit conceived not as a philosophical abstraction, but rather as a higher reality and as the means of a process of transcendent integration of the personality. The limited influence that, in such a regard, the Catholic tradition could still have (here we cannot stop to

analyze the means to come to that conclusion), the subversive forces had to try in every way to ensure that every new contemporary aspiration toward the supernatural, developing outside of the dominant religion, became distorted and paralyzed. The whole of what can be called neo-spiritualism, with allusion to the various theosophical, spiritist, Orientalizing, and “occultistic” sects can be considered the effect of one such maneuver. In all that, again, it is a question almost exclusively of deformation, counterfeits, and distortions of spiritual doctrine, due to the least qualified persons, who in this respect, seem often to be subjected to a truly demonic influence.

The consequent outcome is twofold. First of all, it provided an easy way of extending the general discredit into which those counterfeits had to fall, to the doctrines in themselves, with which they were practically put in condition of no longer damaging. We can mention that, in recent times, the maneuver has even employed political factors: and there are some circles that, in good faith, are able to see only “Masonry” (something that was made the synonym of revolutionary, anti-Christianity or international subversion) wherever one speaks of secret associations of esoteric symbols, even when such references lead back to ancient traditions, whose original spirit and aristocratic nature everyone should note.

In the second place, because of poorly understood theories and false practices, they are joined to channel all the forces that, constricted by the suffocating stranglehold of materialism and yearning for something extra-natural, not toward the supernatural, but rather toward the subnatural, i.e., the subconscious, mediumship, and, in general, toward a world that, far from representing an integration of the personality, can only propitiate its collapse and disintegration, as much by making of it the tool of some of the darkest “influences”. So with neo-spiritualism the danger constituted by true spirituality was contained and reduced to an almost inessential minimum.

Part III

Tools 5 and 6 of the Occult War. In the Ricochet, Evola warns against causing divisions for particularistic reasons, particularly against another Tradition. Unfortunately, this is not uncommon today. He warns against scapegoating a group or organization for all problems. The focus must always remain on the plan of the subversive powers; focusing on the alleged agents will distract from the fundamental task.

Tactic of the Ricochet Attack It consists in provoking one of the forces to be torn down because of their still traditional character to undertake an action, that initially was aimed against a similar force and apparently of value to strengthen and increase the first force, but that then ricochets against it, dragging it down into the same ruins that it had propitiated against the other. By means of timely infiltrations, the secret forces of worldwide subversion often incite the representatives of a tradition to defend it through the discrediting another: whoever is subject to such a maneuver does not notice that to attack the tradition in the person of another people or civilization, for particularistic reason or contingent and inferior interests, means to be condemned to see itself attacked, sooner or later, in their own home, through a ricochet motion. The forces of worldwide subversion very much count on this tactic, and therefore make every effort to put every higher idea under the subjection of particularistic interests, pride, ambitions, and proletarian tendencies. They know that this is the best means to destroy every unity and true solidarity and to propitiate a state of division, in which their game will be extremely easy.

In this case, one can also allow every Machiavellian utilization of revolutionary forces back in. Some statesmen of scant discernment believed that propitiating or helping the revolution in the nations unfavorable to them was the best means to sustain and defend their true interests. Without realizing it, they prepared the exact opposite result, while they

believed they served the revolution like an instrument, they themselves became tools of the revolution, which had to reach them after having passed over the body of their adversaries. We can say that the entire history of modern times, above all starting from the French Revolution, was the theatre of a subversion that tragically worked in such a way. We can never insist enough, in such regard, on the fact that only the absolute, ascetic, unfaltering adherence to an idea can serve to safeguard against the forces of the occult war. Wherever this standard is abandoned and follows contingent factors, the front of the resistance is broken and, with it, the possibility of a true autonomy.

We do not want to fail to mention a final appearance of an similar maneuver: the ideology characteristic of the “principle of nationality”, the “self-determinism of the people”, and imperialism, proclaimed by the Allies to mobilize every force against the Central Powers and then to beat them World War I, is exactly the best among the ideologies adapted to propitiate a general revolt of the nations of color against the great European powers and to overturn every supremacy from them.

Tactic of the Scapegoat When the hidden forces of worldwide subversion avoid the danger of being unmasked in some of their aspects, they see to it that all the attention of their adversaries is directed and concentrated on some elements, that only in part, or only subordinately, can be considered as responsible for their evildoing. All the reaction is then unloaded on such elements, becoming the true scapegoats. And the hidden forces remain free to pursue their game, their adversaries believing they have at this point identified the enemy and do not have to look for others. We repeatedly admonish certain anti-Semitic extremists to remain well attentive, so that, in their seeing the Jew everywhere, they do not end up by making themselves victims of a trap of that type. The same admonition could be applied equally to those who instead see everywhere Masonry or Protestantism, and so on, analogous processes being also verified in many

other areas. It is necessary to guard against every unilateralism, never forgetting the complex plan of the occult forces which we must combat.

Part IV

The final segment of **Julius Evola's** essay. The final tactic, the **Tactic of the Substitution of Principle to the Person**, is very important, as it describes the creation of the modern world from the Medieval period. As a corollary, it defines what can be meant by the **Right** in the relative sense: it is whatever resists the dissolution of a stage, and the **authentic Right**, in its only true meaning, is whatever works toward the stage prior to the successive degeneration of the castes.

Evola concludes with the necessity of recognizing and indicating the tools used in the occult war. Only then can a man be called a *counter-revolutionary*.

Tactic of Dilution This is a particular case of the “tactic of substitution”. To understand it, it is necessary to start from the idea, that the process that led us up to our current general crisis, had distant origins and various phases and that in each one of such phases—corresponding to specific forms of Civilization, State, ethics, etc.—the crisis was already present even in a less acute, more dilute, potential form rather than actual. The theory of “progress”, or evolutionism, can be considered as another of the suggestions hurled by the subversive hidden forces into the general environment, in order to distract anyone from looking from the perspective of the origins and always pushing well beyond the process of falling, under the thrust of false mirages, and, above all, of that of the conquests of the technical-mechanical civilization. However, the hard experience of tragic events in recent times saw to it that such a hypnosis was no longer able to conserve its efficacy and was no longer able to prevent many spirits from recognizing that the presumed course toward progress was a course

toward the abyss and that a going back was imposed. The hidden front then put into notion every means to prevent any radicalism. One of the preferred methods was, above all, putting a prejudice against “anachronism” into circulation, against “that which is no longer adapted for the times”, and then directing the forces that returned to look toward the origins, toward one or the other of those preceding phases, in which the crisis and evil were found in forms less advanced and, for that very reason, less visible. And even this trap had success. The leaders of worldwide subversion know naturally that, having come to that point, the danger is eliminated, because the whole was reduced to soon retrace the same path and to push, at the end of it, to dissolution even these forces that were awakened and that wanted to react and pull back.

We could also indicate many historical examples of this tactic, both recently and further in the past. Above all, the political Leaders of current anti-subversive movements should not lose it from view. Let us say in all frankness—since in such a field a lack of frankness is certainly equivalent to a fault—there are aspects of contemporary nationalism that would merit being tested thoroughly. Anyone can note, in fact, the anti-traditional, anti-hierarchical, revolutionary character that, in the past, compared to the preceding ecumene of imperial and feudal civilization, had the notion of nation. Now, it is the nation that today predominantly challenges to combat the extreme forms of the crisis and subversion, represented by various red internationals communist parties. There is therefore the necessity to formulate a concept of the nation different from that which makes of it a stage of the path that had to lead to what today we must combat. Several years ago we provided the necessary points of reference to confront and resolve this problem, and to distinguish two nationalisms *La Vita Italiana*, Mar, 1931. We must return to our essay.

Tactic of the Substitution of Principle to the Person It is undeniable that, in many respects, the decadence of traditional institutions

occurs through the decadence of their leaders and representatives. But this is not the only cause: in order to come to a true dissolution and involution, it is necessary that the tactic of the substitution of principle to the person be added to it, a new tool of the occult war, which works in the following way. When the representative of a given principle appears unworthy, a process against the principle in itself is set in motion in the person of this representative, or the process is extended from the person to the principle. They do not come to the conclusion that that representative does not measure up to the principle and must therefore be substituted with another person who can really represent it, but instead they go on to say that the principle itself is false or harmful and must be substituted with another principle.

In how many cases does the attack against this or that degenerate, vain, or vicious aristocrat get translated into the attack against the very aristocratic principle in itself and into a tool of demagogy? And perhaps the subversive and heretical action of Luther, having as his excuse the corruption of the representative of the Roman Church, had a different meaning? Again, history is rich with episodes of the type, equivalent to many other moments of the worldwide subversion. Let us remember that the ancient hierarchical system was constituted by a spiritual authority, under which stood the warrior aristocracy, then a bourgeois caste and then the working masses. The fall of this traditional system, in many of its aspects, had as its instrument the tactic here indicated. The warrior aristocracy rose up against the decadent representatives of the pure spiritual authority, not through substituting them with another, more worthy representatives of the same principle, but by drawing from that the pretense to be emancipated or lay claim for itself the supreme authority. In a following phase, i.e., in a following civilization, the Third Estate rises up against the degenerate warrior aristocracy not because it ceded the place to the true aristocrats, but to seize power for itself. In yet another phase, the process against capitalism and the bourgeoisie (i.e.,

against the Third Estate) in its destructive and negative aspects does not aim for a corresponding reform, but is only the excuse for the revolt of the proletariat and the usurpation of power—descending progressively from step to step—straight through to the party of the proletariat (bolshevism, communism).

Conclusion The fact that, for reasons of space, we only indicated some examples and we were concerned above all with the exposition of the principles, not to prevent—we hope—seeing what vast fields of application these principles can have and to that valuable results it could reach those who, adequately equipped, can apply them methodically in any field. Since one can assert without uncertainty that there is not a single area in which the occult battle of the forces of worldwide subversion are not in any developed way; and indeed these areas that would seem more unrelated to events of the type are those that, by principle, should be considered with the greatest wariness.

We repeat one more time that it is not a question of “philosophical positions”, but of things much more real and that there is no leader or combatant at the front of the counter-subversion and the tradition that can be called mature and at the peak of its true tasks, before having developed in itself the faculty of seeing clearly in this subterranean world of cause and of indicating quickly the action of this or that invisible tool which our enemy does not cease to adopt in every epoch that, like the current one, sounding the prelude to the moment of final decision and the final battle of all, a cycle of civilization.

Posted on 2012-05-07 by Aeneas

* * *

Lyon on 2018-05-07 at 14:54 said:

Hmmm... Does this possibly dovetail with the work of E Michael Jones, specifically in his work titled, *The Jewish Revolutionary Spirit and Its Impact on World History*? Jones, in that work, describing the comparatively small portion of the iceberg that can be seen above the surface.

I've only recently been introduced to his writings via Fidelity Press and his culturewars.com website. Admittedly, both Evola and Jones are approaching our predicament from differing vantage points.

As for Evola, the only work of his I've read in depth (... studied and ruminated) was *The Hermetic Tradition, Symbols and Teachings of the Royal Art*.

My understanding of both Jones and Evola are still in formation. Any general guidance and cautions on either is appreciated.

fractalkhaosstrikesonceagain on 2018-05-09 at 17:48 said:

As usual with your Blog GornaHoor: Thanks a lot Cologero for OPENING OUR EYES : You help us to face our real(s) foe(s) ...

jalexandermaximilian on 2020-08-18 at 21:08 said:

I've been thinking lately, about the past decade or so, of these occult forces, which use men, men who appear as powerful but are really just pawns of these forces. It seems now more than ever "leaders" are not in control of their own thoughts and actions It seems the world of men is being propelled toward some finale. Can it continue in this manner without a finale, or will it continue unto a whimper? This sort of understanding is why now I eschew all U.S. polytricks, the men you see are not in control of anything... even themselves. They may think they are. But their works and goals are all for another Thing. I seek God. Then wonder if I am my own Master? From where does even thought arise?

Lyon: Jews would merely be another group of pawns serving another more powerful force, they are certainly hardheaded and organized, but that seems to me to be a case of an external mind using them to its own goal with great success.

veritycacciatrice on 2022-01-09 at 05:34 said:

"For now, it is enough to establish this point: we must not allow the third dimension of history to vanish in the fog of abstract and philosophical views, but we must consider it inhabited and occupied by quite precise "intelligences", whose expression and closest mouthpieces were almost always certain secret societies or organizations, but which must not at all totally express the intelligences, but just having their beginning and end in them."

I witnessed this first hand less than a fortnight ago.

My son was doing some study on Garibaldi in Italian and he suggested I watch a video he'd seen on it (more for the comedy styling than the content).

I was following along and was surprised to see the most bloody battle location in the second War of Independence chosen due to its name.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 07:53 said:

Yes, subversion – ‘black magic’ works by subverting and perverting the true spiritual forces, in no small part through ‘bad practice’. Depending on the individual and their potential and actual power, this can indeed be disastrous. The abomination of the desolation, the breaching of the Holy of Holies. the rend must be fixed. The ancient forces tend to react badly – out of character, out of bed the ‘wrong way’ – when needlessly awoken (mediumship), roused for the wrong reasons. And yes, it is all too easy to be deceived outside the known framework, the ‘safe zone’, amounting to entering a labyrinth without the guiding thread which one follows in order to return. The severance of the silver cord is no laughing matter, one requires rescue!

logres on 2012-05-09 at 09:23 said:

Evola is unusually clear and prescient, and not so wordy, in these passages. Many thanks! I am interested in his idea that the Catholic Church (at that point, and perhaps still) could be made a bulwark against certain tendencies and currents. I fear that we may have moved beyond such a point, irremediably, although certainly the question cannot be decided on an empirical basis. My instinct tells me that the Church could still be awakened, that it slumbers, and that it is a sleeping giant. Who will awaken her?

logres on 2012-05-09 at 09:52 said:

Tactic number 3, falsifying substitution. Classic example of this would be the resurgent Confederacy of the southern states in 1865 – they thought they were fighting for altar and hearth – in reality, they were being used to provoke a frightful advance of the occult power, by obscuring the goal in the midst of a provoked reaction. I suppose 1938 Germany might be an even better example. Each time this “false start” occurs, it cements the overall process.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 12:38 said:

Oddly enough I was compelled yesterday to revisit one of Rudolf Steiner's stranger books, *Secret Brotherhoods and the Mystery of the Human Double*, in particular the lectures relating to Individual Spirit Beings and the Constant Foundation of the Universe.

I know there are no big Steiner fans here (unless they're hiding!), but in the present context he is very helpful and penetrates even further into the ‘nature of the beast’, as it were. I just transcribed a large portion of this work on Alchemical Weddings:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/the-constant-formation-of-the-universe>

One thing I've omitted is the constant talk of 'post Atlantean epochs', be they fifth, sixth or whatever, as I've never really made sense of them, perhaps I don't like the labels.

Here is the end of the extract, which I think you might enjoy:

What lies in store for humanity is that cosmic forces will be won for humanity in a dual way that is wrong or a single way that is right. This will bring a genuine renewal to astrology, which is atavistic in its old form – a form in which it cannot continue to exist. Those who know about the cosmos will struggle against each other... for the remainder of earthly existence the dead will collaborate with us to a high degree.

The moment you penetrate fully into all the secrets of the double, you will find yourself able to assess the value of brains that are merely lumps which you have placed on a scale, lumps which can be brought to life solely by the double.

You must come to realise that all the wishy-washy talk of 'cosmic religiosity' or 'how powerful the yearning for it is', and so on is nothing other than a means of spreading fog over these matters which ought actually to be entering the world in clarity and which, above all, ought only to be carried in clarity into human life as practical moral and ethical impulses.

It generally sheds light on the nature of the occult war as it is manifesting now, very helpful I thought, along with Evola's texts. When occultists manage to agree you know you're onto something!

Also coincidentally, the recent talk of 'Saturn' made me think, firstly, that he was eaten by his children so we should really focus more on IoPitar? Also I was contacted by a group related to the Philosophers of Nature, so of course the memory of 'touching saturn' was revived. Interesting synchronicities from a personal point of view that may also resonate with others here.

logres on 2012-05-09 at 14:34 said:

Steiner was tainted with evolutionary worldviews, but "knew" better. That statement of his about religious "feeling" demonstrates such. Steiner was Goethe's heir, so he shared Goethe's failings. Just as there is a danger that the individual could "fail" and collapse in the postmortem state, so there is a cosmic danger that this world could implode, in more than a physical manner. Christians can "rest" in Christ's sure sacrifice, but this may entail complications which are unnecessary, not to mention enormous suffering.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 14:54 said:

well I think it's tricky to find any occultist (human after all) who doesn't have failings, though? Evola, Guenon etc are routinely attacked for being 'fascist' or whatever – I think it's partly a hazard of the job and a consequence of the times they lived in. Even VT had, in my opinion, unfair ideas to do with shamanism, so I can't even agree with him on everything. Lots of wisdom to be learned from them all but we must always take care to show discernment and

think for ourselves... also to be heedful of the fact that we are at a different stage in history, esoteric or otherwise. Nevertheless, I do think Steiner's insight into the occult war are very illuminating in the present context, bringing a bit more spirit to the dryness of Evola, which I nonetheless found useful.

Angolmois on 2012-05-09 at 15:10 said:

Steiner may be helpful as you say Charlotte, but in reality the only reason why Evola is "dry" is because he doesn't stray into unnecessary or fantastic areas in his analysis of the occult war.

You are certainly right about thinking for ourselves. Many esotericists have a hidden need, sometimes even a vice, to rest upon the shoulders of this or that authority.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 15:27 said:

I wonder how we should see the present wars around the world in light of all this... .

logres on 2012-05-09 at 22:25 said:

Charlotte, thanks for the quote, which I read in full at your site. I agree that Steiner is useful, just trying to place him in full context. As Cologero says, we learn from and (hopefully) in some sense, go beyond (in the sense of seeing their failings more clearly).

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:36 said:

I think we have to define 'fantastic' as it's a matter of opinion depending upon experience. From a rational perspective much of what Evola says is right, and yet I personally see a lot more depth in Steiner's analysis, which speaks to personal experience more concretely. Something is only 'fantastic' if you don't believe it's possible, but there are not the usual rules and boundaries in the 'other worlds', of time and space, for one, which are pretty enormous limiting factors on the physical plane. The rules 'on the other side' are different but the playing is just as hard. I agree, however, that one must learn to read Steiner in a particular way and not take everything to heart or on board, simply to scan for what resonates.

logres on 2012-05-10 at 08:34 said:

Ricochet – Luther thinks he is re-masculinizing the Church, but actually, the destruction of intellect & tradition leads to sentimentality. A warning... to me.

Angolmois on 2012-05-11 at 03:39 said:

... but actually, the destruction of intellect & tradition leads to sentimentality."

And it leads also to protestant capitalism, bouregous liberalism, and finally to "kulturkampf" and to the destruction of monasticism in the 19th century. Quite a ricochet.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 04:40 said:

so many actions and reactions in the course of history – eventually the balance will be found

Avery on 2012-05-10 at 23:52 said:

Substituting a principle for a person is a very interesting metaphor. It's really a process of the lower ranks being instructed that their superiors do not have special right but are only employing a general principle which can be understood by anyone, which leads them to think that the principle is more important than the person. They rid themselves of what they perceive as a useless middleman, only to discover that they are lost without a dedicated superior to guide them.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 06:06 said:

'superior'... hmmm... ..people have different qualities, in the ideal scenario they will take it in turns to lead depending on what is required – just like a team of long-distance walkers will take it in turns to keep the pace. This should of course happen organically and intuitive in a utopian sense, but in reality there tend to be infights and intrigues if there is no rigid plan to follow. It also supposes the basic equality of peoples, which I do believe in principle but in practice it doesn't always show through. Often people just need a chance to shine and being trapped in a rigidly hierarchical 'management structure' doesn't necessarily allow this. Nowadays people tend to be discouraged from thinking for themselves, one of the reasons I'm sure why alcohol is so widely prevalent, cheap and encouraged, whereas cannabis, for instance – something Americans could once pay their taxes with, and which it was compulsory for farmers to grow in England – is outlawed and demonised. Such is the fate of anything that interferes with the profit potential and control mechanisms of large corporations. I realise you guys probably hate this kind of talk and possibly I was missing the point of your comment, but I still felt moved to say this. Also it's true lol!

Cologero on 2012-05-11 at 08:38 said:

Sure, Charlotte, just as you allow your neighbours to "take turns" fixing your car, or providing you with healthcare.

Alcohol and marijuana are so popular because they are the great equalizers and levelers. In their "normal state", men differ considerably from each other, in their intelligence, wisdom, sanctity, ability ... in every conceivable way. But every drunk and every stoned-out person is exactly alike.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:01 said:

ah well, too much of anything is a bad thing, but I'm not one for stereotyping. I do find it intensely ironice that an extremely useful plant is demonised whereas super strength alcohol and tobacco (a totally non-beneficial product) are considered acceptable. You obviously don't know the history behind 'wacky backy', but I can promise you it was once considered so useful that to grow it was considered helping the war effort. And no, that doesn't mean I spent all day 'stoning'. Apart from anything else I hate tobacco. As for the pros and cons of mind altering substances we could go on all day about this if we were of the HPB, Crowley or Gurdjieff school – as it happens I tend to think there are far more cons because abuse happens far more often than use. However, the Pythia of Delphi and others like her might well disagree, as might the rainforest shamens or other representatives of ancient tradition. Nothing new age about it. Unlike LSD, which was created by the Tavistock Institute to create mind-blown hippies and other enemies. I hate to have to point it out, but probably even the Essenes partook of holy moly, according to recent evidence that has detected cannabis oil around their settlements – the medicinal benefits of this plant are beyond dispute, it's prejudice that makes people blind to it. As it happens I don't keep a car, it's bad for the environment, but when I did the neighbour did help fix it more than once. Healthcare in England is free for all and we like it that way... .

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:04 said:

actually, the one thing you CAN say about stoners is they're total pacifists and adept at minding their own business, whereas alcoholics are invariably violent towards self and others.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:12 said:

the reason alcohol and marijuana are popular is NOT because they're levellers, it's because in the case of the former it lowers inhibitions – good for social interaction – and stimulates the brain to produce dopamine, which is highly pleasureable. It is also very addictive, which leads to repeated use. THC and cannabidiol on the other hand are known neuroprotective antioxidants but the effects of smoking or ingesting it range from total euphoria, feelings of 'universal connectivity', increased empathy and other things that sound dreadful to some folk, to paranoia, nausea and delusions. Strong stuff. But I digress, let me get back to the study books.

Cologero on 2012-05-11 at 19:20 said:

You just stereotyped them, and proved my point. Drunks are all alike and stoners are all alike ... great levelers.

Charlotte on 2012-05-12 at 09:38 said:

what rubbish, I did no such thing!! I read Evola experimented a lot with hallucinogens – does that mean he's 'just like them' ?! :-)

Logres on 2012-05-13 at 00:30 said:

"... and always pushing well beyond the process of falling,"

I didn't understand the syntax here...

The overall thought that Satan leads men back in circles is a brilliant one. Tea Party? Reformation?

Cologero on 2012-05-13 at 08:23 said:

I'm open to suggestions to make it read more clearly ... the word is spingere: push, urge, drive. The idea is that the theory of progress is driving the process of the fall forward.

... by the way, recent high-level announcements and the instant worldwide reaction, seemingly coordinated, seem to demonstrate this tactic in action. So who can anticipate the next "thrust"?

Graham on 2012-05-15 at 23:26 said:

Re: the substitution of the principle to the person, there is a variant. It's interesting how modern popes and clergymen apparently recognize their own lack of spiritual authority, leading them to 'tone down' the principles they are supposed to represent. For instance, John Paul II rejecting the papal tiara was significant. Stated otherwise: conscious of their own lack of 'charismatic' authority, they seek to present the church as a bourgeois 'traditional' and 'bureaucratic' authority, something they feel at ease with.

Return to Tradition. The Future Elite

12.1 Lightning Strikes from the East

Ignorance pure and simple is far preferable to false ideas.

RENE GUENON

Lightning cometh out of the east, and appeareth even into the west.

JESUS CHRIST

In *East and West*, **Rene Guenon** outlines a plan for the recovery of Tradition in the West. Obviously, the plan is complex and requires some unique skills as well as intellectual depth to succeed, and it is something he doesn't expect to happen next week. Nevertheless, it is well worth elucidating in detail, if only for the boons it will bring to those who make the effort to understand. However, we take it seriously as we heed Guenon's warning¹ about the consequences of not undergoing a consciously led

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=35>

social transformation. These are either a fall into complete barbarism or else the assimilation to another Traditional culture, most likely following a period of social upheaval. The plan must take place on three levels:

1. The knowledge and understanding of metaphysical principles
2. The recovery of traditional sciences
3. The transformation of the social order

Return to Intellectuality First of all, it is necessary to understand the goal, or what exactly defines a traditional civilization. Guenon explains:

What we call a traditional civilization is one that is based on principles in the true sense of the word, that is, one where the intellectual realm dominates all the others, and where all things, science and social institutions alike, proceed from it directly or indirectly, being no more than contingent, secondary and subordinate applications of the purely intellectual truths.

To be blunt, the intellectual truths he is talking about are not debating points; they are either understood or they are not. The thinking, willing, and feeling functions must be understood in their proper relation. This is especially true in our age with its emphasis on action for its own sake and sentimentality. Guenon writes:

The pure idea has no immediate relation with the domain of action, and it cannot have the direct influence on outward things that sentiment has; but the idea is, none the less, the principle, the necessary starting point of all things, without which they would be robbed of any sound basis. Sentiment, if it is not guided and controlled by the idea, brings forth nothing but error, disorder, and obscurity; there is no question of doing away with sentiment, but of keeping it within its legitimate bounds.

The dominance of sentimentality is expected in the modern mind, but it seems to be none the less present even among some segments seeking a return to tradition. So we must insist on this initial understanding, as Guenon explains:

Thus a return to tradition and a return to principles are in reality just one and the same thing; but clearly the knowledge of the principles, where it is lost, must first be restored before there can be even a remote thought of applying them; it is quite out of the question to build up again a traditional civilization in all its fullness without first having the supreme and fundamental knowledge that must preside over the work.

Return to Tradition Since the time Guenon's book was published, much has changed in the West. On the one hand, the knowledge of Eastern systems such as the various schools and sects of Hinduism as well as Buddhism, has become much more prevalent, even to the point of attracting many adherents. On the other, there are the many alternative, or New Age, types of spiritualities, primarily deriving from Theosophy and similar movements. The latter consist of a strange mix of not fully understood principles heavily infused with mushy sentimentality. The former, although they show some promise, are too often incompatible with the Western mindset and style of life. The adherents either adopt alien styles of dress and mannerisms which are quite secondary to the intellectual principles or else end up accommodating the Eastern teachings to Western prejudices and, in the process, compromising what is authentic in them. That is why Guenon suggests:

In our eyes, the most satisfactory solution for the West is the return to her own tradition, completed where necessary as to the domain of pure intellectuality.

Now, this requires some explanation since the Western mind is so imbued with egalitarianism, even among those most loudly calling for a return to Tradition. This domain of intellectuality is only suitable for the small minority, or elect, who are capable of understanding. For the rest, there needs to be an exoteric religion that bears these principles in a more palatable form. Hence, we witness the many discussions, often heated, about a return to Christianity or some sort of neopagan revival. That debate is not of interest to the elect who understand that metaphysics and religion need not be in the least incompatible. Guenon writes:

Even if the West repudiates sentimentalism (and we mean by that the predominance of feeling over intelligence), the western masses will retain none the less a need for satisfactions derived from sentiment, which the religious form alone can give them, just as they will retain a need for outward activity.

There are certainly some manifestations of Western thought that are of a high intellectual caliber. Unfortunately, they are ignored by contemporary leaders of the Western religion who falsely believe they are in continuity with that tradition. Or else, they are depreciated and rejected by others because the Western tradition is “*too high for them*”, as Guenon writes. The latter go searching in vain for an elusive “authentic” tradition, when they can’t even understand the one that is closest in time to them. We will bring what Guenon has to say on this topic at a later date.

Posted on 2012-01-17 by Cologero

12.2 Recovering Tradition

Gradually there will revive in Christendom the forgotten, deeply sleeping, and perished treasure of wisdom and sacrificial deeds of

the past — right back to the primeval revelation and the paradisiacal state of mankind. Thus all truth and all love of all times will have their home in the Church of Christ, which will then be the all-embracing (catholic) unity of all things and all beings who are striving for timeless values — in the sense of realizing the ideal of one Shepherd and one flock. The words of the Creed: “I believe in one holy, catholic and apostolic Church” receive their full significance when the Church becomes universal (catholic) not only in space but also in time, i.e., when it embraces not only all peoples of the present, but also times of the past.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

In recent posts we have been delineating the characteristics of a Traditional society, so that those so inclined would know what to work towards. Moreover, we emphatically deny that there is such a movement or school as “Traditionalism” or that a man can be a “Traditionalist”, *sensu stricto*. “Traditionalism” is a term without content, unless its content consists of the valid Traditions. In other words, one cannot be a Traditionalist, that is, a man who follows Tradition in general; rather, one must follow a particular Tradition. Of course, in a Traditional society, that means one follows the Tradition he is born into, the advice given by the French magician Eliphas Levi. Guenon held the same position, except for those rare men who are beyond caste and hence free to follow the Tradition of their choice.

For the Westerner of today, that Tradition should be Catholicism, although it is now barely recognizable as Traditional. A case can be made that one of the European paganisms is the natural Tradition of the West, and this seems plausible to many since paganism has been in the unconscious of the West and is now beginning to reawaken; or, as Stephen Flowers puts it, “Odin has been sleeping.” He is well read in this field and has done much to reconstruct or resurrect the ancient Germanic re-

ligion. I shall be speaking of the former, since I am more familiar with it; nevertheless, the basic points will apply to both identically.

First of all, the question recently came up about whether Christianity contains the seeds of its own destruction. We need to point out that every human movement, even divinely inspired, will gradually run down; this even happened to paganism, which yielded to the newer religion. This is a spiritual law. After the initial conscious impulse, a movement then continues mechanically, declines, and eventually may even become the opposite of how it started. Periodically, conscious impulses must be applied to it, to set it back on its course.

Unfortunately, what is called Traditional Catholicism does not go back far enough, since its tradition stems from the counter-reformation at Trent, when it really needs to go back much further. For example, it needs to rehabilitate the likes of **Dionysius the Areopagite, Clement of Alexandria, Origen**. The idea of *gnosis* needs to be restored. The idea that *theosis* is required for salvation, not faith alone, must be taken seriously once again. The philosophy of Plato and the Neo-Platonists must form the human side of divine revelation (not a replacement for it). These ideas are not novelties, quite the contrary, they are the true Tradition.

Of course, due to the differences in human nature and the law of castes, not everyone will be capable of understanding things in this way. But the elite will do so, even in not a public way. The warriors will need to apply these teachings to particular circumstances, not because they are more manly, but because that is the law for their caste. This is why a Traditional society is not a theocracy: the elite teach the principles; the warriors and producers apply them.

Posted on 2010-03-16 by Cologero

* * *

Comprehensor on 2010-03-18 at 18:14 said:

Though many Westerners are born into Catholicism it is a dead religion (i.e. it no longer possesses the spiritual influence) and so what is it they are really born into? Something which is beyond their understanding and reduced to an egotistic historicism, moralism, sentimentalism, and messianic marxism. Even if there were some of the church hierarchy who had any real knowledge of tradition other than their theological hogwash the church has such a bad reputation that to fix it one would have to purge it of nearly all its ordained members. And all of this impossible work would be for naught because quite simply Christianity is far too sentimental and Semitic a form, which is in direct conflict with the Aryan spirit. What the traditional man should be focused on today is in taking the essential aspects of Aquinas, Eckhart, and Boehme, mixing it with the Vedanta and Yoga, and applying it to their own ethnic tradition, that is, reconstructing the old "pagan" paths. Above all, one needs to receive an initiation into the lesser and greater mysteries to have any qualification at reconstructing a tradition, and this initiation can only come from living traditions, either Sufism, Hinduism, or Buddhism.

Cologero on 2010-03-18 at 21:31 said:

Yes, I agree with your project in outline, but the devil is in the details.

I would add that the core of Western esotericism has been Hermeticism ... both Guenon and Evola agree on this. Evola, however, insists this is really a pagan movement. Of course, its origin is pagan, if we follow the progression

Hermes Trismegistus → Pythagoras → Plato → Plotinus

Nevertheless, this trend buried itself in the dominant religion of the West, as we see from the grail legends and various thinkers such as Dionysius, Clement of Alexandria, Origen, Ramon Lull, Ficino, and so on. Two recent attempts, both by Russians, have attempted once again to integrate Hermeticism, viz, Valentin Tomberg and Boris Mouravieff. It remains to be seen if they create a lasting impact.

Comprehensor on 2010-03-19 at 00:21 said:

The devil I would say is the industrial-capitalist civilization which is in no way compatible with tradition and culture.

Cologero on 2010-03-19 at 05:04 said:

I'm afraid that is just a symptom, the result of the degeneration of castes. Only a regeneration is the cure, not a revolution.

Comprehensor on 2010-03-19 at 05:50 said:

Whatever it is it is here. Modern education, technology, machines, spoonfed consumerism—all of this ruins the mind physically and psychically, and it is only on course to become much worse.

The masses aren't going to bend a knee to any initiatic elite, nor are they interested in initiatic regeneration. Most people think that initiatic rites are either satanic or imaginary. This being so how much further removed are they from intellectual principles? And as far as the people who have assumed the functions of the rulers, warriors, and priests, they are all rather pathetic—with very few exceptions—and no elite would waste their time trying to teach those who are corrupted to their very core. A restoration of tradition would take the miracle of all miracles.

Cologero on 2010-03-19 at 09:43 said:

The masses will believe any old thing and can change in an instant ... they are not burdened with gnoseological questions. It would be better that they believe something true rather than false.

The elite do not kvetch. The elite, and I mean the warrior elite, have the will to power, the power to impose their will. After the disintegration of the Western half of the Roman Empire, the Occidental world was in worse shape than today. The elite went back to the sources and modeled themselves after the great pagans: Hector, Alexander, Julius Caesar, Vegetius, Scipio. Where is that elite today? Who today knows anything about Charlemagne, Arthur, Boucicaud, Godfrey de Bouillon? Forget the principles, all the principles anyone needs are on this blog. That is really for the tiny few, who are ineffectual in the world without the Ksatriyas to actualize those principles in the world. Forget the paleo, neo, new, alternative rights ... go back to the beginning.

Comprehensor on 2010-03-19 at 17:38 said:

Principles are NOT for a tiny few. They are the backbone of the entire civilization. For a return to tradition we require a complete change of everything modern. That is a mammoth task and no will to power can achieve that. I do not consider Alexander and Caesar great pagans, but rather the enemy. They turned away from the sacred to wage destructive wars and to create a universal empire. I am more interested in preserving unique ethnicities and unique cultures rather than making one great "European Empire." Moreover, I am opposed to the exoteric/esoteric model which limits the esoteric to a tiny few. We need to do away with that entirely and move to a more metaphysical and participative system like Hinudism which doesn't have this distinction.

Cologero on 2010-03-21 at 02:01 said:

Despite many efforts, several misconceptions persist.

We agree, principles the backbone of the entire civilization, but the fact is that different people will relate to them differently.

Some — a tiny few — will understand them directly. Others will implement the principles in the political and economic realms. The remainder need to be taught the principles in the form of stories, imagery, myths and dogmas — just as I pointed out: "It would be better that they

believe something true rather than false." This is the nature of things and it does not imply any defects in the last group.

The way ideas become actualized in the world is through Will ... that's just the way it is. The modern world you apparently detest was a creation of the will. That leads to a few questions. Are sound ideas being actualized or are false ideas? Is this being done consciously or spontaneously? What forces are in play?

By definition, Empire preserves local ethnicities and cultures. If you want to preserve yours, then go right ahead.

Alexander and Caesar preserved tradition, and can't be judged by ordinary standards since secondary causes come into play. They made possible the free exchange of ideas. But I don't need to dwell on this at this time, since that was not the point.

I brought it up for a few reasons. First they were effective. That is why the medievals studied them ... to learn to be effective.

Second, we don't see things as isolated events, but rather as the unfolding of a larger scheme. Alexander made possible the spread of Hellenic culture and philosophy.

The Roman empire made possible the spiritual unity of Europe. That is how the medievals saw it.

To be clear, the purpose of this blog is educational – not political nor religious – and its perspective is twofold: first of all, to expound Traditional ideas in modern languages for those able to grasp them. Second, to indicate specifically their relation to the situation of the West. As for the latter, this requires the recognition of the continuity of a certain spirit appropriate to Western man. There are many today who would deny it, and prefer revolution to continuity, both within the West and without.

But the worst are those who in the name of Tradition reject huge periods of Western civilization, making the dispossession complete. I bring up the medievals because they made a conscious decision to study the ancients and appropriate whatever was of value to them in their situation. The same needs to be done today, and to condemn the great heroes of the West is hardly helpful in that task.

12.3 Human, All Too Human

Tradition cannot be understood from the human, all-too-human, perspective.

One criticism was based on something called "ownness", as though we pick and choose our gods on the basis of their suitability to our hu-

man condition, instead of rising above and seeing our human condition *sub specie eternitatis*. A second criticism arose from the discussion of the I. The critic could only see subjectivity in this and the workings of an arbitrary will. Instead, it must be seen in the light of the One of **Plotinus**, the Atman of the *Vedas*, the True Self of **Meister Eckhart**. This fundamental misunderstanding led him to flee, following some unkind words.

Lately, we seem unable to understand matter from the super-human perspective shown in the obsession with the human body. There is no point in debates, rather the goal is to “see”. There is a superior form of knowing (gnosis, episteme, intuition), that is more akin to “seeing”, properly understood, than to debating. There are forms of meditation, such as Hermetic meditation, and conditions for Hermetic initiation that are unrelated to any book-learning. There are three trials which are only the preliminary steps. Has anyone attempted them? Nothing here will make sense until they are at least attempted.

I call your attention to the Foreward to *Revolt* (which is actually Evola’s Introduction to the third Italian edition. Evola writes: (beginning with a response to his critics, who are bringing in the same accusations 40 years later. What irony!)

In my perspective there is no arbitrariness, subjectivity, or fantasy, just as there is no objectivity and scientific causality the way modern men understand them. All these notions are unreal; all these notions are outside Tradition. Tradition begins wherever it is possible to rise above these notions **by achieving a superindividual and nonhuman perspective**; thus, I will have a minimal concern for debating and “demonstrating”. The truths that may reveal the world of Tradition are not those that can be “learned” or “discussed”; **they either are or are not**. It is only possible to *remember* them, and this happens when **one becomes free of the obstacles represented by various human constructions**... in

other words, **one becomes free of these encumbrances when the capacity for seeing from that nonhuman perspective, which is the same as the traditional perspective, has been attained.**

So to anyone who wants “proof”, I can only say, “Take a look and see for yourself. Then you may remember what you have forgotten.”

Posted on 2011-03-21 by Cologero

12.4 Birth and Essence of the Modern Myth

This essay, *Nascita ed essenza del “mito” moderno* by **Julius Evola**, originally appeared in the March 1936 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, and will be published in five parts. There are a few points to think about in this first segment.

- Once again, Evola, following **Rene Guenon**, brings up caste as the most fundamental division of human types. Hence, caste is more fundamental than religion or race.
- The degeneration of caste is the first step to understand the movements of history. The attempts to interpret history in terms of race or religion (e.g., pagan vs Christian) are all for naught unless the roles of the various castes are first taken into consideration.
- The different castes have differing ways of thinking and being. Specifically, not every caste is capable of understanding metaphysical principles. That is why there are so many unsound interpretations of Tradition.
- In a manner reminiscent of **Plato** in the Republic, Evola likens the social organization of the castes to the organization of human consciousness.

- Myth and Symbol are objectively designed to represent metaphysical principles. Of the various contemporary movements² that claim to be based on Mythos, can any of them make such a claim?
- Myth and Symbol are created by the spiritual elite for the benefit of the lower castes. It also provides a link between them, without which the elite would be isolated.
- Evola brings up the notion of the elite as being the living law on Earth, and mentions Emperor Frederick II³ and Dante in relation to it. Similarly, the Roman popes also claimed to be the final arbiter of the cosmic and natural law, a claim in full compliance with Traditional civilizations. Who today would still accept that claim either by the popes or by some other pretender to the spiritual authority?

For the correct orientation in the matter that we want to treat, we should begin from some general doctrinal premises that do not have for us the significance of personal philosophical construction, but rather that of a rigorously objective matter of fact. It is about the doctrine of the hierarchical quadripartition and the understanding of recent history as the process of descent from one to the other of these four hierarchical levels. To make such a view intuitive, let us stop here, first of all, at its social aspect. The quadripartition is therefore presented as that which in all traditional ancient civilization gave rise to four distinct and hierarchically ordered castes: serfs, bourgeoisie, warrior aristocracy, and the bearers of a pure spiritual authority. We do not mean by “caste” something artificial and conventional, but rather the level that united individuals who have the same nature and vocation in common. In every caste a specific mode of existence took form and expression.

²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3853>

³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Frederick_II%2C_Holy_Roman_Emperor

The hierarchy was normative when there was the natural dependency of the lower modes of life on the higher, i.e., to those adhering to a purely spiritual point of view and metaphysical reality. Only in such a case did they have the right relations of subordination and participation, that was analogous to the human organism. In the human organism, in fact, we do not have a normal and healthy condition, in those cases when the physical element, i.e., the servile stratum, or the vegetative life, i.e., the bourgeoisie, or finally, the uncontrolled and impulsive will, i.e., the warrior caste, assumes the direct and deciding part. Instead there is a normal condition when the spirit constitutes the central and ultimate point of reference for the other faculties, and this is why a partial autonomy is not denied to them, but that, on the contrary, they remain strengthened and transfigured in the totality of overall unity.

And this is effectively the image of existence corresponding to those primordial times that today in common parlance are called "myths". Such times were not those of a half-animal or prepersonal life, but rather those of the greatest metaphysical extent. They were times, in which everything in man that transcends the human is manifested in all its basic vehemence, similar to the free wind from the hills, as an absolute organizing power, as a force stronger than life and death. Superman or golden age, wild immanence or primordial theocracy, all those are only a pale formulae, polluted by the conceptions of a decadent epoch. Those times were superbly Olympic and heroic; a sole purpose animated every activity, freed it and organized it inexorably around a metaphysical axis. One cannot even speak here of religion. Religion is too little, it is a subsequent appearance, a thing already conditioned and already human. Religion, *religio*, means reconnection. But the question of a reconnecting does not arise where a *presence* exists, where man does not know the mutilation of individualism, where the "superlife" is, directly or indirectly, the deepest vein and the justification of everything that is life.

We said: directly or indirectly. This distinction introduces us to the

meaning that *myth* and *symbol* had in this primordial and normal type of civilization. Symbol and myth were not in the least fantastic creations, poetic images, or superstitious transpositions of confused naturalistic representations. Symbol and myth were instead ways of approximating and of participating in metaphysical reality, formulated according to rigorous and objective laws of analogy, by representatives of this same metaphysical reality for the lower strata of the traditional systems, whose Leaders they were. Symbols and myths included two aspects. The first was constituted by an image suited to produce a galvanization and dynamization of the imagination, through which the appearance of profound energies was produced, an inner shift of the psychic level. The second part of the myth was to give the right orientation, consciously or unconsciously, to this dynamized energy through a higher point of reference, as much to start presentiments, illuminations, or actions beyond everything that has form and that is materially and humanly conditioned. The etymological origin of the very term "myth" corresponds to that.

Rene Guenon recently pointed out that the Greek word *mythos* comes from the root *my*, which is found in the Latin *mutus*, mute, and in the verb *myo*, to be silent, to keep one's mouth shut, but moreover in *myeo*, which means to initiate, and specifically to initiate into the mysteries. In fact, the very term mystery, *mysterion*, does not have a different origin and reveals the meaning of teaching silently, i.e., exceeding the limit of everything that is nameable, sensible, and tied to a form. Initiatic myths and poetic myths, heroic myths and physical myths, theological myths and myths descending down to the discipline of the most humble corporative community, were only applications of this sole principle to the various domains of knowing and acting. Myth therefore constitutes the articulation and metaphysical potentiality of every form of traditional life. It saw to it that knowledge and action would develop according to the meanings and possibilities that have been known for centuries, but are now systematically denied. But by virtue of myth and symbol, the

necessary contacts were also established and strengthened so that those elites would not constitute an isolated and hidden vein, but the royal and solar vein of those who *know* and who *have being*, and who, as such, present themselves, all the way up to **Emperor Frederick II** and **Dante**, according to the traditional expression, as “the living law on earth”, *lex animata in terris*.

Here we see **Julius Evola** repeat familiar themes, even verbatim, but in today’s climate, it is well to do so. But besides the outer events of the degeneration of castes, Evola points out how it corresponds to states of consciousness. Not only are the religious, political, and economic structures overturned, but new forms of consciousness arise. No longer aware of the supernatural or the third dimension of history, men become dominated by the sub-conscious: merely vital, pre-intellectual, and instinctive impulses.

Note, too, how Evola defends reason in an essay devoted to myth. As **Rene Guenon** points out, Mythos and Logos, properly understood, cannot be in conflict. But reason without the guidance of transcendent first principles is a boat without an anchor, drifting at random. Its use becomes instrumental, good for limited purposes or to achieve irrational ends, but incapable of revealing any higher truth. In an allusion to Kant, Evola notes how reason itself is used to diminish it.

Please pay attention to how Evola’s and Guenon’s conception of the decline into modernity differs radically from the New Right. Alain de Benoist famously rejects reason as inadequate to lead to truth. This merely reveals his inability to grasp the supra-rational and supernatural. His explanation is superficial, the work of a dilettante, and little more than piling up names and dates, in the hope of providing a comprehensive understanding. He correctly identifies modernity as a process of secularization, but presumes it to somehow be the logical outcome of the spiritual authority rather than its overthrow, as Evola asserts.

There is no organized Right along Traditional principles. Who in the West, today, is ready to renounce individualism and embrace obedience and subjugation to a spiritual authority? Yet that is what Evola calls for, and is comparable to what the Hermetist **Valentin Tomberg** says about obedience. Likewise, Tomberg recognizes the same cause of the modern world, pointing out that atheism and the denial of the supernatural are the marks of the lower castes.

The comprehension of the history of culture as involution appears today as the repercussion of a period of crisis in the mind of certain dilettantes and literati. That does not deny that such a conception also corresponds to a knowledge found with great uniformity and impersonality in the traditional teachings of the most various peoples. As far as what interest us here, it is not an opinion, but a fact, to ascertain that authority and power were passed progressively into the hands of lower castes, especially in the West. Metaphysical and aristocratic-sacred types of State and civilization are thus taken over by monarchical-warrior States already secularized to a large measure. Later on, the true political directive function passes, under the cover of democratic-liberalism, to the capitalistic oligarchy, which corresponds to the ancient Third Estate and the ancient castes of the bourgeoisie and merchants. In the end, phenomena like marxism, communism, collectivism, and above all bolshevism in their original forms came to show the tendency of power passing to the lowest caste, the ancient castes of the serfs, which corresponds precisely to the mere mass.

This political aspect is naturally only the external and consequential side of an internal involution, for which each one of these four phases is accompanied by a corresponding change in the inner meaning of every institution, of every interest, of every ideal of knowing and acting. Thus not only for the State, but also for the concept of nation and family, ethics, law, architectonic types, speculation, art, the meaning of war, and so on

one could be outline a phenomenology and notice the same change, the same rigorous regressive passage through the four stages:

1. metaphysical or solar
2. warrior alone
3. bourgeoisie and humanistic
4. finally collectivistic and plebeian.

But, for our purposes, we are interested only in emphasizing the aspect, through this involution, that corresponds to a collapse of the personality, to a progressive failure of the inner tension that makes possible a supernatural organization of all the powers of the human being, and, finally, to a literal descent from the superconscious to an out-and-out subconscious. Man can be truly free and himself only when he maintains the center of his being on a metaphysical plane. When he detaches himself from such a plane and concentrates on practical goals, on temporal realizations and, in general, on whatever was the domain only of the lower castes taken in themselves, he abdicates, disintegrates himself, opens himself to hidden forces, whose instrument he will soon be destined to be unless he takes account of them.

And it is precisely this direction that modern enlightened persons have glorified as evolution. The point of rupture is constituted by individualism. With individualism, man constitutes himself as an illusory center outside the center, he considers as conquest what is only his shameful mutilation, and he believes he can substitute those traditional certainties, those "non-human" principles from which he has now fallen, with constructions based on the actions of purely human and natural faculties. We can define this phase both as humanism and rationalism; it is of brief duration. Separated from every higher point of reference, reason cannot preserve its autonomy. Yet it, with an auto-corrosive critical

labor, undertakes to refute the dogmatic and legislative claims of pure reason and to limit the validity of reason to an inferior use, i.e., practical, experiential, and utilitarian. In a subsequent moment the same weight of this diminished reason seems too heavy: in the forefront, the irrational and the anti-rational now emerge as the substance of every reality and produce a reversal: the guide to reason is now what is effectively inferior to reason, reason is now an instrument at the service of various impulses that can cover over political or religious, sentimental, or practical-activist forms, yet always retain a subpersonal character and that in principle are merely blind self-assertions.

All that today is the religion of life, faustianism, pragmatism, the new naturalism, the religion of immanence and pure becoming, doctrines of the unconscious and new mysticism, belong to this level: far from having the value of a reaction, all of that corresponds only to the last phase of a process of erosion.

The same development is verified in the social arena. The individualistic usurpation automatically invokes the collectivistic limitation. The Traditional man in his hierarchy and his caste could be free, i.e., himself: he had his law, his organic function, his dignity, whatever stratum he belonged to. Modern man, prideful of having swept away every caste and every true tradition, finds himself facing the mass of others without caste and without tradition. Even here the rationalist and humanist endeavor, i.e., the endeavor to arrange an unstable and chaotic mass of atoms by means of abstract juridical and political formulas. But even here the standard is not regained, nothing arises, for which obedience is also consent and subjection is also identification and elevation. Only unstable and tottering forms appear, against which the flood of new forces press to the end. These forces now belong less to the individual than to the masses, i.e., to what in individuals is the mass, to the purely vital, pre-intellectual, and instinctive part of their being. Atomism is outdated, and with it, too, everything that is liberalism and individualism galvanically settles into a

new superindividual cement under the sign of a radical intolerance for every principle of a higher order and every true discipline. It is a new climate, saturated with enormous tensions, great forces in motion that no longer have a center.

Far from eliminating myths, modernity, starting from the Enlightenment, introduced a new series of myths. Traditional myths were intended to lead men beyond words and thoughts, to a realization in the silence, the brilliant light of transcendence. Instead, the myths of modernity are grey; rather than awakening to superconscious reality, the modern myths can only arouse the subconscious and subrational forces. This is part III of V:

For the symmetry existing between the superrational and the subrational, the myth gets a new life in this new collectivistic climate. As in primordial times, today the myth, more than the idea or the concept, goes from the directing center to the new forces. But its structure and function today, naturally, are totally different. The myth in recent times appears as a simple image deprived of the metaphysical and superrational potentiality that it had traditionally, exaggerated instead in its mere aspect of "force-image", i.e., of an image that on one hand hypnotizes the higher faculty of the conscious personality of individuals, and on the other, dynamizes the energy belonging to the passionate, irrational, and subterranean part of their being. The modern myth corresponds precisely to the critical stage, in which the lucent peaks of the superworld were lost in the grey distance, in which the same dogmatic and sentimental surrogates proposed by positive religions⁴ have lost their strength, in which the mirages of rationalism are revealed in their fundamental inconsistency, yet an unbearable tension weighs on individuals; therefore an authoritative need of a discharge ecstatically freeing itself from the weight and limit constituted by their Self and exalting itself in great collective currents. The myth

⁴A religion with a historical founder.

releases this function. It is an illusory center that permits the discharge of this tension because, so to say, it is substituted for the Self. Precisely saturating itself with an attractive power and becoming "force-image", it acquires not only an appearance of truth and absolute validity, but in the end almost its own autonomous life, which often substituted for the personality of their evokers. In brief, we repeat greatly the same process through which, for the hypnotized, the image proposed by the hypnotizer becomes true, independently of every one of its contents and the Self of the hypnotized, his mind, his senses enter into a state of absolute passivity in the face of it, while from the corporal subconscious profound forces surface also capable of extra-normal effects.

If it is at this rate necessary to measure the inconceivable dynamic spread among the modern masses by the myths, the multitudes fall into a serious error when they believe that they have a sign of spiritual rebirth in the face of a manifestation of positive vital force. Once the energetic side is eliminated, it can be said without paradox that the substance of the modern myth is exactly that which the century of the Enlightenment supposed in the ancient myth, believing that the ancient myth is reduced to a fairy tale, fantastic images and personified abstractions, and that such a myth, which previously never existed, even today takes on life.

In fact, the domain of myth in modern times is quite far from being restricted only to the ethical and social fields. Science, Evolution, Positive Method, Historicity, Objectivity and so on, in the intellectual fields are in fact superstitious myths when Democracy, Liberty, Popular Sovereignty, Progress, Civilization, Race, Universal Peace, the New Age, the World-wide Revolution, and all the other great substantialized words, written emphatically with capital letters, which have played so much a part in the social life of the last century and are the center of irrational crystallizations of very powerful currents. Therefore, for what concerns their internal content, modern myths should be called fairy tales rather than myths. Etymologically the term *fable*, from *fari*, indicates exactly a mere

speaking, the word without a necessary reference to a content: while we saw that the term *mythos* included in itself the idea of an abolition of the word and the idea of a silent and essential realization. On this basis, we can say that if there is an age of fairy tales, it is not that of the ancient mythologies, but the current age, in spite of its presumed positivism.

On the contrary, we can point out that even the so-called positive spirits are those who more ingenuously succumb to myths, accepting as truth ideas that are less than shaky hypotheses, instead are suggestions from the environment. The evolutionist myth, which one knows the part it has had in recent science, belongs to this type. The same can be said of the myth of the unconscious of recent psychology, of the myth of modern civilization as crown and end of every civilization in the domain of historiography, a myth that has devastated every right vision of our past, and so we could continue a long time. Naturally, we are ready to concede that there are types in the social area among some modern myths—for example, the myth of the super-race, the myth of empire, the myth of return to the origins, etc.—that would be susceptible to a higher content and meaning. But we point out that it is not in the least for this possibility that such myths today have value and operate, rather uniquely for their suggestive capacity, through their capacity to offer a point of support for the ecstatic liberation of the personality and for the discharge of irrational and subpersonal powers of the collective psyche.

Thus from a higher point of view, one myth is equivalent to another, there are not any among the modern myths that are susceptible to produce a true reconstruction or even only to serve as its base, since already the simple condition, by which any myth whatsoever can act on the individual, represents a negative and paralyzing condition. On the other hand it would be rather easy to show that even in the cases in which the modern myth is not reduced to simple words, outside of which there is no reality, and to pure hypnotizing images, the higher elements contained in this type of myth undergo a fundamental deformation, for which the

concrete result is an action opposed to that which normally such elements should produce. Finally, we already pointed out that the analogy with the phenomena of suggestions, or the emergence of profound, sometimes materially supernormal, forces is the counterpart of the collapse of the personality and momentary paralysis of the conscious faculties, that this analogy permits us to judge, in accordance with their true significance, the extraordinary capacity of impetus, courage, enthusiasm, sacrifice and dedication which the masses often have demonstrated under the strength of myths. We noted that these capacities can deceive the superficial observer and make him believe that he sees a phenomenon of rebirth, of spiritual revival, and of new youth: while it is a question of the last apparitions in a cycle of decadence, of the hidden flood of spiritually destructive elementary forces after the fall of our hierarchical and traditional edifice, they are deprived of every true center and push men and things in the most unpredictable directions.

In this segment, Evola speculates on how myths are created and then on the necessary steps to reverse the regression of the castes. The creators of myths must come from an elite, since the masses certainly cannot do so. Yet he points out the the ultimate source of myth must come from beyond the human, all too human, sphere, so these elite are really just the visible agents of these higher powers. Presumably, he includes both the modern myths, originating from demonic powers, as well as myths that lead to a true transcendence. This would seem to preclude the notion of myth as just a *noble lie*, created by visible leaders to keep the masses enthralled.

The way out, then, is to mentally discard all the myths of the modern world. Freed from these illusions, the path back to the re-emergence of a warrior caste mentality is laid out. This will require a cold resoluteness of spirit, no longer subjected to the lower impulses of instinct and the subconscious. But this is as far as the natural man can go. The final stage of a true spiritual authority,

will require an “invisible action from above”. Evola avoids details, as he must, since the spirit blows where it wills. All these higher men can do is prepare and dispose themselves for its reception. However, Evola does believe it will be a revival of the spirit of ancient Rome, the first Romanity. However, since he claims the modern world is the result of the regression from the Medieval spirit, it is difficult to see why the spirit would not appear as the second Romanity of the Middle Ages. We have in Dante, *inter alia*, a complete initiatory path which would serve the purpose of preparation.

Since the final few paragraphs deal exclusively with the question of the “elite”, I decided to make it a separate entry.

All that that we have now said, nevertheless still leaves the problem of the true genesis of the myth unquestioned. It is certainly necessary that whoever, at a given moment, invented the myths, since we cannot admit that the masses are capable of the spontaneity necessary to shape and propose them and, moreover, in their origins, myths almost always introduce a rationalistic element, an ideological residue. In the second place, when we treat the type of social myths, it is always necessary for someone to directly or indirectly sustain and feed the collective fascination that makes the myth true and active, even if we must admit that, afterward, the myth often ends up assuming kind of its own life. Here, we can elaborate on such a complex and delicate problem since even evoking the image of the tamer, as someone did, leaves us on the exterior side of the process, does not enlighten us on the deepest conditions of its possibility. We will limit ourselves to say that, as we do not believe in a spontaneity of the crowds, so we do not even believe in a true autonomy of creators of myths and collectivistic directors, since these, in their turn, appear to us almost always conditioned by forces apparently directed by them and will seldom demonstrate the qualities of true spiritual leaders. Except for rare exceptions, those who press to the coming of the lowest social strata with

their visions and their myths seem the initiators of the truth and of new currents, yet are only centers of crystallization and of diffuse collective states, to be considered, in their turn, less as determinate causes than as the results of more distant and less graspable influences.

To elaborate on the true genesis of modern myths and their power, it would therefore be necessary to ask oneself the general question of the true causes of modern decadence since its various elements are without doubt in agreement; it would be necessary to create a gaze capable of penetrating into what is hidden behind the apparent events; it would be necessary to have a foreboding of the secret, and not simply human, influences which, without taking them into account, the "creators" of myths obey and which constitute the true basis of irrational attractive forces of ideologies formulated by them. It is useless to say that an investigation of the type sharply transcends both the possibilities and the methods of any sociology and applied psychoanalysis whatsoever; nor would it be to advise those who in a clear vision of the reality prefer confused hopes and disordered attempts of reaction.

From the complex view of history we exposed, it turns out, in every way, that the new mythological age corresponds to the last of the four phases of the process of the involution of the castes. The myths accompany and animate essentially the era of the servile caste, i.e., of the masses, even if with some connections with the preceding era of rationalism. So that it can be said without hesitation that even when some myths today present an aristocratic content, their true substance and their dynamic do not cease for this reason to be plebian. We also pointed out that the involutive phenomenon is not manifested only in a leveling, *but also in an overturning of polarity*. With this overturning the inferior, i.e., the irrational, the vital, the collective, absorbs and directs the remaining superior elements of the human and social structure: forces of "merchants", forces of "warriors", forces of a new pseudo-aristocracy. Reaching the zone of the spirit, these currents from below project and exalt themselves pre-

cisely in the myth and so reach their highest potential. It is thus that our time appears to us all too saturated with mysticism, but this mysticism, let us repeat once again, has nothing of the supernatural, it is deprived of a true center, and the relative atmosphere is infinitely more dangerous, destructive, and paralyzing than that of a pure materialism or collectivism.

For this reason, if we should indicate the possible ways out of the present situation, we will say without hesitating that the first task is a purification of everything that today is called spirit, an absolute surpassing of all the contemporary forms of mythology and mysticism. Spirit today means fog, sensation, evasion, exaltation. Against that, it is necessary to battle for a new era of clarity, coldness, form. With all the means, it is necessary to lead man back to himself, block him from the insane need to believe and abandon himself, to reduce himself to an essential simplicity. It is necessary to reach a world in which there are only men and things and the pure, absolute connections between one and the other, without images, without feverishness, passionate leaps, words, ideologies, gestures. We will want to call this task the destruction of romanticism and idealism in the name of a new Doric and classical epoch, of a new and Roman dignity. As preliminary conditions for a rebirth, we do not see another way. In such a world, the weak will fall, but the strongest find themselves again. They will learn to remain upright without supports and make themselves active in the higher sense. Ceasing to be moved, they move themselves. This atmosphere of clarity will signify death for every myth. Resolute borders and hard discipline will block the paths of human interiority from the violence of the collective. Slowly, in a silent inner ascent, he will thus initiate the reintegration of the personality, and new forces, forces of an ascending new cycle, will then be able to guide knowledge and action. In fact at this point we will find ourselves already beyond the era of the masses and the era of the bourgeoisie, we should have a civilization and a style of life corresponding analogously to the visions and values of the second caste, i.e., of the caste of warriors and

as such transcending also the plane of every humanistic and rationalistic scheme.

But in its turn, this world composed of virility and of form, this severely personalized, Doric, substantial world will become only a starting point. To bring this world back to a transcendent point of reference, to open it to metaphysical contacts in the sense not of an alteration, but of an integration and a transfiguration, is the ultimate task. However, the resolution of such a task remains problematic. In fact, the spirit does not let itself be constructed. There are no disciplines that lead to it and today it is not preset, as there was with the secret sacred content of the first, virile, Romanity. The action of every culture remains limited to a preparation and a disposition. But because the spirit is manifested as the absolutely organizing and animating power what, is needed is a type of invisible action from above.

In the conclusion to the essay, **Julius Evola** brings up the question of the future elite who will restore Tradition. This will take place in several steps. First of all, Evola tries to clear up the inevitable misunderstandings when people first hear the word. He is not speaking of what are commonly considered the elite in the world. Evola singles out the so-called intellectuals who are active even today in formulating global policies in politics, finance, or war. The true elite will understand metaphysical doctrine.

The first task is to initiate a process of “psychic detoxification”, which will include the elimination of the myths that drive the modern world, which have already been described. The reintegration of the personality will reverse the lower impulses of the subconscious, putting them under the higher parts of one’s being. A smaller group will work in private, developing their spiritual understanding. They will not, at this point, take part in any direct political action.

The transformation of this group in its depths will act as a catalyst, or perhaps leaven, in the environment, gradually infusing new transformative ideas. Once again, Evola makes clear that the will to carry out this project cannot be found on the human level, but only from a higher source. When the will is developed, the elite will make themselves known. True to form, Evola invokes the scepter, the regal sign, to identify the elite. Traditionally, it is the priest who is the bridge between the human and super-human worlds. We have to assume he means a Priest-King as existed in the early paganism of the Ancient City. The action of this priesthood will lead more men to metaphysical understanding, thus re-establishing a hierarchy. Note that "wind" is also the symbol for the Spirit.

Obviously, Evola cannot provide the specifics, since he is not part of the elite. Tradition doesn't end with Guenon and Evola. Hence, it is now more important to be very clear about metaphysical doctrines and not get lost in the fog of idle speculations instead of the clarity of true knowledge. The silent paths must be trodden, even if covered over with growth. Once again, Evola points out that this elite will be intransigent, intolerant, without compromise, unlike the libertarianism of the New Right. After all, truth cannot compromise with error and still remain the truth.

We now bring up the problem of the true elite. An elite of spiritual leaders, not of hypnotizers and arbitrary rulers of irrational collective forces, will be those who will be able to preside over a cycle of a still higher order, a metaphysical cycle. But in such regard, the possibilities of misunderstandings are endless. Today, in fact, we hear everywhere talk of the elite, and isn't there perhaps a dauber of printing paper of a certain rank who is presumed qualified to take part in it and thereby guide the endangered ship of Western civilization? So it is necessary to declare in the most pedantic way that it is not in the least about what today can be imagined and proposed as elite by most people, and less than ever is it

about pale international group of intellectuals more or less in style, as rich in narcissistic and exhibitionistic complexes as poor in true doctrine. While on one hand in the widest strata of Western nations, we should foster a general job of psychic detoxification, of destruction of the myths, of reintegration of the personality and start toward a new active realism, and, on the other hand, a smaller group should make itself capable of treading the silent, secret paths of traditional metaphysical knowledge. Outside of any visible organizations and independently of any immediate goal, this group will enucleate those qualities, will prepare the forces, and will reach a new seriousness, a new depth, a new solar virility, in the face of which every art will signify vanity, every speculation a pointless game of impotent abstractions, every vulgar politician an obscure mechanism, every variety of frenzy of action, which recent times have produced, a deleterious opiate. Only on such a basis will the word *nobility* reacquire in this elite its supreme and original significance, its hard, arid, absolute splendor.

The action of this elite, first of all, will be what the chemists call catalytic, i.e.: *a transformative action through its presence*. It will act as an invisible ferment and as the center of a crystallization of influences of a new type. The whole problem lies in seeing if these influences will succeed in saturating an environment, i.e., of compenetrating and orienting the new world of form, clarity, personality, and active realism in its deepest roots, preventing it from making itself the principle and end in itself. By that, we clearly mean something different from the passage from one "vision of the world" to another, the fruitless turning of a sick insomniac from one side to another. We mean a change fulfilled in the blood, or rather more in one's depths than in the blood, as a remembrance, as an awakening, as a transcendent liveliness. The will to something higher will then arise, and will make itself absolute, even if it contains exteriorly rigid and tempered forms like steel, a will higher than anything things and men alone can ever produce. It is at this point that the elite will also manifest

themselves visibly, they will take on with sturdy hands the direction of every force, they will be the bearer of a scepter. Bridges will be thrown beyond the humanly conditioned. New links will restore the action and knowledge of beings who live below their metaphysical potentiality. The strongest forces of life and death will turn to be present at the center, as the axis, flame, and light of new solar civilizations. An integral hierarchy will reestablish itself. The free wind from the heights will pass once again over new great currents of men of races.

These, naturally are liminal points, a bird's eye view—and no one should believe that with them the practical importance of reconstructive movements have risen against the final forms of collective decadence and demagogic mysticism—above all the fascist one—whether in the least disowned. But from a higher point of view, i.e., in the super-political sphere, in a world of fogs and uncertain flashes, as in the current one, only the pinnacle that towers over above contingencies and tempests can, in spite of their distance, provide the right orientation. In truth, only intolerance for every compromise and every limitation and the spiritual courage of absolute perspectives will distinguish the new group, the group of those who can bear witness to a spiritual vocation and to whom the tasks and the responsibility of the future reconstruction will be restored.

Posted on 2012-05-16 by Aeneas

* * *

logres on 2012-05-16 at 23:52 said:

I think I've asked before, but would Old Testament prophets represent a movement out of religion back to the "presence"?

Cologero on 2012-05-18 at 00:13 said:

Good point to emphasize the 'presence'. We can often forget, with the flood of ideas and doctrines, that Tradition is limited to that. The real point, however, is to reach a higher state of consciousness, beyond mere reason and beyond thoughts.

Nevertheless, Gornahoor is not a guru, ready, willing, or able to pronounce a judgment on any question that pops up; we are responsible only for our own texts. Readers are welcome to comment on the question if it so interests them.

Egemen on 2012-05-18 at 03:34 said:

Thanks to this another review of the situation of "present", filtered by the frame of "the castes". Nowadays, I am wondering and so think about inner dynamics of the traditional castes. Main hierarchical structure of the four-folded castes can be seen also in layers of it, one by one. For example, when you look to the main picture of the "Brahman caste", you can see some leaders as spiritual peaks (in arabic "kutb"), and their disciplines, and followers of that disciplines and so on. Similar leaders, similar sub-rules, similar following masses etc. are also can be seen in other castes. There is a big question is growing in my mind and that is "what is the nature and dynamics of being a leader in any castes?"...

Cologero on 2012-05-18 at 08:58 said:

Progress: The two most serious sins, ignorance and pride, assert themselves in regard to so-called progress.

Guido de Giorgio, Aforismi e Poesie

logres on 2012-05-18 at 23:13 said:

<http://don-colacho.blogspot.com/>

Worth reading his aphorisms, as an antidote to Nietzsche, like the above.

Cologero on 2012-05-20 at 08:45 said:

As a concrete example of the process described here, we can point to the *Declaration of the Rights of Man*⁵, arising from the French Revolution. Article 3 says:

The principle of all sovereignty resides essentially in the nation. No body nor individual may exercise any authority which does not proceed directly from the nation.

This explicitly excludes the idea of a spiritual authority above and independent of the state.

That the French Revolution was a bourgeois, and not a proletarian, revolution is revealed in the difference between the "active citizen" and "passive citizen". The rights of man applied only to active citizens: they must be male tax payers not of the servant class.

⁵http://avalon.law.yale.edu/18th_century/rightsof.asp

logres on 2012-05-21 at 08:48 said:

This really makes Tomberg's connection with Evola crystal clear – thank you. It also be-speaks Evola's "Catholic" sense of grace in a metaphysical context.

Cologero on 2012-05-21 at 12:18 said:

It is interesting, although I would proceed with caution. I think part of the similarity may be due to their mutual background in Hermetism, certainly not from a direct connection. What Evola wrote sure does sound like grace, but I doubt he would approve of that word.

Charlotte on 2012-05-22 at 09:09 said:

From the little I've read of Evola, his insight into using the Left Hand Path as a means of dealing with the constraints of the Kali Yuga is certainly intriguing – at least, it enables one to 'swallow' the humiliation that in some respects seems necessary. Perhaps this is what Tomberg also knew because otherwise I don't see massive similarities between the two authors – I see far more between Guenon and Tomberg, but perhaps I do not know Evola well enough yet to notice any great depth of comradeship between them – certainly Tomberg is not stuck in time....

I also can't help feeling that Evola is somewhat blinded by his own exalted situation in life – could he POSSIBLY be a Roman aristocrat!?!

For example, this statement here – 'it is necessary to battle for a new era of clarity, coldness, form' – whatever one's opinion of its veracity, far more clearly points to classical Greece rather than Rome, the empire of which was notable for its extremes of decadence and decay. Fair enough Dante was Italian, perhaps with all the princely sentiment that entails, but the Renaissance was really one of the classical Greek era not the Roman – of course everyone knows this, but it still seems necessary to point it out in this context.

Personally I feel that a lot of his material has passed its time now, the Spirit is fresh and the 'masses' (how archaic!) who live on the land, wherever they're allowed to tend to be more in touch with the natural elan than their self-professed superiors, who are hampered by inflated egos, the wrong sort of living and generally too much 'knowing' of the kind that comes from books.

Spiritual regeneration comes from the simple virtues of faith, hope and love, the triumph of the heart centre. This is something Dante knew well, as he would have accomplished nothing without Beatrice. Sure enough she enlivened his mind, but first she had to set his heart on fire.

Cologero on 2012-05-22 at 12:57 said:

You seem to be missing his point, Charlotte. First of all, he lived a monkish life with few possessions. The attitude he described was that of Rome, not of Greece. The former was not always decadent and decayed. The very notion implies it had to start from a higher point. A

more apt analogy would be the UK, which used to have the "stiff upper lip", but is now decadent, atheistic, crime ridden, and hopeless for a large segment of the youth.

The Renaissance was the restoration of Greek culture, but Evola regarded it as an ersatz version.

In the Force arcana, Tomberg writes: It is terrestrial electricity that we make use of in the technical field of our civilisation but also in hypnosis, in demagogic propaganda, in movements of revolutionary masses ... for electrical energy has its analogous forms on various planes – physical, psychic, and even mental.

You see, Evola and Tomberg has the same fundamental worldview, whatever the difference in details. Each of those elements mentioned by Tomberg are also found in Evola, as even a cursory reading of the most recent translation will reveal.

Tomberg also writes: The Reformation, rationalism, the French revolution, materialistic faith of the nineteenth century, and the Bolshevik revolution, show that everywhere mankind is turning away from the Virgin.

Once again, did not Evola make the identical list of those forces opposing spiritual renewal?

Tomberg writes: "Napoleon understood the direction which Europe had taken – the direction towards the complete destruction of hierarchy." Tomberg also wrote that Napoleon should have ruled by the sceptre rather than the sword. Did not Evola say that the sceptre would be the sign of the return of the spiritual elite?

Tomberg describes the French revolution, the communist revolution, and nationalism as perverse collective intoxications. Did not Evola use similar language? Do you now understand that a stage of detoxification is the necessary first step?

Where did Evola say that you have to read more books? The "knowing" he is talking about is identical to the gnosis of Tomberg.

Charlotte on 2012-05-22 at 18:02 said:

well it's a matter of opinion I guess, and I have only just started reading Evola so can't pretend to be an expert. However it seems to me that he focuses far more on class and notions of elitism than I ever heard Tomberg openly express. But we live now in different times.

I agree with their assessment of the French revolution and I would be the last person to advocate blind anarchy – whenever I speak to revolutionaries, and believe me I know plenty, I urge them to consider carefully the consequences of their ideas and actions. Never mind the first step, I will say, it's the step you have to take once power is assumed that ALWAYS causes the problems....

I think the difficulty with the attitude you (and Evola) advocate nowadays is that we're in a situation where it's very difficult to trust those in charge – who I suppose are the 'élites'. the ones with money at any rate. We may or may not be past the stage of a 'peasants' revolt'. but I think it is perfectly justifiable for ordinary people nowadays to question the motives of their

'superiors' (especially political) and to wonder whether the people who've been appointed to govern are in fact up to the task. It seems to me that the ones who truly have the qualifications to rule – on the moral scale in particular – lack the desire to go into the governing machine, which in pretty much every country is corrupt at some level. And yes, since Tony Blair's era – he is the classic example of someone who is apparently a member of the 'élite' but in fact is the antithesis of such a word in real terms – England went well on its way to the dogs. This is the whole point. Those with the moral fibre necessary to really good judgement – the true followers of the Virgin – want no part to play in the charade that is global politics.

Of course I understand that true 'élites' are not the politicians, they are the ones who possess the gifts of the Holy Spirit, healing, prophecy and so on. However, there is a world beyond that of formation, and sooner or later the ideas must be put into practice. How shall this be done, who shall 'bite the bullet' as it were? Universal salvation – something the virgin would certainly wish for us – entails saving one and all, not just the 'better ones'. My concern nowadays is that practical solutions are required – we have all been thinking now for aeons and find ourselves irrevocably on Earth for at least the duration of the present life. Correct 'tactics' at an occult level are indeed necessary to understand – and this is something I think both Evola and Guenon can help with, maybe even more than Tomberg in some ways, at a certain junction, but I still feel that the former's understanding of 'élite' is outmoded. This is in part a problem of time – those who came before don't have the advantage of our hindsight!

Charlotte on 2012-05-22 at 18:18 said:

on the subject of the Virgin, I don't think that people really are turning away, in fact I think that ordinary people are embracing her more than ever, just not necessarily in a way that fits with the Roman Catholic mold. I think this is something you may have to consider. Fair enough it may be manifesting (at the moment) as a more primitive form of 'goddess worship'. but the basic principle of turning to the divine feminine is getting stronger by the day. I agree there can be a lack of understanding with respect to what 'divine' and 'feminine' – plus the two together – REALLY mean, but all the same I think we are going in the right direction.

Even Tomberg had to admit that the 'true Church' is a spiritual body – we know this; there has to be freedom.

Cologero on 2012-05-22 at 19:59 said:

In the Arcana of the Emperor, Tomberg does indeed advocate the precise same hierarchy that Evola endorses. These are not in the least "matters of opinion", these are the fruits of gnosis. Tomberg writes:

A pyramid is not complete without its summit; a hierarchy does not exist when it is incomplete. Without an Emperor, there will be, sooner

or later, no more kings. When there are no kings, there will be, sooner or later, no more nobility. When there is no more nobility, there will be, sooner or later, no more bourgeoisie or peasants. This is how one arrives at the dictatorship of the proletariat, the class hostile to the hierarchical principle, which is the **reflection of divine order**. That is why the proletariat professes atheism.

This has nothing to do with social class, an artificial construct, which has never been mentioned on this blog. What Evola and Tomberg are describing is the Divine Order, the reflection of the supernatural on earth. These castes are not arbitrary, they are due to the inherent differences in people, and their respective roles, duties, or dharma, in their incarnation. It is not a question of someone getting an extra privilege; how can that conclusion be reached from anything written here?

Of course we are in different times; that is the entire point! Tomberg says the West is getting old, in other words, it is at the end of an age. A few retrograde movements you describe are no more than small eddies in the downward current, of little ultimate import. There is no right direction, since the direction now is towards dying of old age, rejecting legitimate hierarchy, being blind to the supernatural, and following any number of false movements because they make us "feel good". The only direction is a radical reversal, a new beginning.

Power is not the problem; we have to look beyond our immediate experience. Those in power have the proletarian mindset, a mass mind, that wants to force entire populations into spiritual darkness by eliminating any and all distinctions, including the most fundamental one, that of male and female. But there is no point in my repeating what has already been written here over and over. Arguing opinions is futile; it is really a question of learning to "see", to see in the depths, and not be misled by appearances. Some few will begin to "see"; the future will belong to them. Everyone else are floating flotsam and jetsam, carried along in the currents of the modern world, whatever illusions they privately hold to make that trip tolerable.

Cologero on 2012-05-22 at 20:00 said:

Freedom is not a given; it needs to be earned.

Charlotte on 2012-05-23 at 03:49 said:

Oh I can see it alright! And I have always thought that a 'divine kingship' is the ideal form of government. My protests centre on the fact that the hierarchy has succumbed to total corruption, those in charge either did not prove worthy, or have been usurped and power seized by the wrong people. Get to the top of the earthly pyramid – the manifestation of the hierarchy, and I can guarantee you wouldn't like what's there. The war in heaven has produced unimaginable

horrors here on earth – who is watching the watchers, who can reach past their veils?

Apart from that, my issue all along has been one of solutions – it's alright pointing out the problem but what is to be DONE? high ideals are fine, but when you've been witness to real horror and comprehended the real and present problems of the world, like starving children and millions of sex slaves, it sheds rather a different light on things, the rose-tinted glasses no longer cut it. The fact also remains that most countries have done away with their royalty and won't ever go back to them. The question for 'spiritual elites' is one of how to alleviate the burden of suffering for people here on Earth – this is why we come down from the Holy mountain, in order to help others. This is why the Buddha, king of overcoming karma, preached compassion – united we stand and divided we fall, as we are ALL sparks from God, not just the few at the top, be they priests, artists or politicians.

At the very end of the spiritual exercises Tomberg warns us most stringently that the biggest test of all for the 'mage' is to go back down to Earth after reaching the pinnacle – it is the ultimate test of one's Spirit over one's ego, for surely it's a better view from the top of the pile!! it's SO MUCH NICER to be directing the world of formation and clairvoyantly determining the course of evolution than trying to implement change in the realm of creation. I don't underestimate the trials of this, of course, having battled with them for decades, but I know it takes much greater courage to risk everything in order to see the way it looks from the lowly sheep pen. And in any case, who here is NOT part of 'the masses'. I don't imagine any of us are driving round in rolls royces or are free from the long arm of the law, even if we're lucky enough to have divine protection in other spheres? Got to be realistic about our actual influence in this realm, although a more organised system would reap more tangible results.

I also seem to remember Tomberg speaking of how these hierarchies will, at some stage, necessarily have to move into the spiritual realm precisely because of the very problems I speak of. In particular the office of Pope. The Emperor is a spiritual fact, but where does he really reside? Not in the Roman region, I know that much, he isn't the head of any earthly scheme.

As for freedom, you're wrong about that one, it is our sovereign gift from God and a terrible sin for one human being to remove the freedoms of another. To say that some people do not deserve to be free but are born to be slaves of others is devilish – can you imagine the place where they kept the slaves on the coast of Africa? You know there is still a metre high tide mark inside the building where the excrement level stained the walls – so called human 'elites' kept other human beings standing in a metre of shit for days on end. Try telling me that the slave masters are somehow superior and I'll fight you until one of us dies.

Charlotte on 2012-05-23 at 10:36 said:

So, in the interim a senior tutor from my alma mater dropped by to pass on a message, which I dutifully convey to you now:

Christian Hermeticism itself can only be knowledge of the universal which is revealed

in the particular. For Hermeticism there are no 'principles', 'laws' and 'ideas' which exist outside of individual beings, not as structural traits of their nature, but as entities separated and independent from it.

For Hermeticism there is neither a 'law of gravitation' nor a 'law of reincarnation'. there is only the attraction and repulsion of beings (atoms are beings also) in so far as gravitation is concerned, and only the attraction of beings to earthly life, with its joys and sorrows, in so far as reincarnation is concerned.

Laws are immanent in beings, as logic is immanent in thought, being part of the very nature of thought. And true progress, true evolution, is the advance of beings from life under one law to life under another law....it is thus that the law 'an eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth' is in the process of gradually being replaced by the law of forgiveness. It is thus again that the law 'the weak serve the strong, the people serve the king, the disciple serves the master' will one day give way to the law shown by the Master through the act of the Washing of the Feet.

According to this higher law, it is the strong who serve the weak, the king who serves the people, the master who serves the disciple – just as in heaven, where Angels serve human beings, Archangels serve Angels and men, Principalities serve Archangels, Angels and human beings, and so on. And God? He serves all beings without exception.

Thus the 'law' of the struggle for existence that Darwin observed in the domain of biology will one day cede its place to the law of cooperation for existence which exists already in the cooperation of flowering plants and bees, in the cooperation of different cells in an organism, and in cooperation in the human social organism. The end of the 'law' of the struggle for existence and the future triumph of the law of cooperation for life has been foretold by the prophet Isaiah:

The wolf shall dwell with the lamb,
And the leopard shall lie down with the kid,
And the calf and the lion and the fatling together,
And a little child shall lead them.

This will be, because the new 'law' – ie, a profound change in the psychic and physical structure of beings – will replace the old 'law'. firstly in consciousness, then in desires and affections, then lastly in the organic structure of beings.

'Law' succeed one another and change. They are not immutable metaphysical entities. It is the same wiht respect to 'principles' and 'ideas'. The sabbath was made for man, not man for the sabbath; so the Son of Man is lord even of the sabbath (Mark ii, 27:28) – here is the relationship between beings, on the one side, and laws, principles and ideas, on the other.

Meditations on the Tarot, Letter IX, The Hermit

So now we have reached the time of change and of the returning Spirit. I am called upon to point out that the 'masses' – the sheep, the children – are NOT naturally atheists, but have had their faith, hope and love assaulted by those in whom they placed their supreme trust. In

much the same way as an abused child may become hardened in his or her heart, or a kicked dog might want to bite, have the 'plebians' revolted against tyrannical overlords. The tower falls.

Furthermore, those selfsame plebians could hardly have carried out their revolutionary acts without effective leadership from the ranks of the 'elite' – the Illuminati in the case of the French Revolution, or Thule society in the case of the Nazi party, for example. It might also be pointed out that the kingship of France was in itself held by usurpers at the time of the revolution, the Merovingians having been sold out to the Franks centuries before. At some stage the cycle of closed circles – the materialism of the mages – must be broken in order for those within to be free to follow the true Master.

Cologero on 2012-05-23 at 23:54 said:

We have already address this here, Charlotte: Ideas and Occult History:

We need to see the idea in its relationship to other ideas horizontally and also vertically in its relationship to higher and more general ideas. These ideas do not exist on their own in some ethereal realm. ... "The bearer of an idea ... must be a person."

So you can't use Tomberg to refute what has already been expressed here. A fortiori, you can't rely on Tomberg to make some point, while ignoring what directly contradicts you. If you have a beef, it is with Tomberg who claimed the "proletariat professes atheism". You have also ignored what he wrote about the need for hierarchy. Please tell us how deluded he is.

I don't care if you agree or disagree with anything Tomberg or Guenon wrote, but misunderstanding is not the same as disagreement. You persist in using the term "elite" in your own way, rather than as it has been defined; try to be fair in your discussions. The whole point, which you are apparently missing, is that the "elite" who led the French or Bolshevik revolutions were themselves from the masses. How can you possibly believe some spiritual elite would institute the Terror, the massacres at Vendee, the Gulags? If the masses are so naturally God loving, then how can they go along with this.

Being a "leader" is not the same thing as being an "elite". First of all, the elite, or "elect", are actually chosen from above. A "leader" is chosen by the people. Of course, the plebeians carried the acts under a leadership; that is the whole point of the occult war. The other point is that they did not resist. Did not the masses choose Barabbas over Jesus?

Charlotte, I don't understand your perpetual need to quibble, oppose, and debate, when a conversation would be more pleasant and useful.

Charlotte on 2012-05-24 at 05:51 said:

well to my mind there was a very valid point to be made and as far as I can tell Tomberg DOES refute it quite clearly, perhaps Evola and Guenon are sometimes contradictory or have left loose threads? To me this seems very likely. Almost every occultist leaves loose threads and Tomberg is valued so highly because he has done such an awesome job of completion.

The work of Tomberg is the most complex – it reaches further in every direction – than any of the other authors being discussed. I assume part of the point of Gornahoor is to draw correspondences between him, Guenon and Evola, but he can't be used to bolster everything they write, even if they do concur in places.

If nobody else sees the point I'm making about slavery then so be it – and I really do NOT agree that freedom is something that should be earned, I know it was granted by God to all human beings. The elite who made possible the mind set of French Revolution and Nazi movement were philosophers – certainly Hitler would not have been possible without the Thule. I completely and utterly refute the idea that the masses are atheistic, I think this is an appalling misrepresentation of people who over the years have been abused by overlords yet for the most part manage to display a truer sort of faith, based on love not mind. The heart is all in matters of God.

And yes, the 'elect' are chosen from above, but they do not necessarily occupy earthly bodies – this is another fact Tomberg at least hints at. Yes the masses chose Barabbas but it was the priestly caste of Jerusalem who incited them to do so and who ensured that Jesus did not have a 'free run' as it were. He came to overturn their money tables and to correct them, to rid them of their corruption, their worship of caesar and money. It was the decision of the Roman emperor to commit genocide against the Jews, not his foot soldiers, they simply followed orders.

You see the fish rots from the head down and there's no denying it. The masses – the peasantry – are (or at least were) devoted to their superiors and piously in awe of the hierarchy that they truly DID believe was divinely ordained. Humble men and women, for all their roughness and shortcomings DID love their kings and queens with a passion and would die for them. Of course when the lords, ladies, kings and queens become so utterly corrupted that even the most simple-minded pig-herder can see it, then something has to be done. The former cannot be relied upon to do the right thing, so what happens next? People get unhappy, they feel that the smoke of satan has entered the divine order and they feel compelled to uproot it.

Others with an agenda see that there is unrest – powerful enough for an uprising – and they use that energy to take the power for themselves. And so human history goes round and round – the will to power pollutes the entire pyramid scheme again and again and again. In the end, however, cream rises and it is at least possible that a 'good king and queen' might somehow reign again – but they'll have to prove their worth and credentials. If they turn out to be legitimate then it will work. If not then people will have to keep on waiting.

As for conversations, well there are important points at stake and I'm not one to let false doctrines sail by unchallenged – I could do for my own popularity's sake, I know how men prefer

to be 'managed'. but this isn't the place for that. I've seen MANY heated debates on this website – between yourself and Exit for instance – so I don't see myself as going overboard. One has a right to an opinion after all and we're all out of the first school – maybe we can all learn something from each other...

12.5 Round Table: Ossendowski, Guenon, Maritain

These are the notes of a round table held in 1924 in Paris and hosted by Frederic Lefevre. What follows are his notes from that meeting published in the 26 July 1924 issue of “Les nouvelles littéraires”. The original text in French may be found here: *Le Salut qui veint de l'Orient?*⁶.

Does Salvation come from the East? The arrival in Paris of Mr. **Ferdinand Ossendowski**, who has been called the Robinson Crusoe of the twentieth century, could not go unnoticed; all critics are unanimous in considering *Beasts, Men and Gods*, his first book translated into French, as a prodigious book, the most exciting travelogue they ever read. We had the good fortune to talk with Ossendowski, the man who saw the living Buddha, and we had the no less valued opportunity to meet with the three French personalities who seem best designated to compare their doctrines and science to his experiences, and to judge, in the light of Western concepts, the incredible number of observations he reported about his dramatic trip through Asia. I selected the historian of Asia, **Rene Grousset**, whom we presented to our readers a few weeks ago, **Jacques Maritain**, the Catholic philosopher, to whom the Thomistic revival in this country is largely due, and **Rene Guenon**, the Hinduist, whose meditations have earned us this remarkable book, *Introduction to Hindu*

⁶<http://esprit-universel.over-blog.com/table-ronde-1924-ren%C3%A9-guenon-ferdinand-ossendowski-et-jacques-maritain>

Doctrines, a nice summary, full of substance, both East and West, and who publishes these days on the questions which trouble the European consciousness.

Ferdinand Ossendowski was first of all asked about the political question like all those who were victims of the Russian Revolution. He gave us some interesting reports on Russia and the yellow world. He took the trouble to answer all our questions. The Catholic philosopher Jacques Maritain was neither the least curious nor the least impatient. Let us try, at the mercy of our memory, to reconstruct the back and forth.

J. Maritain: Isn't there an alliance between the Asiatic world and the Soviets?

Ossendowski: In order to answer that question it is necessary to go back into history. The last descendant of Genghis Khan, Amoursang Khan, who was also the emperor of China, took refuge in Russia when the Ming dynasty triumphed over the Yuan dynasty. As a pledge of gratitude, he transferred all his rights as supreme Khan to the Empress Catherine II. That was, you know, in the 18th century. He also gave her the holy stone of prophecy, a type from black agate which was all covered with lichen. As long as it remained at Ourga, sickness or unhappiness would never touch the Mongols, nor their animals. Since they left Asia, the Mongol people slowly began to die.

Lefèvre: Did the czars use the title of supreme Khan and did the holy stone of prophecy grant all its power in Russia?

Ossendowski: Catherine II did not use that title, but Alexander I, aware of the duties that it imposed on him, helped the Mongols diplomatically in their revolts against China and since then, the Mongols and Chinese, follow the titles of czar with "white Khan" (Tzagan-Khan). Also, when Semionov, general of the army of Koltchak, became viceroy of the Far East, he demanded the title of great Khan of Mongolia from the living Buddha of Ourga. He got it. Baron Ungern was no stranger to such a rapid acquiescence.

Lefèvre: Is Semionov still the great Khan of Mongolia?

Ossendowski: He still is, but no longer exercises an effective power. He is now living in Nagasaki, Japan. He fought against the Bolsheviks in the district of Oussouri on the Pacific coast when he separated from Ungern. Effective power then returned to Ungern whose first move was to have the living Buddha address a bull to all the Asiatic peoples in which he ordered the battle against the "Bolsheviks, evil devils who are going to kill the morals and the soul of all humanity." Semionov had moreover been contacted by the Dali Lama who had sent a message to the living Buddha ordering him since 1921 to undertake the battle for the defense of humanity.

It is then that the living Buddha had begun the war, Baron Ungern being his generalissimo. They called Ungern the God of the war, and I saw, in his army, representative of all the Asiatic tribes. They fought first against China for the autonomy of Mongolia. They were victorious. Once free, Mongolia proposed to China to take the leadership of this panasiatic movement against the Bolsheviks first and the white race afterwards. But China is in such a state of anarchy that she could not accept. She is totally divided into small kingdoms which are in the hands of adventurer generals. Before her refusal, Mongolia took the command of its allies and undertook a battle hardly crowned with success. Ungern was betrayed by his officers, delivered to the Bolsheviks forces in Transbaikial, and killed. Since then, it is the Soviets who have claimed the rights of the czars over Asia. For five years, there have been in Petrograd eleven panasiatic congresses, and the university of propaganda of Moscow, where there are two hundred thousand students, counting forty thousand Asian students (the most numerous are the Indians from British India, then the Chinese, the Persians, and Turks). The Bolshevik propaganda is moreover very skilled. Communism is not for it a doctrine of export, as the Orient repudiates it absolutely. It presents Russia as the avant-garde of the yellow world ready to swoop down on the white race. But the living Buddha

and his wife, and especially his wife, created an obstacle to that propaganda. The Bolsheviks did not hesitate; they poisoned the Buddha's wife about two years ago. Unable to fight openly against the Bolsheviks, the living Buddha limited himself to maintain contact with all the people in order to form, at the right time, a great central Asiatic kingdom. China's monarchist party is in a close relationship with the living Buddha and, if he should triumph, it would force China to join that anti-Bolshevik and anti-white movement.

Lefèvre: Does that mean that you do not believe that the Bolsheviks are capable of organizing a panasiatic movement?

Ossendowski: I don't believe so. They do not base themselves only on purely Asiatic elements.

Maritain: Are there relations between the living Buddha of Ourga and Gandhi?

Ossendowski: Yes, they are in a relation, but if a will to fight against the white race unites them, their systems are different. The living Buddha is a warrior and Gandhi is a pacifist. The movement he created is not yet a warrior movement.

Lefèvre: Do you know Rabindranath Tagore? Isn't he critical of that battle against Western civilization as extreme? In three very significant messages that Cecile Gerge-Bazile just translated into French under the title, *Nationalism*, he raises some blunt declarations: "The West is necessary to the East. We are complementary to each other by our different aspects of truth, which is why, if it is true that the spirit of the West has fallen in our countries like a storm, it sows nevertheless here and there some living seeds which are immortal. And when in India we become capable of assimilating what is permanent in Western civilization, we will be in position to bring a reconciliation of these two great worlds."

Tagore is an intelligence nourished by all cultures of the world and besides he declared: "I believe in the true union of the East and the West. All the glories of humanity are mine. No people can make its salvation

while detaching himself from others." If there is an affectionate esteem for Gandhi, he fears the Ghandians.

Ossendowski: I saw Tagore in London. He is an Asiatic. In his black eyes, you can see nothing. When I look into those eyes, I always had the impression of a screen that is necessary to lift up.

Guenon: Tagore is a very Westernized Asian.

Ossendowski: Don't rely on that too much;

Maritain: Did you encounter in Mongolia any traces of Catholic evangelization?

Ossendowski: No. A few Franciscans, but without any importance.

Guenon: However, the Catholic missionaries alone could get a hearing with the Buddhist soul. Unfortunately, they all commit, in my opinion, the great error of addressing themselves only to the pariahs, the non-cultivated castes, and they were despised by that fact. They thus strictly limit themselves in the field of their influence since they neglect everything that constitutes the intellectual vitality of the oriental world.

Grousset: Intellectual vitality, intellectual vitality! But there is no philosophical activity in Mongolian Buddhism.

Guenon: What do you know about it? Don't you know that true wisdom is silence? The virtue of the Buddha is something entirely interior.

Lefèvre: But are you speaking to us, Mr. Ossendowski, of the living Buddha, whom you saw?

Ossendowski: I saw the one from Ourga. There are two others.

Lefèvre: That is the trinity of living Buddhas?

Ossendowski: Exactly, and they each have some very distinct attributes. The Dalai Lama, who resides in Lhasa, Tibet, is like the incarnation, or better said, the realization of the hoiiness of the Buddha. The Lama of Tashilhunpo who lives two hundred kilometers from Lhasa, realizes the wisdom and the science of Buddha. The third, the one whose palace I was in at Ourga in Mongolia, represents the material and warrior

force of Buddha.

Lefèvre: I feel moved; I will still keep a more attentive ear. I press the question of the blessed contemplator of the holiness of the living Buddha. Well, is he truly more than a man? What impression did you get during your first interview. Formidable, wasn't he.

Ossendowski: Yes; unfortunately, he is an old drunkard.

Lefèvre: I am aghast.

Guenon and Ossendowski together: That has no importance.

Ossendowski: The power is with the Russian merchants who forced him to drink in order to exploit him better. He lost his sight. The personality of the living Buddha presents the same duality that one finds again in all Lamaism. When he became blind, the Lamas fell into the deepest despair. Some of them were sure that it was necessary to poison him and put in his place another incarnated Buddha; the others valued the great merits of the pontiff in the eyes of the Mongolians and of the faithful of the yellow religion. They finally decided to build a great temple with a gigantic statue of Buddha, in order to appease the gods. This however did not succeed in bringing back the sight of the Buddha, but gave him the chance to hasten his departure for the other world of those from among the Lamas who gave proof of an excessive radicalism, as to the method proper to resolve the problem of his blindness.

Lefèvre: Mr. Ossendowski's statements surprise us. We poorly explain to ourselves the strange morality of the living Buddha.

Guenon interrupts: Don't judge those things with your Western categories. What you call virtue is for Hindu wisdom something exterior and quite incidental.

Maritain: It is because of this that the living Buddha doesn't disregard the help of his brotherhood of poisoner lamas.

Ossendowski: These are the doctors in political medicine. Coming back to the living Buddha, he is not drunk every day and apart from that defect, he appeared to me to be a very superior man. At certain moments,

I sensed something pass in him like a true inspiration. He was 64 years old. He is the son of one of the Dalai Lama's squires. He himself has a son who the intrigues of Japan tried to circumvent.

Maritain: What do you think of the mystery of the King of the World, leader of a subterranean humanity with marvelous science and power, whom you regard in your book as the central animating mystery of Mongolian hope?

Ossendowski: I suppose that this legend has a political origin. No nation in Asia being strong enough to sustain temporally the imperialism of the yellow religion, that function was devolved to a subterranean humanity and to its leader. And so the hopes of the Asians had the point of necessary support... while waiting for the new Genghis Khan.

Guenon: The idea of the King of the World dates back In Asia to high antiquity, and it always had an important role in the Hindu and Shaivite tradition which form the base of Tibetan Buddhism.

Maritain: For us, in any case, this name evokes different assonances, "the prince of this world has been" judged," say the Gospels.

Lefèvre: Of all the strange phenomena which you witnessed, Mr. Ossendowski, and that you relate in your book, is there anything in it that appears inexplicable?

Ossendowski: I have to say that I spent several months in an excruciating solitude, the nerves strained at each instant in a constant battle for life. I was ripe for all suggestions and even auto-suggestions.

Maritain: However regarding the other things that you had the same vision, of your family which was far away and certain predictions made came true. Prediction is not of the domain of suggestion.

Ossendowski: I am a traveler and observer. Therefore, I am leaving soon for North Africa. I am going to visit Morocco (I have a letter of recommendation from Marshal Lyautey), Algeria, Tunisia, Egypt. Next year I will push onto Central Africa. I have the feeling that I will report some things about it. I come in sympathy with the peoples, with the land

itself. I have the romanticism of the land.

Maritain: Did you record any teachings given by the Lamas?

Ossendowski: The Lamas are very intelligent and cultivated, but they keep the people in credulity and superstition. At all the bends in the road, it is necessary to offer sacrifices to the evil spirits.

... with a melancholy smile: I myself offered numerous sacrifices. The people live a type of crude pantheism. Everywhere I saw them bent under fear.

Maritain: And it is these Lama teachers who want to bring to Europe the kingdom of the spirit ... what strikes me is that in place of these distinctions between the different orders that can be regarded as one of the most precious acquisitions of western civilization, and as a condition of human freedom, one notices over there a universal confusion between the spiritual and the temporal, between mysticism and politics, between the interior hierarchy of holiness and the hierarchy of spiritual government.

Guenon: But there is also over there a deep wisdom that the West does not know how to become aware of.

Maritain: I am quite far from denying it. But in what mixtures does it take place? And what spirit does it come under? It is the task of Catholic theologians to discern it. When will they decide to study that question in the light of their principles? That is urgent. However, Mr. Ossendowski, one thing astonishes me in your book: doesn't it seem, after what you bring back from there, that this wisdom is turned above all on the side of the administration of created things?

Ossendowski: That is true without doubt from what I saw at Ourga. Don't forget however that at the side of the living Buddha of Ourga, and above him, there is the Panchen Lama and the Dalai Lama who turn away from the things of the world, and are absorbed in a pure contemplation.

Maritain: In that the yellow religion remains faithful to one of the deepest truths of the spiritual order. And certainly, they are correct to

reproach our civilization for its materialism, and its dissipation in outer activity. If Europe is in its torment, it is because she has failed in her mission. But that is not from them that she must receive initiation into the things of the spirit. It suffices for her to come back to her most authentic tradition which, with a better claim than the oriental tradition, affirms the preeminence of wisdom and contemplation.

Ossendowski: The Asians think that the war of Asia against Europe is inevitable and holy.

Grousset: But Japan, so hungry for material progress and passionately turned towards western civilization, will not follow them on this path.

Ossendowski: the Japanese are now regarded as the renegades of Asia.

Maritain: It is not only force that must be opposed to force, but also spirit to the spirit.

Guenon: Why do you speak of an opposition? It is rather necessary to say alliance and agreement.

Maritain: There is no alliance possible outside of truth.

Guenon: Such is certainly my thought. But the Orient brings us a truth which can agree with the truths of the highest western traditions: the Aristotelian and Catholic traditions.

Maritain: Aristotle's metaphysics will never agree with a thought that it is necessary, so cleverly that you defend it, to call pantheist and which, in wanting to go beyond being, can only smash reason.

Guenon: The word pantheism is a western word which should not be applied to Hindu speculation. There is nothing in common between this and what we call pantheism, nor what we call idealism.

Maritain: As to the Catholic religion, the alliance in question will be for her only an inadmissible subordination and the ruin of the distinction between the natural and supernatural orders, between nature and grace. Theology, supported on the revealed principles of faith, is the supreme

science.

Guenon: No, it is only a determinate of metaphysics, I speak of the true and authentic metaphysical wisdom. This goes well beyond.

Maritain: No science goes beyond revealed faith. Moreover, does Hindu wisdom know the complete way, not only the order of morality properly called, what we call merit, sin, etc., but also the order of charity?

Ossendowski: The Mongolian people are honest, peaceful, and deeply worthy; they practice hospitality. But there is in effect no place in eastern religion for charity in the sense of the love of God

Guenon: That is a sentimental element and consequently secondary.

Maritain: Come on then! It is a fully spiritual and fully supernatural virtue: "God is Love." It is by that alone that man reaches perfection; it is by that also and by the gift of wisdom which is inseparable from it, that true contemplation has its place. It is by that alone that the Spirit can rule among men. That is the main point on which no agreement is possible between absolute intellectualism and Hindu esoterism.

Lefèvre: Is it necessary then, in your opinion Mr. Maritain, to reject en bloc all oriental thought?

Maritain: No way. There are precious and very high truths to gather from them, which keeping oneself from all injustice and all vicious bias, and in evading (on this point I am in agreement with Mr. Guenon), applying to it deficient methods that the critical rationalist applies to Christianity in the West. On condition notwithstanding of subjugating everything by an intelligence faithful to sacred truths which are our heritage! One can ask oneself if the Greco-Latin culture, where the salvation of reason is, is not destined to lose soon its privilege in fact, to cease to be the only form of intelligence, as culture becomes truly worldwide.

Lefèvre: Evidently we cannot prevent Tagore's books, for example, from being translated into all the languages and the oriental conception of life from belonging to cultivated readers in the entire world.

Grousset: The Anglo-Saxons have understood for a long time that

this compenetration was inevitable and that it was useless to oppose it.

Maritain: No protectionist barrier is in effect possible for the products of the spirit. That "expansion of culture" will be for human intelligence a tremendous ordeal. All the more reason to study the Orient with attention and sympathy, but while at the same time without bending the Hellenic, Latin, and Catholic deposit.

Ossendowski: I repeat it to you, I am only an impartial observer, but I will not hide from you that I dream sometimes with anxiety at what will happen if the entire peoples of color, religion, different tribes begin to emigrate into the West. Would that be the last march of the Mongolians?

Posted on 2013-06-23 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2013-06-23 at 12:04 said:

This should be blatantly obvious, but just in case: this entire conversation is colored heavily by Lothrop Stoddard.

Amarsanaa Khan was the last ruler of the Zunghar Empire which received the title Khan from the Dalai Lama. He sought asylum with the Russians in 1757 and died in Tobolsk (no word on magical black rocks in the historical record). A common legend among the Mongols, current in the 1920s, stated that Amarsanaa would one day return from the world beyond to free them from the Chinese. When Ossendowski was in Mongolia, a self-proclaimed reincarnation of Amarsanaa called Ja Lama was fighting the Communists. No joke.

The "white Khan" thing is true, as is Semionov's flight to Nagasaki. Information about the Bloody Baron's reign, of course, cannot be confirmed.

Ossendowski: "The Dalai Lama, who resides in Lhasa, Tibet, is like the incarnation, or better said, the realization of the holiness of the Buddha. The Lama of Tashilhunpo who lives two hundred kilometers from Lhasa, realizes the wisdom and the science of Buddha. The third, the one whose palace I was in at Ourga in Mongolia, represents the material and warrior force of Buddha."

This offhand statement, which does not correspond to anything in *Beasts, Men, and Gods*, is quoted and analyzed by Guenon on page 25 of *The King of the World* (Sophia Perennis edition).

The exchange between Guenon and Maritain is excellent. We are surprised that *The King of the World* was the most lasting product of the discussion when Guenon was its least constructive

contributor. He comes off as simpering and lacking any command of the discussion, especially when Maritain gives him a tongue-lashing about the essence of Christianity. But his insistence on avoiding "sentimentalism" is in fact a fine understanding of Eastern doctrine.

Finally, it is amusing to see Tagore's poetry talked about with such fear, when much more obvious sources of art and literature like the entire tradition of Far Eastern painting, haiku, and the Pali Canon have had a far greater impact on the West.

Ash on 2013-06-23 at 16:07 said:

One finds Ossendowski's description of the way in which the Lamas and their disciples ruled in the Mongolian and Tibetan lands to be one begging for examination. Guenon's dismissive attitude towards the character of their rule (keeping the populace in fear, although that may of course be Ossendowsky reading his own prejudices into things) when they themselves apparently have corruptions to address. When the Brahminic caste falls into corruption, is it the duty of the other castes to see that the corrupting individuals are replaced? Is it still rebellion when those of a caste acting properly move against a caste which has become corrupt in this way? Or is there no way to avoid the cycle of decay? Perhaps we must try even when it is hopeless, like the "Roman guard at Pompeii."

Although Tagore is usually viewed as a more "humanist" writer in the Bengal and broader Indian tradition, he does seem to have the more "Traditional" point of view here regarding the relationship between "East" and "West", at least with regards to the manifestations of Tradition in each. The idea that either the East will take the West or that some sort of war is inevitable may serve well as a warning but is dangerous when it leads to fatalism and barriers which need not exist between spiritual friends. Grousette's comments on Japan are ironic indeed.

Maritain is certainly one who seems worth exploring further. To clarify, what precisely is meant by the "Aristotelean tradition"? Greek philosophy as a whole or Aristotle and his Thomist successors specifically? It seems strange to leave out the Stoics, Plato, the mystery cults, and a legion of other non-Aristoteleans from the Western Tradition. Maritain's statement that metaphysics comes before epistemology is useful when we look at the nature of the Outer Contender discussed in the previous post. For this current, the reverse is the case. The metaphysics of Tradition are useful insofar as they lead one to accept other political ideas. This reversal of the sources of Truth becomes very apparent in writers like Dyal. The New Right has caught this fatal mistake from the New Left. To educate the willing and combat the error, it is absolutely fundamental to maintain the proper ordering which Maritain described in his works.

Avery and Cologero, could you recommend some sources for the "white Khan" claim? I tried looking around online but I couldn't find much to verify this apart from works not citing any primary sources.

Logres on 2013-06-24 at 00:33 said:

I noticed, in reading Ouspensky, that he makes the claim that all anger is a waste of spiritual energy. However, when you read the first section of the *Philokalia*, you find Isaiah advocating a “holy anger” whereby the practitioner sides with God in being angry at the seeds of sin sown in the soul, and flashes like lightning against it with the prayer of Jesus. This seems to be a fundamental disagreement, not merely in “theory” (which for Ouspensky is not “real” anyway) but in praxis, between East & West. Nevertheless, I still consider that this division must, in some way, not be exhaustive, although it is telling.

Graham on 2013-06-25 at 23:47 said:

Guenon's interjections were mostly amusing. 'Don't judge him with your Western categories!' On the other hand, to tell the truth, I find it somewhat sinister when he says “the Orient brings us a truth which can agree with the truths of the highest western traditions”, simply because he has no intention of placing the two on an equal footing.

Cologero on 2013-07-01 at 23:26 said:

In 1931, Citroen sponsored a year long expedition (the “Yellow Expedition”) through China and Mongolia desert; Teilhard de Chardin was in that part as the official geologist. The excerpts of the report that I've seen mention the political turmoil in China, but no organized movement against the European race. There was much interaction with the Buddhist lamas, but no mention of anything like Agarththa.

Presbyter Iohannes on 2021-05-18 at 16:45 said:

“The virtue of the Buddha is something entirely interior.”

Quite interesting remarks by Guénon here. I thought he at that time still thought Buddhism was but a hinduist heresy. In fact, it was only in 1939, already living in Cairo, that Guénon had his mind changed on the subject by Pallis and Coomaraswamy (“A Fateful Meeting of Minds” on the book “The Essential Ananda Coomaraswamy” by Marco Pallis).

Very interesting indeed.

12.6 From Egypt to Eire

... there is a short but intriguing list of facts that link the ascetics of Egypt and the western fringe of Europe. For example, an early Irish litany makes an enigmatic reference to the “seven monks of Egypt”...

An Irish-born monastic, writing in the late seventh century, show a remarkable knowledge of the Middle East, including the Nile and Alexandria. ... The abbot presents all this knowledge as information gleaned from a wandering pilgrim who washed up on the shores of the Scottish island of Iona ...

And in September [2010] the National Museum of Ireland added to the list of clues with an exciting announcement: traces of Egyptian papyrus had been detected in the binding of a 1,200 year old psalter ... they lend weight to the idea that Celtic scribes labouring in their rain-swept refuges were not so much saving Roman civilisation as participating in a spiritual movement inspired by the desert hermits of Egypt; a movement that was conceived, in part, as a revolt against civilisation [i.e., the “modern” world of the era]. Or at any rate, against what some saw as the jaded decadence of urban life in the twilight of empire.

from *The Economist*, December 18th-31st, 2010 page 150

I want to take this opportunity to address some recent comments. Gornahoor has made it very clear and very often that we are interested in principles rather than contingent historical events. Also, we choose topics first of all to elucidate the Roman Tradition and secondly to protect the honour of our ancestors by demonstrating their understanding of Traditional principles from Ancient time through the Middle Ages and beyond. We are not trying to save “Christianity” per se, which, in any case, does not need any defence from us. First of all, in our day it is an utterly meaningless word. Similarly, “pagan” likewise a meaningless word; it was originally a pejorative used by Christians against the practitioners of the old religions. Nowadays, it just means non-Christian.

Everything historical has to be understood in the light of the degeneration of castes, described by both **Rene Guenon** and **Julius Evola**. So what we experience of Christianity today is that of the lower castes. Thus

one is “saved” by “faith alone”, that is, by doing nothing. “Salvation” is a legal, or nominal, judgment, requiring no real change in the person. How is that even remotely related to the Christianity of the Alexandrians, from St Anthony to St Clement, who divided men into the spiritual and the merely psychic? The Alexandrians describe a real change in the being of the Christian.

We have also pointed out that the aristocratic class had their own orders that emphasized warrior virtues such as loyalty, strength, bravery. Once again, that has been lost. And today’s neopagans have done nothing to revive them. What about the metaphysics deriving from Hermes or the philosophy of the Middle Ages which rival in their depth anything from the Orient? What Sunday preacher brings that up? For that matter, what neo-pagan has built on that base.



Gornahoor regards them as wings of one Tradition, not opposites, but someone needs to take ownership of the very real accomplished of our ancestors. No, they were not duped by “Jews” for 1500 years to adopt an alien religion; nothing could be more absurd. In a very real sense the monks from Egypt to Eire were protecting a Tradition had become corrupt and petty.

I won’t dwell on the latter point, but will instead direct anyone interested to the December 2010 issue of *Culture Wars*⁷. I will simply quote a few relevant passages from *The Ciompi Rebellion on 1378*, which documents the debasement of currency of the pagan world (see Guenon’s **Reign of Quantity**) and the quest for “gold”.

Everything which had seemed great and beautiful and honorable for the fathers, was weathered by this corrosive air, and nothing remained but unbounded self-seeking and a craving for pleasure, along with all of the affected sophistry by which people sought to make the empty shell palatable as the fare of life.

⁷<http://www.culturewars.com/>

Even as far back as Plato, this corrupt influence was present.

The pursuit of gold (chrematistics) became the all-powerful incentive for action for at least a part of society. This change in the public spirit, according to Plato, gives rise, even in an aristocratic society, to a class of people whose gods are money, which they honor secretly with crude passion. The money chest of the rich, filled with gold soon begins to exert its fascination on the whole community. A substantial competition for material possessions is unleashed which constantly increase the avarice; whereas on the other hand, the ideal goods (the *arete*) sink in the public esteem. For where one bows down before the riches of the rich one must naturally look with disdain on the virtue of the good.

Pace Evola, who describes a similar situation in *Pagan Imperialism*⁸, this was the situation in late Antiquity, and does not reflect the influence of "Jewish" values as Evola seems to have convinced himself. That was the milieu into which Christianity developed, whatever one may think of some alleged "primitive" Christianity. Besides upholding traditional values and hierarchical society, it sought to correct the self-destructive excesses of Antiquity with its prohibition of usury and its emphasis on a just society and living wage. Little of that religion remains in the modern world and one must even look carefully to recognize it in the past. If the pagans want to reclaim the Roman Tradition, they need to move things forward, not return to old myths. What is required should be clear to those who know.

Posted on 2010-12-21 by Cologero

* * *

⁸https://www.amazon.com/Pagan-Imperialism-Julius-Evola/dp/0999086006/ref=sr_1_1?crid=1GUANM6WT05WZ&keywords=pagan+imperialism&qid=1576940759&s=books&sprefix=pagan+im%2Caps%2C157&sr=1-1

Matt on 2010-12-21 at 22:06 said:

Oh Cologero, don't you know the neo-pagans constantly move things forward with their solstice parties!

But to be serious for a moment, would you be receptive to the idea of starting out with the writings of Orthodox thinkers for building a western metaphysic as an alternative to Thomism?

kadambari on 2010-12-21 at 23:45 said:

Yes this is something I have mentioned—the Christians noticed that there is suffering and people suffered and there is an appeal to “conscience”. You do not see this in the Greco-Roman world, I find lacking the “compassion” you see in Buddhism or Hinduism, you see in Christianity, and this is not to be taken lightly but stems from a real confrontation with the extent of human suffering and misery, for Aristotle, the slave is not relevant and he does not think twice about him as profound as he is, the idea that perhaps there might be “humanity” in the slave as well and we have some duties and obligations to those that depend upon us in the sense of following us, is a deeply spiritual idea, and not to be tossed out and made fun of as encouraging egalitarianism and humanism, this instinct stems from a sense of the sacredness of life...

James O'Meara on 2010-12-22 at 09:24 said:

“How is that even remotely related to the Christianity of the Alexandrians, from St Anthony to St Clement, who divided men into the the spiritual and the merely psychic? The Alexandrians describe a real change in the being of the Christian.”

Not wanting to “hijack the thread” or ride a hobby horse, but what do you think of the Freke/Gandy theory [The Jesus Mysteries, before their books became completely new-agey] that the Jews tried to create a Hellenistic-style mystery religion of their own, using their own traditions to create new mystery texts [‘historical fiction’ being a Jewish invented genre, Yeshua = Joshua, etc.]. The ‘scriptures’ we have are the first level texts, for non-initiates [not even psychics, perhaps], not the true doctrine. When the Romans crushed the rebellion, contact with the centers was lost, and the relative ‘outsiders’ [in Rome, not Jerusalem or Alexandria] carried on as if the literal story was “The Gospel” [Ireneaus and the heresy hunters].

It would certainly explain a lot; the reliance on scripture, not experience, interpreted with crude literalism at that; the little pockets of Gnosticism that pop up and are relentlessly crushed as ‘heresy;’ the weird way Christians claim to be a religion but consider all other religions fundamentally wrong [i.e., hylics vs. psychics and gnostics], etc. In fact, I frequently hear radio preachers [I love their lunacy] smugly ‘point out’ that Christianity [theirs] isn’t a ‘religion’ at all; those are man or indeed demon-made cults, including RC and GO, while they have ‘Christ himself.’ Just read the scriptures; ‘real change’? That’s ‘witchcraft’ or ‘magic.’ Etc.

Cologero on 2010-12-22 at 13:19 said:

Wow, James, there is way too much in your hijacking to address at once, particularly since we are continuing to lay the foundation to be able to address these issues in a metaphysical way. You are anticipating some future posts which may come slowly since they involve translations from Evola on "Esoteric Catholicism" and neo-paganism. His perspectives are well thought out and will certainly offer some surprises.

I'm not familiar with Freke/Gandy. But if their thesis is that myths are not history, then I don't understand why they are creating a new myth while claiming it to be actual history. I don't know how they know what they claim to know.

Of course, myths are not strictly history. Philo the neo-Platonic Jew knew that about the OT; the Alexandrian followers such as Clement and Origen understood that, also. The historical meaning of the Biblical text used to be considered just one interpretation, and the lowest, at that. They symbolic was more important. That seems to have been lost. In his reconstruction of esoteric Catholicism, Evola considers that the symbolic meaning of the texts needs to replace the literal historical meaning. That task was taken up by Tomberg, who basically ignores the historical meaning. Find out something about the enigmatic Kabbalist Friedrich Weinreb whom Tomberg mentions. Weinreb treats the entire OT symbolically, including the "Jews" themselves. If the very existence of Jews as a chosen race is only a symbol (isn't that necessary to be perfectly consistent?), what does that do to the Freke/Gandy theory? Meditate on that a bit and something quite interesting may come up.

As we mentioned, evangelicalism itself is a man-made religion with tenuous ties to historical Christianity; as such, it is a symptom of the degeneration of castes. "Those who believe" now are in position to promote themselves as the final arbiter of Revelation. Of course, we understand Revelation as gnosis, knowledge that transcends the human state. Therefore, the written word itself is not Revelation. Rather, its symbols, stories, myths, miracles and so on are the means intended to lead one to gnosis.

Here is a question for you to ponder. Why, at a certain point, did the Hermetic Tradition, to a large extent (some remained pagan, others Islam), move to within the ambit of Christianity? For example, Evola's Hermetic Tradition, after mentioning early pagan alchemists, ends up almost exclusively with Christian alchemists and symbolism. Was it a matter of convenience such as Guenon's conversion to Islam or was something else at play?

12.7 Essence of Archaism

In *The Essence of Archaism*⁹, Guillaume Faye describes the return of what he calls “archaic values”.

First of all, the Greek word *arche*, like the Latin *principium*, means what comes first, either temporarily (“beginning”) or ontologically (“principle”). Thus the Prologue to John’s Gospel in Greek is, “En arche en o logos”, and in Latin, “in principio erat verbum” (“In the Beginning was the Logos”). This we can understand to mean, “The foundation of order is the first principle.” This is the foundation of Christendom, the ancient pagan civilizations, the Bhagavad Gita according to B G Tilak¹⁰, and the Tao Te Ching as Matgioi informs us.

Mr. Faye makes a list of archaic values, which are listed here:

- distinctive sexual roles
- the transmission of ethnic and popular traditions
- spirituality and sacerdotal organization
- visible and supervisory social hierarchies
- the worship of ancestors
- initiatory rites and tests
- the reconstruction of organic communities that extend from the individual family unit to the overarching national community of the people
- the deindividualization of marriage to involve the community as much as the couple

⁹<http://guillaumefayearchive.wordpress.com/2007/07/11/the-essence-of-archaism>

¹⁰<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1619>

- the end of the confusion of eroticism and conjugality
- the prestige of the warrior caste
- social inequality, not implicit, which is unjust and frustrating, as in today's egalitarian utopias, but explicit and ideologically justifiable
- a proportioned balance of duties and rights
- a rigorous justice whose dictates are applied strictly to acts and not to individual men, which will encourage a sense of responsibility in the latter
- a definition of the people and of any constituted social body as a diachronic community of shared destiny, not as a synchronic mass of individual atoms

He attributes this list to **Raymond Ruyer**, whose books are all apparently out of print and difficult to find. It seems to be a good list, most of which can also be found scattered around Gornahoor. The difficulty is determining the source of those values.

Mr. Faye suggests they are biological values, which seem untenable (if the phrase is even coherent), since biological laws (not values) are immutable. It would be surprising to find beavers building dams out of poured concrete, or honey bees to suddenly build their societies around a King bee. But human societies that abrogate all those those archaic values do exist, so a biological explanation seems untenable.

So we are left with human values. Obviously, we need to know what a human being is, before we can suppose those archaic values to specifically human. Then the question arises about why humans would choose disvalue instead of value. That Gornahoor has suggested is due to the cosmic cycle, the degeneration of castes, and the incarnation of inferior beings.

So we are left with the true source: the values are transcendental, as the very term “archaic” implies. Those archaic values follow the principle of order; to choose otherwise is to be in rebellion against the Logos. That is the essence of revolution.

As for the return to such values, either deliberately or from their imposition by Islam, Rene Guenon¹¹ has already shown us the options:

- Degeneration
- Assimilation
- Transformation

As for the press baron complaining about the problems of capitalism, which he expects Islam to eliminate: Mr. Faye should have looked to the recent past of his country, particularly the works of **Charles Maurras**, like him, a pagan with an appreciation for the civilization of Christendom.

One of the key points of Action Française was Catholic social teaching. Since it has its foundations in natural law and Roman jurisprudence, it is universal, and not solely Catholic. It addresses issues such as just prices and wages, competition, the problem of usury. Neither socialist nor capitalist, it proposes a widespread private ownership of the means of production, with competition based on quality and reliability. Through the prohibition of usury, those with access to capital would not be able to simply buy up the market, and thereby, effectively eliminating competition.

That social teaching was not “imposed” on Europe, it was accepted as archaic value. The real question that Mr. Faye does not answer, since he never even asks it, is “who imposed the alternative?”

¹¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/index.php?s=prophecies+rene+guenon&submit=Search>

12.8 The Notion of an Elite

Due to the nature of blog posts, you may feel like someone watching a movie starting from the middle. Nevertheless, there is an architectonic plan as summarized:

- **Thesis:** Tradition is the normal state for human spiritual well-being.
- **Hypothesis:** The Western world is in crisis due to its forgetting of Tradition.
- **Antithesis:** The proper response, then, is to revolt against the modern world.
- **Synthesis:** Some few men will undertake the effort to restore Tradition.

Rene Guenon's *The Crisis of the Modern World* is the fundamental text that proves the hypothesis. Julius Evola's *Revolt Against the Modern World* is the text of the antithesis. By understanding the thesis, hypothesis and antithesis, work can begin on the synthesis.

What follows can only be an outline, since all of the topics have been developed in full in other posts. The quotes are from Guenon's book.

Since we are concerned primarily about the West, that is where the focus will be. Moreover, we agree with Evola that Guenon is the master of the 20th century. If you have any objections to Gornahoor, most likely they begin with an objection to Guenon. If you disagree with the thesis, there is nothing much here for you; there is no desire to convert anyone. You are part of the anti-Tradition, which most people today consider sane and normal.

The more insidious movements are the counter-tradition. They claim to be part of Tradition, or "influenced" by Tradition as it is usually put.

People gravitate to it since they are still under the sway of the modern world, while pretending to be in revolt. Or else, the “revolt” is strictly on the material plane. There is no “influence”; you have to decide to go “all in” or not at all.

The Western Tradition Both Guenon and Evola postulate a polar or Hyperborean origin of our Tradition. If you prefer, you can presume this to refer to a “spiritual north”. It began with a Primordial Solar Monotheism¹². From there, the next step was the religion that developed around the Vedas in India, then the paganisms in Europe, and finally the Catholicism of the Middle Ages. As St Augustine wrote, “there is but one Tradition, which is now called Catholicism.” As Guenon wrote:

It is moreover quite certain that it is in Catholicism alone that all that may still remain of the traditional spirit in the West has been preserved.

Hence, that is where we start to begin the synthesis. Guenon confirms that:

The least fantastic venture, in fact the only one that does not come up against immediate impossibilities, would therefore be an attempt to restore something comparable to what existed in the Middle Ages, with the differences demanded by modifications in the circumstances

The counter-tradition rejects that in favor of some imaginary past or future paganism. This is hardly necessary, since all that is valuable in paganism has been preserved, as we have repeatedly demonstrated. These are some highlights:

¹²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3205>

- The Church Fathers regarded Christianity as the esoteric aspect of Greek philosophy
- Evola, no friend of Christianity, conceded that the Middle Ages preserved essential pagan elements.
- Pope Benedict XVI made the point that once the Logos was admitted into the Gospel, the whole of Greek philosophy came along with it.

We can rightly extend that idea. Once Greek philosophy is becomes a part of Western Tradition, then we are justified to also pull in the Vedic Tradition. We have been justifying that point. Moreover, Guenon claims it is a necessary step:

If the Catholic Church could thus be brought into touch with representatives of the Eastern traditions, it would be a preliminary step.

We have taken that step, and several others, relying on the likes of Bede Griffiths and Guido De Giorgio. Anyone still interested in debating “paganism vs Christianity” is wasting your time and has nothing to say in regard to the proposed synthesis.

Types of Religion Any discussion of the religions of the West needs to take into account three degrees of its manifestation, which correspond to Evola’s three stages:

- Folk religion
- Exoteric religion
- Esoteric religion

The folk stage is tied up with superstition, the desire for material protection, unusual phenomena, and so on. The exoteric stage is roughly what is called “organized religion”. Beyond doctrine, there is a lot of focus on “churchy” news and so on. We are not concerned with that here, while not rejecting it. A fortiori, we don’t identify a Tradition solely with those in whom it is entrusted. What some bishop does or does not do or say is not relevant to the synthesis.

We don’t need to dwell on the esoteric aspect here, since it has been covered many times. So, if someone wants to reject the Western tradition and replace it with some “neo-paganism”, the obvious question, is which form? They deny the pagan folk religion with its belief in bodily gods and so on. They can try to convince a population to adopt some new exoteric form, but for what end? Ultimately, they need to deal with the esoteric aspect and, in that, no such replacement is possible. Perhaps a development or a deepening, but that can be accomplished more easily with the forms that currently exist.

The entire concept is pointless. As a personal example, there are two Indian colleagues with whom I have frequent conversations. When we discuss meditation, witnessing thoughts, staying watchful, and so on, there is mutual understanding, despite our different exoteric commitments.

Race and Tradition We can say a word about this, based on the interest in recent posts. First of all, the task is the return to Tradition. It is not to “save” some ill-defined “Western civilization”, nor especially is the goal to “save the white race”, assuming that is even necessary. Since Evola wrote more on this than did Guenon, we can fill in some details as he saw them.

Based on Bachofen’s studies, Evola accepted the early existence of gynocratic and matriarchal societies in remote history or pre-history. However, the Hyperborean peoples never went through that stage. He at-

tributed that to the masculine spirit of the Hyperboreans and their branches. However, even within the Hyperboreans, the feminine race has more in common with the gynocratic societies. The Hyperborean branches decline when they start adopting the feminine perspective. You can read his descriptions and decide if they match what you see.

One of the hallmarks is the lack of a sense of differentiation. For example, those who call for a united “white race” lack that sense. It simply is not a “possibility of manifestation” in Guenon’s phrase. Were it a real possibility, it would have happened by now. The desire for unity on the material plane is a feminine trait, suitable for women or those beings with a man’s body but a feminine spirit.

Men understand differentiation, since there are many kinds of people and ways of being in the world. There are various castes, for example, or “races of the spirit” as Evola calls them, and so on. There may be little in common between them, despite outward racial characteristics. For our purposes, especially, this brings up Guenon’s ideal of the “elite”, which is the greatest differentiation.

Intellectuality and the Elite Guenon is emphatic that Tradition can only be restored by an “intellectual elite”. By necessity, an intellectual understanding is possible only for a few. Guenon writes:

This is why a true understanding can come only from above and not from below; and this should be taken in a twofold sense: the work must begin from what is highest, that is, from principles, and descend gradually to the various orders of application, always keeping rigorously to the hierarchical dependence that exists between them; and it must also of necessity be the work of an elite in the truest and most complete meaning of this word: by this we mean exclusively an intellectual elite, and in reality, there can be no other.

Hence, the synthesis must begin with an understanding of principles, not from political concerns and most definitely not from biological concerns. Unfortunately, I cannot just tell you what such an elite would think. There are certainly texts and the best place to start is with your own Tradition. We have convincingly demonstrated that the Western tradition is still alive and viable.

As Guenon points out, such an elite is beyond all forms, so it doesn't help to look for another organization or formal order. Rather they will arise as needed. Meanwhile, there are certainly some things to do to prepare or to be able to recognize an elite. The first requirement is an intellectual conversion which represents the return to the center. For this, a sane and normal way of life, in its traditional understanding, is a prerequisite. Then, the practice of one's exoteric religion, for reasons that we've discussed many times.

If you choose to ignore opportunities in your life that come up, ask yourself where your life is headed. I watched a few episodes of a TV show called *Dig*, based on its premise. I once thought it may be worth reviewing, but that won't happen. However, there was one incident that raised this thought.

One of the characters is a boy who was being groomed to be the next High Priest of Jerusalem. One of his handlers, a prole woman and former junky, got it into her mind to rescue the boy from that, so she kidnapped him. It got me to wonder. On the one hand, he is on a high spiritual path (speaking figuratively, not that I am endorsing the specifics of the show). But what is she offering him against that, except a life of TV, video games, pop tarts, and so on?

One thing for certain is that the end of this world is a possibility of manifestation. Where will you be?

Posted on 2015-04-30 by Cologero

* * *

Name on 2015-05-01 at 03:51 said:

Another great post, Mr. Salvo.

Paragraphs which I like:

"They claim to be part of Tradition, or "influenced" by Tradition as it is usually put. People gravitate to it since they are still under the sway of the modern world, while pretending to be in revolt. Or else, the "revolt" is strictly on the material plane. There is no "influence"; you have to decide to go "all in" or not at all.

The folk stage is tied up with superstition, the desire for material protection, unusual phenomena, and so on. The exoteric stage is roughly what is called "organized religion".

A fortiori, we don't identify a Tradition solely with those in whom it is entrusted. What some bishop does or does not do or say is not relevant to the synthesis.

The desire for unity on the material plane is a feminine trait, suitable for women or those beings with a man's body but a feminine spirit.

For our purposes, especially, this brings up Guenon's ideal of the "elite", which is the greatest differentiation.

Hence, the synthesis must begin with an understanding of principles, not from political concerns and most definitely not from biological concerns.

The first requirement is an intellectual conversion which represents the return to the center."

IA on 2015-05-01 at 10:31 said:

I like a lot of what you say here but do have some problems with the term "intellectual." Maybe a definition is in order. Or, if you've written about this or Evola or Guenon have you could refer me to such definition?

The problem is very well examined in Paul Johnson's "The Intellectuals".

Wayne Ferguson on 2015-05-01 at 11:35 said:

Thesis: Tradition is the normal state for human spiritual well-being.

Hypothesis: The Western world is in crisis due to its forgetting of Tradition.

Antithesis: The proper response, then, is to revolt against the modern world

Synthesis: Some few men will undertake the effort to restore Tradition

That seems a rather odd use of the word "antithesis". It seems more like a minor premise or – if we construe the hypothesis to be a premise – the conclusion to an argument in standard syllogistic form:

Major Premise: Tradition is the normal state for human spiritual well-being.

Minor Premise: The Western world is in crisis due to its forgetting of Tradition.

Conclusion: The proper response, then, is to revolt against the modern world

Corollary: Some few men will undertake the effort to restore Tradition

Wayne Ferguson on 2015-05-01 at 11:41 said:

"Both Guenon and Evola postulate a polar or Hyperborean origin of our Tradition. If you prefer, you can presume this to refer to a "spiritual north". It began with a Primordial Solar Monotheism. From there, the next step was the religion that developed around the Vedas in India, then the paganisms in Europe, and finally the Catholicism of the Middle Ages. As St Augustine wrote, "there is but one Tradition, which is now called Catholicism." Why no mention of Guenon's tradition of choice? And what of Judaism as a tradition in its own right?

Cologero on 2015-05-01 at 12:43 said:

Mr Ferguson, you must have gotten out of the wrong side of the bed this morning; that's the only explanation I can think of.

Perhaps I've taken some artistic liberties, but your objection is off the mark.

The hypothesis is the statement that needs to be proved. The proof, I contend, is in Guenon's Crisis of the West.

Re antithesis, this is from wikipedia:

According to Aristotle, the use of an antithesis makes the audience better understand the point one is trying to make through their argument. Further explained, the comparison of two situations or ideas makes choosing the correct one simpler. Aristotle states that antithesis in rhetoric is similar to syllogism due to the presentation of two conclusions within a statement.

You are not the best audience, but the intended point is to emphasize the point. If the modern world is truly in crisis, then revolt is the proper response as claimed.

Synthesis is the act of building up.

As for your other "point", if I write this sentence:

Since we are concerned primarily about the West, that is where the focus will be.

you can take that as my actual intention. Islam and Judaism are not products of the West, that is why there is no mention.

As for why Guenon ended up in Islam, that is certainly a topic we've addressed. If it is truly a burning issue for you, you can do the homework to look it up.

Cologero on 2015-05-01 at 12:47 said:

Mr IA, if I write a sentence like this:

Guenon is emphatic that Tradition can only be restored by an “intellectual elite”.

that means that I am quoting Guenon. Since I even wrote this:

The quotes are from Guenon’s book.

obviously referring to the Crisis.

Did you bother to consult that work? Do you know what “intellectual” means in meta-physics? Did you ever consider that Johnson’s use of the word is incorrect?

Wayne Ferguson on 2015-05-01 at 13:41 said:

My apologies—I did not mean to sound so grumpy. Your explanation is sufficient, but the references to the Vedas and India left me wondering how the other traditions would fit in. My exposure to the thesis/antithesis/synthesis triad has, in the past, been that commonly attributed to Hegel...

Alistair Fraser on 2015-05-01 at 17:21 said:

This is a quite fabulous clarification , in my perception

Mark Citadel on 2015-05-01 at 18:27 said:

I’m going to have to link to this upcoming. It’s lucky Guenon’s works are easily accessible, and I mean that in both senses of the word. The man comes off as very elegant and open to the layman as opposed to Evola who can often appear as an enigma.

I am in the preliminary stages of writing a book at this time, a sort of overview of the Reactionary ideal. Would it be okay to quote small sections of your work, attributed of course? I think you elucidate the non-conflict between Traditional Christianity and what Guenon espouses so well.

IA on 2015-05-01 at 20:35 said:

“I’m going to have to link to this upcoming.”

I wouldn’t if I were you. Too much the prima donna. They don’t age well.

White Rabbit on 2015-05-01 at 23:43 said:

“But what is she offering him against that, except a life of TV, video games, pop tarts, and so on?”

That’s why young men are “dropping out” and finding their passion in playing video games all day. Tendies and pop tarts

David on 2015-05-02 at 13:01 said:

Greetings. I saw the term « Christianity » and « Catholicism » used (sometimes) interchangeably on Gornahoor. Sometimes specific topics of Roman Catholicism (RCC) and Eastern Orthodoxy were addressed. But here the focus seems to be directed specifically towards the RCC : is it because you deem the Orthodoxy as a product of the East ? Is it because I am misunderstood and you therefore use the word Catholic as the "One and Holy Catholic and Apostolic Church" therefore considering the Orthodoxy ? Because on many topics the Orthodoxy is more akin to the Tradition that is possess, and since the Metropolitan and other Patriarch do not have (and didn't had as far as I know) the same power as the Pope, they do not possess the same Guelph pretension that the RCC has. Also let's include the fact that some of the Eastern European countries such as Greece, Romania, etc. are all Orthodox; and that Orthodoxy is claiming people from RCC and Protestantism (slowly of course) in European countries and America. Therefore I am asking you what to make of Eastern Orthodoxy, or if it is already within your definition of Catholic. Thank you.

Cologero on 2015-05-03 at 09:30 said:

David, I don't see how the focus is directed exclusively toward the RCC, but rather the focus is on Tradition. As I've made clear, our true focus is on the *Church of John*¹³, which is beyond form, yet not opposed to the exoteric church.

Apparently you are unaware that there is no more schism. The mutual ex-communications were lifted 20 years ago in 1995, even if there is not yet actually full "communion". With all the emphasis we've placed on the Philokalia, Cavarinos, Berdyaev, Solovyov, and Mouravieff, your objection makes no sense.

We are not interested in promoting or defending specific institutions ... we simply assume that one should participate in an exoteric tradition.

Guenon, and even Evola, use the Western Middle Ages as an example of Tradition, so that is as "akin" to Tradition as you could want. Certainly the West is more pagan than the East, because of the Frankish elements which tend more to legalism and objectivism. Nevertheless, the Germanics adopted the Roman religion.

The East never passed through a "Middle Age" ... it went from the Roman Empire to being overrun by Islam. So the differences are contingent, the result of historical events, but not essential, even if some prefer to battle indefinitely over the unessential.

The Eastern churches are far from an ideal model. They have their own problems with modernity ... for example, they boast about Tom Hanks despite his public scandal. There are many like him. In personal dealings with laypeople, I haven't seen any great love for or understanding of Tradition. In fact, they often confuse the specifically ethnic elements with transcendent truths.

¹³<http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-church-of-john>

So, if you think that switching allegiances, or the occasional poaching between Churches, is meaningful, we disagree. The fundamental issue still remains.

Jacob on 2015-05-03 at 16:48 said:

I really like this post and can't figure out why anyone who understands the previous material would have any problems with it. The task has been laid out, but because it's been found difficult many don't want to even try it. It's a lot easier to clamor for regime change.

IA on 2015-05-03 at 17:24 said:

Jacob,

If you are referring to me I will try to answer but as I mentioned this problem is dealt with by the devout, traditional Catholic artist and writer Paul Johnson.

Basically, the entire modernist world was created by intellectuals. Starting with Rousseau.

Roger Scruton also writes about intelligent but socially maladroit individuals who harbor resentments against powerful men.

I think both authors are concerned about the motivations of "intellectuals."

David on 2015-05-03 at 19:38 said:

Cologero. I didn't know of the uplifting of 1995. In what kind of document was it made ? Thank you.

As far as the rest of the information, it goes without saying that what you say is logical. Yet my (visibly poorly formulated question) was more linked with your third paragraph "We are not interested etc..." ; so that answers my question : you use the "real" term of Catholic as the One church, and not as the RCC. Sorry for any misreading. Thank you.

Cologero on 2015-05-03 at 20:13 said:

David, here is the document:

*COMMON DECLARATION SIGNED IN THE VATICAN BY POPE JOHN PAUL II AND PATRIARCH BARTHOLOMEW*¹⁴

Matt on 2015-05-04 at 02:11 said:

IA,

When Guenon – and Evola too – speaks of an intellectual elite, he doesn't have in mind what Johnson and Scruton write about. The intellectual elite is not composed of the common types from academia, or intelligent individuals that have chained themselves to their resentments; rather, it is composed of persons who directly and completely grasp the essences of

¹⁴<http://www.ewtn.com/library/PAPALDOC/BARTHDEC.HTM>

things, which are synonymous with the divine ideas, archetypes, or to use Guenon's terminology, the possibilities of manifestation. Furthermore, they have the will to help carry out the actualization of the possibilities and to close the gap/privation that can arise between the concrete particular and its respected archetype. On that second point, Evola goes into further writing about it than Guenon did.

IA on 2015-05-04 at 09:47 said:

Matt,

Thank you for taking the time to offer a polite response.

I don't have a problem with anyone who has a grasp of transcendent archetypes. In fact, I rather like the idea if these persons are poets and artists or devout and humble monks and saints who can help others achieve the same experience.

What I do have trouble with is the idea of being coerced by an elite who actually want to block me from my own development. They do this not out of a love of knowledge but by love of a system of knowledge, two very different things.

Cologero on 2015-05-05 at 08:18 said:

By law, Mr Citadel, you have the right to fair use for your own work. My concern is to be lumped in as part of some amorphous movement of "neo-reaction", "new right", etc.

Mark Citadel on 2015-05-05 at 14:01 said:

I am neither part of the ENR nor do I label myself a NeoReactionary (I abandoned the label over concerns about certain elements which seemed to want to cherry-pick from Tradition as and when it suited the movement a la Mussolini's mistake).

I describe myself plainly as a Reactionary, working off a synthesis of various right wing thinkers, including De Maistre, Evola, Sarda, and others. I would not associate you intentionally with any specific group. My admiration for Gornahoor is in the intellectual rigor with which these theories are analyzed. You're a valuable source of information.

Br. Giles Mary on 2015-05-06 at 14:17 said:

This is a fascinating post, Cologero.

Thesis: Tradition is the normal state for human spiritual well-being.

>Granted: We don't live in "normal times".

Hypothesis: The Western world is in crisis due to its forgetting of Tradition.

>Yes... Of course Guenon would say that it is one aspect of the manifestation of universal possibility.

Antithesis: The proper response, then, is to revolt against the modern world.

>Right now, I think I'd say, we should revolt against the anti-/counter-tradition.

I agreed with the basic premise of Evola's *Ride the Tiger*, that the new disorders offer new possibilities. That means some kind of dialogue with the modern world and not a wholesale revolt. I don't think an elite would exist for itself, it should serve the brethren, who are by and large modern folk. Do you agree?

Synthesis: Some few men will undertake the effort to restore Tradition.

>This is interesting. The way I see it, the metaphysical principles are the most important instrument for countering the counter-tradition. We should act like men, not sitting by passively while error reigns. And a material unity is effeminate, like you said. And few are capable of thoroughgoing metaphysical knowledge. I think Guenon would say that a man with metaphysical aptitude need not resemble anything like what we'd call an intellectual. But, I think we should be concerned about what the bishops are doing. Many of them do a lot of good. Many do good in spite of themselves. And unfortunately, it seems, many have made nice with the modern world, falling for the hermeneutic of discontinuity, as Benedict XVI would say. I leave this quote from the *Summa Theologiae*. You might substitute, "member of the faithful" for "religious" if my point has any substance.

"I answer that, As Augustine says (Gen. ad lit. xii, 16), "the agent is ever more excellent than the patient." Now in the genus of perfection according to Dionysius (Eccl. Hier. v, vi), bishops are in the position of "perfecters," whereas religious are in the position of being "perfected"; the former of which pertains to action, and the latter to passion. Whence it is evident that the state of perfection is more excellent in bishops than in religious."

And from *Lumen Gentium* #27: "In virtue of this power, bishops have the sacred right and the duty before the Lord to make laws for their subjects, to pass judgment on them and to moderate everything pertaining to the ordering of worship and the apostolate."

Certainly, Faith, Hope, and Love trump any status we might have within the Church... But, bishops have power to curb or assist anyone in their worship of God and service to the brethren...

Wayne Ferguson on 2017-06-27 at 18:57 said:

"Pope Benedict XVI made the point that once the Logos was admitted into the Gospel, the whole of Greek philosophy came along with it." Might this be the source you have in mind?

"Every person as a rational being shares in the Logos, carrying within himself a "seed", and can perceive glimmers of the truth. Thus, the same Logos who revealed himself as a prophetic figure to the Hebrews of the ancient Law also manifested himself partially, in "seeds of truth", in Greek philosophy.

"Now, Justin concludes, since Christianity is the historical and personal manifestation of the Logos in his totality, it follows that "whatever things were rightly said among all men are the property of us Christians" (Second Apology of St Justin Martyr, 13: 4).

"In this way, although Justin disputed Greek philosophy and its contradictions, he decisively oriented any philosophical truth to the Logos, giving reasons for the unusual "claim" to truth

and universality of the Christian religion. If the Old Testament leaned towards Christ, just as the symbol is a guide to the reality represented, then Greek philosophy also aspired to Christ and the Gospel, just as the part strives to be united with the whole.

“And he said that these two realities, the Old Testament and Greek philosophy, are like two paths that lead to Christ, to the Logos. This is why Greek philosophy cannot be opposed to Gospel truth, and Christians can draw from it confidently as from a good of their own.”

http://w2.vatican.va/content/benedict-xvi/en/audiences/2007/documents/hf_ben-xvi_aud_20070321.html

The Hidden Meaning of History

13.1 Ideas and Hidden History

One of the problems philosophers have long debated concerns the ontological status of the Platonic world of ideas. Aristotle proposed a solution that is fruitful as far as it goes, although it does not go far enough. His solution was that the idea is immanent in the object, a doctrine called hylomorphism. That is, the object is not material (hyle) only, but is also informed by the idea (morphe). Hence, when we see a material object, we know it by grasping its form.

Metaphysical insights from **Benedict Spinoza** and **Vladimir Solovyov** may show a way to rethink the problem. For Spinoza, ultimate reality is Substance, beyond space and time. Although infinite and beyond direct experience, Substance is known by two of its modes: **Extension** and **Thought**. These modes are appearances. Ultimately, the **Logos** is the source of ideas.

Extension Extension refers to things in Space and Time. Hylomorphism, therefore, accounts for our knowledge of ideas in Space and Time. So, when I look at a banana tree, I experience its material aspects through the senses, while judging it to be a banana tree through the Intellect. Discussions of this sort usually stop at the spatial aspect. However, a deeper seeing will unveil the temporal aspects. I then understand the banana tree to be a living being, unfolding in time. I can see the processes of germination, growth, and fruition. A real seer, or rishi, will see even deeper into the interiority of the plant, its nutritive soul.

Thought Since thought is temporal, but not spatial, we can grasp ideas in the mind apart from any objects in space. The ideas form higher and higher interconnected systems. Hence, grasping an idea in isolation falls short of understanding its full reality. We need to see the idea in its relationship to other ideas horizontally and also vertically in its relationship to higher and more general ideas. These ideas do not exist on their own only in some ethereal realm. An idea becomes manifested in a person.

Logos The Logos is beyond space and time, i.e., it is part of formless manifestation. Relating this back to **Rene Guenon**, we would say the possibilities [ideas] of manifestation become manifest in the modes of Extension or Thought. The possibilities of non-manifestation, or non-being, are ideas in the mind of God, since the Logos is the Thought of the Father.

Hidden History So now we have a clue to the hidden aspects of history. In the material world of Extension, we need to see beyond Space into Time. This brings us into Thought. From the ideas arising from sense experience, we need to dig deeper and understand it in both in its broader and more general aspects. In this way, we move beyond outward appearances to understand seemingly contingent and unrelated events

as manifestations of a larger system. Ultimately, it must relate back to the Logos itself.

Solovyov insists that Ideas are forces, so Action follows Thought. Hence, by understanding Thought, we will understand the world. Nothing happens by accident, but rather as the result of a deliberate act. The primary causal agent is always an idea become person, with a will that pursues determinate ends.

Traditional teachings considers the agent to be the work of angels or devas, since so-called natural forces have personalities. As an aside, we should point out that **Valentin Tomberg** asserts the same thing. If nothing else, this leads credence to Solovyov's claim that Hermetic philosophy is the foundation of Christian theology.

Posted on 2011-11-23 by Cologero

* * *

charlotte on 2011-11-24 at 07:37 said:

I like Origen's theory of universal salvation, which instinctively seems true to me and ties in with Buddhist and Islamic ideas as well. But I heard Origen became a self-imposed Eunuch because the sexual demons were too great for him to muster. I wonder how much of a problem this is for other people with spiritual callings....

charlotte on 2011-11-24 at 07:38 said:

master not muster, Freudian slip

Perennial on 2011-12-02 at 02:35 said:

Good question, Charlotte. I note St. Anthony of Egypt and St Augustine as being among those who had a long struggle with sexual demons. It seems to crop up in the lives of certain types of saints.

13.2 Review of the Meaning of History

This review by Julius Evola of Nikolai Berdyaev's book *The Meaning of History*, in its German translation, originally appeared in

Bilychnis, volume XXXII, August-September, 1928.

This book and review was published some 75 years ago, when the events they describe, like the frenetic self-assertion of the ego and the negation of man into some biological being without discernible qualities, were visible to few. Although the two men disagreed on some finer points, they did not disagree on what was happening then in its germinal stage. A couple of generations later, what they saw coming is now in full force. Whether that mystical third stage will arrive over the ruins of the modern world remains to be seen.

History for Berdyaev is an originary spiritual phenomenon identical to the very depths of Being: it is an absolute category, an *a priori* in respect to it; everything that is outer determinism material forces, phenomenon, or form are only subordinate parts that are included in itself. Man is essentially history, and only from history—not from psychology, sociology, or physiology—can he be understood in the concrete fullness of his spiritual nature. He has in himself the entire history, as in a microcosm, yet not outside but in the deep strata of his interiority lies the same abyss of the times.

This essential identity of man and history give Berdyaev the way to resolve, actually to not even pose, the vexed question of the “possibility of history as a science”, or, if one prefers this expression, of the “relativity and phenomenality of the historical consciousness”: history for him rises spontaneously as objective knowledge on the basis of a spiritual recollection, almost like a Platonic anamnesis.

Truly a miraculous anamnesis, because it permits us, following Berdyaev, a sudden theologization of history; what would be human history and divine history at the same time, in the sense that it would express the metaphysical in the physical. God would reveal himself in history, or rather He would be Himself history, since He considers history in an eternal and continuous way, and not in the fragmentary form of man’s experi-

ence of time in three dimensions (past, present, future). The historical eras are eons of the life of eternity, fluent just to gather in the womb of eternal life, where time is in the form of a transcendent: this is not a new image and that would be difficult to become something more than an image.

In any event, according to Berdyaev the theophany is not closed up in a divine solipsism but has two poles: it is the tragedy of interior free relationships between man and God: a birth of God in man and of man in God, a self-revelation of God to man and of man to God in accordance with a mystery and a dynamism of spontaneity that exactly constitutes the meaning of history.

Berdyaev, descending a little more to earth with a clear and elegant treatment, then tries to find again in the development of historical epochs the meaning of that theandrophany. Thus the famous doctrine of the three epochs reappears. The first of which would be established by mythology, understood as effective experience, i.e., as an animistic state in which man found himself in relation to a living connection with gods, demons, elementary forces of nature.

A second decisive stage follows, always, according to Berdyaev, from Christianity in which man surpasses this promiscuity, unchains himself from nature and then he opposes it, combats it, tends to dominate it—and so fulfills himself as a free personality while, on the other hand, nature closes itself in on itself, and becomes a material and impenetrable reality. This epoch includes humanism, understood as an orgy of freedom, as an uncontrollable self-manifestation and self-assertion of the “I” in all fields—a tendency that however would end up with overturning (that would happen in a special way in our days) through the law that every self-assertion of the individual, when the individual puts himself as the end in itself and does not recognize a higher order, he transforms himself fatally into negation. The coming of the machine and socialism would be two consequences and two manifestations of this law; products

of the individualist expectation, they lead to an inorganic and exterior relationship, to a depersonalization of man, to an absolute dependence from brute and automatic forces, and to purely economic collective interests.

In this state of crises it may lead to a third era, in which man, in order to feel himself free and individual, will overcome isolation and egoism, and will return to an organic, living, religious connection with the totality, realizing the mystical meaning of history as the reciprocal self-revelation and self-generation of man to God. We said: "it may lead", insofar as, letting history finally breathe a little, freeing it from that veiled form of historical determinism that is every "philosophy of history" in its concern to deduce historical facts from a higher law in order to understand them and a free and irreducible nature; he admits, in this solution (that would constitute the Christian, as opposed to the humanistic, Renaissance), the possibility of "evil", i.e., it would instead bring the world to the depths of individualism and the machine.

The book can be read with interest, the style is rather clear and meaty. Like every philosophy of history, it is necessary to take it more as a work or art, or as a pretext to justify the choice of values of certain objectives for the epochs to come, rather than as a science and a knowing; something that, in our opinion, needs a rather more cynical, and rather less mystical, eye.

Posted on 2013-04-03 by Aeneas

* * *

Mihai on 2013-04-04 at 04:20 said:

Berdyayev's book is excellent. The chapters on the analysis of the decline of the modern world are interesting, but more valuable are the opening chapters on the hermeneutics of history, since they can be applied inwardly, to a genuine knowledge.

The only lacking part is where he brings the typical Russian "tragedism" into the Supreme Non-Being of God. Admittedly, he does describe it as a mythological template, but it makes me feel somewhat uncomfortable. Guess it's because I'm more philosophical than poetical...

13.3 On the Hidden History of Rome

This article by **Julius Evola** was published in February 1939 issue of *La Vita Italiana*. **Duke Colonna di Cesaro** was both an Anthroposophist and an adherent of “Roman Neopaganism”. Evola had had a long relationship with the Duke, dating back to their participation in the Ur and Krur groups. While they both sought to understand the “third dimension” of history, their approaches ultimately differed. The Duke distanced himself from Evola’s *Pagan Imperialism* in the book, *The Mystery of the Origins of Rome*.

At one point, the Duke proposed to Mussolini to make Anthroposophy the spiritual alternative for Italy. The early attempt fell on deaf ears, but during the time of the Salò republic, Mussolini was given Steiner’s book “The essential points of the social question with respect to the needs of life in the present and in the future.” His response allegedly was, “[this book was the] answer I have been looking for all my life”.

On various occasions, in this very journal, we insisted on the necessity of a radical revision of the methods and criteria by which history is made, in the order of common teaching and of that culture that claims to be, and it alone, “serious”. We showed that history, packaged in such environments, understands only the two dimensions of the surface and leaves itself completely devoid of the third dimension, that of depth, where the essential meanings and the truly determining causes of so many events are concealed. Finally, we indicated the inherent absurdity, today, in insisting so much on the Roman tradition, on its symbols, on its vision of life and, at the same time, in continuing to consider the world of Roman antiquity with the usual views that lack erudition, archaeology, philology, or criticism.

As things stand, we were brought to consider with interest, and almost with avidity, the most recent, powerful work of Duke Colonna di

Cesaro¹ since from the first pages a different spiritual and let us even say initiatic scheme is announced for the study of the origins of Rome and the meaning that the rise of this fateful city had in the history of the world. Nevertheless, after the first moment of immediate interest, at the point of deepening the central thesis of the book, we were struck by a perplexity, derived from the thinking of a peculiar juncture of motives, about which it will not be useless here to say something, at the end of a clarification of the methods and otherwise of the dangers peculiar to an investigation in the depths of history, since it is that, as we have already said, we ourselves hope for.

The work of Cesaro constitutes a valid and living contribution along the line on which the most valuable representatives of the new Italian culture should be fought, in all of its introductory part, in which the truly adequate criteria of every exploration of the origins are made precise. Cesaro justly blamed the error lay in consisting to examine ancient history through the eyes of modern man instead of seeking to adapt to the same ways of feeling and seeing characteristic of the subjects of that history. Therefore, it also consisted in considering as valid and positive only those documents that were encountered in the rationalistic, positivist, and contemporary secular spirit and in judging as irrelevant, fantastic, and inconsistent everything that, in ancient traditions, is symbol, myth, legend, or allegory. Even here the center of traditional consciousness fell to the knowledge proper to the great, the wise men, and ancient priests, i.e., “to those who, in modern terms, could be called the directing classes of remote antiquity”. On such a path, Cesaro, coming to so much through a broad and acute critical examination, defines the possibility and the necessity of integrating the order of the usual historical researches with a research following new interpretative methods with a spiritualist, initiatic, and metaphysical character. The process examin-

¹Giovanni Antonio Colonna di Cesaro, *Il Mistero delle origini di Roma* (The mystery of the origins of Rome), 1939

ing the origins, myths, symbols, and legends produced not impracticable, fantastic processes, but rather of fantastic processes brought about by something spiritually real and positive.

Whether purely under dramatized form, they actually and truly represent the history of the beginnings of a nation, but the history not of events brought about materially on the earth, but rather of spiritual processes that have brought to birth, amidst other peoples, a new and different people through culture and civilization: history, so to speak, of its prenatal period, of its "mystery".

The more or less obscure intuitive perception, translated into images provided by a particular attractive force of such a mystery, is the true essence of the legends of the origins. Therefore, Cesaro continues:

Legend and history are strictly connected; the former proceeds through interiorization and is deployed by means of images, and the latter proceeds by exteriorization, in facts and events. Images are the result of living formative forces; facts are organised by human thought. In the former, one is carried away by formative forces; in the latter, there is a thought-out coordination of facts. But the legend is the invisible part of history, it is the root of history; it is not poetry, but rather, it is a reality more vast than history itself. The threads of the destiny of a people that are united invisibly in the most various ways in their historical development, rise to the impulses, to the creative spheres, to which the heroes of its legends were tied.

Therefore, the latent consciousness or memory of the same mission is conserved in legends, and is handed down to those who, in later times, are capable of recognizing that which a people and a civilization had on its own on a spiritual, super-historical plane. Where they cease to have value as positive documents of the material history of the origins, they assume that of the documents, no less positive, of their spiritual history.

As we noted, we consider it salutary that these criteriological views of a traditional and anti-modern type were reaffirmed decisively by Cesaro and, to tell the truth, not in terms of simple statements, but on the basis of a serious close examination of criteria adopted by various contemporary historical-mythological schools and of a persuasive assessment of their one-sidedness and insufficiency. Yet, at the same time, it is regrettable that Cesaro, at the moment of the application of the principles and therefore of exploring the secret of ancient civilizations and of Rome itself, ends up in positions of questionable consistency, thereby giving ammunition to his adversaries and critics who seek at every occasion to demonstrate the arbitrariness of the constructions of whoever departs from their presumptive serious, positive criteria.

To indicate what it is about, we will say that when an argument like that which Cesaro clarifies in the introductory part of his book is confronted, it is not possible to stop at compromises, to formulate conciliations. There exist some modern exponents of the hoped-for methods of Cesaro — we could cite Dacque, Bachofen, Wirth, Baumlet, and in part, even Vico — but that does not prevent this method, in its essence, ought to be called *traditional*, which is of pertinence to an mentality irreducible to everything that is modern and informed by principles and the consciousness of a super-individual character, completely detached from everything that is the construction or interpretation of individuals. Now, whoever wants to pass coherently from the statement to the application, it is necessary that from views and teachings equally traditional he draws his guidelines, his points of orientation, and nourishes a fundamental suspicion towards everything that feels the affects of any modern influence whatsoever.

Such, unfortunately, is not the case with Cesaro. In the reconstruction of that hidden spiritual history of the origins and mission of Rome, the part played by the fascination of an Anthroposophical or Steinerian type is too evident.

We are not certain of the philistines capable of being alarming as soon as one speaks of occultism and theosophy and to seize in this regard, as do so many dilettantes, the watchwords of hebraism and masonry. In *La Vita Italiana* where systematically we are clarifying the ideas to serve as guidelines for the new fascist culture, in regards to the study of the “occult powers” and even also very recently in the writing of Arthos published in a preceding article [on the occult war], there was occasion to indicate what should be thought in regard to forms similar to “neospiritualism”. It is necessary to see in it a vague desire for the recovery of some traditional conceptions, however associated with the dross of every type and especially of those deformations which often entirely falsify the original meaning and that, in the field of the “occult war”, are destined to throw disrepute and ridicule also on those traditional views, partially and inadequately taken up, in themselves.

In such terms it is necessary to nourish a fundamental suspicion of all the modern forms of spiritualism and esoterism; which should be subjected to a severe discrimination that will confirm the legitimacy of the ideas being raised in it only in the measure in which these find exact, rigorous, and univocal confirmation with traditional conceptions, the patrimony, one in its essence, but various in the forms of expression of premodern wisdom. That said, we don’t mean that, in a field where a living knowledge must have a fundamental part, everything must be reduced to a type of scholastic exegesis and that every intuition would have to be banned. Instead, we mean that the aberrations of which the above mentioned schools and cults in modern times give us a great abundance of examples, impose, in this regard, a criterion analogous to that of the Catholic Church: which leaves to the mystics the freedom of personal excursions in the supersensible, however with the provision that the corresponding results are conformed to dogma and traditional teaching, without which, a verdict of “heresy” will be pronounced. Now, on the basis of an “orthodoxy” that, by being differently defined and of a more

subtle and impalpable order, is not less rigorous than the Catholic one, on the basis of a traditional “orthodoxy” in the higher sense, heresy can really be denounced, the heresy of the great part of the new swarming forms of occultism, theosophy, neo-mysticism, and modern Rosicrucianism.

This is certainly not the place to discuss Steiner and to make precise the importance of his doctrine—on that, we have already written in one of our works, *Maschera e volto dello spiritualismo contemporaneo*². Here, instead, only the highlights can be mentioned, which are those steinerian views that noticeably influence Cesaro’s interpretation of the origins and mission of Rome. They certainly belong to that which, in such an author, from the point of view indicated, must be considered heretical or heterodox, insusceptible, in any case, of being in conformity with traditional teachings; they are the fruit, instead, of an individual interpretation, therefore arbitrary like those of various modern philosophies of history. We will note only some of the main points.

Cesaro’s merit is his ability to recognize the importance, for the exploration of the origins, of the fundamental opposition of the myths, cults, and symbols of an olympian-uranian character, solar, virile, heroic and regal, to those that are telluric, chthonic, infernal, lunar, feminine, and priestly. But even here, Cesaro overlooks two important points.

- I. It eludes him that this opposition is not to be considered, in an absolute way, originary, but rather consequentially, inherent to the phases and determined cycles of civilization, during which eras a process of involution and dissociation already occurred. The primordial cycle of hyperborean civilization, progenitor of the principle forms of the Nordic-Aryan civilization, was superior to and anterior to similar oppositions. So, for example, for the point of view that is of more interest to us, there was even a synthesis between the regal and sacerdotal elements, between spirituality and

² *Mask and Face of Contemporary Spirituality*

virility. The ignorance of this point constitutes a serious preliminary question, for its allowing a margin to evolutionist ideas, like those that have a fundamental part in the steinerian ideology. Hesiod's teaching, which finds an exact confirmation in a series of other Aryan traditions, speaks clearly in this regard: the civilization of the heroes does not constitute an innovation nor, in any case, progress, but rather a restoration, a return, a taking up again of the primordial Olympic tradition entered in a phase of involution. Instead, it is really a progress that, in heroic forms, to which the same Roman civilization itself belongs, which Cesaro recognizes; therefore, since he starts from the above mentioned opposition, he erroneously considers it originary and investigates the points in which, in history, there had been a surpassing of it. The true value of Rome is instead a restoration, an attempt to take up again in a universal body an original spirituality of the hyperborean and solar type, an abortive attempt at the moment of the putrefaction and asiatization of the empire of the Caesars.

2. In every way, even in the reference to the stages in which the mentioned duality constituted the dominant motive, Cesar overlooked an important element, which is the relation of the visions and cults, of one type or another, to different racial factors, mixed or coming into conflict in the events of the origins. In place of trying to interpret the transformations of the various civilizations and the various religious ideas in this way, Cesaro conceives a type of general abstract development, of an evolutionary character, strictly adhering to steinerian schemes. The real problem is that the same methodological value and the same significance of the oppositions we indicated, in a similar way, turn out to be almost irreparably compromised. The predominance, and almost the arising, at a given moment, in ancient Mediterranean spirituality, of cults of a telluric, feminine-demonic, Dionysian character, opposed to the heroic

and Olympian forms, does not signify for Cesaro that which must be thought even from an almost positive point of view: a type of reconquest of the substratum of inferior pre-aryan and anti-aryan races and civilizations against higher forms, issuing from the primordial traditions that, initially, had subjected them (for example, in Greece with the descent of the Dorians and Achaeans). For Cesaro, that signifies instead an evolutionary phase in a general predetermined process, predetermined no less than for the coming of Christianity.

Now at this point, those issues must be raised, that spiritually—our friend Duke di Cesaro will permit us to be sincere—have a subversive character. We said that in such a placement the very meaning of the opposition between the Olympian and telluric elements remains distorted, since Olympian spirituality is not conceived as it should, that is, as the state of consciousness of a type of solar and regal super-humanity, conserving intact the light and the power of the origins; rather it is interpreted as the state of a dreaming spirituality, external to man, pre-personal, anterior to the sense of the Self, passive because it would have been conditioned by the tie and the heredity of blood, race, family, caste or tradition. A variety of modern interpretations of the evolutionist type on the same lines of Darwinism and Freudianism is therefore fully revealed, since even if, at the origins, the beast or the reign of the forms of the libido is not assumed, one always sees there something “less”, something that, through a development propitiated, by whom nobody knows, (according to Steiner, by disincarnate entities which would only be concerned with the events of men not yet evolved), must be surpassed to lead to true consciousness, to true humanity.

Consequently, the rising of the telluric cult does not have, for Cesaro, the sense of a contamination, rather that of an interiorization: it is the disappearance of the transcendent gods of the Olympian cycle, it is their becoming, as chthonic gods, something immanent to the earth,

dwelling at its center as a new interior consciousness of man, as the impulse toward the formation of a human and independent individual Self. It signifies neither more nor less than the sanctification and legitimation of the anti-tradition and the revolution in the spiritual world, that subversion, propitiated by contaminating crossbreeding and by the ferment of inferior races and cults, that already made the ancient Mediterranean world appear here as a world of ruins.

And that this assertion is not extreme results from the fact that Cesaro connects the meaning of evolving stages, also to everything that is critical and rationalist thought, individualism, the destruction of the ties of blood and soil, secular and only warrior civilization, rebellion against every earlier form of authority from above. Behind the symbols are the meanings of the type he seeks to recognize in the Trojan war: the fall of Troy expresses the end of an era, the era of traditional sacred wisdom, a descent from the memory of the ancient stages of a formless participation in transcendent divinity, and the "beginning of a new era, of science conquered by the will and individual reasoning", of the "Self freed from the chains of consanguinity that lay at the base of the psyche of the collective form of the ancients". But the germ of ancient wisdom was not destined to perish, but rather to be transmuted, to give rise to a new cycle, and which would be the meaning of the legend of **Aeneas**, a refugee from Troy who survived its destruction and was the bearer, at its foundation, of the heritage of that of which Troy was the symbol. Aeneas lands in Italy, and from him, according to the legend of its origins, begins a new cycle corresponding precisely to the Roman civilization and to the Roman mission of the history of the world.

Here, naturally, we cannot even mention the laborious exegesis made by Cesaro with the purpose of including all the symbolic and legendary material of the first Romanity, up until the closing of the cycle of the Kings, in a similar scheme. Moreover, it is worth mentioning that he avoids the same possibility of again finding the right way for a type of

indirect road, which is that of the improbable, evolutionary views. In fact, even admitting the mistaken premise, he would have been inclined to give consideration to the Roman cycle already as a synthesis, as a surpassing both of the presumed, impersonal and priestly primogenial wisdom, as well as the opposite purely individualistic, critical, and warrior principle, in something higher and solar, that naturally would not have meant a conquest and an evolution, but only a rebirth of the true force of the origins. That would have constituted, let us repeat, in an indirect way, a bases to really discover the deepest and secret meaning of so many solar, heroic, and heroic aspects in the institutions, cults, laws, even in certain simultaneously historical and symbolic deeds of Romanity. But not even that is verified: what there is in Rome that is truly, specifically Roman, Cesaro in fact considered it as a mere preparation, as something valid not in itself, but in so far as it paves the ways to the other, to the Christian gospel, considered by him as the “fulcrum of the evolution and of the history of humanity”. And if one adds that in Christianity itself above all, Cesaro seems to valorize these aspects, for which such a religion presented at the origins of the really revolutionary, anti-traditional, universalistic and subservient traces, one can well imagine where he is going to finish.

Let us let Cesaro speak:

Rome became the instrument through which ancient humanity, divided on vertical lines, according to ethnic groups and descendants of consanguinity, moves, fragmented by individualism, towards a horizontal solidarity, towards a brotherhood that must not take into account distinctions of race, people, and family. The ancient collective spiritual patrimony of men rises up through the will of individuals. Races, peoples, families, through individualism, make themselves humanity. The ancient racial and family conceptions of love, of innate and implicit love in natural communions, are transformed, through egoism, tempered by the forces of individualism in universal love.

In other words, Rome had a historical mission, insofar as it was made the instrument of ethnic chaos, a leveling universalism, and a cosmopolitanism deadly for the preceding, differentiated types of civilization: insofar as it was what Gobineau or Chamberlain had called "semitic Rome". And Cesaro sought to recognize even in roman origins such a blessing, interpreting the legend of the asylum given by Rome to every type of people at birth, and thus to those of a lower class, according to a spirit that would anticipate the Christian preference for the rejected, the disinherited, those without tradition.

Therefore, the valorization of Rome on Cesaro's part is really a valorization in reverse. In all these aspects of Rome, its cults, ethics, customs, symbols, laws, in which we, from the traditional point of view, recognize, in these enigmatic but also unmistakable forms, the resurrection of the remote Nordic-Aryan spiritual heritage, Cesaro sees, or should see, "traditional residues", the debris of a past destined to die, which Christianity had to give the *coup de grace*, prior to a preliminary ethnic chaos. With Christianity, for him, the new truly solar era was opened up.

Ever since, no more mysteries, unless as residues of ancient cults destined to disappear; no more occult initiations to conquer the immortality of one's own individuality, which now is virtually the heritage of all.

In that there is, not only in the ideas, but even in the words, the reproduction of Steinerian digression in the centre of the philosophy of history.³

³NOTE by Evola: Steiner's and Cesaro's conception, according to which the ancient, pre-Christian civilization had known only collectivist and impersonal forms of spirituality and initiation, is inconsistent, not only from the initiatic point of view, but even from that of positive [scientific] research into the history of religion. It would be enough to remember that, for example, the Indo-Aryan civilizations had known the double way to immortality:

- i. the Olympian, solar, and celestial way of the gods (*deva-yana*)

A few words of comment will suffice. We, first of all, ask ourselves if, Christianity had itself ultimately accomplished this presumed leveling function. In fact, we see Christianity becoming Roman with Catholicism: purifying itself of its original anarchic, universalist, and humanitarian aspects, and giving rise, in the Middle Ages, to a civilization that is characteristic of the type we articulated: hierarchical, tied to traditions of caste and blood, interspersed with initiatic elements, certainly not at the level of the first appearances that Cesaro relegated to the past, to the “pre-Christian evolutionary stages”.

By way of such aspects, we clearly see in the Middle Ages an awakening of the true forces already acting in Nordic-Aryan Romanity, of its true solarly, propitiated from such a resurgence or rebirth from a new contribution of Aryan blood: but Cesaro should coherently see in that a “time of the stopping” of evolution, in order to recognize instead the resumption of progress in phenomena, such as the Reformation, Humanism, the French Revolution, and, (why not?) liberalism, modern democracy, jewish internationalism: in fact not before this point, i.e., the final fall of the West, the Self is truly liberated from tradition, blood, caste, traditional cults, dogmas that have become in truth empty words, and then he is truly self-conscious, detached from everything, actually ready to create, from nothing, a new civilization on the base of a freely willed universal communion.

Some may say that we are exaggerating: but it is difficult for Cesaro’s

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2. the way of the fathers (*pitri-yana*) tied to the earth and collective blood

This twofold division corresponds, in a certain way, to the distinction between the Greater and Lesser Mysteries of classic antiquity. It is evident that, for polemical purposes and to give consistency to the evolutionistic-Christian interpretation, the two authors act as if antiquity had known only the way of the fathers and similar forms that, if they were also present in the ancient world, were nevertheless relegated to the inferior social strata or races.

friend⁴ to demonstrate here that Cesaro's premises, i.e., those of Steiner, rigorously thought out, are sufficient to lead to so much. We don't want to be considered tendentious and therefore we will emphasize that in Cesaro's thought (as also in Steiner's), this immense centuries-old destruction, of which western history was miserably the theatre, would have brought about, in the end, a good, in view of a new civilization and a new spirituality. But hypotheses of the type, in truth, are a bit too gross. Since it is certain that a destruction happened, this needs to be called by its true name: tomorrow we will be able to pick ourselves up, we will be able to surpass this decadence—the idea of the so called “cyclic laws” and of the “avatars” is characteristic of traditional conceptions—but that will never be able to and later never lead ourselves to allow what happened to be considered as providential, to justify it in terms of phases of a higher evolution. We are in addition aware that, when it will truly surpass what should be surpassed, the modern world will not reach new heights that the inferior humanity of the past could not know, but, simply, it will return to “normal”, it will know, although in different forms, what it had already known and possessed.

And that is not simply a difference of interpretation, but it also entails precise consequences in regards to orientation. Whoever holds firm to traditional teaching, from an intelligent exploration of what already has been, will in fact be able to derive certain guidelines for reconstruction: race, tradition, virility, solarly, difference, hierarchy, traditional ascesis that will give back to him living meanings and ideals. Whoever instead thinks in terms of evolution, since his point of departure is man as *tabula rasa*, from bridges cut from the past, will have to posit himself to make the future, to dream up principles, systems, and myths of every type, naturally having principles and a goal in their reality apart from the individual, if he will not prefer to put himself in the retinue of some new “prophet” and new Messiah of the modern world. Steiner's formula, in such regard,

⁴Evola himself.

is that of the “new universal era of love”, that our planet would have the mission to realize with the development of “true Christianity”.

To finish up, the question of the solarly of Christianity, as Cesaro asserted, merits a comment. From what was already said, we can already foresee the way with which, from the traditional point of view, such questions must be posed: solar elements without doubt are present in Christianity (and naturally rather more so in Roman Catholicism): but not *by virtue of*, but rather *in spite of* these subversive and universalistic aspects, whose qualities were valorized by Steiner and Cesaro, not to mention Buonaiuti⁵ and many other protestant admirers of “pure Christianity”.

These elements are not to be considered as “achievements”, but rather as residual fragments of the great primordial solar tradition, or echoes of it, resonating in an historical setting quite unfavorable to the goal of the actual protection of their purity and their deepest meaning. And it is appropriate, at any rate, to explain the fact that such solar elements in Christianity lost their original metaphysical importance and assumed only a religiosity, at the most theological, and that it is no longer connected to the mysteries and to a true and proper hereditary sacerdotal caste, but were only points of reference for a general faith and heritage of a clergy enlisted without any condition of blood and race.

Even this difference is important for its practical consequences. In fact, while the evolutionists, starting from their premises, even here will grant themselves an arbitrary digression, thinking up this or that “new” form of “Christian initiation”, (and something similar even claims to furnish Steiner’s anthroposophic doctrine, close to Rosicrucian wishful thinking), which instead poses as tradition, will measure the current value of Christianity and its possibility to contribute to a future spiritual reconstruction like the susceptibility, from among the solar elements present in it, to integrate it into a wider order of the solar primordial tradition, to what can be legitimately applied the saying *quod ubique, quod*

⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ernesto_Buonaiuti

ab omnibus et quod semper. And in this order, undoubtedly, an essential convergence will be verified of the positive element of Christianity with what it had that was great, virile, Olympian, whether the authentic pristine Romanity, or the greatest forms of the common Indo-European and Aryan civilization.

Because of this confusion of motives and applications, we therefore said of Cesaro's work that it can engender only a sense of authentic perplexity. And it is truly a pity because the quality of the criticism and exegesis that the author demonstrates are indisputable, and the clarification of the lacunae that official history leaves open and for which a higher interpretation is imposed, is conducted with mastery. That such a work has therefore not been able to have the significance and the value that, otherwise, would have been proper, that is accordingly to be ascribed to the load of the deleterious influence that, in one way or the other, and even in perfect good faith, the modern occult and theosophical neo-spiritualism does not cease to wield in a cultural world disorientated in respect to true traditional spirituality, like that of the modern West.

Posted on 2012-03-08 by Aeneas

13.4 Nationalism and Cosmopolitanism

We are in a world of Generation and death, and this world we must cast off.

WILLIAM BLAKE, *Vision of the Last Judgment*

Vladimir Solovyov wrote a massive volume, *The Justification of the Good: An Essay on Moral Philosophy*, which has achieved a modicum of notoriety in the past few years⁶. There are two sections — on Nationalism and

⁶<https://www.nytimes.com/2014/03/04/opinion/brooks-putin-cant-stop.html>

on War — that are worth reviewing, with the goal of understanding the moral and intellectual currents behind current events.

Collective Hostility First of all, Solovyov needs to establish the existence of superpersonal morality above and beyond the personal. He begins, not from moral principles, but by identifying the collective evil:

The work of embodying perfect morality in the collective whole of mankind is hindered, in addition to individual passions and vices, by the inveterate forms of collective evil which act like a contagion.

There are three aspects of superpersonal or collective hostility, although only the first one is of interest for our purposed.

- **National:** between different nations
- **Penal:** between society and the criminal
- **Socio-economic:** between the different classes of society.

He points out the prejudices between the various nationalities in Europe at the time. If Western Europe claims to have overcome such mutual hostilities, it is still not the case in the Balkans. There is open hostility toward Asians and Africans. Nowadays, hostility toward one country in particular is not only tolerated, but is actually considered virtuous. Unfortunately, rapprochement can never be achieved, given such hostility.

National Differences Two contradictory ways have arisen to overcome mutual hostility, which makes matters worst:

- Social violence.

- The elimination of all differences.

These manifest, in the international sphere, as Nationalism and Cosmopolitanism, although the latter often goes under the guise of globalism these days. The following definitions are Solovyov's.

- **Nationalism:** We must love our own nation and serve it by all the means at our command, and to other nations we may be indifferent. If their interests conflict with ours, we must take up a hostile attitude to the foreign nations.
- **Cosmopolitanism:** Nationality is merely a natural fact, devoid of all moral significance; we have no duties to the nation as such (neither to our own nor to any other); our duty is only to individual men without any distinction of nationality.

Nationalism ascribes an absolute significance to national differences and cosmopolitanism deprives it of all significance. Nevertheless, there is no fault in loving one's own country; on the contrary, patriotism has always been regarded as a virtue. And nationalism does not preclude justice for other nations.

Patriotism False patriotism can be recognized in these characteristics:

- **Irrational:** does harm instead of the intended good and leads nations to disaster
- **Vain:** based on unfounded pretensions
- **False:** serves as a cloak for low and selfish motives

Moral and Material Goods Solovyov shows that the moral content of personal relationships is analogous to superpersonal relationships. To love someone means to strive to obtain for them both moral and material good, but the latter only on condition of the former. Material goods can be obtained by immoral means or used for immoral purposes. Material ends are subordinate to moral ends.

Spiritual goods, on the other hand, can never be achieved by bad means. He emphasizes the point:

One cannot steal moral dignity, or plunder justice, or appropriate benevolence. These goods are unconditionally desirable.

Solovyov points out that these moral principles become dim when one's country is involved. Worth quoting in full:

Everything becomes permissible in the service of its supposed interests, the purpose justifies the means, the black becomes white, falsehood is preferred to truth, violence is extolled as a virtue. Nationality here becomes the final end, the highest good and the standard of good for human activity. Such undue glorification is, however, purely illusory, and is in truth degrading to the nation. The highest human goods cannot, as we have seen, be attained by immoral means. By admitting bad means into our service of the nation and by justifying them we limit the national interest to the lower material goods which may be obtained and preserved by wrong and evil methods. This is a direct injury to the very nation we wish to serve. It means transferring the centre of gravity of the national life from the higher sphere to the lower, and serving national egoism under the guise of serving the nation.

Solovyov claims that nations prospered only when they served higher and universal ideals. Hence, the nation cannot be the final and ultimate bearer of the collective life of humanity. He then describes the inner history of various cultures and empires.

The examples he provides are for a future post.

Summary Solovyov has identified the superpersonal moral principles. Just as humans do not perfectly embody their moral ideals, neither do countries. Nevertheless, by overcoming natural hostilities, there are criteria to apply to international relations. For example, is the country pursuing a moral end, or material ends like price of oil, commodities? Moral ends may include protecting the innocent or eliminating evil ideologies. What are the moral ideals of the country? Although the claims may ultimately be shown to be false, that must not be the starting point.

Posted on 2022-06-29 by Cologero

14.1 Donoso Cortes, Carl Schmitt, Bonald

Nowadays, “discussion” has become commodified, the saleable product of cable news and journals of opinion; there is no longer even the pretense of a “search for truth”. Learn the reasons why.

I don’t believe that **Carl Schmitt**’s monograph on **Donoso Cortes**, mentioned by **Julius Evola**¹, has been translated into English. However, the last chapter of Schmitt’s *Political Theology* is titled *On the Counter-revolutionary Philosophy of the State (de Maistre, Bonald, Donoso Cortes)*, so it can serve as a summary to Schmitt’s understanding of Donoso.

But first, we need to point out an interesting anomaly. The Catholic Schmitt, along with the three Catholic counterrevolutionaries, have had absolutely no impact on the contemporary church. Their ideas on Tradition, authority, and opposition to the modern liberal world were rejected by the modernist Vatican II church. So why was the anti-Christian Evola so entranced by the figure of Donoso Cortes? As Evola points out in his

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4432>

review of Schmitt's monograph on **Thomas Hobbes**², what counts is the "manifestation of a principle and a higher order" and the implementation of a "type of truly spiritual and traditional hierarchical organization". Since there is no longer any institutional support for such ideas, it is the task of the few to understand and development them.

As we saw, Evola rejects Hobbes' claim of the social contract as the foundation of the Leviathan state, as that would serve to provide it with a veneer of legitimacy. Rather, it is the devolution of the Traditional state, the result of the loss of the sense of a transcendent truth, while still retaining its authority. Such a state, left to its own devices under the "influences of a deeper elusive nature, always capable of infiltrating wherever they do not find the way barred by the presence of authentic principles and in a firm, abiding truth", will continue to devolve into the "individualistic breakup of the State". So what does Donoso tell us about that liberal crackup and its opposite?

The liberal ideal is "free inquiry", the "marketplace of ideas", "everlasting conversation". Schmitt writes:

Catholic political philosophers such as de Maistre, Bonald, and Donoso Cortes ... would have considered everlasting conversation a product of a gruesomely comic fantasy, for what characterized their counterrevolutionary political philosophy was the recognition that their times needed a decision.

For Bonald tradition offered the sole possibility of gaining the content that man was capable of accepting metaphysically, because the intellect of the individual was considered too weak and wretched to be able to recognize truth by itself.

The antitheses and distinctions that Bonald was so fond of contain in truth moral disjunctions... Such moral disjunctions represent contrasts between good and evil, God and the devil; between

²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4444>

them an either/or exists in the sense of a life-and-death struggle that does not recognize a synthesis and a “higher third.”

We see that the counterrevolutionaries reject the liberal ideal that every man’s opinion counts. “Error has no rights”, and few men are capable of overcoming intellectual error. Donoso was even more emphatic. According to Schmitt: Donoso Cortes’

Contempt for man knew no limits: Man’s blind reason, his weak will, and the ridiculous vitality of his carnal longings appeared to him so pitiable that all words in every human language do not suffice to express the complete lowness of this creature. ... The stupidity of the masses was just as apparent to him as was the silly vanity of their leaders.

In essence, Donoso is describing a man at the “first stage”, who is moved “by forces, ideas, and objects outside of himself. Lacking a will, the man in the first stage can do nothing without being directed by outside forces.” Donoso also is contemptuous of bourgeois society. Schmitt writes:

According to Donoso Cortes, it was characteristic of bourgeois liberalism not to decide in this battle but instead to begin a discussion. He straightforwardly defined the bourgeoisie as a “discussing class”. This definition contains the class characteristic of wanting to evade the decision. A class that shifts all political activity on the plane of conversation in the press and in parliament is no match for social conflict.

How prescient was Donoso? Senators, TV “journalists”, etc., drone on about “having a conversation”, “dialogue” and the right to “free speech”. Their goal is to win an argument, while the goal of the opposition is to win.

The Futility of Debate Here is the heart of the matter. The bourgeois class, although nominally in power, has no understanding of, nor even belief in, any principles of a transcendent order. Hence, there are no longer any convictions. With no grasp of true principles, there is no argument against the destructive forces of disorder. When the opposite of the truth is given equal footing with the truth, there can be no resolution. The debate will continue without resolution, like some eternal Highlander battle³, but without the heroic elements. Instead of an either/or, there is now an and/or. The masses themselves have no way to resolve the issue, and hence consider themselves free to choose either alternative based on nothing but whim. Thus, the choice for disorder is just as valid as the choice for order.

If a child touches a hot stove, he gets immediate negative feedback and learns never to do it again. In the course of his life, a man will make many mistakes. Often, the consequences are not clearly experienced until years later when the entanglements he created become difficult to escape from. On the societal level, the full negative effects will not be noticed for many years, often exceeding even the span of a man's life. This is why they persist, to the intense bemusement of those who are still capable of seeing the true causes and consequences of events.

Decision The liberal, bourgeois state lacks the will to make a decision. Schmitt explains:

Donoso Cortes considered continuous discussion a method of circumventing responsibility and of ascribing to freedom of speech and of the press an excessive importance that in the final analysis permits the decision to be evaded. Just as liberalism discusses and negotiates every political detail, so it also wants to dissolve metaphysical truth in a discussion. The essence of liberalism is

³[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Highlander_\(franchise\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Highlander_(franchise))

negotiation, a cautious half measure, in the hope that the definitive dispute, the decisive bloody battle, can be transformed into a parliamentary debate and permit the decision to be suspended forever in an everlasting discussion.

We see, however, that the negotiation keeps moving just in one direction. For example, suppose I offer \$50 for a product and the seller demands \$100. We negotiate for \$75. The seller then knows my limit. So the next time we negotiate, we start at \$75 and he demands \$125. If, through indecision, I lack the will to hold firm, you can see the price will continue to increase. Thus, social conflict continues to be resolved just in one direction, despite the intentions of conservatives to maintain the status quo, which, in any case, continues to move in the same direction.

The opposite of discussion is decision. In a Traditional society, the ultimate decision was made by the High Priest or the King. At that point, the decision was final and discussion ended. In the religious sphere, the spiritual authority is infallible; in the political sphere, the King laid down the law. In this view, conflict cannot be negotiated away and must be dealt with in a more primal way. This was always recognized. For example, **Dante** recognized the duel as the ultimate arbiter⁴. **Joseph de Maistre** praised the Executioner as the hidden force behind order. That is why the revolutionaries always oppose capital punishment, at least until they gain power themselves.

For Donoso, who lived at a time when Kings no longer held power other than in a nominal sense, the solution was a dictator, or a “man of destiny”. This is the logical conclusion. This is a step back, in the direction of counterrevolution, but it is still authority without truth or legitimacy. While not rejecting this notion, this is only

the stage at which authority suffices and truth is superfluous; in which myths, and not true principles, are the best instrument to

⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3636>

capture and organize collective forces; in which the miracle of an exceptional personality, of a “man of destiny” saturated with the “numinous”, and not a pure “divine right”, founds a legitimate sovereignty and command and confers a transcendent character to the idea of the State.

Ultimately, this stage must itself be surpassed:

we will enter into a new phase in which the Leviathan, so to speak, will become the body formed to make possible the incarnation and the manifestation of a principle and a higher order: with that, the collectivistic and irrational aspect of the principle of totalitarianism and authority will be surpassed and will again implement a type of truly spiritual and traditional hierarchical organization.

Posted on 2012-07-19 by Cologero

* * *

logres on 2012-07-20 at 01:42 said:

Almost all “classical liberals” of the older, well-bred school were suspicious of democracy, yet today’s group denominating themselves that have accepted it as indisputable, literally. It seems they have an either/or as well, in a twisted way.

logres on 2012-07-20 at 01:45 said:

I also found this: there are first stirrings (in a quiet way) of the coming realizations:

http://www.legends-and-myths.com/40_1.cfm?f=22-legends-myths-initiation-romance-of-the-rose

I am not even sure he is a “traditionalist”.

Andrew on 2012-07-20 at 04:27 said:

Posts like this are the reason I read Gornahoor daily. Simply giving voice to these ideas makes Gornahoor one of the most valuable websites that exist. I cannot name one other blog that describes Tradition so consistently.

Avery on 2012-07-22 at 11:30 said:

"For example, suppose I offer \$50 for a product and the seller demands \$100. We negotiate for \$75. The seller then knows my limit. So the next time we negotiate, we start at \$75 and he demands \$125."

A useful metaphor, since economic metaphors are easily understood these days. We can say that modernity is a seller's market. The buyer has no choice but to accept the constantly raising social "price", or else walk away. And what's being sold? Power, reputation, fame... all the stuff that your friends with a foot in tradition can warn you about.

14.2 Donoso on Liberalism, Socialism, and Catholicism

Although this book by Cortes was not one of Evola's favourites because of its overt theological emphasis, it is still very valuable reading for several audiences. First of all, for counter-revolutionaries, it makes clear the ideas of liberalism and socialism and brings to awareness that this opposition to Tradition is nothing recent, but has been ongoing for a few hundred years. For anti-Catholics, it will make clear the Catholicism at one time was the sole serious and viable force opposed to the modern world. They need to ask themselves if they are really willing to reject the world that defined Europe, a world created by foundational documents of Augustine, Aquinas, Dante, or Bossuet, not to mention art, architecture, chivalry and so much else. For neo-Catholics in thrall to the "spirit of Vatican II", they need to decide if they are in continuity with the Church described by Donoso. Since the legitimacy and authority of the Catholic Church derives only from its adherence to Tradition, neo-Catholics have to demonstrate they are still Catholic.

Donoso's *Essays on Liberalism, Socialism, and Catholicism* with a new introduction by Cologero Salvo is now available in the Library⁵.

My principles are only those that, before the French Revolution, every well-born person considered healthy, sane and normal.

⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf>

JULIUS EVOLA

In this short list of modern authors—that is, those writing after 1789—Evola includes Juan Donoso Cortes among those holding to those sane and normal principles. He writes:

In the same spirit ... of the great Catholic philosophers of authority, Joseph de Maistre and Donoso Cortes, I deny everything that, directly or indirectly, derives from the French revolution, which, in my opinion, has Bolshevism as its ultimate outcome, in contrast to the World of Tradition.

To the modern mind, such a view is summarily dismissed as “Fascism”, the common accusation hurled at any idea opposed to the “manifest destiny” of the modern world. Yet as Evola points out, this spirit of Tradition predates the Fascist movements of the 20th century because:

It brings back a tradition higher and prior to Fascism, insofar as it belongs to the heritage of a hierarchical, aristocratic, and traditional conception of the state, conceptions having a universal character that were maintained in Europe right up until the French Revolution.

In contrast to the totalitarianisms of the modern age, this traditional view was based on an organic society, with power distributed under the principle of subsidiarity, and bonds of loyalty freely given.

In these essays, Donoso reaches down to the fundamental assumptions of the modern world as expressed in Liberalism and Socialism, in contrast to the spirit of Tradition that Catholicism used to represent. Since few men ever bother to question and articulate clearly their assumptions, a common dialog among the three world views becomes literally impossible. Donoso writes:

The supreme interest of that school is in preventing the arrival of the day of radical negations or of sovereign affirmations; and that it may not arrive, it confounds by means of discussion all notions, and propagates scepticism, knowing as it does, that a people which perpetually hears in the mouth of its sophists the pro and the contra of everything, ends by not knowing which side to take, and by asking itself whether truth and error, injustice and justice, stupidity and honesty, are things opposed among themselves, or are only the same things regarded from different points of view.

How much more true this is in our day, with instant and incessant televised discussions and the multitude of Internet blogs. The intent is seldom to discern truth, justice, and intelligence, but instead the goal is to promote a particular point of view.

Liberalism and Socialism This is how well-born men used to think:

The Liberal school regards it as certain, that there is no other evil but what is in the political institutions which we have inherited from time to time, and that the supreme good consists in levelling those institutions in the dust. The greater part of Socialists look upon it as settled, that there is no other evil but what is in society, and that the grand remedy is in the complete destruction of social institutions. All agree that the evil comes to us from times past; the Liberals affirm that the good can be realised at the present time, and the Socialists that the golden age cannot commence till the future.

The supreme good consisting, according to one and the other, in a supreme disarrangement, which, according to the Liberal school, must be realised in the political, and according to the Socialists, in the social, regions, the one and the other agree in the substantial and intrinsic goodness of man, who is to be the intelligent and free agent of both disarrangements. This conclusion

has been explicitly enunciated by the Socialistic schools, and is implicitly involved in the theory which the Liberal schools hold. That conclusion follows from their theory, in such a way, that if the conclusion be denied, the theory itself comes to the ground. In fact, the theory, according to which the evil is in man and proceeds from man, is contradictory of the other, according to which, the evil is in the social or political institutions, and proceeds from the political and social institutions. Supposing the former, what logically follows is, to extirpate the evil in man, with which its extirpation in society and in government must necessarily be secured. Supposing the latter, what logically follows is, to extirpate the evil directly in society or in government, in which are its centre and its origin.

From which we see that the Catholic, and the rationalistic, theories are not only incompatible, but even contradictory. By the Catholic, disturbance, whether political or social, is condemned as mad and useless. The rationalistic theories condemn all moral reform of man as useless and mad. And the one and the other are consistent in their condemnations; for if the evil be not in government or in society, why will you disturb society or government? And on the contrary, if the evil is not in individuals, nor proceeds from individuals, why will you attempt an interior reform of man?

DONOSO CORTES

In a nutshell, Donoso Cortes points out the fundamental worldview of the three schools. Since no one ever reaches down to their fundamental assumptions, dialogue is literally impossible. There can only be incessant and fruitless debate. As Donoso puts it:

The supreme interest of that school is in preventing the arrival of the day of radical negations or of sovereign affirmations; and

that it may not arrive, it confounds by means of discussion all notions, and propagates scepticism, knowing as it does, that a people which perpetually hears in the mouth of its sophists the pro and the contra of everything, ends by not knowing which side to take, and by asking itself whether truth and error, injustice and justice, stupidity and honesty, are things opposed among themselves, or are only the same things regarded from different points of view.

So we are forced to take one or the other “side” of the debate, when what is really necessary is to understand one’s fundamental assumptions. And many so-called conservatives hold a reactionary position on political or social issues, more or less out of old habit, while their fundamental worldview differs little from liberals or socialists. To summarize, see Table 14.1.

Position	Source of Evil
Liberalism	Political institutions
Socialism	Social institutions
Tradition	Man himself

Table 14.1: Positions and Sources of Evil

From this chart we can see where each school is logically compelled to find a solution:

- Liberals look to change political institutions
- Socialists look to change social mores
- Tradition looks to the moral regeneration of man

As Donoso points out, the liberals are ultimately incoherent. Their political institutions are lifeless and without soul. The liberal regards

them as self-existent apart from the peoples, their values, history and consciousness. The conservative senses this but is unable to articulate it properly, primarily because he is a believer himself in his political institutions.

The socialist believes that the solution lies in the overthrow of traditional societal norms; only then will justice and happiness be achieved. Here we see the constant push against and challenge to traditional morality and social norms.

So we hear the cry from the conservative that the battle must be fought in the social arena. However, he himself absorbs the socialist view on issues — if not now, then eventually — due to the constant flow of propaganda. Hence, he gradually concedes the ground that he had initially won.

The war is really about worldview but no one notices. Metaphysics must be opposed to the rationalism of the liberals and socialists; the moral regeneration of man must be given primary place before political and social change. These voices are few, and where they do exist, they are unconvincing and their philosophy is inconsistent.

Posted on 2010-03-12 by Cologero

* * *

Cologero on 2010-03-23 at 06:50 said:

... the Liberal school has done nothing but establish premises which end in Socialistic consequences, and the Socialistic schools, nothing but draw the consequences contained in the Liberal premises. Those two schools differ not in ideas, but in daring: when the question thus stands between them, it is clear the victory belongs by right to the more daring, and the more daring without any doubt is that which, without stopping midway, accepts their consequences with the principles. If this be so, there is no doubt ... that Socialism has the best of the battle, and that hers is the palm of victory.

Donoso Cortes

Attila on 2011-12-22 at 23:37 said:

I tend toward the view that “Man” IS the “problem” –even though I have no connection with Catholicism. All of the secular -isms have left people without any reference points – except those furnished by the media complex.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-23 at 06:20 said:

There is an incredible all-round dumbing down of people and it only seems to be getting worse. Although on the one hand I see more and more people unfolding into their spiritual awakening – in accordance with the divine plan – it is quite astonishing how clueless human beings are becoming on the other. the distinction between the haves and have nots is not one of money but of wisdom-knowledge. Education to put it simply. Of course this is a ploy – possibly unconscious – on the part of governments and other institutions to keep people stupid, to feed them bread at the circuses so they remain bloated and content without the desire to seek for more. When I worked in a large office I was routinely shocked by the lack of true education I saw among people – young people especially – who are actually considered to be top graduates and recruits. The lack of understanding was not simply spiritual but historical and political, it made me wonder what on earth they had been doing to have escaped university with first class degrees but zero wisdom-knowledge. It made me very sad actually and I wondered what hope there is, but of course hope comes from the spiritual hierarchies who will individually awaken (the memories of) people with the revelatory fire of divine love, the only means by which true wisdom-knowledge may be attained. But you are right to say the media has a lot to answer for, so many of those corporations are in a prime position to offer wonderful educations that will help open people's minds, but they instead take the quick road to greed by filling their heads with reality TV nonsense and tabloid news. One is therefore beholden to remind one's self of who owns these corporations... ..we know the answer, the old new world order has poor taste in entertainment, the new new world order should take over ASAP :-)

14.3 The Faith of a Prince

Europe arouses pity in the heart of the thinking man and horror
in the heart of the virtuous man.

Source unknown

In the century preceding Rene Guenon and Julius Evola, there was also a revolt against the modern world equal in depth and insight to what fol-

lowed. To a large extent, this we spearheaded by several Catholic thinkers: **Joseph de Maistre**, **Vicomte de Bonald**, **Juan Donoso Cortes**, **Louis Veuillot**, not to mention several popes.

We shall, from time to time, bring to light their ideas, beginning with **Prince Clemens Metternich**. First of all, it is necessary to be clear what the "Right" means in a specific and objective sense. If the Left represents the state of permanent revolution, then the Right must be, in de Maistre's expression, the "opposite of a revolution". Revolution seeks to overturn the established, natural, and organic order of things through the secular state. Hence, the counter-revolution wills a hierarchical order and the state founded on true spiritual principles. In short, the Right is the party of the Logos and the Left, that of the anti-Logos. This will be the standard not only to judge the world, but a fortiori to judge those who claim to hold a more traditional view.

Hence, Metternich held that society must be governed by a true understanding of God and Man, or else it will devolve to the administration of passing needs. Unlike the modern mind for which everything is political, for Metternich the "social principle" held primacy; this is the rights of the family, or, more generally, the principle of preservation and continuity. The following comments are derived from his personal memoirs (1847). He lists the symptoms of disorder in these words:

Kings have reached the stage of wondering how much longer they are going to last; passions are let loose and are in league to overthrow all that society has hitherto respected as the basis of its existence: religion, public morality, laws, customs, rights and duties; everything is attacked, confused, overthrown, or made a matter of doubt. The great mass of the people looks calmly on, in the face of so many attacks and upheavals, against which there is an utter lack of any sort of protection. Some of them are lost in vague dreams, while an overwhelming majority desire the maintenance of a public order which no longer exists, the very first elements of

which seem to have been lost.

Metternich then asks two questions: (1) what is the cause of these disorders? And (2), are there any means of halting the growth of this disorder? We will let him speak of the causes. The answer to (2), more than a century and a half later, is still elusive. Those who are new to this line of thought are too often sanguine about the prospects and need to take the long view espoused here. Furthermore, it is fair to ask whether those claiming to be opposed to disorder are in fact contributing to it. "Nothing is as fatal as error," he tells us, so, following his lead, we need to abandon the temptation to fall into it.

The Causes of Disorder Institutions are uncertain in their origin, go through periods of development and perfection, and then fall into decay. At the peak of their strength, there are two foundational elements: (1) the precepts of religious and social morality and (2) the local needs of man. When men rebel against that base, society moves to a state of unrest and eventually upheaval and bloodshed. Metternich admits that is not new in human history, but that in his time, it was more extensive than ever before. Of course, the succeeding century proved to be even bloodier and even more disorderly.

In a snapshot view of European history, Metternich points to the rise and fall of Rome, followed by the period of darkness. He then claims that the Christian religion dispelled that darkness, reestablishing civilization on a new basis of a pure and eternal law. Although some critics of the modern world may want to deny that, or at least deny that it would be applicable today as Metternich held, they have the burden of suggesting another source for the "pure and eternal law".

The breakdown of the Medieval civilization was due, he says, to the perfect storm of the inventions of the printing press and gunpowder, the discovery of the Western hemisphere, and the Reformation. He writes:

The march of the human spirit was therefore exceedingly rapid throughout the last three centuries. This march having progressed with a more rapid acceleration than the course of wisdom—the unique counterbalance of passion and error—had been able to take, a revolution, prepared by false systems of philosophy, and by fatal errors into which several sovereigns, the most illustrious of the second half of the eighteenth century, had fallen, at last broke out in that country [France] which was one of the most advanced in intelligence, the most weakened by a love of pleasure, in a country inhabited by a race of people who can be considered the most frivolous in the world, considering the facility they have in understanding, and the difficulty they experience in judging an issue calmly.

Presumption In short, the disorder can be expressed in one word: presumption, the natural result of such a rapid progress of the human mind in material improvements. The influx of false ideas, the new riches extracted from the New World, and the revolution in the moral order resulting from the Reformation, led to the presumptuous man. Metternich expands on this idea:

Religion, morality, legislation, economy, politics, administration, everything seems to have become common property, accessible to all. People think that they know everything; experience does not count for the presumptuous man; faith means nothing to him; he substitutes for it a so-called personal conviction and feels himself dispensed from any examination or course of study in order to arrive at this conviction, for these means seem too lowly to a mind which thinks itself powerful enough to take in at a glance a general review of problems and facts.

Laws are of no value in his eyes because he did not help to make them and because it would be beneath the dignity of a man of his caliber to recognize the milestones traced by brutish and ignorant

generations before him. Authority resides in himself; why should he subject himself to what is only of use to a man deprived of intelligence and knowledge? What had formerly, in his view, been sufficient at a tender age non longer suits a man who has reached the age of reason and maturity, that degree of universal perfection which the German innovators designate by the idea, absurd by its very nature, of the emancipation of the peoples? Morality alone is not openly attacked, for without it he would not be sure of his own existence for a single moment; but he interprets it according to his own fancy and allows everybody else to do the same thing, provided that the other man neither kills nor robs him.

Of course, Metternich could not imagine how far “morality” would come to be “reinterpreted” today and how the ideal of emancipation would be extended. Metternich says that what he described can hardly be called “society”, since the social elements have all been individualized.

Each man is the head of his own dogmas, the arbiter of laws according to which he can deign to govern himself, or allow others to govern him and his fellows, in a word, the only judge of his faith, of his actions and the principle according to which he means to regulate them.

As a proof of this, Metternich interestingly points to the fact that nationality—one of the most natural sentiments in man—is lacking in the liberal ideology. Nationalism, or its contemporary analog “identitarianism”, was never denied by the religious and spiritual systems that Metternich followed. There is the idea, today, that the opposite, and hence enemy, of nationalism is something called “universalism”, allegedly taught by the spiritual authority prior to the French revolution. Quite the contrary, according to Metternich the natural sentiment of identity is abolished by the spirit of individualism, which by its nature denies such ties. A collection of individuals is easier to control. Metternich explains:

The true aim of the idealists of the [liberal] party is religious and political fusion and, in the last analysis, is not other than to create in favour of each individual an existence which is entirely independent of all authority and all will, except his own—an absurd idea, which is contrary to the spirit of man and incompatible with the requirements of human society.

Suggested reading: *Catholic Political Thought 1789-1848*, ed Bela Menczer

Posted on 2013-06-04 by Cologero

* * *

Ash on 2013-06-05 at 00:26 said:

It's ironic that the Left itself, seeing the failure of "emancipating" man from his social order, would go on to create ideologies like socialism and Marxism which attempted to correct against the detrimental effects of old liberalism. It's often missed by the Right that the Left itself saw these failures in their predecessors. Even the rights of freedom of speech and association, previously trumpeted as fundamental, are spat upon these days in the respectable academic left, such as in doctrines like the "safe space", where speech must be carefully controlled so no one feels threatened. Of course, this usually becomes a way to control against the "threats" of ideas which are outside the accepted ideological and metapolitical bounds of those who rule the "space" in question.

It will be interesting to hear from Metternich, someone whose work I myself have not yet studied much; thank you for posting him. Unfortunately, a major theme in these and later generations of Rightist thinkers is that they seem to regard "reinterpretation" of morality and faith as bad in and of itself. At least, they don't examine much what a positive reinterpretation could look like. Students of Tradition found on this site accept that the myths, spirit, and morals of Rome were reinterpreted over the centuries it took for Christianity to give a new life and meaning to old traditions in and outside the Empire. It would be useful to see how more recent developments can be harnessed for similar ends (such as Alan Watts attempted to do with science and the modern market). Clearly, any reinterpretation that strengthens or improves upon old traditions (as opposed to Tradition), is desirable. This is especially true when the old myths have long lost their power, save for those who know how to hear them. Frederick the Great of Prussia, admired by Evola, may be a more aristocratic example of such a re-interpreter (though his ultimate success may be questioned indeed).

Cologero on 2013-06-05 at 07:24 said:

Interesting points, Ash. As regards reinterpretations of morality, I believe Metternich was referring primarily to individuals inventing private moral codes rather than communal mores which are somewhat more adaptable. I did leave a small part out, where he wrote about variations due to the material and environmental factors in which a community arose and exists. Nevertheless, Metternich accepted a higher law, or as said nowadays, the "permanent things."

I suppose verbal "threats" to one's feelings are now considered analogous to bodily threats. It seems that new types of group identity are now in play, based primarily on behaviors rather than on the natural sentiments of the "nationalism" that Metternich referred to.

Logres on 2013-06-05 at 13:38 said:

"In short, the disorder can be expressed in one word: presumption, the natural result of such a rapid progress of the human mind in material improvements. The influx of false ideas, the new riches extracted from the New World, and the revolution in the moral order resulting from the Reformation, led to the presumptuous man..."

Brilliant.

"Quite the contrary, according to Metternich the natural sentiment of identity is abolished by the spirit of individualism, which by its nature denies such ties. A collection of individual is easier to control."

J.Nisbet's phrase for this is "intermediate institutions". They provide a buffer between the Nomos of the State and the local self-government that is proper to the state of fallen (and even un-fallen) man. The naked Self is what the Left wants to "unveil" as their grand finale, a naked Self devoid of rule by General Law, the hierarchies of heaven & earth. Althusius made one of the few Calvinist attempts at formulating a real political theory which took this into account: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johannes_Althusius.

The Church made a big mistake in losing the idea that even un-fallen man (Adam) would have had a form of government; once one believes that one has overcome Sin and achieved the emancipation of peoples, then if no need for government remains (having achieved Eden), the ideas of the Left follow naturally.

Phillip Rieff is recommended reading for anyone wanting an expose of Fanon and the trendy ultra-modern deconstructionism which logically results from emancipating the naked Self. Mouravieff's doctrines of General Law (discussed also by Ouspensky in *The Fourth Way*) can help the Right and the Church re-establish an esoteric basis for exoteric doctrine. "Force & Right rule the World – Force till Right is ready" (Bishop Joubert). Even dictums like this can be "re-interpreted" by the Left.

How to keep man from thinking he is ready when not?

Timotheus Lutz on 2013-06-06 at 02:27 said:

A good book on him is 'Metternich 1773-1859: A Study Of His Period And Personality' by Algernon Cecil, uncommon but definitely available from online sellers for reasonable prices. It's one of those gems that fell through the cracks.

'You-know-who' liked it, if that means anything.

14.4 The German Conservative Revolution

In this useful collection of essays, *From the German Conservative Revolution to the New Right*⁶, **Lucian Tudor** introduces us to several German political thinkers, loosely grouped under the rubric “conservative revolution”. In the second part of the book, Mr Tudor tries to link these authors to a more contemporary movement called the “New Right”. For this review, we will focus on the German authors, perhaps to deal with the second part at a later date. Readers are advised to skip past the Foreward.

In my notes to the book, I have extracted several extended quotexts (marked off with a blue bar). Therefore, I will leave the commentary to a minimum and reproduce those here. The intent is to encourage the reader to consult the book itself and even the German authors themselves, many of whom have never been translated into English. But first some preliminaries.

The book was published by a Chilean identitarian group, *Círculo de Investigaciones Pancriollistas*. I don't know what attraction German writers or the New Right have for them, since there is sufficient material in Spanish and other Romance languages that, in my opinion, is of equal or greater value. Moreover, we can recall Charles Maurras' ideal of an alliance of Romance language speaking nations, which would have included Romania (Lucian Tudor is Romanian). That ideal is based on the undeniable cultural, historical, linguistic, and spiritual identity of those nations, if “Identity” is truly the goal.

⁶<https://pancriollismo.com/>

Unlike historical Europe, the Americas are much more ethnically diverse. This can perhaps be seen as the fourth “hyperborean migration”, i.e., the habitation of the Americas, Australia, and so on. It brings up the question of how exactly does such a group establish a separate identity within such a diverse country like Chile? The German writers all assume that the nation and geography more or less coincide.

Nevertheless, as Mr Tudor shows us, these German thinkers often reaffirm the same ideas as the French and the Spaniards. There are actually many valid principles that can be applied to any claimants to be heirs of this line of thought. Mr Tudor lets **Edgar Julius Jung**’s definition set the tone for the first part of the book.

By conservative revolution? we mean the return to respect for all of those elementary laws and values without which the individual is alienated from nature and God and left incapable of establishing any true order.

- In the place of equality comes the inner value of the individual;
- in the place of socialist convictions, the just integration of people into their place in a society of rank;
- in place of mechanical selection, the organic growth of leadership;
- in place of bureaucratic compulsion, the inner responsibility of genuine self-governance;
- in place of mass happiness, the rights of the personality formed by the nation

At this point, we need to mention an inconvenient fact: the liberal societies of the West have had great material success and enjoy popular support. People flock to liberal states and no one tries to leave. Hence, it

will never be a question of who has the “best” argument, since the psychological trumps the logical except in rare men. After all, who is willing to assume his “rank” in society? Mr Tudor deliberately left out any detailed analysis of Julius Evola, so there is no discussion of the degeneration of castes; that is the real explanation for the state of things. But getting back, Mr Tudor extracts some common features:

- the belief in the values of Volk (people, nation, or ethnos)
- the recognition of the value of differences between individuals and between peoples
- the importance of authority
- the value of holism and supra-individual community-feeling
- the importance of religious belief
- the supremacy of vital and spiritual forces over material and artificial forces in human life
- the call to overcome modern nihilism
- a revolutionary view of tradition (**radical cultural conservatism**)

Moeller van den Bruck distinguishes between the “reactionary” who wants to restore lost forms from the “conservative”. Quoting him, Mr Tudor adds his own conclusion:

“Conservatism seeks to preserve a nation’s values, both by conserving traditional values, as far as these still possess the power of growth, and by assimilating all new values which increase a nation’s vitality. He [the conservative] distinguishes the transitory from the eternal.” In other words, there are values and principles

which are timeless and eternally valid, but the particular forms (institutions, laws, social orders, cultural forms, etc.) in which they are manifested are temporal, and vary and transform by time and place. This conception of Conservatism makes it possible to resist undesirable modern developments without unrealistically rejecting everything in the modern world and to revolutionize contemporary society by regenerating what was valuable in the past, conserving what is valuable in the present, and accepting positive new ideas for the future.

Conservative Socialism Mr Tudor identifies 7 themes addressed by the conservatives: Conservative socialism, folkish integralism, Christian radical traditionalism, cultural pessimism, Biocentrism, political philosophy, and philosophy of war. What he calls “socialism” is actually more like a “third way”, more medieval than modern. These are its features:

- an anti-individualist value of organic community and social solidarity
- the reconciliation of social justice with a respect for the inequality of character and hierarchy in society
- a corporative organization of the economy
- the view that ethics (work ethic, altruism, devotion to service and the whole) are just as important as economics in defining socialism,
- a greater emphasis on national unity rather than class warfare

Integralism This includes:

- Social wholeness (holism)

- Cultural particularism
- The collective meaning of the Folk

Combined, individualism and total openness harmed the integrity of peoples (Folk) and created uncertainty and alienation in social and cultural life. The Revolutionary Conservatives advocated the overturning of liberal society and the creation of integrated, more closed, ethnically particularist, and holistic (anti-individualist, community-oriented) states which would restore the profound sense of collective meaning in life.

Christian Traditionalism Mr Tudor mentions **Othmar Spann** and **Edgar Jung** as the most prominent representatives of this line of thought.

The Christian radical traditionalists advocated the creation of a monarchical state which would also be led by a hierarchically organized, authoritarian elite that would be open to accepting new members based on their quality, thus creating a spiritually aristocratic leadership. As Jung described it, the state as the highest order of organic community must be an aristocracy; in the last and highest sense: the rule of the best.

Christian radical traditionalists also asserted that their vision of the ideal state was the True State, meaning a socio-political structure which varies between cultures but which reappears across history, and is thus based upon an eternally valid model.

Obviously, this line of thought is more appealing than the others to Traditionalists.

Cultural Pessimism The pessimist rejects the idea of human progress and recognizes that cultures go through cycles of growth and decline. Unlike what a Spengler may write, however, there can be no “law” behind that.

Biocentrism

Biocentrism posited an essential distinction between Seele (Soul) and Geist (Spirit), which conflict each other in human life. The Geist is the nous, the pneuma, or the logos ... what we would call in ordinary speech the intellect, the reason, the spirit, the mind.... The Seele corresponds to the Greek psyche. It is the living principle, the vital spark ... and one with the body, soma. Biocentrism is a romanticist and anti-rationalist philosophy which poses the Soul as positive and the Spirit as negative. According to Biocentric theory, human beings had originally in primordial, ancient times lived ecstatically in accordance to the principle of Leben.

Biocentric philosophy also attacked Judeo-Christianity as a Logocentric religion opposed to Life and upheld ancient Paganism (which has a Dionysian character centered around vitalistic, feminine values) as the Biocentric religion of Life. 33

Biocentrism is the exact opposite of a principle. It extols brute animal life above proper human life. The admission that biocentrism is explicitly “feminine” says it all. It is the philosophical ideal of the neo-pagan.

Political Theory

Carl Schmitt’s philosophy began with the concept of the political,[?] which was differentiated from politics? in the normal sense and was based on the distinction between friend and enemy. The political exists wherever there exists an enemy, a group which is different and holds different interests, and with whom there is a possibility of conflict.

Sovereignty is the power to decide the state of exception, and thus, sovereign is he who decides on the exception.

Another notable argument made by Schmitt was that true democracy is not liberal democracy, in which a plurality of groups are treated equally

under a single state, but a unified, homogenous state in which leaders' decisions express the will of the unified people.

Democracy requires, therefore, first homogeneity and second, if the need arises, the elimination or eradication of heterogeneity.

Ultimately, the party system displaces the friend-enemy into the bosom society itself: each party sees the other as the enemy. That inhibits rational political discourse within democracies and makes the quest for the common good more difficult.

Philosophy of War The conservatives viewed universal peace as unrealistic and accepted the inevitableness of war.

[Spengler] warned that if Europeans adopted the pacifist ideal, non-Europeans would wage war and rule the world: Strong and unspent races are not pacifistic. To adopt such a position is to abandon the future, for the pacifist ideal is a static, terminal condition that is contrary to the basic facts of existence

Schmitt also critiqued the notion among liberals and Marxists of the claim to fight for universal humanity, for such a notion dehumanizes one's enemy, essentially declaring him to be an outlaw of humanity; and a war can thereby be driven to the most extreme inhumanity. Schmitt especially held in high regard the system of limited and civilized warfare developed by Europeans since the Middle Ages, which allowed the avoidance of excesses.

Werner Sombart wrote of the difference between nations whose dominant character is marked by the Trader type (exemplified by the English) and the Hero type (exemplified by the Germans). The former is marked by utilitarianism, materialism, individualism, and commercialism, while the latter is marked by altruism, the willingness to sacrifice, orientation towards duty, anti-individualism, and contempt for materialism

Arthur Moeller van den Bruck In the next part of the book, Mr Tudor provided us with some interesting ideas from the Conservatives themselves. What follows is a small selection of those ideas.

Young peoples, which included Germany, Russia, and America, possessed a high amount of vitality, hard work, will-to-power, strength, and energy. Old peoples, which included Italy, England, and France, were saturated, highly developed, valued happiness over work, and generally had a lower amount of energy and vitality.

Moeller van den Bruck actually proposed an alliance between Germany, Russia, and America. Obviously, that never happened.

He had a peculiar idea of race which presented a dichotomy between *Rasse des Blutes* (Race of the Blood), which refers to the common biological concept of race, and *Rasse des Geistes* (Race of the Spirit), which refers to psychological or spiritual character which is not hereditarily determined.

We have no idea why Mr Tudor considers that view “peculiar”.

Secondly, the nations which Spengler claimed constituted the West had powerful differences between each other, especially in terms of being young and old, which affected whether they would rise or decline, as well as cultural differences. Moeller wrote that due to these significant differences there was clearly no homogeneous Occident and for that reason alone there can be no homogeneous decline . . . the English and French nations were old? but shrewd and politically experienced, while Germany was young? and vigorous but had behaved in an inexperienced and impetuous manner.

Comment: losing has consequences

Revolutions cannot transform a nation because the past customs, traditions, and values of a nation cannot ever simply be totally brushed aside ... Materialism and rationalism “embraces everything except what is vital” ... Higher spiritual forces and ideas guided his actions”.

Comment: How to recognize them?

the proletarian is a proletarian by his own desire. Thus the proletariat in the Marxian sense was not a product of his position in capitalist society, but merely of “the proletarian consciousness.”

Along with the idea of the spirit of the race, this recognition of the role of caste aligns Moeller van den Bruck with some of Evola’s ideas.

Othmar Spann Spann is one of the more Traditional thinkers. Besides his concern with the social whole over the individual, he looked to the Nordic-Roman Tradition of the Middle Ages as the model of a healthy social order.

Spann essentially taught the value of nationality, of the social whole over the individual, of religious (specifically Catholic) values over materialistic values, and advocated the model of a non-democratic, hierarchical, and corporatist state as the only truly valid political constitution

It is the fundamental truth of all social science ... that not individuals are the truly real, but the whole, and that the individuals have reality and existence only so far as they are members of the whole.? This concept, which is at the core of Spann’s sociology, is not a denial of the existence of the individual person, but a complete rejection of individualism; individualism being that ideology which denies the existence and importance of supra-individual realities.

Because he also believed that the German nation was intellectually superior to all other nations, Spann also believed that Germans had a special duty to lead Europe out of the crisis of liberal modernity and to a healthier order similar to that which had existed in the Middle Ages

Spann attempted to formulate a conception of race which was in accordance with the Christian conception of the human being, which took into account not only his biology but also his psychological and spiritual being. This is why Spann rejected the common conception of race as a biological entity, for he did not believe that racial types were derived from biological inheritance, just as he did not believe an individual person's character was set into place by heredity... The material or physical substance and appearance is shaped by the immaterial, pre-material, or super-material substance ... Race is not determined by biological inheritance but by the spirit, which holds a social and historical dimension, and thus is formed by the spiritual community.

Of course not. That is not just the "Christian conception" of the human being, but the actual human being apart from any conceptions. A human being is a physical, psychological, and spiritual composite; that must be part of any intelligent thought. If biological race is primary, then there would be no cultural decay or decline. Nations decline spiritually before they decline materially.

The principles of the True State, on the other hand, were metahistorical and eternally valid, because they were derived not from material reality, but from the supra-sensual and transcendent reality, from the Divine order. Spann regarded the Holy Roman Empire as the best historical reference for the True State.

Spann expected the "subordination of the intellectually inferior under their intellectual betters". With universal education, however, the belief arises that one man's opinion is as good as another's.

The state would be led by a powerful elite whose members would be selected from the upper levels of the hierarchy based on their merit; it was essentially a meritocratic aristocracy... Another defining characteristic of the elite of the True State was its spiritual character. The leadership received its legitimacy not only from its intellectual superiority and its power, but from its possession of valid spiritual content... Furthermore, the leadership must be guided by their devotion to Divine laws and animated by Christian spirituality, which inherently rejects rationalistic and materialistic thought, asserting the primacy of the metaphysical, transcendent reality

Such views made Spann unpopular both with the Nazis and with the liberals. Edgar Jung also took up the theme:

The phenomenal forms that mature in time are always new, but the great principles of order (mechanical or organic) always remain the same. Therefore if we look to the Middle Ages for guidance, finding there the great form, we are not only not mistaking the present time but apprehending it more concretely as an age that is itself incapable of seeing behind the scenes... neither Fascism nor National Socialism were precursors to the reestablishment of the True State but rather simply another manifestation of the liberal, individualistic, and secular tradition that had emerged from the French Revolution.? Fascism and National Socialism were not guided by a reference to a Divine power and were still infected with individualism, which he believed showed itself in the fact that their leaders were guided by their own ambitions and not a duty to God or a power higher than themselves.

Hans Freyer

Tönnies's work established a fundamental distinction between *Gemeinschaft* (Community) and *Gesellschaft* (Society), a distinction which Freyer and many other German intellectuals would

agree with. According to this concept, *Gemeinschaft* consists of the organic relations and a sense of connection and belonging which arise as a result of natural will, while *Gesellschaft* consists of mechanical or instrumental relations which are consciously established and thus the result of rational will... The community (*Gemeinschaft*) thus designates a social entity which is based upon solidarity, bonding, a sense of connectedness and interdependence; it means belonging to a supra-individual whole on a deep spiritual level.

Hans Freyer's cultural philosophy began with the theory of the *Volk* (people or ethnicity) as the primary cultural entity, and the reality and importance of cultural particularism. Drawing from the German philosophical tradition, Freyer argued that the *Volk* was the collective entity from which particular cultures emerged, which bore the imprint of a particular *Volksgeist* (folk spirit) or collective spirit of the people.

It is here [at the *Volkstum*] that all the talk of race originates and has its truth. When one objects that this is pure biology, that after all spiritual matters cannot be derived from their natural basis, or when one objects that there are no pure races, these objections fail to grasp the concept of race that is a component of the new worldview. Race is understood not in the sense of mere biology but rather as the organic involvement of contemporary man in the concrete reality of his *Volk*,

people in modern times held an awareness of the existence of the multiplicity of human cultures and their historical foundations. This awareness caused many modern people to feel an uncertainty about the full validity of their own culture, something which served as a factor in the loss of a sense of meaning in their own traditions and therefore a loss of a sense of personal meaning in their culture. That is, a loss of that sense of guidance and value in one's own traditions which was more common in ancient and

Medieval societies, where human beings tended to recognize only their own culture as valid.

His new conservatism also held Christian religiosity at its center, emphasizing the direct experience of the faith in Christ, rather than the institutional body of the church

Oswald Spengler Since Spengler is much better known than the others, I will just provide this quote:

In his critique, Evola pointed out that one of the major flaws in Spengler's thought was that he lacked any understanding of metaphysics and transcendence, which embody the essence of each genuine Culture. Spengler could analyze the nature of Civilization very well, but his irreligious views caused him to have little understanding of the higher spiritual forces which deeply affected human life and the nature of cultures, without which one cannot clearly grasp the defining characteristic of Culture.

Identity As Virgil noted in the Aeneid, it took a lot to form the Roman people. What this means is the Identity is not given a priori, but rather it must be created. There is an essence, or possibility of manifestation, and the manifestation itself which occurs in time and space. Since the mass of people are passive consumers of "culture", the true creators and bearers of culture are necessarily few.

Posted on 2015-09-14 by Cologero

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2015-09-27 at 05:06 said:

Wonderful stuff. I had never heard of Edgar Jung or Othmar Spann, but their views certainly seem to be close to my own concerning the proper institution of Christian autocracy and the race of the spirit.

“The state would be led by a powerful elite whose members would be selected from the upper levels of the hierarchy based on their merit; it was essentially a meritocratic aristocracy”

This should not be unfamiliar to Tudor. From what I have read, Corneliu Codreanu had this exact same conception. He rejected hereditary monarchy and instead favored an elective position determined by an elite caste. I think I'm going to pen a discussion of this view to coincide with the date of the Captain's martyrdom. It's an interesting debate hereditary vs. elective. I'll have to see more of Jung and Spann.

I really hope Tudor, being Romanian, could help get some translated works of Nichifor Crainic available. He was extremely influential in Interwar Romania as a political theorist and theologian, but literally nothing is available in English.

Political Prisoner on 2015-10-06 at 10:24 said:

It would be interesting to see how Christians reconcile war or the just war concept with Jesus' sermon in Matthew 5 on the non-resistance to evil. Matthew 5 makes perfectly clear that all of the militarism and crusading during the Middle Ages on was inherently anti-Christian, and that none of Jesus' teachings, which were to be taken literally as with the early martyrs, were to be violated in the least. What has manifested under the Catholic church therefore cannot be called Christianity but a satanic parody of such. Rather it would seem that “liberal” pacifism is much more attuned to his teachings than conservative “toughness”.

Cologero on 2015-10-06 at 21:20 said:

If the topic of the just war teaching is so interesting to you, then I suggest you review the relevant literature.

In any case, your comment has nothing to do with the post. Comments should follow the rules of cross-examination and deal only with what was said or suggested in the post.

Unfortunately, you misunderstand Gornahoor's purpose, which is to explore Tradition including its social structures, metaphysical principles, and esoteric teachings, with the ultimate aim being its possible restoration. We are not promoting any specific religious teachings, although we will use them to illustrate the manifestations of Tradition. We focus on the Medieval tradition for the practical matter that it is closer to us in time, customs, language, etc., so presumably it will be easier to grasp for the modern mind seeking to understand.

Now the authors that primarily interest us – Guenon, Evola, Coomaraswamy – all agree that the European Middle Ages, along with its spiritual teachings, constituted a valid tradition. If you don't understand why that is so, then you have no understanding of any traditions at all. Besides, we have expended considerable effort in justifying that judgment.

I can provide you some material for self-study that may help you on your spiritual journey to liberation from your self-imposed prison.

We agree with Charles Maurras, at least in principle although not in all specifics:

What our fathers did through custom and feeling, we ourselves pursue it through reason and will, with the assurance and clarity of science.

What you see as a ‘Satanic parody’, other, more intelligent pagans see something else. For example, Evola wrote:

we see Christianity becoming Roman with Catholicism: purifying itself of its original anarchic, universalistic, and humanitarian aspects, and giving rise, in the Middle Ages, to a civilization that is characteristic of the type we articulated: hierarchical, tied to traditions of caste and blood, interspersed with initiatic elements

And this one, again quoting Maurras:

All my favorite ideas – order, tradition, discipline, hierarchy, authority, continuity, unity, work, family, corporation, decentralization, autonomy, organization of workers – had been preserved and perfected by Catholicism.

Here are some quick bullet points for your consideration (all these topics have been developed in various posts).

- We reject the doctrine of “Sola Scriptura”, so your out of context biblical quotes prove little
- The spiritual authority has the sole prerogative to decide on the final meaning of revealed texts. On this both Guenon and Evola agree. See Donoso Cortes on why it is necessary for a stable society to settle infinite debates.
- A man should normally follow the tradition of his land and ancestors. This is tied in with notions of fidelity, loyalty, piety, duty and so on. Your implication that your ancestors were idiots who followed a “satanic parody” of true tradition is a truly contemptible notion. Shame on you.

V on 2015-10-11 at 10:44 said:

@Political Prisoner.

This issue regarding violence and Christianity has been addressed over and over again. I think maybe the original teaching may have been lost somewhere in Protestant deviations and that

is why so many people no longer know it. The teachings of Jesus regarding non-violence and pacifism are meant to be taken as behavior designed for the individual, not as for the nation or the state or the military. In other words, Jesus's teachings are of a personal nature, not of a national or collective nature. They are something for individual people to follow in daily interactions, they are not meant to be followed by nations in war. In any case, I think Cologero makes a good point.

14.5 Evola Viewed from the Right

This is the first part of a multipart review of Julius Evola's book *Il fascismo visto dalla destra*. It will continue sporadically and I truly hope to get to the actual book in one of the subsequent parts. In quoting the text, I will usually rely on my own translations.

*Arktos Media*⁷ recently provided an English translation of Evola's *Fascism Viewed from the Right*, actually Fascism viewed in hindsight from the point of view of Tradition. To review such a work, we will accept Evola's definition:

Ideally, the concept of a true Right, what we mean by the Right, must defined in terms of the forces and traditions that acted formatively on a group of nations, and sometimes also on supernational units, before the French Revolution, before the accession of the Third Estate and the world of the masses, and before bourgeois and industrial culture, with all its consequences and effects of actions and concordant reactions that have led to the current chaos ...

Hence, Evola fails or succeeds to the extent that he follows through on this project, and this requires that he defines the forces and traditions

⁷<http://www.arktos.com/>

prior to the French Revolution. Specifically, at that time there were the three estates of the realm: the clergy, the nobility, and commoners. So we should expect to see how those estates were reconstituted during Italy's Fascist era. However, Evola adds a little twist with an import he did not consider. He adds:

[the actions that led] to all that that threatens to destroy the little that still remains of the civilization of Europe and European prestige.

If we take "Europe" in the broad sense to include its extensions in North America and the South Pacific, that is simply false. European culture dominates virtually the entire globe, except for Muslim countries, from political systems, philosophy, law, science, technology, global capitalism, financial dominance, and then to sports, art, and all other manifestations of popular culture. For example, apart from the recent introduction of Asian martial arts (which unfortunately have pushed out wrestling), all Olympic sports derive from Europe. This is not the place to detail this extensively, but European culture and prestige is more dominant than ever, especially since it is freely accepted and not imposed through colonization. At one time, I used to support the Free Tibet movement as it represented a theocratic, patriarchal, hierarchical society; however, the Dalai Lama now plans to introduce European style parliamentary government to Tibet should he get the chance.

To explain the point of this digression: since European culture and prestige are not in decline, there is no sense of crisis and certainly no fear of an impending chaos among contemporary power holders. That would be true only if viewed from the Right, which regards contemporary European culture as anti-Europe, not really Europe. Those on the Left, on the other hand, consider modernity and its fruits of universal democracy, general literacy, science, technology, sexual liberation, free thoughts, to be the true Europe which cast off the ignorance, supernaturalism, oppression, racism, etc., of the previous era.

I bring this up because most today, who claim to be of the Right, seem frustrated that no one seems to notice the “chaos” that they see. Of course, chaos cannot be “seen”, since it is not a presence, but rather the absence of order. It is that order that the Right seeks to restore, but it must be intuited and yet is hidden in broad daylight from those whose mode of being in the world is precisely to overturn the established order of things. Hence, a dialog is not possible and there is nothing left but the will to power; and we know who today has the superior will to power. This should refute the idea of any nationalism based on zoological ethnicity or “whiteness”; rather, an appeal to the soul or spirit is necessary. The values of the modern world, hence, need to be understood as the values of a particular estate, specifically, those of the third estate of the bourgeoisie and even of the fourth estate of the undifferentiated mass, as opposed to the estates of the Priests and Warriors.

Before continuing, let us get out of the way a couple of misleading translation errors. The “idea of force” (p. 78) is the translation of ‘idea-forza’ which is itself the translation of the French ‘idée-force’. That term is taken from Georges Sorel and refers to a “myth” that has the power to motivate men to action. Certainly it does not mean the “idea of force” and perhaps a “forceful idea” would be closer. The term itself means nothing in French or Italian; that is why the translations of Sorel into English leave it untranslated so that ‘idée-force’ is the better choice.

The other misleading translation, although it is explained correctly in the notes, is the use of ‘thoroughbred’ to translate ‘essere di razza’. That is certainly incorrect since thoroughbred refers to a breed of horse used for racing. Perhaps the translator meant to say ‘purebred’. but that is still incorrect, since the biological race is not the critical point for Evola. It is best to let it stand as ‘the elite is of race’, understood as Evola intended. Now Evola has claimed the origin of that expression was from the Romans, but I am not enough of a classicist to know the exact source. However, Oswald Spengler uses the term, although he means race in a

cultural, rather than a zoological, sense. So only the elite of a culture were truly “of race”.

In this introduction, I’ll also mention some inherent defects in his approach, one because of the nature of Fascism, the other due to Evola’s persistent prejudices. For the former, Fascism was not systematic, i.e., it was not derived from any ideological systematization, so there is an effort involved to extract its principles from what it was and not just from its texts. Moreover, I am not as sanguine as Evola about the possibility to cleanly separate the essential from the accidental or contingent.

To the extent that it did have an intellectual framework, that derived from the philosophy of Giovanni Gentile. Unfortunately, Julius Evola had a personal animus against Gentile, attributing ideas to Mussolini which were actually ghost-written by Gentile. Evola came of age within Fascism while Gentile was at the peak of his influence. In many ways the worldviews of the two Sicilians were similar, or at least had a family resemblance; perhaps Evola felt he need to create more distance in order to create his own sphere of influence. However, Gentile was a professor, bourgeois, and part of the high culture of Italy. These were antithetical to Evola. Although an Evolian critique of Gentile could have been of interest, I recommend instead reading this book in conjunction with the several books by James Gregor (who likewise harbored an animus against Evola) to get the full view of Fascism from the Right.

Evola points out an obvious, yet forgotten, fact that is more applicable to the USA than to Italy or Europe in general. In the USA, what is called “conservative” is actually “liberal” in historical terms. Specifically, it is the political system of the Third Estate, of the bourgeoisie, of “free enterprise” capitalism. Hence, in respect to the rule of the Priests and Warriors, it is actually on the “left”, a revolutionary idea. Only in relationship to socialism and communism can it be considered to be on the “right”, but only relatively, not absolutely or in principle. The true right,

therefore, is confusing to conservatives; on the one hand, it also opposes socialism, but on the other it seems alien. That is why American conservatives are so fickle on the so-called “social issues”, sometimes attached to them, and other times, wishing they would disappear from public discourse. Hence, when pushed, the conservatives eventually side with the socialists against the true right. That is why they always lose and only claim victory when the eventually adopt more and more values of the left.

In the USA, the so-called liberals are actually socialist. Most will deny this, but keep in mind that we are describing real relationships, not nominal. Anyone who opposes not only the Priests and Warriors, but the Bourgeoisie as well in favor of formerly marginalized groups are of the left, in reality, even if not nominally. That is why the left is constantly in fear of an alliance of the Church and the Military, to which they add corporations (the symbol of the bourgeoisie), often with the prefix of “evil”. The irony is that those groups hardly oppose the left any more, in fact, they are often at the forefront of promoting leftist ideas. Rather than a direct attack, the left prefers incentives, regulations, cultural domination, and even outright infiltration to shift the remnants of the three estates of the realm to the revolutionary side; hence, they have become useless as counter-revolutionary counterweights.

Hence, Evola’s project will also have to show how the Fascist system dealt with the economic domain. He points out that unified Italy, which had come into existence just a generation or two before Mussolini, was modeled on the French revolution and not any true right. Evola points out that Italy did not have an established aristocracy to represent a true right; on the other hand, there was no reign of terror as there had been in France. Evola does not point out that the right was dominated by the church at that time, which was opposed to the Italian republic.

An excellent point he made is the idea of the “loyal opposition”, which can have some merit within a parliamentary system. The purpose

of the opposition party is really to keep things honest, to offer sound criticism. The ruling and opposition parties both still support the state and its transcendent principles. Compare that with contemporary systems in which the various parties agree on no principles and are constantly trying to overturn the other. Hence, there is constant agitation as one party seeks to assert its dominance over the other, not just for power's sake, but rather to alter entire moral and social structures.

Evola wants to distinguish certain principles of Fascism from its specific manifestation in Italy during the twenty years under Mussolini. He explains:

Fascism has undergone a process of what can be called mythologizing. In regard to it, the attitude taken by most people has an emotional and irrational character, instead of a critical and intellectual one.

That may be true, so his appeal to rationalism over emotionalism makes sense. However, in the traditional point of view, there is a perspective that is higher than the "critical and intellectual one". Perhaps Mussolini is not a mythical figure, but the Leader was often mythologized. If we start from Guido De Giorgio's understanding, he acted quite literally as God's representative on earth. The Leader was revered as such from the Egyptian Pharaohs to Roman Empire. In some cases the Leader could even be understood as an avatar of God, such as, for example, Parashurama, who overturned the revolt of the Kshatriyas.

That is why one should take with caution Evola's assertion that "the two planes of principle and historical contingency are absolutely distinct." Of course, they are not "absolutely" distinct as though the plane of manifestation had an independent reality and was not itself the reflection of the spiritual plane. He means here the limited sense that the events of history cannot be understood simply as a judgment on the truth of principles; hence, Italy's defeat does not imply the invalidity of the principles of

Fascism, nor the truth of the political systems of the Allies. Hence, Evola intends to evaluate Fascism in a more limited way. He is hampered in this task in that Fascism did not start from a clearly formulated doctrine, but rather it developed in an organic way over time. Evola's task, then, is to extract the main principles while ignoring any stillborn intellectual offshoots.

In chapter III, Evola says that Fascism began as a "reaction" against the secular masonic state, which Evola describes as:

a state that on the whole lacked a myth in the positive sense, i.e., a superior animating and formative idea that could have made of it something more than a mere structure of public administration.

Against this, Fascism, Evola claimed, revived the idea of the state. Actually, the neo-idealism of Giovanni Gentile provided that revival, and it owed more than a little to Hegel. WWI awakened forces that "were intolerant of bourgeois Italy". These forces were a fortiori intolerant of the socialists who had opposed interventionism, so Fascism began to define itself as a movement of the counterrevolutionary right. As such, it opposed democracy, plutocracy, freemasonry, in short, the principles of the French Revolution. It is obvious now, a half century after Evola's book, that no major movement (i.e., one with any pretense of political power) of the so-called right would adopt any of that platform and would actually be appalled by it. Hence, the universal opprobrium attribute to Fascism or to any movement that smacks of it. So when Evola tries to extract what is "good" in Fascism, it won't be seen as universally good.

The first principle that Evola gets into is the idea of the state, which is given pre-eminence, both over the people and the nation. He quotes Mussolini:

Without the State there is no nation. There are merely human aggregates subject to all the disintegrations which history may

inflict upon them ... only the State gives structure to the people
... the nation is created by the State which gives the people a will
and thereby a real existence. [my translation]

Evola makes use here of the notion of hylomorphism, which has done so effectively in various contexts. Here, specifically, the “state” is the form and the people the “matter”, in a relation analogous to that between the soul and the body. The Fascist state, therefore, is the animating and organizing force; this is the opposite of the modern minimalist liberal state which protects the liberties of the individuals who inhabit a particular geographic region.

To perform its task, the Fascist state affirmed “authority, order, and justice”, and appealed to the Roman idea (“Romanity”). Evola describes it:

Fascism recalled the Roman idea as the supreme and specific integration of the myth of the new “strong and organic” political organism; Roman tradition was not merely rhetoric and tinsel, but an “idea of strength”.

Evola admired that audacious move, since it tried to build a bridge across the centuries, connecting Italy at that time to ancient Rome. Evola points out a problem in that the significance of the state differed on both sides of the bridge. Moreover, the virile ethics, severity, and discipline of the Romans may not have transferred so well to the Italians. This Evola marked as a defect and the attempts to re-assert Romanity were non-existent or ineffective. He points to the Institute of Roman Studies which was never more than mere erudition promoting the study of philology and archaeology, rather than an effective political, spiritual, and ethical force.

Evola concludes that in principle, the Fascist doctrine of the state is traditional. Evola’s next task is twofold: (1) to draw out the full implications of that doctrine and (2) to point out its deviations. To recap, the

state, in his view, is preeminent to both the people and the nation. He then contrasts the idea of the state to “society”, which represents the physical and vegetative side of the community. Doctrines based on society as such include theories of natural rights, contract theory, and democracy, including the people’s democracies of the communists.

Opposed to this social ideal, there is the political ideal which involves transcendence, rather than the materialistic and hedonistic concerns of the society. The problem of transcendence was never satisfactorily solved by Fascism.

The Bovine State Evola points out that the “impulse to self-transcendence can be repressed and silenced, but never completely eliminated, except in the extreme case of systematically degrading people into a bovine state.” I don’t think he realized how close that bovine state was. He pointed to the “blind, anarchic, and destructive” revolts of the youth as a sign of the ennui induced by the prosperity and comfort of the consumer society. But those days are long gone as these same youths are now the possessors of power. Yet, they have maintained the revolt as their ideal and have persisted in overturning one by one every previous customary and traditional notion of order.

The destructive aspects of the constant revolt are not immediately apparent, or else they are hidden and kept out of public discourse. Furthermore, it coopts that impulse among the young, since there is nothing left for the young, since revolt is public policy. When post-menopausal women are getting tattoos, nipple rings, and bikini waxes, the youth are forced to take things to absurd levels. Blind, anarchic, and destructive revolts are left to the proletariat who have been shut out of the bourgeois consumer culture and resent it. By the logic of revolt, such public behavior is beyond criticism.

The Mystique of Power Similar to Guido De Giorgio, Evola points out that “in traditional societies, there has always existed a certain liturgy or mystique of power and sovereignty that was an integral part of the system and which furnished a solution to the problem we have been addressing [i.e., the urge for transcendence],” but here a divergence appears. The natural objection is that the system takes on a religious significance, so that a secular state replaces religion, the normal object of transcendence. Evola denies the dualist notion that the state is secular; we can point out that idea is a modern notion. However, Evola traces its source to Jesus’ command to render unto Caesar, but would preclude the existence of any such idea of the state in Europe since Constantine.

So, the state depends on a spiritual charism and is thus more than a merely administrative and social system. This brings Evola to the relationship between Catholicism, the majority religion of the Italian people, and the Fascist state. Unfortunately, Evola’s distorted understanding of the proper roles of the Priests and the Warriors colors his analysis. He praises Mussolini’s occasional references to the Roman ideal, which was necessarily vague. De Giorgio’s larger view does not have such a problem since it has a place for the Priests in the traditional system, as the upholders of that tradition and the source of the charism of the state.

Clearly, if the existence of the Fascist state had depended on the replacement of the common religion with one that could only be partial, incomplete, and mostly forgotten, it would have been stillborn. The state, despite his claim, is not ultimate and does not have infinite capacity to form the people. Even by his logic, for the state to have a charism, then the religion necessarily precedes the state, ontologically and temporally. Nevertheless, Evola somehow has to demonstrate the spiritual foundation of the state as opposed to the secular and desacralized interpretations.

Nationalism One of the shortcomings, Evola says, is that the Fascist doctrine did not distinguish fully between nationalism and Tradition in

the higher sense. He described the former as “mediocre conservatism”, bourgeois, priggish, superficially Catholic, and conformist. As the nationalist elements were absorbed into Fascism, its ideals became blurred, and “nationalism” became identified as the “Right”. Evola traces the idea of nationalism to the principles of 1789, which were opposed to the traditional structures of the Middle Ages.

Curiously, this syncretism of nationalism, with a lip-service commitment to tradition, has become the hallmark of the so-called right in the USA. Neo-conservatism is often associated with the Jewish element, but that ignores the even stronger Catholic influence, or actually neo-Catholic, since their tradition does not reach beyond Vatican II. This nationalism accepts a large part of the modern liberal state, although it promotes the roles of the bourgeois money powers over the state’s more socialist tendencies. Beyond that, the nationalist right supports a vigorous foreign policy, even to the point of being jingoist. Nevertheless, nationalism is not an exclusively rightist tendency, since even the liberal state is nationalist. Although the USA has a federal rather than a national government, there has been an increasing tendency towards the latter. At its inception, a person regarded himself as the citizen of one of the states and owed his allegiance to it, but now schoolchildren pledge their allegiance to the federal government. This nationalist feeling is demonstrated in its holidays, which are mostly associated with wars and political figures; in pre-nationalist Europe, holidays used to be associated with religious celebrations.

Obviously, the emphasis on nationalism was unacceptable to Evola, since he regarded the state as superior to the nation. I’ll leave it to readers how this may apply to such contemporary movements like “white nationalism” and various “identitarian” initiatives, which often claim some sort of affiliation with Evola. The latter are really nationalist movements since their source of identity is a common nation, in a zoological sense. Their fault is not the desire for a unity, but the belief that that unity will

arise from below, democratically as it were, rather than from above, as a spiritual ideal and the state as the organizing principle. As for “white nationalism”, it is simply an oxymoron.

Totalitarianism Evola next makes the distinction between the totalitarian, which he associates with Stalinesque type states, and the organic state of Tradition. The central authority can become degenerate when it tries to control everything, as in the Soviet Union. The Traditional system is based on spiritual values, the importance of the personality, and the hierarchical principle.

The traditional state is “organic”, “differentiated”, and “articulated”. That is, the state coordinates forces, making them a part of a larger unity; however, in themselves, they have a certain amount of liberty. The organic state depends on the voluntary loyalty of the hierarchical levels beneath it, so it does not need to maintain an iron control. Nevertheless, the state is all powerful and ignores the “fetish of the rule of law” in cases of necessity. Of course, that can cut both ways; presumably the positive law of the state is not “all powerful”, since it must be consistent with the transcendent law.

The organic state is divided into regions and smaller subdivisions; however, these must be natural groupings and not merely administrative structures, as apparently was the case in Italy. That would be odd, considering that the different regions had different histories, cultures, languages, and even cuisine.

Evola says the essential task of the true state is to create a general climate in which

liberty is always the fundamental factor that can take form in a way that is virtually spontaneous and which can function in the right way with a minimum of rectifying interventions.

The Ethical State So the state has three essential roles:

1. It is a higher principle or power that gives form to the nation.
2. It creates a general climate
3. It is the principle of a new way of life

The obvious question, therefore, is how does the state perform these tasks? Evola claims that it is more like a catalyst; he has in mind something like this from the Tao Te Ching: 'The highest type of ruler is one of whose existence the people are barely aware.' Obviously, that is hardly the case for Fascist Italy, since the state was ubiquitous and unavoidable.

In nations with a long history, such as China, roles (1) and (2) may be very natural. However, (3) is of a totally different order. In ancient China, why would there be the need for a new way of life? However, in Italy during the period in question, when it was still amorphous, (3) was necessarily the most essential role. That goal was to be achieved through the "Ethical State", proposed by Giovanni Gentile.

Here, it seems to me, Evola reveals one of his irrational prejudices, such as described by Rene Guenon in his correspondence with Guido De Giorgio. The ethical state in this conception is a moral reality that "realizes itself in the free and ethical will" of the citizens based on a "religious conception of life." I don't see how this differs substantially from Evola's ideals of liberty and "spiritual values". Nevertheless, Evola is quite critical of Gentile.

As the first minister of education under Mussolini, it was Gentile's task to reform education; so Evola's complaint about reaching into the schools make no sense. Gentile restored religious education to the schools, returned the crucifix to the classrooms. There is a free ebook from Amazon with Gentile's speech to educators; the tone is nothing like what Evola describes. In many ways, they align, since Gentile emphasized the will, loyalty, the ascetic life, and so on.

Another task of the educator is to maintain the continuity of the cultural life of the nation; for this, Gentile was ideally suited due to his

expansive knowledge of Italian art, literature, philosophy, and history. The life of the soul of a nation cannot be neglected. In this regard, Evola was markedly deficient and showed little interest in art, music, literature and all other aspects of High Culture. The notable exceptions were his attachments to Futurism and Dada, both really anti-art and anti-poetry. They are hardly suitable to educate the child or to pass on culture, which is really the meaning of “general climate”. Dada is meaningless in itself and can only be defined in relation to true poetry.

The fundamental point is that if the religious authority and the ethical state do not educate the people, then they will be subject to the random influences of special interests. Evola is inconsistent on this point, both expecting the state to form the nation, but to do it from afar somehow, as if by osmosis.

Sexuality Evola objected to the “Pronatalist Campaign”, a Fascist program to increase the birth rate, on the grounds that mere quantity does not make a strong nation. This applies to the proletariat whose only contribution to society is their progeny. As birth rates increased and death rates decreased, population increased leading to increased massification. That occurs to the extent that the masses cannot be integrated into the state, or said another way, the state is unsuccessful in their “formation”. On the other hand, as we discussed in an earlier post about Pareto⁸, a strong peasantry keeps the people racially strong. In the years subsequent to Evola’s death, which he clearly did not foresee, the decreasing birth rates of Europe is making them weaker, not stronger. This is not unlike the Spartans whose low birth rate led to their slow extinction.

Concomitant with that, Evola brings up the topic of sexual morality. Italy, at that time, prohibited divorce, abortion, pornography, even contraception, all part of the general category of “sexual morality”. Evola attributes that to the bourgeois aspect of Fascism. As the counterpoint,

⁸See Section 15.6 in this book.

Evola appeals to the “liberty of the person”. If he means that what someone does in private is not the concern of the state is one thing, actually hardly worth mentioning; however, if he means the hypersexualization of society as exists in the contemporary Western states, that is quite another.

Sexual desire is undifferentiated and egalitarian, and when that is made into the standard of behavior, the hierarchical society Evola desires becomes impossible. E. Michael Jones, in his historical studies like *Libido Dominandi*, demonstrates the close relationship between sexual liberation and political control. The sexualization of the West does not lead to more liberty, but precisely to its opposite. Evola seems to recognize this, but without putting it in this context:

A people and a nation will go adrift or be reduced to a labile mass in the hands of demagogues skilled in the art of acting on the pre-personal and most primitive strata of the human being.

Sexual desire certainly falls within that strata, so the ethical state, in its function of forming a free people, will want to channel that sexual energy to avoid the dangers expressed above. Hence, it is not necessarily the reflection of a puritanical attitude. Actually, for the proper warrior attitude that Evola praises so much, we can point to Marcus Aurelius, who characterized the sex act as the rubbing together of membranes to produce a spasm. Moreover, as we demonstrated in *Family Values*⁹, the Germanics that he admired were not so “sexually liberated”, so it has nothing to do with “bourgeois” values.

The Mass Mind Evola concludes this chapter with Plato’s notion that the person without a sovereign within, will require one without. The related idea today is the distinction between the notions of “freedom from” and “freedom to”, i.e., negative and positive liberty. When modern

⁹See Section 15.4 in this book.

man has cast off the fetters, he does not know what to do, given “the lack of direction and the absurdity of modern society”. He continues:

In truth, personality and liberty can be conceived only on the basis of the liberation of the individual from naturalistic, biological, and primitively individualistic bonds that characterize the pre-state and pre-political forms in a purely social and utilitarian-contractual sense.

Evola makes an interesting distinction between anagogical and catagogical transcendence, the former toward the higher and the latter toward the lower. The anagogical means that the individual transcends himself, moving beyond his own personal interests.

The catagogical possibility

happens precisely in the “mass States”, in collectivizing and demagogic movements which are fundamentally passionate and sub-rational, and can also give to the individual the illusory, momentary sensation of an exalted, intense life, moreover such sensations conditioned by a regression, by a diminution of the personality and true liberty.

With this, Evola exposes the attraction of Leftism: by diminishing the personality in the excitement of the mass movement, the leftist feels alive and with a purpose. I need not go into detail here, but readers can find abundant examples of this in the many mass demonstrations and movements today. They are always vulgar, emotional, illogical, even when the cause may seem just. It is nearly impossible to communicate in depth with anyone who has made that catagogical descent into the mass mind.

Julius Evola asserts that “a true Right without the monarchy ends up deprived of its natural centre of gravity and crystallisation”, since the Crown in traditional societies is the principle reference point. Hence, in

any situation in which a Right takes form, its function needs to correspond to that of the system characterized by loyalty to the crown. In the context of Italian Fascism, Evola undertakes this analysis. (For Evola's more general view on monarchy, please see *The Meaning and Function of Monarchy*¹⁰).

Even for Mussolini, the monarchy was the fundamental element of national unity. Evola brings up an interesting side point. After 1943, the Germans established the Salo Republic in northern Italy with Mussolini as its head. Since it no longer had a relationship to the monarchy, there is nothing of interest for Evola in it. Hence from this comment, we may presume that Evola's fundamental loyalty was to the Crown, and not to Fascism in itself.

For those unfamiliar with Italian history, Mussolini did not seize power, but received it from the King. In the remainder of Chapter V, Evola argues, with historical examples, for the legitimacy of a titular king while the state is actually under the management of a strong leader. We defer to his judgment in this area. He concludes with an interesting personal revelation. After the invasion of Italy by the Allies, Evola escaped to Germany, where he was spent time at Hitler's headquarters in Rastenburg, and was there when Mussolini arrived prior to establishing the Salo Republic. From Evola's perspective, that republic—detached from the kingdom—was a degeneration and a regression, based solely on Mussolini as an individual. Nevertheless, he conceded that there was some basis for those who felt loyalty to Fascism. Interestingly, Evola complained about the vulgar anti-monarchical attitude of the National Socialists, that made them more like revolutionaries than representatives of the Right.

Evola next points out that the role of Fascism, after its initial revolutionary phase, should have been the reestablishment of "normality and unity". An obstacle was the Fascist party itself, which became a state within a state. A true state is not ruled by parties, which are restricted

¹⁰See Section 8.2 in this book.

to democratic, parliamentary regimes. Hence, even a “one party” state makes no sense, since it asserts that the “part” wants to be the “whole”. Evola claims that instead of a “party”, what was need was an “order”, like the nobility, that embodied the “idea” of the state.

Fascism could not overcome its origins as a party with democratic ideas and its desire to become a mass party. Instead of consolidating and purifying itself, making membership a “difficult privilege”, it extended membership horizontally. This allowed in superficial adherents, opportunists, and conformists. Instead, Evola wished that the creation of an Order should have been the goal after gaining power.

Interlude

There is little point to publishing or reviewing this book, unless we can extract some contemporary lessons from it. First of all, it is clear, as he often insisted, that Evola was not a Fascist since his first loyalty was to King and country. Fascism was merely a contingency that should have led to the establishment of a traditional state, as it faded away as a party in favour of a superior order. Obviously, things did not work out that way.

We also see, in the minor resurgences of most soi-disant rightist groups, often under the guise of identitarian movements, the same party attitude. This is little attention paid to “quality”, as participants are accepted willy-nilly, with wildly varying spiritual, political, ethical, and ethnic world conceptions. The hope, apparently, is that they share a common goal and the differences will somehow work out after the “revolution”. That is quite far from what Evola has described. When personal bonds have been established, it can be difficult to make the decision to exclude certain members, i.e., to purify the movement. However, sometimes there is no place for sentimentality.

Spiritual Conclusion Curiously, Evola has left out of the discussion anything concerning the spiritual atmosphere of the country, seeing in the King alone the symbol of its unity. In Evola's conception, the *dux*, or leader, receives his legitimacy from the King, or *rex*. However, he neglects to point out that the legitimacy of the king himself derives from the spiritual authority.

In contrast, we can consider Maurras' solution. Although non-religious and a Positivist, he recognized that the real France was the creation of the 40 Catholic kings of France. Like Evola, he agreed that the King was the symbol of the unity and identity of the nation. As a thought experiment, you could compare how the contemporary Frenchman regards what it means to be "French", keeping in mind the Republic's commitment to the secular state and universal human rights.

For Maurras, there was little difference between the Catholic and Positivist France, since they were, or would be, based on the natural law. Hence, the laws of the state would generally be acceptable to both groups. Since then, and considering Benoist's early adherence to Maurras and then his subsequent rejection, there has been nothing to replace it. Without a king, without a real religious tradition, without a natural law, on what basis can a new state arise? The only options are some sort of zoological camaraderie or else despair and nihilism. Yes, I suppose there is also "wishing and hoping".

The closest example today, I believe, is in Iran. There the Supreme Leader is the religious authority, who has the power of veto and sets the general direction of affairs. The President would have the duties of running the government. This is analogous to Evola's distinction between the *rex* and the *dux*, except in this case, there is a legitimate spiritual authority. Certainly, this organization would have little appeal in the West. Nevertheless, the Pope used to play a similar role, but that was rejected over time, often in very bloody ways.

Julius Evola concludes Chapter VI of *Fascism Viewed from the Right* with the criticism that the Party was not selective in terms of who was admitted into it. In Chapter VII, he deals with another problem with the system, that of the cult of the leader. First of all, in some ways it is too democratic for Evola since it depends on the “applause of the people”.

Rather, the traditional state relies on an anagogic, or mystical, climate. On the contrary, the Fascist system depends on stirring up the lower parts of the human soul, not unlike a criticism I made recently. He explains (this translation differs slightly from the English text):

Such a [anagogic] climate cannot be obtained with an enthusiasm that can, in certain cases, reach the level of fanaticism and collective passion, although based on the sub-personal aspects of man as mass-man and on the art of firing him up against every other possible form of individual reaction.

Despite the intensity of such feelings, it has only an ephemeral character which differs profoundly from the formative force from above of a true tradition. That is why things in Italy and Germany could unravel so quickly. Evola points out, too, that the democratic nations also rely on propaganda, demagoguery, and the fabrication of public opinion. However, he does not explain why the liberal democracies have been able to last longer than the “ephemeral” axis states of Europe.

In the traditional state, the leader has a natural authority rather than the formless authority of the dictator who depends on arousing the emotional and irrational elements of men. The leader is almost of a different nature from other men. Perhaps he meant here a “supernatural” authority. Curiously, he points to recent popes who have come down to the level of the people. Here, Evola was referring to Pope John XXIII, not Paul VI as in the notes. Of course, since then, popes have dropped more and more of the regalia and ceremonies that used to set them apart and have opted instead to identify with the “people”. Some commentators make

much of this; for example, they claim that more people saw Pope Francis in Brazil than saw the Rolling Stones. Unfortunately, they haven't noticed that the youths at World Youth Day live more like the Rolling Stones than like the pope.

Mussolini believed he was one of the great individuals who would arise, according to Oswald Spengler, at the "Decline of the West" (the translation oddly says "Sunset of the West"). The corrective to this situation would require a superior tradition and a different chrism. Yes, that is the point, but Evola does not offer us much. What is the tradition? Which spiritual authority would administer the chrism? These are the issues that need to be discussed at the present time.

Next, Evola addresses the military component of Fascism. Mussolini tried to instill a warrior ethos in the Italian people based on the virtues of obedience, sacrifice, discipline, and dedication. Clearly that is a fool's errand, since you can't "instill" such qualities en masse. He opposed the bourgeois spirit. This Evola can agree with and he points out that the army and the monarchy have always constituted the essential pillars of the true state before the revolutions of the Third Estate. He left out the spiritual authority as one of the "essential pillars".

Evola concludes this discussion with the idea of public service as honour. To accentuate this, public officials wore uniforms. Here, also, he gets a dig in against Giovanni Gentile's ideal of the ethical state. Gentile did not write anything much different from the Duce. He, too, advocated discipline, sacrifice, courage, and so on. As the education minister, he had to develop a school program to teach such virtues. Otherwise, by what means could they be "instilled" in the people? By way of contrast, apparently, Evola describes his own set of values which sound pretty good to certain types, although most people would consider them cold and even inhuman.

They include in the first place discipline, the sense of honour, active impersonality, relationships of responsibility, command, and

obedience [not “responsible relationships ...”], dislike of small talk and “discussions”, a virile solidarity with true freedom as its starting point — freedom for doing something that is worth the effort and that carries you beyond the stagnation of bourgeois, “prosperous”, and vegetative existence.

Fascism, as the conscious agent of the state, next had to confront the parliamentary system that it had inherited. Evola put it this way (in Chapter VIII):

The parliamentary system had sunk to a level where the politician had been replaced by the party hack, where everyone could see a system of incompetence, corruption and irresponsibility.

Since parties could replace each other through elections, there could be no stability to the state. Evola names three principles of the problem:

- The electoral principle in general
- The representative principle
- The political principle of hierarchy

Evola is quite caustic about the principle representation which is based on universal suffrage and the principle of “one man, one vote.” As such, it is based merely on quantity and the individual as undifferentiated mass man. Evola opposes this individual to the “person” who has “a specific dignity, a unique quality, and differentiated traits”. Interestingly, Evola provides examples in “a great thinker, a prince of the Church, an eminent jurist or sociologist, the commander of an army”, etc.

Such persons should have the public interest in mind, whereas the individual has only personal interests or, at best, the interests of his group. Since in modern democracies, the transcendent is moved out of the public sphere and can be no more than a personal interest. Hence, the appeal

is always made to economic interests. In the democratic system, the battle of parties, each of which aims for the conquest of power, leads to a “totally chaotic and inorganic situation.”

In theory, the democratic system sounds fair, since open and free “debate” should lead to the “best” policy. Ultimately, however, quantity always dictates policy regardless of the quality of the debate. This is the representative principle based on egalitarianism, individualism, and quantity.

However, Evola points out that in a traditional society there is a different representative system based not on individuals, but rather on the different bodies or functions within it. Specifically, these would comprise the “corporations” (more like a trade association than a business venture), the nobility, the scholars, and the army. Evola glaringly omits the “Church” or the spiritual authority.

What distinguishes this system is the hierarchical principle which overrides any decision based purely on the quantity of votes. For example, the spiritual authority would demand protection for its role in performing rites and offering education. This is not a “theocracy”, i.e., the rule of priests, since rule is still reserved to the aristocracy or warrior caste. The producing caste rules itself, subject to the warrior and spiritual authorities, through the various corporations. In the principle of subsidiarity, decision making is made as diffuse as reasonable and effective. Of course, Evola does not go into all the details here, since his primary interest is in how closely Fascism adhered to this system.

Like the traditional system, the Fascist system also relied on corporations, which replaced political parties. Instead of endless debate (note the influence of Donoso Cortes here), ideally the corporations should arrive at decisions through coordinated labor as well as technical and objective criteria. In this, Fascism was more or less successful. Italy did, however, emerge from basically third world status when Mussolini assumed control to somewhat of an industrial power twenty years later. The activity

of the producing class is ignored by the “traditional” authors, but, despite Evola, it is legitimate for the state to take an interest in questions of the economy and labor relations.

Evola next criticizes the so-called “ethical state”, a coinage of Giovanni Gentile, regarding it as “the dross, the unessential, and invalid part of Fascism.” That is absurd, as Evola lets his personal opinions intrude, since, for better or worse, Gentile was the philosopher of Fascism. The goal of the State was to create the nation, thereby giving the people a will and effective existence. How else does the State do that except through education? Gentile uses the term “ethical”, not as schoolmarmish moralism, but in the philosophical sense of relating to the Will. Hence, education is necessary and of high priority.

Evola was probably objecting to the role of the Church in education. As Minister of Education, Gentile returned the crucifix to the classroom and made religious education part of the curriculum. Yet one of the roles of the spiritual authority is indeed education, so there is nothing at all untraditional about that. Evola often complains about the lack of a full spiritual content in Fascism, because of its relationship to the “dominant religion”, but it is certainly not the place of the temporal power to fabricate religions out of the air.

Posted on 2013-07-16 by Cologero

* * *

Avery Morrow on 2013-07-23 at 10:27 said:

“Without the State there is no nation.”

This is precisely the inverse of the truth, and if that sounds like a political or loaded statement, try knocking it down a few levels: “Without City Hall there is no city,” or “Without the Bureau of Indian Affairs there are no Indians.” Evola shouldn’t have been surprised that Fascism could not engineer itself into being “organic”. Ancient Rome never needed an Institute of Roman Studies.

Saladin on 2013-07-23 at 13:39 said:

I agree with you Avery! The only point of contention that I have always had with the Maestro has been his total defense of the State. Granted, his state is more nuanced than what you have described, the Hegalian influence on Evola was not entirely wholesome. Here I side with Nietzsche when in *Thus Spake Zarathustra* he likens it to a monster.

Logres on 2013-07-23 at 17:53 said:

I think he means something more subtle, along the lines of the symbol: "the eagle is not a piece of metal – the eagle IS Rome".

"We believe that we invent symbols. The truth is that they invent us; we are their creatures, shaped by their hard, defining edges. When soldiers take their oath they are given a coin, an asimi stamped with the profile of the Autarch. Their acceptance of that coin is their acceptance of the special duties and burdens of military life—they are soldiers from that moment, though they may know nothing of the management of arms. I did not know that then, but it is a profound mistake to believe that we must know of such things to be influenced by them, and in fact to believe so is to believe in the most debased and superstitious kind of magic. The would-be sorcerer alone has faith in the efficacy of pure knowledge; rational people know that things act of themselves or not at all."

? Gene Wolfe, *Shadow and Claw*

I agree that in a sense, the Nation brings forth the State. But in another sense (and I think this is the meaning intended by Evola, although I could be wrong), it is the Regime or State and ultimately the Capo or Head who gives a final definitive cast to the political body.

Cologero on 2013-07-23 at 20:33 said:

Avery, you are confusing the State with a government. The examples you provide are bureaucratic agencies, mere artifacts, not something natural and organic.

Evola claims the organic state is actually the soul of the nation, intimately connected to the people, of which it is the organizing principle, its consciousness. The state, in this conception, does not exist in a vacuum, but only in relation to the "matter", i.e., the people. The state, then, is the conscious manifestation of the not yet fully conscious of its identity. That does not mean it lacks an identity.

The modern idea is along the lines of Rousseau's Social Contract. Individuals get together to create a government, regulated by a contract or constitution, that is supposed to safeguard each of their interests. That is not a nation, but rather a congeries of competing interests. Of course, the actual individual is helpless in that situation, so various power blocs emerge further fractioning the government which is forced to expend all its efforts in appeasing the various factions.

The situation Mussolini encountered was a people who only knew a the liberal social contract type of state. That was the matter he needed to work with, mold, and shape; in other words, the historically contingent situation. So, his task was more than the situation in a truly organic society which did not know such a conception. Hence, there was an educative aspect necessary, for which he invoked the idea of Romanity (a word which the English translation avoids using, for no good reason. The Romans did not need an institute because they did not need to be educated, they already embodied those qualities.

This is one of Evola's main points. The historical failure of Fascism was not because of the falsity of its principles, but rather to the contingencies of the time.

As we mentioned in the review, those principles are anathema to the modern mind, which can see in them only totalitarianism and stultification, rather than the call to live life on a superior, virile level. Individuals today, however, prefer to choose their own paths to fulfillment even if the almost always fall short. As we showed in *Kidz, Kulcha, Kreativiti*¹¹, even the best and the brightest seldom find their way beyond animal existence.

Cologero on 2013-07-24 at 05:54 said:

Saladin, I don't believe that Evola was particularly fond of Hegel. Actually, he gave a classical, not an Hegelian, justification for the state as the soul of a nation. If Evola's view of the state is not pleasing to you, then what would you put in its place as the consciousness of the nation? Or do you reject the concept in toto and see nothing but an aggregate of individuals? If not, how is that aggregate organized?

I should also point out that Evola referred to Guenon as the Maestro, so it is preferable to reserve that term for him.

Saladin on 2013-07-24 at 11:21 said:

Thanks for your clarification Cologero!

You maybe right in saying that Evola's justification for the State was Classical and not Hegelian, but Evola himself mentions that Hegel was one of his earlier influences.

I do not reject the State in toto (I don't think any Traditionalist would) but to say that "Without the State there is no nation", as Avery said, is an inversion of the normal order of things. Again, I have to renew my studies of Evola's writings on this topic, but in your reply to Avery, you make the case that Evola's use of the term is quite different from it's modern connotations.

Taking my tradition as an example, ss far as I can tell (and I am not an expert in Islamic history, even though I grew up Iran) in Islam the "state" is subordinate and secondary to the "umma". That is to say: the nation (or the folk) is the soul of the state and not the other way around.

¹¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1582>

Cologero on 2013-07-24 at 12:39 said:

Now you are getting to an interesting point, Saladin, which exposes a contradiction in Evola (and also the Fascist state). I was eventually going to get to this, but here is suitable as a starting point.

Forgive me for venturing beyond my competence, but I believe the following to be true. The umma is not really an aggregate of individuals, but rather of a community of persons united in Islam. Correct? So the state expresses the will of the umma and speaks for it in temporal affairs. Nevertheless, the state is subordinate to Islam. This is more in line with how Guido De Giorgio understood the traditional state. Iran, moreover, even has a Supreme Leader, as De Giorgio suggested, and his role is certainly higher than Il Duce Mussolini since it encompasses spiritual leadership.

What Evola wants, and this was true even of his philosophical foil Giovanni Gentile, is for the state to be absolute. That is why Evola had so much trouble with the Catholic church's role in the state. This is an extension of Evola's failure to resolve consistently how he saw the relation between the Priests and the Warriors. Hence, the Italian state as such could not create the spirit of the people as much as Evola expected it. The people were united in their religious tradition, and the state grudgingly had to come to terms with it.

JA on 2013-07-24 at 13:49 said:

Cologero brought up the Iranian leader who is a fine example of the Capo.

Is there not though an inherent problem within Catholicism that an absolute state could never be created because the Pope could never tolerate a Duce having temporal authority over the priests (as de Giorgio's Capo does) ? and unlike Islam the Pope is not a temporal ruler as the Caliph or Imam Khomeini was so we are stuck with a dualism at the top – the same dualism that destroyed Frederick II's attempt to build a new empire in the XIIIth century.

Saladin on 2013-07-24 at 14:56 said:

Interesting point indeed Cologero! I agree with your assessment of the umma and you are right that it is inline with De Giorgio's understanding of the traditional state.

However, even though we might disagree with Evola's definition, I am still not clear how his is a contradiction as you say?

Ash on 2013-08-02 at 01:05 said:

Taking the example of Iran, I would tend to see it as more like medieval Europe in terms of the division of authority. The religious lead is taken by the Ayatollahs of the Guardian Council, but the political Leader in terms of every rule seems to be the President (previously Ahmadinejad, now Rohani). Does the revolutionary Guard fulfill the role of Kshatriya, if in an imperfect form?

On the State, perhaps we should watch our definitions. Do we mean the bodies which govern the country, or the foundation on which they are based? The Romans lived under several forms of government, from monarchy to Republic to various forms of Imperial rule. So what was the constant in each era which defined the State and people? Even Roman values like severity and simplicity changed throughout the years. The only uniting principle was Rome the idea, even as Rome referred first to a city and then to an Imperium. Rome did not fall when Alaric sacked the city, but when that idea ceased to define its civilization (and that in itself is hard to place. Secessions took place several times...look up the Empire of the Gauls). So then the nation is the "folk", the people and culture in its diversity and unity; the State in Traditional terms comes to be when the ruling elite among a people uses Traditional principles as their standard. The communist State, alternatively, uses communist ideology as its standard and guide. So the State is definable as when a ruling body has principles to guide and judge themselves, and are not just ruling for personal gain.

To use Dugin's analysis, fascism was defined by taking the State in and of itself as its foundation (an observation which has problems, but useful nonetheless). This is why it tended, like communism, toward totalitarianism. One of its errors was to abandon the idea of the State as needing to embody the Idea. Others never intended this at all and simply used religious and nationalistic rhetoric to attain power. A State without such a foundation is a ruling gang. And indeed, most States are gangs which are molded over time to higher purposes. Rome was once, after all, a band of tribes just trying to survive on the Italian peninsula.

JA on 2013-08-08 at 10:35 said:

The question about deGiorgio I was really to get at but failed to enunciate properly is – does the Capo have the power to determine spiritual dogmas ? In other words can Mussolini decide we should go to Mass on Monday instead of Sunday ?

The problem I'm having in understanding Evola's idea of the absolute state and his opposition to the Catholic Church as a separate entity not part of the state is – how is his idea any different from England or any other Protestant state where the king rules over the church ?

Cologero on 2013-08-08 at 20:53 said:

I believe De Giorgio is very clear that the Priests are the upholders of the deposit of Tradition and the Warriors and, a fortiori the Capo, have the duty of protecting them in that task. Evola's notion is indeed vague, and it stems from his misconceptions as revealed by Coomaraswamy and Guenon. I don't think he ever was clear about his spiritual vision, particularly as it might apply to the contemplative life, as he was always more focused on the way of action as a spiritual path. Certainly, the heroic path and the discipline associated with loyalty, etc., can lead to a certain transcendence, but that cannot be the whole story. In particular, they can't pass on the tradition because they lack the discursive knowledge of it, as we pointed out a couple of months ago.

The role of the priests in Evola's conception was like an appendix, i.e., a vestigial organ with no real purpose.

JA on 2013-08-09 at 10:24 said:

I find very interesting Fabre d'Olivet's point about mediaeval Japan in his history book that it was a deviation – a revolt of the warriors – from the priest-ruled prior era. The Emperor of Japan was and is actually more akin to the Pope in our culture than to a king. The Shogun would be more like the Emperor.

I also find it puzzling how writers such as Dugin, taking their cue from Evola's regal supremacy promote Orthodox Christianity in Byzantium and Russia as embodying the Traditional ideal of church-state relations when as I mentioned before de Maistre, Soloviev and others show how the post-Photius eastern church was the same as protestant churches like the Anglicans.

This speech shows us the way to a good society, I believe

<http://www.traditioninaction.org/History/A04CharlemagneSpeech.html>

PS – this is tangential but were you aware of what Dr Plinio had said about the Nouvelle Droite? his opinion is that the new right is a false flag resistance created by the revolution, to deceive and give a false hope to those who are of anti-communist mind, and convert them to an anti-Christian philosophy. I agree with Plinio because I find that especially with Dugin's people, it starts of talking bout order, hierarchy, tradition, but when you get in deep there's Crowley, chaos magic, nihilism and communism.

Ash on 2013-08-10 at 04:06 said:

JA, I think false flag may be giving a bit too much credit. The Nouvelle Droite and the Identitarian movements which are following it aren't "false flags" but legitimate expressions of dissent, in my view. That said, they are in dire need of education in proper doctrine. As students of Tradition, I think it would be far more worthwhile to focus on this, at least for the time being. This is how I myself came to return to metaphysical teaching after a journey through the ideas of the Nouvelle Droite and its associates. In time, we may see elements of the Anti-Tradition... I personally have my own ideas about who and what parts of these rightist movements are such manifestations. But only in time. For every Varg Vikernes, runic/chaos magician, and racial ultranationalist, there are many who have found their course their because of their alienation with the order around them and may yet be open to the truth. Could you link to Dr. Plinio's comments? I would be interested in seeing them in full.

As an aside, do you find TIA to be a useful website? I used to read it more myself but I was always rather put off by its rather extreme dogmatism. Forget more Catholic than the Pope, I got the sense sometimes of more Catholic than the SSPX. I'm no bleeding heart myself and more judgmental sometimes than I should be, but an article entitled "Four Ways to Discern A

Man's Soul From His Appearance" which marks his laugh and walking speed as signs? I know body language tells a lot, but come on now.

JA on 2013-08-10 at 12:11 said:

The Plinio quote comes from <http://www.kelebekler.com/cesnur/storia/gb20.htm>

"A 'cocktail' of evolutionism, neo-positivism, scientism, sexual revolution and clearly Masonic doctrines in an 'Indo-European' package: in the first place in order to subtly corrupt those young people who escape from social-communist and progressive conformity, favouring their transformation into 'anonymous revolutionaries'. in the second place, in order to prepare the pollution of any anti-Communist reaction and to try to satisfy its inevitable spiritual needs in an anti-Catholic and anti-metaphysical sense, in view of a dark and fatal neo-pagan mirage".

The whole article I linked to is worth reading as it shows the Masonic connections of many important NR leaders such as Christian Bouchet (who is very close to Dugin). More and more I am convinced that Dugin-ism, or a successor ideology that will be derived from Dugin's work, is the Counter-Tradition Guenon said would come in The Reign of Quantity and the Signs of the Times – a communism mixed with false metaphysics .

I used to be a national bolshevik so I understand what you're saying Ash, if it hadn't been for Dugin I'd have never read Evola or Guenon – Dugin being the bridge for me from Marx and Lenin to Tradition. But for others Dugin has become a god-like figure who can never be questioned.....

I like TIA alot, I find it defending true mediaeval Catholicism, something that is a very rare fact in this world. Maybe they aren't 100 % correct all the time but who is ? I'd go to Mass with them if I knew them personally.

For the sake of honesty though my thoughts are moving more towards Plinio/Lefebvre/Williamson/ and away from Evola, Guenon, those types, not that I disagree with Guenon or Evola so much as I just think traditional Catholicism is more on the money and less screwed up than traditionalism. I mean I'm not a liberal and if I'm going to be a Catholic which is what God chose for me to be, I'm not going to say choice of religion is meaningless and can be switched.

Ash on 2013-08-10 at 17:48 said:

In my view, TIA is a site which provides some good resources but could be so much more. I thought when reading them at first that it was a satirical site mocking the "backward Christian". The site seems to be pure reaction in many ways. It is one thing to understand and promote the Catholic social teaching on modern issues, it is quite another to be shocked and outraged at rock music and bikinis as if they are a new fad and haven't been around a good 60 years or so. In some ways they read like a Catholic Jack Chick comic, focusing on the decline of handwriting and titles like Mr./Mrs, not really mentioning that for most of Catholic civilization neither of

these things existed in their current form. Perhaps I'm being a bit harsh (and off topic from the post) but I really do think that ultimately the group undermines its own project.

Most certainly some interesting information in that article. Guenon himself was of course acquainted with Masonry in his younger years so we should of course leave open the possibility for maturing beyond petty "spiritism", but there is cause to be weary. I take Dugin for what he is: a man who has certainly been influenced by authors of Tradition but is certainly no initiate himself. As such there is good and bad to be found in him. I have neither a natbol background (although I have read some of their writings online) nor do I speak Russian, so perhaps you can judge better than I what he is at his core. I've heard the remarks that he does not take well to dissent before... a true Guru knows that the truth can stand any test, and a teacher who does not allow for such likely has something to hide. Time will tell, I suppose. I studied Catholicism for a long time as a potential neophyte, starting when I read Scott Hahn's *Rome Sweet Home* and eventually becoming interested in more traditional authors like Lefebvre, before moving on to Orthodoxy and eventually away from the Christian tradition. For my part, although Christian symbolism and teaching still are great sources of learning for me, it is my philosophical issues with anthropomorphic theism keeping me from it as an exoteric tradition.

Cologero on 2013-08-10 at 18:43 said:

Ash, you keep mentioning "anthropomorphic theism" as though you know what you are talking about. I think Gornahoor has dealt with that issue sufficiently, but if you have some particular objection, the comment belongs to the relevant post. If that is still not enough, check out Edward Feser's site and ask mention your "philosophical issues" there. You will be tarred, feathered, and ridden out of town on a rail.

JA on 2013-08-12 at 10:14 said:

Personally if someone can find enlightenment through a non-Christian path as Guenon did, it is for Christ and nor for me to judge. I simply choose not to apostasise from the religion I was raised in as a child, I have little but the little I do have in the form of the beliefs of my ancestors are worthwhile enough for me to keep. I've studied other paths though, Shia Islam, Korean Buddhism, Thelema, but found they were foreign to my soul.

I first got into Nazbol as a punk, although now he's moved away from that, for a while Dugin – when associated with Limonov (read Sedgwick's book for the history) was appealing to the punk-Crowley set for recruits so that's where they hooked me. Thanks be to God though I've moved far away from that way of life.

One thing I've learned about initiation recently is that – people keep looking for all these little groups of hoaxsters for the "secret knowledge" that can enlighten them but they're missing the point – initiation is not a ceremony, initiation is the spiritual change in the interior of a person. Only I can change myself. A guru can help but at the end I have to do the work – he can't

do it for me. In that sense all initiations are self initiations. It helps to have a teacher obviously but since I can't find one, that's no excuse not to start working by myself. Now I've focusing my search for books of spiritual exercises I can do to raise my consciousness.

Ash on 2013-08-13 at 23:55 said:

Evola's comments on the Germanic society in *Revolt* provide a good backdrop for the comments in this review about "the sovereign within" and the notion of freely-given loyalty versus totalitarian control. He describes how the free men would rally around the chieftain, and how the nobles would be defined by their "free" status. He gives a quote which would certainly apply in the situations of totalitarian states: "The supreme nobility... does not consist in being a master of slaves, but in being a lord of free men, who loves freedom even in those who serve him." This freedom is both inner and outer, of course. Thus the positive liberty which we find in Maurras also animates the economic ideal of autarky; only a self-reliant nation is a free nation.

Insofar as the ethical state must find healthy channels for chaotic currents, it may be useful for the Traditionally minded to examine not just the particular public and educational programs for sexual morality, but also their results. Spain, which practiced in the 20th century a hardline Catholic program of public morality, also had a very promiscuous sexual culture in some ways, egged on by the attraction which forbidden fruit holds. Writers would report the high levels of pregnancy outside marriage and the free sexual relationships which were common enough in rural areas. Does that sound like the ends that such a program was pursuing? A good modern equivalent may be the high levels of teenage pregnancy and pornography consumption in "red" states and politically conservative countries like India and states in the Arab and Islamic world. More "progressive" programs have in fact resulted in lower health risks and pregnancies, but are of course based on values we find abhorrent. One hopes there may be some third alternative.

This article has great value in allowing us to see what a Traditional society and State actually look like, by comparison to the excesses and errors of fascism. The manifestation of Tradition in culture (in our day, both folk and even media culture) is something which has been dominated by the New Right (which has had great advances in this area) and was far too overlooked by the intellectual heavyweights Guenon, Evola, and co. I'll definitely peruse Gentile's work on the issue.

Matt on 2013-08-14 at 18:48 said:

"One hopes there may be some third alternative."

I think Cologero was probably hinting at that in the post with the Marcus Aurelius quote. Both the puritanical mind and the modern/post-modern mystify sex for different reasons – and neither award it the symbolic value it has that opens up higher possibilities for the select few among humanity. A possible viable education program with influence from the Emperor's teachings would try and demystify the act to the masses; its neither in principle an abominable

act in itself (the puritan view) nor is it the path that will lead to the greatest of human happiness and that can adequately satisfy all your desires (the modern/post-modern view). Its all just the rubbing together of membranes (to paraphrase Aurelius) with spasms and grunts where if you actually saw yourself from a third-person distance while engaging in it, you would laugh (I think that was a view stated by a certain renaissance figure might have been Da Vinci). There are more important goals and actions to spend your life engaging in. Teaching the symbolic value of the sex act should be reserved to the few who can understand it and then correctly implement it. Exposing the average individual to this is a waste of time; the message/point completely goes over their head. Miguel Serrano did an excellent job explaining these issues – Gornahoor has a post or two on Serrano's explanation in fact.

Ash on 2013-10-24 at 17:54 said:

I've seen Pope Francis praised by certain traditional quarters as an "imaginative conservative" and heard whispered warnings from others. Many of my progressive, even atheist, friends are very supportive of him. It appears they need reminding that, no, the Church does not now in fact allow abortion and homosexuality. That said, His Holiness' focus on the virtues of charity, faith, and hope, if paired with a cleansing of the Church's own house may well yield much fruit. The Pope Emeritus' vision of a smaller but doctrinally purer Church was constantly marred by his inability to effectively combat the problems which the Church had faced and restore the trust of large numbers of the faithful in it. Do those of our number who are Catholics feel that this Pope will help or hinder the Tradition where it is still present within the exoteric body of the Church? Forgive me if this would be a better topic for the forum or another thread.

On another note, I've pondered the "inhumanity" of some of the qualities Evola promotes before, particularly when reading the chapter of Revolt on Man and Woman. It is hard to reconcile the radical detachment which his Traditional Man has from the woman, to the point where even the emotions of affection or love are inherently feminine and have no place in the psyche of the true Man, with the image of the Family or the values of faith, hope, and charity preached by the Saints. Perhaps Gentile would be more useful on some of these "worldly" manifestations of Traditional principles, or at least in how to live and teach them.

scardanelli on 2013-10-25 at 08:34 said:

I think the comment was made somewhere here on Gornahoor that Evola's insistence on masculinity as an absolute ideal rather than a relative quality was somewhat misguided. Perhaps this contributes to these ideals relating to a man's relationship with woman. As Tomberg explains, man has a feminine or receptive soul whereas woman has a masculine or active soul. "In the lord, neither is woman independent of man, nor is man independent of woman." Of course, Evola was not very keen on Christianity...

JA on 2013-12-19 at 10:17 said:

In my opinion despite its flaws Fascism was the best that could be done and can be done now – we can't simply revert to l'ancien regime as de Maistre hoped for because the people having been roused up by the Illuminati-Masonic-philosopher conspiracy to demand "power" are not willing to give it up easily and force can not solve the problem – a true monarchy is based on the lord-vassal relationship, anything other than that is a dictatorship but dictators are sometimes needed (Cincinnatus from Roman history for one), Fascism offered an opportunity within the modern world to begin the process of healing – it was not an ideal system but it was a start. Rather than criticise fascism the task of the Italian man of reason I think should have been to work within the state (to which he owes loyalty to from birth) to improve it.

Gentile I admire as well as a man who working with modern philosophy managed to re-express ancient principles. It doesn't concern me what Evola's personal gripes were with the man, but I don't think Gentile should be quickly rejected; his education book for one we can still take a lot from.

I am not a fascist but I have no problem saying I prefer fascism to democracy and think fascism can be a prelude to monarchical restoration as per Franco and Juan Carlos.

Cologero on 2013-12-19 at 14:24 said:

JA, James Gregor makes a similar case as yours, at least for developing nations. He considers the Fascist model to be better than the pure Marxist models usually adopted.

14.6 Order and Progress

Yes, when the mind is missing, a soul will do.

JEAN RASPAIL

Disturbed by the chaos following the French Revolution, which overthrew the order imposed by Throne and Altar, Auguste Comte sought to locate a sounder foundation for the order of society. He created a new science of man, sociology, that he hoped would support that foundation. The fundamental basis of his system is the idea of three stages of social development. One of the defects of that idea is that the three stages do not follow each other so neatly historically, but all exist at any time. The

other defect is the restriction of positivism to the knowledge of all things visible. Hence, a metaphysical positivism, that also includes all things invisible, includes Comte's insights in a larger system. Given that, the three stages can be redefined this way:

Mythological The mythological stage is symbolic, pre-thematic, and pre-reflective, similar to what Eric Voegelin called "compact consciousness". As pre-reflective, it exists fully at the level of being.

Ideological The ideological stage regards the mythological stage as something primitive to be overcome. Thus, it attacks the foundations of the mythological society in the pursuit of "progress", replacing the world of Being with an artificially constructed world of Thought.

Metaphysical The metaphysical stage is a differentiated recapitulation of the mythological stage. Hence, it unites Being and Thought, unlike the ideological consciousness which separates them.

In Comte's view, the final, or Positivistic, stage understands Progress as the evolution of Order. Evolution here is understood in its etymological sense as the "unfolding" of what already is. In our times "evolution" has come to mean the opposite: it means the rejection of the established order of things in order, while appealing to some ideological system that represents an allegedly higher order of being.

Now one of the appeals of ideology is its role as a status marker. It takes a certain degree of literacy and education to be initiated into an ideology. Since the mythological consciousness is pre-rational, its defenders come across as inarticulate, thus reinforcing the impressions held by ideology.

The metaphysical stage, however, is much more difficult since it requires not just a new way of thinking, but also a change in one's level of being. Anyone can adhere to an ideology: moral development or self-knowledge are not necessary to understand an ideology. Moreover, the

mythological consciousness is often suspicious of the metaphysical consciousness, so it cannot usually recognize it as an ally.

We have provided several examples of the last stage. For example, they mythological and metaphysical stages roughly correspond to Guenon's distinction between the exoteric and esoteric traditions; for him, the esoteric does not reject the exoteric, but rather brings out the deeper understanding of its symbols, myths, and rites. Another example is Valentin Tomberg. Despite his deep understanding of the inner meaning of dogmas and spirituality, he regards himself as no higher than the simple believer with a symbolic, compact consciousness.

Roots of Order I have attempted here to list the roots of order of the compact society, at least of one of Solar beings. I expect the list to be modified over time. To qualify, a quality would have to be essential or innate, not something acquired over time. Hence, this is not an empirical list culled from the external behavior of several societies. As pre-rational, these beliefs are simply assumed although they are embodied in the customs, myths, institutions, etc., of the society.

Besides the natural moral law against murder, stealing, etc., there are several other properly basic qualities that are natural, without necessarily having the force of a moral law. I applied a simple test to determine the items on the list. The questions to ask are:

1. Is it absurd to offer an argument in support of any of the qualities?
2. Do ideologies offer arguments opposing or attacking any of these qualities?

For example, for Gornahoor to post a translation of an Evola essay in support of a heterosexual nuclear family would be ludicrous. Hence, we can presume it is the default position. On the other hand, promoting some other notion of family or sexual orientation is an indication of an

ideology, since it does not “evolve” out of one of the basic positions. Here is the list of basic sources of social order, subject, of course, to comments and revision.

- Family as fundamental social unit
- Spiritual orientation and public worship
- Patriarchal rule
- Functional stratification into spiritual authority, political power, and economic activity
- Veneration of ancestors
- Preference for one’s own
- The common good supersedes the individual
- Children considered a blessing rather than a burden
- Incest taboo
- Assortative mating
- Hypergamy
- Heteronormative

Addendum on Dialectic and Rhetoric As I was getting ready to publish this, I came across this essay by **Richard Weaver**: *The Cultural Role of Rhetoric*. In that essay, Mr. Weaver addresses the same point in a more sophisticated way. He opposes dialectic, or “rational and soulless discourse”, to rhetoric:

- **Dialectic:** abstract reasoning upon the basis of propositions.
- **Rhetoric:** the relation of these terms to the existential world in which facts are regarded with sympathy and are treated with that kind of historical understanding and appreciation which lie outside the dialectical process.

Hence, in this view, dialectic is not integrated into the historical life of a community. Weaver warns us:

Too exclusive reliance upon dialectic is a mistake of the most serious consequence because .

He writes that a society cannot live without rhetoric, wince there are some things in which the group needs to believe which cannot be demonstrated to everyone rationally. To keep questioning them (i.e., the “roots of order”) is to destroy the basis of belief in them and to weaken the cohesiveness of society. The essay concludes with an appeal, in retrospect, much too sanguine, for rhetoric and dialectic to once again join hands.

Enthymeme An enthymeme is a syllogism with one of the propositions missing. Rhetoric uses enthymeme in Aristotle’s sense that

in conversing with the multitudes you do not aim at fresh scientific instruction; you rest your arguments upon generally accepted principles and beliefs, or broadly speaking, on things received.

Hence, the roots of order were simply assumed in public discourse with no justification needed. Weaver apparently did not foresee the extent to which those formerly generally accepted principles and beliefs have now become “extremist”. The West has not replaced rhetoric with coldly intellectual dialectic, but has instead replaced the rhetoric of being with a

new, emotionally charged, neo-rhetoric. This neo-rhetoric lacks both the societal cohesiveness of rhetoric as well as scientifically derived dialectic.

Rhetoric used to serve the needs of a community with its common customs, beliefs, and historical development. Neo-rhetoric disrupts the community since it takes the view of the “other”, the outsider to the community. Neo-rhetoric has its own enthymemes which cannot be publicly disputed.

Posted on 2015-07-21 by Cologero

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Logres on 2015-07-22 at 07:04 said:

“Now one of the appeals of ideology is its role as a status marker. It takes a certain degree of literacy and education to be initiated into an ideology. Since the mythological consciousness is pre-rational, its defenders come across as inarticulate, thus reinforcing the impressions held by ideology”

Politics as a form of Lust for Power: that shirt seems to fit the Progressives rather well. It's fortunate for them that their political enemies were arguing (and by and large personally believed and practiced) that power should be restricted and orderly. Also, fortunate that their enemies shared many of their revolutionary principles at some level. This made victory inevitable. It's also made them very sloppy and full of hubris. If an elite were to appear that had had an evident change of being, that would create a very resentful slum mob of progressive intelligentsia. Maybe they could Twitter their way out of it.

Francis on 2015-07-29 at 22:58 said:

“Here is the list of basic sources of social order, subject, of course, to comments and revision”.

Let us assume all such basics are endorsed. One must then decide to either live them in their own life alone, or make an effort to see them normalized and woven into the fabric of greater society.

One glaring issue, to my mind, is that many of these basics become difficult to normalize in modernity as a direct result of economics. For example, one factor in the destruction of family has been the necessity of the woman to enter the work force. Dad is at “work”, mom is at “work”, and the “family” sees one another less than they do their co-workers.

What seems an appealing option is the development of “intentional communities”, such as might be explored within the context of “The Benedict Option”. In time, what one could hope, is

that these communities sprawl, and eventually “touch” one another, thereby reinventing large territories.

Yet, the communities still exist within the larger geography of some modern state, and ultimately remain bound by their laws; in fact, if such communities begin to gain some steam, and become a perceivable “threat” to the existing state monopolies on power, it would be easy to predict them as targets—labeled “cults”, accused of child abuse, stockpiling weapons, evading taxes, and so on—Waco Texas serves as a reminder.

This is why, I’ve toyed with the idea of living Tradition within the communities, while advocating libertarianism, or “anarcho-capitalism” without. With libertarians in outside “public office”, comes a weakening of state and enforcement power, as well as a positive deregulation of business such that larger economic wheels are greased (better facilitating trade between the Traditional intentional communities and the “outside” world, thereby facilitating their growth and development). Thus, a bridge, or means to an end. It is often mentioned that Evola saw in the Italian Fascist state, something of a stepping stone toward a world of Tradition—it was a model that suited his times, and existed. Today, Fascism of that Italian model does not exist, nor will return again—so, little good in attempting to “restore” that, or advance a “Mussolinism”. Nor shall we see, some sudden return to monarchies, built from the tattered remnants of living hereditary heirs.

Instead, a new, fresh, and practical model must be considered as a “bridge”—that is, if one is inclined to a path of “action”. And, that bridge, I reiterate, is outward advancement of candidates representing an anarcho-capitalism/libertarianism, while internally building self-sustaining intentional communities having Tradition at their core, governed along aristocratic principles (unlike leftist “communes”), out of which, an “elite” will begin to take shape.

14.7 The Country of the Blind

The time has long gone by when anyone who claims the title of philosopher can think of religion as a superfluity for the educated and an ‘opiate for the masses’. It is the only known explosive in the economy of that delicate internal-combustion engine, the human mind. Peoples rich in religious energy can overcome all obstacles and attain any height in the scale of civilization. Peoples that have reached the top of a hill by the wise use of religious energy may then decide to do without it; they can still move, but they can only move downhill, and when they come to the bottom of the

hill they stop.

ROBIN COLLINGWOOD

R G Collingwood was the last of the British idealist philosophers (save a recent mini-revival). Although greatly influenced by the Italian idealists, including Giovanni Gentile, he found himself on the opposing side of World War II. That involves a conflict of the man as philosopher and as citizen. In the former role, he needs to develop an objective political science; while in the latter role, he needs to justify his own nation.

British idealism is genteelly liberal, while Italian idealism in general, not just in Gentile and Julius Evola, is nothing of the sort (apart perhaps from Benedetto Croce). Nevertheless, Collingwood does make some interesting points in political science. In particular, we will focus on the three laws of politics that he identified. (cf. *Essays in Political Philosophy*.)

The Blind Leading the Blind The short story, *The Country of the Blind*, by **H G Wells**, is about a lost South American tribe in which everyone is born blind. A mountaineer accidentally discovers their city. He imagines that, with his sight, he would become their ruler. Unfortunately for him, the villagers do not believe in his “alleged” sense of sight. They think he is crazy and his eyes are a cause of his disease. The consequences of this will be brought up at the end of this essay.

Civilization First of all, political science, as a human science, has a *telos*, unlike the physical sciences. So if you are a warrior for civilization—whether by pen or sword—, it is necessary to define exactly what that entails. Collingwood says that civilization includes three conditions:

- **Law and order.** This is a condition of society in which men live according to definite rules, known to all, and enforced by the political power.

- **Prosperity.** This is a condition of society in which a man acquires the things he needs for sustenance and comfort not by taking them from others but by earning them.
- **Peace.** This is the condition of society in which the arbiter of human affairs is not violence but agreement.

At this point, Collingwood describes WWII as a battle between civilization and its destruction by the Axis powers. Of course, there is more to be added to these brief summaries, but these three conditions may be useful to determine the state of a civilization. This is an exercise for the reader.

Society and Community A number of human beings living together constitute a **community**. A **society** is a kind of community with origins from Ancient Rome. Under Roman law, a society (*societas*) is defined as a number of partners who must be adult, free, male, Roman citizens acting together in the pursuit of aims advantageous to all. That is, they are members through their own free will. As Evola points out, a king wants loyalty freely given by free subjects.

A community, on the other hand, lacks some of these features. In particular, actions are no longer always governed by freedom, but often by constraint. Many examples of such constraint can be found, from the subtle to the gross. Collingwood defines it thus:

The essence of constraint is that a man should be brought into a condition of emotional disturbance in which he cannot make the free decision. The disturbance may be of many kinds; for example, it may be a state of fear.

First Law of Politics The First Law of Politics is that *in a community there are two classes: the rulers and the ruled*. Collingwood points

out that **Abraham Lincoln**'s ideal of a "government of the people, etc." did not include women, children or non-citizens, however it may be re-interpreted today.

Second Law of Politics The Second Law of Politics states that *the division between rulers and ruled is permeable*. That is, there may be movement back and forth between the two divisions.

Third Law of Politics This is the more interesting law. It states that *the characteristics displayed by the ruler will tend to be imitated by those over whom he rules*. Specifically, in a democracy the ruler will be chosen by the feeling of affinity rather than on any particular qualities of a candidate. The issues are too complex even for educated citizens.

I grew up in a small town outside of Boston which still had town meetings. The issues that came up for votes, however, were along the lines of how many new snow plows should the town buy this year, not existential questions. That is, it was more like a society with a common aim.

However, to be an informed citizen requires knowledge of political philosophy, bioethics, economics, geopolitical strategy, and so on. That knowledge is rare, especially among the rulers. Rather, they focus more on the second law and spend their energy in maintaining or gaining power. The ruler reflects the soul qualities of a community as the images indicate.

Refrain By the third law, the ruler is like the ruled, although he excels in some quality. Harkening back to the Wells' story, this quality must be something that the community recognizes. Hence, since a democratic community is not composed of rational and intelligent men, they cannot recognize those qualities in a ruler. Rather, they gravitate toward qualities

related to appearance and style; it is not what he says, but how he says it that matters. So we get unintelligence, of which there are two kinds.

- **Negative unintelligence.** A person in this frame of mind, trying to grasp something, grasps nothing. He comes away from all mental effort empty-handed.
- **Creative unintelligence.** Rather than “nothing”, this type of unintelligence creates fantasies and chimeras. It fabricates imaginary causes for things. This is more intractable since it is a simulation of real intelligence.

Hence, there are two ways to be a **fool**.

- There is being *foolish to stupidity* in which the mind grasps nothing. This may happen, for example, at a weekend seminar on transcendental idealism.
- Then there is being *foolish to craziness*. In this case the mind creates illusions or hallucinations about what it is trying to understand.

The stupid fool knows his weakness and may try to overcome it. Unfortunately, the crazy fool believes he is being intelligent, so he has no motive to change. The crazy fool has as much initiative over his fellow man as does the intelligent man. In some ways more, since he does not have the reticence of the intelligent man.

Postscript Collingwood believes he is describing the Axis powers as the fools. In his opinion, Britain, as the peak of Protestant Christianity, represents the peak of civilization. Germany, he claims, was the last European nation to embrace Christianity, so it is still pagan at its core. Even Roman Christianity in Italy owes much to ancient Roman paganism.

Britain won that battle, but may eventually lose the war; the verdict is still out. Britain is hardly a Christian nation anymore. If his understanding is correct, Great Britain is heading downhill, despite all appearances. If it eventually stops at the bottom, then Collingwood's reputation will return, but this time as a prophet, not as a philosopher.

Posted on 2015-03-25 by Cologero

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Mark Citadel on 2015-03-25 at 13:29 said:

Having experienced the degeneration of a few countries, Britain being one of them, I can tell you that it may be one of the first to go into a period of total self-destruction. The people cannot even stomach populist parties like UKIP because they're so 'extreme'.

There is an adherence to a rival religion known as 'British values' which are explicitly anti-Traditional and enshrined into the legal and education systems. It's not even as if there is a significant hold-out vestige of Tradition. The Kali Yuga picked the bones clean with this one.

Max on 2015-03-25 at 15:05 said:

The current condition of "civilization": laws are arbitrary, changing all the time, so numerous no one knows them and enforced selectively. "Earning" something is most often synonymous with stealing it lawfully and unopposed. Violence and conflict are artificially engendered and engineered.

How to move in a positive direction.

1. Most seems incapable of either being ruled or to rule. The ordered man knows both and will rule himself.
2. An organic hierarchy is not static. A new nobility will be earned and self selected.
3. In Germanic languages the words for stillness, peace, freedom and friendship have the same root. A society will be formed by affinity.

14.8 Mythos and Logos

We want to substitute faith for law, mythos for logos... will for pure reason, the image for the concept, and home for exile

Therein lays **Alain de Benoist**'s creed, which he takes seriously and every reader of **New Right** literature also needs to take seriously. When Benoist claims to reject **Charles Maurras** in toto, he necessarily includes Maurras' commitment to reason, which Benoist regards as a fault. In his interview, he makes this perfectly clear:

Maurras is certain that it suffices to stop trusting in one's sentiments and to appeal to "reason", to avoid falling into utopian thinking and to reach to an almost perfect system of order. He boasts of building his system by a suite of logically irrefutable deduction, while he is only making his demonstrations in the abstract. His error, fundamentally, is to believe it suffices to reason correctly to reach the truth. It is to think, as Emmanuel Beau de Lomenie noted: "that reason is one, that everyone reasoning correctly can only lead to the sole conclusion, which is inevitably true, and that consequently all doctrine which, in place of trusting in the intuitions of one's passions or feelings, will be concerned to reason correctly on the relationship of man with society, will be able, as to the problem of the political and social structure to establish, to admit as sane and just only one sole solution, that of Charles Maurras." There is in that a pretention that can be judged as exorbitant. There is also a certain naïveté, since his adversaries hold close to the same thing, that they believe that they also reason correctly, yet lead to opposite conclusions.

So according to Benoist, reasoning is useless in determining socio-political ends, and he prefers to rely on the intuitions of his passions. So instead of logically presenting his views, he prefers to present a narrative, or something to believe in that conforms to one's deepest feelings. He is able to gather followers who likewise believe in that narrative; these are his people, the like-minded. What about differences of opinion? Since they cannot be resolved by reason, then diversity is the necessary position

to hold. Different groups will embrace different narratives, corresponding to their particular intuitions. Hence, his commitment to multiculturalism. Any attempt to embrace a single narrative, suitable to all, or different, peoples is considered by him to be a totalitarianism, the result of a monotheism as he understands the term.

Now we at Gornahoor embrace a different anthropology, viz., that man is a **rational animal**. Hence, we have a prior commitment to reason and logic. Nevertheless, there is a certain sympathy with Benoist, not in his methods, but rather in his objections. The Traditional conception of reason, however, is not that of the Enlightenment. Rather it embraces an intuition, but an intuition of higher things, which is quite different from that of the feelings. Furthermore, since Beauty is one of the transcendentals, we also embrace an intuition of feelings of a specific kind, which are of a different order than the lower passions.

To the objection that reasoners reach opposed conclusions, we agree with Benoist that this is due to a difference in first principles or postulates. The Traditional view, however, is that these first postulates are known through intuition. Hence, they are known directly or they are not; that is the nature of intuition. But relying on the intuitions of one's passions can hardly be the superior alternative.

The frustrating thing about Benoist is his lack of respect for metaphysical, logical, and historical precision. We ask whether a given belief is true or false, whether it conforms to Tradition or not. This is irrelevant to Benoist since, for him, a belief has only an instrumental value. For example, his understanding of monotheism is quite defective. So he never asks whether monotheism is true or not. Rather, he is concerned with the effects of accepting it as true.

Over time, we can deal with the specific errors, but for now, we are content with some examples exhibiting Benoist's creedal points. The main issue is that we don't recognize these dichotomies. Rather than an either-or, there is a both-and, properly understood.

Faith and Law Benoist rejects law in favor of faith, which he intends in the sense of conviction or fidelity. Hence, one does not follow an external law, but rather one's convictions to a belief. We also value fidelity, loyalty and conviction, but we also recognize the importance of the great pagan lawgivers, such as **Manu, Solon, Numa Pompilius**.

Mythos and Logos Cosmic order is foundational to Tradition, whether called Dharma in the East, or Logos in the West ... this is pagan, Western, and Traditional. Yet, myth is also part of Tradition. Since the Logos is beyond discursive thinking, it can only be fully expressed in terms of symbols, legends, rites, and myths. Yet, as Guenon repeatedly points out, symbolism is not irrational, yet it is beyond reason.

Will and Reason The relationship of will to reason: in some conceptions, reason is felt as a limitation. However, unlike a physical law, there is no compulsion to be reasonable. In any case, Tradition accepts the unity of being; hence, there can be no difference between the transcendentals of truth, good, and beauty. The will is oriented towards the good and the reason is oriented toward the truth. These must be one and the same, a view described by the New Right as totalitarian.

What is the alternative? If each group, or worse, each individual, is a law unto himself, each asserting his own will, then conflicts are inevitable. Without reason, there is no way to adjudicate competing claims. In Benoist's polytheistic system, for example, man is at the mercy of the gods, beseeching their favors whenever possible. For example, Aeneas was hindered by Juno, yet supported by Venus. This view does nothing to eliminate conflict.

Image and concept Once again the concept must not be misunderstood in rationalistic terms, as does Benoist. Rather, it is the idea, which

is known directly and intuitively. The image is a lower form of knowing, for those who are incapable of thinking in metaphysical terms.

This misunderstanding is especially evident in the New Right's obsession with monotheism. Classical monotheism, in the West, is based on **Plato**, **Aristotle**, **Augustine**, and **Aquinas**. Thus, it has deep roots in pagan thought, and is far from a Semitic thought form. Moreover, as Guenon points out, the western understanding is equivalent to the notion of **Ishwara** in the Vedantic schools, again emphasizing its pagan origins.

Hence, Benoist's description of monotheism has nothing in common with Western tradition, which can only be understood conceptually, that is, transcendent to any imaginings. Since Benoist is committed to the image, his view of monotheism is absurdly anthropomorphic and is, in truth, unrecognizable to anyone steeped in the Tradition of classical theism. This topic will require extended treatment.

Posted on 2012-03-13 by Cologero

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Cologero on 2012-03-21 at 00:50 said:

Everything is perspective. Even the claim to reason is a sham, just a mask for the will-to-power. Yet we all feel compelled to promote our own perspectives as though they are absolute and come from God. So which perspective has the most power? Choose and exclude.

14.9 Paganism 2.0

I see and approve what is better, but follow what is worse.

OVID, Metamorphoses

I do not do the good I want, but the evil I do not want is what I do.

PAUL, *Romans* 7

For some reason, there are some who think it is a simple matter to create a religion *de novo*, often with the intent to trick a population into pursuing some desired end. Historically, however, starting with an existing, respected religion and adding onto it seems to have a better chance of success. Recent examples include Joseph Smith with Mormonism and Mary Baker Eddy with Christian Science.

For a variety of reasons which are not important for our purpose, there are occasional calls for a return to a pre-Christian paganism. This is often tied in with the belief in a more “natural”, almost Edenic, lifestyle, unpolluted with the Christian consciousness of the loss of original innocence. Unfortunately, that state never existed, as our epigraph shows. Rather, the pagan was also in torment, feeling himself tied to a fate beyond his control, or at the mercy of boons and banes coming from the gods.

This is not to deny that a noble attitude could not arise, far from it. But the modern neo-pagan does not believe in that in the same way. Moreover, the “mule” of neo-paganism is burdened with things few want to return to: raids and conquests for personal gain, human sacrifice, slavery, a real metaphysical pluralism, and so on. A new paganism, therefore, should build on what currently exists and try to move beyond it.

We can point to two attempts in the 20th century at a new pagan philosophy: **Julius Evola** and **Charles Maurras**. Although much of what they believed is anathema to the modern world, their systems are worth investigating, if only for historical interest. At a minimum, they set standards for intellectual rigour.

Magical Idealism Evola rejected the neopagan project. He even asserted that the neopagans would be better off joining the Church than pursuing an impossible reconstruction. Rather than back-tracking, he

proposed, it seems to me, a post-Christian paganism that wants to recapture a certain nobility of spirit without resuscitating the dead mule of paganism.

For example, Paganism 2.0, in his view, would have to incorporate the spirituality of the Middle Ages by separating its pagan elements from the strictly Christian elements. This brings to mind Psyche's task of separating the various grains from the pile. In other words, it requires a super-human effort.

Now Evola took the concept of "person" as central, even writing more than once of the "dignity of the person". The Person, moreover, is a Christian concept, not part of the pagan mindset. Evola also rejected polytheism, since a philosophical pluralism is non-Traditional. Nevertheless, his idea of God seems to be a "god in evolution". That is, God exists to the extent that the Self achieves the Absolute Self. So rather than pluralism, Evola actually defends solipsism. Guenon regards a belief in an evolving god as "Satanic".

So what are his raw materials? First of all, there is his philosophical system of magical idealism as expounded in three books (*Phenomenology of Magical Idealism*, *Theory of Magical Idealism*, *Essays in Magical Idealism*) plus the *Yoga of Power*, that is, Tantra Yoga as mediated by John Woodroffe. Magical idealism draws on German and Italian idealism, with insights from Otto Weininger, Max Stirner, Carlo Michelstaedter, Friedrich Nietzsche, Rene Guenon, of course, and various Eastern and Western occult, esoteric, and spiritual traditions. It certainly is an interesting melange.

Beyond that, Evola wrote books on Hermetism and Buddhism. Although the history of Hermetism is entwined with Christianity, as a post-Christian pagan, Evola attempted to extract its aspects that suited him. He also proposed a form of Buddhism, which I don't believe actually exists anywhere.

This seems to have been a purely intellectual exercise, since, apart

from some experiments in the Ur/Krur group, there was no actual esoteric path for the actualization of magical idealism. Since Evola was not fond of priests, there was no basis for an esoteric chain. The post-Christian pagan society would be ruled by a class of nobles and warriors, with the priestly role relegated to secondary importance. Perhaps they would be suitable for the merchants and serfs, but the nobles and warriors would follow the ethos of magical idealism, even if they couldn't understand it.

Positivism The French Revolution shook up Europe at its foundations. The old regime, based on religion and aristocracy, holdovers from the Middle Ages, was suddenly replaced by a revolution from below. That revolution overturned the established order of things. In its aftermath, the distinction between the Left and the Right arose: the Left was in a state of permanent revolution, while the right was nostalgic for throne and altar. The best representatives of that tendency are **Edmund Burke** and **Joseph de Maistre**. Anyone interested in the actual “**Old Right**” needs to start with them.

From that experience, there arose the mathematician and philosopher, **Auguste Comte**. If the old regime could no longer support the established order of things based on religious ideals, Comte looked for that support instead in science. His philosophy of **Positivism** regarded as real only that which could be experienced. Hence, he created a hierarchy of the sciences, based on the object of experience. He regarded the soul faculties of thinking, feeling, and willing as experiences, thereby avoiding the scientific reductionism of the positivists who came after him.

Because his system was conservative, and had space in it for the “higher” impulses in man that religion had previously claimed for itself, his ideas gained some traction. In particular, he had influence in South America because his social policy was compatible with Catholic thought. Brazil's flag includes one of his mottoes (*Order and Progress*), although I haven't

met a Brazilian who knows where it came from.

Charles Maurras was one such thinker who considered Comte as his mentor. He also looked to Catholic social theory, as it was then being formulated by the popes starting with Pope Leo XIII ... that was the original “third way” between socialism and capitalism, although neglected today. His other influence was **Ernest Renan**, the historian who gave up the priesthood and wrote the famous history of Jesus instead. Although he wrote it as a secular history, he wasn’t destructive, since he still recognized the ideals of religion while denying its supernatural content. Maurras also took much more from Renan, such as his ideas on nationalism. Nationalists today should follow that cue, rather than the enraged irrationalities coming from neopagans today. Nevertheless, such ideas will be pretty indigestible in Western nations today.

In France, Maurras brought **Action Française** to its peak of influence and popularity. It brought together secularists and Catholics, since they could agree on social issues. Catholic teaching is that such doctrines are knowable by natural reason, so there is a legitimate reason for cooperation. Even thinkers like **Jacques Maritain** and **Rene Guenon** were supporters of Action Française, until it was condemned by Pope Pius XI. When Pius XII lifted the condemnation, the damage had been done and it never recovered its former prestige. Atheistic secularism was given free rein in France.

Neopagan, nationalist rightists would do well to look to these figures for their intellectuality and emotional detachment, since they actually had a following. There is a reason that neopagans are not taken seriously today.

Posted on 2015-05-03 by Cologero

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Max on 2015-05-04 at 10:30 said:

One of the problems with Evola is that despite all talk of asserting masculine values, he sometimes approaches a kind of feminine solipsism. It seems that a true masculinity would have to acknowledge the feminine as well, internally and externally, for creation is not complete without it. Grounding ourselves in positivism, we have to. Otherwise we commit a similar fault as regarding the world as evil, but on a microcosmic order. Drawing from previous posts, it seems the way to overcome a “privation” is to love it.

obcure on 2015-05-04 at 19:29 said:

Max,

To overcome privations one must simply turn to the Good. Wherever there is any degree of reality there is the Good. Where there is not the Good there is not just privation but negation and thus nothing.

15.1 Scientific Clarity and Assurance

Ce que nos pères ont fait par coutume et par sentiment, le poursuivre nous-mêmes avec l'assurance et la netteté scientifiques par raison et par volonté.

What our fathers did through custom and feeling, we ourselves pursue it through reason and will, with the assurance and clarity of science.

CHARLES MAURRAS

With this quote, we see the dominating influence of **Auguste Comte's** system of positivism on Maurras' entire political program. The other dominant influence was **Joseph de Maistre**, with his love of Tradition structured by the Church and the Monarchy. However, unlike Maistre, Maurras did not have Maistre's indomitable Catholic faith to justify his worldview. Nevertheless, Maurras accepted Comte's claim to have discovered the true scientific basis for de Maistre's views.

Of the two great “fathers” of a scientific sociology in the 19th century — Marx and Comte — Marx has won out handily and Comte is nearly forgotten. So we are left with a view of science that allegedly supports the forces of revolution. That this “science” is ideological, is all too obvious. Comte, on the other hand, rejected both religion and ideology, in favour of a purer science, which was simply the exposition of laws concerning what can be seen or touched. As such, it avoided both metaphysical pre-suppositions (e.g., materialism) and reductionism. In place of the latter, Comte proposed a hierarchy of sciences, even leaving room for a scientific ethics.

Nevertheless, Comte gets little support primarily because self-described religious conservatives have no interest in supporting Comte’s atheism or Maurras’ paganism. On the other side, secular rightists believe they can corral Darwin to their own ends, and accept its materialism and reduction as “rational”, often adopting a form of zoological racism. These secularists also oppose the role of religion in society, which they regard as mere superstition, whereas Comte and Maurras accept religion as a natural conservative and stabilizing force. What religion accomplished through “custom and sentiment”, the positivists seek the same ends through “reason and will”.

Posted on 2009-10-20 by Cologero

15.2 Social Facts and Group Control

Emile Durkheim, following the positivist school of sociology, defines the **Social Fact** as social phenomena having an existence independent of the individuals comprising the social group. As such, it has a coercive effect. A corollary is that the individuals comprising the group can change, while leaving the group behavior intact.

Positivism admits only the existence of facts, not consciousness, the material world, not the spiritual. Hence Durkheim cannot provide a theory of how the social fact came to be independent of any human beings; nor can he explain how the social fact controls the group, nor even how the group came to be constituted in the first place. How are we then to understand this from the metaphysical point of view?

First of all, to be an effective force, the social fact must be experienced as a thought in consciousness, though to be efficacious, it must not be reflective self-consciousness. That is, it is experienced in its immediacy and as unquestionable as any observation of the external world; in other words, no epistemological distinction is made between the social fact and an external fact. Julius Evola describes this type of consciousness:

the "I" still lives only as if in a dream: it is not yet a self-consciousness, nor an autonomous principle of action: immersed in an immediate, indistinct coalescence with nature and the world, we can say that it is not so much he who thinks, speaks, and asserts himself, as much as that various forces and impulses think, speak and assert themselves in him. He therefore is only a type of medium, a passive instrument that has his very life outside himself, and he experiences everything as grace, as spontaneity, as the immediate self-manifestation of something that transcends him.¹

In the first edition of *Pagan Imperialism* intended for an Italian audience, Evola makes explicit reference to Durkheim and other similar sociologists by name. Although the names are removed in the subsequent German edition, the argument is the same. Durkheim used field studies of primitive societies to reach his conclusions, on the mistaken assumption that they represent earlier stages of evolution of more developed societies. Evola comments on the stage of consciousness of such societies, although he uses the word "totem" in much the same sense as social fact:

¹From *The Individual and the Becoming of the World*.

the totem is the mystical soul of the group, the clan, or the race: the individual members do not feel themselves, in their blood and in their life, as anything other than incarnations of this collective spiritual force, and possessing in themselves almost no trace of personality.

Given Evola's thesis, then, such societies do not represent human societies at all, but something else entirely. In them, individuals are fungible, essentially indistinguishable from each other. Just as in a bale of hay, one piece of straw can be replaced with another without altering the characteristics of the bale, so in such societies the individual members may change without altering the group characteristics. Thus, they persist unchanged for centuries, unless disturbed by outside forces. Evola writes:

If the totemic force remains at this diffuse and faceless level, so to speak, and if, consequently, there are neither leaders nor subjects, and the individual members of the group are nothing more than "placed together" (*com-posti*) — then we find ourselves at the lowest level of human society, at the level which borders on the subhuman, that is, the animal kingdom: this is confirmed by the fact that the totems—the mystical souls of the clan — are often regarded at the same time as the "spirits" of particular animal species. In addition, it is interesting that, even though the totems represent masculine figures, the composition of these societies reflects above all the telluric-matriarchal type.

So, while Durkheim's ideas may pertain to such societies, they are not valid for a Traditional civilisation, properly so called. Thus the claim of sociology to represent a universal knowledge of social groups is falsified. A true civilisation is composed of persons, not individuals. A person, as opposed to the individual, is a conscious agent. As such, he is not replaceable by any arbitrary individual, as he has a specific place and role. The aim of such a civilisation is not to keep its members in bondage to a

lower animal-like form of life, but rather to further develop the personality. Evola explains:

A civilisation, in the true and higher sense — with reference both to individuals and peoples — arises only where the totemic level is surpassed, and where the race element, also understood mystically, is not the last resort; where, beyond blood, a force of higher, meta-biological, spiritual, and “solar” type manifests itself, which does not lead outside of life, but determines life, transforming it, refining it, giving it a form which it initially did not have, freeing it entirely from every mixture with animal life, and opening the various paths for the realisation of the various personality types.

This is not to say that Durkheim’s ideas fail to describe man as he is in a disordered untraditional “civilisation”. Stuck in a worldview of naturalism, materialism, and rationalism, modern man is no longer able to transcend the social fact. Seeing no sense in the idea of a “virile overcoming”, he is mired in sensuality. Unable to discern any connection with a higher world, he is satisfied with an animal existence. Intellectually incapable of understanding the sacred traditional sciences, he subjects himself to the limiting ideas of a scientific positivism as a self-fulfilling prophecy. The modern techniques of mass manipulation — advertising, propaganda, media — have introduced new totems to occlude the personality of modern man. Evola offers an alternative:

Far from exhausting itself in a naturalism — as today only the ignorance or the tendentious falsification of some people are able to present it — beyond knowing the ideals of virile overcoming and of absolute liberation, in the pagan conception, the world was a living body, suffused with secret, divine and demonic forces, with meanings and with symbols, as illustrated by that saying of Olympiodorus: “the sensible expression of the invisible”. Man lived in an organic and essential connection with the forces of the

world and of the supraworld, so that it could be said, with the hermetic expression, to be “a whole within the whole, composed of all the powers”: the sense which is revealed by the aristocratic doctrine of the Atman is no different. And that conception was the basis on which, as a whole in its perfect way, the corpus of the sacred traditional sciences developed.

Posted on 2010-09-06 by Cologero

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VisionsOfGlory14 on 2010-09-06 at 22:41 said:

Durkheim's theories, then, represent a will to turn man into the Totemic, mass type described above. Belief in sociological fixes for problematic Social Facts like suicide presuppose a will to make oneself compliant with the proposed fixes. For instance, Prozac as a tool to “cure” the growing dissatisfaction with modern society presupposes an agent's compliance with the idea that they are simply a “depressed” person in need of the medication.

Durkheim reduces religion and matters of the spirit to the same sociological level, valuing only their communal aspects. His system is an attack on the individual's ability to rise above mere “individuality” and become a person that acts as opposed to being acted upon.

Matt on 2010-09-07 at 00:45 said:

VisionsofGlory14

I very much agree with your sentiments about what appears to be the growing desire to immediately medicate people who have a deeper angst about the existential condition than what is seen on average in a given population. However, and correct me if I'm wrong, I don't agree with (if that's what you meant) that anti-depressants are solely prescribed to make someone not have to deal with the existential and metaphysical concerns/questions of the current human condition. A lot of the time that is the case, but though science is obviously not omnipotent and omniscient, one still cannot dismiss its findings (just like how someone cannot dismiss non-scientific avenues, which is unfortunately is happening more and more). And scientific findings have shown that symptoms like depression and anxiety are sometimes caused by chemical imbalances, and the drugs are then prescribed to try and correct those imbalances. I don't really have a problem with that, it's when they are prescribed when a given individual does not have chemical imbalances. It's the attitude of “this can just be solved by medication and that's that” that I am concerned about.

Matt on 2010-09-07 at 00:59 said:

* The second last sentence in my previous post should have had "its when they are pre-scribed when a given individual does not clearly have a chemical imbalance that I begin to have a problem".

As for Durkhiem, his system has obvious flaws, which rightly pointed out. But with that said, I very much prefer the sociological school of thought that he is associated with (functionalism and socio-biological theory) over all the post modern, feminist, marxist-frankfurt critical theory that dominated sociology for almost all of the second half of the 20th century. Durkhiem, Comte and others at least saw society in very much the same way as Tradition does as an organic composition whose inhabitants' nature/identity are not based solely on social constructs and that much of their identity is not determined by mere society. The only difference is that their worldview does not allow for possibilities that extend beyond the physical/natural.

Cologero on 2010-09-07 at 08:28 said:

It's true that Comte was a counter-revolutionary; in other words, his view was that positivism would provide an intellectually acceptable ground for traditional European society, which had been previously grounded on throne and altar. In the latter part of his life, he took a mystical turn, discerning that sociology was insufficient to explain and motivate European civilisation.

The real issue is that sociology claims to be a science; how then did critical theory and its offshoots gain such a hold in the academy? Imagine geocentrists on the astronomy faculty – not even thinkable. Yet the equivalent is acceptable in the "soft sciences".

Matt on 2010-09-07 at 15:31 said:

Cologero

That is quite interesting about Comte. I didn't know he took that turn in his worldview later on in life.

As for your comment on sociology....yeah, it does seem quite hard to argue that its somehow a science when you take that point you made into account.

Cologero on 2010-09-08 at 21:52 said:

He created a religion of humanity that mimics the trappings of Catholicism without the supernatural. He posits the "Great Being", which, as far as I can tell, collects the great thoughts of humanity. As a positivist, Comte accepts only what can be experienced, and the Great Being is experiential. Maurras has a nice introduction to Comte on this web site:

<http://www.gornahoor.net/Library/AugusteComte.pdf>

A side note involves Solovyov. His doctoral thesis was a polemic against positivism. Yet, later on in life he came to see some positive (pun intended) value in Comte's conception of the

Great Being, which Solovyov related to the Diving Sophia. I have a piece on that topic in the pipeline.

15.3 Solidarity and Continuity

Auguste Comte was a 19th century French philosopher, although seldom read today. He called his philosophical system **Positivism** and he is rightly regarded as the founder of sociology as a science. Dismayed by the French revolution and its aftermaths, Comte was motivated to put the civilization of the Middle Ages on a foundation secured by science rather than faith. His efforts should serve as a model for all contemporary secular reactionaries.

He regarded the social structure of the Middle Ages under the influence of the Catholic Church ("what every well-born person considered sane and normal") as the ideal for humanity; however, in an age of unbelief, only an appeal to science rather than faith can lead to that conviction. He began by ordering the sciences in their natural sequence: mathematics, astronomy, physics, chemistry and biology. Beyond that he proposed sociology and the moral and political science. Towards the end of his life, he attempted to found a non-supernatural religion that he expected to be at the top, though it met with little success.

The Positivist is concerned only with facts and the laws that can be derived from them. This precludes any non-empirical assumptions of a philosophical, ideological or metaphysical nature. In particular, his system doesn't presuppose the doctrines of materialism and determinism which undergird science done today (even if only as methodological presuppositions). Since each science in the hierarchy has its own set of facts, he also avoids reductionism.

Thus, his science of sociology is qualitative since that is the most appropriate way to understand man. This is in sharp contrast to the sociology of today which attempts to apply quantitative methods to describe

human behavior. It is a fortiori opposed to the reductionist efforts that go under the name of sociobiology which replace observed facts with the alleged unobserved acts of genes. No, by direct observation we see the three primary elements human nature: **Feeling, Thought, and Action**. This is where the sociologist starts.

Now, just as the astronomer studies the movements of the planets, and so on for each science, the science of man must begin with History, "regarded as a continuous whole". That provides the set of facts for the study of man, hence, that must be our starting point (not genetics, dialectical materialism, etc.).

The principal feature [of Positivism] is a theory of history which enables us appreciate and become familiar with every mode in which human society has formed itself.

As an example of a social law, we can look at the basis for the cooperation of effort in political and social action.

The consensus of the social organism extends to **Time** as well as **Space**. Hence the two distinct aspects of social sympathy: the feeling of Solidarity, or union with the Present; and of Continuity, or union with the Past. Careful investigation of any social phenomenon, whether relating to Order or to Progress, always proves convergence, direct or indirect, of all contemporaries and of all former generations... In our thoughts and feelings such convergence is unquestionable; and it should be still more evident in our actions, the efficacy of which depends on cooperation to a still greater degree.

In an age where social sympathy is lost or disrupted, we see clearly the path to recovery.

Solidarity This depends on formulating a common basis for thought and feeling. Obviously, this cannot arise simply from a common

genetic heritage or race, as History demonstrates time and again. Rather, this depends on a common moral and spiritual outlook. This seems impossible today when every man is his own pope, but we now have the lineaments of this task based on the works of the Traditional authors.

Continuity Like the Old Pagans of the Ancient City, who venerated their founders and continued their ways, we need to do the same. We have an example of this in the Medieval idea of the Nine Worthies². However, those opposed to the Old Order work overtime to portray the past in the most negative light, or else they ignore it totally. Yet what is more insidious is the neo-right, the self-proclaimed defenders of that order who portray the past in even more vulgar terms than their opponents. Furthermore, rather than using History as the raw material to lead to the understanding of Tradition and social laws, they hold a tendentious and superficial view of that history.

For further reference, please consult these works of Auguste Comte:

General View of Positivism

Appeal to Conservatives

Posted on 2011-07-15 by Cologero

15.4 Family Values

There is a rather oddball notion floating around that the traditional family arrangement is actually unnatural to Europeans and reflects—and this is intended as an insult—“Jewish family values”. This should be of no

²See Section 9.2 in this book.

interest to us, except that it is an idea promoted by self-defined “Traditionalists” and for rather ignoble purposes. Unfortunately, in understanding this matter in its depths, we cannot count on Julius Evola who, while disparaging so-called bourgeois values, actually proscribed important aspects of the Roman tradition. Also, as this is a matter of principle, we cannot appeal to contingent factors such as the “disorder of the world” or “riding the tiger” to justify a truly un-Roman attitude.

Preliminaries We can immediately and unequivocally dismiss the notion on a strictly factual basis: “Jewish family values”, under the Mosaic Law, included polygamy and easy divorce. On the contrary, Roman family values required monogamy and divorce was forbidden or rare.

To demonstrate this both historically and principally, we will make use of two works, one on Ancient Rome, and the other on the Second Rome, describing what well-bred men considered mentally healthy and normal; these are respectively *The Ancient City* by **Numa Denis Fustel de Coulanges** and *The True & Only Wealth of Nations: Essays on Family, Economy & Society* by **Louis de Bonald**.

I want to clarify the method once again, since it may not yet be clear to everyone despite our many posts on the topic. First of all, after gender, the next differentiation in man is caste³, since it refers to fundamental orientation of a man towards the conditions of his being. This is prior to subsequent differentiations such as race, nationality, or religious affiliation. In our day, a man’s caste is not immediately visible to the senses, nor even necessarily understood by the man himself, so they play very little role in social analysis today, except perhaps in its degenerate form of economic class. Yet, it is a fundamental notion, certainly more important than racial or religious characteristics, despite the false importance attributed to these latter distinctions by most “defenders” of Tradition.

³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1698>

The second point is that we regard the Roman Tradition as a spiritual unity. **Rene Guenon** often remarked that the Christian Tradition was unusual in that it did not contain a law in its scriptures. Instead, the Medieval spiritual tradition adopted the old Roman Law; that is why the Mosaic Law was never part of Christianity. Of course, there is a clear and obvious reason for this. The law of the more ancient traditions, including those of the Ancient Cities, comprised detailed requirements for the performance of rites, the conditions of ritual uncleanness, various taboos, and so on. To an outsider, including men today who think they can return to such pagan traditions, these laws would seem arbitrary, even unreasonable. In fact, that is the case; although in general the principles are true, in specifics, the exact relationship is difficult to discern.

As Guenon pointed out, in its origins Christianity was esoteric, hence its primary emphasis was on the interiorization of the law, not on outward observance. Morality, that is, outward observances or law, was secondary. By that I mean nothing more than that morality could be derived from metaphysical and theological principles, and therefore did not require its own revelation. I will expand on this at another time.

This is not at all to deny that the Ancient Tradition lacked an inner or esoteric dimension. The quotes that follow are taken from the two books mentioned; it is easy to see the spiritual continuity between the two.

The Ancient City We have previously indicated, in *The Son of Duty*⁴, the importance of family to the ancient Greeks and Romans. For a man, especially for a man claiming to be recovering the ancient Roman tradition, to deliberately fail in this task, indicates a severe fault and is not at all normative. This is what I mean by a “dead end”, it is the end of a tradition, not a revolt against the modern world which, in any case, is similarly, and radically, opposed to the Traditional patriarchal family. This is how the

⁴See Section 2.5 in this book.

ancient Romans actually did consider it:

[The Ancient City] rendered marriage obligatory; celibacy was a crime in the eyes of a religion that made the perpetuity of the family the first and most holy of duties. But the union which it prescribed could be accomplished only in the presence of the domestic divinities; it is the *religious, sacred, indissoluble union* of the husband and wife. [my emphasis]

Civil marriages were not valid. Adultery was a crime. For the sacred fire should be transmitted from father to son.

The son born of adultery annihilates in this world and in the next the offerings made to the manes.

Of course, this applies to the higher castes, as the plebeians did not have a sacred marriage. The proletarian mentality even today eschews marriage as the high illegitimacy rates attest to. Even so, there are remnants still alive of the old idea as we see in divorce statistics.

A few days ago I saw a famous actor, whom I did not recognize, on a TV interview show. The hostess asked him (an obvious set up question) when he planned to marry his attractive blonde gf named Kirsten. He said they will when their "friends" are allowed to do so. "I don't want to perform a ceremony as long as they can't." There you have it; for the prole mentality of an actor⁵, marriage is not a "sacred union", but only an arbitrary and unnecessary ceremony. Yet, the power of the ancient ideal of marriage persists as we see in these ceremonial elements that go back thousands of years: father gives away the bride, bride wore a veil, white clothing, groom carries her across the threshold, sprinkled with water, bride and groom share a cake.

By law in Greece and Rome, no family could become extinct, and it was the duty of the leaders to prevent this. The modern world, on

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4338>

the contrary, is intent on making the family itself extinct. So, you rebels against the modern world: where do you take your stand? Which path do you intend to take?

Germanic Monogamy Tacitus in *Germania*, sections 18 and 19⁶, describes the Germanic women of his time. Tacitus notes that the matrimonial bond is quite strict among the Germans, with monogamy being the norm. The woman is not the weak link in that relationship; rather she shares fully in their common life:

That the woman may not think herself excused from exertions of fortitude, or exempt from the casualties of war, she is admonished by the very ceremonial of her marriage, that she comes to her husband as a partner in toils and dangers; to suffer and to dare equally with him, in peace and in war: Thus she is to live; thus to die.

Their society is based on chastity, with no “seductive spectacles”, adultery is extremely rare and immediately punished. Young couples are expected to be virgins, so marriage is lifelong. They don’t try to limit children through birth control, nor through infanticide as in other cultures.

That opposition to divorce, promiscuity, adultery, and birth control was very influential on the Roman church. Even the Greeks allow divorce and have been inconsistent on contraception. Of course, the neopagans believe in none of it.

The Ancien Régime The concrete situation in the medieval and subsequent era is different from the ancient city. First of all, the specifics of the rites and duties of family life are not spelled out in detail, but must be inferred. Then, there is the separation of the spiritual authority and political power, so the latter is entrusted with enforcing the law determined

⁶<https://www.gutenberg.org/files/7524/7524-h/7524-h.htm>

by the former. Bonald distinguishes between the domestic professions, which we would call the Third Estate, or the professions of the Vaishya caste, and the public professions of the higher castes of Priests, Administrators, and Warriors. In the book referenced, Bonald discusses the ideas of marriage and divorce. Implicitly rejecting the notion of the social contract as the source of social order, he writes:

Domestic society began with monogamy and the indissolubility of the conjugal bond.

For Bonald, this is not just a religious, or even Catholic, notion, but is fundamental to any Traditional society. Aware of the Roman Tradition, and in agreement with Fustel, he informs us:

For several centuries the Romans fought against divorce. It appeared among them only very late.

Interestingly, he considers the Roman attitude as indicative of the “highest wisdom” and understands the role of Christianity to apply this wisdom to society. In his words:

The highest wisdom made itself heard, the Christianity, which is only the application to society of every moral truth, began by constituting the family, the necessary element of ever public society.

Bonald also pointed to the customs of the Germanic tribes, which he admired:

The general march of society toward civilization was no less constant and continuous, and the peoples of the north, who in the end came to renew the worn-out body of the Roman Empire, received the Christian religion from the vanquished wherever they settled in exchange for the monarchical constitution that they brought to them.

As for their attitude toward divorce, “[divorce] was not so among the people [Germanics] whose martial way of life was chaste and simple.

For Bonald, marriage is understood in its organic wholeness, and is farthest thing from a “right” or to the personal whim of just the two parties involved. He explains:

[Regarding divorce], the government will have fulfilled all its duties toward religion when it will have seen to it that the bond of marriage, formed by the mutual consent of the parties, guaranteed by the civil power, and consecrated by the religious power, cannot be dissolved by law.

Marriage is at once a domestic, a civil, and a religious act which, in the public state of society, requires for its validity the concurrence of the three domestic, civil, and religious powers: In the consent of the two parties, authorized by their parents, in the intervention of the civil power, and in the concurrence of the religious authority. Once the bond had been formed by this triple knot, and the family that it has founded has taken its place among the families that compose the State, the legislator should consider it as an integral part, inseparable from the great political whole, composed itself of families, religion, and the State.

This is absolutely incomprehensible and absurd to the modern mind which understands society to be composed of individuals, not families, and religion to be a private, rather than public, matter. Even at the time Bonald was writing, in the generation following the French Revolution, marriage was considered a mere civil contract, requiring only the consent of the two parties. Clearly, this the dominant view today, among the chattering classes. Their ill-equipped opponents simply sound ridiculous to educated people today. That is because they sense something is wrong with the modern view, but they lack the intellectual tools to oppose it; a fortiori, their viewpoint is actually consistent with what they oppose. For

example, in the USA, the dominant Protestant ideology sees no sacred or sacramental character in marriage, they oppose any public spiritual authority, and their view of society is itself individualistic and atomic, rather than organic. That they are shocked by recent developments is itself shocking.

That the civil power would have any say in marriage is rejected today. Here is Bonald's view on that notion, although his sanguinity is unjustified, given subsequent developments:

The right of the civil authority to establish impediments to marriage will not, I am sure, be contested. Politics, sometimes more stern than religion admits some that religion has not been able to recognize.

For example, from a strictly theological perspective, parental approval and certain levels of consanguinity may not be absolute impediments to marriage; the Church is more interested in the parties sharing the same religion. Nevertheless, the State itself can require parental permission; it can also prohibit marriages both to close relatives and even to those whose bloodlines are too different from each other. Such laws would be impossible today.

In continuity with the requirement of the Ancient City to preserve the family, Bonald provides his own understanding of it, along with a disturbing prophecy:

Let us make bold to say it: The State has no power over the family except to affirm its bond, and not to dissolve it. And if the State destroys the family, the family in its turn will avenge itself and will silently undermine the State.

Posted on 2012-07-28 by Cologero

* * *

Andrew on 2012-07-28 at 16:29 said:

While I agree with this in principle, realizing such a marriage is the difficulty. Is this something that would be worth expatriation and moving to a "healthier" society?

Matt on 2012-07-28 at 16:49 said:

On a related note, recent statistics also show that on average, those in the upper-classes are more religious than those in the lower classes. Not too surprising considering marriage and religion seem to be linked....though it is surprising to the current assumption of today that the lower-classes are more religious and committed to marriage than the upper-class. This then gets to the question (for Gornahoor readers its rather rhetorical) that is really interesting....since the modern assumption of marriage/religion and its relation to the proles does not align with reality, where does this assumption originate from?

Izak on 2012-07-28 at 16:53 said:

Good work.

Although the guy responsible for the theory you're refuting makes a few good points here and there, this essay needed to be written nevertheless, if not only to help establish the basic universal quality of human heterosexual partner-bonding. My guess is that the "mannerbund theory" (or whatever) will blow over fairly quickly.

Cologero on 2012-07-28 at 17:06 said:

"While I agree with this in principle, realizing such a marriage is the difficulty."

I'm afraid I have no advice to you, Andrew, as all we can talk about are principles. The required social structures no longer exist. Nevertheless, action follows thought.

Matt on 2012-07-28 at 17:18 said:

Izak,

Yes, the whole "Mannerbund theory" is an interesting case.

I'm reminded of what Evola said in his book on eros. In the chapter on homosexuality, Evola stated that pederasty may have had a noble origin as a purely platonic relation ("only a love of the boy's soul" to quote Evola, if my memory serves me well). And I think that is probably the case with the mannerbund/male warrior phenomenon....in that it most likely started out as a chaste, brotherly love relation and then eventually declined to where it turned into a relationship of an erotic nature.

Aghorable on 2012-07-29 at 05:26 said:

Turning now to the question of conjugality...

Our good host asks where we rebels take our stand, what will be our path; I fear that more than a few readers have, after lobbing a few stones at the forces of the modern world, long since passed beyond what we might call the rampart of rebellion. They now trek through the deeps of the Detachment Forest, soothing their wounds with help from the nymphs and gnomes who dance and play at the edge of the waters of the Lagoon of Indifference, and seeking the uncharted lands beyond.

One Ms Moretti recently wrote an article published on another website, where she eloquently summarised the issue: "So stop intellectually masturbating to Evola and go make your Nordic gods proud." And this for a relatively 'activist' audience – imagine the bombs she would drop if she partied with us!

Cologero comments, in response to Andrew: "The required social structures no longer exist. Nevertheless, action follows thought."

I think it is worth mentioning the interesting writings of a Karlo Z. Valois, wherein he treats of behavioural orientations (his 'style elements' as they pertain to those, including women, who open and seek to follow the way of a superior, vertical development in our current unfavourable milieu. He does this without collapsing into trivialities. The writings can be found on his dormant but still online blog.

Indeed, the fact that the social structures no longer exist means that the highest reasons for getting married and having children in the West have sadly evaporated, and so we see (and will continue to see) appeals to surviving but subordinate reasons from interested quarters. Will this be enough to seduce students of spiritual perfection who hide in their hearts visions of love and order so rarefied that, as Cologero says, the modern mentality would find them incomprehensible and ridiculous?

Perhaps a cultivated detachment will eventually motivate some of us to take a woman (or three) for wife precisely because we have jettisoned all fear about the outcome, the glorious *Me ne frego!*

Yes, de-detachment. Oh the lure of Mephistopheles!

Michael on 2012-07-29 at 11:24 said:

Outstanding post, but this statement raises a question: "Of course, this applies to the higher castes, as the plebeians did not have a sacred marriage."

How does one know whether he is a member of a higher caste or a plebeian? It sounds like it makes a difference as to what type of marriage one should pursue.

Cologero on 2012-07-29 at 12:13 said:

"It sounds like it makes a difference as to what type of marriage one should pursue." A plebeian would not even bother to ask himself that question.

Izak on 2012-07-29 at 19:30 said:

Matt: I wouldn't be surprised.

Aghorable: Over on corrupt.org, which I think was originally meant to be a nihilist blog (?), the last few entries were about how wonderful it is to get married in one's mid-twenties, completely oblivious and indifferent to the decay of the surrounding world. It only makes sense that the blog was discontinued soon thereafter.

Similarly, there was another blog called In Mala Fide, which was also intended to be a nihilist blog, and the last few entries there from the blog's curator were about the virtues of abstaining from meaningless sexuality, masturbation, and rejecting the basic onanism of society at large. That blog also was discontinued soon thereafter.

All of this makes sense to me. These people are probably doing more good without blogs than with them.

Aghorable on 2012-07-30 at 21:35 said:

I wrote above "...the fact that the social structures no longer exist means that the highest reasons for getting married and having children in the West have sadly evaporated..."

Inspired by an excerpt on marriage from the writings of Bô Yin Râ, I feel it necessary to state that just as there is nothing in principle preventing a man from attaining full spiritual integration even in our day, there is nothing in principle preventing a man and woman from coming together (no pun intended!) and likewise spiritually reintegrating one another, this being the highest reason for getting married. Indeed, the first case will always involve a 'marriage' of sorts (i.e. not necessarily to a person), for every complete spiritual integration must resolve the male-female binary.

Therefore, the highest reason for getting married actually cannot 'evaporate' entirely; the important social reasons can (and largely have), and the possibilities of realisation may not be great, but let it clearly be said that there are likely many cases of lovers who even today have forged commitments that carry them beyond the profane to a greater or lesser extent, so it is not vain to seek to make this the basis of your personal spiritual opus.

May the Eternal Lover light our path.

Sparrow on 2015-05-22 at 19:04 said:

No doubt most, if not all, of those peddling this nonsense about traditional family values being Semitic, are the same people who fawn over the Vikings and pagan societies as (alleged) proto-feminists. Such folk dominate the White Nationalist scene.

15.5 Prolegomena to Historiography

As an experiment in historiography, I was planning to analyze the recent election in the USA. However, it became obvious that some prefatory notes are necessary. It is pointless to repeat what has already been said ten thousand times, words that convince no opponent and shed little light for their supporters because they are based on unsupported opinion rather than metaphysical principles. We take it for granted, at least in small things, that acting against reality will lead to dissatisfactory results. At the physical level, the negative outcome may be immediate: a child learns that falling or touching a hot object leads to immediate pain.

Unfortunately, the feedback may not be immediate. For example, a woman may go from one abusive relationship to the next before she understands, if ever, the role she herself was playing. At the social level, it may take generations for the lesson to be learned. As it is said, the iniquities of the fathers fall on the children. Very few men have the acuity to see how decisions made today will affect their descendants three generations hence. Fundamentally, this is because the deciders themselves are ignorant of the cosmic Order and act against it. They seldom experience the consequences of their acts.

So in the midst of this endless discussion, no one ever bothers to pause to ask why people hold the opinions they do, why they persist in holding them in the face of all illogic and counterfactual evidence, and why all debate ends in *aporia* rather than a higher resolution. If we start with the reasonable assumption that all rational men act in accordance to what they consider to be real, the only conclusion is that men have different notions of what is real. The remarkable fact is that men will not budge from their positions. No matter how poorly he may have done in school or on tests—which should certainly bring a measure of intellectual humility—every man is convinced he understands the real.

For a few, there is an understanding of the transcendent as real. For

others, it is nobility and virtue. A much larger group can only accept the material world as real, while the masses have no reality beyond their own satisfactions. These various understandings of the real are characteristic of caste. It is important to keep in mind that caste is a metaphysical principle, i.e., an expression of the very nature of things, hence it surpasses any moral or psychological considerations. Specifically, caste is not detectable by psychological methods, nor is it “curable”. Furthermore, there is no moral significance to caste, so any discussion of their characteristics does not imply any moral judgment, whether positive or negative.

Nevertheless, the same cannot be said for any disorder in their power relationships. In a Traditional society those who know, will lead, and the rest will believe depending on their positions. For example, the man whose concern is with the physical world will nevertheless be able to participate in the transcendent through his faith in his leaders. Of course, the modern world rejects this, because of its commitment to egalitarianism; all men are equal insofar as they are animals, but not in respect to their Intellects. Only in the primordial state are there no caste distinctions.

Fundamental to this historiography is the notion of Order in general, and specifically how that manifests in the relationship of the different castes to each other. Although we have written enough posts about the castes of those who pray (Brahman) and those who fight (Kshatriya), their influence on the modern world is essentially negligible. Since the rule of the modern world is in the hands of those who work, the characteristics of the relevant castes need to be more fully fleshed out.

Frithjof Schuon’s discussion of castes provides a fuller discussion of this topic. The castes categorize the different way that men understand what is real.

- **Brahman.** Those who pray. This is the intellectual, contemplative and sacerdotal type. For him, the changeless and the transcendent are real. He is an idealist (i.e., ideas are real) and objective (he can transcend his own perspective).

- **Kshatriya.** Those who fight. This is the warrior or the administrator type. For him, it is action that is real. His aggression is tempered by generosity, and his passionate nature by nobility, self-control, and greatness of soul. He values action, honour, virtue, glory and nobility. This caste is also idealist, but in a subjective way.
- **Vaishya (or bourgeois).** This is the first division of those who work. He is the merchant, the peasant, the artisan, the man whose activities are directly bound up with material values. For him, it is riches, security, prosperity and well-being that are real. He even thinks of religion in a material and economic way, which he understands as the need to accumulate merit. This caste is materialist and objective.

These three castes constitute the twice-born, or spirits with a body. Beyond them, men can be described only as a body with a human consciousness.

- **Shudra (or serf).** Of those who work, the shudra who can only perform manual work of a quantitative type. For him, it is bodily things that are real, such as eating, drinking, the satisfaction of physical needs, and all other corporeal or sensual activities. This caste is materialist and subjective. Thus, the shudra is passive in relation to matter, hence he cannot govern himself. Therefore, he is dependent on the will of another which, in a well-ordered society, would be the spiritual authorities who guide and protect him. Their religion is the one that makes them feel good.
- **Chandala.** This is the outcast, the man lacking caste because of his chaotic character. He exists because he realizes the possibilities that other men reject and exists on the fringe of a normal society. Schuon claims he may appear as a "chimney sweep, acrobat, comedian, or executioner, not to mention illicit occupations."

Those who have understood thus far will come to some immediate conclusions. The USA is under the dominance of the bourgeois, serfs, and even outcasts. It is their rivalries and power struggles that determine events. There is no possibility of returning to "traditional values" in this milieu. Just as the woodsmen can determine what animals surround him at night in the woods just by listening carefully to their sounds, so can we hear the words rise up from the various castes. Those of the bourgeoisie insist that "it is the economy, stupid." The serfs are interested in physical satisfactions, hence they want to keep feticide, sodomy, and drug use or drunkenness (meant in the larger sense as the deliberately induced impairment of normal conscious activities) all legal. Even the outcasts have a place in this society. An entire generation of American youths get their news from a comedian. Rock stars and actors mould public opinion. The USA admires in a crude way the gangster, the prostitute, the pusher, and so on. The ugly, the dissonant, the unusual, the freakish, the perverted have destroyed their taste for the beautiful, the harmonious, the normal, the sane, the healthy.

There are some direct quotations from *Castes and Races* by Frithjof Schuon.

Posted on 2012-11-13 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-11-13 at 22:14 said:

"A much larger group can only accept the material world as real, while the masses have no reality beyond their own satisfactions."

This is an important distinction and worth explaining in full. After all, we live in an age where such an esteemed moral philosopher as Richard Dawkins conceives of reality as a "virtual world" created inside our heads, without any understanding of the values that are caused by such a view.

Cologero on 2012-11-13 at 23:47 said:

Can we conclude that Dawkins, then, is a subjective materialist, i.e., a serf? Since his mentality is limited, you can see there is no fact or logical argument to budge him from his conception of reality as mind produced. Given his assumptions, has he ever been able to explain how people of quite modest intelligence are able to create such complex “virtual worlds”?

Aziz Ali on 2012-11-14 at 05:27 said:

How does one find out which caste one belongs to? On one hand I have an interest in this kind of “unconventional” spirituality/metaphysics, on the other hand I do enjoy standup-comedy and hip-hop & r’n b (albeit not exclusively). If I am a shudra or a tschandala, maybe I’m missing the point of reading these kinds of blogs and related literature and reading them for the wrong reasons. Isn’t the most Traditional thing of me to do, then, to stop caring about Tradition and do what I’m metaphysically designed to do best?

Cologero on 2012-11-14 at 07:49 said:

If only life were so easy, that we could categorize everyone, put him in a box, and arrange him on a shelf. The Spirit blows where He wills and we judge not by appearances. There have been crazy saints and men of blame (malamatiyah).

Schuon aptly puts it:

If religious hypocrisy is an inevitable fact, the contrary must also be possible, namely wisdom and virtue hiding under appearances of scandal.

As Guenon points out, today hardly anyone is in his natural place. We judge caste by level of understanding; a shudra personality would have little interest in anything truly metaphysical. At the level of knowledge, we are the same, but that does not imply outer conformity.

Read what Nietzsche writes about giving style to one’s character⁷ and then avoid being gloomy.

Avery Morrow on 2012-11-14 at 08:27 said:

The list above is intended to answer that question, but if you don’t recognize yourself in those spiritual categories, let me restate them a little:

Brahmans have direct access to the Divine. They understand their life calling and can intuit traditional knowledge. A brahman wouldn’t be offended by stand-up comedy, understanding the nature of its arising, but wouldn’t need it to enjoy life either.

Kshatriyas have knowledge of virtue and, if they understand it properly, can attribute virtue to the Divine. Kshatriyas become fed up with a world full of heterodoxies and settle into a single

⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=11>

orthodoxy. They are the caste you may be imagining who would be offended by rap music if they are not members of the culture that actually produces rap.

Vaishyas, when directed properly, believe in reality and therefore in an Order to reality. When misdirected by outside forces, they stop believing in order and pretend to deny reality (Dawkins falls into this category), and instead propose that traditional institutions should revise their principles to meet the needs of the lower castes, and that all metaphysics is simply an expression of taste, preference, and sentiment.

Shudras simply don't believe that anything can exist outside their perceptions. They believe that religion is only good for getting what you want. They have no conception of metaphysics and would not understand any of this blog. Dawkins does not actually fall into this category because if he did, he wouldn't be writing books, he would just be hanging out in pubs using his high-falutin fancy talk to scam men and seduce women.

Outcasts, for some reason or another, have been excluded from mainstream society so they lack access to their society's tradition, including what Guenon calls the "initiation". Instead, the force that dominates their minds is chaos, and they must take whatever work they can get in a world of chaos. An outcast can maneuver his way into one society or another if he works hard for it, but he can also be manipulated as a disruptive agent if he does not try to deepen his understanding.

Note that Western society, i.e. late modernity, attempts to make life easy for shudras and outcasts especially.

Avery Morrow on 2012-11-14 at 08:37 said:

By the way, that comment was completely off the top of my head, as part of the conversation about this post; I haven't read as much as Cologero on this subject and I don't mean to contradict any information he has.

Logres on 2012-11-14 at 09:07 said:

Just from watching the bookshelves, you can see that most (or at least a large part) of American new literature is about shudras and outcastes – that is, goldenhearted crazy people who "make good" in the end, one way or the other. TV, on the other hand, seems to still revolve around the merchant caste, mainly. Is this anyone else's experience?

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-14 at 17:14 said:

From my own readings, I've come to feel that I am a debased Kshatriya, debased because I am not able to perform my natural function in this society. One aspect of my Kshatriya nature is that I'm not interested so much in Tradition as an abstract ideal but rather Tradition as the knowledge and practice of my ancestors. I love to learn but at the same time find learning useless unless it is combined with actual actions that I can perform. To the modern world, I am

an outcast because I find that my personality is too strong to fit in with the mediocrity and nihilism of the masses.

I think there is a problem that Kshatriyas, if they remain uninitiated, can find themselves debased by the modern world into chandalas and warriors for the forces of destruction.

Michael on 2012-11-14 at 18:13 said:

Is there a connection between caste and European nobility? Is it fair to assume that a European noble belongs to one of the upper castes?

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-14 at 18:23 said:

Used to be the case but now I question it – I've known some people of noble descent who behaved no better than ghetto scum....

Dominion on 2012-11-14 at 19:24 said:

I'd say this was probably the case in the first few generations, when the caste was proven through warfare and when new blood could enter it at will so long as they showed the characteristics of the caste. When it became institutionalized and 'closed', the degeneration began.

Saladin on 2012-11-14 at 21:45 said:

Excellent observations! I agree with almost all of the ideas expressed except that "the rule of the modern world is in the hands of those who work [i.e. Vaishias and Shudras]." I disagree! I am certain that you are well aware of 'La Guerre occulte' waged against every Tradition on the face of the earth. This occult war is not directed by "those who work". These multitudes only serve as tools or at best auxiliaries of the real masters of the Anti-traditional party. Therefore, if we only consider the human "leaders" of the Counter-Initiation (and leave the more sinister forces and entities who control these men), we are forced to acknowledge that the masters of the modern world are either castless or Brahmans who have gone astray (if such a thing is in fact possible).

Mihai on 2012-11-15 at 04:07 said:

Dawkins never used the term "moral philosopher" to describe himself, nor any kind of "philosopher" for that matter. He writes about religious and/or philosophical matters because he believes that anyone can talk about these things according to fancy, since they do not come under any empirical observation.

His works on religion and morals display a complete ignorance of even high-school level philosophy and logic. In general they are mere rambling, without any basic knowledge about the topic discussed in them.

Avery Morrow on 2012-11-16 at 22:44 said:

Yes, I was being sarcastic.

Max on 2015-05-02 at 10:29 said:

The third caste have been on the decline and is becoming rarer. How often today is someone actually producing something of quality, just speaking in material terms? Capitalism is likewise uncommon even though some cling on to names without understanding their meaning. Enlightenment-type rationality is almost gone, with universities now occupied with conforming to popular opinion. Shudras are a majority, but what is more disturbing is an idealization of outcasts. They have been moving behind the scenes, manipulatively providing entertainment or whatever for the masses. The bourgeois would have found that repulsive, but they have been replaced by shudras on many official positions.

15.6 Power and Intelligence

The strong man strikes only when it is absolutely necessary, and then nothing stops him.

VILFREDO PARETO

Modern civilized man cannot endure cruelty, pain and suffering and is more merciful than men of the past, but this is not because he is morally and spiritually higher than they. He fears pain and suffering more than they did; he is more effeminate, less firm, patient and courageous than they; in other words he is spiritually less strong.

NICOLAS BERDYAEV

The sociologist and economist **Vilfredo Pareto**, through a positivist analysis of the human condition, went far in uncovering the underlying roots and causes of events. His insights are still valid today, and the most famous is probably the 80-20 rule. He makes the important distinction between

logical and non-logical actions. The latter are the most important in determining the social system, since logic and rationality are beyond the capabilities of most people. If you are still not convinced, tell me what proportion of the population could pass even an elementary university course in logic or economics.

Nevertheless, there are those who insist on argumentation, believing they have the perfect syllogism to defeat all opposing views. They just get themselves frustrated or else engage it interminable discussions like a band of intellectual Highlanders, when what is necessary is decision. What follows is a brief review of Pareto's description of the role of the elites within a society.

Distribution of Wealth and Power

The curve of the distribution of wealth in western societies varies very little from one period to another. What has been called the social pyramid is, in reality a sort of upturned top.

That is, it is like a bell curve except that the base is wide, and the slope to the narrow top is much steeper. Since that distribution is constant across time and space, Pareto concludes it is not by chance, but must be related to physiological and psychological characteristics of human beings. This is not static, since within the system, some men may grow rich while others become poorer.

Similar curves would arise from distributions of various aptitudes or moral qualities. But therein lies the root of the contempt of intellectuals and saints for wealth, since those who achieve the latter do so without excelling in those qualities of intelligence or moral virtues. The Church says that God prefers the poor and **Origen** said that the intelligent are more congenial to God than the unintelligent, whereas Calvinists regard wealth as a sign of God's election. The Church is making a good bet since there will always be the poor among you, as even Jesus admits. Politicians

also benefit since they can boast about soaking the rich and benefitting the poor, while logic says that is a futile endeavor. But it keeps them in power and the logic of power is illogical.

The same diagram applies to those possessing political power with a large overlap with the wealthier elements; these he calls the aristocracy. Once again, the qualities necessary to grab and hold power are not great intelligence and moral virtues. Pareto points out this fact of “extreme importance”:

Aristocracies do not last. They are all subject to a more or less rapid decline.

The good news is that the apparent stranglehold of the Modern Consensus Reality over political systems will not last, but will necessarily collapse from its own illogic. This god, too, will die. The bad news is for so-called white nationalists who have been displaced for the same reasons. Those who manage lightly read blogs do not have the qualities necessary for the will to power, although they know how to talk about it. But power is not logic, and logical and scientific reasoning will convince no one as long as they can maintain power by other means.

One of the causes of the extinction of aristocracies is their degeneracy. You have heard of the Boston Brahmins? They were the descendants of the Puritans and used to have a financial and political stranglehold over Massachusetts. Yet they put themselves out to pasture by the immigration of the Irish, and then other groups; hence the Kennedy name is now associated with Boston politics. There are no Brahmins left to complain. Some, however, have a longer memory. A Greek woman recently told me that the Greeks used to be blonde and blue-eyed until the Turks polluted them. Apparently, she resents her brown hair.

Circulation of the Elites Pareto explains that aristocracies can subsist only by the elimination of the degenerate elements and the adhesion

of new ones, i.e., a process of elimination and assimilation analogous to biological systems. If this circulation fails, the animal dies. The same applies to the elite, even if it takes longer to notice. It may happen that as degeneracy increases among the elites, there is an increase in the number of elements of superior quality within the subject classes. In this case, the social equilibrium becomes unstable, and a revolution or conquest may bring a new elite into power. Pareto, writing before 1916, shows great prescience in this paragraph:

For contemporary European societies, conquest by foreign eugenic groups has been of no significance since the last great barbarian invasions, and it no longer exists as a factor in the European social organism. But there is nothing to indicate that it cannot appear again in the future. If European societies were to model themselves on the ideal dear to the humanitarians, if they should go so far as to inhibit selection, to favour systematically the weak, the vicious, the idle, the ill adapted—the “small and humble” as they are termed by our philanthropists—at the expense of the strong, the energetic who constitute the elite, then a new conquest by new “barbarians” would by no means be impossible.

This vision alone commands us to consider Pareto carefully. He claims that the new elements indispensable to the subsistence of the elites will come from the lower classes as the crucible in which are being formed, in the dark, the future elites. That made sense in 1915, when Europe was not ethnically diverse and the lower classes had more children, many of them dying young. This produced a hardier stock. However, because of technology, these classes now have many of the benefits that only the elite used to have; furthermore, the new lower classes are now ethnically distinct from the elite. As for the elite, Pareto points out:

The high-minded people who would persuade the rich classes in our societies to have many children, the humanitarians who give

no thought to replacing them by others, are working without realizing it for the enfeeblement of the race, for its degeneracy. If the rich classes in our societies had many children, it is probable they would save almost all of them, even the sickliest and the least gifted.

Of course, nowadays all classes are having fewer children since most of them, weak and strong, now survive through medical technology and government economic aid. Pareto insists for various reasons that the elite will be replenished from the rural classes. It is hard to see that as true now, but perhaps the new elite will come from among the survivalists, seed savers, and gold hoarders if some extensive collapse should occur. The collapse of the elite is not merely hereditary. Pareto gives the example of the Catholic clergy:

What a profound decadence this elite underwent between the ninth and eighteenth centuries! The decadence originates from the fact that the elite, in recruiting itself, chose subjects of increasingly mediocre caliber.

Does this sound familiar? In filling its ranks today, do the ruling classes select the most intelligent, the most learned, the strongest, the creative? Seldom, unless such men can force themselves into its ranks. Rather, external characteristics are now more important to promote “values” that are unrelated to the actually functional needs of governing.

The Decadence of the Aristocracy The simple way of looking at things is to presume an elite against the masses, although it is not so simple. Following Pareto, **A** will designate the elite, **B** the social element seeking to displace it, and **C** the rest of the population. A and B count on C for support; in fact, A despises C while B tries to be their champion. In many cases B can slowly infiltrate A, thus avoiding open conflict; in that

case, there may be a period of prosperity thus obscuring that infiltration, or at least, the resistance to it.

As B attains power and there is prosperity, most will ascribe its merit to C, "the people". Since some of the new elite may arise from C, this seems plausible to some. Nevertheless, the lower classes are always and everywhere incapable of ruling themselves. Pareto points out that many among the B

genuinely believe that they are pursuing, not a personal advantage for themselves and their class, but an advantage for the C, and that they are simply struggling for what they call justice, liberty, humanity.

Unfortunately for them, A is also affected by this illusion and many among them betray the interests of their class, believing they are fighting for the realization of these fine principles all to help the unfortunate C. Ironically, the sole effect of that position is that the A simply helps the B to attain power. The few among the A and B who may glimpse what is going on make accusations of hypocrisy. Nevertheless, they are sincere in their delusions, hence not hypocrites.

Only those who are scientific, objective, logical, and detached can understand the entire process. Please try this thought experiment at home: in the USA today, who are the A, the B, and the C, and how is this drama being played out? It is obvious to those who think clearly about it and I need not, and will not, spell it out. Now, I have described the way of contemplation. Those who prefer the way of action will have to become the B without, however, himself falling into the illusion that energizes it. Few men are capable of that. He will have to be hard and strong as well as scientific and detached. Otherwise, we get this as Pareto describes:

A sign which almost invariably presages the decadence of an aristocracy is the intrusion of humanitarian feelings and of affected

sentimentalizing which render the aristocracy incapable of defending its position. Violence, we should note, is not to be confused with force. Often enough one observes cases in which individuals and classes which have lost the force to maintain themselves in power make themselves more and more hated because of their outbursts of random violence. The strong man strikes only when it is absolutely necessary, and then nothing stops him. Trajan was strong, not violent: Caligula was violent, not strong.

Pareto makes clear that social phenomena are extremely complex and this is only part of it. I will conclude with some quotes from Pareto, letting them speak for themselves.

When a living creature loses the sentiments which, in given circumstances are necessary to it in order to maintain the struggle for life, this is a certain sign of degeneration, for the absence of these sentiments will, sooner or later, entail the extinction of the species. The living creature which shrinks from giving blow for blow and from shedding its adversary's blood thereby puts itself at the mercy of this adversary.

Any people which has horror of blood to the point of not knowing how to defend itself will sooner or later become the prey of some bellicose people or other.

For right or law to have reality in a society, force is necessary. Whether developed spontaneously or whether the work of a minority, law and order cannot be imposed on dissidents save by force.

In considering successful changes of institutions, persuasion should not be contrasted with force. Persuasion is but a means for procuring force.

An elite which is not prepared to join in battle to defend its positions is in full decadence, and all that is left to it is to give way to another elite having the virile qualities it lacks. It is pure day

dreaming to imagine that the humanitarian principles it may have proclaimed will be applied to it: its vanquishers will stun it with the cry: "Woe to the vanquished". The knife of the guillotine was being sharpened in the shadows when, at the end of the eighteenth century, the ruling classes in France were engrossed in developing their "sensibility". This idle and frivolous society, living like a parasite off the country, discoursed at its elegant supper parties of delivering the world from superstition and of crushing "l'Infame", all unsuspecting that it was about to be crushed.

Posted on 2013-05-01 by Cologero

15.7 Family Values

If anyone does not provide for his relatives, and especially for his immediate family, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever.

1 TIMOTHY 5:8

The method of Positivism is to derive sociological laws from observing man as he is, not as how one would wish him to be in accordance with some ideological scheme. One such observation is that man is a social being with natural and organic relationships, not an isolated entity engaging solely in contractual relationships, as the liberal would have it. In accounting for this social feeling, Comte writes:

There are three successive states of morality answering to the three principal stages of human life; the personal, the domestic, and the social stage.

Between self-love and social feeling, Comte places domestic attachments on which "the solution of the great moral problem depends." Comte elaborates:

The love of his family leads Man out of his original state of Self-love and enables him to attain finally a sufficient measure of Social love. Every attempt on the part of the moral educator to call this last into immediate action, regardless of the intermediate stage, is to be condemned as utterly chimerical and profoundly injurious. Such attempts are regarded in the present day with far too favourable an eye. Far from being a sign of social progress, this would, if successful, be an immense step backwards ...

On the one hand, then, we see today — even more so than in Comte's — the attempt to induce an indiscriminate universal love in disregard for natural and organic familial relationships. These latter, instead, are under attack and “family” becomes no more than a definition, fluidly and tendentiously redefined. On the other hand, the “defenders” of family values limit themselves to an idealized image of the nuclear family and are unable to relate it to the larger social whole and probably would even reject the conclusion were they able to even see it clearly. Thus, true social feeling is forcibly separated from its natural and organic roots; in its place, there is only a legal fiction which can only be enforced by increasingly onerous laws and other social controls.

Comte identifies four familial relations that aid the transition from the individual to social feeling:

- Filial love
- Fraternal love
- Conjugal love
- Paternal love

Filial Love Filial love is the affection of the child toward its parents. It is the starting point of moral education and the instinct of Continuity springs from it. The social consequence, then, is reverence for our ancestors which binds us to the whole past history of our people.

Fraternal Love Fraternal, or brotherly, love is the affection of child toward its brothers and sisters. From it, the instinct of Solidarity arises. Hence, we learn unity with contemporaries. Relationships become voluntary rather than involuntary.

Conjugal Love The second stage of moral education begins with conjugal love—"the highest type of all sympathetic instincts" — in which the "perfect fullness of devotion is secured by the reciprocity and indissolubility of the bond."

Paternal Love From the conjugal relationship, paternal love comes next.

It completes the training by which Nature prepares us for universal sympathy: for it teaches care for our successors; and thus it binds us to the Future, as filial love had bound us to the Past.

Posted on 2008-11-30 by Cologero

15.8 Sex and Liberation

It is no secret now that lust is also a form of addiction. My point here is that the current regime knows this and exploits this situation to its own advantage. In other words, sexual freedom is really a form of social control...The truth, the one propagated by the regime through advertising, sex education, Hollywood films, and the university system — the truth, in other words, for general

consumption — is that sexual liberation is freedom. The esoteric truth, the one that informs the operations manual of the regime — in other words the people who benefit from “liberty” — is the exact opposite, namely, that sexual liberation is a form of control, a way of maintaining the regime in power by exploiting the passions of the naïve, who identify with their passions as if they were their own and identify with the regime which ostensibly enables them to gratify these passions.

E MICHAEL JONES, *Libido Dominandi*⁸

These began with divine ideas by way of contemplation of the heavens with the bodily eyes. Thus in their science of augury the Romans used the verb *contemplari* for observing the parts of the sky whence the auguries came or the auspices were taken.

GIAMBATTISTA VICO, *The New Science*

Intro During my youth, I used to study the writings of Herbert Marcuse, sometimes called the “Julius Evola of the Left.” There is some justice in that appellation since their interests overlapped — fascism, sexuality, the drug culture, hippies, etc. — and they both opposed the modern world, particularly in the dual pincers of American capitalism and Soviet communism.

In *Reason and Revolution*, his study of Hegel, Marcuse opposed the monopoly of rationalism by positive science. Thus philosophy or metaphysics has a claim on truth and rationality. That has stuck with me, particularly because my fields of study were maths, physics, and chemistry.

In *One Dimensional Man*, he documented the deleterious effects of consumer society on human fulfillment. I was especially interested in

⁸http://culturewars.com/CultureWars/1999/libido_ad.html

Eros and Civilization. Marcuse combined the personal and the social in a powerful way. That technique provides a lesson for the development of a historiography of the right. For example, we've related Plato's political systems to the rule of men dominated by the different soul centers.

This brief essay continues that project, albeit in a sketched-out form. For the reconstruction of the prehistory of the West, I am relying on **Giambattista Vico's** *New Science* as well as **Fustel de Coulange's** *Ancient City*, as well as the studies of myths by **J J Bachofen**, **Julius Evola** and **Julian Jaynes**.

Eros and Civilization At that time, it was possible to be a materialist atheist using Darwin, Freud and Marx as the foundation. Life, mind, and society could be explained without recourse to anything transcendent. Marcuse combined Freud and Marx very effectively. Marx had always claimed that consciousness was formed by the material conditions of life, without explaining how. Marcuse took the major themes of Freudian psychology to show how social structures become reflected in human psychology.

Thus Freud's major themes of sexuality and repression could be explained in the individual by the systems of production and consumption. Since Freud's conceptions are ultimately conservative, Marcuse had to rework his ideas quite a bit.

As is common with the left, Marcuse felt that men are born good but become repressed by society. Unlike Freud who contended that the sexual instinct (eros) had to be sublimated for civilization to develop, Marcuse claimed that unleashed sexuality is liberating and constructive. For Freud, the superego, by absorbing cultural norms, was able to repress sexuality. However, for Marcuse, the superego instead absorbed unjust social structures. This "surplus repression" was beyond anything really necessary.

The Freudian system apes the traditional view of man. The ego is the

self, or rational center of consciousness. The superego is what is transcendent to the ego and the id represents desires and instincts. Of course, for Freud there is no real transcendence, hence it can be explained only by material terms; that provides the opening for Marcuse.

So if the superego is merely the result of alienated consciousness, there is no reason at all to suppress the instincts. The assumption must be that they are good in themselves, which really means that Darwinian random evolution somehow produces the good.

Freud said that we go through three stages: oral, anal, genital. In maturity, our sexuality is centered on the genital phase. Marcuse regarded that as a form of repression. Hence, in his utopian vision of human centered production based on technology, the fully developed human would become polymorphous perverse, like a child. His whole body would be sexually charged, without the repression of the oral and anal stage.

That hardly seems like a manly or worthwhile goal, but there is little doubt that such an idea resonates in contemporary culture. This is evident from the porno film *Deep Throat* in the 1970s which mainstreamed fellatio to more recent obsession with the ass and anal sex. A recent episode of the “edgy” HBO series *Girls* featured a gratuitous scene of anilingus.

This is an inversion of true Eros which is a drive to God and the transcendent. Biological sex, then, is a mere distortion and materialization of that drive.

Fundamental Principles Giambattista Vico identifies three customs of all nations:

- All have some religion
- All contract solemn marriages
- All bury the dead

These, therefore, are the basis of the first three principles of his New Science. He points out that they are reinforced by their religious practices. The consequences of not doing so are, according to Vico:

Otherwise, the world would return to a brutish state and again become a wilderness.

Now the facts of human societies can be reformulated as principles:

- Divine Providence
- The moderation of passions through marriage
- The immortality of human souls attested by burial

Just to be clear, Vico again emphasizes:

These are the boundaries of human reason and transgressing them means abandoning our humanity.

Of course, modernity in its fullness is the exact opposite:

- Man to be fully human requires freedom from God
- The free expression of passions, especially but not only sexuality, is human liberation
- Live for the moment

Thus, we have another barometer to measure the decline, or progress if you prefer, of the human race. Of course, most people do not consciously think about such things and try to steer a middle, i.e., a “lukewarm”, course; but those are the positions for those who think it through.

Providence and Religion Vico makes Providence a principle of his New Science, so he regards Providence as a historically verifiable fact. He writes:

Providence must provide a history of the orders and institutions which providence bestowed on the great polity of humankind without the knowledge or advice of humankind, and often contrary to human planning. For although by its creation our world is temporal and particular, the orders which providence establishes in it are universal and eternal.

Thus he claims that the human race could not have survived without divine providence. The actions of men are insufficient to explain all the cultural and social benefits that accrued to them.

The modernist, on the other hand, rejects Providence. For him, the human race evolved through random processes into an environment that quite fortuitously was able to support human life. Gods and religions, therefore, are social constructs used to bolster and legitimize existing social arrangements.

Rene Guenon expressed it this way:

It is not that the order of the cosmos was conceived on the model of social institutions, but, on the contrary, these institutions were founded on the basis of analogy with the cosmic order.

Marriage and Immortality

When we discuss immortality, we must grant considerable importance to the consensus of humankind, who either fear or worship the spirits of the underworld. I follow this general belief.

SENECA

Vico recognized a hierarchy of allegiances. First a man cared for himself, then his wife and children. This extended to his clan, nation and so on. Marriages were solemnized not least of all for the sake of the children. Without that legal bond, the children could be left to their own devices. Vico was prescient in foreseeing that the children of unwed mothers would come to depend on public or private charity, as we see today. Any exceptions just prove the rule.

Vico simply assumes that sexual relationships are genital. In the Freudian scheme, the child advances sexually in three phases: oral, anal, and genital. Hence, the psychologically healthy and rational adult regards sex as genital-to-genital contact. Its proper use is within marriage as he describes. Obviously, this is not an arbitrary command of a totalitarian church, but rather the common experience of the human race, insofar as it is civilized and guided by divine providence. Specifically, this applies also to pagan societies pace the new age neo-pagans, and Evola alludes to it in Ancient Rome:

every offense to the sacredness of aristocratic marriage and to the lineage was considered as a crime above all in the face of the *genius* of the lineage

On the contrary, the revolutionary goal is to return to the childlike innocence of polymorphous perversity, for whom the entire body is sexually charged. This is considered liberation although, as E Michael Jones points out, in its actual effect it is a form of social control. Rather than the result of the overthrowing of capitalism as Marcuse had hoped, sexual control becomes just another capitalist commodity. In Marcuse's terms, sexual liberation has been "co-opted" by the capitalist system he opposed.

Historical Reconstruction So, in his reconstruction of prehistory, Vico sees the formation of society the father, as the protector of his family. The fathers gather together for mutual support and protection. Thus, at

its origin, society was a patriarchy. This is not exactly the mannerbund (with its homoerotic overtones in some circles), as Evola would have it, since it was composed strictly of fathers. Evola does recognize the “son of duty”, since that is the only way that the father’s memory would continue in the burial rites.

Now each family was considered to have a divine origin as the primal father was regarded as a god. The consequence is that each family also had its own religion with rites and legends of its own. The clan also had a divine origin and its father, not necessarily biological but certainly spiritual, was likewise considered a god. The result was a hierarchy of religions and religious practices. Daily life was regulated by the rites, taboos, and rituals of the religions.

Thus, society was at its origin patriarchal and theocratic. Vico called it the age of the gods. Clients were attracted to the patriarchy for protection. They did not have the same spiritual foundation. Hence, they followed the rites of whatever family they are attached to. They were not necessarily biologically related; over time, due to endogamous marriage, racial differences between the clients and the families become more pronounced.

They didn’t have an inner center (ego in Freud’s terms) and were driven primarily by desire, or id, in Freudian sense. They may even have been pre-Adamics. Their consciousness was formed by the families. Without a strong ego, or rational capability, they are directed by command, poetry, symbolism (see Jaynes). This inner consciousness of external commands is the Freudian superego.

Over time, the age of the gods gave way to the age of the heroes. This was the result of a schism between the priestly and noble functions. In Platonic terms, it was the movement from aristocracy to timocracy. The next phase was toward democracy or popular rule. This was the result of the desire of the clients and plebeians for more political and social control.

Natural and Conventional Relationships Oddly enough, the revolutionary and reactionary reconstructions of history are not that different, although their evaluations certainly are. This is not totally surprising, since Marx himself relied on Vico's works. The revolutionary sees the overturning of patriarchy and theocracy as forward progress. Each stage of decline for the reactionary is progress for the revolutionary. More and more people take part in social life.

For the reactionary, the stages move downward from the rational (in the higher sense) to the emotional to desire and sensation. The latter has three substages: normal desires, excessive desires, and unnatural desires. So the aristocrat knows the divine order of the cosmos and orders social relationships in conformance to it. The democrat lacks that understanding. Originally, aristocratic knowledge came to the democrat through poetry, symbols, and divine commands. In his consciousness, it was experienced as alien and alienating, since it did not comport with the other parts of his interiority. In order to overthrow the commands of the superego, he also had to eliminate its source in religion and patriarchy.

For the reactionary, theocracy, patriarchy and hierarchy are natural and organic structures, a reflection of the divine order. For the revolutionary, they are merely conventional and social structures. They have no origin beyond the human mind. At worst, they serve to maintain existing power structures. For Marx, they are the product of economic arrangements. In a state of wild nature, a patriarchy may have made some sense. However, as economic activity became more complex, power in the hands of the few was not justifiable.

To close the circle with Marcuse: the Old Left was failing because the prosperity in the West of the working classes tended to make them more conservative rather than revolutionary. Current arrangements suited them, so they could not be easily motivated to revolt. Hence, the New Left looked for the revolutionary consciousness not in the working class, but in other groups considered to be marginalized by social arrangements.

These thus are the choices: either the arrangements are rational and supported by divine providence or they are irrational and arbitrary. There can be no middle ground.

Posted on 2015-01-22 by Cologero

* * *

White Rabbit on 2015-01-23 at 01:05 said:

Sex as a form of mind control? I don't know. I've considered it, but when I talk about it my friends tell me I need to get laid.

X on 2015-01-23 at 02:33 said:

Good article.

Actually the result of sexual liberation is the dissolution of true sexuality, everything which rejects being will finally fall into absolute non-being. The more sexuality is liberated, the less polarity exists between sexes, the less true sexuality there is.

David on 2015-01-23 at 04:32 said:

Interesting articles with different things to think upon, especially the study of ancient family regarding rites.

But I have one question : how does the "Freudian system" ape the traditional view of man? It is my impression that the Freudian system is a reversal and misunderstanding of the traditional view of man since for Freud, the conscious (let alone any thought of supra-conscious or supra-individual !) actions are dictated by the drive of the subconscious and its energy. If I do action X, it is because I have that amount of energy which made my representation X bypass my "screen". There is no really conscious choice or action for Freud that seems possible if not for the creation of said "screens" of the pulsion and passion from a "super-ego" which in the end is no more than a construction and by no means a Self in the higher sense. At the same time, I am not a student of Freud, and I would therefore ask for more guidance on this.

Cologero on 2015-01-23 at 05:09 said:

In the same sense that 'Satan is the ape of God'. See Guenon's *Reign of Quantity*:

by virtue of the law of analogy, the lowest point is the obscure reflection or the inverted image of the highest point, from which follows the consequence, paradoxical only in appearance, that the most complete

absence of all principle implies a sort of counterfeit of the principle itself, something that has been expressed in a theological form in the words 'Satan is the ape of God'.

A proper appreciation of this fact can help greatly toward the understanding of some of the darkest enigmas of the modern world, enigmas which that world itself denies because, though it carries them in itself, it is incapable of perceiving them, and because this denial is an indispensable condition for the maintenance of the special mentality whereby it exists.

If our contemporaries as a whole could see what it is that is guiding them and where they are really going, the modern world would at once cease to exist as such, for the rectification could not fail to come about through that very circumstance.

That is central to our project.

David on 2015-01-23 at 08:44 said:

@Colgero : Then I am sorry to have misunderstood your purpose. I must say that the word "apes" was unknown to me, so I tried to understand the sentence without it, which led me to believe it had to do with "copying"; hence my answer asking why you linked Tradition to the Freudian project. Thank you for the answer.

Cologero on 2015-01-23 at 09:13 said:

The word was chosen as an allusion to Guenon's usage.

In French: « Satan est le singe de Dieu »

Rene Guenon *Le Regne de la Quantite et les Signes des Temps*

<http://ekldata.com/ZvjZowigoi2MzLb65e0L92PGSD0/Rene-Guenon-1945-Le-Regne-de-la-Quantite-et-les-Signes-des-Temps.pdf>

Max on 2015-01-23 at 12:12 said:

Cologero, you mention clients ruled by desire and contrast them to the patriarchal families. How are we to understand that the Roman families traced their ancestry to Aeneas who descended from Venus (the word related to the sanskrit "vanas", desire, and to the scandinavian Vanir who were the mythological ancestors of the Yngling dynasty of Swedish kings). Perhaps as a conscious memory of primordiality and virginal nature since the world is apart from desire more significantly perpetuated by love.

Here there is relevance to your quote of Guenon about the highest reflected in the lowest as both the patricians and plebeians are apparently "descended" from desire, but understood in different ways. The lower kind is in truth just a substitute, a realization which opens a possibility to overcome the denial. This suggests that the common man may recover his nobility through a purification of desire and earn the royal privilege to claim descent from Our Lady and the Heavenly Father.

Cologero on 2015-01-23 at 14:33 said:

Max, I'll give you Vico's explanation [512]:

Venus was also regarded as a goddess of solemn marriages. Called *pronuba*, bridesmaid, she covered her private parts with her famed girdle, which lascivious poets later embroidered with all sorts of aphrodisiac charms. At that point, the severe historical truth of the auspices had been corrupted, and people believed that Venus lay with men, as Jupiter lay with women. Hence, Aeneas, who was conceived under Venus' auspices, was said to be Venus' son by Anchises.

So being "conceived under Venus' auspices" is different from what you suggest. The poets represent a corruption.

Tom Blanchard on 2015-01-23 at 15:03 said:

With regard to the burial of the dead as the hallmark of a civilized people, what would you make of the tradition of cremating the dead, which appeared in many ancient civilizations and especially in Rome, where the nobles and the military heroes in particular were typically cremated as opposed to buried? (Julius Evola's rather polemic view is that burial is "telluric" and represents a returning to the Earth, whereas cremation indicates an ascent to the heavens.)

Cologero on 2015-01-23 at 15:25 said:

Cremation was not practiced in Rome until late into the Republic. Fustel de Coulanges describes the most ancient practices:

From this primitive belief came the necessity of burial. In order that the soul might be confined to this subterranean abode, which was suited to its second life, it was necessary that the body to which it remained attached should be covered with earth. The soul that had no tomb had not dwelling place. It was a wandering spirit.

Re Evola, riddle me this, Tom:

- He rejected Providence: Masters of the Right: Joseph de Maistre
- He rejected marriage and left no heir, rather strange for an alleged baron
- He chose cremation instead of burial

Cologero on 2015-01-23 at 15:33 said:

White Rabbit, who said sex in itself is a form of mind control? Sex is necessary for the propagation of the race and bonds families and peoples together with a common inheritance. The point made was that alleged "sexual freedom" leads to the bondage of addiction, and a partner is not necessary for that. I can't comment on your friends.

ja on 2015-01-23 at 16:49 said:

Cologero, do you believe Evola was a hypocrite, was not truly traditional, or was simply mistaken on several points ?

Olavsson on 2015-01-23 at 20:27 said:

Excellent article, as always.

But regarding the discussion about burial practices... Cremation seems to have been quite a widespread practice in various Indo-European cultures, and still is in Hinduism. So even though cremation is unorthodox seen in light of the European Christian tradition, and might have been untraditional in some European 'pagan' cultures as well, I can't see how it would be untraditional in a wider sense. Maybe there is something I have not understood properly, but ancient cremation practices have always seemed to me as manifestations of a rather high religious spirit. To me it represents purification of lower residues by fire – by light; liberation of the spirit from ties slowing its ascension; the impermanence of the body and the ego; and so on. I find its symbolism to be quite beautiful, and have long thought that I will have my own body cremated once I am dead. But I might change my mind if I become convinced that this is actually less favourable than I thought in principle.

Marriage and heir: While Evola wasn't married and didn't reproduce, the same can be said of quite a few historical sages, ascetics, and other great men who weren't really untraditional by any stretch of the imagination. But Evola, though a genius he was, cannot be entirely compared to such figures of course. And to his disadvantage might be pointed out that he probably wasn't celibate either. Evola surely wasn't a perfect man; but I don't think the fact that he chose cremation should be held against him or rejected as untraditional in principle, even if that is true for the particular Catholic tradition he was born into.

White Rabbit on 2015-01-24 at 00:06 said:

Cologero: poor phrasing on my part maybe, I didn't intend to imply that. I was noting that "you need to get laid" is known to be resorted to as a response to political angst.

August on 2015-01-24 at 06:20 said:

My opinion on the simplest way to get over questions about how to live is to adopt an orthodox tradition, generally a religion, and follow the established rules sincerely and to the best of one's ability. Develop further according to circumstance and capacity within that framework.

Why worry about whether cremation or burial is better, how each influences the soul, what is permissible sexual behaviour, etc.? These questions are not to be answered absolutely, universally. If you have a tradition, follow the rules and there is your peace.

But many are those who will not, in today's world. If they decide to live outside of a functioning tradition, the only way to ultimately appraise their actions is by the consequences. Given the limits of human horizons, such a path entails placing oneself at the mercy of powers that we cannot grasp, the same powers that know and deliver all men according to some justice, all men naturally including those who performed rites, and those who did not.

Cologero on 2015-01-24 at 09:58 said:

Thanks, August, for saving me the trouble. Vico's point is the same whether or not burial or cremation was part of the death rites; he was addressing ancient Europe specifically. And Olavsson, your perspective is sound as I was not trying to define any hard boundaries. The comments just sounded like a series of "gotcha" attempts while ignoring the main point. Getting a fact wrong here or there is not the issue.

As for the other question, no, I don't think Evola was a hypocrite. Evola, unlike Guenon, chose to engage with the modern world. He was involved politically, culturally, artistically, philosophically and so on. That is why he is more accessible to people today looking for Tradition. On the other hand, the temptation is to assume that familiarity with Evola's writings makes one "traditional" in some sense. Evola made a conscious choice not to follow an exoteric tradition. This in many ways has distorted things and worst of all it has encouraged others to do the same. Yet he considered the Revolution of 1789 to be the end of civilization, while the rest of contemporary Europe regards it as the beginning of civilization. Who, on any of the various "rights", will propose blasphemy as a capital crime? And how can Evola prefer pre-1789 Europe while rejecting its spiritual source?

Although Evola regarded Guenon as the "master of the 20th century", who among the Evola readers bother with Guenon? I only know of one, but please let me know of others. Now Guenon regarded the entire modern world as based on an illusion so he seldom bothered with it. Perhaps

occasional book reviews and so on, but nothing sustained in a positive sense. I'd rather see a discussion on this point:

"If our contemporaries as a whole could see what it is that is guiding them and where they are really going, the modern world would at once cease to exist as such"

That is what I've been trying to do and even if it has been done poorly, nevertheless, in Chesterton's phrase, it is still worth doing.

ja on 2015-01-24 at 13:16 said:

One aspect of the modern mindset I've noticed on Gornahoor....Cologero, do you notice how the mention of political topics even as just an aside gathers much commenting whereas spiritual topics are less commented ? The modern man, as per Marx, is seeking to change the world when he should be changing himself. ..

15.9 The Metaphysics of Law

Valentin Tomberg wrote about the nature of law in his two doctoral dissertations, *Foundations of International Law as Humanity's Law* and *Degeneration and Regeneration of Jurisprudence*. What follows is a summary of some aspects of those studies.

A complete understanding of law must be based on three insights:

1. The world is an ordered whole
2. The world order is of a moral nature
3. Mankind is called to arrange its own life in harmony with the moral world order

This follows from the understanding that the world is ordered by the Logos, it is a creation of the Will, and the Will must be directed by the Spirit.

In terms of the schema described in *The Degrees of Knowledge*⁹, the study of law may be done on three levels, as shown in Table 15.1.

⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=411>

Doxa	Positive Law	Concept of Law	The study of the actual laws of various nations and times.
Dianoia	Natural Law	Idea of Law	The understanding that the purpose of law is justice
Episteme	Divine Law	Ideal of Law	Direct intuition of the divine basis of law

Table 15.1: Three levels of Law

Tomberg summarizes:

Thus one arrives at the **ideal of law** by introspection, at the **idea of law** by reasonable evaluation of experiences, and at the **concept of law** by knowing the facts of positive law.

A complete understanding of the law requires all three levels. A legal positivist, for example, will understand a “right” as whatever the government legislates rather than acknowledging its divine origin. Or someone may argue on the rational level in favour of economic or social justice, which are really based on the idea of equality, rather than justice.

Every positive law must be both **just** and **possible**. A just law entails two conditions:

- It must not contradict a higher obligation
- It must be necessary or useful for the common welfare

This means a law cannot contradict the natural or divine law. Furthermore, it rules out frivolous, arbitrary, and pointless laws, if they don’t

serve the common welfare. Examples from the past include bans on playing card games or the period of Prohibition in the USA.

A law must also be physically and morally possible. There may be otherwise just laws that are above the common moral level of the general public, so that their enforcement would disrupt the civil order. So despite the principles that “error has no rights” and “doing wrong is not a right”, certain behaviours may need to be tolerated. In other words, not every moral wrong needs to be treated as a legal matter. It is important, however, that mere toleration doesn’t devolve into being considered a right.

Since part of Tomberg’s thesis deals with the proper education of lawyers, there is the tendency to think that simply the study of these two essays should be sufficient to transform the curricula of law schools and legislatures themselves. The problem is that it will only be understood at the level of *doxa* and *dianoia*, and not at the level of *episteme*. That will relegate it to the role of just one more legal theory to be debated, rather than as the ordering principle of legal theory itself. In a Traditional society, men incapable of grasping ideas directly through *episteme* would not even be allowed to teach at or attend a law school. They would find other roles in society appropriate to their intellectual capacities.

Tomberg’s theses may be obtained from the Sophia Foundation¹⁰.

Posted on 2010-05-03 by Cologero

¹⁰http://sophiafoundation.org/activities/hermeticism/study_materials

Myths and the Foundation of the City

16.1 Designing a Republic

In our time, no one considers the acquisition or conquest of a land as a basic right. Rather, it must be justified (i.e., made just) in some way. It is instructive to follow news accounts and to discern what is common in all such justifications.

Any thinker considering the creation of a new nation, republic, or imperium needs to start with Plato's *Republic*. It is a thought experiment in which Socrates delineates the characteristics of the ideal state, that is, the state in which perfect justice reigns. The rulers and citizens are not concerned about that, since they take the state for granted, as a given. For them, justice consists of creating and following the laws of the state.

For the Philosopher, however, justice involves the right order of society. This order is natural or organic, unlike the positive law which is conventional (i.e., the result of human conventions). Specifically, this means "minding one's own business", that is, everyone performs his own proper role in the state. He should expect the "just desserts" of his efforts.

Unfortunately, if the citizens are not virtuous, they will not mind their own business and they will become envious of others, no longer satisfied with their natural role. Since men fall naturally into three distinct types, depending on the dominant center of their soul life, the virtue required for each type is different, as shown below:

- **Sensations.** The virtue necessary for those ruled by the appetitive part of the soul is **temperance**.
- **Emotions.** The virtue necessary for those ruled by the emotional part of the soul is **courage**.
- **Intelligence.** The virtue necessary for those ruled by the rational part of the soul is **wisdom**.

Justice, i.e., true objectivity and truthfulness, is possible only for the integrated man who manages to balance the three parts of the soul into a harmonious whole.

Artifacts and Essences First it is necessary to grasp the distinction between real essences and artifacts. The former constitute the organic and the natural, the latter, the conventional and artificial.

A real essence, subsisting in the mind of God, represents a unified being, one whose unity is in itself. Hence a squirrel, or a particular subspecies, is an essence, as is a human being. Recalling what Garrigou-Lagrange wrote about angelic intelligences, essences are further organized into larger systems or wholes. Hence, cities, nations, and so on, are also essences (that is why nations were said to be ruled by a specific archangel), although the modern mind tends to see those groupings as accidental, rather than essential. This seems to be true even of explicitly Thomist philosophers.

An artifact, on the other hand, is a human creation and exists in a human mind. An artifact does not possess a unity-in-itself. Rather, it

is given a unity by its creator. You will often see simplistic examples of the type describing, say, the “idea of a table”, with tedious discussions on what exactly a table is. Obviously, this is not what is meant, since a table is an artifact not a natural kind.

To be complete, it should be pointed out that qualia also do not represent essences. Thus, there is no “idea of red”, which is known by the senses, not the intellect. This is a simple guide:

- **Essences** are known by the higher, intuitive, part of the mind. This is gnosis, a direct knowing.
- **Artifacts** are known by the rational, thinking, part of the mind. They are either created or defined.
- **Qualia** are known directly by the senses and have no part in this discussion.

The Philosopher’s Dilemma To be clear, we are using the word “Philosopher” in the specific sense of the man or woman who transcends the confluence of ordinary, transient life, and is able to contemplate the timeless essences. In thinking the ideal state, he runs into an immediate dilemma. All the successful states (in Plato’s time) are natural and organic, while the state envisioned or defined by the philosopher is at best an artifact. For Socrates, the just state would require the elimination of natural things such as marriage, familial affections, and the right to property. This cannot be achieved in thought alone, but requires a myth.

Now all the Greek city-states had a myth of their founding. A mythical figure created its constitution which justified the organic structure of the state. These often involved magical stories, such as the original constitution being hidden in a tree. These various myths cannot all be true, at least in a way that would satisfy a philosopher; as we defined it several

years ago¹: *A myth is what other people believe.*

Nevertheless, Socrates was forced to resort to a myth as necessary for the ideal state. He called it the “noble lie”. This must not be understood cynically as recommending that the rulers deliberately lie to the citizens to achieve their ends, for these reasons.

- There is the obvious objection that not every lie is a noble lie.
- The rulers are never philosophers so the liar is not noble
- The aim of the noble lie is justice, whereas the objective of the ruler’s lie is never just

Moreover, it is a strange sort of lie, since the rulers themselves must believe it.

Interlude The next and concluding part of this essay will clarify these points:

- Why lies are necessary in the world
- What exactly is a “myth”
- The elements of the noble lie
- Why the Philosopher cannot create the ideal state

Posted on 2014-12-04 by Cologero

* * *

¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=50>

David on 2014-12-04 at 00:48 said:

Very interesting. Looking forward to the next parts. Especially that last part. Is there any text in the meantime you would suggest reading on the subject?

Matt on 2014-12-04 at 14:51 said:

David,

Only speaking for myself, a possible suggestion would be *The City and Man* by Leo Strauss. Don't be put off by the accusations thrown at Strauss, or the liking many neoconservatives have for Strauss; he is probably one of the most misunderstood philosophers – both by his opponents and his neocon supporters – of the modern era.

That text should hopefully help to get you started on this subject.

16.2 Myths, Symbols, and Lies

Coincidentally, in today's email stream a rabid denunciation of Plato's *Republic* appeared on a Thomism list. The writer attributed to Plato what he regarded as the tyranny of the modern world's political system. He conflated the self-appointed political and economic elite with the guardians, with the mass media as the tool of mind control.

Of course, what he is describing is not the ideal state, but rather the final processes of the state's decline from democracy to tyranny, just as Plato predicted. Actually, Socrates was describing a much different system, rule by the best, or aristocracy. In the *Republic*, the guardians of the state were educated to overcome all personal self-interest. Through training in mathematics, gymnastics, and dialectics, they eventually would come to know the truth of the good.

This, then, is the first crucial question: Is it possible to know the truth of the good? If it is possible, then those who know would have the right and duty to rule — not for their own benefit, but rather for the common good of the city. The denial of that possibility is simply nihilism: the belief that no one can know the truth or the good. This is the actual position of the modern mind. Unwilling to let the best rule, the modern

man simply assumes he knows the truth of the good, even without having undergone the arduous education like the guardians. For him, the good is “what is good for me” and who but himself would know that?

The follow-up question is, “how is it possible for those who know to actually rule?” For this, Socrates’ response is simply *Fortuna*, or dumb luck. In the case of the Western world, **Rene Guenon** was somewhat pessimistic. He proposed that a spiritual elite would need to arise in order to lead back to a traditional civilization, although he thought that possibility rather unlikely.

Boris Mouravieff, on the other hand, was more sanguine about that possibility. Relying on his interpretation of Christian revelation (following a particular thread of Russian religious thinking), he presumed that the era of the Holy Spirit would lead to the rule of an elite of virtuous men and women. He points out that the Knight was accepted as the ruler in the Middle Ages because of his physical prowess. In the modern age, the men of science, technology, and commerce became the new elite, due to their superior rational knowledge. In the age to come, the spiritual elite will likewise be recognized. He summarizes:

In the Cycle to come, the new characteristic of the elite man will be his ability to distinguish, spontaneously, without warrant or demonstrating proof, the true from the false. Such a man might also be endowed with the spiritual gifts of which St Paul speaks. It is obvious that those who add faculties of this nature to existing culture will automatically reach the head of human society. Their commanding authority will be accepted, in the same way that the authority of the intellectual was accepted when he substituted himself for the knight, and for the same reason: an obvious superiority.

This view will be criticized as “elitism” or “Gnosticism” by those who don’t understand. The two alternatives are clearly impossible, to wit,

either democratism (knowledge of the truth of the good is available to everyone), or nihilism (such knowledge is not possible).

The Holy City The philosopher, the scientist, and the theologian do not create anything, but rather study what already is. The scientist studies nature, or the not-I, the theologian studies revelation, and the philosopher contemplates what is. Hence, they cannot lead us to the ultimate answer.

So while the philosopher contemplates the ideal city in thought, that is not the self-understanding of any actual city. In *The City and Man*, **Leo Strauss** concludes with praise for **Fustel de Coulanges'** *Ancient City*. Readers will note that that book was also highly praised by Julius Evola. Strauss calls that city the "Holy City", and he refers to the "dark side" of the city, i.e., the side that is resistant to philosophical and scientific penetration. The Holy City was founded by a divine or semi-divine figure and its life revolved around religious rites, veneration of ancestors, and so on. None of this fits into the rational or scientific view of things.

In an essay on the myths of the origin of Rome, **Julius Evola**, relying on Bachofen, says that myth "is a positive testimony to the spirit of a people." Spirit makes the city, not rationalism nor the material circumstances. Hence, his method is to understand the birth of the state through its myths and symbols, as well as the people who founded it. This is one of the sources of his ideas about races of the soul and spirit as more important than the race of the body.

The twin founders of Rome, Romulus and Remus, were the semi-divine offspring of Mars and the Vestal Virgin Rhea Silvia. At birth, they were left to die in the Tiber River. Since this is a common mythological theme (among them, Moses), Evola explains the symbolism of water this way:

the waters, traditionally, have always depicted the current of time, i.e., the basic element of mortal, unstable, contingent, passionate,

fleeting life. Taken from the waters and transported from the waters is the weak man. Saved from the waters, or capable of standing on the waters, of not sinking in the waters—is the seer or hero, the ascetic or the prophet. In the myth of the origins of Rome this symbol must therefore characterize again the “divine” element of the founders of Rome, their, so to speak, supernatural dignity.

So it is not the philosopher, and *a fortiori* not the technocrat or scientist, who founds the city, but rather the hero, the seer, the ascetic, the prophet. These can be related to Evola’s three stages of development.

1. The ordinary man is taken up in the flow of the waters of the world of becoming. He lives spontaneously, not consciously. Mouravieff uses the image of the “confluence” of A, or worldly, profane influences.
2. Some men rise above this and study their life as the other. They are the scientists, philosophers, and so on.
3. This is the stage of the awareness of the I. Such men have mastery, or will. They are the heroes and rishis.

The next sections can be regarded as appendices. They are extended quotes on the prevalence, or even necessity, of lies in the world, and the meaning of symbol and myth.

World Ruled by Lies In Volume I of *Gnosis*, Boris Mouravieff makes this remarkable claim.

We live in a world ruled by lies. Lying and stealing are the dominant elements of human character whatever the race, creed or caste. Whoever says that this is not true simply tells another lie. Man lies because in a world ruled by lies it is not possible for him

to do otherwise. To all that has already been said, one must add the following peculiarity which at first looks paradoxical; that the progress of this civilization, which is the fruit of an intellectual culture, considerably increases the need for lying.

If we refer to the different aspects of this subject, an analysis of lying permits us to distinguish the following modes:

- Lying to others
- Lying to oneself
- Useful lies
- Useless lies

To these classic cases of lying, one must add two particular cases:

- Hypocrisy: the pretense of virtue, of praiseworthy sentiments, with the intent to deceive persons of good faith
- The integral lie: this characterizes that person who, from a habit of lying and cheating on every occasion

Symbol and Myth The following passages are from *Myth, Religion, & Mother Right* by **J J Bachofen**.

Myths became images and shadows of higher ideas, and by their mysterious character inculcated a profounder veneration.

PLUTARCH

Myth is the exegesis of the symbol. It unfolds in a series of outwardly connected actions what the symbol embodies in a unity.

The higher meditations inspired by the riddle of death, the grief and consolation, the hope and fear, the foreboding and joyful anticipation, are expressed only in art. There is a profound reason for this. Human language is too feeble to convey all the thoughts aroused by the alternation of life and death and the sublime hopes of the initiate. Only the symbol and the related myth can meet this higher need.

The symbol plucks all the strings of the human spirit at once; speech is compelled to take up a single thought at a time. The symbol strikes its roots in the most secret depths of the soul; language skims over the surface of the understanding like a soft breeze. The symbol aims inward; language outward. Only the symbol can combine the most disparate elements into a unitary impression.

Words make the infinite finite, symbols carry the spirit beyond the finite world of becoming into the realm of infinite being. Intimating the ineffable, they are mysterious as all religion by its very nature must be, a silent discourse appropriate to the quiet of the tomb, beyond the reach of mockery and doubt, those unripe fruits of wisdom. Therein lies the mysterious dignity of the symbol ... therein lies the spell of the mythical representations, which show us the great deeds of the primordial age in the muted light of distant melancholy recollection

Posted on 2014-12-04 by Cologero

* * *

andros on 2014-12-05 at 04:59 said:

'The integral lie: this characterizes that person who, from a habit of lying and cheating on every occasion,' ... is completed by ... 'ends by believing his own lies and thus loses all sense of truth.' (Chapter XVII, 2)

Max on 2014-12-07 at 06:36 said:

For a state to be organic it must naturally be formed in an organic way. That does not involve thinking about ideal states -because then what. Asking people to come to the new state that does not even exist? It is not possible to construct something organic because then it just ends up as another machine, not a living being.

When the conditions are right, a child is conceived and born. The real causes for a new life coming into existence is nevertheless transcendent to the physical act. Thinking about ideal babies will not make any, neither do good parents think of children in those terms. Rather, being in itself is proof of perfection. We love that which is for what it is because it is and does our best to help it realize its true potential.

An organic state is also born and unfolds its truth over time. It is not created by man as a ready-made thought-construct that just awaits implementation.

The Holy City is first of all in higher worlds. The spiritual origin of an organic state becomes concealed and explained as myth, understood according to each ones capabilities. A living organic state is superior to any thoughts (regardless of how many worldly faults could be found with it) just by the fact of being here, as is Tomberg's view of the church.

Churches are based on the basilica, which was a Roman courthouse and before that a "royal hall": the original meaning of the Greek word. This is so because a church is the royal hall of the King of Kings, where divine law and justice radiates out to the lands and people. At earlier times the basilica was also a place of economic activity and human law but that was put an end to with the advent of Christianity in an effort to separate the sacred from profane.

Michael on 2019-12-04 at 17:34 said:

Interesting that lies and myth seem to vibrate along similar senses in experience. However, lies we create and myths speak to something more and are not created by "I", as the quote makes out. When developing awareness in moments of lies or when spoken to, it seems like there is an experience when being lied to, a sort of "sense" that even if we aren't sure is there resounds in our experience. Perhaps this sense can be developed in such a way to know false from truth, allowing one to further appreciate the depths of that connection when symbols are present and understand lies when they are made.

Descartes' Nightmare, an Essay

We live among ruins in a World in which “god is dead” as Nietzsche stated. The ideals of today are comfort, expediency, surface knowledge, disregard for one’s ancestral heritage and traditions, catering to the lowest standards of taste and intelligence, apotheosis of the pathetic, hoarding of material objects and possessions, disrespect for all that is inherently higher and better - in other words a complete inversion of true values and ideals, the raising of the victory flag of ignorance and the banner of degeneracy. In such a time, social decadence is so widespread that it appears as a natural component of all political institutions. The crises that dominate the daily lives of our societies are part of a secret occult war to remove the support of spiritual and traditional values in order to turn man into a passive instrument of dark powers. The common ground of both Capitalism and Socialism is a materialistic view of life and being.

S. H. NASR

The rule and criterion of truth is to have made it. Hence the clear

and distinct idea of the mind not only cannot be the criterion of other truths, but it cannot be the criterion of that of the mind itself; for while the mind apprehends itself, it does not make itself, and because it does not make itself it is ignorant of the form or mode by which it apprehends itself

GIAMBATTISTA VICO (commenting on Descartes)

All that is solid melts into air, all that is holy is profaned, and man is at last compelled to face with sober senses, his real conditions of life, and his relations with his kind.

MARX AND ENGELS, *The Communist Manifesto*

La lotta differenzia, seleziona, crea gerarchia; soprattutto quando – per usare delle espressioni tradizionali – non è la piccola lotta, ma la grande lotta; non la lotta di uomo contro uomo o contro l'ambiente, ma la lotta dell'elemento soprannaturale dell'uomo contro tutto ciò che in lui è natura, sensazione, materialità, agitazione, miraggio di vana grandezza; contro il caos che è in lui, primi di esser fuor di lui.

The battle differentiates, selects, creates hierarchy; especially when – to use the traditional terms – it is not the lesser battle, but the greater battle; not the battle of man against man, or against the world, but the battle of the supernatural element of man against everything in him that is nature, sensation, materiality, ferment, delusion of grandeur; against the chaos that is within him, before it is outside him.

JULIUS EVOLA

Taluni tornano sui loro passi, che nuove forze sorgano per la riconquista.

JULIUS EVOLA

Introduction The fundamental difference between the traditional and modern world views is the knowledge of a spiritual level of reality that transcends our ordinary experience. This spiritual level is the source of all manifestation and is known, not through empirical evidence or a process of reasoning, but rather through a direct “knowing”, called Intuition or gnosis. This gnosis is not irrational, but is supra-rational, that is, above reason, though not contrary to reason.

The traditional teaching is that man is a tripartite being, that is, a Unity of Spirit, soul, and body. These states of being are hierarchically arranged, with the lower state subordinated to the higher states.

The modernist denies the existence of a spiritual state of being, and thus, of any knowledge that transcends the senses or the reasoning faculty. Science ignores it completely by its very methodology, and regards any claim to the contrary as delusional. The major exoteric religions accept the existence of the spiritual realm, but insist it can be known only by faith, with a caste of priests or ministers keeping guard over it.

Now, the difference between the Traditional and modern world view must not be understood in a temporal sense, but rather ontologically. “Tradition” indicates a transcendental source that impinges on the empirical at every time and place. “Modern” indicates the denial of such transcendence, viewing the empirical as self-contained. Thus, the Traditional and modern world views are independent of time and place, and have always been with us, with one predominating over the other. Other times, these two spirits are found battling each other for influence.

In *Imperialismo Pagano*, Evola applies these ideas to the particular historico-political situation he found himself in. Opposed to any sort of revolutionary impulse, Evola hoped to draw Italy back to its spiritual roots in the ancient Roman Imperium. He felt that that spirituality was more “natural” and congenial to the people of Italy. Evola analyzes in exquisite detail the root causes and results of the spiritual warfare between the discordant world views then tearing Europe apart. Evola traces

certain viewpoints to their sources in various religions, nations, and ethnic groups. It is important to keep in mind that the battle is first and foremost within one's own consciousness; the outer world is a symptom or result of particular mind sets, or their admixture.

Evola ranges over topics including mythology, philosophy, history, and political science. His ideas challenge us and force us to see beyond our everyday patterns of thought that we often absorb without reflection. In the end, no matter which side of the issue you end up on, you will know precisely why you lean toward one side rather than the other.

Modernism Descartes did not originate modernism, but he outlined its essential features; thus, he serves as a useful foil to delineate its essential features. In contrast with the unity of the tripartite being, Descartes introduces “dualism” – that is, the concept that thought and matter are distinct substances, with no direct relation between the two. Denying any level (spirit) higher than thought and denying any form of knowing (gnosis, intuition) higher than reason, Descartes elevates thought to the pinnacle of human life. It becomes man's very identity – “I think, therefore I am”. A man is identified with the stream of thought he experiences. This leads to some anti-traditional consequences. If I am my thoughts, and there is no higher knowledge, then mere opinion becomes the standard of truth. To deny my opinions is to deny my self; and to deny a higher knowledge means that my opinions are as good as the next fellow's.

For the traditionalist, the “I am” (Spirit) transcends both thought (Soul) and matter (Body). As the Observer, the Spirit is detached both from the stream of thought and the concupiscence of the body. As the Unmoved Mover, the Spirit the source of all creative activity without itself being part of that activity.

This leads to stability and continuity. Detached from the vagaries of public opinion, the traditionalist holds firm to eternal truths. The

modern mind can be swayed by the “winds of doctrine”, by the opinion “du jour”. Thus we see wild changes among the masses, based solely on transient events or mere collective whims.

The second key aspect of the Cartesian system is the method of doubt. Descartes proposed to doubt everything until only “clear and distinct” ideas remained. Since the Traditional teachings transcend reason, they cannot be understood by the modern mind, who can only see in them error, deception, the “opiate of the masses”. Everything arising out of the life of the Spirit is subject to radical doubt – family, nation, race, religion, gender, marriage, etc. Knowledge is replaced by opinion. Public opinion is enforced through rhetoric, “gerede”, the idle chatter of the mass man, who becomes a consumer of information. Where that fails, recourse is made to force and violence to enforce thought within narrow confines. In contrast, the traditional view relies on persuasion – the measure of one’s strength is not force, but rather the impact of “power-ideas” to move men’s minds.

The third element of dualism is that the body is separated from the mind, and so it is no longer subordinated to anything higher. Therefore, the needs and desires of the body are of fundamental – and only – concern. There is no higher spiritual force directing the body – therefore everything is reduced to the material, biological, evolutionary, economic scale.

The whole nature of personhood is altered. No longer are there persons – in the sense of a center of consciousness and will – that are hierarchically arranged and organically related. Instead, there are “individuals”, independent of each other, all presumably equal and identical. Their relations are not organic, but rather contractual – they are entered into as a matter of convenience to the parties involved and have no higher purpose or meaning. An individual is not his own center, or end in himself ... he is a consumer of outside forces: of ideas, of entertainment, of goods and services, all in service to the needs and desires of the body. Anything

that thwarts the satisfaction of desires is “bad” – not just bad, but absurd, beyond understanding. The Person of tradition who aspires to an heroic and ascetical life is considered a fool, or a “troglodyte”, on the way to extinction.

Since the needs and desires of the body are the least common denominator, every individual is equal to every other. As the quest for “clear and distinct” ideas is futile, all that remain are random thoughts, so one man’s opinion is as good as another. Since there is no higher standard, the only people worth emulating or respecting are movie star, the businessman, the sportsman.

18.1 Evola on Spanish Falangism

José Antonio Primo de Rivera was executed by the Spanish left on November 20, 1936. Although we are a day late because we were only recently provided with the Italian text, we will provide this translation of Evola's evaluation of the Spanish Falangists. Intended for the general public, it was published in January 1937 in **Tratto da Lo Stato**. It was subsequently included in the book **Fascismo e Terzo Reich** ("Fascism and the Third Reich").



Please see *What is Spanish Falangism*¹ for the translated text.

We believe that the state does not have to justify its behaviour at every turn, just as no individual or social class does, in so far as it holds to a guiding principle all the time. All the while the state is

¹http://www.gornahoor.net/?page_id=1202

made out to be God by Rousseau's idea that the state, or the will of those it represents, is always right. What makes the state like God is the belief that the will of the state, embodied by absolute monarchs in the past and now by the popular vote, is always right. The monarch may have erred; the popular vote may err because neither truth nor goodness derives from an act or assertion of the will. Goodness and truth are perennial tributaries of reason, and to ascertain whether one is in the right it is not enough to ask the king—whose dictate seemed always just to his supporters—nor enough to canvass the people—whose decision is always right according to the disciples of Rousseau. What must be done rather is to verify whether our actions and our thoughts are in agreement at every step with a permanent aspiration.

JOSÉ ANTONIO PRIMO DE RIVERA

Julius Evola takes the opportunity to express his own ideas on counter-revolution, under the pretext of evaluating the program of the Spanish Falangists from the later part of the 1930s. First of all, he points out that a political soldier must understand the cause for which he is fighting. Ideas, not blind action, are the driving forces behind historical change. Thus, he would seem to support the publication of manifestos or programs and be opposed to the helter-skelter approach of a destructive revolution under the hope of trying to pick up the pieces.

The same applies to nationalism. Beyond any concrete manifestation, a nation is at its base a spiritual reality, that is, "a predestined, cosmic unity." Therefore, it cannot base itself on materialist categories such as race or territorial boundaries. Evola then digresses from this "particularism" and subtly brings up the idea of Empire as itself being a supranational spiritual reality. The Falangist state, therefore, is radically opposed to the liberal, secular, "night watchman" state.

As spiritual reality, the state is organic and results from “cells”: the family, the local community, and common business and professional associations. It is hierarchical and opposes any class conflict.

After defining the state, the Falangists deal with the individual. Once again, Evola notes the Traditional idea of the Person: free, autonomous, ordered to eternal life, an absolute value in himself. The Person’s freedom is legitimized from above and is opposed to individualistic self-assertion.

The Falange is opposed to materialism. Any movement based on biological determinism or race, and justified by empirical science is not a valid counter-revolutionary movement. They attach themselves to the Catholic faith, in reality, the only historical religion of Spain. Evola here comes very close to the Hermetic view of the Catholic religion. He sees in it a relation to the Primordial Tradition (the so-called “Church of John”) while simultaneously entertaining an anti-clericalism (“the Church of Peter”). Evola concludes with a positive evaluation of the Falange.

One sees in this that Evola, despite himself, is really of the **Old Right**. He sees the Europe before the French Revolution as sane and normal. He also writes approvingly of the masters of the Old Right, from Joseph de Maistre, to Donoso Cortes to José Antonio Primo de Rivera. Any group claiming to be based on “Evola” needs to always keep the principles enunciated in his review in mind.

Posted on 2010-11-21 by Cologero

* * *

Will on 2011-01-10 at 14:06 said:

There is some great footage of Jose Antonio, as well as general information about the Falange, here in this documentary:

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yzum_CU44jk

18.2 The Future Order of Nations

In the September, 1941 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, **Julius Evola** wrote a review of *Das Reich der Völker* by the German political theorist, **Hans Keller**. The first part of Evola's essay is a review of the book. In the second part, whose translation appears below (*ff*), Evola provides his own conception of the role of the Volk. Clearly, Evola cannot support Keller's naturalism nor the role of the Volk as the vanguard or the base for the political organization.

In the Traditional perspective, the Volk is lunar or passive and therefore has to rely on a spiritual and political hierarchy for its full development. Thus Evola must needs oppose any sort of nationalism on the basis of an ethnicity or a race. In rejecting that sort of neo-Nordicism, Evola will lead us back to the ideal of Romanity.

Part I *In primis et ante omnia* we cannot adhere to the mythology of the *Volk*, of the "people nation", so dear to Keller, who makes them the base of his juridical edifice. Mussolini once spoke ironically of the "mysterious entity that calls itself the people". "People", be it only as "Volk", is a simple myth that always and inevitably sounds like demagoguery: of the type which is accompanied by intense polemical applications to disvalue and degrade the significance of everything that is the State, the formative political force from above. Keller stands on the most naïve optimistic natural law: he believes that the people exist as a very precise entity, equipped with its own consciousness, its own will, determined by "eternal laws" superior to all political forms in which they are concretized, a depositary of determinate values. We can only speak of similar things to some naïve types for whom, today, the natural meaning of nationality (quite different from every "nationalism" and deprived of a "political" character) became something extremely tenuous in the face of becoming the "mass" of the people and the advent of a civilization no longer based on truly

traditional values. Hegel said, “the people is that part of the State that does not know what it wills”. That is precise. Our fascist idea is that the people, the nation, exists only as the State, in the State, and in a certain measure, only through the work of the State.

But our State is not the end of Keller’s artificial antitheses: it is not a juridical superstructure, a mere fact of “power”, an external power without basis. Our State is ethical and spiritual. It has the value of an *entelechy*, i.e., of a formative force on the nation and the “people”, who otherwise would remain a diffuse and unformed reality, vegetating on a naturalistic plane of life, without any metaphysical, ethical, or truly heroic tension.

Our point of view is detached both from the idea of natural law and the collectivizing of the people, as well as the abstract, juridical and rationalistic of the State. We are realists. We do not believe in the “people”, instead we believe in a guiding, formative elite and, wherever it happens, leaders of the people. Keller has in mind the State only as *caput mortuum*, i.e., as that which became in some cases, when the political structure created by leaders and elites personifying living traditions depersonalized themselves, objectified themselves, created an excuse to justify themselves, giving to understand the existence of public autonomous powers and of neutral juridical forms or norms to order to obtain in that way recognition to which the direct affirmation and the prominent prestige by the high stature of the Leaders and by superior princes was not enough.

To reach the same goal, i.e., to hold it without exhibiting it, along other directions, therefore, it is joined to the creation of a myth opposite in appearance to that of the neutral “State”, but in reality answering to the same end: the myth of the “people”. Keller lets himself avoid the admission that the idea of the Volk was “discovered” in 1933. Even if the date is not for us so recent, having some precise antecedents especially in democratic nationalism and French Jacobinism, (in fact even in France, as the antitheses to an excess of *statism*, determined by the centralizing, absolutistic, and anti-aristocratic work followed by the kings up

to Philip the Fair, it left, for the first time, the mystique of the nation, of the people as source of every law, not putting up with any authority from above)—even, therefore, if the Volk was not even discovered in 1933, only it stands in fact that the mythology referring to it is new, it was unknown by preceding civilizations and there came to life for precise political and propagandistic reasons: the “people” and *Volk*, far from being notions having, today, a real content, are two idea-forces, two myths taken up by a power to affirm a given political system, determined by circumstances, to capture and organize the forces—in themselves directionless and apt to follow very different suggestions—of the true people and to strengthen therefore a given type of political authority. For the less important socializing tendencies, it was not necessary to us in Italy to have recourse to this myth: to us the spiritual idea of the State, and moreover, the direct authority that proceeds from a Duce and from a Monarch were a sufficient base to lead to the same result.

Keller says that all the differences between *statute* law and law based on the idea of Volk lie in the judgment on human nature: in the first case, as in every idea of Reich and Imperium of Roman Catholic origin, it is pessimistic and does not have faith in human nature, while in the second case it has. But what is this “human nature”? We are not pessimists, but realists. We believe in human nature, but not of everyone, less than ever in the collectivity as the mass, whose psychology we know well. Instead, we believe in that of the minority who create the States, who animate the peoples, who lead the collectivities to the heights which they could never reach alone. Neither statism, therefore, nor natural law, but the aristocratic hierarchical ideal, without the charade that is necessary only to demagogues and weak natures. That is what we mean by Roman and Aryan realism.

Keller says: “to the Romanesque people, only the State is important, even if they serve nationalistic motives in addition.”

We say that we can even renounce the additive motives; we value the

Mussolinian idea, according to which the people is something weak and blind, before they came to constitute a reality and a unitary will, penetrated by higher meanings with the birth of the State. But we are not statist, because we do not make an idol of the State, as Keller and certain German jurists make of the Volk: because behind the State, in our view, there is somebody, there are Leaders, Monarchs—if you want, there is a “superrace”, in which alone “nation”, “people”, “race”, “tradition” cease to be abstractions. Every great “people” is always comprised of various influences, various racial elements, various traditions. It is the work of the elites to choose, to affirm, from among them all, a given element, to subordinate every other to it, leading back in that way to a precise order which otherwise would have remained heterogeneous and arrested in the form of a confused potentiality.

Part II

As Evola continues his analysis of the German legal scholar Hans Keller, we see recognizable themes. In particular, Keller comes surprisingly close to the New Right idea of Ethnopluralism. In Klemmer’s scheme, each people is free to define themselves, to realize themselves, and live independently of each in their own enclaves. So, the “New Right” is not so new after all, as it merely resurrects stillborn ideas from the past. Evola rejects this conception on several grounds.

The first and most obvious is Keller’s naturalistic starting point. Evola points out that for every Aryan civilization, the authority of their law was based on its relationship to the supernatural, and the lawgivers themselves were considered “divine”. So Klemmer, and by extension the New Right, have nothing at all to do with the self-understanding of the European peoples of the past. Keller regards such claims as fantasies and projections of earthly leaders onto an imaginary plane. Any rightist movement must be related to a transcendental tradition; the pseudo-

tradition of neo-paganism would not qualify for reasons that will be made clear in Part III.

The second difficulty with Keller's thesis is the very problem of defining a "volk". Keller speaks of nations of destiny or becoming, without specifying their actual destiny or the goal of the becoming. As such, it is not very helpful. Furthermore, it implies that there will be nations in a lesser or greater state of becoming. Would the latter have to treat the former as minors and guide their development?

In common with similar ideas held by new right movements today, Keller blamed "inorganicity and leveling" on the preceding religious Regnum. This thesis, Evola rejects. Keller's ethnopluralism is itself deracinated, since it lacks any content, or principles, that a supernatural conception of the Regnum would provide. Relations between ethnocentric conclaves are *ad hoc*, relativistic and, contingent. In contrast, Evola envisions a supranational Imperium, in which the superior power furnishes the structure to the others. This, he claims, is a real unity, opposed to the merely nominal unity defined by Keller.

The final objection is devastating. Keller sees a pacifistic union of separate peoples, each according to its nature. But Evola asks the question, "what if the nature of a people is to be a warrior race?" This, Evola claims, is an essential part of Indo-European civilizations. This will blow up the ideal of peaceful ethnocentric enclaves, since one (or more) of them will seek to establish an Empire over the others; this is an essential feature and not a historically contingent event that may or may not occur.

We see the Germanic nations to this day adopting most of Keller's conceptions. The sight of 40,000 Norwegians singing together for peace will not convince another people, whoever they may be, who are of a warrior nature, to leave them in that desired peace. Evola's text follows:

Keller believes in immanent laws of the people, given by "nature", re-

spected and followed in themselves, not originating from any power from above or however personified: in any case, having nothing to do with a “beyond”. This is a “faith” like any other. In reality, it would be difficult to adduce a single legal system of ancient peoples, the Aryans included, for whom the authority of the laws was not related to a “divine” origin from above, and was not considered to have been introduced by legislators themselves “divine”. But we already know Keller’s point of view: instead of understanding the order proper to an earthly and temporal *Imperium* as the reflection of a transcendent order and, from another point of view, the secularization of law and authority as purely spiritual in origin, he tends to see in every idea of a spiritual *Regnum* a type of fantastic projection of the fantastic image of an earthly reign. This stands, more or less, at the intellectual level of Euhemerism².

On the other hand, Keller finds it particularly difficult to define the concept of *Volk*. In certain cases, it seems that he values the national socialist conception of it as the criterion and measure, corresponding to the formula *Volksgemeinschaft*. Where he says that the “community of nations”, the hoped for supranational order, will not be able to be realized until all the peoples have been realized according to the Nazi totalitarian social concept, expressed precisely by the formula mentioned. But on the other hand, he concedes:

It is not important to see how the individual peoples conceive themselves, even if each one leaves the other free to form for themselves a given concept of their own essence and to live in conformity with it.

This is the conclusion of the analysis of the various ideas of the people, a conclusion that evidently leads to a full indifferentism and a pale norm of reciprocal tolerance on the international plane. The fact that

²<http://www.etymonline.com/index.php?term=euhemerism>

Keller insufficiently acknowledges race to define the people; that he introduced the rather indeterminate concept of the “community of destiny” (this is a greatness that is defined depending on directions and many directions exist in the history of a great people); that, finally, he speaks of a “people in becoming”, without being able to say exactly what will define the *terminus ad quem*, i.e., the definite form of such a becoming—all that goes to confirm the mythical and weak content of this conception of the *Volk*. The only coherent solution would be to assert dogmatically that nations as truly such do not exist before being “total nations” according to the national socialist formula of the *Volksgemeinschaft*.

Nevertheless, to assume this political form as a condition for the membership with full rights in the *orde nationum* is not, evidently, a falling short of the principle of respect of every “people”, even to the point of judging them “as lesser peoples” and putting them almost under guardianship, even under a foreign State, when it has not reached such a form.

There is more. Keller, as we saw, blames the inorganicity and the leveling that would be typical of every Roman or religious conception of the *Regnum*, or *Reich* if one prefers, of the nations. Such an accusation is even turned against his own conception. In the logic of this, in fact, we don’t encounter any obstacle to not end up in the utopian vision of an order that takes up all the peoples of the earth. And we don’t encounter any obstacle through the fact that this order is rather more abstract and deprived of content of that of the now defunct League of Nations. In it, would be a question of only taking care of the laws of each people, of teaching them, of maintaining peace and the balance of power—in summary, a type of administrative function that does not presuppose any specific vision of the world, no higher point of reference. But, in its turn, the particularistic conception, relativistic, and collectivistic of the *Volk*, is the cause of that. If the authority of higher values is not recognized, it is evident that among the various “national” unities, only extrinsic rela-

tions, “gravitations” and “equilibria” will be able to exist, which do not involve, at its foundation, anything essential. In every way for us, such an *ordo nationum* as universal order is absurd and undesirable: we conceive of the concrete, differentiated, supranational unity, decentered in a well-defined vision of the world and in well-defined values that give the tone and the internal unity to a given “imperial space”. The superior civilization of a dominating race must furnish the reference point to a succession of political ethnic minors, in order that these, rising up from simply national values, and integrating such values, they find in them the basis to understand and to feel united to each other: to actually unite, and not in the style of an indifferent tolerance of belonging to the same club.

Therefore, these supranational unities, that will put a stop to the period of particularistic, schismatic, anti-European, as well as differentiated nationalism, will be able to even be combative. We see that Keller acknowledges war, but without recognizing in it any specific value, in the same way that he eventually acknowledges the State, in a transitional phase, as an instrument and pedagogue that may help tie “people” to realize themselves, finally, in a “total” form. The general intonation of his view remains pacifistic. Wherever he uses the word “power”, *Macht*, Keller thinks only of oppression, tyranny, violence, distortion of the people. He barely remembers Moltke’s phrase: “universal peace is only a dream, and not even a beautiful dream.”

Nevertheless, since every people, according to him, should be respected according to their own inclinations, we can certainly think that there exist peoples of a warrior race and calling—we noted everything that was said, starting from Klemm and D’Eichtal, about the typological distinction of “active races” and “passive races”, “conquering races” and slave races”, etc. Keller, it is true, on the other hand, refers to research on savage tribes, where he would demonstrate natural inclinations to reciprocal respect and peace, for the purpose of challenging the idea that the natural state

is the war of all against all. But much more documentation would be necessary to show such a thesis, against which, all the great Aryan history already remains: it is true, not a history of eternal war and for war itself, but history, nevertheless, which is consistent with virile and dominating natures, capable of realizing superior values in battle— superior, often, to all that can come from a climate of peace of naturalistic harmony. Among the rights recognized by Keller for the people, he acknowledges the right to “their own development”: it would therefore behoove us to ask why this development must be limited to the bourgeois domain of “culture and economy”, with the exclusion of everything that refers to the “power” factor, where the natural inclination of such people was exactly that of the warrior and heroic type. We think instead that the heroic and warrior elements are of particular importance even as the common basis of an “imperial space”, i.e., of a concrete and well-articulated order between a given group of nations.

Part III

The organization of a block of the type like the European, Aryan, and Roman block is the only concrete task of our future and the only object of a serious consideration in regards to a new law and a new ordering of the people.

JULIUS EVOLA

In this final installment of the essay, please note these points.

- Evola declares that Tradition is Roman, it forms a union with preceding traditions, with the Hyperborean tradition as its beginning.
- The Volk is a modern invention, opposed to Tradition. Its roots are found in Rousseau and the French Revolution.

- The life and traditions of early Germanic tribes is poorly documented, relying mostly on some comments of Tacitus, and the Eddas, which were preserved much later by post-pagans.
- However, since the Germans were Aryans, we can surmise about them, based on what we know of other Aryan civilizations. The Roman tradition, particularly that of the Middle Ages, is much more fully documented. Hence, that is where we put our focus.
- The State organizes the people and relates them to spiritual reality. However, this is not a superstructure whose purpose is only to aggrandize its leaders and oppress the masses, as some in the New Right believe.
- This orientation to transcendent values is a feature not only of the Christian Middle Ages, but also the authentic pagan traditions.
- Some civilizations may expand, creating a supranational organization. But this is not merely an administrative function, hegemony, or acting as the “world police”. Rather, it is to spread its vision of a spiritual, transcendental reality. Blocks of nations will arise, united by common transcendental values.

Finding it necessary, therefore, to draw a conclusion, only what refers to the polemic against an abstract juridical internationalistic normativism³ is acceptable in Keller’s ideas, after all, up to this point that is what the idea of State has assumed in certain cases in the modern world, in full settlement and against depersonalized “neutral” forms, deprived of a substrate of quality and true strength. The points of positive reference invoked by Keller against what are nevertheless as problematic as ever, and hardly acceptable from the point of view of a tradition, that we without difficulty

³<http://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Normativisme>

declare to be Roman, in order to immediately add that it in its Romanity forms a unity with the traditions characteristic of every great past civilization, with that of ancient Aryanity at the head. In fact, as we said, this mythology of the *Volk*, of the people-nation as absolute source of every authority, is only a modern invention, that arose in Germany recently and that in Germany itself it now seems somewhat passé, through the same force of European events.

Keller's and other's efforts to relate it back to an ancient German tradition are artificial. We saw, as much, that Keller was constrained to condemn as non-German and "Romanizing" the very tradition of the Prussian State and to extend an analogy, he blamed the Medieval Empire. Perhaps he will be able to support himself on such a view of the primitive Germans. But such views interest us very little, because they cannot be authoritative: The "primitive" Germans are in fact only some isolated, dispersed and involute stocks of the Great Aryan tree, and we have to judge and understand their traditions on the basis of that which, in a rather more complete, precise, and documented form, present to us the great Aryan civilizations of antiquity, including the Roman.

In such ancient traditions, there are so many "myths", but of a more elevated and real content than the modern myth of the "*Volk*", which, as we noted, was essentially given to traditional and dynastic Europe by French Jacobinism and has a strongly collectivistic and anti-hierarchical flavor. According to our traditional point of view, the "nationalities" can exist but on a naturalistic plane, not yet political nor properly spiritual: in place of certain spontaneous forms of sensibility and of certain customs where, however, the primary element ends up being less the "nation" than the race. The centre and the indispensable condition of the nation as political and spiritual reality is instead the State. The State is not a mere fact of "power" or a type of abstract juridical superstructure, but an ethical and spiritual reality and a formative and discriminatory force. This force, in its turn, is connected both to an elite, to a race of leaders and to the

prestige proper to them, both to transcendent, to a certain extent, values (which are not necessarily only those of the Christian religion: ancient Iran, ancient Rome, etc., teach it) that legitimate them, because there is true authority only as authority from above.

The formative power of such principles, after having unified and animated a “people”, can be projected beyond its borders and, in different ways, does not exclude those of war, can give rise to higher unities, i.e., supranational, but nevertheless well defined, and ordered by a determinate law: they are the “imperial spaces”. The “rank” that goes to assure to a given nation the supranational directive function cannot be measured in materialist, administrative, bourgeois pacifist terms, and as quasi-police for collective security and peace. On the contrary, it is adherence to already noted transcendental values and to the corresponding faculty of animating, transporting, making capable of energy and commitment, capable even of confronting tragedy and misfortune, which is the sign of such a superiority. The logic of the system does not then lead to its extension to every nation of the world, but to its limitations and particular zones, as blocks of nations, blocks united by the same chain of an “Order”, capable, where it occurs, of the same heroic unanimity of a “crusade”.

Leaving aside both universalistic and nationalistic myths, *the organization of a block of the type like the European, Aryan, and Roman block is the only concrete task of our future and the only object of a serious consideration in regards to a new law and a new ordering of the people.*

Posted on 2012-04-24 by Aeneas

* * *

Cologero on 2012-04-26 at 08:50 said:

Evola makes clear the difference between volkisch movements and authentic Tradition. It is absurd to make the people, or the folk, the ultimate judge of anything. According to Evola, it is the elite, by which he apparently means the ruling elite, who speak for the masses and animate them.

We can agree with that, as far as it goes, but, following the Master Rene Guenon, we assert that there is a spiritual elite beyond the ruling elite. The latter's task is to cooperate in disseminating the spiritual vision to the mass, through its rule and positive law.

Evola accepts the Catholic pessimistic view of human nature, but only for the mass. He believes that the ruling elite are different, a position he calls "realism". We think instead it is naive. Perhaps somewhere, at some time, the elite had achieved the Primordial State, but certainly not in recent memory.

Dominion on 2012-05-03 at 17:04 said:

Reading this, I'm reminded of two things:

The first is the French Emperor Napoleon. He used his power to spread the values of Liberalism across Europe and attempt to create a new order among the nations, even a new aristocracy. Apparently there can be an antitraditional "Imperium" as well.

The second is the European Federation envisioned by Guillaume Faye, where "Evola is reconciled with Marinetti."

But how, I wonder, is it possible to begin to create such an order? Certainly, the neofascist terrorist attacks of the 1970's did nothing to further the Evolian vision of certain members of that movement. Moreover, any hint of decline in the current order leads people to believe that we are not following the principles of the order itself (Liberalism, democracy, etc) properly. There seems to be no real chance in the near future of a spiritual order in the line of this essay being able to rise. How would you see this happening, given the current climate?

Cologero on 2012-05-03 at 20:57 said:

Evola claimed that Freemasonry was able to reorganize itself (after the chaos of Revolution) during Napoleon's reign, eventually leading to the formation of a Masonic Republic in France. As we shall see, despite appearances, that was not a source of order. Faye's "visions" are of no interest to us, as they are prone to change every few years. There is no reconciliation between truth and error; men are willing to make such distinctions.

How can order arise from disorder? That fantasy we leave to biologists and free market economists. Yet we have the answer to your question which was given by the writers of Tradition. Does anyone take it seriously?

Guenon says it must begin with an intellectual conversion, that is, the knowledge of principles. If an elite of those who have undergone a conversion can congeal, there is a possibility of change. Evola explains that every great Western civilization began with a divine revelation; that is pretty much the same as what Guenon claimed, only that it is publicly acknowledged. That is, the elite through their Power and Will, can shape and form the people.

Either that thought rings true to you, and it motivates you, or it does not. You will never "see" this happening, unless you are among those are "making" this happen.

Graham on 2012-05-03 at 23:18 said:

“That is, the elite through their Power and Will, can shape and form the people.”

To prevent misunderstanding, it should be pointed out that the formal cause here is inspired. The elite aren't just making it up as they go along.

Cologero on 2012-05-03 at 23:45 said:

Thanks, Graham, for making that clear. It is an elite that is chosen from above, not those who manage to grab power. That is what distinguishes them from the likes of a Napoleon, as Dominion mentioned.

Dominion on 2012-05-04 at 02:46 said:

“How can order arise from disorder?”

Isn't the whole process of Initiation one from evolving from a disordered and finite ego to a True Will and Eternal Self? Perhaps I misunderstand, but that seems to be exactly what is being described. The answer would then be that the path from disorder to order is one of following the correct process and being guided by the proper laws and forces.

Graham on 2012-05-04 at 11:13 said:

Dominium, in saying that initiation is guided by “the proper laws and forces” you answered your own question, since he couldn't be guided by an order that didn't already exist in principle.

18.3 Deification of Man

In **Guido de Giorgio**, we often find the best from **Rene Guenon** and **Julius Evola**. Yet, the “personal equation” is qualitatively different. Guenon is cold and logical, the path of the jnani whose goal is the Truth. Evola sometimes writes with a deep passion, but is often wordy; his is the path of action, with the Good as its goal. De Giorgio, on the other hand, seems to speak as a man of conviction, arising from an inner knowing, while avoiding the sentimental and the merely personal. He is a poet and mystic, following the highest path, that of Absolute Beauty⁴.

⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3537>

Guenon and Evola, for all their virtues, are ultimately escapists, Guenon to the “traditional” East and Evola to the long forgotten Ancient Rome. But De Giorgio offers a different way. Unlike Guenon who seems to regard the various Traditions as discrete and independent, Evola and De Giorgio see a continuity in the Traditions of the West, from the Hyperboreans to the Medieval era. Yet Evola wants to stop part way, and even to reverse it, while De Giorgio wants to continue and complete the rectification that Evola described.

Taking Guenon’s claim seriously that **Dante**’s Divine Comedy is a blueprint of the path for initiates, he describes a vision for the reconstitution of Tradition in his *La Tradizione Romana*, under the aspects of the Divine Cycle, the roles of the castes, the role of the Leader, the spirit of the Roman tradition, and its fulfillment in the Comedy.

In the following passage from *Aforismi e Poesie* (Archè Milano, 1999), De Giorgio describes the process of Deification, drawing on Traditional notions. From Guenon, we see that “man” is just one of the states of being, but does not exhaust all the states. From Evola, we see the theme of transcending man as such, and the way to know God is to be God⁵. But we suspect, however, that De Giorgio is saying the same thing, not as an abstract theory, but rather from his own interiority. Readers can judge for themselves. De Giorgio’s text follows:

To lose consciousness of oneself, to become conscious of God. To become conscious of the nothing that I am in order to have consciousness of everything that is God. One does not take a step toward God without this preliminary negative. What I am not, God is.

Man makes himself God in the measure in which he is no longer man, that is, when his transparency, in the absolute sense, is such that God passes through him. This is the deification of

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1875>

man, not human imperfection arrogantly divinized—a haughtiness absolutely outside the place in life that leads to God—but man annulled, abolished, dissipated, so that God alone is because God alone is God and no god is god except God.

Posted on 2012-05-03 by Cologero

* * *

Farid Othman al Deenari on 2012-05-04 at 02:50 said:

“Guenon and Evola, for all their virtues, are ultimately escapist...”

We object to this characterization. In fact, it is the world around us that is ‘escapist’, whilst we, in such a milieu, are automatically faulted for being anchored in the realm of knowledge. This realm, being ever present and not subject to temporal conditions, namely space and time, does not allow one to escape from it; nor could we escape to it, for it is all that exists, both theoretically, and practically to those who possess effective consciousness of it.

Insofar as the West deviates, the defender of truth can and will be misrepresented as an ‘escapist’ by simply holding his ground.

Cologero on 2012-05-04 at 05:23 said:

Farid, I did not intend “escapist” as a personal insult to those men, but rather in the sense that, on a personal level, they abandoned (i.e., “escaped” from) the West. Whatever you may think about not being subject to temporal conditions, as a stark matter of fact, Guenon did indeed translate himself in Space, and Evola was nostalgic for a different Time.

Those of us who choose to hold our ground – in the West at this historical moment – cannot limit ourselves to their choices.

Angolmois on 2012-05-04 at 13:53 said:

De Giorgio quote reminded me about the initiatic experience of being a complete human personality with all traits intact while witnessing also at the same time the universal consciousness.

Astrologically speaking this would mean the dual experience of Leo (integrated personality) and Aquarius (universal consciousness). De Giorgio seems to be taking a stance for the universal consciousness (‘pratyeka’), while Evola was more of an alchemist and a hermetist in this regard, since he “remained in the cosmos and got back to it” instead of choosing to escape from it through the Capricornian gate.

Cologero: I find it hard to see either Guénon and Evola as escapists, yet I understand what you mean with it. And after all, did not Evola describe the way you mention in your last post in his 'Ride the Tiger' with unfathomable precision? "A way out, further in" etc.?

Charlotte on 2012-05-04 at 19:09 said:

woah, rewind, Capricorn gate, say more bro – I've been there!! It's in Atlantis, it's scary, at least I was scared... .panic stations, password, aaarrggg!!

Charlotte on 2012-05-04 at 19:58 said:

deep at the bottom of de-nial!!

Angolmois on 2012-05-05 at 04:39 said:

Concerning Atlantis and escapism, did not the Masters of Light leave the degenerated Atlantis when they saw that it is too late and futile to save it wholly; the preservation of the core of the primordial tradition clearly outweighed the saving of a few souls who do not even recognise the need to be saved.

Charlotte: I've been in the temples Atlantis also in my dreams. Finely arranged beautiful temples and amazing surroundings, that's all I can say. The water was in a very important role in the surrounding gardens, and the whole scene was very beautiful. Although this is my personal fantasy, it certainly reflects the stories told about the Atlantean tradition.

Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 06:44 said:

well that's kind of right, but an essential factor is missing there. The Atlanteans, as you probably know, were of one mind – not of 'scattered' consciousness such as humanity experienced after the destruction of the Tower of Babel. This enabled them to do extraordinary things in terms of building, for instance, and the manifestation of 'gods' in what is perhaps best understood in terms of the literary myths we now have. They were also very 'in tune' (understatement) with the forces of nature, which is what led ultimately to their downfall. The power they had access to became corruptive within their souls and they began performing ever more extreme feats of power to do with the weather, for instance, and fire – the discovery of nuclear energy, in particular. They also became very interested in sex and started to enhance their bodies in order to maximise sexual pleasure (hence their association now with the dolphin race, which is the most sexual creature on earth, humans included). This is why there are such uncanny resonances with the modern world, which is staring into its mirror at Atlantis – a magical future prophecy as much as a past 'legend', or buried memory (for 'weather modification', read 'HAARP'). As far as I'm aware the memory of the flood and all that went with it was so traumatic that humanity collectively wiped it out of its consciousness, leading to the state of 'slumber' experienced by the mass of humankind. And yes of course it was the 'elite', as ever, who largely escaped the

consequences of the group actions, of which they – as the ones in power – were must culpable. Another parallel with modern life in which the ‘elites’ – all that means now is those with money – are more able than most to escape the horrific consequences of ‘the fall’... .to a point... .there’s only so far one – even a privileged one – can go along that road, be sure of it. There’s more than one reason why the princes Buddha and Jesus renounced their wealth. The escape of the elites is a plan that has once again been activated, but this time around more people are aware of the situation – more people whose memories of Atlantis are NOT buried. The priests weren’t quite the only ones who escaped. They planned their exodus, but others simply survived and were washed up on other shores. A lot of these have ended up as ‘new agers’ because of their resentment at the way the priestcraft handled the catastrophe – causing the problem then saving themselves. So even though they ‘know’ the hierarchy holds truths about God and man, there is a reaction against the hierarchy and a drive to make known what was formerly kept secret, so that everyone has a chance to survive. A lot of those who imagine themselves to be elite now are not really ‘in the club’. They have been given a certain amount of information and this in itself is so monumental that for the most part they are content to simply indulge their password potential, opening of the magical doors and access to the other world. In this way are some of the greatest minds and initiates kept a degree lower than they are really able to achieve, because if they were to attain to the highest orders they would then understand the terrible side of the truth and comprehend the extent to which they have been fooled. The key at that point is to break open the closed circle by invoking the name of Jesus Christ and through love and compassion (Happy Birthday Buddha!)throwing one’s lot in to help the children in the nursery to survive, to awaken, in other words. Tangentially, the swastika goes back to at least Atlantean times. It is still possible to go there in the astral so your dreams, if lucid, are most likely to be true. I’ve pestered Cologero about this so many times I see no reason to break the habit and hold back now – here is my story :-)

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/atlantis>

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/half-man-half-fish>

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/swastika>

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/ancient-script>

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/pisces-capricorn>

Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 06:55 said:

this isn’t just ‘altruism’, by the way. Humanity is bound together by its collective karma, so it’s essential that the ‘weight’ of this is light as a feather, that the balance is tipped towards ascension not sinking. United we’ll stand and divided we fall... .

mleow on 2012-05-05 at 09:52 said:

I also find the notion that “Evola was nostalgic for a different Time” is misleading. At least that is not the sense and understanding I get of the man and his writing, as Angolmois said “Ride the tiger” is perhaps the best example that Evola was in fact the one from the “traditionalist school” with the least escapist/nostalgic notions trying to cope with the modern reality as it is and all its destructive tendencies as incitements to inner awakening, instead of trying to conjure up artificial paradises, medieval, roman or whatever. The word “Good” in this regard also seems a bit strange, he always mentions the “Unconditioned” as the highest goal to steer one’s compass to. Would you care to elaborate or refer to parts of his writing as regarding claims for this goal towards the “Good”?

That said, I’m hoping to see more of these Giorgio translations. In what form has his writings survived: is it merely texts from various correspondences or has he also written books on esoteric topics?

Cologero on 2012-05-05 at 10:28 said:

The object of Action is the Good, otherwise action would be purposeless. Please think of it in the Traditional sense as a transcendental. For Plato, the Good itself was the ultimate. But as transcendentials, the Good, the True, and the Beautiful are ultimately unconditioned and One. How else could Action “lead” to the Unconditioned?

How is “riding the tiger” not passive? You are basing your judgment of Evola only on what has been made available to you. We have undertaken the effort to show the Evola of the 30s and 40s to demonstrate that he was decidedly not “riding the tiger”, but engaged in the political situation of the time. A man may have to ride the tiger, when historico-material conditions are unsuited to him. But our position here is that conditions have changed, so to ride the tiger is no longer an option. *A fortiori*, the time is come for the elite to arise and create the proper conditions. It is your option to *cope* with conditions, and continue to whine about the modern world, but the point is, as someone once said, to change it.

De Giorgio published nothing while he was alive. *La Tradizione Romana* existed in manuscript form in the 30s, presumably a copy was sent to Mussolini. It is systematic and describes the lineaments of the constitution of a future Traditional society. At that time he was associated with Evola and presumably they were trying to influence the political situation in the early 1930s toward a more Traditional direction.

At some point, De Giorgio withdrew, living a solitary life in the mountainous part of Italy, where he traveled a more mystical path. He left behind notebooks of poems and short essays, but nothing systematic; these have been gradually published after his death. I will translate more of the Roman Tradition on Gornahoor to show that Tradition is more than nostalgia. I will translate the more mystical and devotional texts elsewhere, since they may not be suited to the

more analytical tone of Gornahoor. For example:

Woman: <http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/woman>, from *Aphorisms and Poems*.

Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 11:08 said:

So what course will the 'elite' take in trying to improve conditions in the present world for one and all, because a political party or philosophical school won't achieve this? What is required is positive practical action, of that there can be no doubt. Who is prepared to give up home comforts, abandon the supermarket in favour of small stores, cut out food additives, quit supporting big businesses, to cease buying into the system, to desist from believing the lies of politicians, to understand that the corporate tapeworm economy is strangling the world – who can and WILL break free of the matrix-net surrounding us, be they elite or otherwise? Acknowledging with searing honesty who the desposynic heirs really are – and what it really takes to partake of the promised spiritual truths – is a difficult but necessary first step to achieving the desirable goal of saving the world. A leap of faith is required by almost everyone, plus individual determination to reform the self as a microcosmic alchemical procedure that brings about the cosmic renewal. Really there is no point denying it!

Angolmois on 2012-05-05 at 15:06 said:

I have personally understood Evola's 'Ride the Tiger' precisely as a path of action and positive change in-side the modern world. In Evola's own words it is meant for "the elite", but only as a handbook and a manual for individuals who may perhaps have no apparent connexion between each other. If this is out of the question for you Cologero and "not enough", I think that Gornahoor and websites / blogs like this one are one of the best way for the eventual organisation and appearance of the spiritual hierarchy of the earth that will change the world "in an instant" when the time is ready. Right now "we" are still scattered around and largely unorganised, not the least because of petty infighting among those who should first and foremost have a mutual understanding and the spirit of co-operation in their hearts.

mleow on 2012-05-06 at 04:11 said:

That makes it more clear.

I have read all of Evola's work that are available in english and the few snippets of translations made available on Gornahoor has not made any drastic revelation or revaluation about him or his work on my part. Well please remember that "ride the tiger" was one of his later books so its quite natural that he did not pursued that path of apoletia etc under the war and fascist years, where at least the possibilty and "humanmaterial" existed to change and influence the millieu in a traditional direction. I dont whine much really anymore about being born in this declining world. I accept my situation and embrace it as Evola would say, as a spiritual test, try

to see things according to truth and don't succumb or waste my life trying to cut off hydraheads ie spend my time on any vain action, as a spiritual master once said "Who has improved the world? People have improved themselves and then gone."

You say that the conditions have changed and yet in your next sentence you say that an elite will arise to create the new conditions? Sounds paradoxical to me. From my point of view i don't see it as realistic that a spiritual elite will spring up and take control, could you please specify as concretely as possible and not merely in the abstract how the current conditions seems apt for such an event to occur? How will this legion of beermongering footballcrazed pursuit of pleasurist sentimentalist secular cynical rationalist people ever recognise ,not to mention obey or need such an elite??

Charlotte on 2012-05-06 at 04:34 said:

Let's keep it real shall we? the actual spiritual elite are out there right now saving lives, with no time to sit around chit-chatting, hampered mainly by the refusal of the super-rich and super-powerful to either offer support to the solution or cease working against God and for themselves only

Cologero on 2012-05-06 at 12:56 said:

Evola's subtitle for *Ride the Tiger* was this: "orientamenti esistenziali per un'epoca di dissoluzione". Apparently, it was the American publishers who added: *A Survival Manual for the Aristocrats of the Soul*. Does anyone suppose that aristocrats of the soul publish "how to" manuals in mass market paperback editions? As the real Marcuse wrote, everything is co-opted by the system.

No, mleow, I cannot describe in detail, because it involves a singularity, the end of one world and the beginning of another. However, *contra factum non est disputandum*, and the facts point to traditional civilizations, or new spiritual movements, arising seemingly out of nothing. But I agree with you about avoiding vain action, or disputing with the ignorant.

Charlotte, you do true religion a disservice by trying to restrict it to moralism and humanism. That has never been the case.

Charlotte on 2012-05-06 at 15:09 said:

Since when did keeping it real mean doing 'true religion' a disservice – maybe the truth hurts? I thought works were the ultimate proof of faith – the royal road is one we all love to tread, but the greatest Masters preach and practice poverty – how can this be denied? I'd be the last one to discount the power of prayer but I'm not seeing much of that either and I don't like hypocrisy – talk about 'elites' makes me cringe and like it or not, it IS the humble practioners who tend to be the most touched by God's grace, you can see it shining from them. Not that I'm counting myself amongst this saintly group, just pointing out basic facts – we are looong

past the theoretical stage of forming the 'new world', Utopia was good enough. Now it's time for implementation and in my opinion it's beyond urgent, but people are wholly resistant to change for the better if it means disrupting their own comfortable lives even by one iota. And I'm not a humanist, you know I am not, there is no need to be bitchy – something about not shooting the messenger? Apologies, however, if I've over-moralising, I know that can be very annoying... .chit chat is fine, I'll butt out :-)

Cologero on 2012-05-06 at 18:51 said:

I sense a severe communications breakdown here, but I'm not sure what it is. You speak of "Masters", who are, I believe, what we mean by *spiritual elite*. Didn't Tomberg say somewhere that at the necessary moment, someone will appear to right things? I believe he mentioned by name St. Francis and St. Ignatius. Do you cringe because we single them out as "saints"?

We have no objection to spiritual and corporal works, but please keep in mind the story of Martha and Mary. The present danger is a man-centred religion, when it needs to be God-centred. The contemplative life has always been primary and everything else flows therefrom.

Angolmois on 2012-05-07 at 03:17 said:

I believe there is no need to despair if things seem to be currently out of hands concerning making things right again. The world will dissolve and break apart, that's the very promise of all scriptures, and then the "elite" or "the masters" – who are preparing themselves as we speak – will come out of the hermetic closet and reveal the real "new world order" and the new age "in the spirit of Lif and Lifhtrasil"; life, light and breath of the spiritual hierarchy).

Having battled with this issue for years in desperation and in the dark night of the soul I simply some day realised that it actually requires quite little in reality for things to change for the better again. It requires the change in the hearts and minds of men, and for this we all must aim our prayers and deeds. The Good One is still in charge no matter how it looks like right now.

Blessings of The High One for you all.

Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 05:10 said:

Well I think it's the focus on Rome I'm finding difficult, but I accept that this is a large part of what Gornahoor is about so fair enough because it is your website. I certainly never said mention of 'saints' made me cringe, the opposite in fact, I said mention of 'elite', I don't like the connotations of that word, it reminds me of the nazis. I accept, however, that it may not be meant in the way I'm reading it. I believe true 'Masters', like St Francis, practice poverty and love humanity, the notion of a superstructure of 'more brilliant' minds and people controlling the ignorant masses is what 'elitism' speaks of. I also think I make a valid point about works – the 'Masters' of the ilk of St Francis literally went out and healed people, as did the ultimate Master, Jesus. Perhaps I sense my own 'lack', for want of a better word, in the face of people who are able

to put into practice more of what they know, or who know 'less' but do more to help humanity. Put it this way, a starving child needs prayers for sure, but also something else, right? Maybe I'm just reaching the stage of my spiritual journey where I'd like to put the food into their mouths more often, rather than 'just' praying. Which again, is not to discount the power of prayer, more collective positive thinking in the world could work miracles, but in the meantime there are multiple crises that need tackling on multiple fronts. Another example of a 'humble' soul of the kind I was referring to might be America's own George Washington Carver – having read something of his life for the first time quite recently he certainly emerges as a 'Master' initiate of sorts, so in this respect truly 'elite'. Perhaps the real issue, then, is one of defining precisely what constitutes this 'elite'. Maybe I've been misunderstanding by thinking that people here are singled out as being 'elite' simply for having adopted a certain political/religious philosophy and going on to write about it? And yes, I do believe there is a Messiah who rights things, ultimately there is only one Master, the great leveller... I agree the change must come in the hearts and minds of all humans, this is what I'm meaning by 'grass roots' level action, whereby all individuals take responsibility. The time of teaching has been going on for a long while, it's time to put these things into practice. As for 'New World Order'... well, we had a recent discussion about the Georgia Guidestones. Unfortunately most of those who might think of themselves as 'elite' in this context are simply rich and powerful. Any esoteric knowledge they might have gleaned has come from decidedly suspect angles, OTO, etc – and all mixed in with the influx of nazism into America following WWII. They never really lost the war, you know?

Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 05:13 said:

I also refer to Einstein: 'those who know have a duty to act'

Cologero on 2012-05-07 at 08:19 said:

Perhaps, Charlotte, you could read *The Second Precept of Love*⁶, particularly what he says about the prehension of the All or Unity. We tend to experience the world in discrete pieces rather than in its totality. This applies to Time as well as Space; in other words, the panorama of History is also the unfolding of a divine Plan, not just the work of men.

Guenon complained about the change in the word "elite" from the way he first used it. It may be better to think of it as the "elect", as in "many are called, few are chosen (electus)". So, it is not something a person may claim for himself, but rather something that is assigned to him from above. Your Master also speaks of the leaven in the bread, so we are entirely faithful to that message. The change must come from the elect, long before it comes "in the hearts and minds of all humans".

⁶<http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-second-precept-of-love>

Who are you, Charlotte, Martha or Mary?

Cologero on 2012-05-07 at 08:36 said:

As for the focus on Rome, that is due to its central place in the history of Europe, a fortiori, the very creation and self-understanding of Europe, not once, but twice. Aeneas, the spiritual founder of Rome, brought the Wisdom of the East to the West, of which Rome was the center. Dante, in *De Monarchia*, points out the Divine Plan for Ancient Rome, and I assume everyone is familiar with that.

Then we see the central place of Rome in the Tarot, in the Arcana of the High Priest of Rome and the Emperor of Rome. As their influence wanes, the world falls apart.

By the way, there are no Nazis in USA, quite the contrary. USA is the heir to Cromwell's England and the British Freemasons. OTO is a British, not a Nazi, organization.

Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 09:04 said:

Yes I know, from Crowley, but a lot of the 'magick' employed is similar to the way the nazis achieved their dark spiritual aims. A lot of nazi scientists, as you know, escaped to America, they were taken on board by the government. When I say 'they won', I mean in terms of the technological/material emphasis in the world today, in particular the warcraft. Hitler took heart to some extent – for his racial theories, at least – from the American wars against the Indian, and he was also fairly admiring of the English, it's all tied up together as I'm sure you're aware. What is helpful, however, is a clarification of what is meant by 'elite', thank you – as this is a term that's often bandied about these days in a very negative sense. This is an open website so who knows what casual readers might think? (To some extent I'm one of those, if also regular). I still maintain, however, that the change has already come from the minds of the 'elect', the forerunners, and it is up to us now to implement this in some way. To bring it out of the world of formation and into the world in a way that is recognisable to all. The way of salvation. Rome, well, I'm 'Greek', as I think you also know – my tutor was very snooty about Roman history in comparison and I agree with him almost entirely on this point! The answer is to revive the Mysteries, drink from the lake of memory – here! <http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/lake-of-memory-2>

Angolmois on 2012-05-07 at 10:52 said:

For the sake of clarification, Charlotte & others, what I meant by 'the new world order' has certainly nothing to do with what is meant by it today. I used it simply to refer to the emerging Tradition in the ruins of the current world, a transcendental order and a new golden age, the age of Saturn.

The Elite defines itself and *shines*, its activity is salvific in all orders of life according to the dharma of the particular practitioner or order. The crown and the sceptre, on the other hand,

always move only further away from those who seek and yearn for them.

18.4 The Constitution of a Traditional Society: The Capo

The Supreme Leader

This is the concluding section of **Guido De Giorgio**'s description of the establishment of a traditional society. Here, he develops the idea of the supreme leader, above the three castes, whose primary duty is the maintenance of Tradition.

This section, as a whole, needs to be compared to the similar efforts by Guenon, Coomaraswamy, and Evola to describe the respective roles of Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power. However, De Giorgio's work comes from a completely different place, from a deep understanding of the principles involved. The other three try to make an "argument", by referring to various scriptures or historical situations. Guido De Giorgio speaks from the heart, from what he knows; he can be judged on that basis. That is how Tradition is to be recovered.

Interspersed within the main topic, as always there are various spiritual gems to be recovered. We can call attention in particular to the notion that a man creates his own life. Also, pace those who want to create a superman, De Giorgio believes that man qua man must vanish in order for something higher to appear.

We could repeat at this point the exhortation that Homer put into the mouth of wise Ulysses when the Greeks appeared to abandon the Trojan adventure and that even Aristotle cited at the end of Book XII of the *Metaphysics*: "let there be one ruler." There is first of all the great law of analogy according to which the only leader in time must correspond

to the supreme unity in eternity and since God is pure contemplation and only the cognitive fruition of aseity can be conceived in Him, so the Leader inversely will make a pure activity of his life dedicated to the maintenance of his command on the earth.

He holds temporal power, exercises it uncontested, and is the supreme authority whose domain embraces all the active life in its multiple aspects and over which he is the regulator and judge. His function is therefore integrative and his work is strictly dependent on Justice, the highest of the virtues.

If on the one hand, while being the supreme leader, he is above all the prince of the Warriors, his power is exercised over all indiscriminately in the temporal environment because he could not go beyond it without failing in his task and his purpose.

Although he arose from the Warrior caste, in order to carry out his task he is above the three castes and so must, while remaining strictly within the scope of the active life, serve as the harmonious base of the development of the first two castes, from the first receiving consecration, and serving for the protection and the maintenance of the traditional order of the second. In order to preserve inviolate his sovereignty, he will have to guard the Temple that is the foundation of every tradition and defend the Priests who nourish with their spiritual influence the body of the truths accessible only to the contemplatives. While depending spiritually on them, he is absolutely autonomous in his domain and the Priests in this owe him obedience as all men belonging to the other two castes, nor can or should the spiritual insert itself into the temporal and compromise the pure sphere of contemplation which does not have to undergo profanation of that sort.

The unity of command represents the centralizing equilibrium of the active life that loses in the Leader its particularistic and widespread character in order to rise to a level analogous to the Edenic state where everything is put before man who is truly the king of creation. Therefore

the Leader vanishes only before God where his sovereignty is annulled in the Lordship of all the lords: everything in this life, he will be in the other that which he will have merited according to the meaning it will have had from God. "Caesar I was, Justinian I am..." [Dante, *Paradise* vii]. In the face of God the greatest victory will be that which he will have been able to bring back on himself and on what he will have accomplished on earth, nothing will matter for him except the works of justice, rectification, equilibrium, and peace. Since the Leader must always seek peace for his subjects in analogy with that same thing that in the contemplative order is the foundation of every realization and all aspire to that type of activity that develops them. The maintenance of this equilibrium is reserved to the Warriors who will always make war an instrument of peace and not of pure and simple conquest. The unity of the empire avoids the unproductive diffusions of the active life concentrating its energies toward a single end where all disparities and partial imbalances are evened out, therefore if in the Warriors, as was said, inner asceticism is the necessary base for the development of their activity, this is even more strict in the Leader who must annul in himself any individuality whatsoever in order to make justice triumph and the rule secure the empire.

He knows that he is the supreme ruler of the active life and that the active vibration emanates from him that, in analogy with the divine, is extended to all the branches of humanity of which he constitutes the propelling and purifying center through which the backward wave [*onda di ritorno*] obtains new energy for new possibilities of development in a perpetually mobile and fecund circle of flux and reflux.

We are purely in the sphere of action in which all men necessarily live and to which none are exempt except those who can and must dedicate themselves to the contemplative life: what each man accomplishes in it, and the way in which he accomplishes it, has a very great importance for the equilibrium of human perfection that would be maimed and amputated if an element is removed from that current of active homogeneity

that constitutes temporal modality.

All traditions in fact reserve the contemplative life to those for whom it is appropriate and who are worthy of it, while they condemn asceticism and separation from the world for those who lie outside it obeying a sense of inadmissible egoism: those are the weak and the lifeless and they avoid the responsibility of worldly life through real insufficiency. It will be well to insist on that: everyone brings and creates, so to speak, his environment and by this word we do not mean only the closest circle, but the entire temporal extent of human life with everything which is positive and negative in it for the individual. Making use here of an image, we could say that every man has a passage of existence that is not only his world, but all the world that is for him what he is for the world itself: in this passage that starts from the center of a circumference and is contained between two divergent rays which, having as base a segment of the circumference itself, form a cone, there is everything that man wants and that he does not want, his fortune, his misfortune, his battle, his dispute, his victory or his downfall. The essential thing for him is to rise up in ascending planes from the circumference to the center, from the base of the cone to the vertex that represents the greatest of the minimum, i.e., God, while reassimilating all multiplicity gradually into a point only in which he is annulled, because he, dispelling ignorance, will recognize himself in everything, even and above all, in that to which he is most opposite and will recompose in a perfect equilibrium all the antagonisms up to the point of extinguishing them in the highest vortex of his asceticism, or better said, of his recovery, which is God.

When we employ this term, we mean everything that is truly of God in God, truly and not fallaciously, i.e., all the superhuman states of union with God that man can realize only starting from himself in order to reach that which is no longer himself, man before, no longer man afterwards.

The terrestrial level is one experience and not another, that is necessary to start from a base of disablement in order to reach an apex of

absolute immutability: these are the two greatest terms in the sphere of that which appears in the seat of human relativity: a fallacious reality, man, a genuine reality, God, the former only illusory, the latter, supreme certainty. But placing oneself at an integrative point of view, one is reality, God, who is no longer a goal which one reaches except through a dissipation of ignorance, as whoever believes real the phantasms of the fog that are non-existent provided the sun dispels and dissolves it.

The Role of the Leader

In this second of three parts, **Guido De Giorgio** expands on the role of the Leader in a traditional society. It is instructive to compare De Giorgio's point of view with Evola's idea of the state; De Giorgio includes the spiritual or contemplative aspect which brings in some subtle changes. Nevertheless, Di Giorgio also recognizes that the active life can also be a path to realization.

The emphasis on the law is also important, such Guenon pointed out that the western medieval tradition did not have a sacred law. There was, and is, canon law, but that is at a lesser level. What De Giorgio is describing is more akin to sharia law in Islam, or the complex rituals and requirements required of Hindu castes, and even the ancient Romans whose daily lives were regulated by rites and taboos. Abandoning such laws, in his view, does not lead to more freedom, but rather to is opposite: it leads to servitude to one's passions and lower nature.

On the other hand, by not knowing himself man does not know God because only the knowledge of his illusory existence permits him to realize the essential truth of God in a process that moves from negation to affirmation, from human nothingness to divine wholeness, not from a fragment to a totality, but from a non-totality to totality, from illusory human unity to real divine unity, not from duality to unity, but from non-duality to unity. This knowledge entails an effective realization that

in its turn annuls the earthly sphere, the environment in which man lives, putting all its elements on a plane of absolute equivalence, i.e., neutralizing, dissipating the sense of otherness that derives from the possessive conceit concluding in the ontological absurdity "I am I".

The process of realization instead denies the first person, affirms the second, unifies the first and third, and definitively puts itself beyond this union, in what we could call the Fourth Sublime, the Fourth Absolute.

This is the ideal plan of transhumanization presented as a *fieri* while it is an *esse*, and it is the decisive model of everything in principle and therefore also and above all of the Leader who is not such if he does not take on the experience of his subjects in the purity of the distributive standard and in the unification of sovereign power. Therefore his function is, so to say, the restoration of hierarchy, the consecration of the human body whose members are the subjects while he is the vivifying center that accomodates the innumerable expressions of the active life, purifies them in the renovating power of traditional principles whose deposit the Priests hold and returns them almost equipped with a more intense rhythm and clad with the united seal.

In this sense he the first and the last of his subjects because his subordination to divine principles is dependent on his capacity to centralize the forms of active life while expending his personality in a decisive totalization. The relationship between the Leader and his subjects consists in this, that he is in all and all are in him with an absolute reciprocity that makes of the entire active life a veritable sacrifice, i.e., an imperfection made sacred through the gift that is made of it to God in the person of the Leader. He accepts and gives, and what he offers is always himself: he is responsible for how much his subjects accomplish because in him everything merges in order to receive the supreme consecration. The asceticism of the Leader is in a sense superior to that of the Warriors because it is vaster and more integral, accomodating in himself all the developments of the active life in order to maintain them within the traditional ambit

with the spiritual authority of the Priests and the power of the Warriors, from the former, the conscience, and from the latter, the personality so that ascetically the last in front of God is the first in front of men. His activity, obeying the law of justice, is thus purged of any personal motives whatsoever because, by becoming Leader, he consecrated himself to the coming of peace on earth and governs in order to make it respected and he provides the harmony of traditional society with a constant effort of rectification. As God is the ruler of all the worlds, he is the ruler of the earth and of the men who inhabit it, the supreme regulator of their activity without passing beyond his domain which is that of the active life, without which he could be in open conflict with his function and purpose as temporal leader occupying the contemplative sphere that is to the Priests reserved. Harmony must precisely consist in the separation of the two powers that, on earth, and on earth alone, where activity is in force, conserving two distinct spheres while it no longer exists in an ultra-worldly stage that is the starting point for the integral realization of the divine.

The subjects owe the Leader obedience and respect; obedience because he directs human affairs, analogously with God who rules the creative universality, and respect because his function is the application of justice, i.e., the rectification of the disparities produced by the multifor- mity of men's actions and protects them and guides them to the realization of happiness in whose terminal and plenary stage is Edenic perfection.

Human activity when brought back to the purpose of rite is purified from every contaminating egoism and the man who has fulfilled his temporal stage in perfect adherence to the norm of justice, regains the absolute preeminence over the other beings of whom he becomes again lord and he enjoys the Great Peace in the exercise of his liberty released from every abuse. It is the Leader's precise function to tend to this reintegration of the divine state, directing all the forms of earthly activity

toward a progressive purgation and acting so that man can fulfill what is granted to him on earth without actions limiting and precluding contemplation but, regulated and ordered, more than a snag and a chain, is itself a mode of liberation. And he can become it only if conducted according to justice which is the greatest of the virtues, especially for the Leader who must prefer it more than any other virtue because his action neutralizes the will leading every form of activity back into its channel, preventing abuses of power and giving true liberty to the subjects, i.e., the spiritual practice that is gained with obedience to the law.

Here man is liberated by obeying and not otherwise: whoever does not understand that will always be subjugated. In fact, in order to obey it is necessary to understand the value of the law that is placed to redeem men from the appetites that enslave and to make him able to exercise his freedom effectively. The Leader must be vigilant in respect to the law in order to facilitate the gaining of freedom and he himself will be liberated to the extent he maintains the limits of his temporal function without ever passing beyond them. The law in itself does not know how to nor can it make itself respected, but it needs whoever establishes it, and since it is a pure norm higher than men, it must be imposed: in this sense strength accompanies justice, nor can it be separated and the Leader must make the law respected with strength. But from submission to the law, freedom is born that, being purely of the spiritual order and belonging to the contemplative life, arises only from the perfection of this, like a crowning achievement, an apical stage that is the triumph of man over himself.

Man calls himself free only when he again becomes the son of truth and does not recognize subjection other than this to the point of confusing himself, identifying with a further state which will be that of pure unity. But in the domain of the active life, it is not possible to be liberated other than by obeying the law personified in the Leader who must make it respected with strength, not through an affirmation of supremacy—

which is to be excluded in a traditional society—but to prevent the subjects from falling into servitude by breaking the law. The temporal power is inclined to the achievement of freedom and is established for this, so that, by imposing the law, the immoderate will is avoid, the bestial part in man is restrained, and it is started precisely to be free. To regulate the active life can signify nothing other that is positively fertile than to permit contemplative practice in the measure conceded to each one by his spirit. In civil life, freedom is therefore obedience and in the contemplative life it is liberation: up to this point it is understood that man is not so much born free as he becomes free, and better said, born free, he can maintain his freedom or fall into servitude: most men, by forgetting freedom, which is a divine gift, prefer servitude to their passions, and this they call freedom and are opposed to the monarchical regime because they see in the Leader a man like them and not a model who, in order to make himself respected, must necessarily personify himself: one is not liberated, but becomes liberated, and naturally he becomes it because he is it, but ignorance prevents him from knowing why man is born free: only for the fulfillment of his earthly experience and not for the exaltation of that which is least human in him. He was free at his birth as the son of God, but, straying in order to follow his impulse, which he fallaciously calls freedom, he has become again a slave: in order to become free again, i.e., a son of God, he must put himself under the regulative norm of the active life and to regain the freedom of the contemplative life.

Conclusion

This is the conclusion to the role of the Leader in a traditional society. It needs to be read meditatively, and not with the intent to refute or falsify it. If read in silence, without the infusion of personal opinions, something very different may be heard.

We said that man first denies himself and then affirms himself: he denies himself in the law and affirms himself in love, which is only the supple-

mentary knowledge of the truth. Now the active life cannot be abandoned to the disordered will of the appetites which would make it an end in itself, while it is only a means whose purpose is clearly determined by the temporal power embodied in the Leader. In order to be truly such, it is necessary that this power be employed by a single man so that every subject contemplates himself in his sovereign, his better part, to whom he must submit himself, the reason that regulates every activity restraining them within their limits and preventing them from gravely obstructing the attainment of the pure values of the spirit.

If the natural end of man is heaven, the starting point is the earth, so that the necessity for making its foundation organized by a liberating action that acts especially on the obstructing element, the body, which abandoned to itself, precludes every possibility of overcoming and attainment. That which is corporeal remains subordinated to the psychic element that is transparently vague through its elusiveness and diffusivity: the virtues inherent in the active life, that the Leader rules and directs, have as their field of action the psychic complex that must be contained and limited by reason as if by a supreme command. But reason is in a certain sense two-edged to the extent that on the one hand it dominates and restrains the lower faculties and on the other, it inserts into a higher order of reality where the intellect extends and, while being human, is the mediator between the human and the divine: likewise the Leader rules in the sign of justice so that a higher stage becomes a reality, whose domain belongs more specially to the Priests, but it is necessary for the Warriors to facilitate this perfection.

Given that, it indicates that war is the condition of peace as long as it is truly conducted by those for whom it is their only given mission and within the limits that make it justifiable and necessary.

In the earthly and human domain, law must make use of force and the symbol and the means of justice is two-edged sword, one of which strikes and points toward the lower, which the other points higher and is

bloodless, the point representing the peak of unification of the higher and the lower, the supreme acme, death, or resolution. Thus what seemingly appears cruel, is not always so in reality, and the justice that imposes itself with force is often the necessary vestibule of the highest sphere of love. The activity of the Leader in human and earthly life is analogous to that of God, whose direct instrument he is, in order to coordinate the modes of activity pursuant to justice, truth, and love. No one more than the Leader knows that by punishing others he punishes himself and that with an act of justice he fulfills an achievement of love and truth: if he does not know this, if he ignores his purpose, he is not truly a leader, but a slave of his own cupidity, since he cannot command if he is not aware of the *raison d'être* of his authority, of the divine character of his mission.

A Warrior among the Warriors he must be an ascetic among the ascetics: so he will reach the point to rule others by how much more he will rule himself and to defeat his enemies by defeating himself, and to fight the small wars by fighting the Great War, and to achieve external peace by how much more profoundly and perfectly he will have achieved interior peace, knowing that earthly life is only a stage, but the most important of all, of which he is the orderer. His responsibility is very great before men but especially before God since by betraying his creatures he betrays his Creator and by neglecting justice in order to follow his own impulse he contradicts the nobility of the position that he occupies and abuses the power that is given to him: then he will truly be last among men and servant among the servants. Since there is no justice without a judge, so the Leader is also judge among men and here his task is still more serious and difficult: he must be very attentive and not exceed the scope in which his activity unfolds, since as judge he can affect the case, but not the knowledge of those who have accomplished it. He knows in fact that everything that happens may not happen and that there is nothing open to censure that others accomplish that he himself cannot accomplish, since men are the mirror of man and he, as Leader, is the

mirror of the time in which he lives and is also the supreme responsible man for it.

His more or less great adherence to tradition is measured by the degree of greater or lesser spirituality of the era in which he lives and of which he is the judge. He must dematerialize the world, bring active life back within its normal limits, to make action a means and not an end, and contemplation an end and not a means, and force the pure expression of law and power, the assertion of his humility before God, and justice the implacable rectification, and the gift of himself the constant offering.

He is in the world to redeem it, to purify it in the name of God, for the love of God, because he, with the Warriors, is the protector of the Temple and his mission is the respect of the sacred law to which he is subject and through which he is the Leader, since everything that comes from God must return to God, and what is accomplished on earth is only for the dignity of the true man who is a son of God. His true glory, his true conquest will have facilitated it, prepared it, realized the coming of the kingdom of God, having transformed life in a rite redeeming man from his state of servitude, leading him to liberty through to liberation, making of the active life a connecting bridge to the beatitude of contemplation where the divine is only realized, ransoming not oppressing, spiritualizing not materializing.

Only in that way will he be the God's chosen and his power will receive that consecration from which all authority comes. He knows that man and the world are of God and that everything must flow into the great traditional axis that is sustained by sacred knowledge of which he is the most pious and aware supporter. The active life that he rules and normalizes must be contained within the limits that permit each man to rise to the sphere of contemplation where true life begins, the divine life, and his mission unfolds in the temporal sphere for eternity, on earth for heaven, the center of the innumerable efforts that flows from every point into a single wave, in a single rhythm, for the glory of the one before

Whom everything is nothing and the nothing is all.

Supreme bundler of fasces [Fascificatore], the Leader redeems the transience of man and the world with the vivifying rhythm of tradition of which he must be the most intransigent defender in order to establish the constitutive unity of castes, the harmony of principles, the respect of standards, the convergence of all the efforts in the fulfillment of his very high mission, so that the world is truly the mark, the crown, and the sign of God.

Posted on 2013-07-21 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-07-21 at 12:26 said:

In the Christian tradition, the capo existed in the form of the Byzantine Emperor, and later the Russian Tsar who was the absolute ruler over both spiritual and temporal realms.....in the East the Emperor protected defended the church but the church was still subject to his laws. In the West the Capo never emerged due to conflicts between the Popes and the Emperors.....

Cologero on 2013-07-22 at 13:07 said:

J-A, do you suppose that Guido De Giorgio is proposing a thought experiment along the lines of Plato's Republic? Although the domain of the Capo is activity, unlike God, he can never be pure act, so there is always non-being or privation associated with his rule. The stronger Leaders can come closer to the ideal.

JA on 2013-07-23 at 12:16 said:

Of course de Giorgio is discussing an ideal, but it is our task to make the ideal real....if not now then when the time is right.....

It is also a good question whether or not the Capo could ever actually exist, perhaps Justinian or Charlemagne came close ?

JA on 2013-07-29 at 10:42 said:

From my first readings de Giorgio's ideas read very much like that of the Byzantine-Russian practice of symphonia where church and state were separate but linked in that the Tsar was anointed by the patriarch and expected to be a good Christian at the risk of losing his legitimacy

from God, but while subject to the church in spiritual matters the Emperor was ruler of the church in temporal realms.

In the western history I'm trying to understand if Roman Catholic doctrine would allow for a Capo or would the Pope claim too much power in temporal affairs that an absolute monarch would never be able to exist ?

Cologero on 2013-07-29 at 12:39 said:

Tomberg addresses this very question, as it is enshrined in the arcana of the Pope and the Emperor.

For example:

"The authors of the Middle Ages could not imagine Christianity without an Emperor."

JA on 2013-07-29 at 14:17 said:

Tomberg follows the Catholic conception but is his vision of the Emperor the same as de Giorgio's ? I'll have to read this essay several more times before I am able to conclude for sure but now it's seeming to me that the Capo has more power than the Holy Roman Emperor (for example the priests are subject to him in the temporal sphere, whereas the Church claimed that a King or and Emperor had no power over a clergyman, the clergy answer to the Pope alone, hence no state could be absolute because the clergy constituted a caste that was not in service to the monarch) – later on the arrangement changed more in the Kings favour (Spanish Baroque period, France under Louis XIV) but that was the decline of Catholicism already....

basically my worry about the Catholic system of government is that the duality of heads is unstable (Pope vs Emperor) and allows for rebellions of kings (as what happened with protestantism). The Orthodox model seems more stable but then its problem is that it become too national (greek church, russian church all under their own Tsars) and fails to create an Imperium as Rome was meant to do...

Logres on 2013-07-30 at 10:27 said:

The Orthodox apparently have a tradition that St. Feodor of Tomsk was Alexander I, who staged his own assassination.

<http://www.johnsanidopoulos.com/2012/11/was-saint-feodor-of-tomsk-really.html>

Logres on 2013-07-30 at 10:53 said:

Would de Giorgio's doctrine imply that, even in our time, such a person necessarily exists, however hidden or concealed? It seems to me that it would – God would be sustaining his link to the world through the sacred body of the King. King Alfred seems like a close approximation to the ideal, in the West.

scardanelli on 2013-07-30 at 11:57 said:

Logres,

You jogged my memory, and I recalled that I read of this same concept in the introduction to Sedir's Initiations:

"There is a Prince of this Earth –delegate of Lucifer; and there is also the Lord of this Earth –delegate of Christ... [T]he Lord of the Earth is the one among the servants, soldiers or friends of

Christ who possesses the qualities and the right quantity of Lights most suited to link our terrestrial life to the Word directly. He receives the orders of Christ, executes them, then transmits the hopeful aspirations of the earth's inhabitants to Him."

Ash on 2013-08-02 at 01:58 said:

An essential question to ask here must be, who judges the Capo? Or rather, can anyone decide when he has failed in his role? Presumably it would be the duty of the Contemplative caste to make these judgements and of the Active (warrior) caste to carry them out and replace the Leader. We might think of what happened during the Empire when Emperors such as Caligula, Nero, and Elagabalus were killed by the Praetorian guard (admittedly, money and preservation of power had more to do with those than concern for Traditional principles). A troublesome situation arises when the Capo begins to feud with the other two higher castes, such as Henry VIII and the Catholic Church. While it is obviously not de Giorgio's principle, I must admit to some unease as much of the language used here could easily be hijacked to justify totalitarian and decidedly anti-Traditional forms of ideology and tyranny. There are many out there eager to grab the reigns of power and ignore the voices of those who remind them that this power is meant to be exercised within its proper dominion and no further.

Cologero on 2013-08-03 at 14:01 said:

Perhaps, Ash, tomorrow's conclusion will clarify some things. However, it seems you are thinking in terms of the modern mind and the examples you give are hardly traditional. It's true, there is literally no one to judge the Capo since he is God's representative and no one can judge God. Of course, the modern mind regards that as a trick, some kind of ruse to keep the people under control, the opiate of the masses. The modern mind denies the very possibility of God manifesting through some particular man, whereas the traditional mind can see things no other way: the cosmic order is in continuity and harmony with the social order.

Jung made an interesting point, for example, that the Pharaoh was the only individuated person and the mass was undifferentiated. The latter state would have been more like that described by Julian Jaynes and thoughts would have seemed to them to originate from the outside, from "gods". Hence, the command of the Pharaoh would have had the same force. We

may suppose that the consciousnesses of the scribes and priest were similar to the Pharaoh's to some extent. Jung and Serrano claim that the "persona" is more marked in the West and that may account for the turmoil.

In the Ancient City, the leader was a priest-king with divine authority. Unfortunately, we don't have sufficient documentation, but Fustel de Coulanges claims that at some point the function of the Chief Priest and King got separated as the Warrior caste asserted more control. The relevant period for Rome was the Kingdom. For example, the second king Numa also led the Priests. It is interesting that the way the King was selected is nearly identical to the way Popes are selected today. Again, that documentation was lost, to the extent that in the Republic and the Empire, the ancient laws became incomprehensible.

I guess the point is that the traditional system is not simply one alternative among many, as some sort of political party among many others. It would require an intellectual conversion, a real change in consciousness.

Ash on 2013-08-03 at 18:51 said:

Cologero, would you not say there is a concern to address in terms of the abuse of such authority? Clearly the boundaries of the Capo are defined and as such the truly differentiated man would be following them, but we also have accounts of corrupt Emperors and Pharaohs. I suppose in some ways this question is very cart-before-the-horse, since presumably a traditional force in society would establish itself before the question of a Capo ever arose. But if, as de Giorgio says, the priests consecrate the Capo even as he comes from the warriors, that would seem to mean that they can prevent unworthy individuals from attaining such position, and would it not simply be a further fulfillment of this role that they act as a check on the Capo (if ideally an unnecessary one). To put it more plainly, I think we are all generally suspicious of individuals claiming that they are God's representative and that they must be followed as His own voice, precisely because they are generally scammers and anti-Traditional. We, as students of Tradition, must strive more than anyone to be sure that those who guide and teach are authentic and acting in accordance with their duties and the Truth.

On the point of the King I can provide some assistance, as I did some in depth studying on the religious heritage of Rome for university papers last year. My main secondary source was a book called *Religions of Rome* (Beard, North, and Price). It makes the case that the political Rex and the Rex Sacrocum were always separate positions in the regal era. During the early Republic and onward, the Rex Sacrocum was a member of the Pontifical college and as such himself under the authority of the Pontifex Maximus. This is however a new development, as it was previously assumed by many that the Rex Sacrocum at some point simply took over the religious duties of the King. Your example of Numa is ideal though: assuming separate functions, Numa would seem to fulfill the role of Capo and thus the Rex Sacrocum would be subordinate to him, being the head priest.

Cologero on 2013-08-03 at 19:34 said:

If the *Capo* has the qualities that De Giorgio describes, then there is no abuse. The Roman king selection followed an interesting process. The Senate elected the King from among them, so presumably they should know him well. He was presented to the people who could refuse him. Finally, the priest had to wait for the omen to indicate the new king had divine authority. So the king required approval from the three castes. Is that not sufficient for you? In your studies on the Roman Kingdom, why did it eventually fail and get replaced by the Republic?

Ash on 2013-08-03 at 21:12 said:

That would seem more than sufficient for choosing the ruler, yes. I am thinking more about degeneration over time (as the castes themselves face as well). Perhaps it would be useful to reflect on past incidences of this degeneration. Keeping Rome as our example, the last King was remembered as a tyrant who forever swore the city off that system of government.

As to why the Kingdom fell...the simple answer is that historians are left in many ways to guesswork. We know of the story of the rape of Lucretia and the fall of Tarquinius Superbus, but I would personally think that the "other" myth of Romulus' death may provide insight. In this account, Romulus is murdered by the *Patres*, the body which became the Senate. They then dismember his body and attempt to hide the murder by claiming that he became a god, who was worshiped as Quirinus. We know that the Kings were generally chosen from outside the *Curiae*, the collections of families from the Roman population. Thus the six legendary Kings consist of Latins, Sabines, and Etruscans, none of whom directly succeed fathers. This suggests that conflict always existed at some level between the *Patres*/Senators and the Kings who were meant to deliberate among them as outsiders, as would be expected. As an aside, we also know that the senatorial and priestly bodies were overlapping to a great extent, and that the major priests would often also be major political figures, particularly in the later Republic.

Having derived these points, and knowing that the Republic was established following a rebellion of the Senatorial class against a King who had become considered tyrannical, we may conclude that this conflict came to a head. History being written by the winners, we may assume that the Senatorial patrician classes decided that they were better off with the familial competition than regal moderation. If we are to examine this with de Giorgio's vocabulary, this means that the warriors (the Senators and Equestrians alone had the property and wealth to be able to train and arm themselves to protect Rome) overthrew the *Capo* who had been previously approved by them. We do not know who the "people" (the plebs and plebeians) supported in this struggle, though later generations remembered the overthrow as a great event and shared the Senate's hatred of Kings. Perhaps the previously mentioned defeat of the rebellion of the *Kshatriyas* in the Hindu epics is an example of a similar conflict which was won by the other side.

Saladin on 2013-08-03 at 22:28 said:

Ash@ "We do not know who the "people" (the plebs and plebeians) supported in this struggle"

Ash, I am sure you meant Plebs and Proletariat, right?

As you said, it's not too much of a stretch to think that "Senatorial patrician classes decided that they were better off with the familial competition than regal moderation" and they replaced a degenerate king with a Republic. As for the masses, I don't think their taking side would have made that much of a difference at that period of time. Even though "bread and circus" was invented for them much later, during the Empirical period, a different version of "bread and circus" was enough to keep them preoccupied during those early Republican period.

Ash on 2013-08-04 at 00:24 said:

Saladin, I did mean pleb and plebeian. The two words are not wholly interchangeable, as pleb and proletarian would probably be. Pleb means a labourer and man without property who is working in labour or perhaps a trade, whereas plebeian simply denotes one who is not part of the original patrician families. The patrician/plebeian distinction actually lost importance rather early during the Republic, when the "nobiles"/new man distinction between those who had held consulships and those who had not gained importance. Many major figures during the Republic and almost all of those in the Empire were plebeian, but not plebs as they had attained high standing. Augustus' familial links with the Julians aside, there were no real patrician Emperors. It's just a distinction between terms and sometimes gets confused with catchalls like nobility or aristocracy, and for here I wouldn't worry too much about it.

Avery Morrow on 2013-08-04 at 05:09 said:

Ash, Fustel de Coulanges distinguishes the concept of rex from tyrannus, a king who rules without religious affirmation. All Emperors were tyranni because their authority came from the secularized SPQR and not the patrician faith. (They weren't categorized that way by their contemporaries but they would have been recognized as such in the preclassical city – a great demonstration of how much Rome changed over the centuries.) Regardless of whether rex and rex sacrocum were different positions, it should go without saying that they both had the symbolic quality of rex.

A comparison to the Far East is interesting.

18.5 The Establishment of a Traditional Society: Priests

In *La Tradizione Romana*⁷, **Guido De Giorgio** dedicates a section to the question of the reestablishment of a traditional society. It includes four chapters: *The Priests*, *The Warriors*, *The Workers*, and *The King*. This is the first part of the chapter on the priests. De Giorgio provides some very precise indications which are very demanding and ought to be taken with some seriousness.

Introduction

The general lines that are given here about a society established along the norms of a tradition truly such, can serve as the model and example for leading the current West to a normality that it has lacked for quite some time, which could, however, be gradually and prudently restored without great difficulties by the return to those principles and to that spirituality of thought and life that are indispensable to the very existence of men. Therefore it is a question of a general type according to which Europe could be oriented and hence the world with the necessary adaptations to change conditions of life while avoiding a violent and radical dissolution that would jeopardize, through its rapidity, the reintegration of a normal state.

If a return is possible, if a rectification is still possible to save the world from spiritual and material ruin, it entails a change of direction that must absolutely proceed from the inner to the outer and not otherwise. First of all, spiritual conviction of a similar change is necessary, and this conviction must be founded on a *purely intellectual realization*, i.e., without any sentimental infiltration whatsoever, of principles that rule a traditional society, and, since it would be useless and childishly utopian to

⁷*The Roman Tradition*

believe that the entire people and the masses can achieve it through an instant process, it would be sufficient that a few at the beginning would constitute a formative nucleus with an increasingly more efficient operative irradiation leading up to the reintegration of a nearly perfect form. These few would be animated by a single force, that of truth, and guided by a single goal, that of making it triumph, and not to give in to any concession toward oneself or others, but to become true and proper centers of salvation for men misled and corrupted by centuries-old errors. If such men do exist, the return to normality would again be possible and the truth could still triumph over ignorance.

A change of this type entails the pure and simple rejection of all the prejudices that have debased Europe for centuries, of all the errors that the Anti-tradition has been amassing for hundreds of years to corrupt thought and life, impoverishing the mind and paralyzing those spiritual forces promoting the true and only good, the fruition of the Truth in a superhuman order where it alone resides and where it is necessary to have the courage and the strength to maintain it. These men could save Europe and the world, leading the people back into the great traditional channel, toward the light of those principles that are the very basis of existence. But a great energy is necessary to conquer pessimism and skepticism which are opposed to any reestablishment on the one hand, and superficial optimism, on the other, that considers apically reached that which is a simple degree of transition. Above all, great detachment is necessary, strict intellectuality, the absolute absence of that pseudo-mysticism so much in style at the present time where spirituality and sentimentality are equivalent, where enthusiasm and faith are placed on the same level, where the darkest and murkiest impulsiveness is believed to be an expression of strength, where the external is not only excessive, but tends to destroy the internal, where agenda kills true development, where finally all that is inferior and illegitimate is affirmed with an immodesty which the world has never known before now even in the most acute periods of decadence.

But above all, great courage would be necessary in these men and a great faith to conquer so much darkness of ignorance, to break up so many false bridges, to facilitate the return to the comprehension of the truth, to give back to thought its dignity and to life, its justification. Many currently in Europe are aware of the mud the world gets mired in every day, but their conviction is half-hearted and imperfect: it is more about a pessimistic and skeptical attitude than a true and proper conviction. None of those would be able to indicate the remedy or to show the way to return to true life, which, before all else, reconfirms the values of the spirit that are divine, but do not neglect the necessities of existence, orienting them along the purely traditional axis.

Every traditional society entails the organic allocation of labor and the assignment of tasks to various categories of men adapted to their nature and their possibilities. Even currently, in the agonal state of Europe and the world, this allocation exists, but it is false, arbitrary, unnatural, temporary, not founded on traditional norms, i.e., according to a strictly and purely hierarchical order that derives from the very meaning of the term *hierarkhia* = high priest in Greek, whose sacred character should not elude anyone. Since every tradition is sacred, the allocation of labor must be imposed only from deference to the truth that is the divine order; therefore, the priests would stand at the apex of a traditional society, who are the bearers of the divine order, the divine knowledge. We could say Ascetics, but we prefer to preceding term because it better highlights the precise character of the nature and the office assigned to the bearers of supernatural truth. This caste includes those who do not participate in active life, who lack every responsibility of the profane, temporal order and are the leaders of traditional society, but in reality, through the very character of their mission, occupy a marginal place in respect to the practical act of existences, but one that is central, determinative and indicative for the maintenance and the development of traditional society. They are the poor of God, the voluntary renouncers of the world, the truth givers,

the Spirit lovers, the last because the first, whose life is devoted to the realization of the great divine norms that constitute the traditional body. No confusion is possible regarding their nature and their missions which are of a purely spiritual order, without any worldliness, extending into the pure regions of the Spirit of God who governs the world invisibly.

Process of Degeneration

This is the second installment from **Guido De Giorgio**'s chapter on the priestly caste from *La Tradizione Romana* **The Roman Tradition**. He sees the process of the degeneration of the castes as beginning, not from the revolt of the Kshatriya, but rather from the failure of the Priests to fulfill their divine mission. Nevertheless, Tradition may be forgotten, but never lost, so there are always some solitary men who continue to maintain that sacred knowledge. De Giorgio moves on to the topic of faith which, he says, is necessary because a man must believe before he knows.

Therefore, they constitute the caste of the invisible ones because their continuous, untiring, hidden action is of the sacred spiritual order and is spontaneously fulfilled through the very force of the soul, the purity of their life that must be a rite, an offering, a sacrifice. We insist particularly on the character of the priestly caste to determine the modality of the hierarchic power and the efficacy of the revelatory mission entrusted to them. They are the leaders of traditional society, but invisible leaders because the sacred knowledge of which they are the depositaries is not a purely dogmatic system nor a dead body, but a living, perennial fire that they must nourish, living continuously in communion with the spirit of God, acting so that His truth is towering at its peak, in isolation from His profound virtue, in the active and effective development that only the contemplative life allows to be realized.

They are the great hermits and they descend among men, the bearers of the graces of the truth, but, even if living in the world, they are really

on the outside and dominate while not dominating, act while not acting, illuminating with their light, they save with their presence, strengthen with their example. Their hierarchy and their organization, the traditional type to which they are tied, the value of the character of their mission are absolutely determined by their having freely and consciously chosen not a career, not a profession, not a job, but the way of God, that by leaving from God leads back to God, and of having chosen it not only for itself, but rather with the precise task of showing it to all. They sacrifice themselves and they sacrifice: it is reflected carefully in the value and in the immense importance of these two expressions when led back to the precision of their etymological meaning sacrifice=make sacred. The Priests cannot not be sacred themselves, they cannot not make sacred everything that they touch and go near because they were born for that, they were destined to that and their choice, in embracing the holy ministry, is an absolute match with the inherent possibilities of their nature.

They cannot deviate if they are truly priests, they cannot, if they deviate, not fall into the lowest abjection because they have betrayed God, they failed in their vows, and by abjuring, they contaminated themselves and men. If the value and the height of the task entrusted to the Priests is fixed and well understood, one will reach some conclusions to which the modern world, having become anti-traditional, is no longer capable of elevating itself. Let us outline one of them.

Since the Priests are the holders of sacred knowledge and constitute the insuppressible base of a truly traditional foundation, they are to secure its normality, they are to maintain the unity with their invisible spiritual hidden work and therefore are responsible for the general defection of the traditional spirit, because no one can fall if the priests themselves do not fall, no one can fail if the priests themselves do not fail, no one can be banned against the truth of God if the priests do not betray it first, no one can corrupt the world if they do not corrupt it first, abandoning their sacred mission for the concerns of the temporal order, passing from

the contemplative life for which they are destined, to the active life that is not absolutely the place of the development of their activity, with falling short of their caste, their obligations, and especially the divine principles whose radiating virtue they must keep intact. How many are capable of understanding how *the current state of abjection is due to the defection of the priestly caste who are responsible for it* because they alone, the Priests, maintaining contact with the divine not only by means of their action over men, but above all with the constant realization and efficacy of their interior asceticism? Just as God's strength is mysterious and invisible, so is the Priest's occult and hidden: contemplating they act, fulfilled in God, they work in the world, sacrificing themselves they sacrifice, praying they save, although their mission is genuine and not the unholy profanation of God's laws.

If one can with absolute certainty impute to them the state of current Europe, whatever defection of this caste, whatever decadence of humanity is not attributable to the traditional form to which they are reconnected and of which they could be the authentic representatives. Tradition is invulnerable, inviolable, unassailable, it is God's truth and is kept intact because, even if betrayed by His ministers, He always finds those who preserve its sacred character, those who, among men not belonging to the priestly caste, become its legitimate and authorized carrier. And almost always those, priests among men, carry out their mission more dangerously than if they belonged to the officially recognized caste, because they have to fight against a profane force that tends to suppress them, that of those who have betrayed the faith, repudiated tradition, abandoning the divine for the human and the sacred for the profane: those are the false priests who are no longer such, i.e., holders of sacred knowledge. Reflect on the importance of what we say, and you will be able to understand how the solitary Ascetics, those who we will be able to call "hoi exo" the outside, in all the periods of decadence of the priestly caste, have kept alive the perennial fire of tradition against the deceit, the

hatred, calumny of those who failed in their mission.

The self-establishment of ascetic groups outside the priestly caste, the presence of Masters, i.e., of solitary Ascetics, in all the period of decadence is explained precisely by the abandonment of tradition by parts of those to whom its deposit was entrusted, and the necessity—of the divine order, we insist—that others seek to keep contact between man and God, purging the sacred ways of the profane dross that the false priests amassed, i.e., the most ungodly deniers of the supernatural world. Dante *docet*... It is necessary, to avoid misunderstanding, to insist on the nature and character of this definition, of this contamination that takes place in the ambit of the priestly caste in the periods of decadence. The divine truths that constitute the sacred body of tradition has a purely metaphysical, or transcendent, character: they are superhuman, eternal, and to approach them, it is therefore absolutely necessary to pass beyond the human condition and bring oneself with the intellect into that sphere of pure actuality where the divine reality is developed beyond the domain of Forms and Rhythms in the silence of its ineffability. Faith prepares this transition from the human to the divine, in fact, it is its essential condition, that which cannot elude anyone through the elementary analogy with so many human and contingent situations. It is necessary to believe that one knows, because one knows only by knowing that one can one know before knowing, i.e., before having acquired the wisdom and having already completed the passage from the human to the divine in order to do so that only the divine is.

Faith in whom? In God, in the Master, so say all traditions that insist on this absolutely necessary condition for the effective realization of the divine. One believes in the truth before reaching it, i.e., before being there and being it, and the intensity of faith is in direct relation with the efficacy of the achievement.

Faith is therefore the rail, the bridge, the isthmus between the human and the divine, between what man is not and what he really is when

he is no longer, when he surpassed and passed over forever the human condition. But since this is the fruit of ignorance, faith is the necessary condition for the dispersal of ignorance and the reaching of wisdom.

It annuls every human limitation in man, abolishes individuality, opens all the passages of Infinite possibility, considers the chains as untied so that they are really so, it works a type of preparatory radiation of individual faculties, because one believes in things other than oneself, in the sacred text, in the hidden value of the rite, in the minister, in the master, in other words, in whatever passes beyond quotidian reality, the illusion of the world ordinarily experienced in the ambit of all sensible and rational limitations, it denies resolutely the tangible whole and affirms an invisible reality.

To have faith means to believe in what one does not yet know, one does not know, it is the most noble and desperate attempt to bring oneself face to face with the threshold of mystery and to affirm that beyond it there is an unspeakable reality, that which is revealed. Even for those who cannot pass over this threshold, it is enormously positive that they succeed in bringing themselves to the extreme limit connected to their strengths with an act of faith that leaps over error, the visible presence, the world and things, in one stroke, to genuflect in the face of the Invisible Presence, God and His Names still concealed precisely because they are absent, asserted, and believed and not known. Faith is therefore superior to any human knowledge whatsoever, to any conquering activity of the human alone, because it passes beyond it, considers it as ancillary, negligible, negotiable, even nothing in the face of the divine that it recognizes as the invisible venerable root through its invisibility, real through its apparent unreality, divine exactly because not human, not tangible, not discernible with the senses, and analyzable by reason, placed in a sphere of this the good ones, those who believe, will be able to enjoy, if it will be pleasing to God, only after the dissolution of the human compound, i.e., *post mortem*.

Faith works this miracle that those who cannot reach by an operational effort and aware of the threshold of the divine, attain it with the rapid and direct contact that can be fecund with greater results: compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far, but compared to those who do not believe, to the small men of the small world, the affirmers of the minimum in the minimum and lovers of the shadows, they are in a clearly privileged position because they are distant from just as far as the spirit surpasses the flesh and intelligence surpasses imbecility.

Conclusion

This is the third and final installment from **Guido De Giorgio's** chapter on the priestly caste from *La Tradizione Romana* **The Roman Tradition**. He continues the discussion on faith. He points out that when the priesthood deteriorates, it gives rise to priesthood of solitary Ascetics. Although they maintain traditional teachings, these solitary men do not have the authority to maintain traditional society. Furthermore, they find themselves opposed by the decadent priests. The priests who go astray need to be punished in order to prevent scandal. In the contemplative life, one's own thoughts and desires are emptied and the Invisible Presence begins to manifest in one's center in an endless number of stages. By losing his life in this way, his life becomes more real and more fulfilled.

Those who are called "geniuses" by men of today, so tied to the human to see them through the greatest irony, even the superhuman, enclosed as they are in human and terrestrial limitations, are greatly inferior to the most humble of believers because they hypertrophy a nothing, man and the world, and they make everything from this nothing, while the believers deny the nothing, man and the world, and reaffirm it only

putting it back on God, i.e., in the supreme cause. Those who do not believe see the effect separated from the cause, which is absurd, while those who believe see the effect in the cause, which is conformed to truth: those who know even abolish the effect and this is the truth. Deepening this last point, one will be able to come to understand, first of all, the triple attitude of man in the face of the truth in accordance to what is subhuman, human or superhuman, and consequently the way in which the principle of causality must be considered in the transition from the profane to the sacred, from the human to the divine, according to what the schema of death, life, and liberation makes of it. This triple schema can be more crudely formulated in connection to these possibilities: *without God, with God, God*.

Faith is therefore the traditional base for excellence since it is the necessary anticipation of the means through which the path begins from the human to the divine and it resolutely builds a bridge that is fixed on the other shore without seeing it but only knowing it as revealed: tradition works this fixation in the divine that constitutes for the believers the invisible *ubi consistam* place to stand, the fulcrum of its elevation to the threshold of mystery.

We note that God, precisely because He is believed but not known, is affirmed in His deepest reality, that of the Unmanifested Principle, and that simple faith pronounces itself more positively than what would appear to a superficial examination, since by affirming the unknowability of the destination, it admits implicitly that only a realizing knowledge can attain it with an effective becoming. This knowledge follows faith, it passes over the threshold of the divine to carry oneself into the same mystery.

It is the most interior part of the Temple where the sacrifice is performed, that altar where the Priest resides.

So if the whole temple constitutes the domain of the sacred and we have the profane only outside of it, in the temple itself among the altar

and the rest, there is a clean separation, and while the altar constitutes the active realization of the divine and therefore it is the true domain of the sacred, the rest of the church is reserved to those who are present at the sacrifice, they participate in it, *but do not perform it themselves*, therefore they are always only the profane because there is a barrier between them and the divine truth. This is the relationship between faith and knowledge, between the faithful and the Priests, between those who only believe and those who know and should know, between the throng of the *called* and the rank of the *elect*, between passive love that genuflects and pulls back outside of the sacred threshold and the active love that performs the sacrifice directly with a gesture that is a benediction, a voice that is of God, an altar that is the very throne of the Eternal.

From all that it is easy to reach this conclusion that the Priests, as the bearers of sacred knowledge, must really possess it by means of a realizing knowledge in order to be able to perform on the altar the highest of the sacrifices, the divine sacrifice, through which they strengthen the faith, reconfirm it in its strength, and reach the hope that it can, by crossing the threshold, reach the sphere of *charitas*, of divine love.

If the Priests do not attain this realizing knowledge, they are not such, they cannot be the sustainers of Tradition, the princes of a traditional society, those who maintain the contact between the human and the divine in a permanent current, who secure life and the justification of life itself, placing it back in God. This is the true sin which a Priest can incur, of not having attained the realizing knowledge, of performing a rite with knowing its value, efficacy, and meaning, of not knowing, in other words, the sacred knowledge and of reducing it to a simple babbling of the lips or to an idle formulation that, in the scope of realizing knowledge which should be that of the Priest, is an absurdity because the one falling short puts himself beneath the believers, the profane among the profane and the profaner among the profaners.

Tradition remains untouched however, even in such a case, the in-

tangible rite does not diminish the efficacy that it had on believers, on the faithful, some of whom can even substitute, if not in fact, in a reality that even leaps over the fact, the Priest, performing for them the rite and becoming for them the transient or permanent deposits of God's truth. If this defection does not harm Tradition in itself, it harms enormously the basis of a traditional society, it invalidates the principle of authority that is absolutely necessary to the maintenance of the two orders, the human and the divine, the profane and the sacred, that of faith and of knowledge, of those who believe and those who know, but what is more serious, it gives rise to the *priesthood of solitary Ascetics* who, by God's will, maintain the traditional secret with their work reserved to a minority, they safeguard it, they protect it against profanations, and they end up being opposed by the priestly class that fears in then its same knowledge, that which they themselves abandoned and betrayed. These deplorable clashes always occurred at the expense of sacred knowledge, giving rise to upheavals and conflicts of every type contrary to the maintenance of traditional order.

In making the Priests the depositaries of sacred science in in considering so these various questions, we thinking of a traditional form that more is adapted to nature and the spirit of the West where the sole ascetics should be the Priests, where they along should truly safeguard the traditional body realizing effectively in itself the doctrine with the deep knowledge of everything that constitutes the divine truth.

The Priests besides being deprived of real knowledge of sacred things can also come up short of the decorum that is imposed on their caste. The accusation of immorality is too noted and too usual because one has to insist there, instead of this were derived incomprehensible devaluations of tradition itself, which is truly absurd, giving rise to the sect, schism, heterodoxy. We will immediately and clearly say that the morality is for knowledge and not the inverse and the purely moral side of a question of any fact is the least act for make it comprehend and valued its meaning.

The first and only sin is ignorance and one is responsible more for not knowing or poorly knowing than to act evil. As to judge conscience, we do not believe that his is not only a very arduous and insolvable task, but directly a sacrilege, because from God alone and in the name of God consciences are judged and where it never than the so called more judgments are given in God and in the name of God? One reflects attentively that and one will see that only the facts can be judged in the customary place as the condition capable of determining others and therefore, if harmful, condemnable.

Therefore what must be judged, condemned, and punished is the deed when it is visible, it is “active”, it leads to imitation, it is the example, the seed of other deeds, it corrupts: what must be condemned is scandal in all forms, in all classes, and this is the healthy principle of a truly traditional ethic that maintains the privilege of the conscience in action as God’s privilege, and represses the infraction not because the motives are condemned, but to prevent the repetition, the example.

And since there is a vast range in the intensity of the propagation of an offense, i.e., in the immortality of a deed, a truly civil society should adopt all those natural, external, brutal, repressive measures that punish, from the death penalty up to the torture and flogging, but *they do not judge*, in beating the man, what he has that is the most external, i.e., the flesh.

A truly civil society, readopting all the old measures of physical, outward coercion, returns to the truth of the traditional river-bed, obeys scrupulously God’s truth, and at the same time enriches the number of true, real reasons for action, creating a game, an alternation, a reciprocity between the crime and the punishment, fruitful in sensations beneficial to life, fertile in expansions and the surpassing of the brutal fact. Capital punishment, the various types of torture publicly inflicted with their tragedy, are always considerably effective and instructive and they can even determine true sources of purification, positive complexes, whose

importance does not elude those who are equipped with sense and truly constructive imagination and not esthetically and softly deviators. But there is another consideration of a deeper order: the crime has degrees integrally subordinated to human passionate nature, i.e. to the darkest complex that dominates ordinary men undisputedly: it is therefore necessary that hierarchically or analogously proportionate penalties correspond to these levels, penalties determinate by an impersonal justice that strikes in the flesh, abstracting from any experimental character: thus only a reward and a rectification reaching a balance is established; this is the indicator of a true and proper traditional society.

The Priests can and must be blamed only if they fail at their task through total or partial incomprehension of traditional truths: their existence, on the purely exterior side, i.e., from the moral point of view, is reprehensible when it offers matter for scandal and then only if they submit to a tribunal that can be constituted only by men belonging to their caste. In fact from what has been said thus far, it results that real knowledge, i.e., integrative and realizing, belongs to the contemplative, and not the active life. The relationship between contemplation and action is of the greatest importance for the maintenance of the traditional idea because their imbalance constitutes a rupture, a hierarchical inversion, a veritable deviation that, prolonged for centuries, was the origin of the current abjection of the West. Contemplation stands to action in the same relationship as the divine to the human, the sacred to the profane, the eternal to the ephemeral, since their range is distinct and cleanly circumscribed by the two different types of activity. In contemplation there is an activity of a special order that is accomplished in the eternal place, beyond time and space in the sphere of transcendent truths, in an apparent retreat and in an interiorization that in reality are a veritable translation from the human to the divine and a cancellation of the human so that only the divine remains in its absolute autonomy.

In this sense, contemplation and revelation are synonyms because

the divine truth can be revealed only in man becoming a temple, i.e., the refuge itself of the truth, the empty temple of humanity founded on earth and elevated to heaven in a verticality symbolically reflecting the lifting up of all being to the totalization of the higher states for their inclusive and intensive integration.

If in the Primordial Tradition the world itself was the temple, with the successive degeneration of humanity, the sacred enclosure was established to separate the sacred from the profane and maintain the distinction between the two orders in the way that the higher directs and guides the lower. The temple is the symbol and more than a symbol, it is the place of peace, of absolute interiority where, every individuality is denied, annulled, or distanced from every human dross, the realization of the divine is accomplished, the theophanic cycle of all its effective fullness.

Whoever contemplates—and contemplation is only of the divine order, therefore it must be judged absolutely inappropriate to any order, especially to the esthetic order which is visibly inferior—not only separates himself from others, but from himself, that which is the essential, and it empties his heart making it the center of his being where the Invisible Presence is manifested in a progressive irradiation whose levels are without end and constitute the hierarchy of divine stages. This term therefore cannot be, nor must be, applied to another that is not the real, effective achievement of higher states not passively glimpsed as though from the outside, but actively realized in one's interiority of the great temple which is the purified heart, cleansed, made a receptacle of light, the holy chalice where the divine mystery is completed. Everything that is purely and clearly human—like art in the profane sense and philosophy especially in the modern meaning—is excluded from the contemplative field that is the divine and not human life, reality and not illusion, truth and not ignorance. Philosophy that is an impaired wisdom and art that is a purely exterior infatuation for their very degeneration, are excluded from contemplative life and represent an artificial interstructure that the

current abjection established between contemplation and action, small spurious world where weakness and imbecility produced by the ignorance of external things is depleted.

If contemplation is therefore reserved to the Priests who are the bearers of divine wisdom, what will be the relationship between the contemplative and active life? It is identical to that which rules the divine order and the human order: the active life must be oriented in accordance with a vision that can be determined only by those who live contemplatively. In fact, if man and the world in themselves are nothing when separated from their cause and not put back in it, i.e., in God, they acquire instead quite another meaning when they are integrated in the real order because they represent the same place where one of the divine possibilities is fulfilled. Reflect attentively on this: the contemplative life is a larger circle that includes in it a smaller one, the active life, the integration of these two modes constitute the traditional unity. Affirming the superiority of the contemplative life, we postulate the necessity of the active life provided that the latter is included in it, i.e., it remains hierarchically subordinated in order to shape it and procure for it all its operative efficacy. One, contemplation, works in the eternal, the other, action, works in the ephemeral, which is the symbol of the eternal: one, contemplation, is the domain of the sacred, the other, action, is the domain of the profane that becomes sacred only if it receives light from the former. To be more explicit: the contemplative returning to life properly called, i.e., to external existence, sees it under another aspect, different from that of the common man, therefore it is logical and natural that he seeks to consider it not as separate from the divine truth, but as effective preparation for that, the vestibule, the pre-position that rules and determines a final development realized only in the place of pure contemplation.

The harmony between contemplation and action is necessary for the complete integration of human possibilities so that man could be truly such, rich in every development, judge of his own destiny, capable of

elevating himself from earth to heaven in a progressive expansion of all his faculties. But that is possible only if contemplation dominates action: in the reverse case we have the hierarchical revolution, the annulment of the traditional axis, the impoverishment of man demasculinized, made ugly, victim of all those inferior forces on which he can have the upper hand only if he is guided by the spirit of God.

It is up to the Priests, besides, to act so that the spirit of God reigns in the world and sustains the forces of man and truly dignifies him because man is everything with God, nothing without God, and his action deprived of any traditional content is a groping in the lower darkness, a wicked shadow among wicked shadows, sterile bedroom activities *fornicatoria* that impels him from illusion to illusion, from error to error in the great detrital riverbed, the hellish, subhuman, ghostly, and lemuric world.

But if instead the active life is regulated along the traditional axis, as a rite, then all the apparent imbalances are annulled while counterbalancing each other, all the varieties of human expression and deviations are arranged and are resolved in an integrative homogeneity. It is necessary to insist on what men have completely forgotten in the collapse of all traditional values: the active life is so much richer the more it is subordinated to the contemplative life, because in a truly traditional society there is an amplification of human possibilities, an infinitely more fertile development of their most various activities, in the modern world, they are completely wasted. For a law of analogy that regulates the parallelism of the two orders, we will say that the more intense the contemplative life is, the richer is the active life, as much as God is exalted, so much more is man valued, and that in a truly traditional society, everything profane is something sacred *in fieri* pending and all aberrations are recomposed in the equilibrium between the divine and the human, love and hate, wisdom and ignorance, war and peace, virtue and vice, good and evil, in a full, integral, oceanic confluence, are harmonized, surpassed, and twinned, in

the great traditional river-bed.

But because this takes place, it is necessary for the Priests to truly be the supreme club-bearers and that their life be purely contemplative, as the bearers of divine truths, the great fee men of the eternity that they keep watch on the bastions of time, intermediaries between the higher and lower waters, between the divine and the human, between the cosmic and the hyperuranium where the Platonic ideas reside, knowers of the light that is the only light emanating from God.

* * *

Janus on 2013-02-10 at 21:53 said:

This is essential, and something many “political” traditionalists should read. There is an unfortunate trend toward restoring the forms of Tradition before its essence. Seeking out a spiritual or religious discipline would probably be the most important thing for those of a contemplative (brahminic) nature to do at the current time. Providence may yet provide teachers in surprising places.

That said, the essence is gaining more ground in surprising places. While being aware of the somewhat ambivalent attitude of many on this board to Dugin, it would be worthwhile to look at the Against the Postmodern World conference held in Moscow some time ago. No national bolshevik rally this; Shaykh ‘Abd al Wāhid Pallavicini was among those who saw fit to attend. Behind the petty racialists, neopagans without understanding, new right and national revolutionaries seems to be a stirring of some who are ready to look beyond the political form and see the inner life it is meant to reflect, be they of a contemplative or active nature. I’m especially interested in seeing what follows here. For those interested, here is an article from Dugin’s conference: it is by Claudio Mutti and entitled “The Doctrine of Divine Unity in the Hellenic Tradition”. Cologero, I’d love to hear your thoughts on it. <http://against-postmodern.org/node/127>

Logres on 2013-02-11 at 11:40 said:

Iamblichus would say that “courage” or “daring” is the Dyad – the warrior – the feminine principle: hence, the purely “political” is the Dyad without the Monad, doomed to futility. Very lucid article!

David on 2013-02-11 at 22:44 said:

«A Christianity that is largely without doctrine and sacrament is a Christianity of slogan and extravaganza. A “Churchless” Christianity is simply, a heresy. It is a strange reading of the

New Testament with conclusions as novel as they are effective. It is also destructive of the long term health of the Christian faith. Many who grow tired of its slogans and extravaganzas do not turn elsewhere – they turn nowhere. The fastest growing religious group in America is the unchurched.

The truth and richness of the Christian faith is only found in the deep-woven fibers of the historic Church. The life of sacrament, rooted in a thoroughly Christianized network of families, parishes and monasteries, is the normative existence of the Christian faith. This is the faith that converted the Roman Empire and the barbarian ancestors of people like myself. From it grew a great civilization, one that has been challenged and dismantled at many points, but which has yet to disappear.»

– Ft Stephen. <http://glory2godforallthings.com/>

I.e., the Church is Tradition. Priests are part of a tradition and we need it back.

This author is very interesting for those who are Christians.

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-12 at 14:46 said:

Guido de Giorgio's book is amazing and I wish a full translation of it existed. Cologero, do you know of a link to the full text in Italian online ?

As for Dugin, I know the man personally and can say that he does not act like an aristocrat – meaning that he does not discuss and debate logically and cordially, the way that Cologero, Avery, Logres and all the folks at Gornahoor do, instead he expects one to accept his words without question and obey them, if one raises an objection or merely asks for further clarification of what he means, he gets angry and then starts calling names like “reactionary” “CIA agent” and down the line..... I ultimately broke with the Dugin camp after I realised that, at least in the west, he is totally uninterested at all in monarchy, Catholicism, anything from the west's past, he only wants to talk to communists, neo-nazis and those ilk.....

Senkosmos on 2013-02-12 at 21:00 said:

I need to agree with all of you: Cologero, David, Logres and Janus. Priests are the backbone (so to speak) for the preserving of tradition, and an instrumental tool to the intellectual elite (if they are not the elite themselves) to put the West back in the right track. Today, most agents of tradition are more concerned with political action than individual/local action, and more important, contemplation, spiritual non-acting action. All attempts to a “back to roots” without a “back to the Absolute source” is futile and ridiculous. Great post!

caseydeann on 2013-02-12 at 23:13 said:

Great comment, David. Thank you.

Logres on 2013-02-18 at 11:07 said:

This is an immensely penetrating article – I can see why Guenon regarded him as a peer. It's interesting that, like Kukai (the Japanese master), he places those of "faith" far above the secularists and agnostics, as pilgrims on the ladder up to heaven who have begun the ascent, which will bear fruit in time, or out of it. Did Giorgio consider himself part of the priest caste?

Cologero on 2013-02-18 at 12:26 said:

I suspect he sees himself this way, as he described:

Reflect on the importance of what we say, and you will be able to understand how the **solitary Ascetics**, those who we will be able to call "hoi exo" the *outside*, in all the periods of decadence of the priestly caste, have kept alive the perennial fire of tradition against the deceit, the hatred, calumny of those who failed in their mission.

Certainly, he understands the nature of the priestly caste. When we get to the warrior caste, we will see that he describes them in terms very much like Evola. However, Evola was tone deaf to the contemplative caste and never understood it or its true role. That is why he saw the Ascetic and the Warrior on the same level. De Giorgio, on the other hand, will make their real relationship very clear.

Tosti on 2013-02-18 at 14:59 said:

As was intimated in your earlier posting passion is clearly evident. Can this passional orientation lead one astray? You are privy to the full work, as yet unrepresented so we will have to wait and see but a question arises in dealing with a pure faith as mentioned with regard to the solitary ascetics: are we to assume that Evola's concept of Initiation is superior to Guenon's? Will we assume that a solitary ascetic(whose practice may reflect either the exterior or the interior-without the discernment of a traditional caste we can never know) can preserve Tradition without any other reference? How are we to make a determination. And is it possible that there has been a continuity so subtle that those of the second function will have difficulty determining its existence in an extant structure without the help of the first function(who may be already embedded within such an expression)?

Cologero on 2013-02-18 at 15:58 said:

I don't see where he is saying anything of a sentimental nature or advocating the "passions" as somehow superior to intellectuality. On the contrary he writes:

Above all, great detachment is necessary, strict intellectuality, the absolute absence of that pseudo-mysticism so much in style at the present time where spirituality and sentimentality are equivalent, where enthusiasm and faith are

placed on the same level, where the darkest and murkiest impulsiveness is believed to be an expression of strength, where the external is not only excessive, but tends to destroy the internal, where agenda kills true development, where finally all that is inferior and illegitimate is affirmed with an immodesty which the world has never known before now, even in the most acute periods of decadence.

The unassailable “reference point” would be the “truths of God” or Traditional teachings; that is the standard to judge by.

Tosti on 2013-02-18 at 16:11 said:

Perhaps it was just the general tone. That may be subjective on my part..my Anglo-saxon temperament.

Janus on 2013-02-18 at 22:44 said:

I can see what de Giorgio is saying when he speaks about the central importance of faith. However, I don't understand how he can say that faith is superior to knowledge. He begins by saying (as I understand it) that faith is good because it allows the one without knowledge as yet to move forward in the path, giving him strength and courage. But surely that means that, when knowledge is attained, then faith has fulfilled its purpose? And this seems to imply that knowledge of that which faith led us to pursue is superior, though no less essential, than faith itself.

It also makes me wonder how many priests or ascetics need to arise before a turning of orders can begin. Surely there are some left in Europe, in the old monasteries or as hermits who fulfill this role. But apparently, these few have not prevented the decline, any more than did the Russian hermits in the early 20th century before Bolshevism. Does that mean there was a decline or betrayal among these priests? Who knows... but apparently this function must be fulfilled in a specific function or grow to a certain size before its affects are more generally recognizable. Perhaps this is the distinction between Ascetic and Priests proper? “Lord, if there is but one righteous man in the city...?”

David on 2013-02-18 at 22:57 said:

@Janus : I cannot answer for De Giorgio, but I don't think we can ever attain perfect knowledge of Reality without being in perfect union with Reality, i.e. God. That is, faith will always be there, because there will always be knowledge. Someone can correct me if I'm wrong.

Cologero on 2013-02-19 at 00:13 said:

Janus, please show me where you think De Giorgio says that faith is superior to knowledge... it means I need to make the translation clearer. Here is a quote I have in mind, which says the opposite of the impression you have:

Faith works this miracle that those who cannot reach by an operational effort and aware of the threshold of the divine, attain it with the rapid and direct contact that can be fecund with greater results: compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far, but compared to those who do not believe, to the small men of the small world, the affirmers of the minimum in the minimum and lovers of the shadows, they are in a clearly privileged position because they are distant from just as far as the spirit surpasses the flesh and intelligence surpasses imbecility.

Specifically, *compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far* means those who believe are far from those who know, but those who believe are superior to those who neither know nor believe.

As for your other question, let's wait until I get the final part up which addresses some of those issues.

David, perfect knowledge is perfect union as you point out. But I don't understand the other point: where there is knowledge, there is no need for faith.

Janus on 2013-02-19 at 03:25 said:

This is the passage:

"Faith is therefore superior to any human knowledge whatsoever, to any conquering activity of the human alone, because it passes beyond it, considers it as ancillary, negligible, negotiable, even nothing in the face of the divine that it recognizes as the invisible venerable root through its invisibility, real through its apparent unreality, divine exactly because not human, not tangible, not discernible with the senses, and analyzable by reason, placed in a sphere of this the good ones, those who believe, will be able to enjoy, if it will be pleasing to God, only after the dissolution of the human compound, i.e., post mortem."

Perhaps I'm not understanding it correctly. Is he saying here that faith is superior to human knowledge in terms of "merely human" ideas about the Divine (it might be useful here to think of the Orthodox doctrine that all human attempts to describe God, while they may be good enough for Man, are ultimately lacking)? I doubt he means the higher Knowledge of gnosis, as that contradicts the passage you mentioned and your point about union and perfect knowledge.

The passage you mentioned says what I would have expected, that gnosis is greater than faith, which itself is greater than ignorance.

Cologero on 2013-02-19 at 08:20 said:

Not specifically human knowledge about the divine (if there can even be such a thing), but in general. Human knowledge is never more than opinion or a likely story. It does not survive death, as De Giorgio points out, whereas faith certainly does.

David on 2013-02-19 at 18:47 said:

My question can be rephrased : how can we attain perfect knowledge if not for perfect being, that is, God, while still here, in the temporal and therefore imperfect realm (on a dualistic gnostic view, or a monistic one) ? I'm just trying to understand, thank you. To me, union with God can be but partial. Or maybe I'm mistaken ?

Janus on 2013-02-19 at 19:49 said:

Well, it might help to remember that this unity is in many ways a process of realization of a reality which already is. "Thou art That"... the singularity of Atman and Brahman. The true Self is the Atman realizing its manifestation and source of being. Thus, a complete awakening, difficult as this might be, should constitute a unity that is total and conscious, and that seems to be whole instead of partial.

Cologero on 2013-02-20 at 08:11 said:

David, the rephrasing of the question is better since a response can be split. First of all, there is the question of the possibility of "perfect knowledge" or union with God. To that the answer is "yes", since what the Intellect knows is ideas or possibilities. That possibility has been described over and over, as there is no shortage of literature. Here on Gornahoor, we try to summarize that literature and re-express it contemporary terms.

Nevertheless, that does not conclude the story, since what you are interested in is the "actuality" of the union (theosis), i.e., its realization, not merely its possibility. But that is a question for the Will, not solely the Intellect. Apart from the various claims, there is no scientific way to determine someone's "state of realization". We have the testimony of St John Climacos who says in his Ladder of Divine Ascent that theosis is not complete in this life. So perhaps your opinion is aligned with his. Even De Giorgio admits that the steps on the ladder are infinite, so a finite life cannot achieve it.

However, if you are called on that path, that is no excuse to not begin. St Mark the Ascetic in the Philokalia mentions three great enemies:

1. Ignorance

2. Forgetfulness

3. Sloth

Ignorance is the first thing to overcome, and obviously Gornahoor readers probably have subdued, or are subduing, that enemy, if they refer to the text we write about. We have addressed the topic of forgetfulness over and over. Never forget who you are, why you were born, what you need to accomplish, what your real life is. For the several hundred daily readers here, we hope, if nothing else, to be their reminders to stay on track, although there are many other resources. Of course, most humans prefer to drink from Lethe, the river in Hell that causes them to forget.

The third enemy is sloth, and in that regard everyone is on his own. No matter how much you know, you cannot expect George⁸ to do it for you. So you will never really know what is possible unless and until the right efforts are made.

David on 2013-02-20 at 16:58 said:

That answers it. I will look into St John Climacos to see if I can clarify my mind on the matter. Thank you.

Saladin on 2013-02-20 at 20:18 said:

Excellent piece! Loved it! Thanks Cologero! I think De Giorgio is very clear so I don't know why some people are confused. He never says that "Passions are superior to intellectuality" (Per Tosti) and neither does he declare the superiority of Faith over TRUE Knowledge (as claimed by Janus). He says Faith is infinitely (Guenon would object to my choice of word here) superior than any worldly (read Philosophical and Scientific) knowledge but at the same time miles away from True Knowledge (i.e. Gnosis). That's what he says, and it's all clear.

I really loved the passage where he lays the blame for degeneration on the Priestly caste. That's a simple fact and needs to be acknowledged. Just as blaming women for Feminism is completely inaccurate: For it is the duty of the Best to insure everything is according to Order (and where the teaching is different, there the Best is lacking!

Olavsson on 2016-04-05 at 11:24 said:

Yes, the degeneration of the First Caste of contemplatives is at the origin of the regression of the castes. So if one's true nature, function, purpose and providential destiny (completely without regard for a relative and conditioned, illusory self-will based on forgetfulness) can only be perfectly realized by giving oneself heart and soul, with all one's might, to this path, and even still one chooses to ignore the call in order to invest one's energies in false interests and desires, one is failing in one's true task and responsibility and consequently a serious part of

⁸[http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Let_George_Do_It_\(radio\)](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Let_George_Do_It_(radio))

the problem. Too many who potentially (hence not actually) belong to the spiritual caste waste away their lives within profane domains at best producing bourgeois triviality, or at the very worst leading to catastrophic and demonic scientific “advances.” My advice can only be: Leave that to the fallen ones—they are many and have no need for you. IF you do in truth have the nature of a contemplative, your true path should already be mapped out clearly: The example to follow is the sages of old, not the profane functions honoured, respected and admired most highly by the modern system. How many more of us can we afford losing to such games falling short of the unworldly super-caste’s true principles and agenda? The spiritual conquerors of the contemplative life who uphold the bridge between time and Eternity are fewer with each passing year, whereas the profane classes from high to low have a never-ending supply of new recruits ready to feed the monstrous machine of modernity in whatever way. So it should be obvious enough which task is the most important one for our kind, not only in view of our own spiritual destiny, but in view of the needs of humanity as well.

Indeed, dear De Giorgio is utterly correct regarding Faith. Even a quintessential jnanin-ascetic like Buddha Shakyamuni, founder of a tradition which is as known for its emphasis on Gnosis as any other, many times stressed the great importance of faith, and the superiority of the man possessing unswerving faith as compared to the one who doesn’t. Likewise, he listed DOUBT among the most serious obstacles to progress on the Path. In our absurdly degenerate postmodern world, doubt is not seldom glorified almost as if it were a sign of intelligence. But if one lacks the ability to have complete, unfailing and permanent faith as strong as diamond in the truths that are derived from the very Divine Wisdom of the sagely masters, prophets, and avatars, we will never have sufficient determination to go all the way and attain direct and illuminating Knowledge. As far as orthodox essential principles are concerned, starting with sacred metaphysics, there should be no room for doubt if we are serious about our sacred endeavour—such doubt is nothing but a profane weakness hindering absolute resolve on the upward path, and you hardly need complete illumination in order to attain absolute certainty as to the impossibility of every modernist, profane and materialist worldview, upon which the profanely skeptical scientist unbelief-ideology is based, when recognizing its fundamentally flawed principal assumptions. Doubt must be conquered and destroyed long before we can attain complete integral Knowledge. Without perfect faith, we cannot even begin the journey. And without perfect faith in God, in the Supreme, there is only unreality, not even a distant reflection of light.

reader on 2013-02-20 at 13:09 said:

“Those who are called “geniuses” by men of today so tied to the human to see them through the greatest irony, also the superhuman...”

“also the superhuman” = “as the superhuman”?

Cologero on 2013-02-20 at 13:26 said:

I opted for “even the superhuman”... the phrasing is a little awkward. If anyone else wants to give it a shot:

Coloro che sono chiamati “geni” dagli uomini attuali così legati all’umano da scorgervi per suprema ironia, anche il superumano, chiusi come sono nell’ambito umano e terrestre, si trovano di gran lunga inferiori al più umile dei credenti perché essi ipertrofizzano un nulla, l’uomo e il mondo...

18.6 The Constitution of a Traditional Society: Warriors

The Role of the Warrior Caste

This is part I on the role of the Warrior caste in a Traditional Society. Here Guido De Giorgio describes the role of the warrior caste and its relationship to the priestly caste. He then relates that to the Great War and the Lesser War.

In the active life, they are the bearers of power and therefore constitute the second caste of traditional society whose duty is the maintenance of activity guided by virtue. We say power only in the arena of the active life because in the contemplative life, true power is manifested in its highest reality, from the invisible to the visible, from the divine to the human, and thus represents the supreme authority that belongs to the priestly caste. Power in the active life is realized by giving a sacred character to every manifestation; hierarchically organized, the Warriors sacrifice themselves in order to remove the purely contingent aspect from human activity and to make it a kind of need that is accepted by consciously sacrificing themselves for the fulfillment of divine reality. They are the hosts of the earth and choose the most difficult path in it, keeping the sanctity of the intent unbroken in the pang of the most intense activity by virtue of a continual ascesis that is a purification and a preparation for glory. Since the Warriors reach glory that makes them the victors of the time

in perpetuity that is immortalized for ages and their name is preserved as the constant example of sacrifice. They choose to be victims to affirm the victory of man over death even where death reigns: voluntary and active victims, arbiters of their destiny, aware of the transience of the flesh and the perpetuity of their example. As everything pivots on the contemplative life for the Priests, so for the Warriors everything is based on the active life because they constitute its summit and its law. In fact, the active cycle reflects the contemplative, and as the death of the human is the prelude necessary to the fruition of higher states, so the Warrior lives in order to die in the awareness that everything is vanity except victory over death, which is also the seal of glory.

They obey a purely interior discipline that purifies the passions, exalts them, and directs them toward a single end, the affirmation of power in the intensive deployment of a force that acts materially, but has its origin in the world of Rhythms. As the spiritual and the noetic dominate in the Priests, in the Warriors the psychic dominates, the hidden network of Rhythms that heighten human possibilities creating the heroic turmoil which, like a flame, nurtures the great warrior virtues.

No one, more than the Warrior, is averse to Silence, to the world of the Spirit, because he voluntarily chose the active life in its most violent form to set his strength against it, to defeat it with his own violence, exalting his hidden energies and carrying the Rhythms to such a high tonality that it encroaches on the Forms and bends them integrally, surpassing them. We observe that this overflowing of strength cannot be absolutely effective without a true and proper ascesis, a self-denial in every moment for self-assertion only in victories, unless this assertion has the aspect of rhetorical jubilation, but rather it is like the blossoming of now equalized warrior virtues, recognized in the flower of all the activity precisely because surpassed and triumphant. While all other men compromise, they are the intransigents, those who make the obstacle the prize of their strength, for which the cement is the sanctification of man: they know

that only death can placate them, so in confronting it, they escape it, and in escaping it, they confront it because it comes only when the peak of power is reached in the peak of abandonment.

In this sense, peace is their war and war is their peace. They are appointed by the Priests who sanction them the sacred character of their activity with the rite, which is uniquely directed to self-sacrifice as an offering of all of the active life on the threshold of contemplation, a sacrificial purge of the existence that is continued even after death, and even after death. While the contemplative death that is faced by the Priests can neither be seen nor understood by the masses of men who, as we said, believe but do not know, they do get a glimpse of, but do not understand, the degrees of integrative knowledge, while the death faced by the Warriors is visible to all; it reflects, in an active place, the former and is carried out, analogically like the former, with a sacrifice whose value for men is as much higher as it is more apparent. But while this sacrifice is fixed plastically for the masses that relive it in its most conspicuous phases, its secret rhythm and intimate character elude them. In the Warrior the active life asserts itself by exalting itself and in the fierce heroic heat, it denies itself: in fact, the force that animates the Warrior is love in its most destructive capacity and devotion in its most constructive form: love and devotion constitute the warrior cycle which is that of triumphant virility. While knowledge dominates for the Priests, for the Warriors, love dominates, because all their strength is a type of offering in a continuous dissatisfaction that is satisfied only with death. While they cannot know the divine world, they love it and tend to it, climbing over human limitations with a constant overcoming of Rhythms over Form, of the psychic over the organic that it sustains, it increases a hundredfold the resistance to the obstacle and the force that surpass it, establishing a formidable aura of secret flashes that the ancients symbolized with the real, but invisible, divine assistance of the heroes.

The Forms, in heroic action, undergo a greater or lesser inflection in

accordance with the intensity of the Rhythms that make them jump, by encroaching on them, replacing them, fringing them, so to say, with an imprecision that makes them more indefinable, while the Warrior himself is dragged, aware only of the sanctify of his sacrifice, in an always more overwhelming turmoil that is crowned, while filling up with death. But we can say here that love defeats death as glory defeats time, not in the absolute sense that is realized only through the knowledge and in the knowledge which dissolves every duality in the integral fulfillment of the divine.

It is necessary now to speak of the great and the small war to make precise the two fields of active contemplation and heroic activity.

The Great War is the development of the being in the surpassing of human conditions that are first confronted and then surpassed, destroyed, transformed, and resolved only in the divine sphere: the enemy to defeat is the man who must be struck centrally in himself: the field of action is his own heart that must be emptied of every dross: victory is that of truth over ignorance, of divine reality over cosmic and human illusion that is dispersed with the realizing knowledge just as the fog breaks up in the sun without residue, and that which disappears had never existed in reality. Victory in the Great War is Divine Solitude, the decisive summit of every ascesis where nothing remains except pure aseity and what in Him is absolute ineffability. The starting point of the Great War is the non-duality of the human and the divine: the destination is divine unity: but since what vanishes is not a reality but only ignorance, once this is dispersed, only what always was remains, that cannot be said of the transient, but only and uniquely of the eternal.

Now this victory, which is the only real and definitive victory of Life over death, which, for simplification, we say call the resolute peak, while in the reality of its development it is manifested as a difficult complexity of states, it requires such a concentrated force, a task so resolute of the whole being who must be transfigured in a succession of progressive re-

alizations, from being able to be produced only in externally favorable conditions, not that these are the necessary principle, but practically they become so. Hence, the isolation of the Temple for the priest, of the remote place for the ascetic, the hermitage and finally an ensemble of conditions that favor and facilitate this which is the highest and the holiest of all rites, the most heroic of all actions, and the most perfect of all tasks, the killing of man in the Law of God, the real abandonment of Rhythms and Forms dissolving in the allness of Silence. Now evidently whatever type of action is contrary to a similar achievement, and every rhythm must be recomposed, every whirlwind assuaged for the achievement of the Great Peace that is the true Victory of the Great War. The enemies to defeat in fact are so numerous, so terrifying, the dangers to avoid, the states to revive so repetitive and successive, that only the integral cessation of every activity can make victory possible. It is about surpassing the human and the cosmic in all their forms and in all their rhythms, to remake the creative process in the reverse path, to lead to where God formed man with His breath, to be able to initiate the paradisiacal cycle. This is the model barely noticed for the Great War that constitutes the traditional secret, the sacred deposit held in trust by those who know, i.e., the Priests.

One can understand from that how much this caste surpasses all the others and is not, almost the truth, a caste, but a true and proper super-caste, because of its absolute preeminence. Thus its supreme authority, its consecrating, legitimating power, the dependence of the three castes on it, the justification of their existence, because nothing that is accomplished by men has value in reality if it is not sealed by the divine spirit.

Now the Warriors themselves are consecrated by the Priests, nor can they not be, without ceasing to belong to their caste since the war that they fight must represent a reduced version of the Great War in order to be legitimate, it must lose, i.e., the external character and conquer a deep meaning that justifies its attainment. The Warriors therefore submit themselves to an inner discipline, to a true and proper ascesis that

will consist in their depassionalization so that by killing, they know how to kill themselves, by defeating, to defeat one themselves self, by considering the enemies as victims, in the sacred sense, and not as flesh from the slaughterhouse, by respecting them as themselves, by passing over the carnage with the love that redeems, over the contaminations with the purity that justifies, over death, and over atrocity of death with the consciousness that nothing can die because nothing can be born, only the eternal existing in its inaccessible reality.

The Devotion of a Warrior

It seems to me that **Guido De Giorgio** and **Julius Evola** agree on the role of the Warrior caste, with some fundamental disagreements. The first obviously is that Evola fails to understand the relationship of the warrior caste to the priestly class. The second is more difficult to express. Evola is “cold”, i.e., for him, the warrior is cold and detached. We could say that for De Giorgio, the warrior is hot: he loves, he is devoted, he is faithful. For Evola, the warrior fights as it is in his nature. For De Giorgio, too, it is in his nature, but he fights for his family, his land, his Temple, his lord. We can note here how the notion of bhakti yoga has been sentimentalized and the understanding of devotion trivialized. There is something else, more subtle, to consider, but since it is not part of De Giorgio’s purpose, I’ll save it for another time.

The Small War acquires a deep ascetic significance and imposes on the caste, only to which it is reserved, not slight surpassings that have, as we said, love and devotion for its foundation. The Warrior is guided by his love for the Divine Principle that is close to him, almost accessible and even distinct, in which he centers himself when the heroic peak happens and the confluence of Rhythms generates the supreme passion, that of dedication to God of the carnage: then a super-action of the normal human faculties operates, that adapt, raising himself in the highest

development of the consuming fire and the Warrior becomes the great sacrificer, the *victimarius*⁹,

and the baptism of blood is a catharsis that renews him, freeing him with his violence from human brutality, redeeming him as in a purifying basin Ex 30:18 that cleanses horror with piety at every death. Piety in fact pushes him to sacrifice of himself and of the enemies in each one of which he catches sight of his own effigy; in the clash of a fight, he seeks to beat back the resurgent duality, the terrible “thou”, the shadow of himself, the eye that looks askance at him, the hand and the arm that threaten him, the love in which his own love is mirrored, the “other” who blocks his vision of the Supreme Unity. He kills and gets killed in the name of God, in the name of God he defends his lord and his land since his weapons are blessed and he is invested just as his lord is, and his country is the place fixed by God for the conquest of heaven, the support, the base of his ascension, and he must defend it in order to keep God’s law in the world, as long as the enemy does not deprive him of God by snatching his land, home, temple. His caste is the guardian of sovereign power in which the virtues are combined, that when entirely followed, lead man to the Edenic fruition, restoring his eternal and original country to him, whose necessary starting point is this land. The king and the country are made sacred by the radiant vision of divine Glory since in loving it, the warrior loves God, and in protecting it, he defends God’s possession.

Note that the realization by means of warrior asceticism is always indirect, while the priestly asceticism is direct or final: the former is accomplished through the world of Rhythms, the latter in the Silence, the former remains in duality, the latter reaching unity from non-duality. This difference is essential and eliminates whatever arbitrary reduction that would subvert the traditional order. The warrior caste obeys its own law that is justified only through a higher law which, originating in the divine, ex-

⁹<http://referenceworks.brillonline.com/entries/brill-s-new-paully/victimarius-e12204070?s.num=0>

tends it. In fact, if the Primordial Tradition is taken as the starting point, the castes are reduced to just one, that of the Priests, nor is it put there for others because in this stage only the contemplative way exists which excludes any action: there is no caste in reality in the Primordial Tradition in which *human unity* is realized in its most absolute expression. The King here is the high priest and one can speak of regality only in the sense of cognitive absoluteness. But in successive traditional forms, the distribution of human possibilities is necessarily carried out, because we are already in a greater state of decadence and complexity through which life assumes a internal and external double aspect; in this stage, the priestly class assumes an absolute position that puts it back in the Primordial Tradition, that of the Warriors is internal in respect to the purely exterior Workers but, considering the whole tradition in its triple aspect of Silence, Rhythm, and Forms which correspond to the Priests, Warriors, and Workers, the second caste occupies an intermediate position of equilibrium between the two extremes and serves to maintain the traditional unity because its attribute is power.

Representing the traditional boundary circularly like a fortified city, we will say that the center, the Temple, corresponds to the priestly caste, the periphery, i.e., the ramparts, to the Warrior Caste, while the workers remain in the middle. Considering such relationship, the Warrior caste occupies the most dangerous place in the traditional defense, the one most exposed and, if one understands the value of this depiction in relation with what has been said, the Warriors are the lords of Rhythms and the art that is most appropriate to them is Magic.

Whoever is capable of reflection will understand without difficulty how, this caste living in the paroxysm of action, must necessarily be involved in the wave of hidden forces that are unleashed especially when the rhythm of the active life is intense, so that the warrior asceticism has as its principle goal the knowledge of the world of Rhythms, of the laws that govern it, and the defense from the traps of the field of shadows.

That appears more clearly to those who consider with attention life and the work of the great conquerors where one easily sees how materially infinitesimal elements have engendered inevitable imbalances. What is true for every man is doubly so for the Warriors who live intensely in order to confront the most terrible enemies, those who are invisibly close to us and of which the visible enemies represent a type of material duplicate.

Speaking of this caste we implicitly asserted the necessity of war, but not less implicitly we asserted the need that it is uniquely entrusted to the true and proper Warriors that they have the legitimate use of it. Now as one does not become a priest, so one does not become a warrior, and the contamination of castes has unfortunately produced the current degradation since, with democratic leveling, introductions of every type have taken place, distorting the traditional order and engendering the fall of a truly civil society. A return to normality worked with discernment, progression, and measure would permit the restoration of the sole and true hierarchy in the attributions of caste conformed to the nature of man, to his possibilities, and to the effective development of his more specifically productive activities.

The warrior is the ascetic of the active life and his discipline is purely interior: whoever cannot kill himself will never be able to kill or, better said, in killing he will profane life and death because his cause is not holy. Now a man kills himself by his own hand or with the sanctified arm in a way that the enemy is visible and close, otherwise a true assassination is accomplished and not an act of purification. If war, as we said, is justified only as the symbol of the Great War, it is inconceivable that the battle be not focused, faithful, open, frontal, because only by knowing oneself can one dominate himself and only in seeing his own enemy can he be surpassed without the battle and the carnage having the bestial character of the battle and anonymous, unholy, and sacrilegious carnage. If one is capable of developing all the aspects of the question when placed in its true light, one understands that war must be made by warriors and not

by the entire democratically leveled people and violently carried back in great conflicts to the state of savage desperation: it follows from it that war must be normally conducted man to man and, in its most typical expression, brought back to the preliminary dispute, to the duel.

We said that the Warrior caste is founded on a dualistic base that the Latin term *duellum*, the ancient form of *bellum*, expresses with perfect obviousness: war is the expression of this fundamental duality of which love and hate—the latter reducible, if you reflect on it well, to love—represent two extremes: in the event a traditional restoration is produced, which is difficult but not impossible, and which, in every way, only modern devirilization can gravely obstruct with its two most typical expressions, pessimism and skepticism, war should be led back to its fixed normalizing function, i.e., to exist permanently for the single caste of the Warriors. The duel that so called civil society of the West, barbarous in reality, repudiated with satanic thoughtlessness while they turn current conflicts into a hellish game of machines that work the foolish and most ungodly destruction, would be the essential condition of the return to normality in case it was led back to its natural, spontaneous, i.e., effective, form and not to that modern parody that stands to the duel as the courtier stands to the knight.

If normal arms were only in the hands of the Warriors, the duel would take back its traditional value and would constitute the customary standard training of the caste, developing the sense of honor that has now faded in the heart of men. The duel with cold weapons¹⁰ *arma bianca* is the most noble, the purest, the highest expression of the warrior caste because it establishes a reciprocity of force, honor, and love in two men confronting each other, who are saved by killing each other and sanctify themselves by being killed. One observes that duality remains before and after: before life against life, after life in the face of death. And this duality is precisely the permanent indication of the warrior caste and is the

¹⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cold_weapon

basis of its purpose. War in a traditional society is the amplification of the duel, but other factors intervene: family, country, lord. It should have led back to normality, limited to the only caste that can do it without involving entire peoples, working that chaos that compromises the very existence of a civilization. Brought back to clarity, to the brutality of the ancient wars, although circumscribed and delimited, it should be, if not permanent at least frequent, giving in that way the acceleration necessary to the rhythm of life that makes it deeper and more fertile for revelation.

Modern wars—and for us, this “modernity” lasts for centuries—are the products of the democratic degeneration that has leveled humanity substituting for the Warrior caste a fictitious hierarchy in times of peace, even chaotic in times of conflict when every citizen must become what he never was, i.e., a soldier. The soldier obeys external discipline while the warrior obeys the inner: the warrior is always a warrior, the soldier can occasionally become a warrior through force, not by choice or by natural inclination. But there is a more important consideration. The Warrior is the refusal of sentimentality and among the ancients it did not exist: only modern degeneration has created through the monstrosity of democratic conflicts the romanticism of war, because in these conflicts in which all the people participate, there are only mediocre warriors, while the mass is constituted by a type of human gelatin that trembles with pathetic oscillations at every twisting that violates his nature. Instead, war reduced to lesser proportions, but with a more intense and more frequent rhythm, because it is entrusted only to men and not to machines, to Warriors and not to other castes, would be an indispensable element of a full and fecund life if led back to the traditional type, i.e., sanctified by the rectitude of causes that would give rise to it. Its delimitation would constitute a permanent and normal base of the activity to paralyze by no means all the people, but to intensify the rhythm of the active life with a continual contribution of strong and decisive reflexes.

Conclusion

This is the final segment on the role of the Warrior caste in a Traditional Society. Here we see that the point of war is to establish peace. The respective spheres of influence of the priests and warriors are made clear, although caste conflicts can still break out for the reasons specified. **Guido De Giorgio** then relates the roles of the castes to contemporary events circa 1940 : when priests are no longer the bearers of the holy science, there is a state of perpetual war and democratic leveling, then spiritual ruin results, as man is left to his own devices.

The return to normality restores the people's strength established of the Warrior caste which abides by love and whose sacrifice, different from that of the Priests, comprises an ascent of psychic energies oriented in the direction of heroic glorification. As action is subordinated to contemplation, so the warrior is subordinated to the priest, without however this subordination equalizing or confusing the two domains that are autonomous and separated and which constitute the spiritual authority and temporal power. These two jurisdictions are as cleanly separated and distinct as eternity is from time, therefore the two domains are unmistakable through the impossibility of reducing the first to the second or of extending the second to make it correspond to the first, since the eternal cannot be contained in the transient, nor can the transient cease to be such and to coincide with the eternal. This only consideration suffices to show that the temporal regiment is independent of the spiritual without however opposing it in any way, but rather in parallel turning to itself up to what is the maintenance of traditional unity that contains the both together and harmonizes them.

If in the primitive phase of perfection, with life being only contemplative, we can acknowledge a true unity of development oriented toward purely spiritual ends, this is not possible in the subsequent traditional forms where action appears immediately next to contemplation, tempo-

ral activity next to the spiritual, from which arises the separation of the two domains.

But this separation is necessary for the purity of the ends to which activity and contemplation tend: a fusion or an overpowering in part by one of these jurisdictions would constitute a true anomaly because it would confuse the divine with the human, the spiritual with the temporal, the sacred with the profane without reaching any profitable result. When we spoke of subordination we meant it only hierarchically, i.e., from the unique, traditional point of view that embraces and contains the contemplative life and the active life: in this sense one cannot escape anyone that the temporal is subordinated to the spiritual as and in the same measure that the human is subordinated to the divine from which it derives, and the existence and the justification of existence.

The Priest consecrates the Warrior and arranges that his action returns to the traditional sphere, but in his sphere the Warrior is autonomous and he neither can nor must collide with the Priest since his activity does not oppose the spiritual activity carried out in the bosom of the first caste. In a traditional society every dispute between the temporal and the spiritual is resolved in the unity the encompasses them; if, in fact, there is conflict, this must uniquely be ascribed to the temporary deviation of one or two domains due to essentially individual, and therefore unimportant, factors.

As long as the Priest remains priest and the Warrior, warrior, no conflict is possible because each one of them will understand he belongs to a sphere whose activity is clearly separated and distinct: this knowledge, this awareness, must guarantee the harmony between the temporal and the spiritual. But whenever, through complex circumstances that are not always easily discernible, a serious conflict between the two powers may happen, it is necessary to come back to the principles that safeguard traditional unity and then they will be resolved hierarchically in the seat of pure spirituality to rectify the deviations and annul the deflections that

can be produced by one side or the other, with leading the two castes and therefore the two powers each back to its own domain.

The elimination of the purely individual factors will produce the placation of the dispute, because unfortunately these will take place only through the surpassing of certain personalities who respectively break the law and the norm which regulate activity and establish the limits of the two castes. The relationship between the two powers is very delicate and the development of Europe shows how often the disputes between the spiritual and the temporal have assumed immense proportions up to the point of becoming outright hostility. There is a reason for all that: the imperfect realization of the traditional unity, that must be ascribed to the defection of the priestly class which can always make its authority matter, with well understood spiritual means, provided they don't distance themselves from sacred knowledge and in this, it only demands the defense of the highest values of the spirit. The temporal cannot undermine and diminish the eternal, and therefore the temporal power, in any way whatsoever and by whatever means, will not be able to harm the spiritual authority which will always know how, when it wishes, to withdraw from the world and allow it to deteriorate because it is deprived of divine help. Reflect very attentively on that in order to understand what is happening in Europe and in the world.

Nevertheless the bearers of sacred knowledge must at all cost maintain contact with traditional principles and undergo whatever duress, submit to any violation, in order to continue to save men by getting them back in touch with the eternal. The spiritual authority asserts itself with quite other means than those with which the temporal power asserts itself and we think that, in case of conflict, through oppressive or destructive that is the deviation and the overpowering of the temporal power, the spiritual authority will always have the upper hand, if it obstinately remains in its domain and does not descend into open battle with the temporal on the terrain of activity properly assigned that is not absolutely

of its sphere.

We think instead that as much as it will stay in its domain, so much more effective will its own work be because therefore, as was said with the greatest absoluteness, it assumes its authority from God and not from the world, and its strength, nourishing itself fervently on the divine, will not be able to triumph over hidden dangers, incomprehensions, suppressions, and apparent collapse. Because if in addition the deviation of the temporal power assumes such proportions by becoming absolutely anti-traditional and sacrilegious and the Warriors, forgetting themselves, insulting the principle of love, which is the foundation of their existence, were exceeding their deplorable actions, compressive of every traditional spirituality, know that nothing can touch, profane, and be admitted to God's Truth that is not God himself and that also the ruin of the world would leave perpetually together the Silence or where the divine mystery unfolds.

But we are convinced that the dispute between the two powers is almost always due to a remote deviation in the very heart of traditional unity and above all in the priestly caste whose members have often forgotten what is their only and great strength: sanctity. Whenever the spiritual authority, without any concession to the profane, takes up its true function, the maintenance of God's truth in the world for its salvation, and the Priests, who are its bearers, may not fail in their task which is contemplation and not action, effective realizing knowledge and not pure external, literal science of holy things, the traditional unity would harmoniously include the two distinct powers, but in parallel tending toward a single end, the return of man to God, through time, into eternity.

The temporal power in fact, of which the Warriors are the bearers, offers as terms the realization of the divine through time, in a concert of all the faculties tuned by their own equilibrium. Until now, in regard to this caste, we have spoken of war, but it is now necessary to consider the positive aspect of war, i.e., peace. War is an imbalance that produces a

balance which in its turn is broken through the intermittent character of human affairs: but if one considers that in analogy with the spirit whose domain is eternity, war appears as a renewal, a purification, radical emendation, followed by the achievement of a state of absolute and permanent pacification that represents the fruition of beatitude.

As much as equilibrium is superior to disequilibrium, so peace is superior to war of which it is the crowning achievement. No consideration of aesthetic order may contaminate the vision of the truth in the seat of pure spirituality. The Warrior yearns for peace since his war is holy only if it leads to a permanent and definitive peace. War represents the germinative suffering, and peace, the flower and the coronal fruit. If intermittence is a type of destiny of human and temporal affairs, it must never be considered as a cyclic law on the part of the Warriors and the Leader, meaning to say by that, that each war must be completed for the end of the disequilibrium and the realization of peace. That intermittence exists, but it does not make law, this is the foundation of the right and healthy development of temporal power. If, as we said, war is in analogy with the Great War that represents the permanent conquest of the divine, it must tend to peace and this must be the true and holy goal of the Warriors: only a soft and superficial esthetic, ignorant of the profound truths of certain analogies and the symbolic relationship between the temporal and the eternal can consider war as the end in itself, a spastic state, fascinating for its own anomaly; only when true peace is not realized, can the nostalgia of war be felt, this very dubious sentiment of order because it belongs to the purely sentimental sphere.

In order to prevent this anomaly, it would be necessary to avoid, above all else, the wars that are not decisive, considering them as imperfect actions, true and proper permanent crises that contribute to the crumbling of traditional societies.

What has happened and is happening in Europe must be considered under this light and then one will understand the gravity of the current

situation in which, through the confusion of castes, through consenting to an absolutely bestial democratic leveling, the detachment of the human from the divine takes place and therefore the very end of man is prepared. When we speak of the end, we mean the true and proper end that is certainly not that of the flesh, as every person gifted with the most elementary good sense can comprehend, but the spiritual ruin, the collapse of those bridge that connect the world to the Superworld, of which follows the instantaneous formation of the hidden ways that connect the earth to the darkness of the Underworld. If humanity does not want to become an immense and sterile hell, it is necessary that it brings back the great traditional ways by which only will new bases be found for new developments.

The Warriors must participate with the Priests for the restoration of order because these two castes are the bases of traditional unity: from their concordant action everything can be made smooth, the one being the bearers of sacred knowledge, i.e., of wisdom, the other the judges of power; the one, if you will, the club bearers, the others the fasces bearers. The harmony of the spiritual and the temporal can rebalance the world against all pessimisms and skepticism so acute and stupidly brayers of the current times; in no mode will be realized a permanent arrangement of the world without the cooperation of the spiritual authority and the temporal power because the return to normality must be effectuated from above to below, from the higher to the lower, and not the other way around.

For centuries the masses flounder in bestial tumults and will still flounder as long as the Priests and the Warriors permit it: that if these two castes feel the enormous weight of their responsibility and have the awareness of their respective domains and their true obligations, no one could prevent the restoration of traditional unity, the new equilibrium that would reopen the great passageway to eternity for the glory of God in heaven and the peace of men on earth.

Posted on 2013-03-04 by Cologero

* * *

Saladin on 2013-03-04 at 22:19 said:

Wow! That was intense! Cologero, you mentioned in your earlier post that comments have declined by 50% since you started posting translations of de Giorgio. If everyone is like me, it may be due to being awestruck after reading materials like this. Thank you for making these translations available!

Logres on 2013-03-05 at 12:45 said:

Seconded – I believe there is not much to add, and the meditation may take a lifetime. The Trinity is partially ordered after caste, with the Father as the archetype, or Person without which Godhood does not exist, the Son as the executor or warrior (this is more clear in Revelation), and the Spirit as the silent partner who upholds everything. A case could be made for switching Spirit and Son, depending on how you view it. If God has caste-like orderings, what hope do mortals have to escape from it?

This was a beautiful translation.

Pickman on 2013-03-05 at 18:07 said:

Ever since reading that brief introduction to De Giorgio in Evolas' "Road of Cinnabar" (under "My Explorations of Origin and Tradition") I have hungered for De Giorgio translations of "outraged and aggressive letters, strewn with brilliant insights". My praise extends to Cologero for his selfless task in making these works a possibility.

I get that sense of magic once more when reading this mans work, whose absolutist spirit is most congenial to my own character.

David on 2013-03-05 at 18:42 said:

Di Giorgio is a genius, and those translation are a gift from the Holy Spirit. Thank you.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-06 at 01:04 said:

Personally, I find little reason to comment on De Giorgio's writings because they are so full of wisdom I have nothing more to add than to just nod my head and learn from him.

Max on 2016-04-01 at 07:14 said:

Gandalf in a powerful scene that was not included in the final movie adaption of "The Return of the King":

"A thousand years this city has stood. Now at the whim of a madman it will fall. And the White Tree, the tree of the king, will never bloom again."

"Why are they still guarding it?"

"They guard it because they have hope. A faint and fading hope that one day it will flower. That a king will come and this city will be as it once was before it fell into decay. The old wisdom borne out of the West was forsaken. Kings made tombs more splendid than the houses of the living and counted the old names of their descent dearer than the names of their sons. Childless lords sat in aged halls musing on heraldry or in high, cold towers asking questions of the stars. And so the people of Gondor fell into ruin. The line of kings failed. The White Tree withered. The rule of Gondor was given over to lesser men."

In Tolkien's world the race of Men represents the warrior caste, and the Elves the priestly caste. As the end of the world approaches, many men become corrupted by their own mortality which would have otherwise been a source of great heroism and glory, and the Elves do not wish to take action but prefers to withdraw and isolate themselves contemplating what is eternal as if no external events concerns them. The Elves come to believe that the worlds destiny is inevitable and that resisting it is pointless, however man at the brink of destruction, by remembering the meaning of death as a gift of men, sees that there is nothing to loose and everything to win, with the fate of men's souls unknown even to the wisest. There are no shortages of battles, and even the "living dead" – believing in nothing – out of the despair of what they have become, are bound to answer the call of the Emperor where he to return. A role of the still remaining Elves includes awakening the King to his quest and to help provide the sign and means by which to conquer, reforging the broken sword that they have safe kept throughout the ages.

Aryayana on 2016-04-07 at 15:19 said:

I think there are some good scenes dealing with the relationship between the First (spiritual elite) and Second (warrior nobility) castes in the Japanese movie 'Zen' about Master Dogen. See, for example, the part starting from 1:28:24 and lasting until Dogen returns to his temple.

<https://youtu.be/8s5Uz8XSc-Y>

Notice how the Zen master's non-acting spiritual power prevails over the Shogun. The warrior-leader had the power even to kill the master if he so desired, but in the end it is the latter who wields the purest authority and who, indeed, is the true master of the former in terms of the essential hierarchy, and who may save him when he goes astray.

J on 2018-05-11 at 20:09 said:

What would a Warrior in today's world do, given that there's (seemingly) no legitimate path for them to fulfill their destiny, and they can't just withdraw from the world like a Priest? Asking for a friend.

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-07 at 11:12 said:

"The brutality, although circumscribed and delimited, of the ancient wars, it should be, if not permanent at least frequent..."

Guido De Giorgio seems to be gunning for Evola's role as "greatest comic book supervillain of all time". Too bad he looks more like Richard Feynman in the few photos available of him online.

Cologero on 2013-03-07 at 13:03 said:

Yes, and it may discourage some warriors if they think they could be called out on a duel at any moment. Do you think his justification is incorrect? ("giving that acceleration necessary to the rhythm of life that makes it deeper and more fertile for revelation") In other words, to live without the thought or awareness of death: does that also hide the rhythm of life and diminish the possibility of revelation? He is getting at something ... he may be right or wrong.

Does it relate to this: *Noble Savages*¹¹.

graham on 2013-03-08 at 14:45 said:

As a woodworking apprentice nowadays, I'm looking forward to the part on workers and forms, it may be helpful in the task of discernment.

Logres on 2013-03-08 at 21:58 said:

There is an interesting tale, here, about "Deadwood Lighter", a Cherokee medicine man who used dream magic to win against a deadly raid from a neighboring tribe. Would this be an instance of magic employed by a warrior culture (even though these tribes had "degenerated")? http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Townsend,_Tennessee

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-08 at 23:58 said:

Of course, the crux of his argument is that modern, conscripted life gives a different meaning to war than traditional gentleman's duel, and it's hard to argue. But to use the concept of *war* itself instead of valor and a readiness to duel more generally, and then putting it in the imperative form, can't help but arouse amusement.

Cologero on 2013-03-09 at 01:23 said:

The final segment will make things clearer, I presume. De Giorgio is not promoting war for its own sake, unlike others.

¹¹<http://www.nytimes.com/2013/02/19/science/napoleon-chagnons-war-stories-in-the-amazon-and-at-home.html>

Caleb Cooper on 2013-03-09 at 11:25 said:

I tend to favor an expansive use of the term magic (I perturbed my RCIA deacon by insisting that the Mass was a magic ritual and the Eucharist Blood Magic), but this sounds more like the guardian Archangel of the community initiating communication with it's representative before heaven. Magic to me seems to imply some intent or desire in the operant setting subtle forces in motion.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-10 at 21:00 said:

I am interested to know how de Giorgio would have explained the conflicts between the Popes and the Emperors in the Middle Ages... ..

also, if the spiritual and temporal realms are autonomous of each other, does that mean the two swords (spiritual and temporal power) that Boniface VIII claimed the church had is a wrong idea ?

Cologero on 2013-03-10 at 21:58 said:

Didn't De Giorgio explain the conflicts in this segment? He certainly alluded to them. The causes may be the weakness of the Priests who no longer are the bearers of sacred knowledge, or occasionally individualistic or egoistic factors.

De Giorgio is not refuting Boniface VIII. He emphasizes that the Warriors are subordinated to and consecrated by the priests; that is how they derive their power. The doctrine of the two swords does not mean that the priests are actively engaged in temporal affairs, just the opposite. In *Unam Sanctam*, Boniface VIII wrote:

Both, therefore, are in the power of the Church, that is to say, the spiritual and the material sword, but the former is to be administered for the Church but the latter by the Church; the former in the hands of the priest; the **latter by the hands of kings and soldiers, but at the will and sufferance of the priest.** ... one sword ought to be subordinated to the other and temporal authority, subjected to spiritual power

So the temporal power is indirect, not directly controlled by the spiritual authority. But bring this up in the chapter on the Capo.

The question is does Vatican II reject *Unam Sanctam*, which it certainly seems to have done.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-10 at 23:00 said:

Ah, you've cleared some things up – so far De Giorgio's thoughts are in quite exact agreement with the teachings of the Church. I eagerly await the chapter on the Capo as I think it's the most important one in the book.

I am currently trying to understand the decline of Christendom – we all know the events of history – but I am more interested in the whys... ... so essentially the decline began in the Church, I suppose de Giorgio means, which is why Boniface was not able to control Phillipe ? but what caused the qualuity of the priests to descend from their former level ?

Cologero on 2013-03-10 at 23:32 said:

De Giorgio gives his interesting take on it in one very telling paragraph (beginning with "The elimination of the purely individual factors ... "). Certain personalities (e.g. Phillipe) will bring in individual factors. He ends with a cryptic claim, if anyone has any thoughts on it.

To wit, the priestly class may choose to defect, since the priests should always be able to control the temporal power through spiritual means. Obviously, actions in time cannot affect the spiritual ("gates of hell"), which can also be found in Guenon. That is why the latter objects to Evola's raising of action to the same level as contemplation. So the priests may "withdraw from the world and allow it to deteriorate". De Giorgio concludes with this:

"Reflect very attentively on that in order to understand what is happening in Europe and in the world."

How do you deal with that, Jason-Adam? Is the Church self-destructing as the secular media believes, or is there a deliberate withdrawal? Didn't Benedict XVI says there will be a contraction in the church? And De Giorgio mentioned the "apparent collapse"; is that true or is the collapse real? And who are those "solitary ascetics"?

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-11 at 00:06 said:

If I understand him correctly, De Giorgio is saying that the spiritual centre has not degenerated but is voluntarily withdrawn from the world allowing the tides of history to take their courses ?

The solitary ascetics are the priests... ... whose true nature is hidden...

Cologero on 2013-03-11 at 00:59 said:

That is the way I read him. Of course, many structures have indeed degenerated, but no material action can destroy the spiritual center. It may be forgotten by many, but it can never be lost. Some day I'll have to tell the story of the book's publication. The manuscript was found several years after his death. The original editor had to use a pseudonym, although the book seems pretty tame today.

Synodius on 2013-03-11 at 06:45 said:

Interesting, I just finished reading Rama Coomaraswamy's *Destruction of the Christian Tradition* where he mentions a quote of Paul VI about 'auto-demotition' and the whole book favors the version of destruction. Also it seems they are not only dismantling the Church but actively pushing for NWO. Doesn't look 'apparent' to me, but what do I know? Can you please provide some context to what Benedict said about contraction?

Saladin on 2013-03-13 at 22:39 said:

The Spiritual Center(s) never degenerate. It is only castes (and before all others the Priestly caste) that degenerate. There is little doubt that the priestly caste in Christendom has declined to the point of non-existence. Therefore it is only the solitary ascetics who carry the flame and enlighten humanity (albeit in a subliminal manner) in this darkest of ages.

And, no! The solitary ascetics are not priests, although priests can be solitary ascetics. Guenon, De Giorgio, ... are fine examples of solitary ascetics but there are many more whom we have never heard of!

scardanelli on 2013-03-14 at 13:42 said:

This seems also to relate to the post on Evola and the initiatic centers of Tibet falling to the communists. The church retracts materially in the face of the modern world just as the Tibetan Lamas would not act to safeguard sacred centers against communist invasion. Yet perhaps what seems like a loss only appears so from the perspective of action, for "the spiritual authority asserts itself with quite other means than those with which the temporal power asserts itself."

Perhaps this retraction is what leaves so many dumbfounded and bemoaning the lack of a spiritual path in the west. They are looking without, rather than within. As De Giorgio states, the bridges to the superhuman may be crumbling, but the way remains open for those with the eyes to see.

So what looks like a retreat is actually a safeguarding, an attempt to "maintain contact with traditional principles and undergo whatever duress, submit to any violation, in order to continue to save men by getting them back in touch with the eternal."

If I am not misunderstanding Tomberg in this regard, would this be a retraction of the church of St. Peter in order to safeguard the church of St. John?

Max on 2015-02-16 at 15:35 said:

De Giorgio states that what provides meaning and legitimacy to war is peace. If the situation is such as that can not be achieved the only viable option is withdrawal to prepare and await the conditions that allow victory since we can not aim for anything other than the Greatest Peace. The Romans never fought any battles if the signs were not auspicious -corresponding to the will of the gods. Continuing the thought of "the roman": when is the tiger tired? The Augurs silently gazed into the heavens.

When anti-reality fought reality it became increasingly unreal while reality stayed the same. The separation widened until un-reality could no longer recognize what is real or not, starting to fight its own shadow. For unreality every sky became cloudy, but Reality will make itself known like a lightning from the eternal clear sky.

Excerpts from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*

19.1 The Mystery of Birth

To allow such traditional views to act on oneself, until they awaken precise interior forces, means to progress on the way that leads to a spiritual level from which the significance of life constitutes something absolutely different from what it means for the rest of men: a significance of clarity, absolute force, and incomparable certitude.

JULIUS EVOLA

In *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, Evola addresses the mystery of birth and how it relates to one's destiny. After discussing the notions of the races of the soul and spirit, he raises the question and addresses some objections to his view:

What blame does a man have if he was born in one race and not in another? Is he perhaps responsible for the fact that his parents and ancestors are Aryans, Jews, blacks or Amerindian? Has he

perhaps willed all that? With your theory of race you remain, in spite of it all, in a purely naturalistic point of view. You turn a natural event into a destiny and construct above your system, instead of bringing attention above all to those values in which it can truly enter into play, and be considered imputable, as a human responsibility.

He regards these objections not as weird or artificial, but of a real importance to avoid reverting to materialistic and collectivist degradations of the doctrine. The traditional point of view stresses the values of the person over any of its manifestations.

Evola asserts that only pre-Christian conceptions of man and life can satisfy his requirements. We prefer to deal with concepts rather than labels, so we need to reformulate Evola's argument somewhat. In a subsequent post, we will show how his views challenge both the traditional right and its modern alternatives. Evola describes the Christian solution to the mystery of birth this way:

The Church had to reject the idea of pre-existence that the preceding traditions always recognized: that is, it denied that the spiritual nucleus of the personality pre-exists terrestrial birth and, naturally, conception. In Christian theology things in this respect are not so simple, as far as this denial could be believed. Nevertheless, the fundamental Christian view is that each human soul is unique and is created by God from nothing at the moment in which it is breathed into a body or embryo ready to receive it. That a man is born in one race rather than another becomes then a theological mystery: "God willed it" and, often, it is admitted that the divine will is inscrutable.

In that paragraph, there is something true, something false, and something ambiguous. It is true that the human being exists from the moment of conception, so, here, Evola is more Catholic than the pope. It is false

that Catholic doctrine teaches that the soul is infused into the embryo at some point subsequent to conception. That is the Cartesian view that presumes a duality of soul and body. What is ambiguous is the meaning of the pre-existence of the soul. The common misunderstanding is that the soul exists in time prior to conception. This is the view of Plato of all systems deriving from Theosophy, and even popular views of oriental religions such as Hinduism or Buddhism.

To clear up the latter point first, Evola makes it clear that this pre-existence cannot be conceived in a temporal sense, since the human Self is transcendent to the world of space and time. The Thomist view, then, is not as dissimilar as Evola would like. The soul is the form of the body, which cannot exist without the soul. So the soul is pre-existent in the ontological sense and the physical aspects of the body are the reflection of soul qualities. This is really Evola's point, and should be the Catholic viewpoint, had the understanding brought by Thomas Aquinas allowed to be further developed instead of being petrified at a certain point. Evola explains his doctrine:

The view of ancient Aryan humanity was totally different and it alone permits us to overcome the objections indicated... According to that view, birth is not by chance nor a fact willed by God; neither fidelity in regards to one's own nature signifies a passivity, but rather testifies to the more or less clear knowledge of a profound connection of one's Self with something transcendental and otherworldly, to be able to act in a transfiguring way. This is the essence of the doctrine of karma and dharma, a doctrine that must not be confused with the idea of reincarnation.

It is necessary to distinguish a double heredity. That which stands before the individual in the temporal non-transcendental, sense is the heredity of parents, the gens, the race, a certain civilization, caste, etc., therefore, more or less, everything that commonly is meant when speaking of heredity. But all that does not exhaust

the spiritual reality of the individual, as materialism and historicism claim: as determining and essential it must rather be considered an intervention from above, a principle assuming and utilizing, as its material of expression and incarnation, everything that this heredity has gathered with its laws and determinism. Moreover, it must be thought that the historical-biological heredity of a given line is chosen and assumed when it can be approximately worth as a type of expressions analogous to a transcendental heredity.

That is why in every being two heredities meet and join each other, the one terrestrial and historic, in good measure positively detectable i.e., known to science (tr) , the other spiritual, otherworldly. To establish the ties between the two, is therefore to determine the synthesis that defines a given human nature, and intervenes in an event represented in various traditions with various symbols... Basically, as noted, a type of law of elective affinity acts here. Wishing to clarify with some applications, we will say that a man is not of a given gender, race, or caste because he is born that by chance or through the will of God, or through a mechanism of natural causes, but vice versa. He was born that way because he already was a man or women, of one race or another, etc., naturally in an analogical sense in the sense of an inclination of vocation or deliberation transcending use, through lack of adequate concepts, we can present only through its effects. In a certain way, one has therefore the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and non-earthly. At the point of crossing, according to traditional teachings, birth occurs, or better said, the conception of a new being, an incarnation.

Race, caste, etc., therefore exist in the spirit before manifesting in terrestrial and historical existence. Diversity has its origin from above, and what refers to it on earth is only a reflection and symbol. As one willed to be on the basis of a primordial nature or a transcendental decision, so one is. It is not birth that determines

nature, but vice versa; it is nature, in its widest sense, because common words are inadequate, that determines birth.

It is this point of crossing that accidental, or contingent, qualities intersect with transcendent, or essential, qualities. Clearly, the modern conception ignores the transcendent, by its nominalism and denial of formal causes, hence every quality is accidental. The Aristotelian-Thomist scheme agrees in principle, yet is limited by its commitment to the genus and species distinction, so it is forced to define various types of accidents. We will address these issues subsequently, after we translate another section on the impact that Evola's conception has on ethical theory. But first we will repeat some quotes from Plotinus and Plato that Evola relies upon.

The general plane is unique, but divides itself in diverse parts, in a way that in everything there are distinct places, some more pleasant, others less so. And souls, also unequal, come to inhabit these distinct places that correspond to their own diversity. In such a way, everything is arranged and the differences in their situations correspond to the inequality of the souls.

Plotinus

It is not the demon that chooses you, but you yourself chose your demon. You yourself choose the destiny of that life to which you are irremediably connected.

Plato

Mystery of Birth For the presentation of the directive principles of this part of race theory it is however necessary to make a few remarks related to the problem of birth, and a final clarification of what has been said about heredity.

Even when we have worked out all the principal objections against the doctrine of race that are made from an immediate, practical or intellectual point of view, whether in good or bad faith, there remains one that is insuperable but decisive. They can say: good, everything affirmed is correct. But with everything taken into account, what fault does a man have if he was born into one race and not in another? Is he perhaps responsible for the fact that his parents and ancestors are Aryans, Jews, blacks or Amerindian? Has he perhaps willed all that? With your theory of race you remain, in spite of everything, in a purely naturalistic point of view. You turn a natural event into a destiny and you build above your system, instead of paying attention above all to those values in which human responsibility can truly come into play, and be considered imputable.

This is, in some way, the *ultima ratio* of the adversaries of race theory. And it must be conceded that such an objection is not artificial and farfetched, but of a real importance, if it does not support the materialist and collectivist deterioration of the doctrine in word and is posed instead from the traditional point of view, which always emphasizes the values of the personality. Nevertheless, to consider that objection certainly means confronting the problem of birth. From a higher, spiritual point of view, the justification of the race idea depends on the problem of birth and its solutions.

In this regard, arriving at some firm points is still rather difficult, as long as it remains in the ambit of views introduced by the coming of Christianity into the West. And that is not by chance: race and super-race, cult of blood, arianity, etc., are all concepts that were formed and affirmed essentially in pre-Christian civilizations. It is therefore necessary to look in such traditions and in their knowledge for the elements of the solution of the problems, that the recovery of those ideas today are going to raise. Every reference in more recent conceptions of man and life can only furnish us incomplete and often inadequate points of view.

Thus we must not be surprised that the problem of birth is remark-

ably obscure in the Christian vision of the world. For precise and certainly not arbitrary reasons, that we cannot discuss here, the Church had to reject the idea of pre-existence that earlier traditions had always recognized: that is, it has denied that the spiritual center of the personality pre-exists terrestrial birth and, certainly, even conception. In Christian theology, things in this regard are not as simple, as this denial can be believed. Nevertheless, the fundamental Christian view is that each human soul is unique and is created by God from nothing at the moment in which it is breathed into a body or human embryo ready to receive it. That a man is born into one race rather than another therefore becomes a theological mystery: “God willed it” and it is usually admitted that the divine will is inscrutable.

The view of ancient Aryan humanity was totally different and it alone can overcome the indicated objections. For a complete explanation, we must again remind the reader of our work *Revolt against the Modern World*. Recapping, here we limit ourselves to say that according to that view, birth is never by chance, nor a fact willed by God; nor does fidelity in respect to one’s own nature signify passivity, but rather it gives evidence to the more or less clear consciousness of a deep connection of one’s own Self with something transcendent and otherworldly, to the extent of acting in a transfiguring way. This is the essence of the doctrines of karma and dharma, which must not be confused with the idea of reincarnation. As we have shown in other works, the theory of reincarnation is either a conception foreign to “Aryan spirituality, essentially characteristic of pre-aryan, telluric, matriarchal cycles of civilization, or it is the effect of misunderstandings and deformations that certain traditional views have undergone in some contemporary theosophical circles. And if, in the traditional world, even in the Aryan, seemingly clear evidence in favor of the belief in reincarnation, in reality, it is only about symbolic forms that a superior knowledge had to disguise in regard to the people and the uninitiated.

In any case, for the problem that concerns us here, it is necessary to refer, not to reincarnation, but to the doctrine that the human Self, as I having my own given nature, would be the effect, the production, the mode of appearance under certain conditions of existence, of a spiritual entity that preexists and transcends it. And since everything that is time, sooner or later, is just something inherent in the human condition, so strictly speaking we cannot speak of anything preexisting or antecedent in the temporal sense.

We are getting into a rather difficult field, precisely because conceptions and expressions cannot be applied to it that we are formed in the existence of this world and that, applied to a different reality, they can easily lead to distortions and deformations. We say, in any case, that It is necessary to discern a double heredity. What stands before the individual, in the temporal, non-transcendental sense, is the heredity of parents, the folk, the race, a certain civilization, caste, etc., therefore, more or less, everything that commonly is meant when speaking of heredity. But even that does not exhaust the spiritual reality of the individual, as materialism and historicism claim: rather we must consider an intervention from above as determining and essential, a principle assuming and utilizing everything that this heredity has accumulated as its material of expression and incarnation, with its laws and its determinisms. Moreover, it must be thought that the historical and biological heredity of a given line is chosen and assumed when it can be approximately be considered as a kind of expressions analogous to transcendental heredity.

That is why two heredities meet and join each other in every being, the one terrestrial and historical, positively detectable to a great degree i.e., known to science (tr), the other spiritual and otherworldly. To establish the connection between the two, and thereby determine the synthesis that defines a given human nature, an event intervenes, represented in various traditions with various symbols, which we cannot examine here. Basically, as noted, a type of law of elective affinity operates. In order to

clarify with some applications, we can say that a man is not of a given gender, race, or caste because he is born that way by chance or through the will of God, or through a mechanism of natural causes, but vice versa. He was born that way because he already was a man or women, of one race or another, etc., naturally in an analogical sense in the sense of an inclination of a transcendent vocation or deliberation, which we, because of the lack of adequate concepts, can indicate only through its effects. In a certain way, we therefore have the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and an otherworldly. At the point of crossing, according to traditional teachings, birth occurs, or better said, the conception of a new being, an incarnation.

Race, caste, etc., therefore exist in spirit before manifesting in terrestrial and historical existence. Diversity has its origin from above, and what relates to it on earth is only a reflection and symbol. As you have willed to be, based on a primordial nature or a transcendental decision, so you are. It is not birth that determines nature, but vice versa; it is nature, in its widest sense, because common words are inadequate, that determines birth.¹

The Mystery of Birth Explained

The general plane is unique, but divides itself in diverse parts, in a way that in everything there are distinct places, some more pleasant, others less so. And souls, also unequal, come to inhabit these distinct places that correspond to their own diversity. In such a way, everything is arranged and the differences in their situations correspond to the inequality of the souls.

PLOTINUS

¹For further reading, see “The Doctrine of the Castes” in *Revolt against the modern World*, “Man and Woman” in *Revolt against the modern World, Life of the Spirit* (<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2163>), *Law of Attraction* (<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1664>).

It is not the demon that chooses you, but you yourself chose your demon. You yourself choose the destiny of that life to which you are irremediably connected.

PLATO

After the quotes from Plotinus and Plato, **Julius Evola** next discusses various supernatural beings from Tradition, which Evola accepts as real entities and essential for his ideas on spiritual races. However, there is no reason to restrict their influence to antiquity; they are present and fully active today.

This expression “demon”, from Plato is particularly interesting for us, since here the concept of demon has nothing to do with the Christian idea of a wicked entity, but instead has a close relation to the deepest forces of races, both of the soul and of the body. Even here, we cannot delve into the traditional doctrine in regards, but only to recall that, likewise, the demon, the lares, the penates, the “doppelganger” *doppio*, which is a synonym for “subtle body”, are entities that in antiquity interfered in and reflected the precise knowledge of the true roots of the differentiation of bloodlines, *gentes*, and ultimately the individuals themselves on the basis of a totalitarian vision of the world, including the invisible and the visible, and not of that mutilation of the moderns who only know material and psychological processes. From such testimonies which could be multiplied with reference to the traditions of all peoples, the idea of transcendental, or vertical, heredity therefore is confirmed, and of the choice that on the base of analogous correspondences, determines the connection of it to a horizontal, historical, biological heredity. The consequences of all the in regards to the justification of the racial ideas are clearly visible.

Since we have already discussed the notions of Angels and Demons², we will move onto the other supernatural beings. The lares³ are protecting spirits of dead ancestors. They kept watch over the affairs of the family. Many pious people today are aware of the watchful presence of their ancestors. In addition, there are lares to protect broader domains such as neighborhoods, cities, states, livestock, and so on. Obviously, we still know these spirits, but they are now called patron saints or guardian angels. The principalities are the guardian angels for the various nations and countries, as accepted by Muslims and Traditional Christians, as well as the ancient pagans.

The penates⁴ more or less serve the same function as the lares. Since Evola accepts demons, lares, and penates as real beings, we should expect their presence to be made known, at least to those of the proper disposition and sensitivity. That they are called today the spirits of one's ancestors, patron saints, or angels makes no difference for their reality.

By “double”⁵, doppio, or doppelganger, Evola means the subtle body, i.e., the soul. In ancient Egypt this was called Ka. In the *Ancient City*, **Fustel de Coulanges** describes the state of the soul after death, as related in Hindu, Greek, and Roman traditions. Since we have previously discussed this on several occasions, and in the future we want to compare it to the state of the souls in Limbo according to Dante, we will move on.

So it should be absolutely clear now what Evola means by the “third dimension” of history. The modern mind can only see material or historical processes, which correspond to gross and subtle manifestation. However, the vertical dimension includes a whole array of beings who are involved in the creation of nations, peoples, and individuals. The actions of these beings are invisible to the modern mind which can only

²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2995>

³<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lares>

⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Di_Penates

⁵<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Doppelg%C3%A4nger>

attribute them to material and biological causes.

Given this, we are in a position to better understand the existence of man in the light of Tradition. As Evola points out, the difference between Essence and Existence is a matter of degree. Here we understand man's Essence as who he is in himself, his Spirit, his karma (what he carries into the world) and his dharma (his task or destiny in the world). His Existence, then, is the meeting of this Essence interacting with the horizontal forces at the proper time and space suitable to him, by the Law of Elective Affinity. This is not a bipolar process between Essence and Existence, but rather an emanation involving higher beings and influences. If you look at the diagram from *Spiritual Beings*⁶, this process takes the being through the angelic influences which determine his race, nation, family, and so on, then through the astral and planetary influences, and finally through the four elements. This is the birth of man in the vertical direction.

Posted on 2012-04-05 by Aeneas

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Temenus on 2012-04-06 at 06:39 said:

The Plato quote is taken from *Republic*, Book 10, 617e. Here is an other translation of the whole passage that I found (I think that the translation of greek "daimon" as divinity and deity can be misleading): 617e No divinity shall cast lots for you, but you shall choose your own deity. Let him to whom falls the first lot first select a life to which he shall cleave of necessity. But virtue has no master over her, and each shall have more or less of her as he honors her or does her despite. The blame is his who chooses: God is blameless. "So saying, the prophet flung the lots out among them all, and each took up the lot that fell by his side, except himself; him they did not permit. And whoever took up a lot saw plainly what number he had drawn."

<http://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=plat.+rep.+10.617e>

golgonooza on 2012-04-09 at 15:39 said:

⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1941>

In 'Lazarus, Come Forth' Valentin Tomberg discusses the second miracle of John's Gospel, the healing of the nobleman's son, and the sixth day of creation in terms of two types of heredity – 'vertical' and 'horizontal'. The Fall is seen by him as the substituting of the vertical heredity of creation in image and likeness of God for the horizontal heredity of ancestral traits, original sin etc. The healing of the nobleman's son placed him into direct relationship with Christ allowing the heredity of the father to be subsumed into the 'vertical' relationship. This seemed to me to be very similar to what Evola is saying here – am I right?

Cologero on 2012-04-09 at 17:46 said:

Thanks for reminding me of that passage. Yes, it is the same understanding although Evola would avoid using the words "God" or "Christ". Of course, Tomberg is drawing on the same tradition as Evola from Hermes to Plotinus. However, Evola is too polemical and eager to see differences, where Tomberg and Guido de Giorgio see continuity and a deeper development.

Logres on 2012-04-09 at 22:56 said:

Ortega y Gasset cites the Chinese custom of worthy deeds ennobling the ancestor. Transferred to a spiritual plane (vertical plane), is this also the same thought?

Angolmois on 2012-04-28 at 13:55 said:

Ancestors and God should be brought together in one's worship, not to separate them, but of course the Divine, the vertical should have a pre-eminence. (For the record, I'm not implying that this would be recommended here, just mentioning it.)

What is the most presumptuous and hypocritical comment one hears alot in favouring multio-racialism and multi-culturalism nowadays is that Aryans and Non-Aryans come in all colours and nationalities. This has never been in doubt anywhere in world's traditions, but somehow these modern idiot's seem to think they're wiser and that all the world Aryans should mix with each other everywhere and then we'd have the grey-black-brown globalist utopia they hunger for. Spit and shame on them.

Cologero on 2012-04-28 at 17:37 said:

Angolmois, I think you mean that as the One is manifested, it becomes more and more differentiated, not less. The modern mind, denying the supernatural *de facto*, even if they confess the opposite, believes instead that the One must appear on the material plane. Hence, they deny all differentiation and hierarchy in the face of all evidence.

40,000 Norwegians singing together a communist inspired song for peace changes nothing. Moltke said: "universal peace is only a dream, and not even a beautiful dream."

There are still some who are willing to combat; they may even have an inkling of their enemy (the negative pole). But they will not be effective unless they know precisely what they

are fighting for (the positive pole).

Angolmois on 2012-04-29 at 03:08 said:

Yes, that is what I meant with my comment. The differentiation of the divine and its multiple manifestations in the form of different races, colours etc. should and could be a compliment for representatives of different races, nationalities and traditions – separate yet unified – but instead the modernists have made it an insult with their dis-honesty and linguistic / semantic plays. For example, “a negro” is a four letter curse word nowadays, whereas it was a compliment and a honorary title for the representatives of their race before. It has nothing to do with “hate speech” or anything like that for sure.

Timotheus Lutz on 2013-01-08 at 22:52 said:

Evola wrote: ‘In a certain way, one has therefore the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and non-earthly.’

I wonder if Francis Parker Yockey, noted American Axis-sympathizer, read and was influenced by the Synthesis. The characterization of spiritual and physical race as horizontal and vertical appeared in his book *Imperium*, although if I'm remembering right, the words were switched.

19.2 Men of Destiny

Remembering oneself, discovering the true will, following one's Dharma, can all be summarized by the ancient call to *know thyself*. This is what defies every attempt to define or limit Tradition. It is not a question of reading the next book, knowing about Etruscan fertility goddesses, or adopting the very next craze. It is irrelevant to a debate about which religion is traditional or not. It is not about adhering to any particular political program. Tradition is not reducible to a formula.

There are very specific spiritual states: detachment, a calm mind, mental strength, or a feeling of deep-rooted security. That is the only standard and the necessary pre-condition to understand Tradition in any meaningful sense. If you are anxious, if your mind is scattered, if you react emotionally, then you need to follow some spiritual practice that will lead to such the state of awareness he describes. Becoming a pagan, or

Buddhist, or Hindu, or thelemite is insufficient in itself, and those who convert often reveal a disheveled, superficial mind. **Julius Evola** explains:

Yet that is not enough. It is not by chance that the formula, “know thyself”, which, in its deepest meaning, refers exactly to such teachings, was itself written on the Delphic temple of Apollo, i.e., the Hyperborean God⁷. Letting such traditional truths act on oneself, until they awaken precise interior forces, means to proceed along the way that leads to a spiritual level at which the meaning of life constitutes something absolutely different from what the rest of men think: a sense of clarity, of absolute strength, of incomparable security.

But to have an inkling of all that, to glimpse a “character” in whom a type of indomitability is united to the feeling of detachment of “those who are joined from afar” and to an interior inaccessibility; in whom, therefore, there is simultaneously a superior calm, an aloofness, and a readiness to attack, to command, to absolute action—to have demonstrated this “character”, means also to have foreshadowed the mystery of the primordial Nordic race, or Hyperborean race, as the race of the spirit. Such is in fact the olympian and solar mode of being; the popular imagination refers to them today as the so-called “men of destiny” and yesterday referred to them as the vanished types of great leaders—in reality, in that it is now about the last echoes or flashing of what was characteristic, in general, of the great Hyperborean super race, before its dispersion and alteration. One remembers Plutarch’s expression about the members of the ancient Roman Senate: “They sit like a council of kings.”

Hence, a further consequence: if a civilization of the “classical” type, in the olympian and virile sense, not in the vulgar aesthetic and formulaic sense, reflects something of the Nordic

⁷<https://gornahoor.net/Hyperborean.htm>

race of the spirit, every romantic and “tragic” civilization, as opposed to it, will instead be the certain mark of the prevalence of the earlier influence by races and ethnic residues of a non-Nordic, pre-Aryan and anti-Aryan nature.

Despite all the talk about the Law of Cycles, it is poorly understood. It means that the material and historical circumstances have deteriorated to a certain level. By the Law of Elective Affinity, certain spirits will be attracted to that world and will feel very natural in it. Coincidentally, as the Wheel turns ever so slightly⁸ to begin the next cycle, there will be attracted a smaller group. Their task is to be the spiritual elite for the next cycle, the men of destiny. To do so, these men will have to make special efforts to remember, to recall the distant past, to truly know themselves. Those who recall their Past will create the Future of Tradition.

Posted on 2012-04-12 by Cologero

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Cologero on 2012-04-17 at 17:37 said:

The few readers who take this seriously may be interested in comparing this passage from *The Consolations of Philosophy*. Here, Sophia is speaking to Boethius:

Now I know the other cause, or rather the major cause of your illness: **you have forgotten your true nature**. And so I have found out in full the reason for your sickness and the way to approach the task of restoring you to health. It is because you are confused by loss of memory that you wept and claimed you you had been banished and robbed of all your possessions. And it is because you don't know the end and purpose of things that you think the wicked and the criminal have power and happiness. And because you have forgotten the means by which the world is governed you believe these ups and downs of fortune happen haphazardly. These are grave causes and they lead not only to illness but even death. Thanks, however, to the Author of all health, nature had not quite abandoned you. In your true belief about the world government—that it is subject to divine reason and not the haphazards of change—there lies our greatest hope of rekindling your health.

⁸<https://gornahoor.net/images/circlespirito.jpg>

19.3 The Demonic Element in the Anti-Race

In this chapter from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** takes up the question of the mismatch between one's spiritual and biological race. It is hopeless to understand what Evola is saying in normal terms. "Race", for him, is a spiritual quality that seeks to be manifested. However, there are other forces in play that may impede this process. In this regard, and also in terms of the differences of historical periods, he is closer to a Rudolf Steiner than to more conventional views. Here he admits the existence of demonic spirits.

In relation to that, and to complete the argument, it is time to consider the following. As a follow-up to the preceding objection we could call attention back to the fact that, in reality, the types at this point are not so differentiated, to be able to establish that aforesaid principle of fidelity to oneself; in the second place, the doctrine in question does not seem to give any explanation of the fact there exist types that are dilacerated and affected by serious conflicts, so much so that not all are "their own type" and not all feel themselves to be "in their own home".

On the basis of the general principle that everything that appears here is the analogical reflection of a reality existing above; in order to explain such cases one must think of everything that the aforesaid freedom of the individual without roots can do and likewise of the action of special historical conditions and social collectives; but above all, one should suppose, for such cases, some corresponding prenatal circumstances. Close to the central force that led to a given human manifestation, lesser and divergent forces can also have influences which, nevertheless, precisely because they are weaker, were, in a manner of speaking, overwhelmed and led to create expressions corresponding to elements of a unfavorable and discordant, biológico-historical, "horizontal" heredity.

The cases in which the "race of the soul" and the "inner vocation" do not correspond to the race of the body, such as those of every romantic

laceration, in the final analysis, are to be explained in such a way from the metaphysical point of view. Even modern psychology knows, at this point, about so called “split personalities”. And the more the minor forces diverge from the central direction, the more we will have, as the effect, men in whom the physical is not in accord with the soul, in whom the spirit contrasts with the body and the soul, whose vocation does not correspond to race or caste, the “personality” is in disagreement with tradition, and so on.

In similar cases, “classical” ethics, shaped by the ancient Nordic-Aryan norm of life, evident in a still more distinct way in its active and creative aspect, because it requires that the various divergent elements of these natures must obey a single, iron law on the basis of an inner decision, that cannot fail in the face of a negative example: and, as we will see, activist race theory must arouse precisely such a decision in the greatest number of individuals of a nation, as the base for all the rest. To exalt the romantic instead, the tragic, anxious soul, always in search of new “truths”, is essentially something from a civilization sick and damaged in its race. Calmness, style, clarity, command, discipline, power and the Olympic spirit are instead the points of reference for every formation of character and life in the Nordic-Aryan sense.

But if even in the world of causes and metaphysical meanings we must presume the existence of natures and vocations manifesting a diverse degree of unitariness, we must also think that not all civilizations, and not all periods, offer the same possibilities of incarnation and expression to any of the forces that tend to an earthly form of existence. It is said that in every birth two different heredities interfere. The earthly and the historical gather, in a type of bond, certain biological, anthropological, and in part even psychological elements, a tradition, eventually also a caste, a given point in time and place in space, etc. Now, there are civilizations in which everything “is in order”, so to say, in which life, at its maximum, develops around a great unity and organicity of all these elements of “horizontal”

heredity. Other civilizations are instead characterized by individualism, anarchy, the destruction of every limit, and every difference deriving from race, blood, caste, tradition, nationality. From what was said about the law of elective affinity and analogous correspondences that act in birth, obviously the civilizations of the former type are those that, in order to offer them circumstances and possibilities of adequate expression, attract unitary natures and pure and decisive forces. The chaotic civilizations of the latter type, for the same reason, will become instead, so to speak, the “exact place”, or the meeting place on earth, of every “otherworldly hysteric”.

This curious expression is the least alarming that one can use to give the meaning of the thing. In fact, on the metaphysical plane, hysteria, the internal contradiction, can appear only as the quality of those beings, “who say no to being”, to a greater or lesser measure. But such a quality is exactly that which Christian theology attributes to “demonic” forces — now meant in the current sense of the term or to the “creatures of chaos”, the will to incarnation of those, wherever situations arise that, for analogous reasons, evoke them, have thus a meaning as precise as it is alarming, that cannot be developed here. Typology, physiognomy, a type of transcendental psychology in the whole of a race theory examination of the first and second degree applied to the most typical figures of revolutionary and still outer, popular leaders of the frontlines of worldwide subversion, both political-social as well as cultural and spiritual, could lead, in this regard, to some impressive results.

We are not saying however that such chaotic civilizations accommodate these forces exclusively: unitary natures in themselves can also arise, which however will be particularly at a disadvantage and, in order to hold firm and keep faithful to a vocation, which in such cases often has the sense of a true mission, are condemned to dissipate a quantity of energy to face the conflicts between soul and body, race and character, inner dignity and rank, etc., that are typical of such civilizations and that the

make them, in a normal way, the homeland of all other vocations. But in these cases it is necessary not to forget **Seneca**'s words, who correctly understood some unhappy circumstances in which a higher spirit can find himself involved in the discomforts and dangers to which he is exposed, or who is in a risky mission or in the line of combat: the most courageous and worthy are chosen for such tasks, while the cowardly and weak can be left to the "comfortable life".

It is not necessary, in any case, to emphasize the importance that the preceding considerations, although unusual for the common mentality of modern man, have for the racial idea and, in general, for the philosophy of civilization, once these exceptional cases are put aside. If a destiny of millennia has led the West to circumstances in which it would be difficult to still find something truly pure, intact, differentiated and traditional, to establish firm limits again, by any means, even with the harshest, is an endeavor whose beneficial effects perhaps at first sight may not be perceptible to everyone, but that nevertheless will not be found lacking in subsequent generations, through the effect of the secret way joining the visible with the invisible and the world with the "superworld".

Posted on 2014-03-19 by Aeneas

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andrew on 2014-03-23 at 17:40 said:

Although I do not understand all of what is being said, nevertheless it touches me. I would appreciate some practical guidance on what can be done by those who do not feel themselves to be "in their own home".

19.4 The Solar and the Demetrian Races

Julius Evola begins his discussion of the spiritual races in his *Sintesi di dottrina della razza* with the Solar and Demetrian races.

He gives and almost Heideggerian take on the *avidya* teaching of the Vedanta. To recast it in these terms: The Hyperborean experiences a feeling of homelessness, arising from the ignorance or forgetfulness of Being, and finds himself thrown among beings.

This homeland, from the North, should be understood in a metaphysical, rather than a temporal, sense. Evola repeats the error we pointed out about the ritual between the priest and the king as described in the Brahmanas. Certainly the priesthood can decay (or has decayed) into a lunar type, but are (or were) there not sages or wizards with the solar powers described?

In order to move onto something more specific, we will say that the doctrine of the third degrees of race must essentially limit its researches to the sphere of influence of a given race of the spirit and of its primordial tradition, following its developments, the mutations (paravariations) and also the distortions in the cycle that coincides with them and in which they act and react in the confrontation with the influences of different races or new environmental conditions. Once research is circumscribed that way, we arrive at a more limited concept of race, corresponding to that of the various differentiations or articulations of the primary element of such a cycle. It is natural that likewise we cannot think of an atomic separation of the various “races of the spirit”: their differences are not such as to exclude relationships not only of derivation, but even of different hierarchical rank.

We already outlined the typology of races of the spirit, as far as it concerns the specific human cycle of the hyperborean race, in the second part of our work *Revolt against the Modern World* (with special regard to the properly traditional and spiritual aspect), both in the choice of the writings of J. J. Bachofen, and in the related interpretation of them in a racial sense, as understood in the previously mentioned volume we edited under the title *La razza solare*. For a fuller treatment, the reader is therefore referred back to these two works. Here we will give only a brief

schematic synthesis, necessarily lacking any justifying elements.

The solar or Olympic-solar race, corresponding to the hyperborean lineage and tradition, is to be considered superior and anterior to all the others in the cycle in question. It has as characteristic a type of “natural supernaturality”; spirit and power, calm dominance, and readiness for precise and absolute action, a sense of “centrality” and of “unshakeability”, and in its exterior effects, that virtue to which the ancients attributed a “numinous” quality (from *numen*), as superiority that imposes itself directly and irresistibly, that awakens simultaneously both terror and veneration, are marks of this “race of the spirit”, by means of which it is naturally predestined to command and, at the limit, to the regal function. Fire and ice are united in it as in the vague symbols of the original Nordic homeland and of the cycle in which it is eminently and primordially manifested: ice, as transcendence and inaccessibility; fire, as the radiant specifically solar quality of the beings who give, who awaken life, and generate light, but always from a supreme distance and almost with indifference, as in the wake of a boat, not through zeal, inclination, or human concern.

The ancient symbol of gold always had connections with this form of spirituality. In the political forms of the origins, it acted as the substrate to sacred, or divine, regality, i.e., to the union of the two powers, of the regal and priestly function, the latter understood in a higher sense that will soon be made clear. The symbolic designations of the “divine” or “celestial” race for it must refer to the absence of the dualistic sentiment in relations to supernatural reality, something that however is quite distinct from everything that, in the modern sense, is immanence or Promethean velleity: it is not about men who believe they are gods, but of types who naturally, through a still not dim memory of origins and a condition of soul and body that do not cripple such a memory, feel they do not properly belong to the terrestrial race, to the extent of believing themselves men only by accident, or through “ignorance”, or “sleep”. The two terms

vidya and *avidya* of the ancient Indo-Aryan teaching, that mean respectively “knowledge” (of the “supreme identity”) and “ignorance” (that leads to the self-identification with one of the forms or modes of being of the conditioned world), are to be understood exactly in this connection: when these are applied to a different human condition and a different race of the spirit, that is, when turned into “philosophical” terms, they lose every meaning and give rise to misunderstandings of various types.

The most recent “spiritual races” of the cycle, to which our contemporaries also belong, have as a prerequisite a division and a separation of the two elements of “spirituality” and “virility”—and also “transcendence” and “humanity”—that are synthetically reunited in the solar race. First of all, let’s specify the lunar race or demetrian race. According to the analogous relation, while the solar element is that which has in itself its own light and, in general, its own principle, the sun being, in such regard, the center of a given planetary system, the lunar element is that which instead receives or draws from another its light and principle. In the lunar race the sense of spiritual centrality is therefore lost, or through degeneration (the moon as the sun extinguished), or through passive crossbreeding with races of other cycles, of the “telluric” type, that have degraded its originary solar quality. The moon, as Bachofen points out, was also called the “celestial earth” by the ancients. There is therefore a sublimation of the law of the earth, the fate that is disclosed under the types of cosmic harmony and natural law: man here no longer feels himself the active center of spiritual reality: he is not this same reality, but rather the one who contemplates it, who studies its laws, who surpasses material action with contemplation and “tellurism”, but still does not reach spiritual action. The adjective “demetrian”, that we likewise give to this race, refers to a spirituality of a diffused, pantheistic, less dominating character that is pervaded by the sense of cosmic naturalistic laws and by a sacredness placed essentially under the feminine sign: spirituality that was precisely typical of the ancient demetrian cults. By extension, the priestly man is

lunar in opposition to the regal man, he is the man who in the face of the spirit behaves as a normal woman facing a man, i.e., with a sense of submission and devotion. It is then interesting to note that the ancient traditions associated what today would be called cerebrality or intellectuality with the moon, labeling instead the heart with the sun and referring higher form of consciousness to this. The lunar type is in fact also intellectual, the man of passive reflection who, as the word says it, moves only among “reflections”, among shadows of ideas and of things.

Therefore the characteristics of the lunar race are varied. In the political camp, wherever a division between the temporal and priestly powers is perceived, the lunar spirit inevitably arises. The lunar is the dominator who receives the supreme consecration of its power from the other, from a distinct priestly caste, which it does not give it to itself. In general, the lunar man has spiritually feminine traits. He lacks the feeling of centrality. In correspondence to the races of the body, he has the predominant nature of the demetrian race which is of the stock we called Atlantic-Occidental, in its prehistoric forms that lead us, e.g., up to the Pelasgic, Minoan-Mycenaean, or Etruscan civilization and to its last revival, among which Pythagoreanism returns. Such a race represents a decay of the hyperborean spirituality which appeared suddenly in the regions of Atlantis through processes of action and reaction, causing a series of other changes. Lunar elements can moreover be observed in the race of the man of the East (Alpine-Oriental) by some racialists—the psycho-anthropology of Claus designates this race as the “race of evasion” — *der Enthebungsmenschen* — something that corresponds visibly to a characteristic of the lunar man.

Posted on 2014-03-26 by Aeneas

19.5 Race and Death

In this short segment on death and race from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** returns to traditional doctrines. As expected, he makes clear that personality transcends race, i.e., the person creates race, but the race does not create the person. That is because the person transcends his material and biological conditioning, and has a dual destiny. On the material plane, he continues the race with his first-born son, the “son of duty”. Yet he also has a supernatural destiny. Hence, at a certain stage of life, a man may abandon, after having fulfilled them, his family duties and dedicate himself to that spiritual destiny.

He condemns biological racism as “telluric”, since it is restricted to the material conditions of life. Furthermore, such views are associated with the denial of an afterlife. This is the path of darkness, the southern path, unlike the path of light, or northern path, described by Evola. His last line is quite harsh: “they pass onto others the task for which they were inadequate.”

Those commenters who would dismiss us as just another “traditionalist” site saying the same things, are not very careful readers (as already has been demonstrated). On the contrary, few such sites adhere to traditional principles and promote lifestyles in conformity to Tradition, as this chapter demonstrates.

On the strength of what should be clear at this point, we would like to pause a moment to make precise the limits of the membership of personality to its race. In this regard, we will immediately point out the view that is unacceptable from the traditional perspective: it is the view of those who have conceived race as a purely biological-human, historical, and, to sum it up, only a terrestrial entity, and who now think that such an entity is the goal of every being who belongs to it, that nothing exists superior to race, since race is the origin of every value and they consider that the

idea of the extraterrestrial attainment and purpose of the individual is illusory and detrimental: “to remain faithful to land and race.”

We have already encountered and criticized this conception more than once. Opposed to it, moreover, we can appeal to the racist criterion for the evaluation of the “truth”; according to the various “races of the spirit” there are, in a particular way, similar conceptions of race itself—and there is no doubt that the conception we just pointed out can be “true” only for a telluric race, only the telluric man is able to support unconditionally such limited horizons. Furthermore in this telluric vision of race the assumption, that we have sketched out, of those “neo-pagan” racials also comes into play, since for them the only conceivable immortality would be that of the survival in the blood, in terrestrial descendants.

It is true that similar positions, today, are presented to us less on the basis of a theoretical value than of a practical and political value—i.e., they seek to consolidate the unity of the race of the people and to concentrate every spiritual energy of the individual into temporal and historical tasks that this entity has to resolve. But it is likewise true that the ancient Aryan civilizations, even with respect to terrestrial, heroic, and political achievements, had their greatness without feeling the need to appeal to these myths, recognizing instead rather different truths; it is quite evident, in fact, that this view about race recalls the *pitryana*, the “way of the South”, which we previously mentioned, which is opposed the *devayana*, the “divine way of the North”, that stood alone as defining the highest Aryan ideal.

And the theory of “double hereditary” is also related to such an ideal. Personality is not fully accounted for in historical-biological or horizontal heredity: instead, it appears as a principle that, in order to manifest itself in race (race meant here in the restricted sense), stands in itself beyond race but cannot be exhausted in it. To recognize race—as has been made clear on principle—does not mean to diminish the personality:

personality owes the living and articulated material for its specific expression to race and to as much as terrestrial heredity includes, through its self-manifestation and action. However, there is a conditioning that is neither passive nor one-sided in that. Every individual also reacts on race and his heredity, on the basis of his own most intimate nature; he develops the substance in which he is manifested, the form beyond, and it is in that way that interracial differentiation and that diverse purity or completeness of types are realized, things which we already mentioned and to which we will now return, with regard to its social effects: here it is a giving as much as a receiving. At the points where the highest equilibrium and adaptation are reached (equilibrium, according to our tripartite view spirit, soul, body, between the various component of the true race), there is as a culmination beyond which the personality has nowhere to go—it has nowhere to go along a horizontal or earthly line. His work remains and belongs along this line and his child is physiologically his lineage. But personality itself, if it reached such a peak, is “free” and can approach a perfection that is now properly supernatural.

This is precisely the most ancient Aryan conception, pertaining to those who do not belong properly to the group of spiritual leaders, conceptions that can also be found in the various views and legends of the Western Middle Ages. The scrupulous observance of the earthly laws of race, caste, etc. is prescribed, i.e., *dharmā*, to the point of complete compliance. Such laws also require the assurance of a lineage: life, which is received at birth, must be given back before death, with its own mark, to another being, and it is for this reason that the firstborn son is called the “son of duty”. After the “active life”, according to Aryan law, one can retire to an ascetic-contemplative life. And the Iranian-Aryan saying is rather expressive: the true task is not only to first procreate oneself on the horizontal line of terrestrial descendants, but also upwards, in the ascending vertical direction. In Western religion all these views were confused—above all, what is pertinent to the active life was sharply disconnected

from the contemplative life and almost always the truly traditional solutions were forgotten, according to which the law, which is not of this earth, prolongs, completes, and strengthens the law of the earth. But even more harmful than such confusions are the “telluric” racist views alluded to, in case they should be taken seriously and have a future. According to the traditional teaching of the Aryan peoples, the idea instead became fixed that the destiny and the dignity of the personality is essentially supernatural; this goal, however, acts as the highest motor impulse and the deepest animating force at the heart of the expression that race gives to the personality, therefore simultaneously raises race up to a limit, beyond which, after having left a sign of greatness, the same force is liberated and tends to act so that death is precisely the fulfillment—*telos*—a new birth—the third birth of the Indo-Aryan teaching.

Only the mediocre or failures among beings, i.e., those who are unable to completely fulfill the law and earthly duty, who perhaps think that they do not have an afterlife, that they have for their destiny, the self-dissolution into the confused vitality of race, into the collective and terrestrial substance of blood and heredity, surviving only in that way—in a rather relative sense of the word—to the destruction of their physical individuality, and passing onto others the task for which they were inadequate.

Posted on 2014-03-30 by Aeneas

19.6 The Group of Aryan Races

In this section from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** describes the third migration from the Hyperborean regions. This was the incursion of the Germanic tribes into the Roman Empire. He points out that they were a degenerate remnant, and were unable to continue the civilization of the Roman

Empire. It took several centuries for European civilization to re-emerge, beginning with **Charlemagne**.

Evola then sketches out the various branches that followed from the Hyperborean migrations. As we see, his understanding of “race” is more in line with the UNESCO understanding of a race as an “ethnic group”. As such, the Hyperboreans, or “Aryans”, include the inhabitants of the Indian sub-continent, ancient Egyptians, Persians, and even Amerindians and Eskimos.

By “race of the first level”, Evola refers to the race of the body, which is how most people conceive race. Of course, there are also two higher levels: the race of the soul and the race of the spirit. He rejects so-called “scientific” racism, since it deals strictly with the race of the body. For Evola, genetics cannot explain the soul and spirit of the various races.

As justification, he refers to the philosopher Emile Boutroux⁹, who denies that even the physical world is deterministic. This type of philosophizing is virtually unknown today, but was a dominant perspective among French and Italian philosophers at the time.

A fortiori, man, as a free spirit, can hardly be fixed and determined by his body or genetic makeup, despite certain tendencies or habits. Any attempt by “science” to “fix” a given race to predetermined characteristics or behaviors is ultimately deleterious.

The most recent of all is the emigration of the third voyage which followed the north-south direction. Some Nordic lineages had previously traversed this direction in prehistoric times; they are those, for example, who gave rise to the Doric-Achaean civilization and brought the cult of the Hyperborean Apollo to Greece. The last wave was that of the so-called “migration of the people” which happened at the fall of the Roman Empire and corresponds to the race of the Nordic-Germanic type. In this respect, we must make a very important observation. Those

⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/%C3%89mile_Boutroux

racas that spread in the north-south direction descend more directly from the Hyperborean lineage who last left the Arctic regions. For that reason, they often display, from the viewpoint of the race of the body, a greater purity and conformity to the original type, having had fewer possibilities of encountering different races. The same however cannot be said from the viewpoint of their inner race and traditions. Their self-maintenance, further from the sister races, in the conditions of a climate which had become particularly harsh and unfavorable could cause in them a certain materialization, a one-sided development of certain physical qualities and especially of character, courage, resistance, tenacity and inventiveness, having, however as its counterpart, an atrophy of the truly spiritual side.

That is seen previously among the Spartans: to a greater extent, however, in the Germanic peoples of the invasions that we may continue to call "barbaric"; barbaric, however, not in relation to degenerate Roman civilization, in which those people appeared, but in relation to a higher stage, from which those races had fallen by that point. Among the proofs of such an interior degeneration, or spiritual darkening, is the relative facility with which such races converted to Christianity and then to Protestantism. For that reason, the Germanic peoples in the first centuries after the fall of the Western Roman Empire, up to Charlemagne, were unable to oppose anything of importance in the spiritual domain to the crepuscular forms of Romanity. They were enchanted by the exterior splendor of such forms and easily fell victim to Byzantinism, they were unable to reanimate much of Nordic-Aryan existence, in spite of everything, in the Mediterranean world, that by means of a faith corrupted, in more than one aspect, by Semitic-Southern racial influences as soon as they later on gave form to the Holy Roman Empire under the Catholic sign.

Thus even some of the German racial theorists, like Gunther, had to recognize that, while trying to reconstruct the vision of the world and the type of spirituality characteristic of the Nordic race, had to refer less to the testimony included in the traditions of the Germanic peoples of

the period of the invasions – fragmentary testimonies, often altered by foreign or decadent influences in the form of popular superstitions or folklore – than to the superior spiritual forms characteristic of ancient Rome, ancient Greece, Persia, and India, i.e., of the civilizations derived from the two first waves.

For the combination of the races and traditions generated by these three currents, the first transverse (Ario-Nordic lineage), the next horizontal (Nordic-Atlantic or Nordic-Occidental lineage), the last vertical (the Ario-Germanic lineage) we can apply, not so much for true conformity, but rather on the basis of a usage that has become current, the term “Aryan”. In order to take into consideration the races defined by the most noted and recognized of racial theories of the first level, we can say that the trunk of the Aryan race, having at its root the primordial Hyperborean race, is differentiated in the following way. There is first of all, as the blond race, the branch called Nordic in the strict sense, that some differentiate into Teutonic-Nordic, Dalic-Falic, and Finno-Nordic sub-branches. The same lineage in its mixing with the aboriginal Sarmatian populations then gave rise to the so-called East-Europid and East-Baltic types. All these human groups, from the point of view of the race of the body, as was noted, preserve great fidelity or purity in respect to what can be presumed to have been the primordial Nordic, or Hyperborean, type.

In the second place, we must consider the races that are most different in relation to the original type, whether in the sense of its phenotype, or form, which the same dispositions and the same hereditary genes caused under the action of a different environment, or of mix-mutations, i.e., mutations produced by more accentuated mixing. It is a matter of predominantly brown types, of smaller stature, in which the dolicephalous is not the rule or is not too pronounced. We mention, using the terminology that is more in vogue, the so-called race of the man of the west, the Atlantic race that, as Fischer defined, is already different from it, then the Mediterranean race, from which, in its turn according to Peters, the vari-

ety of the Euro-African man, or African-Mediterranean is distinguished, where the dark component has greater prominence. Sergi's classification, according to whom these last two types more or less coincide, must be rejected and, from the point of view of practical racial theory, especially the Italian, is among the most dangerous. Equally dubious is calling the Mediterranean race, as Peters does, the Pelasgic: in conformity with the meaning that the word had in Greek civilization, it is necessary to consider the Pelasgic type, in a certain way, in itself, especially in terms of the result of a degeneration of some very ancient Atlantic-Aryan stocks established in the Mediterranean before the appearance of the Hellenes. Particularly, from the point of view of the race of the soul, this meaning of the "Pelasgics" is justified, among whom the ancient Etruscan people also are included.

In a certain way by itself is the Dinaric race because while it is very close to the Nordic type in certain aspects, in others it shows characteristics in common with the Armenoid and desert race and, like that which some racial theorists define properly as the Alpine or the Vosgic race, is prevalently shown brachycephalous: the sign of crossing that happened along other directions. The Aryan race of the east has, again, distinct characteristics, both physical and mental, through which it is distanced substantially from the Nordic type.

There is nothing contradictory, from the traditional point of view, in assuming in the doctrine of race of the first level the clarifications that the various authors make in relation to the physical and, in part, mental, characteristics of all these branches of Aryan humanity. Only it is not necessary to create too many illusions on the importance of all that, in the sense of establishing rigid limits. Thus, although neither white nor blonde, the superior races of Iran and India, and, although not white, many ancient Egyptian types can moreover be included in the Aryan family. Not only: authors like Wirth and Kadner, who sought to utilize recent studies on blood groups for racial research, were led to believe that

some North American Amerindian and Eskimo stocks were closer to the primordial Nordic type, than the greater part of the Indo-European Aryan races just noted. And in this kind of investigations, for example, it indicates moreover that the primordial Nordic blood in Italy has a percentage close to that of England, and certainly higher than that of the Germanic peoples. It is therefore necessary to not be fixated on rigid schemas and to think that, except for rather rare cases, the “form” of the original super-race, more or less latent, obstructed, overpowered, or exhausted, subsists in the depths of all these human types. Under certain conditions, it can reappear as predominant and shape a given type from itself, which proves them equivalent, even where it is least suspected, that is, where the previous races according to the schematic and static conception of race, would have instead made the appearance of a type of race, let us suppose, Mediterranean, Indo-Afghani, or Baltic-Oriental, seem probable.

Emile Boutroux, in one of his classic works *On the contingency of the laws of nature* has compared the regularity of phenomena that permits relatively exact scientific predictions, to the course of a river, whose waters follow a riverbed that however it itself hallowed out, so that they can modify it and in exceptional circumstances even abandon it. He considered natural laws as a sort of “habit” of things: what originally was also able to be a free act, in repeating itself, automatizes and mechanizes itself and ends up appearing to be a necessity. If that is valid for the laws of so-called inanimate, physical nature, it is of greater validity in respect to races. The proper description of racial theory of the first level, that, in certain authors, leads up to distinctions of an almost scholastic pedantry, fits in the measure to which the forces of races, so to speak, follow a type of law of inertia that automatizes them and fixes them in the state in which, at a given moment, they find themselves being. In these conditions the models drawn for each of the Aryan race fit, determinisms are verified, and sciences observe. At the moment in which the most original forces

begin to advance, these constructions demonstrate their relativity and an excessive attention conceded to racial theories of the first level and its “scientific” results can even end up bringing damage to the creative and evocative task of race theory.

Posted on 2015-04-15 by Aeneas

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-15 at 09:47 said:

Often with these writings on the Hyperborean Race and its various branches, I feel the need to break everything up and draw diagrams. The run-on sentences get a little too hard to follow. Its one of the troubles I had with a few of Evola's chapters. Excuse me while I go and decipher what is no doubt enlightening information that there is no way I comprehended with just one read.

Aeneas on 2015-04-15 at 12:43 said:

Please let us know of the most confusing passages. Evola does not write very pretty Italian. We've already had to break up several longer sentences into shorter ones in the translation, but perhaps that was not enough.

Bill on 2015-04-15 at 13:34 said:

Wouldn't it be more accurate to say that Evola doesn't reject scientific racism, but recognizes it as subordinate to the higher aspects of race?

Aeneas on 2015-04-15 at 17:05 said:

Bill, if you can provide some exact quotes to support your “more accurate” understanding, then we can discuss. But first of all, you'll have to explain what you mean by “subordinate”. You may also want to comment on the paragraph about Emile Boutroux.

obscure on 2015-04-15 at 20:38 said:

Let us just say that the distinction between ‘phenotype’ and ‘genotype’ is, from the highest point of view, superficial since both ‘types’ are phenomenal. The gene is just as much a symbol as the facial structure, but it possesses a certain technical value with regard to material analysis and the overall program of techno-science. If one starts from this point of view, the real discourse begins with this question: What is the intelligible essence ‘behind’ the symbol? In other words, how does one really ‘substantiate’ the phenomena?

The materialistic racist errs especially in his individualistic viewpoint. For individuals are always understood within some holistic structure. I couldn't study a race unless I studied them as a nation and not just a nation constituted in terms of 'culture' (or what the anthropologists mean by 'culture'), but in spiritual terms. Ultimately, this leads to the understanding of a people as a spiritual corporation. If one goes far in this direction then the type of 'evolutionary psychology' which amazes the multitude and the cliques will be seen in its full vapidty. But, to take such an intellectual path requires a certain individual decision which is not in the least bit suitable for all.

Mike on 2015-04-15 at 21:06 said:

Thank you so much for this.

Since you were kind enough to offer some clarifications, I am having a difficult time with this passage:

"... that proves the corresponding even where it is least suspected, that is, where the antecedent, according to the schematic and static conception of race, would have made instead the appearance of a type of race, let us suppose, Mediterranean, Indo-Afghani, or Baltic-Oriental, seem probable."

What is the "corresponding" and the "antecedent" that Evola is referring to?

And so I know I'm on the right track, in the first half of this passage (sentence), Evola is stating that for Aryans, a return to exact Hyperborean form (race of the second and third levels) is impossible to them, since they have all, to varying degrees, parted from the Hyperboreans in terms of race of the first level. Am I correct in this understanding?

obscure on 2015-04-15 at 22:00 said:

And to Cologero,

Thank you for publishing all of these items.

Aeneas on 2015-04-16 at 00:09 said:

Mike, I tried to clarify that passage a little bit with a re-translation. Curiously, that entire passage is missing from the German translation and replaced with a totally different one.

I believe he is saying the opposite: specifically, the qualities of the original race can reappear, often unexpectedly. We are all trying to pull too much out of one section. Evola will discuss Mendelian genetics (whose scientific validity he doesn't deny) as well the the problems with crossings, and so on.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-16 at 14:37 said:

"They were enchanted by the exterior splendor of such forms and easily fell victim to Byzantinism, they were unable to reanimate much of Nordic-Aryan existence, in spite of everything,

in the Mediterranean world, that by means of a faith corrupted, in more than one aspect, by Semitic-Southern racial influences as soon as they later on gave form to the Holy Roman Empire under the Catholic sign.”

You really have to pick this apart to find out what is actually being said. I'm sure everyone appreciates all the effort you put into translation. This is invaluable stuff.

Max on 2015-04-19 at 13:52 said:

The Nordic-Germanic wave were unable to continue civilization writes Evola, however their intent was to keep civilization alive in face of roman degeneration and they managed to restore the monarchy with new northern blood. Evola says they descend more directly from the polar center than the remnants of the earlier migrations. They were physically pure, but “asleep” from long periods of dark isolation. The material conditions took its toll, a certain heaviness in the inner life of the nordics. They are sometimes prone to materialistic cults of the body or external phenomena, often a type of spiritual lethargy can be seen as counterpart to an outer activity. It is then a question of illuminating the shadow cast on the north.

Evola does not equal Hyperborean to exclusively Indo-european, so it makes one wonder if the Indo-european speakers should actually be regarded as part of the same wave to a degree, or if a classification according to language is irrelevant. In the case they are seen as the third wave spread out over several millennia, the chronology should move back in time to make the origin of the earlier waves prior to the end of the ice-age. The Germanics represent the most northern population and consequently exhibit some tendencies developed to an extreme. One of the characteristics is a high degree of individuality, whose negative shadow manifested in northern protestantism. Individuality could be seen as a fault or virtue depending on the expression it takes and we should strive to bring out the positive quality in each “character flaw” while remedying its negative. This particular flaw actually seems to be highly developed in Evola himself, for better or worse. In a positive expression, rather than just denying authority, it could for example take the form of an inviolable accountability before God above else, the northern ideal of every man being his own King, or a healthy disregard for false authorities.

There is definitely an anarchic tendency in the northern soul, explored by Jünger for example, but it is coupled to a strong social conformity advantageous in sparsely populated areas. The modern world brings out the negative side of both, so what gives rise to a democratic leveling by “conforming” should instead be realized in a higher state by humility, a certain concealment in a calm and ordered behaviour and distaste for expressing every whim arising from below. A negative development would be to repress all impulses becoming almost mechanical as is a Germanic stereotype.

Many ethnicities and physical races contains the “higher” race latently, and contrary to earlier periods it does not express itself “naturally” and integrally. We have to distinguish various influences acting upon us and uncover some that have been obfuscated. This is a practice in

ordering ourselves. We can not simply accept everything as “a part of me” indiscriminately as is the modern habit, but have to consciously explore our “parts” and choose the higher over the lower. It means that race is not something we just possess passively but have to acquire through effort and introspection. It would not be surprising if an inner change shows in outer appearance too, not necessarily in hard facts and measurements but as the subtle expression that is impossible to calculate or catalogize. It is said that initiates tend to recognize each other, supposedly not due to hair colour or the shape of the nose though.

I am wondering if the classical civilizations of the ancient world could actually be attributed to a “recombination” of different Hyperborean voyages sharing a common past to then reunify after being separated for a long period. In any case, the Germanics were those stubborn enough not to migrate much south, but stay and gradually be surrounded by darkness rather than subject themselves to the violent revolutions of the south; it has to be admitted as some form of asceticism.

19.7 The Sexes and Race

In this and in the following section, **Julius Evola** deals with the traditional view of the sexes. He will justify the notion that the division into sexes has a corporeal, psychic, and spiritual component. His opinion is quite “politically incorrect”. Oddly, he had to deal with PC in his own time: the German translation omits all references to Germany or Germanic people.

Text On the bases of the above-mentioned ideas, it would also be necessary to return to the question of hybrids, bringing the sexes into the discussion. Even here we encounter a curious contradiction in race theory, that such questions are almost never posed. Contradicting this principle, claiming the differences of all human types as subjected in equal measure to the same biological laws that race theory considers in the same way, so it seems never to have been considered that normally the inheritance and the power of race can have a different weight according to whether it is about a man or a woman. Anyone who faced this problem had to resolve it directly in reverse, by supposing, again on the basis of simply biological

considerations, a greater power of conservation of the race and the type in the woman.

From the point of view of traditional doctrine, it is exactly the opposite that is true in the case of normal humanity. This doctrine, if worthy of the rather minor attention of what today some of the most theatrical and insignificant grant to biological considerations, would furnish some rather useful suggestions for a problem of no small importance, which is the technique for the elevation of relatively inferior breeds through various cycles of heredity. Thus, in the most ancient Indo-European code, the Laws of Manu (Manava Dharmasastra), the transition of a non-Aryan into the caste of the Aryans is possible after seven generations of crosses maintained on the male line. This number seven also reappears in other traditions in analogous circumstances, while, in regard to the cycle of an individual human life, it is the number of years that are necessary for a periodic rejuvenation of all the elements of the body according to scientific research.

In this situation, the Laws of Manu stipulate what must be considered as a cornerstone for the question from the traditional point of view: male inheritance cannot be put on the same level as the female, because, in principle, the former has the “dominant” quality, as it is called in Mendelism, and the latter is “recessive”. Therefore, when the woman is of the higher race, her higher inheritance is overpowered in the mixture, while the superior male inheritance, in the opposite case, is not necessarily contaminated, except in limit-cases or exceptions, and except what we will say about being man. “Whatever are the qualities of a man with whom a woman is united by legitimate rite, she acquires them like the water of a river united to the ocean” (Laws of Manu IX, 22).

And again (IX, 33-36): “If one compares the creative power of the male with that of the female, the male must be declared superior because the ancestor of all beings is distinct from the male characteristics. Whatever type of seed that is thrown in a field prepared in the appropriate

season, this seed is developed in a plant with particular qualities, which are those of the male seed.”

By sacred tradition the woman is declared to be the soil, the man is declared to be the seed; the production of all corporeal beings takes place through the union of the soil with the seed. In some cases the seed is more distinguished, and in some the womb of the female; but when both are equal, the offspring is most highly esteemed. On comparing the seed and the receptacle, the seed is declared to be more important; the offspring of all created beings is marked by the characteristics of the seed. Whatever seed is sown in a field, prepared in due season, a plant of that same kind, marked with the peculiar qualities of the seed, springs up in it.

Completing the image, all the more, we can concede that when the field is not prepared and the season is not suitable, the male quality will be obstructed in the descendants or will wilt, or certainly it will dry up, but it could never happen that the seed of a palm might come from a juniper plant through a miraculous power of the soil or season – i.e., by analogy, of the woman and the psychic conditions of a sexual union. As we have deliberately revealed, as long as we have the normal world in view, that is always presupposed by every traditional teaching.

Thus, in order to know what one must think today in this regard, rather than consulting the biologist, it is necessary to clarify the extent to which the modern world can indeed be called normal in regard to the condition of the sexes. The answer, unfortunately, can only be negative. The modern world no longer knows what it means to be a man or a woman in the higher sense. It is moving toward a lack of differentiation of types that is already very visible on the spiritual plane and, from it, here and there it seems to be translated onto the physical and biological plane giving rise to worrisome phenomena. In the West, masculinity and femininity are considered as things simply of the body, instead of qualities, above

all, of the inner being of the soul and the spirit. In this respect, in the West, little more than nothing has been known about the polarity, the gap, the different function and dignity of the two sexes for some time. And so, very important problems regarding race are today considered in their exterior and consequential aspects, rather than in their internal and substantial aspects. For example, they are very concerned with the demographic problem and they create every type of institution for hygiene and social assistance and the increase of the race in the strict sense, but they ignore the fundamental point, which is the meaning of the relationship between the sexes and the precise imperative that whoever is born a man, is a man, and woman, a woman, in everything and for everything, in the spirit and in the body, without mixing and without attenuation. Only in this case the traditional teachings have validity and open up almost unlimited possibilities for the initiatives of selection and elevation of the races through adequate crosses and hereditary processes. Certainly not in the case in which, like today, we see in regard to being man or woman, a still more oblique mixing than in regard to being of one race or another: in which some beings are men in the body but feminine in the soul or in the spirit, and vice versa, while being silent about the spread of sexual and psychical inclinations of a really pathological character.

But at this point we have to remind the reader of what we already wrote about it in *Revolt against the Modern World*, while touching on the death of races. Since descendants are not formed through combinations of hereditary elements made in a laboratory or in appropriate state institutions, but derive from the unions of men and women, it would be logical that, as the premise to every active conception of race and every discrimination of one race or another, the race of the male and the race of the female be defined and separated, in the same corporeal, psychic, and spiritual completeness, by which we formulated the theory of the three levels of race theory.

Moreover, we note a unique circumstance which confirms the fact

that races, which have biologically preserved more of the Nordic type, are sometimes found inwardly at a greater level of involution and degeneration than others of the same family: we mean that some of the Nordic peoples—Germans and Anglo-Saxons—are those in which the traditional relationships between the two sexes have been greatly subverted. So-called woman’s emancipation—which only means her mutilation and degradation in reality—has in fact begun from those peoples and has had the greatest hold in them, where in the Roman peoples, even if only due to bourgeois and conventional reflexes, something of the normal and traditional way of relating is still preserved, in this regard. The height then is reached when some foreign theorists exalt the triviality of terms like *compagno* and *compagna* and so-called “respect for woman” as an alleged characteristic of the Nordic race, not suspecting in the least that by doing so, they simply echo an abnormal state of a relatively recent date, while they assume every conception based on the proper distance, polarity, and different dignity of the two sexes as the Asiatic prejudices of the inferior races of the South. It is necessary to recognize that if such distortions are assumed as principles, the path taken would lead not to the reawakening and the reintegration of the pure Nordic type, but to a further involution—in the direction of a trivialization of an inner leveling of the types—of what still remains in the Germanic peoples.

Posted on 2015-04-23 by Aeneas

* * *

Cologero on 2015-04-24 at 08:03 said:

*Feminism in Norway*¹⁰ confirms what Evola wrote in regard to the feminist movement in the Scandinavian countries.

argusandphoenix on 2015-04-24 at 21:23 said:

¹⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Feminism_in_Norway

It's interesting that the British Empire had its two "greatest" sovereigns, Queen Elizabeth & Queen Victoria, as the apex of their monarchy. The males seem to have been largely forgotten or vilified. I remember coming across a reference to this, vis a vis Evola and "race", and will try to find it. Contrast this with the Middle Ages, in which "Good King Richard" or Henry II are far more important figures. The ancient sources I'm familiar with do indicate that the Teutonic races, when encountered by Rome, had differing conceptions of male-female relationships. I think Caesar remarked on the power and influence held by women among the Celts, as well. It's troubling that the roots of this stretch back almost to pre-history. For what it's worth, Caesar in the Gallic Wars comes across as mild and even-handed and "frank" by comparison with the perfidious Celtic tribes which were migrating around Western Europe.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-25 at 15:53 said:

"In this situation, the Laws of Manu stipulate what must be considered as a cornerstone for the question from the traditional point of view: male inheritance cannot be put on the same level as the female, because, in principle, the former has the "dominant" quality, as it is called in Mendelism, and the latter is "recessive". Therefore, when the woman is of the higher race, her higher inheritance is overpowered in the mixture, while the superior male inheritance, in the opposite case, is not necessarily contaminated, except in limit-cases or exceptions, and except what we will say about being man."

Fascinating. So even during miscegenation, the male genes overpower regardless of race. This presents an interesting study for the various combinations of miscegenaic birth.

@Cologero – Say it ain't so that you're actually throwing in the towel on Gornahoor! May I ask why? Have you simply run out of material to work with, or just a general moving on. I've found your analysis of Evola's work to be invaluable to my own.

Cologero on 2015-04-26 at 00:28 said:

Mark, I don't believe Evola is referring to biological heredity through "genes", but rather the inherited soul and spirit of the race. The next section of Sintesi might expand on that idea.

There is no lack of material, quite the contrary. I'll make clear soon why it is necessary to end one phase and begin another. Moreover, the actual personal work with the Gnosis group is much more important, so it needs to be expanded.

Nexist418 on 2015-04-26 at 23:55 said:

Will these be collected together? Were they released in order? If not, will a table of contents be provided?

Cologero on 2015-04-27 at 07:54 said:

Yes, Nexist418, the chapters will be collected together and published as a book. They are not being released in order, and there is a table of contents online if you bother to look for it.

Can you tell us what value this work has for you?

Nexist418 on 2015-04-27 at 13:31 said:

I wanted to read it in order. I did not find the TOC when I looked, but I will look again.

Lu Dongbin on 2015-04-28 at 09:36 said:

Strange situation regarding the Germanic relationship between man and women and the overall masculinity and heroism of the Germanic people in relation to that of Southern Europe, Italians, etc. which Evola himself commented on in many places. From his writing on Disraeli and the British Empire:

“England possesses a monarchy, an almost feudal nobility, and a military caste which, at least up until very recent years, showed remarkable qualities of character and of sang-froid.”

Or from Seyyed Hossein Nasr recounting his meeting with Evola:

“While he extolled the ancient Romans and their virtues, he spoke pejoratively about his contemporary Italians. When I asked him what happened to those Roman virtues, he said they traveled north to Germany and we were left with Italian waiters singing o sole mio!”

So how is it that the masculinity, heroism, and Roman virtues Evola admired are at once concentrated to a greater degree among the Germanic people since the Fall of Rome, and yet these same people have a degenerated relationship between the sexes in comparison? What would be spiritual source or cause of this odd state of affairs?

It seems that Evola was certainly correct about his overall view on the matter, especially regarding “further involution” when we take a look at the current state of affairs in the Western world today and especially in Germanic and Nordic countries regarding feminism, etc.

19.8 The Masculine and Feminine Races

In this chapter of *Sintesi*, **Julius Evola** demonstrates that the male and female are equivalent to different races. This is not simply the obvious corporeal differences, but extends also the the soul and the spirit. The female spirit is undifferentiated whereas the male spirit is differentiated.

He appeals to **J J Bachofen**’s writings on ancient gynocentric civilizations which had “promiscuity, communism, mother

right, general equality as their characteristics”. He mentions two possible outcomes:

- an awakening, a reaffirmation, and a vivification
- dissolution and debasement

From this perspective, the Western nations are moving toward a more gynocratic form. This is not *imposed*, but rather accepted and even chosen, by a race in decline, that is, those who have followed the second possibility. There is still the first possibility.

The Masculine and Feminine Races The notion of the “race of man” and the “race of woman” is not a totally gratuitous extension of the concept. We believe, in fact, that in order to truly take these things into account one should not disregard at all the observations made in Otto Weininger’s notable work¹¹, especially in two points. The first is in the determination of the type of the pure man or pure woman, as the basis for measuring the “quantities” of one or the other that are found in each individual and then to govern oneself in a compliant way. The second is in the daring idea that the existing relations between true man and true woman correspond analogically to those that exist between the Aryan and Semitic races. For Weininger, man is to the woman as the Aryan to the Semite. Weininger did the research on feminine qualities that appear as an exact match to those typical of the Semite and the Jew. One such research is tendentious to a great degree. Weininger, being half-Jewish, was began especially to lose heart and degrade even without wishing it—he did not find the true value of the woman where he should have found it. Nevertheless, his views are still valid; the idea that, from the point of view of a normal and differentiated conception of the sexes, man and woman

¹¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/SexAndCharacter.pdf>

almost manifest as the expression of two different races, if not pure opposites. It is therefore a serious defect of descriptive and typological racial theory to not take that into account when making the effort to identify and describe the characteristics of each race, while not asking if certain qualities, normal for the masculine type of a given race, continue to be so regarded when applied instead to its feminine type.

In order to remedy this defect, naturally we need to consider the sexes also in their psychical and spiritual aspect. From that point of view, it is certainly absurd to conceive, for example, as normal that the “Nordic” woman embodies the same values typical of the pure Nordic man—that is to say, everything that is calm and dominating superiority, solarity, sense of distance, active detachment, connected to a readiness to attack and whatever else we find out. Without directly referring to the Semitic people (unlike Weininger), if we do not want to end up at leveling and therefore mongrelization, it is instead desirable and normal that the same Nordic woman has her own psychical and spiritual qualities, which have a central position in different, non-Nordic races.

Moreover, once the race of the body, or anthropological race, where the female racial differences are well-known and obvious, is omitted, the distinctive characteristics of the women of the various races are much less pronounced on the level of the race of the soul than in the case of the male. In fact, then, at the level of race of the spirit, there is often a true undifferentiation. The real support of the race of the soul and, especially of the spirit, is the man. It is especially in him that the principle of differentiation falls, while the principle of equality is reflected more in the feminine element. Not by accident did the ancient traditions associate, in cosmic analogy, the feminine element with that of matter or unformed power, hylé, dynamis, and the masculine, instead, with the celestial principal of order and individualization. Still less is it an accident that the ancient gynocratic and matriarchal civilizations, as an immediate consequence of the preeminence accorded to the feminine principle in its various, ma-

ternal or aphroditic forms, had promiscuity, communism, mother right, general equality as their characteristics. See *The Solar Race* by Bachofen. Strictly speaking, opposite to every man worthy of this name, the true woman that our ancestors considered significantly as “woman of race”, had to present herself as something dangerous, as a foreign principle that attracts, insinuates herself, and demands an inner action: almost the same type of reaction of which we said speaking of cross-breedings, where foreign blood puts the type to the test and gives rise to two possibilities: either to an awakening, a reaffirmation, and a vivification, or else to dissolution and debasement. In the first case, the man maintains himself at the peak of his purpose and, according to traditional teachings, his qualities permeate and persist intact in his progeny, as the “dominant” character. In the second case, in a form more or less disguised, he will undergo at least an internal degeneration of the type. Uncontrollable forces will take the upper hand in the processes of heredity, the protection of the race will become something problematic, until the limit-case is realized, that is, the return, in new forms, to the spirit and promiscuity of the gynocratic civilizations formed by the anti-Nordic races and from the degeneration of the Nordic race.

Posted on 2015-04-29 by Aeneas

* * *

Boreas on 2015-04-30 at 10:04 said:

The Gornahoor wordpress site seems to have been made private; what do I need to do to be able to read the article?

Cologero on 2015-04-30 at 12:12 said:

Boreas, we plan to leave it open for certain windows. Eventually, it will probably be made private for those interested. Since only 20% of readers are clicking through, it really doesn't matter.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-30 at 18:11 said:

Correct me if I'm wrong, is Evola saying here that a 'race of the sex' dichotomy is spiritually present during the procreation event and that in Modernity a feminine, degenerative descent is occurring rather than a masculine, heroic descent (that being proper to Tradition.)

If so, what is the solution to this problem, which is obviously not medical or genetic? Will this simply return to the old masculine sexo-racial line of descent once the World of Tradition is restored, or does something active have to be done as it pertains to child-bearing and conception?

Átila on 2015-05-15 at 11:38 said:

Read the book "The Myth of Matriarchal Prehistory" By CYNTHIA ELLER

Cologero on 2015-05-15 at 12:35 said:

Sorry to have to make a public example of you, Atila, but that is not how to write an intelligent comment. If you want to help your fellow human beings, you would have mentioned specific points from the book and then applied them to the post you are commenting on.

I read the amazon page for the book as well as some comments by those who actually read the book. As one reviewer wrote:

"Firstly, it must be understood that Dr. Eller was not out to prove that prehistory was in any way universally patriarchal. Dr. Eller is certainly aware of the many matriarchal, matrilineal and matrifocal prehistorical societies."

This more or less confirms, or at least is consistent with, Evola's thesis.

19.9 Race of the Soul

There are many cases of people who are exactly of the same race of the body, of the same tribe, sometimes even, brothers or fathers and sons, of the same blood in the most real sense, but who nevertheless fail to understand each other. A barrier separates their souls, their way of feeling and seeing is different, and the common race of the body and common blood can do nothing about that. A possibility of comprehension exists, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, only where a common "race of the soul" exists.

Since man is an ensouled body, his outward physical characteristics,

or race of the body, are insufficient to determine him. That is, the body is neither a chunk of matter, nor an animal, so DNA will fail to define him. Keep in mind that by “race”, **Julius Evola** does not mean how it is understood in the USA, with its emotionally charged history of slavery, apartheid, and civil rights. Rather, it is much more specific, so he can speak of a Nordic race, an Italic race, and so on. This is more obvious in languages like Italian or German, since the word for “race” in those languages is also used to refer to “breeds” of animals.

Applying phenomenology to the experience of race, we see, as did Evola, that sharp and deep divisions separate even those of the same physical race. These are not merely accidental qualities, but are constitutive of the person. These divisions often make mutual intelligibility impossible, without the effort to transcend such differences on a higher plane. There are two all too obvious consequences to this. First of all, any attempt to appeal to some racial solidarity of the first level will necessarily fail. Secondly, these divisions at the soul level will not be resolved by discussions or “debates”. **Fabre d’Olivet** confirms this:

Nature does not make men equal; souls differ still more than bodies.

From the esoteric perspective, what is of interest is why people hold certain views, not the views themselves. For example, a convinced materialist or atheist holds his view with a passionate intensity, since he is unable to conceive of, or experience interiorly, any other possibility that makes sense to him. Bracketing out for the moment the possibility of a spiritual or intellectual conversion, people remain locked into certain fixed patterns of soul life.

Evola also provides a different understanding of “purity”. Physical purity is impossible, or at least, undesirable. There is a small, but not negligible, mutation rate in any population. Since most mutations are deleterious, an endogamous population will decline over the centuries. Purity,

then, can only mean the adequation of corporeal and psychic qualities. Thus for example, on the one hand he can praise certain Nordic qualities, while also mentioning the degeneration of the Nordic race. Note that these qualities are all on the plane of the soul and spirit, not the body.

The takeaway is that successful movements depend on a core group of “like-minded” people, if that is your goal; great leaders instinctively understand this. As Evola explains,

A possibility of comprehension, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, exists only where a common “race of the soul” exists.

For example, desirable qualities may include “calm and dominating superiority, solarity, sense of distance, active detachment”. Those that have such qualities actively can then identify those who may have them virtually. However, an indiscriminate mixing, a “big tent”, won’t come to much beyond putting some people in positions of power for its own sake. The telltale sign of degeneration is the failure to differentiate, which is also the hallmark of the Kali Yuga. Differentiation at the level of the soul is more important than the body. Evola concludes:

it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he “is of another race” and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He “is no longer ours”.

A leader needs to make that determination. Of course, the most fundamental differentiation is that between a man and a woman, who relate to each other not just physically, but more importantly at the soul and spirit level. Nowadays, even that differentiation is losing force. Many, today, even fail to differentiate between humans and animals. The text follows.

Let's now return to the clarification of the three levels of the doctrine of race. We consider a theory of the race of the soul and a typology of the soul of the races as the doctrine of the second level. Such a doctrine needs to identify the elements, in their primary and irreducible modes, that act from the inside, causing groups of individuals to manifest a consistent mode of being or "style" as far as acting, thinking, and feeling are concerned. With this we arrive at a new concept of racial purity of a given type: it is no longer about, as in racial doctrine of the first level, seeing if a given individual manifests a specific group of physical characteristics or even character traits, that makes him conform to the inherited type, but it is about establishing if a given individual's race of the body is the adequate expression or confirmation of his race of the soul, and vice versa. If that is confirmed, the type is pure also in the sense of the investigations of the second level.

That then complements the results of the of the first level, because it no longer considers the various corporeal characteristics in the abstract, in a simple classification, which could even be disguised, instead of in living faces and individuals. It seeks instead to understand their secret, that is to say, what they express, the function for which they are used and by way of which, from case to case, they might even mean something different. As we already noted, a nose of a given form and an elongated, dolicephalous skull can meet both in a type of the races derived from the Nordic stock, or in an exemplar of the African race: but it is obvious that the two cases do not have the same significance. Besides, it is quite possible that a given type has predominant characteristics, e.g., Mediterranean in the anthropological race of the body – so much so that the racial doctrine of the first level would assign him precisely to the Mediterranean race of the man of the West: nevertheless the latest research may notice that these Mediterranean traits, in the type in question, are assumed in a different function from what would normally be expected. The type that we are talking about uses them instead to express a soul, an internal

attitude that is not Mediterranean, but, for example, Nordic or Near Eastern. That gives an absolutely different expressive value to the same traits and leads sometimes to certain distortions or alterations of the exterior Mediterranean element that are almost imperceptible in the research of the first level or are considered irrelevant and unimportant, while for the research of the second level they represent many ways to understand the "inner race". Here physiognomy, the study of the meaning of the human face, has an important role: it will however develop in a different direction from the preceding, which conceived each individual separately instead of as a member of a given superbiological community, of a given race of the soul.

On this higher plane, anthropology and paleoanthropology become valuable aids for the research into the original racial elements that entered into composition, were superimposed, or clashed at the dawn of civilizations. For the highest tasks of the race theory, it is insufficient to have considered the presence, for example in Italic origins, of a given number of typical skeletons and skulls and, integrating such researches with the archeological ones, to be able to affirm fundamentally the existence of an ancient pure Nordico-Aryan Italic human type. That would not get beyond an area of a museum. It is necessary, furthermore, to make this type speak, to penetrate into what a given corporeal form expresses, or what a given human structure is the symbol of. This is impossible without taking into account the field of the racial doctrine of the second level, and even to a certain extent the third level, disciplines that work with other methods of research and utilize another order of documents and evidence.

We can consider the so-called *Rassenseelekunde* or psychoanthropology of L. F. Clauss as racial theories of the second level, insofar as it concerns his methods and general criteria. The necessity of such research was made clear by Clauss with convincing examples. For example, he considered the phenomena of comprehension. Actually, there are too many

cases of people who are exactly of the same race of the body, of the same tribe, sometimes even, brothers or fathers and sons, of the same blood in the most real sense, but who nevertheless fail to understand each other. A barrier separates their souls, their way of feeling and seeing is different, and the common race of the body and common blood can do nothing about that.

A possibility of comprehension, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, exists only where a common “race of the soul” exists. Subtle elements of an instinctive sensitivity come into question at this point. While for many years nothing was suspected, in a given circumstance it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he “is of another race” and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He “is no longer ours”. Usually, they spoke of character in this case. The expression is vague. There is not, in fact, a “character” in general but there are different modes of appearing of the dispositions of character conditioned by the inner race. For example, the way of being “faithful” of a Near Eastern people is different from that of a man of the Nordic or Dinaric race. The way of conceiving heroism by a Mediterranean man is different from that of a Japanese or a Russian, to use generic expressions and while not getting into precise classifications inherent to a doctrine of the race of the soul.

Posted on 2015-05-10 by Aeneas

* * *

Alistair Fraser on 2015-05-11 at 06:38 said:

“it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he “is of another race” and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He “is no longer ours”. ”

Is it possible that by the power of early conditioning , the impulse that exists to express the genuine race of ones soul can be hindered greatly , so some people appear to be one type but are actually a repressed other type imprisoned withing their societal cage , but yet even as their true expression has been overwritten, blocked and given little room to sprout, still there may be signs of it that seep out through gesture and energy presence perceivable by others of similar ilk and so the “virtually quality ” confirms

Paulo on 2015-05-11 at 15:49 said:

well being born and raised in brasil,the eye of the hurricane kali yuga

i cant fail to notice the effects of this kind of mix

mix of the body,mix of the soul and mix of the sexes really,destiny had put me in a position were the chalenges will not give up on me!!!

Mes idées politiques, by Charles Maurras

20.1 His Political Ideas

Ideas belong to no one; they are what they are.

CHARLES MAURRAS, *My Political Ideas*

Tonight, I'm outlining the plan for translating a series of essays by Charles Maurras. This fulfills a promise and responds to a challenge. The promise was made in the comments section of Taki's Magazine¹ a few years ago when it used to be a conservative resource instead of the journal of choice for hip urban racists that it is today. The challenge is from **Alain de Benoist** to compare and contrast the ideas of Evola and Maurras. It appears no one has the will or the talent to accomplish that.

That still does not fully answer the question of "Why bother?" In his prime, Mauras was highly influential, not just in France, but also on the Iberian peninsula and across Latin America. Echoes of his thought still

¹<http://takimag.com/#axzz27L592q87>

reverberate in Traditional Catholic circles through the SSPX² and TFP³, although they are far from the mainstream. Yet for the modern world, his ideas are not only irrelevant today, they are positively distasteful. Nevertheless, there may still be salvageable concepts if we leave aside the more contentious parts of his writings.

The French Republic prides itself on its secularism, but Maurras himself was a secularist. The difference is that Maurras includes the entire history of France in his vision, while the Republic looks is concerned with the moment. Like the liberals, he also claims to base his worldview on science. However, for the liberal, the individual is the atom, and family, culture, and nation are the results of his will which he may freely choose or reject. For Maurras, family, culture, and nation come first, they are the source of the individual's identity and hence demand his allegiance. For the liberal, there is no fixed human nature since he creates his own identity. Maurras, on the other hand, based his understanding of a fixed human nature on the philosophy of Thomas Aquinas.

There is no compromise possible here. To the modern mind, Maurras' ideas are necessarily restrictive, as they limit his freedom in the present, and they are reactionary since they tie him to the actual past whereas he wants to be liberated for the possible future. For them, this exercise can serve as a museum for discarded ideas, useful for pedagogy, but not much else. The real challenge, then, is for the so-called New Right. This will serve as a touchstone to evaluate its doctrines which hardly differ from liberalism considering its commitment to a functional polytheism and its tolerance for the aesthetically ugly and the unnatural. We hope there may still be those looking for ideas on the Right that derive from traditional sources rather than from foraging in the weeds of postmodern thought for imaginary gems as does the New Right.

Maurras was a poet and a member of the prestigious **Académie française**

²<http://www.sspix.org/>

³<http://www.tfp.org/>

until his postwar conviction of collaborating with the enemy. Hence, his prose is written in beautifully expressive French so it is a shame to have to translate him as I will be unable to capture that.

Maurras was not often a systematic writer, so it is difficult to find a representative sample of his work despite his voluminous output. We considered two works. One was written late in his life, *Order and Disorder*, which fits into a theme we have been exploring recently. However, it is not broken up into sections so it is not so suitable for a blog. The other is *My Political Ideas* which does attempt to lay out his ideas somewhat systematically. Next Sunday, we will start with the chapter titled "Principles" and then decide if it is worthwhile to continue. These can and should be compared to some of the metaphysical principles we have been writing about. Like Abraham, I am hoping for ten good men to be able to provide insightful and relevant commentary on these essays, although in reality I would be satisfied with one. The forthcoming principles are:

1. Truth
2. Strength
3. Order
4. Authority
5. Liberty
6. Right and Law
7. Property
8. Heritage
9. Duty of Heritage
10. Tradition

Posted on 2012-09-23 by Cologero

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Matt on 2012-09-23 at 23:37 said:

Excellent. The translation of Maurras' writing on Comte you provided a couple of years earlier was great so I'll be looking forward to this.

Both Maurras and Comte remain quite unique in their defense of traditional social-political structures while respectfully remaining non-committed to affirming the spiritual reality that the structures are intended to reflect. Though even then, Maurras became a committed Catholic near the end of his life, and Comte appeared to take a quasi-mystical outlook in his outlook with venerating the great predecessors that came before us.

Hope your health has improved.

Avery Morrow on 2012-09-24 at 00:52 said:

"Tradition means giving votes to the most obscure of all classes, our ancestors. It is the democracy of the dead." – Chesterton

Drieu on 2012-09-24 at 17:17 said:

"However, for the liberal, the individual is the atom, and family, culture, and nation are the results of his will which he may freely choose or reject."

This is inaccurate and flat out stupid to anyone who has actually bothered to research the history of ideas. Not all liberals and leftists hold the same views, just like not all rightists hold the same views.

Immanuel Kant and Denis Diderot, both radicals in their time, did not see individuals as atoms but as "cultural agents", i.e. that man was unavoidably shaped by his culture. The same applies to Johann Gottfried Herder, the philosophical founder of nationalism, who supported the French Revolution.

The anarchist Mikhail Bakunin wrote that "Nationality is not a principle; it is a legitimate fact, just as individuality is. Every nationality, great or small, has the incontestable right to be itself, to live according to its own nature. This right is simply the corollary of the general principle of freedom."

Even among economic liberals, Milton Friedman explicitly states in *Capitalism and Freedom* that the basic component of society is not the individual, but the family.

Hell, Maurras's own ideas on nationalism (as well as Maurice Barrès's) were primarily shaped by Hippolyte Taine and Ernest Renan, both agnostic liberals (though of a conservative bent more akin to British Toryism).

There are many more examples, but those are just some prominent ones off the top of my head. You need to drop the inane traditionalist platitudes and straw men about some monolithic "Enlightenment" or "liberalism" and actually figure out what the other side thinks. Especially since most of the ideas attributed to the "Enlightenment" (secularism, republicanism, written constitutions, equality before the law, civil liberties) were organically developed well before then in the religious sphere by devout Christians, not by deists or skeptics.

"We hope there may still be those looking for ideas on the Right that derive from traditional sources rather than from foraging in the weeds of postmodern thought for imaginary gems as does the New Right."

Except that the right, including *La Vera Destra* to which your dear Evola refers, has always incorporated the latest philosophical trends into its thought. By absorbing some postmodern currents, the *Nouvelle Droite* has not at all betrayed the legacy of people like Joseph de Maistre or Juan Donoso Cortés. And considering that postmodernism thought aligns with certain motifs of the right, such as a suspicion of the Enlightenment narrative, disdain for rationalism, and rejection of an historical telos, I don't even see it as a necessarily corrupting element.

For the record, I'm not a leftist or liberal, but someone who is tired of seeing people who are nominally on my side repeat the same nonsense again and again and make themselves look like idiots in the process.

As for Maurras, I'd go for one of the early works like *Enquete sur la monarchie*. You forgot to mention that his views changed a bit after WWI. In the early period, he advocated decentralization, regionalism, and flirted with unorthodox economic doctrines such as syndicalism. After the war, he shifted towards support for centralization while still retaining some affection for the provinces, and became more reconciled with capitalism and less interested in activism. The latter two changes ended up driving away many of his most talented disciples who were much more dedicated to the earlier radicalism, such as Georges Bernanos, Lucien Rebatet, Robert Brasillach, and Thierry Maulnier.

Andrew on 2012-09-24 at 18:10 said:

And that is not the tradition we are talking about.

Cologero on 2012-09-24 at 19:03 said:

Drieu, I'm afraid we differ in method. In order to understand "liberalism" or any "ism", it requires an understanding of the principles that govern it. Hence, we here reject out of hand the empirical approach of asking those who call themselves "liberal" what their positions are on various issues. This fails for two reasons. The first is that focus turns to secondary issues. The second, and more important, is that few men are really aware of the principles and motives that drive their thought. In our language, we are interested in the "thesis" rather than the "hypothesis". Although I have hinted at that distinction previously, I will have to expand on it at a later time.

The sign of a great thinker is that he knows and can express his first principle. These are the men we need to focus on, not a hodge podge of random quotes. For example, Francis Bacon explicitly rejected "formal causes", which is antithetical to any Traditional understanding of the world. This has consequences in what you call the "history of ideas" even if later developments were not apparent to Bacon himself. Yet, this rejection is considered normal today even to the extent that very few men even realize that it underlies their entire worldview. We will deal with this again soon, probably on Wednesday.

Kant took this further by denying knowledge itself. Given Bacon's premise, Kant's conclusion absolutely follows. Yet this is opposed to any Traditional world view. So for Kant "culture" is an empirical reality that "shapes" an individual; unfortunately, that is not a very profound observation. The Traditional worldview is that a culture is a transcendental reality, something Kant denies necessarily as unknowable. It more than "shapes" the individual; rather the individual is unthinkable without it.

So, yes, Drieu, we try to "figure out" not just "what" they think, but rather "how" they think. And that is very often not exactly how they see themselves. In other words, what are the presuppositions of their thought? And, of course, we mean consistent thought since very few men are able to think consistently.

If this project has no appeal to you, you are welcome to leave and hang out wherever there are no stupid people or idiots. Traditional thought is always considered stupid, superstitious, and ignorant by the modern mind. Since you appear to have a modern mind, I don't see how we are on the "same" side, not even nominally.

I am always amused by readers who want to tell me what to write on this blog, or what to translate, or what I omitted. Obviously, I omit quite a bit, since my contention is that a single blog post needs to be narrowly focused. If you prefer that I translate *Enquete sur la monarchie* for you, cut me a check for all the time required and I will move it to the very top of my priorities. Otherwise, I will select texts based on my own purposes and interests.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-24 at 19:31 said:

As someone whose life has been influenced by Maurras' ideas himself, I will gladly do what I can to assist in this project.

Let me ask Cologero, we know already the distinction between the traditional and modern minds. The new right seems to think the postmodern mind is something else and an improvement upon the modern that can lead back to traditional thinking. Do you agree and if not why ?

Izak on 2012-09-24 at 23:02 said:

I'm not really seeing the willingness to discourse with postmodern theorists as any indication that the New Right is eo ipso postmodern, or informed by liberal values, or even definable

in any meaningful way as of now.

The medieval Catholic justification for glossing heretics like Origen was that “even in a heap of dung one can find a nugget of gold.”

Like most intellectual movements, the New Right will be defined by whatever influence it manages to concretely produce. Because that’s what politics is all about.

Cologero on 2012-09-25 at 00:17 said:

Jason-Adam, what I will be looking for are comments on the texts, either explicating the text, relating it to other ideas, or putting it into a broader context. I don’t plan to “debate” the New Right. I really do understand the allure of postmodernism; I have experienced it firsthand. The fundamental point is that if the knowledge of ultimate reality is already known, has been known since ancient times, and is handed down as tradition, then why the quest for novelty?

I suggest to the advocates here of the new right that they explain why Benoist ultimately rejected Maurras ... that would be useful and would add to the store of knowledge.

The other part of the project is to compare and contrast Maurras and Evola; comments in that regard are welcome. Moreover, I am curious why Benoist thinks it a worthwhile project as well as the reason neither he nor anyone else has followed through with it.

Avery on 2012-09-25 at 01:33 said:

I employ vulgar sources wherever they may help people understand, and resort to fleshing out the Guenonian depths only when there has been a clear disruption of our common sense.

In this case, I see a clear connection between Chesterton’s romantic definition and Cologero’s statement, “Maurras himself was a secularist. The difference is that Maurras includes the entire history of France in his vision, while the Republic looks is concerned with the moment.”

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-25 at 20:25 said:

I could write an essay explaining clearly the exact differences between Evola and Maurras so I will gladly comment when the texts appear. Let me just say one thing for now – that ultimately Maurras and de Benoist are looking to different pasts, one to the Middle Ages, the other to ancient Greece. I conjecture de Benoist has not gone through with the project because he would have to explicitly state then that he does admire mediaeval civilisation.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-25 at 20:26 said:

forgive me, it should say de Benoist does NOT admire mediaeval civilisation.

Dominion on 2012-09-26 at 00:50 said:

The issue is one of form rather than essence, in my understanding. While it is true that the ultimate principles already exist, the way in which they manifest are not. This differs between

Traditional civilizations; Christendom did not look identical to the Caliphate, which did not look identical to old Rome, and so on. Traditionalists in the New Right, particularly Dugin, use postmodern thought to critique the basic principles of Liberal civilization and thought, which is similar to what Maurras sought to do with positivist philosophy ("What our fathers did through custom and feeling, we ourselves pursue it through reason and will, with the assurance and clarity of science.") When Faye (who is admittedly not a Traditionalist) talks about reconciling Evola and Marinetti, I interpret this as taking the ultimate principles which we already know and seeing how we can live by them in our current, temporal and changing world. Tradition of principle must not be made equivocal to traditionalism of form. As Guido de Giorgio once said:

"Tradition is absolutely different from traditionalism: one is an eternally fecund living patrimony, rich with infinite potentialities in all times and circumstances . . . the other is but sterile residue, an inefficient, self-enclosing concreteness impossible to adapt and lacking all energetic and creative force. Tradition is clearly opposed to traditionalism, just as truth is opposed to commonplaces."

Cologero on 2012-09-26 at 07:29 said:

Well put, Dominion. The phrase you quoted also explains my own interest in the thought of Maurras and Comte. So are you saying that the Maurrasian critique of liberalism is no longer effective and that the postmodern critique may be more fruitful?

Dominion on 2012-09-26 at 14:46 said:

Considering the influential role that positivism plays in the current order, particularly in the scientific sphere and even to a great extent in the social sciences, I think that both the Maurrasian and postmodern critiques of liberalism would prove useful. Personally, although I find the postmodern critiques interesting and useful, I am more inclined towards rational and scientific perspectives and might thus find Maurras more rewarding. I don't have much background in his thought, however, and thus await your translation.

20.2 Principle I: Truth

From Chapter II, "Principles", of *Mes Idées Politiques*, by **Charles Maurras**.

Yes sir, yes ma'am, because "speech is hard", its efficacy will be sweet; because the book is "bitter to the tongue", it will be invigorating and healing.

The signposts raised up on the road don't show their direction in a sweet and florid style: they flaunt the style of their utility. Clear, direct, insistent, and authoritarian, they don't say: "if I am mistaken", they don't doubt themselves, they do not excuse themselves from roughly throwing the direction arrows and the mile markers into the eyes of the people who pass. But does the traveler complain about it? As long as he has the heart of a philosopher, he gives thank to the author of profitable brutalities which he does not even feel tyrannized by.

It is his choice to slow down or step on the gas, to follow to change his direction. The milestone says what it is in clear terms, and what is necessary to take into account. The more that precise facts limit thought and, because of that narrow limit, the more that fantasies of the heart, wishes of the imagination, the needs, the amenities and personal interests will obtain safety and will be able to give themselves a career. An uncertain direction, a fact, whether vague or false, while appearing to flatter the arbitrariness of the walker, will restrict the freedom of his movements, of his rest, they will diminish his real powers, for the risks attached to the consequences of an indifferent or capricious itinerary will be increased by the insufficiency of his knowledge.

It is a great error to think that *contingencies*, as they say, accommodate themselves more easily to a lax and vacillating principle: to the contrary, all indecision of principles complicates the study of the facts, as well as their treatment; uncertainty thus is inserted at the sole point from where a little light could come to them, to the complexities of the earth shadows in the sky will be added.

Truth, a harsh but clear sun, is content to establish from above what is necessary to know and think before acting. It shows the good, it marks out the bad; it distinguishes the proportions following which the one and the other confront each other and mix in the infinite variety of our human events. Once so enlightened, man is far from having resolved the problems of practical life, but he has something to resolve them and if, as

happens to him too frequently, he can choose only between evils, he will better discern which will be the least, his effort can be applied to avoiding the worst; that makes perhaps the greatest point of the government of oneself and others.

Not only is truth defended by what it has that is naturally general, elevated, abstract, and foreign to man, but in order to decide to ascend to it, a general impulse [*élan*] of thought beyond the present, a full calculation of the future, is necessary. In order to adhere to this truth that veils everything, in addition an effort of will imposing silence on many instincts is necessary.

Truth (I do not say sincerity, I say the whole truth, the agreement of language and thought with external realities), can still be something besides the highest delight of intelligence: it is the empowered sovereign, it is all powerful force.

Sincerity is not the truth. The most correct intention and the firmest will cannot create what it is not.

Let us not underestimate any virtue, but let us give justice to the obvious virtues. There is no smile, grimace, or chattering of beautiful spirits that can stand against them. The decisions that they lead to are serious, sometimes painful, in the life of the spirit; exterior life doesn't always accommodate them, but the service that they render is such that they prevail over everything.

Truth is of value in itself. But there are bitter truths and sweet truths. There are useful and dangerous truths. There are those that are necessary to reserve only for the wise, and others which are suitable for the nourishment of all.

Some purely oratorical and mystical revolutionaries can believe that, fable or truth, it is always good enough for the people! We believe that the people have no needs less demanding than the elite. Truth is as necessary as bread. The historico-political lie poisons a people as absolutely as potassium cyanide.

A disdain which is not expressed does not take effect. To the contrary, an error and a lie that one does not take the trouble to unmask acquire little by little the authority of the true.

Complete text: <http://www.royaliste.org/spip.php?article520>

Posted on 2012-09-30 by Cologero

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Dominion on 2012-09-30 at 14:45 said:

"Sincerity is not the truth. The most correct intention and the firmest will cannot create what it is not."

"To the contrary, an error and a lie that one does not take the trouble to unmask acquire little by little the authority of the true."

With those two statements Maurras has unveiled the secret to every victorious lie and legend's success and the key to its power. If a single man or an entire people cannot bring itself to tear the pretty mask off the lies which keep them entranced and captive, they cannot progress. Indeed, they may well fall deeper into the mire.

Jason-Adam on 2012-10-01 at 17:52 said:

This text, written in the flowery French style of which Maurras was a master of, is not something easily grasped by those used to modern Joe Friday "just the facts ma'am" styles of writing. What Maurras is saying here though is just exactly that – before we can figure the world out we need to begin with facts, things we are certain of through proveable means, to avoid being trapped by the lies of the power hungry.

Attila on 2012-10-21 at 02:24 said:

I disagree with the characterization of "flowery French style"—Maurras' writing is highly nuanced, and not reductionist—unlike so much coming from Anglo-Saxon circles.

20.3 Principle II: Force

To the principle of Truth, Mr. Maurras adds the principle of Force, without which the former is impotent. Yet, Force must be guided by sound judgment.

There are despotic weaknesses, malicious stupidities, and losers worthy of being so, as there are beneficent winners, heroes of energy and power to whom humanity owes immense progress, giants of health and strength who have merited the blessing of the past and the future. Force in itself, bared of its adventitious and incidental characteristics, force which is still in the service of neither good nor evil, naked force and by itself a good, and very precious and very great since it is the expression of the activity of being. It is idiotic to want to ignore its benefits.

In order to deter harmful sophism, one cannot grow tired of repeating it: force by itself, reduced to itself, is a good. That does not mean that it always does good or there is not a greater good.

Good in itself, it is also capable of the greatest benefits like defending the country, punishing crime, avenging honor, or protecting innocence.

But as it is capable of everything, it needs a rule as the primary guaranty and, put into the service of the best cause, an order. Order contributes to render it entirely and completely effective. But order also restrains it in the service of what it claims to serve; order prevents it from turning against what is dear to it in spite of itself. All disordered force is exposed to this peril.

It is up to Reason to moderate force, that is to say, the sense of measure and intellectual proportions, there is this civic sense which adds to the higher orders of the spirit I don't know what principle of cordiality, bonhomie, I would dare to say, of charity which does not desire the death of the guilty, but which desires, and very much desires, his rectification.

There remains also that clarity, that sincerity, the natural continuation of the rectitude of the spirit which permits neither hypocrisy nor disguise, but which marches straight ahead of itself, head high and chest bare, this tranquil serenity which belongs to those who have freely assumed noble missions.

The theories of force are not at all in contradiction with the doctrine of solidarity and, anyway, human mutual aid needs to be strong to protect

itself or to be protected against violence.

If there may be in the world force which is of value, it appears indispensable for it to be strong; if there is something else, if, as we think, there is something better, and much better, it is still more necessary to be strong and powerful to save or to develop these true goods.

Posted on 2012-10-07 by Cologero

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Audrey on 2012-10-07 at 23:02 said:

I do find your posts to be a good mirror of self-reflection, contributing to the 'educatedness' of my self-observations and regulations of behavior. I would say, that real education should approach, at least in part, a similar mode, as opposed to stuffing slots in people's heads with ideas and fighting for intellectual real estate. Namely, paragraph #4 from the bottom, I have always wondered why every time I am asked about punishment under UCMJ, such as rank degradation, or jail, I always request instead rectification measures. However, in the Army, this is considered a weakness. I guess their idea of teamwork, is more about pulling like a donkey, and not about actual collaboration.

Logres on 2012-10-08 at 05:22 said:

Bishop Joubert (as quoted by M. Arnold): "Force & Right rule the world – Force till Right is ready". Maurras' style and manner of thought comes across very strongly, even in translation. Thank you.

Sati Shankar on 2012-10-11 at 22:48 said:

Force, is in fact a double edge sword, neutral in itself as such, in the hands of some one capable in using it. Now it depends on the its user that it is used to protect or induce Good. History has enough to cite its misuses. The question is, whether to engineer (by force) a society where corrections will not be needed which depends, dangerously upon the user of force, Or to let the Tradition work so that no engineering is needed at all. Force kills spontaneity and freedom, most often.

The second point relates to the Force as inner energy, that is indispensable for an individual to attain his goal.

Graham on 2012-10-14 at 01:21 said:

"... neutral in itself ..."

Maurras says that force is good in itself. That makes sense, since “it is the expression of the activity of being”. This closely parallels Evola’s remarks about virtue and power which are discussed elsewhere on Gornahoor.

20.4 Principle III: Order

Although he described himself as a pagan, the influence of Thomism on **Charles Maurras** is quite clear. Being and Order, for him, are coterminous. I don’t know the extent of Donoso Cortes’ influence on Maurras, but Maurras also rejects endless discussion, claiming that to debate order, which has a mathematical-like certainty, is a waste of time. To choose disorder (or chaos) is to choose death and annihilation. Man, such as he is, needs to hold firm to his fixed reference points (or road signs?); modernity, on the other hand, wants to knock over every one of them. Who is left to still remember them and celebrate them on the calendar?

As no face could exist without the features that surround it and the line which contains it, as soon as the Being begins to move away from its opposite, as soon as the Being is, it has its form, it has its order, and it is that same thing from which it is limited that forms it. What existence is without essence? What is Being without law? In all the degrees of the scale, the Being weakens when order diminishes; it dissolves as soon as order no longer holds.

Order is only a means. It is a point of departure. To reestablish order restores an atmosphere favorable to the action of the spirit as well as that of the body. That order makes work possible or better. It guarantees it duration, supplies it with assistants or protectors.

Humane rule does not consist in killing, destroying, nor annihilating the subject whom it must, on the contrary, develop while maintaining him on his path.

The necessity to *subordinate* in order to coordinate and order, there is no rhetorical nonsense that can go against that mathematics!

To be conformed to order shortens and facilitates work. To contradict or debate order is to waste time.

Order, they say, is a higher justice.

For historical and political order, *to have* it is nothing, *to hold* it is nothing, if one is not also in a position *to keep* it.

In war as in peace, order is precious among all the goods. With its fake hardness, with its apparent strictness, it saves lives, as it measures and makes use of efforts.

The soldier who complains about the order is the enemy of himself. The blind kindness that joins in with this soldier is an enemy of the soldier. An unconscious and involuntary enemy; what does the intention matter if it sends him to his death?

Precisely because he is ungrateful and weak, because forgetfulness and fickleness are normal for him, man notices early on that it is necessary for him to look again, in Time that is constantly changing, for some points of fixed reference, for invariable points of support, whenever he wants to realize a plan of any importance, or he wants to be faithful to his goal and his love.

I deliberately write this last word, which only expresses the sentiment of persons; for if strong passions have their anniversary rites, if a return of certain dates leads to a natural return of thought to the joyful or sorrowful mysteries of the life of the heart, or even more so, when it is no longer a question of a sole being, but of a society, a religion, a cause, then will it be necessary to immortalize happy or gloomy memories on their dates.

Do not forget: this is the starting point of all order and all law.

Posted on 2012-10-14 by Cologero

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Jason-Adam on 2012-10-16 at 00:10 said:

Indeed, order is the basis of all life. Without a basis there is no society, as we see in our days as all forms of collective identity are in decline.

Cologero on 2012-10-16 at 17:08 said:

It is important to not that, for Maurras, order not only determines what a being is, but also what it is not. This is important for his subsequent analysis.

Lucius Cornelius Sulla on 2017-05-22 at 18:47 said:

How is Charles Maurras pagan? He was pagan after he lost faith, but he was then involved in politics it is only after Dreyfus affair, that he become engaged in political affairs, but I never i read anywhere that he considers himself pagan when he was defending church and become monarchist, or can some point me to were I can find that sentence?

Cologero on 2017-05-22 at 19:09 said:

Obviously, dude, you read it here. Unless you consider here to be Nowhere⁴.

Lucius Cornelius Sulla on 2017-05-25 at 19:17 said:

you misinterpreted my question: how charles maurras is pagan?.It is last thing I could call him, he clear would describe himself as positivist and classicist.

Cologero on 2017-05-25 at 21:12 said:

OK, Sulla, from the OED definition of pagan⁵, the most reliable source:

A person holding religious beliefs other than those of the main world religions.

So that is the sense I used the word. You are correct; he would have described himself as a positivist, at least after his youth. His first book, *Anthinéa*, about his visit to Athens, was originally titled "Pagan promenades". Eventually, however, he embraced Positivism and achieved a rapprochement with Catholicism.

At that time, he became coy about the designation "pagan" or even "atheist", but that need not concern us. Yet if he was a classicist, then he was a pagan in the same sense that Plato was a pagan.

Since the book under discussion was written much later in his life, I will change to text to read: "he was often described as a pagan", or something like that.

But I hope that excessive pedantry does not obscure the main point. To wit, the recognition of a cosmic order, i.e., "natural law", is possible for pagans, so it is not solely a Christian dogma.

⁴<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pesIGuV9DDk>

⁵<https://en.oxforddictionaries.com/definition/pagan>

20.5 Principle IV: Authority

From Chapter II, "Principles", *L'Autorité*, of *Mes Idées Politiques*,
by Charles Maurras.

Nature of Authority The idea that authority can be constructed from below would not have come into the head of our grandparents who were wise.

It is not made, in truth, from below nor from above.

Authority is *born*. In individuals, families, peoples, it is a gift which the will of men has very little to see.

The most vulgar observation is totally in accord here with the Catholic text *omnis potestas a Deo*⁶. In one of the oldest "Letters to Françoise", Mr. Marcel Prevost reminds his niece how, after having passed her baccalauréate, she knew she was obliged to show the secretary of the Faculty her notes, regardless of the rules of the University and the laws of the State. "You have a great gift, Françoise, it is authority," observed Uncle Marcel sententiously. Did he believe so well what he observed. Did he follow through what he observed?

Authority, seized thus at its birth, is something simple and pure. Certain human types possess it, the others are devoid of it.

In leaving aside those who know only how to submit, the man of liberty, recognizable in the pride of a heart that nothing crushes, differs from the one who is characterized by dignity and inspires above all respect: the man of authority differs from the other two. His liberty imposes itself naturally on the liberty of others, his dignity is radiant, it leads and carries. It is neither respect nor admiration—inert feelings—it is an enthusiastic submissiveness which responds to him.

Far from being irrational, instinctive wishes move more quickly than conscious reason, and perceptive logic is not more lacking than the pas-

⁶All power comes from God.

sions of a great love. The author of *La Vita Nuova* tells us that at his first sight of Beatrice his heart begins to beat in him impetuously, which **Dante** develops and explains in these terms:

The spirit of life that reside in the most secret vault of the heart begins to tremble with so much force that the movement is made to be felt again in my smallest veins and, trembling, it says these words: '*Ecce deus fortiori me, qui veniens dominabitur me.*' Here is that God stronger than I, he is going to dominate me. Then, the animal spirit, which is hidden in its high vault where all sensitive spirits go to carry their perception, began to be greatly surprised and, addressing itself particularly to the spirits of the sight, says these words: '*Apparuit jam beatitudo nostra.*' Our bliss has appeared.

It is necessary to reread all that penetrating and poetic analysis which is of an age where the laziest sophisms from Germany and the Jews [Freud] had not imposed on the European West a ridiculous philosophy of the unconscious. What was unconscious, one brought it to consciousness. What eludes the first grasp of reason, a more subtle reason pulls out in the night.

This explanation of the strong premonitions of a loving heart, such as Dante gives us, can be applied to the instinctive transports of an obedient soul before the authority that he judges to suit him: a quick judgment grants him to conceive that it will be good for him to serve that force conceived as useful and beneficial, whose order presages protection, justice, or victory. There is a taste in it of the beginning of a mysterious good. By what sign is it known? That is the great difficulty. Certain military leaders make themselves obeyed by genius, others by bravery, others by a type of mystical faith. The exterior and brilliant gifts of a Condé can add the magic of the example to it, but some generals carried on litters have radiated the same prestige.

Henry Fouquier, who was part of the *Thousand* [who conquered Sicily as part of the unification of Italy], loved to tell that the aging Garibaldi inflamed his band by saying to them in a whisper, from the base of his carriage where rheumatism confined him, a simple: "Gentlemen, move ahead!" So many passions of hope and confidence sleep in the human soul! Little suffices a little in order to make them rise from it, but this nothing is indispensable and no convention, no arrangement, no artifice of will can take the place of the first natural gift.

Authority is of the same order as virtue or genius or beauty.

The most learned cogs have never replaced authority *born* . . .

The French of the tenth century had settled down around the race which, for a hundred years or more, had always defended them effectively. Where did that race come from, from what heaven had it fallen on the country? Immigrant Saxons or native rural lords or even descendants of bourgeois Parisians, scholarship does not stop discussing it. They do not discuss the authority acquired little by little by their fortuitous power nor the benefit of their dynasty nor its constant happiness.

It expresses for centuries a power or protection and increase, it represents everything that the heart and spirit of men, isolated or reunited, wait for, hope for, and believe about a true authority.

True authority is naturally wise; an insane authority is not conceivable. The idea of authority does not mean, indeed, only the power and the great power exercised by a man or a group of men, but all the more, it confines the knowledge of the object on which this power is exercised and applied. The more the authority believes, the more this knowledge itself is developed. The more authority is perfect, the more it assumes the clarity and the exactitude of that knowledge, and the more it proportions itself in it.

Authority would not be an eternal political necessity if, at the same time as that guiding instinct which constitutes the bottom of the soul of the leaders, there did not exist in the soul of the subjects and the citizens

an instinct of obedience, "spirit of following," said Richelieu, who is the living expression of the greatest interest of the crowds: to be governed and well governed, in a good sense, with firmness.

The Conditions of True Authority: the Education of the Leaders

The development of what is called modern civilization tends increasingly favour material forces over moral forces.

If we rely on it in order to achieve social justice or the improvement of morals, we set ourselves up for considerable deceptions! That civilization equalizes neither wealth nor conditions: on the contrary, its complexity never ceases increasing the differences between men. It does not liberate: the authority of science and industry will tend instead to establish new races of slaves. Finally, far from pacifying and reconciling, its needs are so demanding that they seem to intersect at a right angle, to destroy or deny everything that is human.

Neither the game of supply and demand which continues capitalism, nor the principle of nationalities which created our armed peace, nor class warfare, by which the insurgent masses respond to the starvation brought by capitalism, would know how to spread in the modern world an ambiance of a sheepfold. We would be rather be pushed back among the antisocial wolves and pressured to live, by categories of class or race, according to the custom of the wolves. The inherited veneer of customs peels off little by little, the vestiges of general traditions disappear, and the statistics of criminality show what inevitably results from it.

Consider the progress of athletics (which could make, in a well ruled society, an admirable school of discipline and elegance), the passion (otherwise excellent in itself) of winning and prevailing in violent games, the new instruments created by science and those who apply them: this proliferation of ancient forces and these new means put in the service of powers without restraint only have to give their lessons: the moralist, with a thousand signs, sees brutality reborn.

As to the language of our contemporaries, I speak of the best, of those who are elevated, if not highly elevated, men and women, that it comes back to primitive onomatopoeia, if we “let come to grips with life”, forces, destinies.

In the regime of brutality, there are neither leaders nor orders, nor even order, without its necessary hierarchy which is lacking. The massacres of September had leaders. It is not orders that the executioner lacked from the Duke of Enghien or Bishop Darboy. It is not necessary to complain about our times in this regard.

Class differences are more marked than they have been for a half century, the arrogance and despotism of the authorities would rather be on the way to grandeur. What is lacking in the directing spirits is that light which is the sign of the right to lead. The leaders remain and their power increases, but those are barbaric leaders left to the impulses of passion or interest. They command, they lead, because their troops will it, but they command poorly and lead wrongly, the mistake being learned.

They themselves also are, still more than these proletarian masses for which they feign a very vivid interest, the really underprivileged.

The intellectual and moral treasure, whose task of collecting that inheritance belongs to them, was disdained and finally lost. Thus the spirit of liberal democracy used it, which disorganized the country from above; borrowing the language of progress, pretending to possess the promises of the future, it abandoned the sole instrument of progress, which is tradition, and the only seed of the future, which is the past.

The history of the Third Republic can suffice to show the harm that there can be to surrender legislation, armies, the economy, diplomacy, and all the forms of authority and influence to those spirits without direction and without culture, to those hearts without self-mastery and without dignity.

The symmetric history of conservative England, where everyone who governed and served in the top jobs had undergone the hard and long

intellectual and moral preparation in the old universities, with a lot of Greek verses and Latin discourses, confirms how certain it is that the real happiness of the people depends on the good training of their leaders. The sword of the conqueror, the baton of the founder, even the pencil of the stockbroker, all these modalities of strength and cunning can and must bring about great benefits to the condition of having passed the necessary time under the strict rule of the educator. Everything that they take away from the rule, is not taken away from the rule nor from the authority which holds it: that is entrenched in the entire mass of the people; it is the nation and the human race who are the first dispossessed.

The lessening of the common intellectual and moral assets is a loss for everyone: the least will lose as much as the great.

They will even lose much more than the great, because that which perfects, refines, elevates the great, constitutes, to the profit of the others, the most precious, and often the only, guarantee against the abuses of power which greatness is precisely exposed to. Certain nuances of virtue and honor, certain beautiful persuasive accents of the voice which commands are the direct fruits of the sole education.

It is like that of religion.

Whoever said that a religion was necessary for the people spoke complete nonsense. Religion is necessary, education is necessary, a set of powerful brakes is necessary for the leaders of the people, for is advisors, its chiefs, due to the very function of direction and restraint that they are called to keep from it: if the passions of the human beast are to be feared for all, it will be to dread in the proportion that the beast will play with stronger powers and will be able to devastate a more extended field of action.

All liberty is not suitable in every State; each State depends on its historic antecedents and its geographic position like each man on his ancestors and his country. Salutory and tutelary dependencies, since they gave life, sustain it, and conserve it, and whoever rejects it, dies. Liberty

varies with time and place, but this is no State which can last without a sovereign authority.

Therefore, if we want to speak with exactitude, it is not liberty which is general and necessary, an ecumenical, basic, and human right; it is authority.

The Exercise of Authority The property of power resembles other properties; it results from work, from work done and “done well”. Totally naked force can be applied for good and for evil, for construction, for destruction. When it did the good, when it constructed, it has merit from it, it has prestige and glory from it, it also sees the birth from it of this product which is called authority.

A power vacuum resembles the vacancy of a field. Whoever wants it, takes it; whoever is able to, holds onto it.

When there is a power vacuum it is, as Joan of Arc said, a great pity for the kingdom. And it is a great misfortune. To seize power in that case, if one has the strength, is simply an act of charity and humanity. A people needs a leader like a man needs bread. Not only, in such a hypothetical situation, is the right of first occupancy established, but there is a rigorous duty, a strict obligation for those who *can* occupy. When citizens are threatened by the enemy, it is necessary to command them if one can do it. When disorder is in the street, it is necessary to restore it back to order if one has the means.

Power is not an idea, it is a fact, and one believes in this fact when it makes itself felt; all criticism by the world can do nothing against the strength of a conqueror.

Most moralizers, who have confused minds, judged that power corrupted the heart of man. When power is elevated and lasts, when it lasts a little, the effect is totally the opposite; the learning of responsibilities matures and their experience perfects, rather than ruins, them.

Posted on 2012-10-21 by Cologero

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Jason-Adam on 2012-11-02 at 15:02 said:

Here is an interview deBenoist gave where he discusses Maurras in depth.

A case could be made from an Evolian perspective that Maurras did not go back far enough i.e. he defended l'ancien regime while forgetting that the actions of the French monarchy against the empire and papacy are what began the slide to destruction. Evola did say that the French monarchy brought on their own doom by their absolutist, anti-feudal and anti-Empire policies.

Dante was also opposed to the entire Capetian house and saw them as nearly usurpers. (see Purgatorio)

Does anyone know if Evola actually wrote about Maurras ?

Cologero on 2012-11-02 at 22:22 said:

I don't have time myself to find that passage. Where did Evola write that "the actions of the French monarchy against the empire and papacy are what began the slide to destruction"? Then we will be in a position to discuss it.

When specifically did those actions occur? I will be making a case soon that the "ancien regime" defined Feudal society through its understanding of the tri-functional division of society as pointed out by Dumézil. If the monarchy rebelled against the spiritual authority at some point then, yes, that would be indicative of the "degeneration of castes". However, I just translated a text where Maurras explicitly said that the temporal leaders were to undergo a religious education (i.e., the spiritual authority).

Evola did say that he believed what well-bred men believed to be healthy and normal prior to the French Revolution, i.e., the "ancien regime". That is the motivation behind the Maurras translations, viz., to highlight those healthy and normal beliefs.

Given this, I think Benoist's case falls apart.

I have just one complete article by Evola on Maurras from *La Vita Italiana*: "The defeat and future of France according to Action Francaise". I'll try to get it translated before the end of the year.

In other books, there are some references in passing . I'll gather them together at some point in the near future.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-03 at 01:47 said:

1. I foolishly forgot to post the link to the interview, here it is

http://www.alaindebenoist.com/pdf/entretien_charles_maurras.pdf

2. Evola's anti French remarks are all throughout part II of *Revolt against the Modern World*. He specifically attacks Phillipe IV's attack of Pope Boniface VIII, also Francois I warring with Emperor Charles to the point of even allying with the anti-Christian Turks, Cardinal Richelieu's

centralising policy which destroyed the independence of the local aristocracy, and then Louis XIV's continuing wars against Austria and the empire.

Also in *Men among the Ruins* Evola said Italy should move away from France and closer to Germany.

These are not my opinions, I am merely trying to provide Evola's thoughts as I understand them.

Cologero on 2012-11-04 at 11:23 said:

Yes, Jason-Adam, that is the interview that "inspired" the series on Maurras. Unfortunately, there are too many elements for a comment box: the diverse views of Maurras, Evola, and Benoist himself, not to mention the view from Tradition.

As you point out, discrete historical events over the course of centuries can be pointed out, as Evola did. Or else, we can look at these events from the point of view of Tradition: which were informed by a sense of order, and which by an opposition to order. To make things manageable, we therefore reject out of hand the notion of an "Evolian" critique; we are only concerned about the critique of Tradition.

Specifically, then, a fundamental point is the degeneration of castes: how do Evola and Maurras see that. Of course, Evola was explicit about that, and he did not see the "ancien regime" as disordered; quite to the contrary, as we have pointed out numerous times, Evola himself claimed his views were in harmony with those of well-bred men of that ancien regime. I would say the same for Maurras.

Benoist, on the other hand, rejects outright that regime, placing himself in opposition both to Evola and Maurras.

You do point out an important difference between Evola and Maurras, viz., their relationship to German thought. The latter was appalled by it. Maurras actually proposed a sort of greater Romanity, among all the nations speaking Romance languages. Hence, he hoped for a closer cooperation between France and Italy, leaving Germany out of it. Maurras saw a direct line from Athens to Rome to Paris. Evola, on the other hand, was obsessed with Germany and its philosophers.

So what next?

P.S. To those who don't read French: that interview is by a living writer under copyright protection; otherwise I would make it available in English for you.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-04 at 22:13 said:

Our discussion has reached an important highmark – Evola and Maurras are agreed upon which system of rule is best. We can also agree that restoring l'ancien regime, if it could be done, would result in restoring the Traditional form of western society. The major difference between Evola and Maurass is indeed the nature of Germany.

The question I have now is : on the matter of Germany and German philosophy, who is correct – Evola or Maurras ?

Cologero on 2012-11-04 at 23:52 said:

Coincidentally, I have a post planned on German philosophy for mid-week. Ironically, Maurras ended up liking the Germans a bit too much, and that cost him his reputation and his freedom after WW II.

There is an important difference, also, in fundamental orientation. Evola and Maurras were both pagans enamoured of ancient Greece and Rome—although Maurras was more influenced by its classical aspects—and both had high regard for the Medieval period. Evola accepted Tradition as a metaphysical, supra-historical, given. Maurras was a Positivist and historian; his view of tradition was simply as an historical reality and his understanding of it came indirectly from his knowledge of Catholic France.

Logres on 2012-11-04 at 15:39 said:

<http://distributistreview.com/mag/2012/08/lord-acton-tends-to-o-corrupt/>

Lord Acton's dictum has lead to a great deal of mischief in the Anglo ghetto.

Cologero on 2012-11-05 at 13:19 said:

Judging from personal correspondence, there seems to be some confusion about this section. They seem to think that this is a justification for "fascism". I responded that to me, it seems descriptive, not prescriptive. Actually, it can be read as the program for revolution as we wrote about recently. Revolutionary forces deliberately provoke public disorder precisely in order to create a power vacuum which they will attempt to fill. Since the public prefers order to chaos, they are usually welcomed ... at first.

In the light of the previous section, remember that Maurras insisted that the temporal powers needed to be under the influence of religion. This is not true of modernity, following the American, French, and Russian revolutions which were overtly anti-religion to various degrees. That people who consider themselves pious or spiritual would favor modernity over the traditional thinkers who acknowledge the priority of the spiritual over the temporal, absolutely baffles me. They believe that modernity is the only "loving" and sane system.

This should also be read in the context of the "Social Contract" theories. Obviously, Maurras cannot accept that. The social contract theorists postulate that free individuals gather together to work out the mechanisms of power in their social group. Clearly that is not consistent with Maurras' understanding, since he claims that some group will assert power rather than wait for a social contract. The contract theorists presume the individual is supreme, whereas the traditional view is that society is prior to the individual.

Dominion on 2012-11-05 at 13:56 said:

It should be noted, though, that not all religions are equal in this regard. Many people who subscribe to some religious principle or order have felt themselves justified to do great damage to their societies and others, to destroy a Traditional order and heritage (Ansar Dine in the great city of Timbuktu), and so on. If the religion is not grounded in Truth, then it can be as destructive as any "atheist Stalinist."

The social contract can also be read in terms of different groups in society coming together, which is far closer to the way things really work (force isn't discounted). Preferably, the 'contract' would then allow each member of each group the best way to self-development in their respective contexts and according to their abilities.

20.6 Principle V: Freedom

Freedom is not at the beginning, but at the end. It is not at the root, but in the flowers and the fruits of human nature or, better said, human virtue. A man is freer in the proportion that he is better. This evolution is necessary. Our men believed they credited themselves with the prize of the effort by a Declaration of their famous rights, by displaying in their city halls and their schools, in their ministries and churches that that prize is acquired without effort. But to display everywhere that that everyone is born a millionaire, would everyone earn a shadow of a million?

Will you say that it is a right to freedom? The right to the million would not be more futile.

Freedom, a metaphysical principle, is one thing: freedoms are something else. The will of the people, the sum of individual wills, is one thing; the general will, the expression of the general interest of a nation, a race, a country is another thing, totally different.

The freedom of the crowd is called folly, that of a stupid person, stupidity, that of the crook, crime, that of the traitor, treason, and so forth. To say that freedoms limit each other is totally correct in the savage state or the state of anarchy: that simply means that the strong oppress or ex-

exploit the weak as long as the weak do not revolt against the strong and that potential victims did not find a sure process to snipe at and strafe their tormenters at will. Freedom conceived as regime or as principle, is a generally painful chaos.

Citizens who have reflected a little therefore do not let themselves be intimidated by the effects of words. They define freedom as a power or a force, a force or power that is worth what its subjects and its object are worth. The eternal ridicule of the 18th and 19th century consists in taking freedom for a rule or for a goal when it is only a means or the material.

Freedom lives in few men.

Whoever says real freedom says authority. Testamentary freedom creates the authority of the head of the family. Communal or provincial freedom creates the real power of the social authorities who live and reside in the place. Religious freedom recognizes the authority of spiritual laws and the internal hierarchy of a religion. Trade union and professional freedom devotes the authority of the disciplines and rules to the interior of corporations and professional organizations.

These are the observable facts.

If, however, in place of observing, one withdraws into himself to reflect, he realizes that the very nature of positive freedom—that which is not conceived by the relationship to an obstacle to surmount—freedom is the power.

Social issues are exercised in society and have as their point of application not marble, as the power of a sculptor, nor the machine, as the power of a mechanic, but by men engaged with us in social life.

What then is a freedom? A power.

Whoever can do nothing at all is not free at all. Whoever can do rather poorly is poorly free. Whoever can do infinitely is also infinitely free. One of the forms of power is wealth. Another of its forms is influence, it is physical force, it is intellectual and moral force. On what are these various powers exercised in various ways? On men. And that power, to whom

does it belong? To men. When human freedom is found at its highest point and it met human objects to which to apply and impose itself, what name does it take? Authority. An authority is therefore only a freedom reaching its perfection.

Far from the idea that authority contradicts the idea of freedom, it is, on the contrary, its completion and complement. The freedom of a father of a family is an authority. The freedom of a religious confession is an authority. There are still the authorities as freedom of an association, the freedom of a commune, of a given province.

When one wishes that the State respects private initiative in the economic order, one fundamentally demands that it respects what Le Play named with a beautiful expression: the social authorities. All real freedoms, defined and practical, are of authorities. Freedom opposed to authority; freedom which consists in not being *affected* by others, but also to not *affect* them, that neutral freedom is not compatible with nature nor with the order of life.

Posted on 2012-11-11 by Cologero

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Cologero on 2012-11-11 at 19:05 said:

Once again, the intent of this piece is a counter-argument to Rousseau's claim that "men are born free". On the contrary, Maurras asserts that freedom is an achievement, that it comes with maturity. Ironically, Maurras is close to Fichte's claim that a man is free to the extent that he can submit to the laws of Reason. The relationship between freedom and authority brings to mind Evola's claim that only the king can be said to be totally free.

Avery on 2012-11-11 at 23:39 said:

It appears that by restating freedom as a product of power, rather than something necessarily tied up with the kshatriya revolt, Maurras corrects Rousseau better than the Perennialists do, and is rewarded with a definition more meaningful both for historical societies and modern political purposes.

The Roman Senators were always "free" to believe and do what they wanted, and "freemen" or franklins had their power recognized even in the most Traditional society.

20.7 Principle VI: Rights and Laws

I always believed that the privilege of rights also represents the privilege of duties.

The experience of the nature of things established that the domain of common law is very limited and that there is, on the contrary, a multitude of private rights. Each group of men, which has its distinctive life, deserves a distinctive treatment. Whoever “favors” himself wants to be treated for his own benefit, and when this wish is not granted, the subject suffers, first of all, in the body which he is a part of, and secondarily in himself, due to the disrepute and the slackening which, by all necessity, affects that body.

Right, in order to be imposed and even to subsist, requires that it be exercised, that it be sustained, that it be published. It presupposes activity or it fades, little by little, in the blood and ashes of massacred men and burnt buildings, then in the sublime cold of these empty spaces where the raised voice of the most passionate of the rhetors is going to die out.

That is what the rhetors will never understand. They spend their life personifying “the right”. But men of action and men of analysis ask themselves what this person without subject, this right without a living substrate, can be; in their turn, by not understanding the antithesis that lingers everywhere, this right that they oppose to force, this force that they want to make the opposite of the right! It makes as much sense to put the triangle and a color in opposition. There are colored triangles, there can be colors spread on triangular surfaces. I do not conceive a right that would be abstract, which would be separated from a moral or material person in whom it exists, and that is to say, from a force.

There is force, more or less strong, which is right; there is force, more or less strong, which is wrong. But a rational being who, without any force, would be the right or would have the right: that is what I cannot conceive.

The right, which needs force in order to be recognized, needs it even more in order to be.

Legal reasoning starts from the principles of the Just and the Unjust, its first notions already represent the second or the third power of a high abstraction, and its definitions, if extensive, are necessarily fluctuating when it is about adapting their generality to practical life: among the multitude of particular facts, often very different, and which sometimes contradict each other, the spirit is more or less inevitably induced to lose sight of the impersonal reasons to stop its choice or even to lead its attention. It is then that, for lack of impersonal reasons, others appear: the personal motive suddenly appears, active and vigilant, and the idea of the right no longer remains clarified and guided except by the idea of the "*me*", by this "*me*" which is not without rights, but which claims to have them all and which instinctively steers the processes of thought towards its sole interest, sometimes understood in a tyrannical sense but always, to some degree, unconcerned with a good order, unconsciously favorable to some anarchy.

May the heavens protect me from saying that the Right leads to anarchy, he who wants, on the contrary, to rule it and pacify it! But he is a born warrior. In my opinion, the preference given to the legal method over the empirical method must belong to flourishing societies, strongly based on the principles which erupt from all sides and are obeyed by everyone.

Separate man from his family, his nation, his trade, tell him that he is king, tell him that he is God, and intoxicate him with the idea of Justice, you will see from what heart he will count the wrongs which will be done to him and what will be able to be his leniencies for the wrongs that he will come to do to others! This judge is too partial, a party too interested and too impassioned for it to be reasonable of him to remand theoretically all litigation. The one who recognizes all rights begins by imposing on the entire world all duties, without forgetting the penalties which correspond to all negligence.

That is the true folly of revolutionary individualism, whether it is political, social, or moral. It is impossible that an animal as sensible, as sad, as vulnerable as man, once placed on the interior altar that the dogmatic liberal erects on him, does not believe, nine times out of ten, himself to be the creditor of his fellow men and of the universe, in the place that the most miserable is on the contrary their debtor to the infinite!

This illusion of the creditor on society can only be only encouraged by the absurd metaphysics of Rights.

Clarifications on the Nature of Law According to a venerable [the Middle Ages] maxim⁷, the law is made by the action of the sovereign (*constitutione regis*) and by the acceptance of the subject (*consensus populi*). Without doubt our jurists poorly translate these words. They figure that consensus, this must be understood as the agreement of fact, as noisy as the acclamation which follows the coronation of kings, as the simple approving whisper which Homer had follow the word of the leaders, *Epeythymesan axaioi*. But, in the great majority of cases, in the case on which we do not make little stories about, the agreement consists in the fact of raising no important contradiction, of understanding, of carrying out.

To go on to say: “Mister Subject, here is a law that will legally bind you. Do you really want it? Are you sure you want it? We need your signature,” that is exactly to want to inspire him to say “no”, to argue endlessly in order not to agree. The hatred of the new and the spirit of contradiction are so strong in men that we do not put the public good at their mercy.

Yet it remains true that the law must be made to be easily obeyed. A law must be acceptable. The law is not the law when its pronouncement suffices to provoke the people to fear it. It needs a natural and prompt consent.

⁷From the Middle Ages: *lex consensus populi et constitutione regis fit*.

The party which attacks a law which no one defends can be wrong or right, that is not the question: the author of such a law will not have less committed that political fault of not waiting for the best conditions and most favorable arrangements of the public spirit. Its law is only a decree of a state of siege that it will have to support, arms in hand, without having the right to complain or be surprised.

The spirit of modern laws is far from the spirit of the laws which govern the deeds of real life, and these real deeds, unable to worry about the scraps of paper which distort them or the spider which weaves its web in the legislative mind, continued to develop following the weights, measures, and numbers which compose them.

It is said: "But the deed can be the crime! The deed can be the atrocity! The deed can be the error!"

Definitely: realistic politics and morals do not provide bare facts and beliefs as the types and models of life. But they recommend two points:

First of all, to consider laws depending on which real deeds are chained, for if deeds can be vicious or criminal, the laws of vice and crime are not; the order of causes and effects which preside over realities themselves flawed are not the least flawed in the world, it is even excellent to know and to calculate, knowledge and calculation which alone permit action.

Secondly, action has the chance to be serious and useful only on the condition of aiming for a definite and just goal. It is neither sufficient to have an "ideal" in mind, nor to make a second-rate idea of "right" and "duty": this moralism, this legalism, this idealism must conform to the ideal, moral, and legal truth. In other words, it is first necessary to be right.

A false idea is a false idea. The will to impose on the world under the pretext that the world must be governed by ideas is an absurd pretence whose application will be forcibly criminal or fatal. Ideas are not equal to each other. All the claimed rights are not valuable. And not all ways of arranging mores are worthy of respect. The modern error comes from that sudden assimilation of contrary systems dreamed by the human mind. It

is definitely an easy error for orators and litigants. It allows the latter to support all causes. It lets the former please all audiences. But the people who trust in them pay the price.

Posted on 2012-11-18 by Cologero

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Avery Morrow on 2012-11-20 at 05:17 said:

Although it's written as a general principle, I've found that this is an extremely pertinent post in the light of the current Israel-Hamas war (where a lot of claims of one side being "in the right" are being thrown around), and every time I quote it people get very confused.

20.8 Principle VII: Property

Property is the natural safeguard of man, an industrious animal still more than reasonable, for whom his needs, his weakness, the dissatisfaction that he brings from the cradle make a narrow duty of transforming what surrounds him. Pascal is wrong to scoff at those poor children who say: this coin is mine.

One would not say "me", without saying "mine". Without property, man is condemned to death.

To possess is to command, it is to dispose of oneself, it is to be able to resist others, it is to exercise an influence, were it only by reaction.

Property emancipates existence and confers an authority at least on the goods of the earth and the fruits of labor.

Posted on 2012-12-02 by Cologero

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Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 17:57 said:

Very direct and to the point.

It does create a dilemma for those "Traditionalists" so-called who see hope in communism.

Saladin on 2012-12-03 at 19:14 said:

lol! "Traditionalists who see hope in communism"!!! You must be joking, right?

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 19:34 said:

I wish I were but I am not...

There are men who claim to be both followers of Rene Guenon and Karl Marx. Alexandr Dugin's writings are a prime example of this tendency....

The person who first introduced me to Baron Evola's books was a National Communist....

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 19:37 said:

Read this to see how Dugin tries to mix Evolian-ism with Marxism.

<http://against-postmodern.org/section-iv-mission-julius-evola>

I can only imagine what the Baron would say if he could read this....

More and more, I am starting to see Dugin as the prophesied counter-initiation that Guenon mentioned in *Reign of Quantity*....

Cologero on 2012-12-03 at 21:02 said:

It seems that a lingering affection for communism is the equivalent to the Stockholm syndrome⁸ for some Russian intellectuals. Another we can mention is Israel Shamir.

Without property, man is a slave to the state. Even Medieval peasants had their land and couldn't be evicted by bankers or tax collectors. A Romanian friend has told me tales about life under communism. For example, the authorities deemed that his grandmother had more house than she needed. So they took over some of its rooms and moved in another family and a retired military man. She had no say in the matter.

Dominion on 2012-12-04 at 00:43 said:

The right to property is fundamental in order to preserve the ability to attain freedom (the Traditionalist notes, of course, that it is not freedom in and of itself, as the American right would have us believe). However, the right is not absolute. The banker or corporate shark who exploits the worker and nation cannot hide behind his right to property when the State exercises its own rightful duty to uphold Justice.

⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stockholm_syndrome

On the topic of communism, two important points must be made: first, that "communism" is many times used as an umbrella term to describe varying and contradictory elements, making it very much the equivalent of the "fascist" epithet. Second, that the way in which certain Traditionalists view "socialism" (that is to say, a society in which the worker has some sort of democratic control over capital and where the State advances these reforms) as being far from antithetical to the aims of Tradition is far more nuanced than some seem to think. The best criticism I have heard from these branches is that the exploited worker is viewed as a mere unit of production; socialism's aim is to view the worker as a human being whose work cannot be separated from his inner development. Thus, a socialism which allows workers democratic control over capital is necessary in order to allow the worker to develop his various mental and spiritual capacities.

With regards to the exoteric institutions of Tradition, many movements today which can be called "socialist" have moved in this direction, or at least have the potential to be educated towards this framework. One example is the Russian Communist Party today, which supports the Orthodox Church being a foundation stone of Russia, and aims to maintain social systems which view the family as a social good and unit, such as the public kindergarten system. It also wants to maintain small and medium sized businesses, which is not so distant from the distributist view of property's role. Dugin's fourth political theory is useful in that, using Being as its basis, it takes what is useful from the previous theories, including socialism. But what is base must be made subtle; what is made from the dust of the so-called enlightenment must be baptized in the water which brings true enlightenment. Be it property and the market, socialism and the worker, or the fasces and the authority of the State, this will need to be done in order to build an order in which the values of Tradition are embodied.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-04 at 02:54 said:

Cologero is correct on the need for all persons to be property owners. Property is the basis of an individual life as Maurras articulately said above....

I often wondered myself why Russians like Dugin who were victims of Communist repression suddenly turned nostalgic for the USSR....

Do you think though there's any merit in the argument that since the USSR fell before the USA it was therefore not as degenerated ?

Saladin on 2012-12-04 at 19:59 said:

I am only vaguely familiar with Dugin. His Geopolitics is certainly interesting. Tradition has no use for Communism, and communism is totally opposed to Tradition. As Cologero said "without property, man is a slave to the state." There has never been a Tradition that has not protected the concept of Private Property.

Saladin on 2012-12-04 at 20:06 said:

Thanks for the link Jason! Dugin suggests that we read Evola "from the Left"! That explains a lot! He clearly has his own reading of Tradition but I completely agree with Cologero that this may be a bit of Stockholm Syndrome and definitely not "the prophesied counter-initiation" figure.

20.9 Principle VIII: Heredity

Where there is no vision, the people perish: but he that keeps the law, happy is he.

PROVERBS 29:18

In this insightful section, Maurras shows the importance of heredity, both in regard to progeny, but also with respect to the transmission of the "fruits" of a society through its bloodline. He points out that it is the society of those with faith who are most likely to understand this, and that it is due to God's very law: Be fruitful and multiply. Those angst-filled existentialists can fulfill this task only paradoxically by making it a sacred task. As faith declines, men see no need to preserve and pass on their heritage.

Nature proceeds most commonly by imitation and repetition: but it also has innovations, caprices, initiatives. In that case it acts with an extreme vigor.

When it lets a soldier be born in the house of peaceable magistrates, or a marine in the descent of wine growers, the new vocation is marked rather strongly, it is served by a rather firm will so that all resistances are broken. But these resistances, these difficulties have some good. These hardships are natural tests, letting the predestined strong pass, but rejecting the others in the hereditary condition most suitable to them, because nature assures them defense and protection.

As the means of action towards a future, heredity is the most direct and the simplest of all.

Its general utility results from the destiny of the generator gifted with reason, who reproduces himself before dying.

Human life would be shamefully short if nature had not furnished societies with a procedure that transmits the fruits of its works through the blood.

The impersonal passion, whose deposit man holds, acts only through him in order to get to others, but delegates to the children which he procreates a power over the goods that he likewise procreated, very often for them. The inert posterity which comes from his hand will be vivified by his living posterity. When his great sons begin to enrich his heritage, all workers a little amorous of his work feel with some truth that he is going to conquer death twice. The power of bequeathing his remains gives to the activity of a well-filled life the highest natural laurels.

Let us note that the Christian societies of the Middle Age, penetrated by the supernatural sentiment of a future life, always proved themselves extremely sensitive to the terrestrial reward of the father in his sons. They sang, with all their soul, "Abraham et semini ejus in secula" ["to Abraham and to his sons forever"].

Our different royal or imperial races arise out of nations fervently convinced of the reality of the kingdom of heaven: how would less believing peoples pay less attention to the carnal wish of hereditary duration? It is their only defense against time; they have only that anchor to throw on the abyss of the future. In a pinch, hereditary ambitions should have weakened through a sudden flight of celestial hopes; would the opposite be understood?

We can reason this way:

If some God hidden in the secret of hearts or soaring on the interplanetary abyss assists, immobile and mute, ardent and all powerful, the development of the efforts of humanity, it is His own law that He con-

firms in things and men; He can only bless its increased effects.

But if the spaces are empty and if the human heart is itself not assisted by any “internal consolation”, all the happiness of the being and all the benefits of life appear more exposed to the erosion of time and the blow of death, their tradition, their transmission then seems more precious in its solitary immensity to perpetual destitution. All means of saving or prolonging the shaky personal effort becomes more sacred perhaps! The thought threatened is attached more closely to the philosophy of order and the knowledge of the laws of its preservation. Should this order succumb, the believers keep refuge in the divine City: he who no longer believes undergoes the catastrophe of everything that his dream vied with death.

Posted on 2012-12-09 by Cologero

20.10 Principle IX: The Duty of Heritage

In this particularly beautiful passage, Maurras explains the duty of one generation to pass on its culture, customs, and traditions to the next, which in turn, has the duty to accept and develop that heritage. The loss of one’s traditions needs to be taken at least as seriously as the attention we pay today to the possible extinction of various fishes and insects. Unfortunately, the youth of today are the new disinherited, since their fathers have passed on little except a hatred for their own past. How that plays out is uncertain, unless and until they rise up to reclaim what is rightfully theirs.

In order to justify what common sense and custom maintain by force, let us not talk about rights, but instead duty.

The duty to bequeath and make a will.

The duty to inherit.

Those who are called disinherited or proletarian are sometimes understood to be preaching that that is not just in their point of view. That is just and beneficial for everyone.

The good that is established in a natural or legal family can have doubtful sources: it is redeemed and moralized by its fixity, by the firm benefit that it establishes around itself in stabilizing the conditions of life, in distributing work, in securing it, in preparing a point of solid support to the generations to come.

There is no difference between the damages caused to nature by the death of a beautiful animal, followed by the return of its elements to the universal dust, and the destruction of an ordinary fortune to the death of its creator.

There is a dead loss for society as for nature, the obligation to take up again a long and painful task.

Prosperous social organisations are those that prevent these realities from dissolving into the void and which help to keep them from a total death: these purveyors of life, being the born-enemies of destruction, made a respected institution from its heritage, and, one could say, a type of sacrament from its legacy.

Posted on 2012-12-16 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-16 at 21:27 said:

Truly beautiful indeed. The West is in dire straits as even the descendents of the former elite are losing their ancestral heritage.....and instead of rising up to reclaim what is ours, too many faux traditionalists look to another culture....

20.11 Principle X: Tradition

Maurras concludes his list of fundamental principles with Tradition. This will be a disappointment to those who want to reduce

everything to the rational, since traditional is beyond that. It is tied, as he says, to "blood and soil", that is, one's ancestors and the heritage they bequeathed. The deracinated modern mind is limited by the idea, the simulacra of the "proposition" nation.

Yet, tradition is not blind. Its successes serve as the paradigm for the future, its failures as lessons to be learned; there is no point to perpetuate errors. This is a living tradition, not stuck in the past through inertia. A true Tradition is never lost, it is only hidden. If it had one starting point, it can have a second. It will be new only by men who know who they are.

Tradition means handing down.

Tradition gathers the forces of blood and soil. It is retained even when leaving one's country, as an eternal temptation to return to it.

True tradition is critical, and for lack of its distinctions, the past is no longer of use for anything, its successes stop being models, its setbacks stop being lessons.

In all tradition, as in all heritage, a reasonable being deducts and must deduct the liabilities.

Tradition is not inertia, its opposite; heritage is not nepotism, its counterfeit.

All traditions had a beginning and the sentiments of monarchistic fidelity, if they rise up very high, do not do so indefinitely: what began can begin again; what had one point of departure can find a second.

The opposition between reason and tradition, which is the same as the antithesis of reality and the idea, or art and nature, and that can be assimilated to the opposition of vinegar and oil, the sweet and the bitter, the fluid and the solid, in a cosmogony of infant peoples.

Posted on 2012-12-23 by Cologero

* * *

White Stag Knight on 2012-12-23 at 11:31 said:

Maurras, must be handled delicately and with dialectic quasi-Rabbinic intellectualism of finesse. He was not condemned by Catholicism without reason. He cannot be the center of our Right Hand Path counter-revolution. He can be but a source of truths to be mined, but no Doctor.

The nationalism of Maurras, in fact, signified in one sense the miasma of international European aristocracy and the fragmentation of Christendom.

We aim to resurrect the Holy Roman Imperium of Christ Rex.

No single nation can exist in self-deifying separatism and claim special privileges.

The Empire is Universal.

Cologero on 2012-12-23 at 12:32 said:

Obviously, White Knight, we can't disagree with you. However, using his own standard, if we add Maurras' assets and deduct his liabilities, we are still in the black. My prime motivation has been this: to show that a pagan non-theist relying on positive science can still discern Tradition. That is because the Logos is made visible in creation. There are many men today in that position who would still nevertheless want to align with Tradition. Maurras shows that honest science does not necessarily have that corrosive effect assumed by the anti-Tradition.

His hyper-nationalism is not the ultimate reality, but remember that the Empire does not deny nor annihilate nationhood. At one point, there was a group around Maurras that floated the idea of an alliance of the Latin-speaking nations. That would have been a start toward reunifying the ecumene. Had that materialized, the role of Romania would have been important in uniting the East and the West.

Dominion on 2012-12-23 at 14:46 said:

Thank you so much for translating this work. I'm beginning to think it would be worth it to learn French simply to read the originals. Seeing as the Action Francaise was of a royalist nature, perhaps there is room here for an article comparing Maurras' view of the royal vs the religious spheres in the social order with those of Evola and Guenon? I would guess that he would approximate Evola to a greater degree, having the Church being more subject to the King, but if there is one thing I have learned from these principles it is that he is not to be underestimated in his depth.

With regards to what you say about the role of nationhood in Tradition, I see the proper view more and more espoused in the "Identitaire" movement that is currently exploding over Europe. They hold the local (city and region), national, and European levels of identity as valid and complementary. I have found (observing it from a distance from across the pond) that there are many in that movement who are familiar with some Traditional works, Evola figuring large (with his shortcomings compared to Guenon or some others causing some problems, admittedly).

Do you think a possibility exists of leading those who are open from a “mere” nationalism to one informed by Tradition?

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 00:38 said:

Cologero – can you provide some links in English or French explaining in more detail Maurras’ plan of reuniting the Latin nations ? I was unaware that he went beyond French nationalism and would like to read more on this.

Cologero on 2012-12-27 at 06:08 said:

Here is an overview: *L’union des latins*⁹.

In Maurras’ own words: *Les Forces latines*¹⁰.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 17:41 said:

Thank you, Sir. I’ve just read both and find myself in agreement with Maurras – one point he made that I never considered before is that the southern Catholic Germans are actually descended from Roman colonists, and the failed Holy Roman Empire was an attempt to Latinise the Germans. I’m finding myself in accord with his notion of Catholicism being part of the Latin race’s blood, his version of the continuation of Romanity rings truer than Evola’s idea of Germany being the successor to Roma.

⁹<http://maurras.net/2011/10/06/union-des-latins/>

¹⁰<http://maurras.net/textes/196.html>

Sparse notes and Musings

21.1 Are You a Counterrevolutionary?

What is needed is not a revolution in the opposite direction, but the opposite of a revolution.

JOSEPH DE MAISTRE

My principles are only those that prior to the French revolution, every well born person considered healthy and normal.

JULIUS EVOLA

At a time when the right is in a state of confusion, we witness many attempts at its definition. The term “conservative”, with all its various qualifications, doesn’t satisfy. But “right” is vague, meaning little more than “not left”, despite attempts to define a “new right”, or an “alternative right”, as though there is a mainstream right.

No, the correct term is “counterrevolution”, that is, the restoration of order that every succeeding revolution has sought to undermine. As

Evola points out, at one time every well born man was “on the right”, so the distinction was hardly necessary until the aftermath of the French revolution.

I have prepared a little quiz for readers to determine if they are on the side of the revolution or on the counterrevolution. For each position in the table below, circle either the option on the left, or the one on the right. Score 5 points for every circle on the right column. Score 0 points if you circle any option on the left. Your score indicates how healthy and normal is your point of view. If you circled any on the left, the count will indicate whether you are in the revolutionary vanguard or merely a useful idiot.

Table 21.1: Counterrevolutionary Evaluation Form

	<i>Left</i>		<i>Right</i>
Foundation of Reality	Matter		Spirit
Philosophy	Nominalism		Realism (ideas)
Causation is	Horizontal		Horizontal and Vertical
Reality is	Socially	con-	Reflection of Logos
	structed		
Change is the result of	Evolution		Creativity
Social change is caused by	Historical	or	Conscious agents
	random forces		
Basic societal unit	Individual		Family
Societal structure	Egalitarian		Hierarchical
Group interaction	Class/ethnic/gender		Cooperative class struc-
	warfare		ture
Relations are	Contractual,		Organic
	consensual		
Highest authority	State		Transcendence
Function of the state	Welfare State		Ethical State

	LEFT	RIGHT
Evil derives from	Political or social institutions	Man himself
Knowledge is	Opinion (knowledge of the particular)	Wisdom (knowledge of the idea)
Social Justice	To each according to his need	To each his just desserts
Equality of	The Individual or Results	The person
Man is a	Body	Soul
Man's mind consists of	Blank slate	Inherited characteristics
Freedom to act on	Instinctual urges	Rational desires

Posted on 2010-03-09 by Cologero

* * *

GFJF on 2010-08-25 at 11:44 said:

I wonder if it isn't unhelpful to call these positions left and right. Mightn't 'technical' and 'organic' be more accurate?

GFJF on 2010-08-25 at 13:08 said:

To anticipate, I don't think this is a question of mere words. The terms left and right create confusion because they are taken to mean certain things already. Thus even in our own private theorizing we have constantly to qualify different stances as 'not really right' and 'not really left', which causes more than necessary mental convolution. In conversation with others it fosters the impression that Tradition is simply a right-wing political movement, one of the many that arbitrarily defines itself as 'the True Right'. We should keep left and right as descriptors of different stances taken *within* the mechanical worldview, and not try to alter their definitions.

Cologero on 2010-08-25 at 18:39 said:

There is only confusion because people use words improperly, whether out of ignorance or to further their own ends. There is absolutely no "arbitrariness" to the word "right" in a political

sense. It has a definite historical origin and meaning, referring to those defending “throne and altar” against the Jacobins. Tradition is not a so-called “right-wing” political movement; it simply opposes any non-Traditional movement or program.

Now ask yourself who indeed altered the definitions and for what ends.

GFJF on 2010-08-25 at 20:57 said:

Nevertheless it *seems* like an arbitrary redefinition to most people and causes them to lump Tradition in with all the other particular movements. Even if we aren't interested in explaining ourselves to most people, we should be able to do so, and eloquently, if called on. So at the very least, technical and organic are handy elaborations of what we mean by left and right.

Cologero on 2010-08-25 at 22:01 said:

I believe the explanation I gave you of “right” is easy to understand. Try to explain “technical” and “organic” in two sentences.

GFJF on 2010-08-25 at 22:18 said:

You're right. Throne and altar says it all.

Mark Citadel on 2016-04-10 at 08:40 said:

This is excellent, and could not have come down at a better time! Confusions in terms which stem from left wing misuse have led to much dissolution and damaging masquerades. Every ideology that accepts even a fraction of the essential post-Enlightenment revolutions (ALL of them), is to greater or lesser degree a viral extension of the problem. Puts what I had written in my essay on what 'right' means into a very easy format.

One query, when you speak of social change being caused either by “historical or random forces” (left), or by “conscious agents” (right), I understand what you are getting at, but does this account for the cyclical change in universal patterns which tends towards either degeneration or rejuvenation? Perhaps we should interpret these in light of the Vedic tradition, in the same way that we would interpret God's foreknowledge not impacting the free will of human beings, that prophesy and fate are not at odds with our free will, but rather just predict them? Is this accurate?

Cologero on 2016-04-11 at 20:23 said:

RE: cycles

At any particular moment, there are possibilities of manifestation. As disorder (or entropy) increases, there are more such possibilities. Viz., things that had not been possible, are now possible. For any system, we need to look at several elements:

1. The supernatural source of an idea: where in the cosmological hierarchy did it originate. Or is it an idea of the anti-Tradition. These are all possibilities of manifestation.
2. The public agents of change: they promote the idea, good or bad, and do so openly.
3. The hidden agents of change: these are organizations that promote the idea without making themselves known.
4. The unconscious agents are basically everyone else who simply absorb the ideas without understanding them, their true source, or ultimate consequences.

So it is easy enough to predict the results: Ideas have consequences and all possibilities of manifestation must indeed manifest.

21.2 The Order of the Iron Crown

The Iron Crown of Lombardy, dating from the seventh century, is said to contain one of the nails used in the crucifixion of Jesus. The Holy Roman Emperor **Charlemagne** used it at his coronation ceremony in Lombardy, as did several succeeding emperors. Even Napoleon used the crown when he claimed to be King of Italy. Two attempts to create an Order of the Iron Crown were made, first by Napoleon, then by King Victor Emmanuel; both came to nothing.

Apparently Julius Evola outlined his own ideas about the Order. Evola both acknowledges the inception of ascetic orders following the fall of the Roman Empire, while denying any link to the Lombardian Iron Crown, despite using the same name. (The published translation is incorrect, either accidentally or deliberately to obscure the ancient connection.)

I'll not bother to comment on the eight points as they are generic and innocuous in themselves. Certainly, it is unlikely to ever be implemented as they stand. While Cordelia for Lear has the good sense to stop at that point, another site adds a section about qualifications and structure.

What is curious about this ascetic order, especially since there are provisions for passing on membership to sons, is a comment about an affiliated formation of women who would serve as sexual surrogates for the men. Methinks Evola is trying to show he's "got game", but I don't see the appeal. Maybe the dateless computer geeks who seem to be reading Evola these days relish the idea of 50 men sharing the same half dozen or so thots. This would be sure to lead to attachments and the inevitable jealousies and conflicts that would disrupt the group. Any man with real world experience, instead of living in his mother's apartment, can grasp this. Believe me, the women will turn out to be very demanding, to the point of diverting attention from the order's purpose.

Then there is the delicate problem of recruitment. Perhaps in decadent Rome, such an order can find suitable women. But in Evola's ancestral Sicily, those women are likely to be some man's daughter or sister. I can guarantee this idea would not have gone over very well and the Sicilians had their own secret order to deal with such issues.

We have made available several posts about actually existing knightly orders, for example at Random Thoughts on Chivalry¹. Notice the profound difference in values from what Evola proposes. I suggest that anyone interested in a chivalric or ascetic order should take a look at previously successful endeavors and not the laundry list of a man who was never part of any order.

Posted on 2010-04-28 by Cologero

* * *

James O'Meara on 2010-05-03 at 17:57 said:

I've frequently commented on my blog regarding Evola's rather eccentric ideas on sexuality, so this caught my eye. I don't see this as particularly shocking or unworkable. The footnote makes it clear that this is in the context of sexual alchemy, not recreation or 'scoring.' The idea female

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=277>

for this activity, as Evola notes in *Metaphysics of Sex*, would be a virgin suitable for deflowering; as this is a one-time event, the whole issue of “jealousy” etc. doesn’t arise. I suppose the women would be disposed of in some de Sadean way; this would be consistent with his other preferred activity, flagellation.

“I realize these are unpopular idea” as a Python character says, but they are not unusual in the alchemical tradition; just as Madonna knows nothing about Qabalah, Sting knows nothing about Tantra. Actual Tantric or Taoist practices involved the ruthless exploitation of women for their “essence” as General Jack Ripper would say. Women represent “power” but that is precisely why they must be controlled and assimilated; no “goddess” worship here.

You may find these ideas untrue i.e., of no practical use or “immoral” on the basis of some feminine, Christian morality, but they are hardly “unusual” in Tradition.

That a celibate order would need to provide for the children of its members would not be surprising to anyone familiar with the Renaissance Church; for the same reason, I would assume Sicily would in fact be an excellent source of virgins ask Michael Corleone where their “protective” family would, for that very reason, be able to hand them over to the local Elites. Happens every day, man.

Cologero on 2010-05-03 at 23:53 said:

I guess I just find it unlikely. Evola did write of a third order, so I understand that to mean a more or less permanent underclass of groupies, not disposable virgins. In order to count on the locals supplying the virgins willingly, the Order would have to be doing favours in return ... just ask Michael Corleone. The actual activities of the order are left undefined.

I wasn’t addressing the post so much to Evola, but rather to rather to a certain type of neo-pagan who has not a chance at a virgin. For example, consider this quote from a Odinist facebook page: “The key to happiness is a goblet full of mead, a wench, and a steed.” If sex and intoxicants were the key to spirituality, there would be pilgrimages to every American ghetto. But this Odinist wants to act like one; just needs his low rider to make him a man.

On the contrary, sex magick is only of value to someone who has no need for sex (as Evola subtly implies). When the Dalai Lama was asked about Tantric initiation (naturally of intense interest to his decadent American followers), he pointed out that it is only appropriate to someone who could dine on a plateful of shit and a glass of pus or a gourmet meal with the same indifference.

Even our friend *Aleister Crowley*², in a lucid moment wrote:

It is, indeed, of the first importance for the celebrant in any phallic rite to be able to complete the act without even once allowing a sexual or sensual

²<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=51>

thought to invade his mind. The mind must be as absolutely detached from one's own body as it is from another person's.

Who do you know who is capable of that? He's the one that gets to deflower the Virgin. But that attitude is what indeed makes it "unusual" in Tradition, except, perhaps, for poseurs.

But aren't there other ways to deal with feminine energy. Do you suppose **Moonchild** is a bit too sweet?

Or the idea of Polar beings to bring completion. There may be something necessary in the constant irritant of a female companion. Just hanging out with the guys is an option, but even the misogynist went on the quest for "She who must be obeyed." (Rider Haggard)

Matt on 2010-05-08 at 20:53 said:

The difference in Evola's list of requirements and the requirements of the medieval orders is quite interesting. Your suggestion of a possible inaccurate translation is possible, though there is also the possibility that Evola didn't want to include elements that he thought were of a christian nature.

The last sentence of this blog entry makes me think of his ur group and I have always wondered whether Evola and the group at large achieved any kind of inner/spiritual realization, at least of any considerable magnitude.

Francis Mercuri on 2010-05-10 at 03:38 said:

Mark, while it is somewhat true that mainstream Christianity enjoys a greater, albeit superficial, acceptance as an organized religion, as a "norm", among the general Western public (as opposed to Paganism), this does not imply that traditional Christians are not "tested".

1. In the modern (predominantly liberal) social ("public") domain, which is characterized by materialism, mechanism, moral relativism, and to a large extent atheism, the ideals of traditional Christianity are perceived as antagonistic to the overall operation of the current order. So, it is "ok" to be Christian, just as long as one "keeps their opinions to themselves", and doesn't try to apply their traditional Christian theology, philosophy, or ethics to "real world" scenarios, that might just "upset the apple cart". As far as modernity is concerned, the world of Medieval Catholicism, or Eastern Orthodoxy, is just as anathema as "Paganism", if not more so.

2. Inwardly, the authentic Christian path is entirely about being "tested". I get the feeling that you understand Christianity as being just a "belief", or a sentimental "feeling", sort of akin to how one might acquiesce to popular sentiments about their home team(s). However, if you dig a bit deeper, you will find that Christianity is about winning a precious medicine. This healing balm repairs the rupture between a divided immanent and transcendent in man, the fundamental cause originating with the "Fall", but the secondary and ongoing causes arising in man himself, as the result of attachment (identification with) the passions, or as some might say, the innumerable

"i's", which obscure the true "Personality" (per Guenon's meaning of "Personality"). These forces, are what the Christian contends with, in an ongoing effort of "spiritual athletics"—not in the sense of being "sins" or violated rules, to be punished (as exoteric jargon might phrase it), but as energies obfuscating the "Real Presence". This really differs little from what Evola writes about how to deal with the "emotions" while pursuing the real "I", in his tract about the Mithraic Mysteries.

In the past, I've explained things this way to Pagans, who marginally agree with the content as expressed, but always with the retort "Yes, but, that isn't how the 'average' Christian understands Christianity", and I anticipate this is what you might be thinking. In response, I'd say that simply it matters little what the 'average' Christian thinks in this regard, as what we are talking about is Christianity "as it is"; that is to say, not what some modern Protestant deviation has made of it—but, what it says of itself, via the totality of Scripture, the Orthodox Liturgies/Liturgical cycle, Patristic and Saintly writings/exegesis, ascetical commentaries such as Philokalia and the Gerontikons, the symbolism inherent in Iconography, among other sources.

Minimally, in these ways, I do consider that the Christian is indeed "tested"; but, like the owner of the forum recently stated, we must go beyond the "superficial distinctions" to grasp this. It is a waste of energy on all parties behaves to beat each other over the head concerning false dichotomies surrounding some endless "war" between a traditional Christianity and Paganism.

Cologero on 2010-05-13 at 13:31 said:

To quote Guenon:

A still more surprising thing is that some people in these days think that they can expound traditional doctrines by taking profane instruction itself as a sort of model, without taking the least account of the nature of traditional doctrines and of the essential differences which exist between them and everything that is today called by the names of "science" and "philosophy", from which they are separated by a real abyss in so doing they must of necessity distort these doctrines completely by over-simplification and by only allowing the most superficial meaning to appear, otherwise their pretensions must remain completely unjustified.

Similarly, it is quite surprising to me, also, that anyone would take notice of this blog while at the same time rejecting out of hand any of its content.

The regurgitation of definitions purloined from a philosophy textbook is passed off as intelligence, and basing one's life someone else's conception published in a pop psychology magazine is considered creativity.

That, sad to say, is the state of the world today. What we have to offer on this blog is a much deeper and richer conception of life. As such, however, it will be accessible only to a superior type

of man. They will know themselves by their almost magnetic attraction to traditional doctrines, even if their understanding is at yet immature. The purpose of this blog is twofold:

- (1) to counteract the misconceptions around Tradition
 - (2) to encourage those interested to pursue Tradition in depth
- The poseurs will eventually get bored and leave.

21.3 Chastising the General

The General McChrystal affair³ has dominated the news media today. I have no intention of debating the merit or demerits of the war in Afghanistan, but rather about the coverage of the incident itself.

A bevy of commentators and government officials are trotted out to deal with the following two questions:

1. Were the General's comments insubordination or not?
2. What should be the appropriate punishment for the General?

But none of these highly paid experts have asked the far more interesting questions.

Why is the military brass in near mutiny against their civilian leaders?

Is Joe Biden respectable (that is, worthy of respect) as a world leader?

I'm not in a position to answer such questions, but they should have been asked. The easy road is "gotcha" journalism, where the only issue is whether or not something said should have been. The actual content of the thought, whether it expresses truth or not, is simply irrelevant in today's environment.

Posted on 2010-06-23 by Cologero

³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stanley_A._McChrystal

21.4 The New Dawn

To defend an ideal and hold positions even if they be lost positions, or better said: even when it may be problematic that those who still remain awake during the night could meet those who will appear in the new dawn.

JULIUS EVOLA

We have been demonstrating the coherence of the Western Tradition and the inner connections starting from the supposed Hyperborean primordial tradition and subsequently to the Vedic, ancient Greco-Roman, and Medieval civilizations. If it is the case, as Nietzsche claims, that everything is a perspective, we can point out that most perspectives are based on rhetoric, but very few on conviction. The former are chatty, on the assumption that the will to power is a battle of words or ideas; hence, they engage in sterile debates, vilify ideological foes, and create shibboleths to identify friends. That is, they look at Tradition from the outside, as just another influence, to be juxtaposed with other seemingly similar thinkers. They gather opinions like squirrels gathering acorns, with little concern for the spirit that gave rise to them.

To be convinced, on the other hand, is to know Tradition from the inside, as the direct intuition of interior states, and to know oneself as the creator as his life. As **Carlo Michelstaedter** writes of the man of conviction:

He must take on himself the responsibility for his life (as it must be lived in order for him to attain life), which cannot rest with another. He must have in himself the certainty of his own life, which others cannot give him. He must create himself and the world, which does not exist before him: he must be master and not slave in his house.

Rene Guenon has pointed out that time is not a sequence of indifferent moments of the same quantity; time is also qualitative. Julius Evola draws the logical conclusion that at a given period of historico-material conditions, different spirits will be attracted to that world; this he calls the **Law of Elective Affinity**. Hence, there are many spirits who are blind to the teachings of Tradition and experience the modern world as completely rational, good, and progressive. This reflects the formlessness and increasing lack of differentiation of the end of a cycle.

At the same time, the owl of Minerva flies at dusk⁴. That means that only at the end of the cycle can the whole be seen in retrospect. Men are no longer tied to the Tradition of their land, but are exposed to those of the entire world. They are no longer forced into the role of an apologist for one or another, but can instead focus on the heart of their doctrines. Thus, by the same law mentioned above, men of spirit, who manage to stay vigilant in the dark, will also be attracted to this world.

Some of them may constitute the new elite, if not now, then in the next generation. From where they come, it is not clear. The English speaking world is moribund and is burdened with the absurd notion of the “marketplace of ideas”. Europe believes in its own decline, but no longer believes in resurrection. It is not easy to predict from where the elite will arise; perhaps a few Magi will be able to read the skies.

There is a German saying: “Wer sagt A muss B sagen” (Who says A must say B). We think that through these many translations and commentaries we have said A. Now we want to say B and will focus on some specific consequences. Beyond that, it is unclear. I am awaiting the arrival of the more mystical writings of **Guido de Giorgio**; if they are of interest, I will communicate them.

The other half of perspective is the will to power; the idea alone is just a possibility. A possibility of manifestation, though, requires power to bring essence into being, against forces of resistance and the inertia

⁴See Section 1.3 in this book.

and chaos of prime matter. That is entirely different from writing and requires men of sufficient strength and vigor. Perhaps the new dawn has arrived already.

Posted on 2012-04-22 by Cologero

21.5 2016: Obama's America

I saw the surprising hit movie 2016: Obama's America this past weekend and am still unsure what its point is. It is the brainchild of the Anglo-Indian **Dinesh D'Souza**. First of all, it was certainly a well-produced and researched documentary; as such, it is a model of what can—and should—be done by those who find themselves outside of Hollywood's consensus reality. There were several scenes focusing on the squalor of Indonesia and Kenya, hinting that they represent the future course of Obama's America.

First of all, we must point out that we reject the fundamental point of the film, *viz.*, that Obama's views are the result of some childhood psychological trauma. There is no fault in a boy's admiration for his father and there must be some compassion for boy's sense of loss for an absent father. Because of this, the film misses the opportunity to specifically point out the intellectual and ideological roots of Obama's worldview and how it differs from the neo-conservative viewpoint of D'Souza. Nor does it explain how members of Congress, not to mention millions of supporters, many with presumably happy childhoods, have also come to embrace Obama's vision for America.

Besides, although we could point out the psychological issues in D'Souza's childhood, there is something in D'Souza's worldview that colors his own perspective. He points out some accidental similarities between himself and Obama, such as their years of birth and marriage. However, we need

to “read between the lines”, as it were, to get at the essential differences between them, as least how D’Souza sees them.

D’Souza was born into an Indian Catholic family in Goa, as his Portuguese name would imply. This made him neither fully an Indian nor a Westerner. He rejects the Indian traditions of arranged marriages and the caste system, neither of which applied to him, as well the insularity of village life. In India, a boy’s life is mapped out from his birth, while in America, a boy can accomplish anything, depending only on his desires and talents. When he announced his imminent departure to America, his father told him he wouldn’t like it: “There are too many white people there.” D’Souza fails to explain why the “founders” whom he reveres, all but guaranteed that⁵. But that was then, this is now.

So we see that D’Souza’s worldview is opposed to the alleged backwardness, or better said, the limitations, of so-called third-world countries and peoples. The USA, on the contrary, is based on an abstraction, the “ideas” of the founding fathers; a man is an individual, not restricted to ties of family, caste, or religion, nor apparently even citizenship, as he got a position as a policy advisor to Ronald Reagan despite his status as an alien.

That may explain why D’Souza is so sensitive to anything in Obama that suggests the opposite. Specifically, the root of Obama’s vision, according to D’Souza, is that Obama, on the contrary, valorizes the third world, to the extent even of threatening the economic dominance, cultural hegemony, and military might of the USA.

We can provide some quick examples. In foreign policy, for example, Obama allegedly favors Argentina in her dispute with the UK over the Falklands/Maldives. Clearly, this has no impact on American military security. Actually, in accordance with the long-standing Monroe doctrine⁶, the USA should have opposed the introduction of British troops into

⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Naturalization_Act_of_1790

⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Monroe_Doctrine

the Falklands in the 1982 war, as Kennedy had done against the USSR in Cuba; at the very least, by that doctrine, the USA must remain neutral in the dispute.

From the unserious, he moves onto the serious. Putting up a map of countries with nuclear warheads, he shows Pakistan on one side and Israel, with 80 warheads, on the other side of Iran. For Iran, there is a question mark; actually, as of now, the count is zero. D'Souza asserts Obama is anti-Zionist, yet he doesn't make clear why the founders would have wanted the USA to become embroiled in that dispute.

The most serious charge is the Obama is deliberately trying to bankrupt the USA by incurring massive debt. This could be an intriguing film in itself, but D'Souza never explains why the Congress, including the Republicans, continues to permit that. It is true that eventually that debt will economically weaken the USA. Yet the policies that brought on the economic problems in the first place were allowed and promoted by the party that D'Souza supports.

D'Souza may, or may not, have made the case that Obama is unamerican and dangerous. But his strange brew of Neo-Christianity, eschatologically based Zionism, Randian Capitalism, and military adventurism may not be what is necessary to stop him.

Posted on 2012-09-07 by Cologero

* * *

jwthomas on 2012-09-07 at 01:21 said:

Neither Obama nor Romney have a "worldview," unless it's gain power and do everything possible to stay in power. Their fuzzy opinions, like D'Souza's, are just intellectual constructions to justify and to cloak their real motives, which they rarely if ever admit to themselves. Is the "hit movie" 2016 a hit with anyone other than those who already share its opinions?

Mihai on 2012-09-07 at 06:20 said:

You said it in some other article.

This dispute (Democrats vs Republicans) is a dispute between the rising sudra domination vs the degenerate vaishya remnants.

Logres on 2012-09-07 at 10:38 said:

Now that the movie is out, D'Souza is officially as mysterious as M. Night Shamalyan. I saw D'Souza debate someone back in the 90s on CSPAN, one of those "liberal-conservative" cage matches – he made mincemeat of the guy, there is no doubt of his intelligence, & although my dad loved this movie, I've avoided seeing it because of D'Souza's neo-con leanings on foreign policies. This is a good review.

Logres on 2012-09-07 at 10:41 said:

D'Souza had a book out a few years ago that proposed that Muslims and Christians could cooperate against liberals, which got some people's attention.

Avery on 2012-09-07 at 12:02 said:

D'Souza is probably quite literally a degenerated remnant of a vaishya family. But where would you place Mitt Romney in that scheme? He seems like a reconstructed vaishya, his spiritual strength coming from an undeveloped tradition...

Michael on 2012-09-07 at 12:57 said:

Given that all modern politics, conservative or liberal, is really a variation on left-wing thought, shouldn't we still be involved in the political process to retain as many traditional elements as possible? After all, even Dante was involved in Florentine politics before he was banished.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-08 at 22:23 said:

It was right to engage in political activity when there was a chance of restoring Tradition, or at least preventing further collapse but now we've reach the end of the last age, all we can do is try to survive the coming collapse, and prepare to rebuild a new world when this one goes into ruin. Of course, I am talking as an American, to Americans. In other countries the ut look is not so bleak.

21.6 Brainwashing and a Liberal Education

Yesterday afternoon, while I was finishing up a bottle of wine and waiting for the lasagna to bake, I did some channel surfing. I found a channel

called EWTN with an upcoming news show from a Catholic perspective; that sounded better than the secular news shows. Although I never watch that channel, I am familiar with it. I know, for example, that a popular show was canceled when the priest was discovered to be living a secret life of pleasure and luxury. Another show was canceled when the host blamed boys for seducing priests when they are vulnerable. Normally, I follow Terence's dictum that "nothing human is alien to me", but that comment is alien to me.

The news show began with a discussion of the political situation in Egypt; an Egyptian Christian was the guest. Of course, the first topic was the situation of Christians in Egypt, which apparently is precarious. It would have been a good opportunity to discuss how the Muslims and Copts had got along for the past 1500 years, but that was not mentioned. However, the show took an interesting turn, at least for me, although the two interlocutors were oblivious. They mentioned a few Muslim radicals who had undergone an education in the West. They were genuinely surprised how a liberal Western education did not "take" in these men, who nevertheless pursued quite illiberal policies.

While, in their eyes, that was a perfectly natural attitude to take, for me, it was quite jarring. Why bother to watch news from a "Catholic" perspective if it is indistinguishable from secular sources? Perhaps those Muslims, as outsiders, were immune to the implicit supposition that the dogmas of liberalism are rational and axiomatic. **Mohamed Morsi** got a graduate degree in materials science at USC, a STEM major, so he would have missed out on most of the liberal indoctrination. Apparently, even California dreaming did not suffice to turn him.

So what is the attraction of liberal democracies to the religious news hosts? I have mentioned Pope Pius IX's *Syllabus of Errors*⁷ several times and now is the time to look at its points. It has earned the approval of **Julius Evola** for its adamant opposition to liberalism. Now it is true

⁷<http://www.ewtn.com/library/papaldoc/p9syll.htm>

that the current pope claims the syllabus is now overturned, as there is a different critique of liberalism. If so, then what is it? Not even the news anchor is aware of it. Keep in mind that Evola never rejected the **Ancien Regime** even if his views on sexual matters were looser. In reading these propositions, readers may, if they prefer, substitute their own spiritual authority for any mention of the Church.

The literary form of the Syllabus is to state a positive proposition while asserting it as false. Point 3 is the fundamental dogma of Enlightenment liberalism:

3. Human reason, without any reference whatsoever to God, is the sole arbiter of truth and falsehood, and of good and evil; it is law to itself, and suffices, by its natural force, to secure the welfare of men and of nations.

We hope that EWTN agrees about the falsity of (3). This aligns them more with Morsi than with liberal education. Point 39 is related:

39. The State, as being the origin and source of all rights, is endowed with a certain right not circumscribed by any limits.

Clearly the Western Tradition is in agreement with Morsi on this point. The next is more controversial:

40. The teaching of the Catholic Church is hostile to the well-being and interests of society.

In the case of Egypt, readers can substitute “Islam” for “Catholic Church”. Leaving aside for the moment the historical conflict between Traditions in geographic proximity, liberalism rejects any and all spiritual authority. That is why any attempts to “modernize” or to be acceptable to the modern world are ultimately futile. The next proposition is asserted by the French and American Revolutions. With the appropriate change of language, this proposition is also rejected by Morsi.

55. The Church ought to be separated from the State, and the State from the Church.

Proposition 77 is basic for the liberal state as well as by Vatican II under the rubric of “freedom of religion”. Neo-pagans also accept prop 77, thus aligning themselves with liberalism rather than Tradition. We have pointed out that the Ancient City did not accept religious freedom except in an attenuated form. With a suitable verbal transposition, the Islamic state also rejects proposition 77:

77. In the present day it is no longer expedient that the Catholic religion should be held as the only religion of the State, to the exclusion of all other forms of worship.

This is just a sample. The point is that we are hard pressed to determine how the contemporary so-called Catholic viewpoint differs from what is absorbed in a “liberal education”. If we turn to EWTN, we certainly don’t learn much. We can end with an issue of current relevance. One of the functions of the spiritual authority is to determine what is “real”, a prime example, that of the “Real Presence”. Another is what constitutes a “real”, rather than merely a nominal, marriage. We see that the same issue was debated 150 years ago, even if the specifics differ. This false proposition is:

68. The Church has not the power of establishing diriment impediments of marriage, but such a power belongs to the civil authority by which existing impediments are to be removed.

In other words, the spiritual authority alone determines the impediments to marriage. If left to the temporal powers alone, the result will always be wrong. Hence, attempts to “debate” in our time what constitutes marriage are doomed to fail ultimately; the modern mind is not bound by the real but by the nominal.

Posted on 2012-12-03 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 23:17 said:

This was a very good article, Cologero.

Sadly I think we all know that the sect based on the Vatican II teachings calling itself the Catholic Church is the direct opposite of Catholicism.

I am sure you've read Fr Rama Coomaraswamy's book ?

PS – the experience of the shallow hypocrisy that is liberal education is what led me to reject modernity as a whole

Michael on 2012-12-04 at 19:39 said:

My guess is that the EWTN host would have agreed with everything in the Syllabus, but one can't just replace every instance of "Catholic" with "Islam" and have the statements still be accurate. Even if the Church insists that the "Catholic religion should be held as the only religion of the State," there is no one who would listen in the post-modern age. The Church has no choice but to try to work with the liberal culture. The good news (or the bad news) is the attempt to engage the liberal culture is failing miserably. This reminds me of the following quote from Belloc:

"But if I be asked what sign we may look for to show that the advance of the Faith is at hand I would answer by a word the modern world has forgotten: Persecution. When that shall once more be at work it will be morning."

It seems morning is coming soon.

I know that this blog is about Tradition, not theology, but logic still holds. Either Jesus was God or he was not. If he is God, then he built his Church that we must obey. We have his promise that the gates of hell will not overcome his Church so we don't have the option of leaving it simply because large portions of it have capitulated to the liberal culture. There are plenty of Catholics who remain faithful to the Church as she has stood for 2000 years. "Yet I have left me seven thousand in Israel, all the knees which have not bowed unto Baal."

As for Islam, I understand that there are certain aspects of the culture that reflect Tradition, but it is only by derivation. Would you really want to belong to the culture that Morsi is implementing? And even if you prefer it to the Church, is it an option if the Jesus is God?

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-04 at 22:37 said:

I would answer that Islam is still preferable to a godless society.

The Church does not have to engage the world, if the world is refusing to follow God then the Church must withdraw from the world and return to the catacombs.

Indeed, despite all the attempts of Satan, God's Church is still here and is destined to prevail in the End.....

Cologero on 2012-12-05 at 00:06 said:

Given recent comment topics, here is a link to Roger Garaudy's conversions from Marxism to Christianity to Islam: *The philosophical itinerary of Roger Garaudy*⁸. It may be of interest, or maybe not.

I don't know what the Sheik would have thought of Ibn Arabi, Hafiz, or Omar Khayyam who all wrote poems of love. Perhaps Shia is more in tune with the mentality of the West.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-05 at 17:18 said:

I would say, from reading the article, that Garaudy's adoption of Islam was due to residual anti-Western-ness from his Communist past. Many people, even after they realise their need for transcendence in their lives, have still too much "liberal guilt" and self-hatred towards their own people and culture to look for God in the Western past.

I would say also that the elements of Shia that are akin to the Western mind are simply Islamic borrowings from Catholicism.

jAh reZident on 2012-12-06 at 17:56 said:

Surely Tradition points to the way of the One God, and emanates from a received wisdom, ultimately delivered by the prophets Moses, Jesus and Mohammed (pbuh). So 'adoption' of Islam is a misnomer, Jesus as a 'god' is a reversal of tradition, and 'modernity' is the ploy of the Enemy to prepare the way for the dominance of all that opposes the Real.

Dominion on 2012-12-07 at 21:51 said:

Would you elaborate? I gather you might be thinking of things like devotion to Sufi saints and a greater focus on things like devotional practices and pilgrimages, but I'd say these things arose spontaneously during the transition to Islam, built on local practices, despite their similarity to Catholic practices. Both Shi'ite Iran and Catholic Europe built upon Indo-European religious bases, so it's not too unexpected.

Alexander Maximilian on 2012-12-08 at 14:21 said:

There is an excellent book called "EWTN a Network Gone Wrong" about how the have become a station trying to compete with other stations and thereby have sold out to modernism a lot if it due to the number of Protestant converts that produce many of the shows.

⁸<http://rogergaraudy.blogspot.co.uk/2011/02/philosophical-itinerary-of-roger.html>

21.7 How Not to Save Europe

This perhaps shows more clearly than anything else that deviation has, so to speak, only to be developed and allowed to pursue its course to the end in order finally to lead to subversion properly so called, for when that which is most inferior seeks to imitate and make a counterfeit of superior and transcendent principles, then is the time when real subversion can justly be spoken of.

RENE GUENON, *The Reign of Quantity*

From time to time, I get notices from readers about items that they believe are of personal interest to me. They may be books, requests to review articles, or links to web site or talks. Most recently, someone sent me a link to what he called “New Righters debate Christianity”. The idea density of that description is quite low. I asked for a specific reason to listen to that, but never received a reply.

Obviously, anyone who understands Gornahoor would know that we have nothing in common with the so-called “New Right” and we disdain debates. This lack of understanding also demonstrates why it is pointless to go on ad infinitum. There are hard limits to human understanding. Nevertheless, with time running out on the number of posts, I want to make our position clear once again. But first, a few comments on the debate.

I had outlined this piece without listening to the “debate” because the topic was poorly framed. However, I subsequently looked up **Jonas De Geer** and see that he is a serious man, so I intend no disrespect to him. Mr Johnson’s point reduces to this: “my unicorn is prettier than your mule.” His imaginary racial solidarity, imaginary Europe, and imaginary neo-pagan religion are beyond criticism, unlike something that actually exists, or has actually existed.

There is the obvious confusion of “Europe” as the name for a geographic continent; that is merely a conventional (artificial) designation.

However, when we go looking for the “real” Europe, that is, Europe as it exists in consciousness, as a self-identification, we run into a problem. When **Hilaire Belloc** claims, “Europe is the faith and the faith is Europe”, that is what he means. There was a self-identification of oneself as being in Christendom, effectively much of what is now called “Europe”. Beyond that, there were heathens, i.e., those outside of Europe.

For the Romans, the Empire was the whole world, the Ecumene. Beyond the Ecumene, there were only barbarians, i.e., those outside of civilization. The Roman Empire included a good chunk of Europe, but no one thought of himself as a European, but rather as a “Roman”. Even the Germanic tribes that overran Rome, considered themselves to be Roman, not European. They formed the “Holy Roman Empire” in its various configurations, not the Holy European Empire.

No one answered the question about when the Swedes identified themselves as European. Did the Vikings consider the English and the French as racial brothers when they were terrorizing those nations? The question is risible. They only became part of “Europe” after their conversion to Christianity. There are several other quibbles, some of which we mention in passing, both to clear the air and to point out Mr Johnson’s confusions: Notre Dame Cathedral in Paris was confiscated by the State and is not under the control of the Church.

Then there are some points about anger. **St John Chrysostom** pointed out:

He who is not angry, whereas he has cause to be, sins. For unreasonable patience is the hotbed of many vices, it fosters negligence, and incites not only the wicked but even the good to do wrong.

Thomas Aquinas defines wrath as “the spiritual strength to attack the repugnant”. In this case, it is not an irrational emotion set aflame by demons, but rather an inner power that is in the service of the good and the true. **Peter Chojnowski** in his booklet *Flesh of my Flesh* has

a chapter on this topic, particularly as it relates to men in the modern world. Because of the ideals of “tolerance” and “niceness”,

anger is kept from its normal release in the rectification of that which is disordered. When normal release in acts of ordering are forbidden due to a legal and juridical preoccupation with rights and tolerance, you have personal and social explosion waiting to happen. ... to prevent a man from expressing in any way his repulsion to the disorderly, the perverted, the obnoxious, the dishonorable, is to invite and even ensure the engendering of psychological frustration which can only manifest itself in violent rage.

So back to the debate itself. Whatever the stated purpose was at the beginning, it quickly devolved to answering this question: “How can Europe—or “the White Race”, which is for some reason considered synonymous—be saved. Perhaps that is a burning issue in the confines of that small room, but we are immediately struck by a larger issue. To wit,

Europeans have no desire to be saved They are especially opposed to being saved by anything like the New Right, which is considered racist, nationalist, and fascist. Many tens of millions of Europeans were killed in the 20th century to combat those ideologies. Despite occasional outbursts of enthusiasm, European nationalist parties have no traction at the current time. Hence, they refuse to take the actions the New Right considers necessary. Hence, they are forced to embrace the following dubious premise.

Beliefs lead to action Specifically, the belief they hold is the reason the Europeans refuse to take a certain action. So in order to provoke the desired action, it is first necessary to hold the belief that would necessitate that action. Hence, the task is changed from convincing Europeans

to take action to convincing them to embrace a desired belief, or worldview. But then the New Right encounters another obstacle: the European mind is not a blank slate, but is already filled with beliefs, opinions, and worldviews of various sorts. Hence, Europeans must somehow be convinced that their beliefs are false. Herein lies the next obstacle:

Europeans are happy as they are Europeans are prosperous. The top 10 happiest nations⁹ on earth are European. So how welcome is either Mr Johnson's jeremiad of racial annihilation to the average Joe European?

Clearly, the debate has no point, other than to discredit Christianity. If Traditional Christianity represents "superior and transcendent principles", then Mr Johnson is proposing its counterfeit. That is the force of subversion as described by Guenon in the epigraph. Mr Johnson is proposing a new pagan god, the white race, based on no principle higher than biology and no morality other than its promotion. Unfortunately, biology has not been able to provide any stable definition of race. As we recently read, Julius Evola includes many peoples under the "Aryan" umbrella, far beyond the immediate confines of Europe.

There are two inconvenient facts that were mentioned in passing, but deserve being emphasized.

1. When Europe was Catholic, it didn't need saving
2. Now that Europe is *de facto*, if not *de jure*, non-Christian, it does need saving.

For example, during time (1), there would be no issue with birth rates as there is for time (2). Now you can trust and hope that Mr Johnson's future option 3 unicorn will raise birth rates to replacement levels or you can try to identify the real solution.

⁹<http://www.telegraph.co.uk/travel/destinations/europe/11560153/Which-is-the-worlds-happiest-country.html>

There was no explanation given to the change in worldview. Mr Johnson's assumption is the post-modern assumption that beliefs and worldviews are arbitrary and that people are malleable, able to adopt and discard them at will. He makes no rational argument for a contemporary European to discard his current liberal worldview and start believing in unicorns. The truth of the matter is the opposite of what is assumed. It is not that a faulty worldview will lead to degeneration, but rather that a degenerate people will adopt a faulty worldview.

Part 2 will reframe the debate in terms of Tradition.

Posted on 2015-04-26 by Cologero

* * *

X on 2015-04-27 at 02:02 said:

Great post, Mr. Salvo, haven't read such an article which I fully agree internally for a long time on internet.

"The Roman Empire included a good chunk of Europe, but no one thought of himself as a European, but rather as a 'Roman'. Even the Germanic tribes that overran Rome, considered themselves to be Roman, not European. They formed the 'Holy Roman Empire' in its various configurations, not the Holy European Empire."

I specially like this paragraph.

Max on 2015-04-27 at 08:14 said:

It is good to see that a few souls still know the meaning of the Golden Cross flying on a clear sky blue background even as others have forgotten a long time ago. Those who came before us recognized this sign appearing in the sky above and made it their own by heart.

To Europeans it can be quite amusing if Americans having abandoned Europe goes on about paganism regardless of having almost no connection to it, and it becomes even more absurd if they come here to lecture us on it. There is nothing wrong in exploring ones history, but this conception is a fantasy. We can understand if people loosing contact with their roots tries to cling on to the most external aspects, but merely being of European descent is no merit. Even a son of the king would have to prove his nobility in action or loose his privileged status. An irony is that in the unrealistic and hypothetical case Europeans returned to some pagan past, Americans would hardly be welcome anymore.

An honourable thing for a pagan would be to challenge his opponent for a duel to determine who has the favour of the gods. Johnson admits that his pagan vision is nothing but modernism with some biological racial awareness added, managing to insult his pre-Christian ancestors too. De Geer asserts that a true religion can not be artificially constructed and then throws the challenge: who are willing to die for a belief in “superior DNA”? So there you have it, neo-pagans, see and learn, but be assured though that the real “pagans” of old did not sacrifice themselves for that.

Iron Man on 2015-04-27 at 08:54 said:

These debates are indeed quite pointless because of the failed assumption that the West could actually be either Christian or pagan in an industrialist and capitalist society. Tradition and capitalism are wholly irreconcilable! Many of the New Right have pointed this out in their somewhat interesting books (Benoist, for one is worth reading). The battle, if you will, is not about pagan vs. Christian, but a reaction to what exists by that name in the world today. Unfortunately, Capitalism has replaced Salvation and Gnosis. Catholicism and the Vatican have, since WW2, merged with the Anglo-American empire (which is in many ways the new Roman Empire) to wreak havoc throughout the globe for the purpose of world domination by a band of imperialistic oligarchs. The Anglo-American empire is the most nationalistic, fascist, racist, atheistic, and destructive civilization in the history of man (see William Blum's book, *Killing Hope*), whilst Europe is at its most shameful, complacent, and weak period, existing only as vassals to the new Rome and the holy dollar. But the East is just as corrupted by the capitalist idea, and it is not from the East that the Westerner will be awakened. We have long reached the point (beginning in the early 20th century) when neither the West nor the East can be saved from its folly. Man in its complete and original sense no longer exists, and probably never will again, at least not on a large scale.

laughtingtorch on 2015-04-27 at 10:10 said:

“Whatever the stated purpose was at the beginning, it quickly devolved to answering this question: “How can Europe—or “the White Race”, which is for some reason considered synonymous—be saved.”

I've tried to have this conversation about races within Europe.

And I agree with X, the article is very spot on. Can't wait to read it again.

Alistair Fraser on 2015-04-27 at 17:48 said:

Cologero – another exceptional piece of commentary in such a lean writing style, i am extracting wisdom from your crafted works , highly appreciated .

“Beliefs lead to action.

Specifically, the belief they hold is the reason the Europeans refuse to take a certain action. So in order to provoke the desired action, it is first necessary to hold the belief that would necessitate that action. Hence, the task is changed from convincing Europeans to take action to convincing them to embrace a desired belief, or worldview. But then the New Right encounters another obstacle: the European mind is not a blank slate, but is already filled with beliefs, opinions, and worldviews of various sorts. Hence, Europeans must somehow be convinced that their beliefs are false. Herein lies the next obstacle: ”

Observing “Europeans” and others in my own homelands , allows me to make the following observations and confirms why their beliefs do not lead to any actions that may alter the political or philosophical status quo , there are 2 classes , the ones still scrambling on the rat-trap materialistic ladder of monetary achievement from birthright or otherwise , and the ones that are soma-cosed from our new unofficial pharma-religion which has posted its pharmacy outlets in every local neighborhood with delivery vans for those that cant make the trip for their daily doze and most of the uk population are now rattling with pills, eyes wide shut marching into wherever they may be led

Jacob on 2015-04-27 at 20:12 said:

I usually don't speak this candidly (and if my comment is divisive just delete it), but After actually reading Benoist recently, I'd say The New Right are not of the right at all. There seems to be no belief in anything objective at all, it was like Foucault for nationalists.

” It is not that a faulty worldview will lead to degeneration, but rather that a degenerate people will adopt a faulty worldview.”

I've seen this explained in the last few posts (including Evola himself say it), but I'm having a hard time reconciling that to the subtle ruling the dense. I might just be overthinking it and drawing a false dichotomy though.

Looking forward to your next post.

Lu Dongbin on 2015-04-28 at 15:24 said:

I agree with most of the post, but if the faith is Europe and Europe is the faith, does that mean that if all native Europeans were ethnically replaced by African Catholics from the Congo, Europe would still be Europe? How about Arab or Chinese Catholics? I wonder if non-Europeans would feel similar, i.e. if all of Korea were ethnically replaced by white Europeans who continued the traditions of Korean Confucianism, Buddhism, and shamanism, do you believe they would think Korea would still be Korea?

Also, does historical change play a role? The pagan Norse Vikings may not have been considered part of Europe by the Christians of the same era, but since Europe now does possess a largely common historical cultural and religious background, can those elements (such as religion) now be changed and the common identity still remain?

Cologero on 2015-04-28 at 17:22 said:

Where do we begin, Lu Dongbin? Common identity is more than a landmass and more than DNA. So exactly what is "common" or constant over time?

obscure on 2015-04-28 at 21:18 said:

Lu Dongbin,

Of course, the form of a nation is a unified set of abstract principles which inform the possible material structures of that nation (the arrangements of entities and their modes in space and time). DNA relations (or anything phenomenally concrete for that matter) exist in the first place due to a certain perpetual obedience to form from one generation to the next. If you prefer, I could use the language of Nietzsche: 'Physiological value judgments.' Now, these 'judgments' clearly transcend the concrete phenomena which manifests them. Even the totality of phenomena is of no use if one does not go beyond the brute recognition of phenomenal arrangements in one's thinking. One must, at the very least, have a sense for aesthetics.

The central error in your criticism lies in its grounding in a merely 'factual' perspective, but reality is no mere arrangement of facts. It is a real whole-thing. The word 'replace' as you are using it does not signify anything. That is to say, these imaginary population swaps express a kind of total non-entity. For example, look at the reality of actual 'ethnic replacement' (what a stale term): Does it not simply consist of a certain mode or set of modes which actually signify nothing but general disobedience to form; the negation of principles? We must consider that the temporal procession of things is indeed TEMPORAL and NOT a merely spatial arrangement of facts, a techno-symbolic synthesis of data, a momentarily meaningful agglomeration of 'atoms and accidents', etc.

Problems of this order are purely verbal and ought to disappear with the least exercise of serious thinking.

obscure on 2015-04-28 at 22:01 said:

Jacob,

"I've seen this explained in the last few posts (including Evola himself say it), but I'm having a hard time reconciling that to the subtle ruling the dense. I might just be overthinking it and drawing a false dichotomy though."

Possibilities utterly precede any particular manifestation. If a people becomes degenerate in one particular temporal procession then indefinite possibilities of degeneracy already precede, through their mere ontological status, whatever particular mode of degeneracy actually becomes manifest. Manifestation is a certain contraction or restriction on otherwise self-subsisting possibilities.

Even those possibilities suitable for a particular degenerate people, insofar as they are not pure privations, are 'above' any particular manifestation. For, the positive side of degeneracy is in actuality simply this: That the lowest orders of activity are pursued in such a way as to exclude recognition of high and noble things. Even 'materialism' is a positive worldview, although it necessarily involves and presupposes privation in order to be expressed in its 'purest' form.

21.8 A Priori and Ab Initio

Armin Mohler takes as the basis of the vision of the world the opposition existing between two general conceptions, which he calls *linear* and *cyclic*. According to the former, history is development, novelty, evolution and tends to a final end that justifies it; this is the conception characteristic of the various progressive currents, but Christianity as well insofar as it gravitates toward an "end of times". The latter conception is based instead of the idea of the "eternal return", of the repetition of the same forms; that would be the basal view of the "conservative revolution". In our opinion, the contraposition in these terms is not well formulated. If anything, we should speak of historicism and antihistoricism, of "civilizations of being" and of "civilizations of becoming". It is not a question of expecting the return of the same forms, but rather of believing that fundamental values never change, of recognizing a *normative* order containing *a priori* and *ab initio* all the principles, without which a civilization and a normal society are inconceivable.

JULIUS EVOLA, A Failed Revolution¹⁰, *Rassegna Italiana*, June 1952

Looking back at what is now called the German "conservative revolution" several decades after, Evola calls it the "failed revolution". He identifies

¹⁰<https://gornahoor.wordpress.com/2015/12/06/a-failed-revolution/>

the simplistic arguments—literally, “chump change” polemics—which do not “take reality into account”. Half a century later, in our time, we see the same chump change formulas, the same logical impasses, being repeated by the various incarnations of the “right”. Specifically, the debates center around specific forms rather than the principles behind those forms. When the discussions break down, then novelties are introduced: there is a “new” right, an “alternative” right, and so on; in other words, the focus remains in “becoming” rather than in “being”. A normative order is never defined; rather it is debated, perhaps with a great deal of intensity, yet without resolution. So what comes first and at the beginning?

A Priori First of all, the world of being and the world of becoming must be distinguished. Thus, the first chapter of *Revolt Against the Modern World* begins with this:

In order to understand both the spirit of Tradition and its antithesis, modern civilization, it is necessary to begin with the fundamental doctrine of the two natures. According to this doctrine there is a physical order of things and a metaphysical one; there is a mortal nature and an immortal one; there is the superior realm of being and the inferior realm of becoming. Generally speaking, there is a visible and tangible dimension and, prior to and beyond it, an invisible and intangible dimension that is the support, source, and true life of the former.

Rene Guenon makes a distinction between Being and Existence; the former is the principle of the latter. The same doctrine is formulated in Buddhism as *samsara* and *nirvana*. In Taoism, as Heaven and Earth, or Yang and Yin.

Now this is not a metaphysical dualism, or as Evola put it, “There is dualism and there is dualism.” That is, there are not two independent opposing principles, as Manichaeism and other Gnostic religions believed.

Rather, the realm of Being is the “support, source, and true life” of the realm of Becoming. Hence, it is impossible to understand the realm of Becoming without first understanding the realm of Being.

For many, if not most, this comes across as “life denying”. This is more noticeable in the exoteric teaching of this doctrine, which seems to value “Heaven” more highly than life on earth. That can lead to a certain passivity. Yet, its opposite is to live a life enthralled to the glamour of the world. That life values the phantasmagoria of passing phenomena, which is itself “life denying.”

Ab Initio To find out what there was from the beginning, we can turn to the revelation of the Gospels. Mark begins *in media res*. Matthew begins with Abraham and Luke with Adam. However, John begins at the beginning, with the Logos. Since John is the beloved disciple¹¹, this is the best place to start. Hence, the Hermetists adhere to the Church of John¹².

Now in the beginning the Logos was with God. Since God is the principle of Being, there can be no distinction between Being and the Logos, or said differently, creativity and order are at the heart of Being. To be clear, Order is not inferior to Being, nor is there an eternal conflict between Order and chaos.

Hence, Evola can affirm that there is a normative order to Being, even without fully accepting the Revelation that grounds that order. The Left¹³ is fully aware of that order, since its purpose is to overturn it at every opportunity. The various, sundry, new, alternative, and ersatz Rights, on the other hand, all too often are only dimly aware of that normative order.

There is no point in repeating the lineaments of that order, as it has

¹¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=8195>

¹²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=16881>

¹³<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=5709>

been done often enough. This is just a reminder of the criteria to use when entering into a discussion or debate:

1. Is the question related to the realm of Being or of Becoming?
2. Is the goal to repeat past forms or to manifest eternal values?
3. Are the values proposed eternal or situational?
4. Is it a matter of recognizing the normative order or of undermining it?

Posted on 2015-12-07 by Cologero

* * *

Alistair Fraser on 2015-12-08 at 17:49 said:

@Cologero = A super article above and also the ascesis linked one, your such a treasure of expression

Max on 2016-01-13 at 16:19 said:

Interesting how you say that the left is more aware of the normative order than the right. They may not understand it well, but in acts and the actual outcome of events they always manages to be destructive in one way or another. Someone who just resolved to do everything in the other way as compared to the left would perhaps hit closer to the mark than the various alternative rights, although it is not fail-proof and still passive.

It requires a lot more to be right than to be left, for the latter it is simply a matter of furthering opposition and division, which anyone can do, while the right requires integration. The advancement of the agenda of the left has generally nothing to do with skill on their part, but is rather opportunistic, without much of an evil grand plan at work as some attempts to see it. If the left appears to act in unison, it is not because they are united, or have a common mind, but because they fall down the same slope.

I think there were an earlier allusion that leftists seems to have some sort of vague idea of the primordial state, if yet flawed, however their actions leads in the opposite direction. Why is there such a discrepancy between what they say and what they do? It must mean that they have been fooled, that they are inwardly divided, but they do not notice that or avoids it in every way.

In some persons there is a rare drive for coherency, which is among the most beautiful things there is, and it requires a real open mindedness and willingness to abandon the lesser for the greater in a reach for higher and higher horizons.

21.9 Ship of State

Propaganda must become as natural as air or food. It must proceed by psychological inhibition and the least possible shock. The individual is then able to declare in all honesty that no such thing as propaganda exists. In fact, however, he has been so absorbed by it that he is literally no longer able to see the truth. The natures of man and propaganda have become so inextricably mixed that everything depends not on choice or on free will, but on reflex and myth. The prolonged and hypnotic repetition of the same complex of ideas, the same images, and the same rumors condition man for the assimilation of his nature to propaganda.

JACQUES ELLUL

Those who fail to govern risk being governed by their inferiors.

PLATO, *The Republic*

In the *Republic*, **Socrates** compares the democratic system to a ship. The shipowner needs his ship to reach a destination. All the sailors quarrel among each other, all claiming to know how to navigate the ship safely. They even resort to currying favor with the owner. Meanwhile, the navigator, who gets his skill from gazing at the stars and is therefore the only one who really knows how to direct the ship, is ignored.

Physiognomy **Julius Evola** believed that physiognomy, the study of the meaning of the human face, has an important role in the study of race: not biological race, but rather as a window into the race of the soul. In its crude form, physiognomy is a pseudoscience since it claims to determine permanent character traits from static facial features.

However, by observing facial features dynamically, they give a clue to the inner soul life of a person; this is one aspect of the Hermetic teaching

on “external considering” (see Note). Evola includes an Appendix to his *Summary of the Doctrine of Race* which includes photographs of different types. Rather than posed pictures, he would have preferred photos taken during “one of those moments in which the deepest and most expressive elements” are revealed. Keep in mind that 80 years ago, photos were hard to come by and certainly were not as easily accessible as they are now.

There is some actual science behind this. Although there are about 43 muscles in the face, only 5 are necessary to express the six universal facial expressions: happiness, sadness, fear, anger, surprise, disgust. However, the remaining “assisting muscles” actually add the personal character to the facial expression. That is why training is required for actors. Consciously making those basic expression looks artificial and forced; that is why, for example, people can see through a fake smile. However, controlling all those other muscles is not easy. In method acting, which study I would recommend to Hermetists, the actor tries to recall a personal incident, analogous to the role he is playing, in order to relive it. In that way, the facial expression should be more natural and expressive.

NOTE: Besides facial expression, careful observation of posture, nervous movements, voice intonations, etc., are used to become attuned to another’s inner state. Beyond that, the responses to certain probing questions may be taken into consideration.

Identifying Caste Membership One of the traditional teachings is that few of us are in our natural castes in this age. Evola had this to say about the selection of his photographic material:

The great part of the photographic material is affected by a democratic prejudice: in most cases, they are photos of people of the lower or middle classes. While it would be more important and interesting to consider the highest exponents of a people: its nobility, military and political leaders, priests, and intellectuals.

Although it takes some practice to become skilled in the art and science of physiognomy, it may be worthwhile to practice with available images. Specifically, take a look at the leaders of a nation, or a political party, or an intellectual movement, even the priests or religious leaders? Do they reflect nobility or a sense of transcendence? What do they reveal about the people who accept them? Of course, in our democratic age, the populace will gravitate towards those who look most like them.

The Purpose of Political Parties In the USA, which is dominated by two parties, people complain about the lack of choice. In other nations, too many parties prevent governance. Suppose political parties actually stood for something. For example, a party would be committed to a particular and well-articulated intellectual tradition. Its leaders would be trained in that tradition. Office seekers would be vetted by the party before being allowed to run for a political office. That might include health records, psychological profiles, IQ or aptitude test scores, and so on. Or on the other hand, we could just keep the Ship of Fools going as is as long as possible.

That is probably not possible in a democracy. However, the situation in Tradition is different; it is similar as far as intellectual integrity goes, but there is no need for multiple parties. For Tradition, according to **Rene Guenon**, the spiritual leaders follow an unbroken chain and the originary spiritual impulse is passed down from generation to generation.

Similarly, the political class was based on an aristocracy of merit that embodied the highest and noblest ideals of a people.

Perhaps the many alternative movements around today could follow this pattern. They would follow a consistent philosophical, scientific, metaphysical, or political tradition. Its leaders would have to demonstrate competence in that tradition. They would post photographs exhibiting their noble bearing, as well as their qualifications. *We need to identify the stargazer, not the sailors.*

Polish Thought Police

Once upon a time, at a conference of Evangelical theologians, a small group went out to dinner at a nice restaurant. The pretty waitress came to the table and asked, “Would you gentlemen like a cocktail first?” The theologians looked at each other awkwardly until one of them finally spoke up. “Uhh,” he said, “we don’t drink . . . at least not in front of each other.”

Years ago, I had the pleasure of knowing a Polish gentleman, a physicist, who had gotten onto a train to Austria without money or possession, disembarked in Vienna, and sought asylum. Over bottles of vodka, we would discuss life behind the Iron Curtain.

The most difficult thing was the pretense. By the late 1970s, the illusion of Marxism could no longer be maintained. Nevertheless, in a university setting, no one wanted to be the first to speak up for fear of the possible repercussions. Hence, for show, they would study Marx and shout, “Power to the People”.

Paradoxically, that seems to be the situation in the West. If you are among those who are convinced that $2+2=5$, then you feel no discomfort. Otherwise, you do.

Gaslighting and the Authoritarian Personality Gaslighting is a form of mental abuse in which a sociopath, for example, tries to convince the victim that he is insane. We see that at work in political discourse. Vague accusations of racism, homophobia, misogyny, and so on, are made willy-nilly, in order to impugn the mental stability of candidates or their supporters. Attitudes that well-bred men used to believe were healthy and normal—from the big bang to a couple of generations ago—are not anathematized. That is the price of progress.

A prime example of this is a recent study on the so-called “authoritarian personality” (which I saw on GPS this weekend). Now the original

study was made some 70 years ago by the Frankfurt School, allegedly to identify potential fascists. The new study is even worse.

The professor claimed that the identifying mark is the desire for “Law and Order”. Now I don’t like these interview shows because the interrogators are seldom intelligent or quick-witted enough to ask the correct follow up questions. The alternative is illegality and disorder, isn’t it? That sounds absurd on its face, until you think it through and see that it is actually endemic to the modern world. The overlooking of the illegal and the use of disorder as a political tactic is abundantly clear.

Unfortunately for his case, the real authoritarian personality is not the one in favor of law and order. Under the rule of law (at least in its ideal), justice is blind and does not depend on the arbitrary whim of a “strong man”. The opposite case, however, can only be resolved by the strong man. For example, a while back Chris Rock compared the President and First Lady as the mom and dad of a country who should be obeyed.

If so interested, I will allow photo comparisons in the comments. As an example, compare the photos of Pope Francis to Pope Pius XII.



Figure 21.1: Pope Francis / Pope Pius XII

Posted on 2016-03-15 by Cologero

* * *

Cologero on 2016-03-18 at 12:29 said:

Here are some examples of the use of lawlessness and chaos as a political tactic.

When the Law Is a Drag: <https://pjmedia.com/victordavishanson/law-is-a-drag/?singlepage=true>

France's Highways Descend Into Chaos & Lawlessness: <http://www.zerohedge.com/news/2016-01-26/frances-highways-descend-chaos-lawlessness>

Sparrow on 2016-03-21 at 00:15 said:

Coincidentally, I've recently been reading on Hegel's views of the spirit and physiognomy. Racial political correctness did not exist back in the day, but Hegel seems quite eager to correct himself. He asserts that "spirit leaves nothing to chance," then in another work asserts that physical differences do not reflect the spirit and are "accidents." of course, the physiognomy of Hegel's day was largely materialistic, he may have been more accepting to Evola's belief in spiritual races.

Olavsson on 2016-03-21 at 14:37 said:

We could compare Julius Evola and Frithjof Schuon, two "Traditionalists" with a widely different style. Video is even more useful than photographs, as we can study changing expressions, voice intonations, gestures etc in better detail.

Schuon:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F9T90Gwfk40>

Evola:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiCtdi5nCoA>

Note that both men are aging in these recordings, so we see them after they have matured as much as they were capable of.

Evola comes much more alive to you when watching him in this format, than when seeing a few old black-and-white photographs for which he had posed pretentiously. He's certainly got charisma. Every now and then he reveals something almost "vampyric" in a romantic-draculian-aristocratic sense (which I suspect he would even have taken as a compliment). It is also easy to see that he still retains strong residues of attachment to the ego-self. Does he come across as 'noble'. Definitely, but mainly in the cultural and human degree of appealing to a historical archetype, which is done deliberately and self-consciously. I accept Evola's own discernment that he was a kshatriya as far as this four-fold caste-categorization is concerned. The entire aura of Schuon, on the other hand, is very characteristic of the sagely type, which is 'noble' (arya) in

a higher octave altogether. He appears spiritual in a deeper, more essential and selfless sense. (Note that I'm here ignoring the various personal controversies and so on, which would be to stray from the context in question.) But both men, Schuon as much as Evola, were possibly too concerned with outer image, and even in the case of Schuon, this might be a sign of a sublimated vanity. The purest spiritual nobility is that of men who do not deliberately and self-consciously act or appear in a certain manner because they know this is what signals nobility or spirituality, but rather that of men who spontaneously be this way without any thought of the self or any desire thereof or self-interest, who are genuinely selfless before the Divine as well as before others, and thus let the Heavenly wu-wei flow through them unhindered.

For we whose foremost interest when it comes to these men is the validity of Traditional doctrines and truths, the question of their personal qualities aside from their intellectual ability to get these things straight (and none of them—especially not Evola—were entirely infallible or unbiased in this respect) is largely uninteresting. But in this context, when we're concerned with the personal dimension, it may hold some limited relevance. In the preface to the English edition of 'Introduction to Magic' (page xiv), we see that Evola's ex-lover Sibilla Aleramo says of him: "He is inhuman, an icy architect of acrobatic theories, vain, vicious, perverse..." To Evola's defense, it may be pointed out that she was hardly unbiased, and her experience was with the young 'magical' incarnation of him.

It should always be remembered that "not all that is gold will glitter" when we study these things. A man or woman of high spiritual stature, or nobility, may not necessarily give us that impression immediately based on more superficial factors, our prejudices, preconceptions and so on, as our eye—and our integral knowledge—is simply not sufficiently subtle to notice everything that transcends our own inner condition to a considerable extent, and which may be concealed from curious eyes. But these things are never impossible to see for those possessing the required knowledge, as they leave definite signs in the outer being: whether WE as individuals, given our own limitations, are able to consciously register it is quite another question. Also, as the Christ said according to the Gospel of Thomas, "There is light within a person of light, and it shines on the whole world; if it does not shine, it is dark."

One thing I do notice these days is that the outright evil of many members of the modern 'elites' is very clearly reflected—in fact often grossly visible—in their countenance, almost as if they were demonically possessed. Especially the eyes are usually very revealing in this respect, being the "mirror of the soul". There are many, many examples one could refer to, but in these days, Hillary Clinton would be one appropriate case to mention. For those who have eyes to see, the agents of the dark-side may be quickly identified thus, and one may even derive from such observation an impression of the varying degrees of inner 'demonization' (being the fall into the infra-human, as Guenon would say, almost as an inverted transcendence) that dominate different personalities. Here we are dealing not merely with cases of inept and incompetent, mediocre 'plebeians' who have been able to ascend to the ranks of power because of the quantitative

reign of 'demotism'. but in fact with something far more sinister. We must realize that there are even highly "intelligent" and cunning elitists who work under the sign of evil, who are more than what the official images and stories that are presented make us believe. Without being able to see into the depths of such figures, to see which principal forces (and intelligences) they are serving and are infiltrated by ("possessed" of) beyond/behind the official political and ideological facade of the most superficial interests and agendas, we will remain forever blind to what Evola termed "the third dimension of history" in his commentaries on the "occult war."

Some final words: For the highest norm of a noble inner as well as outer "style", we can do no better than studying sages and masters, saints etc whose lives were wholeheartedly dedicated to a single-minded quest for Divine Truth. To the extent they are fully permeated by this path, and have integrated their insights fully, it will show. No person should be taken as an ideal embodiment of any kind unless they are truly holy. Then it will only be a matter of the "blind leading the blind." But if we mimic them for the sake of our egos, instead of sacrificing ourselves fully to the Way, we will have missed the entire point.

Harun on 2016-03-22 at 04:44 said:

I would also consider a few legends about people looking the same.

The state of the being of someone can influence his physical appearance.

For example is the count of St.Germain immortal or is he a succession of initiates that look very similar and also share memories?

Also, Guénon mentioned in a letter to De Giorgio that St.Pius of Petralcina looked very similar to a contemporary sufi sheyk.

Cologero on 2016-03-22 at 21:19 said:

Although the saying goes "never judge a book by its cover", people can't avoid it. Of course, any worthwhile physiognamy isn't interested just in physical attractiveness. Presumably Evola, growing up in Italy, would have been aware of the tradition of physiognamy described in the following links (not taught in RCIA classes AFAIK):

The Eyes and the Gaze: http://www.traditioninaction.org/Cultural/A018cpManualCivility6_Gaze.htm

The Face Reveals the Heart of the Man: <http://www.traditioninaction.org/religious/n001rpFaceRevealsMan.htm>

Four Ways to Discern a Man's Soul by His Appearance: http://www.traditioninaction.org/religious/n003rpLapide_Appearance_2.htm

The Eyes Are the Mirror of the Soul: http://www.traditioninaction.org/religious/n002rpLapide_Appearance.htm

Cologero on 2016-03-22 at 21:40 said:

Many interesting points, Olavsson. I would just confirm that the ordinary person is quite unskilled in this science, otherwise con men and psychopaths, not to mention most politicians, would have no careers. I recall my time at voir dire for jury selection. The attorney asked each of us how could we tell if someone was lying. Most women asserted they "could see it in their eyes". I'm sure that outside the courtroom, those very women would complain about all the lies that men had told them.

Vanity traditionally has been considered the most subtle vice, since it often follows great spiritual progress. It seems unavoidable for anyone who strives to be a public figure, since motives can easily be confounded.

As for Miss Aleramo, her reaction is likely due to Evola's transcendence of bourgeois values. In particular, women sometimes get upset when a man can't be manipulated sexually.

Boreas on 2016-03-23 at 08:28 said:

Interesting points Olavsson regarding Evola and Schuon. I've come to think Evola as some sort of a LHP figure lately, and this 'personal equation' that he himself talked alot could perhaps show out also in his facial expressions and gestures. In my opinion there was always something 'luciferian' about Evola, and this would show up both in his actions, in his personal weltanschauung and even in his physical personality. He was more a "soulful" personality than purely "spiritual" as for example Guénon or Schuon.

This also reminds me of Guénon's view that the "revolt of the Kshatriyas" was a 'luciferian' phenomenon (he mentioned it in 'Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power'. if I recall correctly).

Max on 2016-03-29 at 09:08 said:

Most people have quite boring facial features and expressions. Evola has an idiosyncratic expression as one would expect. One can usually come into contact with interesting people by simply being on the look out for interesting and differentiated expression. The predominant emotional state of a person often shows in the face, and there are often many signs of negative emotion in various forms.

When studying people in for example public transport, it is very unusual to see someone who seems to be inner motivated – most are being carried away by various stimuli and acts as if on auto-pilot. Nowadays it is very rare to see someone simply sitting straight up with a good posture, having a clear and awake gaze, not distracting himself with some gadget, slumbering, talking loudly and incoherently, or just plain mentally drifting. The other day I was on the commuter train and an elderly couple clearly on temporary visit sat down on the opposing seats, actively seeking my eyes and smiling, there was a sense of emphatic and polite understanding, like a refreshing flash from a world that does not exist anymore, it made me think of what we have lost.

Olavsson on 2016-04-02 at 15:16 said:

@Alistair Fraser:

There is an idea in certain initiatic currents that a highly capable master may, under certain conditions, "transmit" by his power a particular inner state into a qualified disciple, an awakening to a higher state inspired by that direct contact with one in whom the inner state is transcendent in relation to one's own. In other words, an act of spiritual grace using the master as an intermediary. This may be very distantly related to what you experienced with that woman, though on a far more ordinary level. Of course, I think it's quite normal to have at least a small awareness of how differently we may be affected by the contact with diverse human types. It is important to learn the art of analyzing the effect of these contacts from the viewpoint of spiritual priorities. For example, we can decide to "ride the tiger" of Kali-yuga and hang out at decadent underground nightclubs in the cities and risk being affected by the negative influences at work in such places, or we can simply stay away and distance ourselves increasingly from the low spirit of the times, thus creating ideal conditions for the contemplative path. (*Beata solitudo, sola beatitudo...*) We've always got a choice.

The same goes for the insidious onslaught of subversive propaganda that you mention, by which we are ambushed from all directions nowadays. We must close our doors upon it to the exact extent this is possible given our circumstances. Regarding propaganda (mentioned in Cologero's post), I recently came across an intriguing satanic counter-initiate (founder of the Temple of Set) who used to work within US military with an above top secret security clearance, Dr. Michael Aquino; he has apparently written a book called 'MindWar'. regarding which he says:

"There is no defense whatever against MW PSYCONS, because they access the subconscious, not the conscious thought process. You would have absolutely no idea a MW campaign was being directed against you unless you knew exactly what to look for, and quite possibly not even then."

But if we are firmly rooted in an orthodox Traditional worldview, metaphysics and esoterism, and are able to thoroughly and deeply apply the proper First Principles to everything, always remaining watchful and guarding our own minds, I cannot see how exactly the enemy would be able to influence us through the subconscious to the degree of conditioning our reactions and orientations in the world. There is a great difference between the average man in the street and, say, a Guénon. So why does our satanic Dr. Aquino want us to believe there is "no defense whatever" against it? Curious, isn't it? Perhaps in order to subtly plant the sinister suggestion that certain elites are almighty, like God, and cannot possibly be opposed? Men like him, and so much the more when they have been involved in extensive scientific research into these matters, are masters of manipulation, and everything they say should be closely scrutinized, never taken at face value.

Re: the Evola video footage: It is true that this interview was filmed after his war accident, but his entire upper body was unaffected, so I don't think his facial expressions and so on would

have been particularly changed. He seems pretty natural and effortless in that video. I would have paid more to see a video of Guenon than the younger Evola, as a matter of fact. Also, being more or less Hermetists, after all, we will know that this very significant and dramatic incident in the life of Evola symbolically corresponds to a facet of his inner condition. Evola himself—having a metaphysical and spiritual rather than profane/modern outlook on every aspect of reality—knew it wasn't a mere isolated coincidence, but he apparently never attained certainty as to the deeper reason for his fate. If my memory serves me right, Mircea Eliade also thought it signalled something about his inner condition. My own suggestion is that the answer to why it happened was hidden where Evola would have been the least interested in searching for it, as it would (perhaps) have humbled him more than a little. Anyhow, he faced these challenging last years of his life with admirable inner strength, and I hope that God granted him in death at least some of the liberation he had lived for. How interesting it would have been to be able to trace his (and others' postmortem destiny.

@Cologero:

Seeing through lies is not so easy if one wants to believe the lies. One word: detachment. And what you say about vanity is the plain truth.

Re: Aleramo: You might be right about that. While I am as defiant towards the bourgeois way of life as anyone, simply because it is completely contrary to my nature, one should nevertheless be careful not to make this a guiding principle of its own, which may possibly even take precedence over more essential principles. What must ultimately be transcended is the lower self, after all, which is perfectly capable of reinforcing itself even while 'transcending' bourgeois norms.

@Boreas:

You are right to view Evola's own chosen course as basically "LHP" ("Left-Hand Path"), which I do not think he would have protested, based on various statements in the video interview I linked to, for example. Here we can mention his individualistic and independent approach to the path, not having made commitment to any formal tradition, but that is widespread in our age and doesn't necessarily make one LHP. However, his insistence on not answering to any spiritual authority higher than his own individual self, almost a 'promethean' approach to transcendence (which is why the way of the magus initially appealed to him), his fascination with what he himself termed the "antinomianism" of certain Hindu tantras (a tradition which Guénon, incidentally, thought Evola wasn't fit to deal with...), and his attempt to practice Left-Hand Tantrism as a 'freelancer' outside a proper traditional context—all of this, and more, combine to make him quite LHP, if we define this term in the broadest fashion possible, allowing for many nuances. It is important to emphasize, however, that this does not at all mean he considered his own solution an ideal path to be emulated from a general point of view. (For example, he referred someone to Sufism, curiously saying that he himself was more interested in "power" than spirituality.) Personally, I am prone to suggest that Evola placed spiritual limitations upon himself,

ironically due to a quest for individual spiritual freedom, independence and self-sufficiency, that could have been overcome if he had submitted himself to a more regular path as was done by a Guénon.

As for Evola's "personal equation", I think you are right in describing him as more of a "soulful" than a "purely spiritual" type, which is not so strange considering his kshatriya nature. He often spoke of the unconditioned Absolute, but due to this personality factor, I doubt that he would ever have been suited for anything above the "Lesser Mysteries", which in any case is the initiatic domain that has typically been appropriate for kshatriyas according to Guénon. Esoterism in Europe seems seldom to have went beyond it.

And speaking of the "revolt of the kshatriyas", it is interesting that Red is considered a stage superior to White in esoteric alchemy, which (as Evola never tired of pointing out) identifies itself much with royal symbolism—almost as if the Will is above Intellection, or the Soul above the Spirit. This is a theme that keeps returning in deviated initiations. (Well exemplified by Crowley's famous maxim, "Do what thou wilt shall be the whole of the law", as if the Great Quest can start and end with the isolated self-will of some individuated "I" that is, moreover, in a fallen state).

Also, there are several things that could be mentioned in connection to the "revolt of the kshatriyas", Luciferianism and the Counter-Initiation, all of which may be inter-related, but it will have to wait, for this comment is getting too lengthy.

Tom on 2016-04-07 at 05:47 said:

There are examples in Indo-European traditions of Physiognomy besides the obvious caste distinctions of Hinduism. In Old Norse literature we can see clearly from *Rígsthula* that the three castes could be identified by physical characteristics with the lowest being the darkest. More subtle examples can be found in the sagas where physical attributes have cultural and symbolic significance in. They reveal aspects of a person's character, disposition and their future. Very often the symbolic nature of a character is identified by their lineage and their behaviour, but both of these variables can in turn be related to the physical attributes of that character. In *Njals saga*, *Hrútr* describes his niece *Hallgerdhr* as having "thieves' eyes", which is a portent to the coming events of the novel generated by *Hallgerdhr*'s un womanly and dominating nature. later in the saga *Hallgerdhr* makes scathing comments about the appearances of *Bergthóra*, *Njáll*, and their sons (whom she calls dung-beardlings due to the implied shame of the fact their father *Njall* is unable to grow a proper beard); this physical lack is a signifier of implied sexual inadequacy. All this contrasts greatly with the physical description in the same saga of the heroic character *Gunnar*:

"He was handsome and fair of skin and had a straight nose, turned up at its tip. He was blue-eyed and keen eyed and ruddy cheeked, with thick hair, blonde and well combed."

Thomas Blanchard on 2016-07-11 at 16:49 said:

I was reminded of this post while reading Plinio Corrêa de Oliveira's physiognomic analysis of political revolutionaries' faces, which I'll share here as it may be of some interest: <http://nobility.org/2016/02/18/three-faces-of-the-revolution/>

As children, it feels natural to make inferences about character based on physical appearance (and particularly facial features), although most modern adults suppress these judgements as they're taught not to.

Max on 2016-09-11 at 14:56 said:

Here is a passage from George Duby's book on medieval artwork "The Age of the Cathedrals" under the heading of "Faces":

"The growing number of characters in the liturgical drama filling the theaters in the cathedral porches meant that each had to be distinguished. Certainly they bore their insignia, the special attribute given to each prophet, each precursor, each apostle in Christian iconography, but they also had to be endowed with personal features capable of conveying a specific psychological expression. The vocabulary of the literary works available to knights in the thirteenth century was extremely poor. Joinville abounded in eloquent portrayals of spirited combat and the motley glamor of courtly gatherings, but became tongue-tied when it was a matter of describing character. In practical life at any rate, in the surveys carried out to ascertain the distribution of feudal rights or to settle points of usage and sometimes even before their confessors, the lords, great and small, gradually sharpened their analytical ability. As for the academic world, it was accustomed to introspection, which already offered a foothold for the morality of Abelard. All theology led to ethics. It involved the exploration of the soul, the classification of its capacities and its virtues. And as the intellectual system of doctors was based on the principle of the unity of the universe, as it asserted the close cohesion of the three components of the human being – mind, soul, and body – it naturally considered that facial features faithfully translated individual dispositions. The scholastic approach, however, was bent on resolving the particularities of each individual through the forms common to his species. It proceeded by distinguishing kinds. More exactly, then, the faces of the statues represent types of men."

The practical science of Physiognomy then, seems primarily to have been a domain of artisans and knights rather than schoolmen, which contributes to its perception as a Hermetic discipline, for in the old tales we find the wise hermit as a retired knight. The intellectual class can be prone to too much abstraction when focusing at what is common to the species, which we need to remember is nevertheless made up of individuals with distinguishing marks. The usage of "species" seems to have undergone quite a lot of change throughout history and should refer more to what is "seen" as a "medium of knowledge" than a dry external classification. <http://www.newadvent.org/cathen/14210a.htm>

On the topic of seeing I found the man in this photo an interesting study, perhaps with a tangent to Swedenborg's claims on hidden teachings, which is unlikely to refer to physical

writings in any case: <http://frontierphotos.blogspot.se/2008/11/bonpo-lama-from-radja-gomba.html>

Primary importance is given to the subtle expression rather than hard facial features, even though those matter as well. This poses a difficulty for art and sculpture since it is naturally easier to capture the outward form than the formless aspect of a person. However, in the ancient world they would also ritually “animate” statues so as to not merely see it as a lump of rock.

The species cannot, in the manner of enlightenment rationalism, be isolated from the spectrum that ties the intellectual to the corporeal. We can take the term “specter” as referring to particular visions of the intermediary realm, however it is curiously enough also an anagram of “scepter”, the insignia of the emperor signifying temporal authority and power, raising images not only of the legitimate ruler but of the specter of the earth, ideas which seems to be somehow connected. To some degree, a ruler will at least need an understanding if not mastery over appearances and the interplay of soft and hard.

“To establish the Way of Heaven: that is yin plus yang. To establish the Way of Earth: that is soft [jou] plus hard [yo]. To establish the Way of Man: that is humanity plus justice” – I Ching, as quoted by Guenon

21.10 Mayday, Mayday

High-minded words of formal meaning are used to arouse passion, prejudice and sentimentality in favor of disguised real aims. This method cannot serve the truth, yet throughout history and down to the present it is consistently used to deceive people in the interests of the mighty.

JAMES BURNHAM, *The Machiavellians*

The cause of all wars and revolutions — in a word, of all violence — is always the same: the negation of hierarchy.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

The primary causal agent is always an idea become person, with a will that pursues determinate ends—a cognizant will that has a program to realize, a concrete thought, effective in history. ... The

few, in so far as they were the conscience and the will of an epoch, were the agents of history. They recognized the forces that were available, and employed that which was really the only active and effective force available to them—their own will.

GIOVANNI GENTILE

Being and Becoming There two worlds of Being and Becoming, or the Civilizations of Space and Time, have corresponding forms of knowing. For the former, there is the “supreme knowing”, or *paravidya*, which is direct knowledge of the highest reality. In contrast, *apraavidya*, is the lower knowledge of appearances. Although Rene Guenon seems to disdain what he calls “profane science”, as *apraavidya* it has its proper place, provided it is subordinated to the higher knowledge.

When Being is forgotten, there is only becoming. Knowledge of becoming alone is illusory because the ego superimposes its own interpretation onto the real. A real science will dispel such illusory interpretations in order to penetrate to the real. For practice, we will try to apply such teachings onto the ongoing presidential election in the USA. Therefore, we will focus on political science. Table 21.2 lists the sciences specific to the four traditional castes.

First of all, it is important to note that this schema is not arbitrary, since hierarchy is reflection of the celestial order. Hence, this is the order of Being, eternally present, beyond time; it is the very opposite of a nostalgia for the past. Forgetfulness of being results in judging things from the viewpoint of becoming: hence, instead of a theophany, what are seen in hierarchy are only privations, defects, and contingent historical events.

There is no doubt about the notion of hierarchy, since it stands at the base of all political divisions of mankind. One group, the reactionaries, favors the manifest existent of the hierarchy while the revolutionaries, to one degree or another, seek to overthrow them. Besides the castes, there are relationships between the sexes and the peoples of the world. The

latter are not eternal. Of course, there are counterfeit hierarchies that are not based on eternal principles.

Formal and Real Meaning We see from the table that man is subjected to laws from the various levels of being. From below, he is under biological laws, chemical, and physical laws. He may even be under demonic laws. From above, he is subject to social, economic, and political forces, not to neglect the natural law.

Now Theology and Political Science have been regarded in the West as the highest of the sciences: theology, for the Medieval schoolmen, and the knowledge of politics as the highest aim of the Greek philosophers. Nevertheless, apart from economics, which is math intensive, the social sciences today tend to attract the least capable students. The result is that political science is underdeveloped with deleterious effects on political discourse.

James Burnham in *The Machiavellians* develops a theory of power based on several recent thinkers influenced by Machiavelli: **Gaetano Mosca**, **Georges Sorel**, **Robert Michels** and **Vilfredo Pareto**. Burnham makes an important distinction between the formal and real meanings of political rhetoric. The formal meaning is an ideological, idealistic, or moral illusory superimposition that appeals to the sentiments and passions of people. As such, it disguises the real aims, which are those of power.

When factions debate ideological issues, the issue of who exactly is seeking power becomes obscured. Now the aims of the political system are security against outsiders and justice within. Nevertheless, the political leaders are still subjected to the laws of power, since few men are just. Hence, on the one hand the ideal state aims to establish security and justice, while on the other hand, the leaders need to retain power against enemies without and interlopers within. That is why, as we shall see, the philosopher-king does not rule.

The Machiavellians approach political science not as the abstract vi-

sion of the ideal state, but rather as the study of how people actually behave when seeking and exercising power. Hence, they try to penetrate the formal meaning of rhetoric to expose the real meaning. Their findings are too rich to explain here, but we can just point out that lying, duplicity, violence, and so on are inevitable concomitants to rule.

Hence, we should not be at all surprised that politicians lie as a matter of course. The strange thing is that the populace cares so little about such lies. Of course, that is likely because the people themselves are liars and consider it quite normal. Then the ideologues actually believe the formal rhetoric and are willing to accept any means they think will lead to the desired ends. Probably, too, many of the politicians are self-deluded and believe in their own formal rhetoric.

Formal rhetoric is often just a sentence, a phrase, or a myth that captures the attention of voters despite its intellectual vacuity. Examples are “we are a nation of immigrants”, “black lives matter”, “women make 79 cents on the dollar”, and so on. There are just enough emotional stirrings that counter any subtleties or exceptions to such generalizations.

The exercise of power depends on force. In the “advanced” societies, social force alone may suffice. Next would be financial pressure. Hence, extreme violence, gulags, and so on are seldom required. Nevertheless, the prisons are full, and as we saw in Waco a decade ago, the state is perfectly willing to annihilate a group like the Branch Davidians when its authority is mocked.

So the philosopher king is in a bind. In order to establish justice, he must hold power. In order to retain power he may have to act unjustly.

Levels of Being This is why so called “debates” about “the issues” are so ineffective. I have never seen a talking head on TV suddenly change his opinion after hearing out his opponent. Those living in Maya only grasp their own superimposition, or interpretation, of reality, rather than reality itself.

Idle chatter about this or that movement or ideology, or how one system of thought “caused” another. This is ludicrous since a thought in itself has no causal efficacy. An idea gains power only when a person with a will entertains it. So the real, and important, question is why a person would believe one idea rather than another. It is related to the person’s level of being, since he cannot understand any idea that comes from a higher level.

So it cannot be liberalism, or conservatives, etc., that is the problem. Rather the world declines due to the degeneration in level of being. Higher things are forgotten.

Bullet Points **Hillary Clinton, the Dominatrix:** this is how she deals with men who stray from the approved program: We came, we saw, he died¹⁴.

Ted Cruz and Theocracy: The talking heads know nothing about Evangelicals and their disputes. I recently spoke to a New Yorker, a book editor, quite intelligent and educated; she admitted she had never spoken to an Evangelical. Most evangelicals are of the “left behind” type, expecting to escape from the world. Cruz, however is a “dominionist” who believes that the world will soon come under Christ’s dominion in seven areas (which they call mountains): religion, government, business, media, education, entertainment, and family. He should have been more upfront about the real motivation for his campaign.

The Conservative Mind: The talking heads and politicians all claim to be the “true conservatives”. I heard one such fellow tonight defend a position that no conservative used to hold. They should start with **Russell Kirk** and move on from there.

Naïve Journalism: It was revealed that the Obama administration “played” the mostly young journalists who were covering the Iran nuclear deal. Of course they are ignorant and even naïve, deluded by Obama’s

¹⁴<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Fgcd1ghag5Y>

formal, rather than real, meaning. A check of declared college majors by SAT score will show that the poorer students go into journalism and communication, so we should not be surprised. Their elders are not really any more intelligent.

Climate change and the rain dance: Vilfredo Pareto identifies many “residues” in human societies; these are cross-cultural constants, although they will be disguised in different forms. One is the idea of controlling the weather through rain dances, rituals, prayers, etc. For the modern man, this manifests as the belief in “climate change”. Although this may not explain the science of global warming, it certainly explains the rabidly emotional and evangelical attitude of its main proponents.

Elizabeth Warren Talks Tough: The Democratic senator from Massachusetts denounced Trump as “sexist, racist, and xenophobic”. From the context, we can assume that she regards those as moral defects, although I can’t find them in any traditional (read “authentic”) manual of moral theology. These accusations are intended to destroy a man; in comparison, Trump’s many insults are quite tame.

Political Exposed Person: A US corporation is not allowed to do business with a family member or close associate of a Politically Exposed Person. For example, a company like Goldman Sachs, hoping to do business in Rio, could not pay consulting or speaking fees to the wife of Brazil’s Defense Minister. A “quid pro quo” does not have to be proven. Apparently, it is OK for a foreign entity to bribe a US official. Or at least, no one is seriously discussing it.

Well-informed voters: To understand current events requires a knowledge of history, geology, politics, science, ethics, and so on. That combination is quite rare. The ideal is that the most intelligent and educated should be put in positions of influence

The Women of Fox: Fox news is supposed to keep us informed, but their reporters hardly qualify. Their dress code is interesting: no exposed cleavage at all, but the women are expected to show a lot of thigh. Must

be good for ratings.

Cuckoo conservatives on Glenn Beck. I caught a few minutes of Beck interviewing someone last week. The poor fellow was frantic, accusing Trump of being a dictator and inviting assassination attempts. No wonder educated people regard conservatives as nearly insane.

Identity politics: Although politicians pander to various demographic groups, there is little doubt about the results. Racial and ethnic groups vote as a mass, so not more than a few percentage points are actually in play. No one is discussing how Hillary will “go after” the white male vote, since she plans to win without them. Just who do they want to run this country?

The Ultimate Sacrifice: This is usually considered giving up one’s life for his country. Sometimes, however, the king must be willing to go to Hell for his people. That is the ultimate sacrifice.

Personhood: In the USA, dogs and corporations are regarded as persons, but the fetus is not.

Term limits: The Roman Consuls used to be limited to a term of one year. Term limits would solve many political problems.

Jains: The Jains in India are a fascinating phenomenon. Their spiritual leaders are very strict ascetics, but the ordinary adherents are expected to engage in material pursuits. They are, on the whole, quite successful in business and the professions, despite their minority status. They could serve as the model for disaffected Westerners, since a mass movement of any sort seems unlikely.

Guilds and Corporations: Medieval guilds were the economic foundation of the age. It was a cooperative effort between the owners and the servile class. Workers were protected with a living wage and the guilds would provide insurance to the member’s families. An apprentice could travel from place to place and be accepted everywhere. The guilds regulated competition and prices.

These developed in some places to “corporations”, one for each eco-

conomic sector. Thus, a corporation is not a private business concern as defined in the USA. Rather, it involves the cooperation of the political power, the productive class, and workers, all working within the parameters set by the spiritual authority.

No comment: Bed, bath, and beyond recently changed the name of their “votive candles” to “filled candles”.

Sins that cry out to heaven for vengeance: These are allegedly the worst sins: Murder (including abortion), sodomy, oppression of the poor, and defrauding workers of their just wages. Two for the Democrats and two for the Republicans.

Posted on 2016-05-10 by Cologero

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2016-05-11 at 17:40 said:

This was an enjoyable foray into contemporary politics, and I completely agree with your assessment of these various facets. I must confess, I once was a listener to Glenn Beck, though was always more of a Mark Levin fan. Ah, the days when that kind of politics held intense interest for me. Conservatism must die to clear the path for Reaction in the coming vacuum.

On an unrelated note, thanks for linking to my essay on Evola’s racial theory. I hope I didn’t make any glaring errors.

Cologero on 2016-05-15 at 07:45 said:

@Mark Citadel, at a time when disparate voices are all claiming to be the “true conservative”, it is opportune to re-establish its meaning. To be intellectually vigorous and consistent, it can only mean following these two streams of thought:

- Edmund Burke, in the English speaking world.
- Joseph de Maistre, on the continent

By this standard, we are all liberals.

21.II Independence Day

Man is neither the slave of his race nor his language, neither of his religion nor of the course of rivers, not yet of the direction of mountain ranges. A great aggregation of men, healthy in mind and warm in heart, creates that moral consciousness that we call a nation. As long as this moral consciousness proves its strength by the sacrifices that are required by the abdication of the individual to the benefit of a community, it is legitimate and has the right to exist.

ERNEST RENAN, *What is a Nation* (1882)

The Liberal State Renan expresses the liberal position of the 19th century: a nation is the result of Will, not Destiny (natural or familial relationships), certainly not Providence (divine sanction). Every July 4, the USA celebrates its independence day as the first liberal state. It is to nations as Esperanto is to languages. It is instructive to compare its founding to that of traditional societies.

The **Declaration of Independence** expressed the fundamental principle that governments derive their just powers from the consent of the governed. This is the opposite of the traditional view that temporal power is derived from spiritual authority, or the consent of God or the gods. This gave them remarkable stability and they typically endured for a long time. Of course, that really meant that they were really based on a transcendental principle. But the masses are fickle. As Renan explains:

We have expelled metaphysical and theological abstractions [i.e., any transcendent principle] from politics. What remains after this? There remains man, his desires and his needs.

A man's desire is insatiable and his needs vary with circumstances; hence the liberal state will always be subject to such vagaries. Since desires

are infinite and resources finite, the liberal state will always experience internal conflicts and its primary task is to arbitrate competing interests. As long as resources are sufficient, stability can be maintained.

Nevertheless, stability is not stasis and power blocs will always try to grab more. This is actually enshrined in the Declaration: In response to a “long train of abuses and usurpations”, the *governed have the right and duty to throw off such government*. That is why political discourse is so often framed in terms of abuses and injustices; that justifies all attempts to radically alter the mores and laws of the country. Pathetic appeals by so-called conservatives to the “original intent” of the Constitution, therefore, are quite beside the point.

The other useless tactic of conservatives is to argue in terms of transcendent principles, which are irrelevant in a system whose only criteria are the passing whims of the governed. If everyone is equal, then there is no hierarchy. If there is no hierarchy, there is denial of divine order. That is why revolutions are always atheistic, both the French and the Bolshevik. The masses profess atheism, at least materially if not formally. This is the insight of **Valentin Tomberg**.

Theocracy and Republic In his *Hermeneutic Interpretation of the Origin of the Social State of Man*, published in 1822, **Fabre d'Olivet** provides a panoramic history of the human race, not in terms of facts, but in terms of the inner forces behind the events. Greece and Rome were theocracies under the reign of a priest-king before they became republics as we pointed out.¹⁵ Yet, they still retained the idea of divine sanction. Plato said in the *Laws* that it was necessary to consult first the oracle of Delphi. All of the republics of ancient Greece invoked the Divinity at their inception. Rome had a sovereign pontiff (chief priest), although his influence gradually waned. Fabre makes some interesting points about the USA, less than 50 years after its Constitution.

¹⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2554>

The USA were “the fruits of a political schism whose principal aim has been to destroy sacerdotal authority. No sovereign pontiff exists in the United States and cannot exist there.” He then makes a telling point that nearly 200 years later, conservatives still have not grasped:

By quite a strange inversion, it is possible in this republic that all the citizens are religious without the government having the least religion; that they are all pious, even devout, virtuous, scrupulously upright, without the government having the least piety, the least devotion, the least virtue, the least probity. For the government is a purely political being which adopts the sentiments of none of its members, and which above all in point of religion, affects an absolute indifference.

Now, as this government has above it no spiritual power to which it owes account of its conduct, and that even God does not exist for it [that is, the idea of God is never part of its political acts], although it may exist in different ways for each of its members, it follows from this that it is really without religion in its political constitution and that the law which constitutes it and which emanates from it is atheistic.

This is why conservatives are so muddle headed. They repeatedly point to the religious beliefs of the nation’s founders as though they are of significance. The state itself is atheist; as long as the governed, who give it their consent, adhere to a specific creed, no one may notice it. Hence, as the demographic makeup of the population is altered, its whims change and it gives consent to other laws. New power blocs arise each claiming abuses (injustices) and usurpations (unequal sharing of goods), which requires a continual overthrow of the government (hope and change). Conservatives claim foul, when long held moral beliefs are suddenly overthrown. Yet, that is no more than the system behaving as designed.

So it is not Christianity that leads to democracy, liberalism, socialism and egalitarianism as some political commentators of the New Right

insist, but rather the atheist state as exemplified in America, France and Soviet Union.

Posted on 2011-07-03 by Cologero

* * *

James O'Meara on 2011-07-05 at 11:09 said:

I would recommend James Kalb's *The Tyranny of Liberalism* for a quasi-Traditionalist [really, neo-Catholic] account of the phony 'tolerance' of Liberalism, especially in terms of seeking a phony "objective" balancing of mere desires.

Americans are so brainwashed by their "civics" and "history" classes [if, that is, they remember anything at all] and so ignorant of the rest of the world, that they continue to "think" that the USA is "the greatest country on Earth" and "the envy of everyone else". Why 9/11, for example? "They hate us for our freedom." I was much amused when Bin Laden himself gave the response I had given for years: "Then why didn't I attack Sweden?"

Speaking of Sweden, Americans never notice that after almost 300 years not one nation has adopted their absurd and ineffective system of "check and balances" etc. Not even when the USA imposes a constitution on them [post war Japan or Iraq, for example]. For the rest of the world, 'democracy' means parliamentary democracy, a la the superior British system, not the crude cargo-cult version cobbled together by men who, as Jefferson admitted, went into politics because there was nothing else to do in this god-forsaken wilderness.

More to your point, though: the unique features of the American system are entirely religious. Concern with "founding fathers" [Patriarchs], a constitution written [unlike England] and unlike other written constitutions not subject to more than trivial alteration by the voters [contrary to your presentation, which is more applicable to France or Sweden, say] but rather treated as a Sacred Scripture to be "interpreted" by a sanctified group of priests in black robes searching out "original intent" — what is this?

This is certainly Protestantism, and back of that, of course, Judaism, Protestantism representing the resurgence of 'primitive Christianity' against the Roman tradition.

It is interesting to note that this Protestant institution, the Supreme Court, now has not one Protestant on it, divided equally between Jews and Catholics. Jews, obviously, and as for the "Catholics," their leader, Justice Scalia's quoting the Talmud and working to found an Academy of Talmudic Law show where his loyalty lies.

Tradition, of course, is not the source of Liberalism etc. [see the Syllabus of Errors] but once the unity of Church and Empire was broken, the result was Protestantism, the secular state, Liberalism, socialism, etc., back of all of which is the 'primitive Christianity' that had been held in check by the "Roman" part of the Roman Church.

That current Liberalism seems to be increasingly “officially” atheist [Hitchens, etc.] is irrelevant. Each stage advances, leaving some behind [just as you say, new groups are added to the mix]; 18th century Protestants bemoan the “social gospel” types, they bemoan the agnostics, they bemoan the atheists, etc. Where, what’s the next stage? Only the final abyss of the Kali Yuga.

Cologero on 2011-07-07 at 07:47 said:

All good points except for: “not subject to more than trivial alteration by the voters [contrary to your presentation”

Of course, since that claim is never made in the “presentation”. But the “consent of the governed” is found in the idea of the “living constitution” rather than the fundamentalist analog of the “original intent”. So no one bothers with the “word” anymore. Over the past 60 years or so, decisions by the federal courts, sweeping and vague laws from congress, and the rule of the executive by rules and regulations of federal agencies have resulted in far from trivial changes in actual life.

21.12 Serotonin and Values

Your time is precious & fleeting ...Spend time with those who light ? up your life and enrich your existence. Make each moment count.

ANTHONY HOPKINS

One Law for the Lion & Ox is Oppression.

WILLIAM BLAKE, *The Marriage of Heaven and Hell*

To be popular, it is advisable to give people what they want, not what they need. Usually, that involves sentimentalism. Frithjof Schuon tells this story about Abd al-Qadir al-Jilani:

The saint relates a story about cats and the whole audience begins to weep from spiritual emotion.

They listened with boredom to the brilliant sermon of the great theologian.

The most important factor in the soul of the human being is not race, nor ethnicity, nor intelligence, nor psychological type. It is one's real caste. Unfortunately, in a disordered age, this may not correspond to your imputed caste in your social milieu.

It governs one's understanding of knowledge, ethics, the good life, or friendship, among others. Because of the widespread usage of social media, the differences are readily apparent, much more so than in previous times because the voices of the lower castes are now so dominant. These are not value judgments, because it would be inappropriate, if not actually impossible, for the castes to be confused.



Two Misconceptions There are two typical types of common comments, which may sound intelligent superficially, but are not:

1. Broad negative generalizations that apply to everyone indiscriminately.
2. "what we need is XXX" type of argument

Of course, the author of these types of comments seldom realizes that he is part of that generalization or that he needs XXX also. We can simplify things and reduce them to two primal principles:

1. Humans are subject to the conditions of ignorance, concupiscence, maliciousness, and weakness. Anything else is a commentary on those four.

2. Humans are “rational animals”, at least in potential, so what we “need” is to actualize that power. In particular, rationality means the ability to choose the good, which in turn requires knowledge of the good.

Instead of the Hindu names, I’ll refer to the four principal orientations as the spiritual, political, merchant, and servile types, without holding to rigid categories. The political type includes those who are attracted to administrative, legislative, judicial, and military careers. The merchant types run businesses or create things, and the servile type prefer manual labor.

As examples, I’ll illustrate how the types approach certain categories. Taking these factors into consideration will reveal much about social life and its potential conflicts. Note that there is no question of one caste being superior to another. Quite the contrary, since a member of one is satisfied with his state and has no desire to imitate another.

The Good Life Those dominated by the conditions listed in (1) experience the good life as “feeling good”

Knowledge

- **Spiritual:** knowledge is metaphysics which leads to *wisdom*.
- **Political:** knowledge is the application of metaphysical principles in the world, which develops *power*.
- **Merchant:** knowledge is practical which leads to *success*.
- **Servile:** knowledge is “how-to” which leads to *competence*.

Distinctions of people

- **Spiritual:** People are either those who know or those who believe.
- **Political:** They see the world in terms of friends and enemies.
- **Merchant:** For the merchant everyone is a potential customer.
- **Servile:** There are those who bring pleasure into their lives and those who do not.

Reading Preferences These lists are not exhaustive.

- **Spiritual:** Metaphysics, literature, poetry, science.
- **Political:** History, political theory, military history.
- **Merchant:** Biographies, motivational, financial, prospectuses.
- **Servile:** Manuals, do-it-yourself videos.

The Good Life We could continue with ethics, friendship, and more, much of which has already been covered elsewhere. The ultimate question, which determines the answers to the other categories, is what you consider to be the good life. Aristotle had his own hierarchy of needs predating Maslow: one desires:

1. To Live
2. To Live Well
3. To Live Better

Once you can survive, once you have achieved some consistency in your life, then what is your best life? Are you driven by the desire to think, to know, to understand, to serve the Good? Or do you prefer to “feel good” by increasing your serotonin levels?

As an appendix, I’ll include these thoughts by Anthony Hopkins, which many consider to be a guide for the good life. Does it help you to become wise? There is nothing about knowing, loving, or serving God.

I Need This in My Life Let go the people who are not prepared to love you. This is the hardest thing you will have to do in your life and it will also be the most important thing. Stop having hard conversations with people who don’t want change.

Stop showing up for people who have no interest in your presence. I know your instinct is to do everything to earn the appreciation of those around you, but it’s a boost that steals your time, energy, mental and physical health.

When you begin to fight for a life with joy, interest and commitment, not everyone will be ready to follow you in this place. This doesn’t mean you need to change what you are, it means you should let go of the people who aren’t ready to accompany you.

If you are excluded, insulted, forgotten or ignored by the people you give your time to, you don’t do yourself a favor by continuing to offer your energy and your life. The truth is that you are not for everyone and not everyone is for you.

That’s what makes it so special when you meet people who reciprocate love. You will know how precious you are.

The more time you spend trying to make yourself loved by someone who is unable to, the more time you waste depriving yourself of the possibility of this connection to someone else.

There are billions of people on this planet and many of them will meet with you at your level of interest and commitment.

The more you stay involved with people who use you as a pillow, a background option or a therapist for emotional healing, the longer you stay away from the community you want.

Maybe if you stop showing up, you won't be wanted. Maybe if you stop trying, the relationship will end. Maybe if you stop texting your phone will stay dark for weeks. That doesn't mean you ruined the relationship, it means the only thing holding it back was the energy that only you gave to keep it. This is not love, it's attachment. It's wanting to give a chance to those who don't deserve it. You deserve so much, there are people who should not be in your life.

The most valuable thing you have in your life is your time and energy, and both are limited. When you give your time and energy, it will define your existence.

When you realize this, you begin to understand why you are so anxious when you spend time with people, in activities, places or situations that don't suit you and shouldn't be around you, your energy is stolen.

You will begin to realize that the most important thing you can do for yourself and for everyone around you is to protect your energy more fiercely than anything else. Make your life a safe haven, in which only compatible people are allowed.

You are not responsible for saving anyone. You are not responsible for convincing them to improve. It's not your work to exist for people and give your life to them! If you feel bad, if you feel compelled, you will be the root of all your problems, fearing that they will not return the favours you have granted. It's your only obligation to realize that you are the love of your destiny and accept the love you deserve.

Decide that you deserve true friendship, commitment, true and complete love with healthy and prosperous people. Then wait and see how much everything begins to change. Don't waste time with people who are not worth it. Change will give you the love, the esteem, happiness and the protection you deserve.

Posted on 2021-09-12 by Cologero

* * *

Greg on 2021-09-15 at 10:33 said:

What does salvation and spirituality look like for the different casts. Since all casts have produced saints How does their sanctity differ?

21.13 Community of Blood vs Individualism

Rudolf Steiner delivered a lecture on 15 June 1915¹⁶ that has become relevant to world events happening in our own day. This is how he starts:

It is our desire and aim to recognize out of knowledge that the world has meaning, significance and purpose, and that the world is not filled merely with evil and degeneration. It is our aim to realize through direct knowledge that the world has meaning. By this realization we try to prepare for actual experience of the Christ.

Oswald Spengler was working on his two volume masterpiece, *The Decline of the West*, around the same time as Steiner's lectures. Both were heavily influenced by **Friedrich Nietzsche** and **Johann Wolfgang von Goethe**, and both were interested in the cycles of cultures. Despite their differences in approach and world outlook, there are certainly correspondences between the two.

Unlike Spengler, Steiner was not interested in isolated cultures like the Mexican. Rather, he recognized a continuity as the end of one culture gives birth to the next. Steiner's cultures, or ages, are then close to Spengler's, as shown below:

1. Ancient India

¹⁶https://rsarchive.org/Lectures/PreSix_index.html

2. Persian
3. Egyptian
4. Greco-Latin
5. Western Europe (and its diaspora in North America and Australia).
This is the current dominant culture.
6. To come: East Europe, Slavic/Russian

This matches up, at least in general outline, with Spengler's list of cultures. However, there is one significant difference between them. Spengler believed that the process of the birth, decline, and death of a culture was blind, unplanned, and unrelated to each other. He explains:

Mankind... has no aim, no idea, no plan, any more than the family of butterflies or orchids. 'Mankind' is a zoological expression, or an empty word. ... I see, in place of that empty figment of one linear history which can only be kept up by shutting one's eyes to the overwhelming multitude of the facts, the drama of a number of mighty Cultures, each springing with primitive strength from the soil of a mother region to which it remains firmly bound throughout its whole life-cycle; each stamping its material, its mankind, in its own image; each having its own idea, its own passions, its own life, will and feeling, its own death.

Steiner, on the other hand, saw the development of successive cultures as part of a larger process. Rather than a blind process, each successive stage was prepared by a spiritual elite. In brief, he wrote:

The centers of the mysteries were the places in which the form of external life belonging to the next epoch of culture was prepared. The mysteries were associations of human beings among whom other things were cultivated than those cultivated in the outer world.

Hence, there is an overlap during the transition from one cultural age to the next. The psychic and spiritual environment has to be prepared for souls with affinity to such environments to come to birth in each age. One thing is certain, however: those at one stage can only with difficulty understand those at another.

Characteristics

Apollonian Spengler referred to the Classical Greco-Latin culture as Apollonian. It was characterized by its preference for the local and the present moment.

This is similar to Steiner's conception. The ancient Greek identified with his city; an inhabitant of Athens saw himself as an "Athenian". Similar for the citizen of Rome. Outside of the city, there were only barbarians. Cosmopolitanism was an alien concept because, at that age, a human being was a member of a group.

Faustian Spengler believed that this Faustian culture is characterized by the unlimited search for knowledge, as exemplified by the elusive search for the "Theory of Everything". He figured that it has run its course since the goal is unachievable and predicted that it would begin its final decline right around the current time.

Steiner said that, at this age, the individual strives to grow beyond the community, that is, to be a "human being", pure and simple, transcending his local community ties. This is expressed by extreme individualism, with each man his own master. But individualism is the principle of multiplicity, so this age led to several major conflicts.

Slavic Age Both Spengler and Steiner saw a special role for Russia. Spengler predicted a new High Culture emerging from Russia, which Steiner called the Sixth Age. However, Russia is still at the Greco-Roman

stage since the Russian soul still identifies with the community. They regard this as their birthright and achievement and are therefore opposed to the extreme individualism or the West. That attitude is retrograde, if not dangerous, and its true destiny is to establish communities based on spiritual affinity rather than on blood.

World War X The war that was being fought in 1915 is analogous to the European conflict now. Then, the instigation for the war was Austria vs Russia/Slavs, representing the fifth cultural age and the fourth, respectively. (The war was triggered in Serbia—aligned with Russia—against Austria). Steiner defines the former:

A great and terrible symbol stands before the eyes of the world. Think of the two states where the war had its starting-point. On the one side, Russia with the Slavic world in general, declares that the war is based on brotherhood of blood, and on the other side, there is Austria, which comprises thirteen distinct peoples and thirteen different languages. The mobilization order in Austria had to be issued in thirteen languages because Austria encompasses thirteen racial stocks: Germans, Czechs, Poles, Ruthenians, Rumanians, Magyars, Slovaks, Serbs, Croatians, Slovenes (among whom there is a second and separate dialect), Bosnians, Dalmatians and Italians. Thirteen different racial stocks, apart from all minor differentiations, are united in Austria. Whether the implications of this are understood or not, it is obvious that Austria consists of a collection of human beings among whom community can never be based on blood relationship, for what its strange boundaries contain shoots out into thirteen different lineages.

This was opposed to the Russian soul:

The most highly composite state in Europe stands in opposition to the state that strives most intensively for life in a group soul, or

for conformity. But this striving for life in a group soul brings a great many other things in its train.

The analog to today is irresistible. Now the EU and NATO, represent the polyglot raceless state, against the Russian soul based on blood. This is confirmed by recent talks delivered both by Putin and by the Patriarch of the Russian Church. Putin believes, as he made clear, that Ukraine is still part of the Slavic community of blood. But Ukraine has been emerging from that stage as the attraction of the Faustian stage is strong.

There seems to be little possibility of any mutual understanding between the Russian ideal of the community of blood and the Western ideal of the cosmopolitanism of individuals. The West regards Putin as mad and Putin regards the West as evil. The Russian church is adamantly opposed to Western “rights” like same sex marriage and transgenderism. That baffles the West, which has no sympathy at all for the Patriarch’s worldview.

Common Task To remain at the community of blood, while a necessary stage at the time, is no longer appropriate. Individualism leads to atomism, thereby inhibiting common action unless imposed by the forces of ideology. It has no explanation for the origins or eradication of evil; neither new government programs, nor alterations to the social structure have been adequate. Evil persists and unhappiness endures in the West.

The Common Task inaugurated by Nikolai Fyodorov, is a start. Intentional communities of spirit will replace dying cultural relics. The Christian world has yet to fully understand the process of the streams of thought inaugurated by Vladimir Solovyov and continued by Sergei Bulgakov and Nikolai Berdyaev.

Then there is the esoteric current in the Slavic soul that has been brought into the daylight by Valentin Tomberg. He recapitulates ideas

from G. O. Mebes, Nina Roudnikova, and Vladimir Schmakov, which have only recently been published in English.

Steiner's view is decidedly Eurocentric. Although it recognizes the contribution of the Vedas to the esoteric tradition, he leaves out the contributions of the Islamic World, or Magian in Spengler's understanding. For this, we need to rely on the works of Rene Guenon.

Part 2, on Evil in the World, will appear tomorrow.

Posted on 2022-03-12 by Cologero

* * *

Imperius on 2022-03-13 at 00:12 said:

Russia is itself a multiracial empire, though. And much of the country is against the invasion, already converged by Western capitalism, not crying out for national identity.

Truly, at this point Putin will be lucky if he is not assassinated, all the collapse in trade.

And by the way, northern Russian cities are more cosmopolitan than Ukraine. Putin is really just a pragmatist, not some avatar.

Cologero on 2022-03-13 at 09:30 said:

It's a possibility that you totally missed the point. The temperature and pressure of a gas can be measured without knowing the positions and motions of each individual atom. That is because the gas is a totality, so the differences in individual atoms turn out to be irrelevant because they average out. Moreover, the individual atoms are not even aware that they are participants in a larger process.

Granted, the cyclic view of history, like that of Spengler or Steiner, is controversial. Perhaps things just happen without purpose or meaning.

Arthur Konrad on 2022-03-13 at 11:02 said:

@ Imperius

What anybody in Russia thinks is totally unimportant, because democracy never existed in Russia other than this Potemkin democracy they orchestrate for whatever reason. Until the collapse of the Russian Empire there has never been any sort of representation in the Russian political system, even less in the Soviet Union. This tradition carried on until the present. It appears you are trying to argue that Russia would be a better place if 'much of the country' had a say in the way it is governed, and not even more degenerate than the modern West.

There is a saying 'misery loves company' which describes very well the kind of anguish the West experiences when dealing with self-confident cultures. Westerners would like you to believe that their loss of prestige and importance had something to do with noble reasons like justice, equality, etc, and not with its foolish choice to abolish all standards and concern for the future in order to enjoy the present in the mist of cannabis smoke and guitar riffs. So subconsciously, they would like everyone else to descend to their level. People like Putin, Jinping or Prince Salman will have none of that. They understand very well that the West lost its place in the world because it is weak and pathetic, and hence cannot fail to express their contempt for Western values at every opportunity. In this sense the East is 'nationalistic', however much this definition of 'nationalism', or 'statism' does not conform to one or another flexible and totally unprincipled schema for winning debates about why your enemies shouldn't exist.

Kris on 2022-03-13 at 13:07 said:

Rootless cosmopolitanism is the handmaiden of liberal plutocratic capitalism. Many Russians see through the intellectual bankruptcy and spiritual emptiness of Western liberal democracy' and rootless cosmopolitanism bus mass immigration, feminism, egalitarianism, and other evils.

Balder on 2022-03-14 at 05:56 said:

This seems most close to an elaboration of current events that I hope for some time ago. Very good!

I'm not an expert either with Spengler or Steiner but I guess they both had some insights although Steiner seemed to elevate rootless individualism. Spengler seemed to be a fatalist; can't really blame him for that.

I can't support Putin in any way in his offensive, but while many if not most American companies (McDonald's, Coca-Cola etc.) are leaving the country, western "values" are downgraded and traditionalist Orthodoxy seems to be venerated (still considering conversion), I think I'd like living in Russia in the near future. Perhaps I'd have the fate of a useful idiot there still because of a wrong nationality.

Greg on 2022-03-14 at 13:07 said:

Fyodorovich and his common task of resurrecting the dead and colonizing the world through science and Christianity sounds more in line with the transhumanism of the WEF than Tradition. What am I missing? My first impulse us that you were joking.

Balrog Booger on 2022-03-14 at 13:46 said:

For anyone with about 45 minutes to spare, this talk by Branko Malic, the Croatia proprietor of the Tradition-adjacent blog *Kali Tribune*, is interesting. I'm a typical American who is

totally ignorant about many aspects of Eastern European history, and his explanation of Russia's tripartite sense of being the *Third Rome* is something I have never been exposed to before. If his view has any truth to it, it explains quite well the cultural impetus that could lead Russia to be the next dominant world power.

<http://en.kalitribune.com/arrivederci-third-rome/>

Cologero on 2022-03-14 at 14:05 said:

Sort of joking, Greg, or just curious to see if anyone would notice. My primary source is "The Russian Cosmists" by George Young although I've read extracts from Fyodorov's book. I don't understand his influence on thinkers I otherwise respect.

A good friend has been translating G. O. Mebes, Nina Roudnikova, and Vladimir Schmakov. When the Schmakov book is ready, I told here I would do a composite review.

Max on 2022-03-14 at 14:35 said:

The Slavic world grows to despise Russian actions more for every day that passes. They are currently at the forefront of establishing intentional communities of spirit, precisely by rejecting the retrograde Russian culture, as expressed here. Soon there might be nobody left who would voluntarily want to be part of it. Those who nevertheless still do, should be sent on their way. That is how intentional community is formed in practice. Back in the days, there were even people who left for the soviet union, and reportedly had a great time there.

Individualism is said to have "no explanation for the origins or eradication of evil". That is not correct, for it sees evil as being in each individual man. The "community of blood" on the other hand, tends to engage in genocidal wars when it somehow feels wronged.

As to capability for collective action, the last chapter has not been written yet, although the initial inertia of atomistic indecision was definitely overcome. It is noteworthy that Western Slavic nations have taken up leadership roles, as they should. They should know more than any of what is at stake.

Adil on 2022-03-14 at 15:42 said:

We are returning to the bi-partisan world of the Cold War between communism and capitalism, but this time the dichotomy is more real – that between liberalism and tradition. The Cold War was just a pretext to a deeper more metaphysical rift. It is interesting that Russia now has both Orthodox and Muslims fighting on the same side against the West.

Logres on 2022-03-19 at 10:28 said:

An interesting twist of history would be that, should the West prove too incompetent and corrupt on a vast scale, Russia could actually triumph and humiliate the Faustian order. This would give temporary validation to the old ethnic impulses and further complicate matters

(similar to how America humiliated Britain in the colonial era). It's by no means clear that they won't succeed in doing so, since our purblind choices here have made that more of a possibility. There is lots of potential to re-arrange historical Karma. Russia asserted a limit. Thank you, a yeoman like essay. Very Sun-Tzu and also, percipient.

Caste	Science	
Spiritual Authority	Theology	Cosmic and Natural Law
Temporal Power	Political Science	Laws of Power. Ideal: Justice Deformation: Lust for power
Productive Class	Economics	Laws of Economic Activity Ideal: prosperity and fairness Deformation: greed
Servile Labor	Sociology	Laws of Social Behavior Ideal: the higher castes provide the means of salvation, security, and prosperity to the people. Deformation: Excessive sensation in the forms of unrestrained sex, drugs, and entertainment.

Table 21.2: Science for the castes